Shadow Weaver... and there are some other princesses... somewhere there's She-Ra as well

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/37205671.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Categories:
F/F, Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Castaspella/Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

Characters:
Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Micah (She-Ra), Original Characters, Hordak (She-Ra), Norwyn (She-Ra), Spell of Obtainment/Entity, Horde Prime (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Canon Divergence, For the Love of Shadow Weaver Collection (She-Ra), Getting to Know Each Other, Eventual Romance, Tags Are Hard, I'm Bad At Tagging, I need help, plz, Hurt/Comfort, Emotional Hurt/Comfort, i don't know what i'm doing anymore, Canon-Typical Violence, Shadow Weaver Can't Catch a Break, Canon Relationships, Good Parent Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Character Death

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English

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Part 1 of Shadow Weaver... and there are some other princesses... somewhere there's She-Ra as well

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by MutsisPP

Summary

Spell of Obtainment was a huge mistake, it infected Light Spinner with a magical parasite that would enhance the sorceress magical power immensely, at the cost of her life.

She would crave for power and for the sake of herself and everyone else, Light Spinner went to excile. (And she did kill some other sorcerers while under the influence of the parasite.)

Now she lived in the heart of Whipsering Woods, shutting herself from the world. Light Spinner took on a new name, befitting her new situation, "Shadow Weaver."

She came across something that she would have never expected. A magicat child, named Catra. This child would change Shadow Weaver's life, for better or worse.

Because, at the end.. every action has a concequence and price to be paid.

So if you like badly written SW and Catra focused fanfic, this is it. Hop in and buckle up!

Notes

So this story will be a lot different than the shows story. First chapter will be prologue and after I get my sht together, I'll start to craft the story.

So not many tags here, yet.. I will be adding more tags as time goes on.

First, Shadow Weaver will be good mother to Catra and quite different from the Shadow Weaver we know in the show, however she will still have her darker tendencies.

Second, Im making change to the Spell of Obtainment... a nice twist to it and I hope you will like it.

Prologue

Late in the evening at Mystacor, inside Norwyn's office. Light Spinner and head sorcerer Norwyn are arguing about what to do with the Horde.

"We can't just sit here and watch while Horde conquers Etheria!'

"Light Spinner, I know you are passionate about this, because you lost your home to the Horde. But we must let the princesses do it." Norwyn said and tried to calm this fiery sorcerer.

'Norwyn, if we don't do anything. We might lose the whole Etheria!" Light Spinner yelled. "I have studied ancient magic and I'm sure it will work."

"If you are referring to the Spell of Obtainment, I have to stop you right here. It's way too dangerous!" Norwyn said, raising his voice. "It could and probably will kill the caster."

"But I've found a way to make it safe! Can't I ever get any credit?"

Norwyn sighed deeply. "Light Spinner, I know you have valuable knowledge about Etheria and its vast history of magic, but I beg you to stop pursuing this spell. It will ruin everything you hold dear."

"But if I have modified the spell to make it harmless, why can't you ever think outside of the box?" Light Spinner said a slightly calmer tone.

"Because there was an incident before. Young and talented sorcerer, wanting to gain power. Led her to the path of destruction and then she vanished. Never to be found again." Norwyn said with calm voice. "I'm never going to forgive myself for that mistake, that is why I don't want you to do it."

Light Spinner sighed deeply and nodded. "Okay, I promise, I won't cast that spell. It might be too hard, even for me."

Norwyn chuckled. "That's the Light Spinner I know. Why won't you go to sleep? It's late already."

"Fine, but can you at least consider helping in this war?" Light Spinner asked.

"I consider it, I would need the agreement of the council first." Norwyn said and smiled, he had just avoided a terrible catastrophe.

Little did Norwyn and Light Spinner know that there had been a young sorcerer eavesdropping on them.

Next day, Light Spinner was teaching the young sorcerers. Something caught Light Spinners attention. Her star pupil was nowhere to be seen.

"Have you seen Micah? I'm pretty sure he had to attend my class." Light Spinner asked her students.

"No, we haven't seen him. In fact he wasn't seen the whole night."

Light Spinner was confused, it was not normal for Micah to skip class. He was stubborn and reckless, also incredibly skilled. "Well, I'm going to find him then. You can keep a break."

Light Spinner left her students and went to find Micah. She searched from many places, but couldn't find him.

Not until she arrived at the Luminarium, where she could see Micah performing a spell. Soon she realized that Micah was performing the Spell of Obtainment.

She started to run towards Micah and yelled. "Micah! What are you doing? Stop it right now!"

"Oh, Light Spinner, I wanted to prove to you that I can handle the most difficult and hardest spells." Micah said casually.

"Micah, that spell is not what you think it is!" Light Spinner yelled. "We need to stop it before it's too late."

She then ran and started to cast a reversing spell, but it was too late. Micah was too far in casting the spell. All Light Spinner could

do is take Micah and get him out of the spell's way.

She grabbed Micah and pushed him far from her.

"Light Spinner, what are you doing?" Micah asked, puzzled.

"Saving you." Light Spinner said and tried to contain the spell once more, but it was futile.

Soon there were long black hands swirling around Light Spinner, pulling her into the center of the spell. Dozens of red eyes staring into Light Spinner's soul and devouring her into the darkness.

Micah couldn't believe what he saw. He started to panic and ran away from the Luminarium.

Soon Norwyn entered the room with other sorcerers to witness the horror.

"Light Spinner!" Norwyn yelled. "Why are you doing this?"

The dark matter had vanished and now Light Spinner was the only one left from the spell. Or what was left of her.

There stood a woman with ripped clothes, body full of scars and shattered pupils. "It worked... It worked!" Light Spinner said and started laughing maniac

"Light Spinner?" Micah asked with a shivering voice.

"It was a serious mistake to let you into the guild!" One of the sorcerers said.

"We have to stop you, whatever the cost!" Others said.

Norwyn was paralyzed from shock and fear. How could he strike his adopted daughter down, the one who he had cared for so much. History is repeating itself again.

Light Spinner was laughing. " You may try to stop me. But you are too weak for that!" And with one swipe of her hand, she just consumed the other sorcerers. Leaving only Norwyn and Micah left.

"Norwyn! Do something!" Micah yelled, covering in fear.

Light Spinner was approaching him, slowly and menacingly. Micah froze, this wasn't supposed to happen. All he wanted was to impress Light Spinner.

"I guess I have no choice..." Norwyn said heavily. "I'm sorry it had to come to this."

Norwyn readied himself to fight against Light Spinner, she turned to look at him with anger and desperation. She then lunged towards Norwyn and they started to fight.

Light Spinner was clearly stronger than him, but he could not let this happen again. Their duel was not even a close match, Norwyn couldn't keep up with Light Spinner. Spell of Obtainment fueled her rage and hatred towards the council of fools.

"I was never good enough! At least now I have the power to do the right thing!" She then proceeded to cast a spell that would blow the whole Mystacor in the sky high.

Before she could finish the spell she felt a tight hug. She stopped casting the spell and looked down. Mica was hugging her and crying. "Please stop it, Light Spinner! No more!"

She stopped casting the spell and sighed in deep. "Micah..."

"Please, don't do it. It was my fault... just don't do something where there's no comin back."

Light Spinner felt like she was paralyzed, she couldn't process anything anymore. Norwyn stood up and looked at Light Spinner with worry.

"Micah.. I.. I am sorry..." Light Spinner said with a shivering tone. She realized what she had done and how she probably had traumatized Micah forever. " *Consume him, get the ultimate power.* " She could hear a foul voice inside her head. " *Do it!* "

"NO! I won't!" Light Spinner yelled and pushed Micah away. "I'm sorry, for everything!" She then turned into a flaming spiral and disappeared in a blink of an eye.

Norwyn walked towards Micah and tried to comfort him, but it was useless.

Meanwhile deep in the heart of Whispering Woods. Dark spiral of flame and smoke appeared and from it formed the shape of a woman. Light Spinner stood there, watching what she had become and what she could do now. She didn't spin the light anymore, even if she wanted to. All there was, were shadows and foul voices inside of her head.

"I'm not Light Spinner anymore..."

" *No, you certainly aren't.* "

"Get out of my head!' Light Spinner yelled.

" *I'm afraid that's not possible, we are one and the same... Shadow Weaver.* "

"What did you call me?!"

" *Shadow Weaver... since you can't spin light, but can weave shadows...* "

"You know... for an ancient spell. You really aren't that original." Light Spinner commented. "But I guess you are right, I'm not Light Spinner anymore. I am Shadow Weaver."

" *Good... Gooooooood... Gooooooood."*

"Just shut up!"

Cat in the box

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver comes to terms with the effects of Spell of Obtainment. How will she manage her life now that inside of her is living an ancient being with a personality of an edgelord.
There is also an orphan child she has to manage, good thing this child has no magical properties.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It has been several months after the casting of ths spell and Shadow Weaver is having hard time to cope with this edgelord entity. " *You will consume the world, leaving none alive! Gaining the ultimate power!* "

"For the last time, I am not doing your bidding! I live for myself!"

" *But I am you and you are me, we are one and same.* "

"Lalalalalala, I'm not listening to you." Shadow Weaver yelled. Her struggles with the entity have been terrible. How has she not gone crazy yet, or maybe she is so crazy already that she doesn't notice it.

"You know, you could help me a little. Like maybe helping me to find at least a place to live."

" *Do it yourself, you have the power.* "

Shadow Weaver sighed. "Ugh! Fine, I'll do it by myself."

She looked at the great tree growing from the ground. "That's where I'm going to make my house."

" *Of all the places you could have done it, you decide to make a treehouse?* "

"I have to keep low profile while I'm trying to find a way to get you out of my head."

" *What part of you and I are the same you can't understand?* "

"Oh I understand it well, but unlike you I am actually intelligent. You are just a power hungry edgelord."

" *Edgelord? Sounds cool. Now I'm going to dig into your brains and read your mind like open book.* "

"Wait, you can't just dig into my brain, it's mine."

" *Ours.* "

"Whatever... why even bother." Shadow Weaver sighed and started to transform the tree into a nice house.

After finishing her house she moved in and started to live there. Her constant clashes with the Spell of Obtainment inside her head caused the certain parts of the manifest with dark aura.

Months in and rumors started to spread, it was rumored that a rogue witch was living there and cursing everyone who crossed her path.

Shadow Weaver tried to live peacefully, but Spell of Obtainment made it really difficult.

"Can't you just shut up, for one day.. please!" Shadow Weaver yelled.

" *I need to entertain myself in some way, since you ain't doing what I want.* "

"I told you, I will try to find alternate methods to get you fed." Shadow Weaver told with an annoyed tone.

" *Fine, I'll accept your offer then and will be quiet.* "

"Thank you." Shadow Weaver replied. She could feel her mind at ease when the Spell of Obtainment crawled somewhere deep inside of her.

It's been many months since her incident at the Mystacor and she felt responsible for what had happened there. She never should have brought up the spell. And she never expected Micah to actually try to cast it.

But she was the one who had told Micah that he was the most powerful and nothing would have been a problem for him. "I really screwed up... it's because of my own projection."

" *Yeah, you really screwed with your student there.* "

"Sush it! I didn't ask for your opinion!" Shadow Weaver told the Spell. "Weren't you supposed to leave me alone?"

" *I guess I did.* " Spell of Obtainment said and dwelled back somewhere.

Years pass and Shadow Weaver learns to control her Spell of Obtainment and to actually be calm around the entity. She won't let the entity get on her nerves and it pisses it off, but choosers can't be beggars.

Shadow Weaver still watches Micah from the shadows, or technically through the location spell. She doesn't want to have anything to do with Mystacor. All she can do is to admire Micah's skills in sorcery, it at least brings her some peace to know he got over her.

More years pass and Shadow Weaver watches through the location spell and sees as Micah becomes the king of Brightmoon after he marries Queen Angella.

"I was never expecting this, but they do make a good couple. ” She thought to herself.

"You mean power wise? They are great power wise." Spell of Obtainment tried to butt in.

"Didn't ask, didn't need your opinion, now f*ck off!"

" *You ain't no fun...”* Spell of Obtainment said and dwelled back into whatever darkness that was inside Shadow Weaver.

Shadow Weaver has seen enough Micah, through these many years she has watched over him, trying not to meddle with his business.

It's hard to let the past go, but she has no other choice. There is nothing she can offer to Micah or to anyone, nor does she want to.

At least she can be in peace, alone and away from other people.

Some time passed and now Sunset was setting down, covering the Whispering Woods into darkness. Shadow Weaver settled down on her bed, ready to get some sleep.

Before she could fall asleep, a loud noise shakes her up. It was like dozens of metallic footsteps stomping the ground. "What in the ever growing darkness was that noise." Shadow Weaver mumbled and turned to look outside of her bedroom window.

There were quite a lot of Horde soldiers walking and it seems they were carrying something with them. Shadow Weaver stood up and went downstairs.

"Ooh hoo, not on my watch!" Shadow Weaver said and put some clothes on, grabbed her staff and walked out from the door.

"Hey Horde Scum!" She yelled. "Don't you know it's rude to trespass on someone's land!"

Horde soldiers stopped and one of them turned to look at the lady who was standing behind them. "Oh I'm sorry, we don't care!"

Shadow Weaver sighed, she did despise the council of fools, but even more she despised the Horde. They were the reason why she had no home.

"Listen here you metalheads, before I start to beat the living SH*T out of you! Do you have any last words?" Shadow Weaver said with a taunting voice and raised her staff to a combat stance.

Horde soldiers just laughed at her. She was just an old hag. "And how are you going to do that?" One soldier said

"By swinging her staff and yelling like an old hag." Other soldier answered.

That's it, now Shadow Weaver was pissed, no need to show mercy or remorse. Shadow Weaver lunged herself into the crowd of soldiers and with a flick of a finger she decimated them.

One by one, she twisted their limbs, consumed them in the darkness until there was only one left. He was scared, he just saw all his fellow soldiers get decimated in a matter of seconds.

"What on the Beast Island are you?" He asked with a trembling voice, body shaking and probably piss in the pants.

"I am the darkness that shall consume this world!" Shadow Weaver said with an echoing and hollow voice, growing herself up in scale.

With a swift flick of a wrist, the last one of the Horde soldiers was gone.

Shadow Weaver returned back to her normal size and sighed in deep.

"What in the ever growing darkness was that?!"

"What is ever growing what, what" Spell of Obtainment asked.

"About the darkness and consumption of this world?"

" *Oh that, it just sounded cool.* "

"Ugh, whatever. There's no point arguing with you." Shadow Weaver said, she then turned to look at the cardboard box on the ground.

"Hmmm, what's this?" She said to herself and walked towards the box and kneeled. She peeked inside and found out it was a baby. Magicat baby no less.

"Are they now resorting to kidnapping children? Horde really is the scum of the world." She said, but her rambling was interrupted by the crying of the baby.

"Oh dear, what am I gonna do with you? I've never taken care of a baby before." She turned to look at the baby and tried to calm her down.

"There, there... umm... Sleep well.... dream about daisies..." Shadow Weaver tried to sing a lullaby, but she's really terrible at these kinds of things.

Lucky for her it worked, her terrible lullaby actually worked. Shadow Weaver sighed in relief and turned to look at the baby.

Noticing that she had a tag on her neck, Shadow Weaver decided to grab it carefully. It was a name tag and it read Catra.

"Catra, is it?" Shadow Weaver asked and pat Catra's head. "I don't sense any magic, so I guess it's safe to keep her. I won't let those Horde scums to hurt her."

She then took the baby with her and made her temporary cradle. "Sweet dreams... uhh... I guess..." Shadow Weaver said and went to be herself.

Chapter End Notes

> The cat has arrived.
> I also added more to this chapter since I realized otherwise I would have screwed over the timeline.

Being mom is an headache

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver takes care of baby Catra, but it seems her new found child will be quite a trouble maker.

Chapter Notes

> Ive got this far... few more chapters and I can maybe start adding more tags.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Shadow Weaver barely fell asleep, before she was woken up by loud crying. First she tried to ignore it, but she couldn't. So she stood up from her bed and went to see Catra.

"What's the matter Catra?" Shadow Weaver asked, byt couldn't get an answer. She sat next to Catra and tried to calm her. She hummed old songs from her childhood. Same song her mom used to sing to her when she couldn't sleep.

It seemed to have worked, Catra was now quiet and seemingly sleeping. Shadow Weaver stood up and right when she was about to step out from the room, crying continued.

Shadow Weaver sighed and decided to pick Catra up on her arms. "Shhhh, it will be alright. Just close your eyes and relax... I'm right here."

Shadow Weaver decided to bring Catra to her bedroom. She laid Catra onto her bed and noticed she was calm.

So Shadow Weaver went to sleep as well and now Catra didn't cry or yell. Now they both could sleep tight.

Next morning Shadow Weaver did not wake up into the sun shining through the window, but something on chest. She could feel something sting through the blanket. Opening her eyes she saw Catra sitting on her chest clearly wanting something.

"Hungry." Was all Catra said.

Of course she was, she hadn't probably eaten much before. "I'll do something for you, but let me sleep a few more minutes." Shadow Weaver said and closed her eyes.

She soon felt something grabbing her messy and tangled hair. It hurt quite a lot. "Owww..."

She opened her eyes and saw a tail swinging before her eyes. "Catra? Get out of my hair."

"Not until I get food." Catra answered, crawling deeper into Shadow Weaver's hair.

"Ugh, fine. Have it your way." Shadow Weaver said and pulled Catra out of her hair and lowered her on the floor. "I'll go do some breakfast then."

She stood up and left the bedroom and headed towards the kitchen, Catra following behind her.

"Just sit down on the chair and wait." Shadow Weaver said. "What would you prefer?"

Catra jumped on the kitchen table and tilted her head. "What would I prefer...?"

"Yes, so I can prepare it for you. I rarely eat anything myself." Shadow Weaver answered.

"No... there's nothing coming in my mind."

Shadow Weaver sighed. "Fine, I'll just make some toast and tea." She then proceeds to make breakfast. It doesn't take her any longer than five minutes. She places toasts on the plates and turns back to the kitchen table, she notices that Catra is nowhere to be seen. "Catra? I made the breakfast."

She then places the plates on the table and goes look for Catra. "Catra, breakfast is ready!" No answer, but then Shadow Weaver hears something crunching. She doesn't have any things that crunch, other than her flowers. "Oh no!" She soon realized that Catra had gone to eat her flowers.

Running towards her greenhouse she sees Catra eating her herbs. "Catra, don't eat them! They are magical herbs that are not meant to be eaten!" She ran to Catra and yanked the herbs off from her.

"Gimme back!" Catra yelled.

"No! They are not edible!" Shadow Weaver yelled back.

Soon Catra went silent and started to shake, this took Shadow Weaver by surprise, these has to be side effects.

Catra started jumping around and running like a hurricane and soon Shadow Weaver's whole house was rocking.

"Catra!" Shadow Weaver yelled as Catra jumped on top of her chandelier. "Get down!"

"Make me!" Catra yelled.

"Catra! You can hurt yourself if you are not careful!"

Catra then jumped off from the chandelier to nearby carpets, her nails ripping through the fabric.

Shadow Weaver was pulling her hair, those fabrics were not easily available. She realized that she can't do anything to change Catra's mind, maybe that's just the nature of cats.

" *Maybe I should get book about cats..."* She thought to herself. As soon she turned her back towards Catra she heard a thumb.

Looks like Catra had fallen from the curtains and was now lying down on the floor, still twitching.

"Oh dear, I better make some medicine." Shadow Weaver thought and picked up the little furball from the floor. She carried Catra to her bedroom and placed her on the bed and went to make medicine.

It didn't take long to Shadow Weaver make some medicine, after all she had also specialized with herbalism. She made some herbal tea and went back to the bedroom.

She then raised Catra and soldered her with the tea. It didn't take much to get Catra up and coughing. "Yuck! What is this bitter and sour liquid!"

"It's herbal tea, it's supposed to help you." Shadow Weaver said gently. "You fainted and I had to do something. Maybe next time don't eat plants that you don't know of."

"But they smelled so good." Catra reasoned.

"Still, don't go eat them, unless you want more herbal tea." Shadow Weaver said while bringing the tea closer to Catra.

"Yuck, no way! Never!" Catra yelled and pushed the tea away.

"Then we have an accord about the herbs?" Shadow Weaver said, raising an eyebrow.

"Fine... I won't eat any of you plants." Catra started with a sad tone.

"Don't worry, we can still go eat breakfast, I bet you are still quite hungry."

"Yes I am." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver smiled and raised Catra in her arms. "Good." She said and carried Catra downstairs.

They headed back to the kitchen and had an actual breakfast this time.

Author here, this has nothing to do with the story. But here is my quick concept art of SW and Catra.

This is how I've imagined SW wears clothes, since she ain't in the Horde.





Chapter End Notes

Finally finished 3rd chapter, I wanna say there will be time skips because I'm not writing 10 chapters of Catra driving Shadow Weaver mad."

Also my main language is finnish, so my english is not perfect and I've had to use translator to get something written right.

And this is just something that has been in my mind for an long time, I want to make it, but its not even near to proffesional writing, nor am I wanting to achieve that. I do this just for funsies.

Never disturb the garden lady

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver hates if someone meddles with her gardening, she despises Horde.. and these Horde soldiers sure do know how to meddle with her gardening.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Shadow Weaver was enjoying her day gardening outside of her house while Catra was sleeping inside. She finally got some rest, Catra has been quite a trouble maker. Shadow Weaver couldn't leave her house for ten minutes because of Catra. She would scratch the front door or even worse, she could rip her curtains or bring down the chandelier. These thoughts are really unpleasant, as unpleasant as having this crazy entity inside of you.

Suddenly a loud rumbling could be heard, ground started to shake and Shadow Weaver lost her balance. She could also hear loud screeching inside of her house.

"Catra!" Shadow Weaver yelled and tried to gather herself up from the ground. She stumbled towards her house and when she got inside she saw Catra hanging on the chandelier again. "Catra, get down! It's not safe up there."

"Catch me!" Catra yelled and jumped towards Shadow Weaver.

Shadow Weaver tried her best to catch Catra, but it was in vain. Catra plumped down on her face and soon they both were lying on the ground.

Soon the rumbling stopped and it was really quiet, almost too quiet. Something must be going on. Shadow Weaver opened her

eyes only to see the furball on her face.

"Catra, can you get off of my face?" She asked, her voice muffled, no answer. "I have to do everything myself then."

Shadow Weaver pushed Catra aside, now she could see her whole house was tumbled from floor to ceiling.

" *You could be a little more careful, You got a bruise in your nose and now I have to heal it.* "

"This is a team effort, it's the least you can do."

" *There really is no end to your demands.* "

"You took over my body, you should have thought twice before possessing me."

" *That young boy would have been a perfect vessel, with so much power in such a small body.* "

"Keep your tentacles out of him! On the other hand, it was good you possessed me."

Shadow Weaver turned to look at Catra who was presumably unconscious. "Catra?" She asked and shook her body.

"Hrmmrm... What?" Catra answered with an annoyed tone.

"Good, you are fine it seems." Shadow Weaver said and stroke Catra's hair.

"What was that earlier?" She asked.

"I'm not sure, I need to find out what it was." Shadow Weaver said calmly.

"Are you going to leave me alone?" Catra asked with a worried tone.

"No, I'm going to use a method that's more convenient." Shadow Weaver said, calming Catra. "Now let's get up."

They got up and looked around, the room was still a horrible mess.

Some time had passed and Shadow Weaver's house was not such a mess anymore. She and Catra had cleaned it up, so it would look a bit bearable. Shadow Weaver was standing next to some sort of vase, or that's what it looked like to Catra.

"What is that and what are you gonna do with it?" Catra asked.

"It's something that helps me see what's going on out there." Shadow Weaver answered.

"How can you see through a vase full of water?" Catra asked even more confused. Shadow Weaver turned to look at Catra and leaned down. "That's where the magic comes in."

"I wanna see."

"You will, but step back. I'm not letting you get near that vase while I cast the spell." Shadow Weaver said and took some powder from her pockets.

Shadow Weaver rubbed the powder in her palms and poured it into water. She closed her eyes and concentrated her mind into

things she wanted to see. What was that thing that caused the rumbling and where did it come from?

Soon the water started to spiral and formed almost something that looked like a mirror or window.

"Wooooooow. It's like a window." Catra said in awe.

"It's a location spell and yes, it basically works like a window." Shadow Weaver answered. "Come here and look."

Catra was too small and couldn't reach there, so Shadow Weaver had to pick her up.

"It's the Horde, they are trying to break through the forest with their machines." Shadow Weaver explained.

"But why through here? What could they want from this forest?" Catra asked.

"I'm not sure, but it might have something to do with Brightmoon." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Brightmoon?" Catra asked.

Shadow Weaver sighed in deep and let Catra gently down. "I'll tell you later. First we need to get these machines out of here."

"How are we going to do that?"

"With magic of course, I was not the best sorceress for nothing." Shadow Weaver said almost boastingly.

"You were a sorceress?" Catra asked.

"Ugh, I'll explain later in full detail. Now I'm sorry, but I must go." Shadow Weaver said.

"But you promised me that you wouldn't leave me." Catra said sobbingly and tears started to stream down her cheeks. Shadow Weaver of course noticed this and kneeled down, she gently

wiped the tears from Catra’s cheeks and said with a calm tone. "Don't cry, I won't be long. I'll promise you, I'll be back in 5 minutes."

"Promise?" Catra asked, still sobbing, but not crying anymore.

"It's a promise." Shadow Weaver said and let out a gentle smile. And so Shadow Weaver vanished in the air as a cloud of darkness.

At the edge of Whispering Woods, a large group of Horde soldiers have gathered around heavy machines. These machines' purpose is to rip the trees from the ground and make way through the woods.

There's one big disadvantage with these large machines, they require a lot of energy and are stored in large tanks that need to be transported.

" *Quite and sight, but seems pretty impractical.* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself as she watched from the shadows. She lets out a sight and takes a deep breath. " *Okay, Spell of Obtainment. You're up.* "

" *Ugh, Fine! But I need a meal after this.* " Entity told.

"What do you think about them?" Shadow Weaver asked and pointed towards Horde soldiers and machines.

" *Hmmmm, I guess that'll do."* Entity said and let Shadow Weaver take control of the dark magic.

Shadow Weaver revealed her presence and approached the Horde soldiers. They could feel a terrible presence that suddenly took over the area.

"What is that!?" One of the Horde soldiers yelled.

"I have no idea! Others yelled.

Horde soldiers aimed their tanks and weapons towards this approaching shadow that had the form of a woman.

"OPEN FIRE!" The Horde commander yelled.

Tanks started to fire and fierce barrage commenced. It's just a shame it had no effect. Shadow Weaver released hordes of shadows that consumed any tank or machine in the vicinity.

There was panic upon Horde soldiers and they started to run away. Shadow Weaver could hear their desperate screams of fear and cower.

" **You think you can escape?"** Shadow Weaver yelled with a deep and hollow voice. " **All of you will be consumed and there will be no hope for you!** "

"Please spare me! I beg you!" One of the Horde soldiers yelled, covered in fear. Shadow Weaver didn't heed his call for mercy and consumed him.

Soon the screams faded and there was no sign of troops, machines or tanks. All of them had just vanished.

Shadow Weaver returned back to her normal form and started to cough dark goo. She could feel herself weakened and soon she will probably faint.

"No, not yet, I have to return home. I promised to." Shadow Weaver said to herself and teleported back to the front yard of her house. As she arrived she could see Catra waiting outside.

"Shadow Weaver! You're back!" Catra yelled and ran to hug her.

"I told you, it was a promise." Shadow Weaver said, smiling with a tired tone. "I think I overestimated myself, I need to get to bed."

Catra nodded and followed Shadow Weaver to her bedroom. Shadow Weaver fell asleep as soon as she got to her bed. Catra jumped on the bed as well and went to sleep next to her legs. Day turned into evening and evening into night.

The next morning, Shadow Weaver woke up with a terrible headache and she felt like she had been squeezed like a lemon. She noticed Catra still sleeping next to her. She decided to not wake her up. She could make breakfast before Catra wakes up. She went downstairs and into the kitchen, she was in dire need of a strong ginger tea.

While she was making breakfast, she could hear footsteps from the staircase. Catra had woken up and was following the scent of the food.

"Good morning Catra." Shadow Weaver said and took a sip from her tea.

"Morning," Catra said, yawning.

Shadow Weaver served Catra her breakfast. "Do you want tea or hot chocolate with it?"

"Tea, your tea is great." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver went to get her a mug of tea with milk and sugar. "Here you go." Shadow Weaver said and handed the mug to Catra.

They enjoyed a quiet morning in silence, Catra still remembered Shadow Weaver talking about being a sorceress and was quite intrigued about that."I remember you told me yesterday that you were a sorceress, you promised to tell me about it."

"Oh that, can it wait? I still feel hazy from yesterday." Shadow Weaver answered. "Let me recover first, I'll tell you later today. Okay?"

"Okay, it's a promise." Catra said and made a smug face, knowing that if she made it a promise Shadow Weaver had to oblige.

Shadow Weaver sighed in deep, she knew she had no choice. Catra sure is a sharp child. "It's a promise."

" *She will become quite a cunning fella if this continues on.* "

Chapter End Notes

Well that's 4th chapter. Quite an bumpy ride.

Explanations and an Blast from the Past

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver gets a visitor, a real blast from the past.
Someone she wouldn't have never expected to see.
Can you guess who the visitor is?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Time passes and Shadow Weaver told Catra about her past, such was the promise she had made. They sat on the couch in the living room, Catra sitting on Shadow Weaver's lap.

"So, I used to be a sorceress at Mystacor, great one mind I add." Shadow Weaver told. "I had practiced and gathered knowledge my whole life. Yet I was never understood or taken seriously."

Shadow Weaver took a long pause before she would continue, it was pretty painful to remember her past life.

Flashback

At the high council of Mystacor, a young sorceress has arrived. Her name was, Light Spinner. She was skilled in magic and knowledgeable, yet ambitious.

"Light Spinner, you are on this council of sorceress, but we do not grant you the rank of high-sorceress." Norwyn said.

"What?" Light Spinner asked. She looked at Norwyn and other high-sorceresses. They had dismissive looks.

"How can you decide something like this? This is outrageous, it's unfair. How can you be on the council and not be the

high-sorceress."

"Take a seat, young Light Spinner." Norwyn said. "You are full of emotions, before we can decide anything. You must learn to control your emotions."

Light Spinner nodded. "I'm sorry, Head Sorceress Norwyn." She then bowed before them and left the council room.

" *One day... I'll show you all."*

Shadow Weaver told her story in great detail, all the way from the beginning to the end. To the day she cast that damn spell. At least an hour passed before she had finished her story, Catra had fallen asleep. It was expected, after all she is still a child and it had gotten pretty late. Shadow Weaver then picked Catra up and carried her to her bedroom. She laid Catra onto bed and whispered into her ear "Good night." and left the room.

Shadow Weaver went to the kitchen and was about to make some tea for herself, but she was interrupted by knocking on the door. " *Who could it be?* " She thought to herself and went to open the door.

As she opened the door she saw someone who she never thought to see again. "Micah?..."

"Light Spinner?" Micah asked and he was as shocked as Shadow Weaver.

Shadow Weaver slams the door on his face. "Light Spinner? Is that really you?" Micah yelled.

"Go away!" Shadow Weaver yelled. "I'm not Light Spinner anymore! Leave before it's too late."

"Too late before what? Light- Shadow Weaver, too late for what?"

Shadow Weaver could feel her guilt rise up, she thought she had gotten over Micah already. She could feel the Spell of Obtainment grow stronger since Micah literally radiates magic.

"Shadow Weaver?" Micah asked and knocked on the door. "What happened?"

"Go away Micah, it's too late!" Shadow Weaver answered. "I can't control it for too long, so go while you still can!"

Micah then realized what it was all about. "It's the spell.. isn't it?" Micah asked, he could feel guilt rise up as well. After all, he went behind everyones back to cast the spell.

Shadow Weaver was about to burst since the entity inside her was about to overpower her willpower, but it was cut short as she felt someone hug her. She opened her eyes and saw Catra hugging her legs. Her lust for power was starting to fade as she looked over Catra.

"Are you alright?" Catra asked and looked up at Shadow Weaver' face.

"Well... I think.. yes." Shadow Weaver answered. She was quite puzzled. She felt less power hungry and more calm and she could

hear Micah once more.

"Shadow Weaver? I... I'm sorry for what you had to go through, but could you at least listen?"

Shadow Weaver took a deep breath and picked Catra up. It seemed having Catra here helped her calm the lust for power. She then opened the door and faced Micah.

"Micah... I have to say.. I... If someone ever deserved an apology.. it would be you." Shadow Weaver tried to apologize but it was quite a hard task. "How did you find me? And what do you want?"

"Well.. there was quite a huge presence of dark magic... or dark aura. So I decided to check it out in case it's something serious." Micah explained. "Also, you have a child? I never thought you were that type."

"Oh her.. she's not mine.. I just kinda took her after saving her from the Horde." Shadow Weaver said and presented Catra to Micah. "Her name is Catra?"

"Well hello there Catra, I'm Micah. Light- erm.. Shadow Weaver's ex-student." Micah said.

"Oh yeah, she told me about you. You were the most talented sorceress she had ever met." Catra said.

"Did she really?" Micah asked. "I'm honored."

"Okay, Micah, you said you were here to investigate my presence. Did you have anything else?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Well... I never thought you would be alive, but I think our rebellion could use your help." Micah said.

"There's only two problems with that." Shadow Weaver said and sighed. "One, I am a criminal in the eyes of Mystacor and second the Spell of Obtainment makes it impossible to be around with you or others strong with magic and power."

"I see.. well then I can't ask you more. But if you ever change your mind.. we are going to launch a counter attack towards the Horde soon and we could use as much of an help as possible." Micah said, slight disappointment in his voice.

"I just can't, it's too dangerous... I might not be able to control myself."

"I understand. Anyways, it's good to know you are at least somewhat okay." Micah said with a melancholy tone. He then turned away and started walking. Shadow Weaver looked as Micah's silhouette got smaller and smaller until it disappeared.

Shadow Weaver closed the door and let Catra down. "Must have been boring to listen to us talk."

"Not at all.. quite interesting, actually." Catra answered.

"I didn't know you had such properties." Shadow Weaver said.

"Like what?" Catra asked, scratching her ear.

"Well, you actually calmed me down and stopped me doing something that I would very much regret."

"I had a nightmare.. again. About my past.. and I got kinda anxious about it." Catra explained.

Shadow Weaver once more picked Catra up and held her tight in her arms. "Better?" She asked with a soft and calm voice.

"Better." Catra answered as she relaxed.

"I was about to make some tea, you want some too?"

"Sure, your tea is always great."

Chapter End Notes

Did you guess it right?

Spell backfires

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver investigates Catra's nightmares with a spell and it backfires.
Rebellion plans on decisive strike against the Horde.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra and Shadow Weaver were enjoying their tea and Shadow Weaver decided to bring up Catras' nightmare. "So, what about that nightmare of yours?" Shadow Weaver asked while sipping her tea.

"Well... it's... complicated to say at least." Catra answered, scratching her ear. "I don't know how to explain it. As much as I want to, I just can't."

"Well then we have a problem here." Shadow Weaver answered and took another sip. "But, I have a solution for that. Two actually."

Catra drank all her tea at once and looked into Shadow Weaver's eyes. "And what are those solutions then?"

Shadow Weaver smirked. "First one is that we both go to sleep and I connect our minds together. So I could investigate your dreams."

Catra felt chills in her spine and all her fur stood up. Shadow Weaver noticed this and found it quite amusing. After all Catra still is a cat.

"Don't worry, I wouldn't do it unless you let me and I assure you. I would not do it if it wasn't safe. That much I have learned." She said while still thinking back in time when the spell was casted.

Catra sighed in relief. "So, what's the second one?"

"You said your nightmare had to do something with your past, right?" Shadow Weaver acquired.

"Yes, in fact it was about my home." Catra answered.

"That's good, then all we need is a simple location spell." Shadow Weaver answered.

"How does location spell help with my nightmare?" Catra asked.

"Well it's clear your nightmare has something to do with your past and by making the location spell. We could confront it head on." Shadow Weaver explained.

"I don't follow, but let's try that location spell." Catra said.

"Okay then." Shadow Weaver said and left the kitchen.

Catra followed her and saw her preparing a vase that had water in it. Catra went to inspect it closer while Shadow Weaver was most likely looking for the magical plants.

Catra peeked in the vase and saw her reflection on the surface of the water. " *I'm not sure how this will help me exactly.* " Catra thought to herself.

Then Shadow Weaver came back with some sort of powder. "Catra, lend me your hand."

Catra lent Shadow Weaver her hand and saw that she put the powder on her hand.

"Hold it tight." Shadow Weaver said and walked to the vase. "Come here."

Catra followed her and now stood on the other side of the vase.

"So, we do this quite simple spell. Close your eyes and think about that dream of yours."

Catra closed her eyes and began to think. Shadow Weaver walked behind Catra and asked. "What do you see?"

"My home..." Catra answered.

"Good, now put the powder in the vase." Shadow Weaver said and Catra did as she was told to. Then Shadow Weaver took Catra's arm and held it. "Now I am going to draw the sigil so the spell will work. Just relax."

Catra could feel Shadow Weaver move her hand and she could feel magic flow through her arm.

"Now Catra, think hard about your home and past." Shadow Weaver said and Catra did as she was told to.

Soon the water on the vase started to reflect something. "You may open your eyes now." Shadow Weaver said.

Catra opened her eyes and saw a reflection on the vase. It was like a picture and really clear one. "Did I do that?" She asked.

"Well... I did the spell, but you were the one needed for it to work." Shadow Weaver said. "It seems it's your home and it does not look good."

Catra looked into the reflection and saw her home. It was in ruins and there were Horde flags around the ruined town. "It's the Horde..." Catra said. "Did you know about this?"

"I can't say I did, but this is what I feared for." Shadow Weaver said. "Horde kidnaps children and brainwash them into soldiers. I happened to be close by when you were being taken."

"Were you that Shadowy figure? The one that has been in my dreams as well?" Catra asked.

Shadow Weaver could feel a sting on her heart. She went pretty hard on those Horde soldiers back then. "I'm afraid, yes... I

couldn't control myself and the end results were horrifying." She answered.

"So everyone in my home is dead?" Catra asked and tears started to stream down her cheeks.

Shadow Weaver panicked, she didn't know this would backfire so hard. She rushed towards Catra and hugged her. "I'm sorry Catra, but that is most likely the case."

Catra started crying, it was very loud. Shadow Weaver had never seen Catra this sad. "Shhhh I'm here..." Shadow Weaver tried to calm Catra, but it didn't help.

" *Great job Shadow Weaver.* " Shadow Weaver could hear a voice inside of her. " *You really know how to handle children.* "

"Oh, for the First Ones sake. I Don't need you to remind me of my screw ups." Shadow Weaver said in her mind. Most important thing was to get Catra to calm down.

Catra kept crying until she couldn't anymore. Her crying changed to quiet sobbing. Shadow Weaver didn't know what to do. Catra had never cried this much.

Shadow Weaver carried Catra back to bed. She sat there a while and hymned the same song her mother had sang to her all those years ago.

She didn't keep up with the time, but it was clearly late. So she herself decided to go to sleep as well.

At the Fright Zone, throne room of Hordak.

"What do you mean everything vanished?" Hordak asked clearly with a disappointed tone.

"I don't understand it myself either." Darkith said. "I have never heard anything like that before."

"But you were well known for your knowledge of magic, that's why I took you here." Hordak said.

"My lord... I apologize for my lack of understanding and lack of skills for this screw up. I won't let it happen again." Darkith said and bowed down.

"You better not, I won't forgive you again if you mess up." Hordak said. "Understand that!"

"Of course, lord Hordak." Darkith said and left the throne room. She walked down the halls cursing her failure. " *I hate him so much...* "

She went to look for the young horde cadets. Most promising of them was Adora, who clearly possessed power on an otherworldly scale.

Next morning Shadow Weaver was first to wake up, or she thought so. As she stood up from the bed she noticed Catra was

not there. Her heart jumped to her throat and she ran downstairs to look for her. She wasn't in the house so she checked outside.

She relaxed when she saw Catra outside, but this time she wasn't eating her plants. She was clearly training.

"Morning Catra." Shadow Weaver said.

"Oh, good morning Shadow Weaver." Catra answered.

"Feeling better?"

"Yes, I thought that I can't just sit around and be pissed about it." Catra said. "So I'm training so I can kick some Horde ass!" And she proceeded to smack a wooden board so hard it split in two.

"I see." Shadow Weaver said. "Are you thinking of joining the rebellion?"

"Not yet.." Catra said and cracked another wooden board. "But maybe when I grow older."

"I've been thinking that maybe I should help Micah out."

"You are going to join in the rebellion?" Catra asked.

"No... they don't want me. I know that, but I would owe that much to Micah." Shadow Weaver said and sighed in deep.

"Well, can I come with you?" Catra asked.

"I wouldn't want to risk your life. You are still just a child."

"But now I know why I had those nightmares and what caused them. Thanks to you." Catra said and ripped wooden planks apart.

Shadow Weaver laughed nervously. "I see, well if you don't. I can't stop you. You are quite a beast."

"So when are we going?" Catra asked.

"Soon, I just need to confirm a few things." Shadow Weaver said and went back inside.

She went to the same vase and cast another location spell. She saw Micah and others in the meeting room and it seemed like they were discussing their plan.

Shadow Weaver decided that now is the time to go. She went back outside and saw Catra wrecking self made mannequins.

"Catra, we are going to Brightmoon. They are preparing to counter attack soon."

"Oh, so soon?" Catra asked.

"It seems so." Shadow Weaver answered.

Shadow Weaver drew a large sigil on the ground. "What is this?" Catra asked as she looked at the circle with different lines.

"It's a teleportation circle. It lets us teleport anywhere we want." Shadow Weaver said and finished up the last sigil.

"We are going to Brightmoon, right?"

"Yes, that's where we are going." Shadow Weaver said. Deep inside of her she felt that this was a really bad idea, but what other choice she had.

Catra clearly wants revenge and this is the only chance she has to help Micah any meaningful way.

"Okay, Catra. Take my hand and close your eyes."

"Why do I need to close my eyes?" Catra asked as she took Shadow Weaver's hand.

"You can get quite dizzy from teleportation." Shadow Weaver said. "One of the drawbacks of this spell."

"Okay." Catra said and closed her eyes. And with a blink of an eye. They were gone.

At Brightmoon, the rebellion were planning on how to execute their plan of action. It's going to be the largest assault the rebellion and Princess Alliance have ever done. It will decide the future of Etheria.

Soon everyone there felt a presence of dark magic and at the entrance of the room was engulfed by black and purple flames.

"What in the name of the First Ones!" Queen Angella was shocked.

Everyone looked at the entrance. As soon as the flames had vanished there were two people. One seemed to be an older lady and the other a young child.

"Shadow Weaver." Micah exclaimed. "You came."

Everyone was shocked, did he mean the Shadow Weaver? The one who had cast the Spell of Obtainment and killed the council members of the Mystacor.

"What is this criminal doing here?!" Angella asked, raising her voice. "Micah? Care to explain?"

"Well... I kinda asked her to help us..." Micah said.

"Her of all people?!"

"It's not as bad as it seems." Micah explained.

While Micah and Angella were arguing about Shadow Weaver. Other members didn't actually know what to do at the moment.

Shadow Weaver could see and feel the uneasiness of others. And she felt like someone had pierced her heart. If she had any that is...

She could also sense the power in the room. So many powerful beings and the Moonstone so close to grab. " *Good... I can feel your lust for power.. take it!* " Entity whispered in her mind.

Catra noticed that Shadow Weaver was about to break so she did what she had done earlier and grabbed Shadow Weaver's hand.

"Shadow Weaver." Catra said.

Shadow Weaver snapped out of her thoughts and looked at Catra. "Yes?"

"Do you feel better?" Catra asked as she hugged her.

Shadow Weaver felt her lust and anger once again vanish. She felt calm again. "Thank you Catra, I feel better." She said and picked Catra up.

"I knew this was a bad idea." Shadow Weaver said, getting everyone's attention. "Look, we can just go. It's better for everyone."

"You aren't going anywhere!" Angella ordered. Her tone was commanding and it even managed to startle Shadow Weaver.

"Guards, chain her hands and don't let her out of sight. Angella said.

Soon guards were approaching Shadow Weaver. Catra took her claws out and hissed. She was ready to shred anyone that got near to her and Shadow Weaver.

"Catra, don't resist."

"They can't just chain you. They can't just do whatever they want!" Catra argued.

Shadow Weaver sighed. "Catra, things will go better if we don't resist."

Catra looked at Shadow Weaver and nodded. She then pulled her claws in begrudgingly.

Shadow Weaver let them chain her wrists, but asked not to chain Catra, she is still a child. Guards nodded and didn't chain Catra even if she showed hostile behaviour.

"Angella, honey. Are you sure this is necessary? Micah asked.

"You or anyone else should know it." Angella said. "She was the one who got you tangled up with the Spell of Obtainment."

Shadow Weaver shrugged her head, was what the Mystacor told everyone. Not that she blamed them, how could a star pupil like Micah do something forbidden.

"Actually, Angella, it isn't that simple." Micah said. "We can discuss it later, we need all the help possible."

Angella sighed in deep, but nodded agreeing. "We shall discuss this later, for now we need to execute this plan." She said,

Everyone nodded in agreement.

" *Oh, for the sake of the First Ones! Where did I stick my nose.* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself while holding Catra tightly in her arms.

Chapter End Notes

Oh dear, what have I done.

Price of War

Chapter Summary

> The Princess Alliance and the Rebellion execute their plan and charge the Horde army. Just a pity it backfires hard.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

The Rebellion and Princess Alliance are discussing their plan of actions and how to execute it. Shadow Weaver just stands there, off to the side of the table. Just observing while holding Catra.

"Maybe this was a great idea." Catra stated.

"It's too late to change it now." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Can't you just use your magic?"

"Well my hands are tied, I can't do much."

Both of them sighed in deep. It felt odd that while others were discussing, they were just standing there. Like they were air, just floating there. Guards were standing next to them making sure they wouldn't try anything. The meeting took hours. Were they really this incompetent, seriously how has the Horde not won yet. These were the people who Norwyn thought would take care of the Horde.

It had to be because of Micah, he is so clever and strong. Without Micah they would probably run around circles like headless chickens. Shadow Weaver's frustration was glaring and Catra took notice of it.

"Everything alright?" Catra asked.

"Yes, everything is just fine. It's just that they are really incompetent." Shadow Weaver said ensuring Catra everything was fine.

Finally the meeting had concluded and everyone seemed to agree on the plan. Micah was walking towards Catra and Shadow Weaver.

"I'm sorry this wasn't this way." Micah apologized awkwardly. "My wife can sometimes be a little bit a lot, but she means well."

"I understand. It's not like we were invited here anyways." Shadow Weaver said playing it cool.

"Good, glad you understand." Micah said. "So wanna look at the plan now that everyone is gone?"

"Sure." Shadow Weaver answered. They went to look at their battle plan and Shadow Weaver could clearly see they had no idea about strategy. More like they are just winging it.

"This plan will fail miserably." Shadow Weaver stated coldly.

"Is it that bad?" Micah asked.

"Yes, mind if I change some bits. To actually make it a proper plan." Shadow Weaver said. "They wouldn't even notice it."

"Of course if I'm with you the whole time." Micah stated.

"Fine." Shadow Weaver said and proceeded to change the plan. Catra and Micah were standing there, looking as Shadow Weaver drew the lines over old ones and setting the troops to better places.

It didn't take long for her to finish it. After all, she had studied strategy as well. "What does the king say?" She asked and stepped aside.

Micah took a good look at the plan and saw Shadow Weaver had improved it greatly. "It looks better than earlier, I'm sure it will work." Micah said, confirming Shadow Weaver's superior battle planning skills.

At the Frightzone, Darkith had gathered information about the rebellion's plans through her spies. She decided to inform Hordak about it.

"Lord Hordak, may I speak with you?" Darkith asked.

Hordak let her into his throne room. "You may, but be quick." He said.

"Thank you." Darkith said and bowed. "My spies had gathered some information about the rebellion."

"Hmm.. I hope it's worth my time." Hordak stated.

"I shall be brief." Darkith answered. " It seems the rebellion is planning some sort of great attack, since many of their kingdoms have had movement. Even Kingdom Mystacor has stepped in. So it must be big."

"So they seem to think they can take me on... they are fools." Hordak said.

"Indeed they are, what shall we do? Lord Hordak?"

"Gather a large army and make sure all of the Force Captains are involved. And I want you to lead them." Hordak said.

"As you wish." Darkith said and bowed down once more. She was about to leave but Hordak stopped her.

"Do not fail." He stated.

"I won't."

At the Brightmoon everyone was ready to leave. This battle would seal the fate of Etheria, it's the only chance they have, so they have to make sure everything goes as planned.

Shadow Weaver had finally been released from her shackles and it felt so good. Finally she could properly move her wrists.

While they were at Brightmoon, Shadow Weaver saw a woman she had never seen before. She looked like she was from Mystacor.

"Micah." Shadow Weaver said.

"Yes?"

"Who is she?" Shadow Weaver said and pointed towards the black haired woman.

"She's my younger sister, Castaspella." Micah said. "And she is soon to be the new Head Sorceress of Mystacor."

"Ah, I see." Shadow Weaver said. "I assume she doesn't like me."

"Actually, she's been trying to convince other guild members that you were not fully responsible for that spell." Micah said. "After I told her how things actually were."

"Well that's rather surprising. I'll have a small chat with her." Shadow Weaver said and walked towards Castaspella.

Castaspella noticed a tall dark woman approach her, she knew well who she was. "I take it that you are the infamous Shadow Weaver." Castaspella said.

"That is indeed me." Shadow Weaver answered. "Micah told me that you are trying to convince the council about my past... or something like that."

"Yes, but with poor results." Castaspella said and sighed. "They would rather see you imprisoned and stripped away from your magic."

"I see they still are a council of fools." Shadow Weaver stated and sighed. "Anyways, Micah told me that you are going to be the new Head Sorcerer soon. I believe that you will be better than that old ram."

Castaspella laughed nervously. "We'll see."

"So, Mystacor finally decided to take action. It's quite ironic. I tried to convince them many times, but they always rejected me. But now they are willing to join."

"Lot of things have changed at Mystacor in recent years." Castaspella said proudly. "Mainly because I have pushed on reforms on many things."

"I see. That's good to hear. I'm also Mystacor finally doing something." Shadow Weaver said and put hand on Castaspella's shoulder. She looked at her and Castaspella looked back at her. Their faces turned and they quickly turned away from each other.

"That was rather awkward, I should go now." Shadow Weaver said and walked away.

Castaspella stood there and turned to look at Shadow Weaver as she walked. " *Why is she so hot?* " Castaspella thought to herself and blushed. She shakes her head. "No, I need to focus. Focus Casta, focus, focus."

As Shadow Weaver was walking she also thought to herself. " *She was way too hot.* "

"No, stop thinking that and focus on the important things." Shadow Weaver said to herself.

" *Oh, now you are starting to have romantic feelings?* Entity inside told her. " *You are a hopeless case.* "

"Didn't ask, don't need your opinion, now go dwell back to wherever you dwell." Shadow Weaver said.

" *You owe me one.* " Entity said and dwelled deep into her, somewhere.

Shadow Weaver arrived on the field where soldiers from all other kingdoms of Etheria had gathered. And then there was Micah rallying everyone and giving motivational speech.

Shadow Weaver took Catra's hand and held it tight. Catra was a bit confused. Was Shadow Weaver scared of something. "Don't worry, we'll get through it." Catra said.

Shadow Weaver let out a small chuckle. " *Imagine having a child to confront you.* " Entity told her.

"I told you, dwell back there and don't come out until I say so." Shadow Weaver told the entity.

"Okay everyone, this is our last chance! To put an end for the Horde and the war! We are doing this for Etheria!" Micah yelled. "For a better future, for better Etheria!"

" **For better Etheria!** " The army chanted and they began their march with high morale.

Everything went according to Shadow Weaver's improved battle plan. Only thing Shadow Weaver didn't account for was that the enemy had a smart if not smarter leader.

Shadow Weaver made sure Catra stayed at the backlines. No child should be in war, but Catra's need for revenge was far too great for her to stop Catra.

Shadow Weaver was surprised that the enemy had actually prepared for their attack. This means Horde had spied on the rebellion, but Shadow Weaver had no time to think about spies. She had to wreck Horde's army.

"Okay... Entity, whatever you are. Now would be a great time to help." Shadow Weaver said.

" *Oh, so now you want help, even if you owe me?* " Entity asked sarcastically.

"I've told you before, it's a team effort. You are part of me so you have to accept part of me." Shadow Weaver stated.

' *I guess so... you are the worst host I have ever had!* " Entity said.

Shadow Weaver could feel her powers enhancing, as much as the Spell of Obtainment keeps bitching about, it still bends into Shadow Weaver's will.

Shadow Weaver went ahead and scorched enemy vehicles and consumed whole battalions of Horde soldiers. And the more she did it, the more she enjoyed it.

Angella was enhancing other sorceresses and soldiers to give them upper hand against enemies and Micah was fighting Horde head on.

He was such a reckless boy, even if he is an adult he still is the same boy he was when he was still at Mystacor.

Darkith on the other hand was sweating, she had never guessed rebellion actually had this much power. Her biggest worry is Micah, he is the head of the rebellion and their beacon of hope.

"I must get rid of him, whatever it might take." Darkith said.

Seeing the Horde fail so miserably, Darkith decided to take matters into her own hands. Rebellion wasn't the only one with a strong sorceress.

She glided down on the battlefield, like a cloud of smoke and took an appearance of a tall sorceress.

"I guess I have to do everything myself!"

Angella herself had never seen someone fighting like Shadow Weaver, her fighting style is downright horrid. How can someone be like her?

Catra on the other hand has slipped through soldiers and was now fighting on the front.

Catra fought very much like a cat, but was incredibly skilled. Her agility was pretty much out of this world and her hit and run tactics work well on badly organized Horde soldiers.

Darkith was sweeping through rebellion ranks, her only goal at the moment was to remove Micah from the battlefield.

"King Micah!" She yelled. "Face me like a true king you are!"

Micah heard her yelling and turned to look at her. "Well well, isn't it Hordak's number one lapdog? Where's your big boss Hordak at?"

"You insolence! Lord Hordak is working on an important project and once he's finished it. There will be no dawn for the rebellion!"

"Big words, fine I'll face you!"

Micah and Darkith were about to start fighting. Their duel was quite intense since both of them were really skilled in magic. Darkith conjured shadowy illusions of herself to distract Micah and strike him down while he wasn't looking.

Unfortunately for her, Micah is far too clever to fall into such traps. With a quick spell he washed away the shadows and only Darkith remained. "You know, that's pretty amateurish. For an sorceress of such high class." Micah taunted.

"You think you're so clever. Then how about this!" Darkith said and proceeded to create a wall from dark fire, she then lunged towards Micah to take him down, but to no avail. Micah shattered her walls and blocked her lunge attack by creating a force field.

Micah then pushed her away from him and cast a projectile spell, aiming towards Darkith.

Darkith easily swung the projectile away. "I've had quite enough of your tricks!" Darkith stated angrily. " **By the power of darkness, I call you upon! To bring despair and destruction! For the end of it all!** " She conjured the darkness of the void towards Micah, to consume him into a bottomless abyss.

Micah was quite taken back by that spell. Its power could sweep out kingdoms from the face of the earth, but she is using it towards a single person. Micah braced for the impact but was not sure if he would survive. He closed his eyes ready to face whatever end.

He expected something to happen, but nothing happened. He opened his eyes and swa Shadow Weaver standing there. She was consuming the incoming strike with the power of the Spell of Obtainment. "Shadow Weaver?"

"Sorry I'm late." Shadow Weaver said and consumed the spell.

Darkiths eyes popped out. "Like how in the name of darkness you consumed it! What are you!?"

"I am the devourer of hope, bringer of destruction and end of all things!" Shadow Weaver started with a deep and hollow voice.

Micah and Darkith both were taken back by her presence.

"*Ugh this is really painful!* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself. "*Why did you make me say that?"*

" *Just go with it, it's your purpose after all.* " Entity told her.

After consuming the spell Shadow Weaver felt tired. She never had done anything on such a large scale. " *I hope you are happy...* " Shadow Weaver stated gritting her teeth.

"Oh, I'm very happy." Entity answered. *"So happy that you might live after this."*

Darkith was retreating, she had never witnessed anything like that. But she couldn't let Hordak down. Something must be done. Shadow Weaver obviously was a greater threat, but now she seemed weak. Maybe if she would target her, she wouldn't screw this up totally.

Shadow Weaver collapsed on the ground and coughed black blood. Micah ran on her side. "Are you alright? We need to get you away from here."

"I.. I'm.. fine. I can get myself up." Shadow Weaver said and coughed more.

Micah moved aside and let Shadow Weaver get up. But before long Micah noticed a projectile coming towards her. Shadow Weaver!" He yelled and jumped in front of her.

Shadow Weaver was puzzled about it. "Micah?" She asked and saw Micah being consumed by something that seemed like some sort of pool of black tar. Before Shadow weaver could properly react he was gone. "Micah!" Shadow Weaver yelled with a desperate voice.

"Yes, I have won!" Darkith exclaimed with a joyful voice. "Take that you filth!" But it wasn't a victory for the Horde either, almost all their troops were defeated and equipment destroyed. "I shall take my leave, we will meet again- " Before Darkith could finish her sentence she felt a hard punch on her face.

Shadow Weaver had lunged towards her and she was not using any magic at all. Only her raw strength and hatred she now had. Darkith was pinned down on the ground and by every punch Shadow Weaver looked more and more like a monster from the abyss.

"You- agh! Know- Ugh! This won't bring him ba-Argh!" Darkith said while being punched.

"Oh It will not, but you won't be back from this either!" Shadow Weaver growled and she proceeded to choke Darkith. But now it

seemed that her stamina had reached its limit. *"Chill the f*#k down! I can't keep up with you!"* Entity yelled. *"You are gonna be the death of us both!"*

"I'm not stopping... I'm not- Until she..." Before Shadow Weaver could finish it she blacked out.

Darkith took her chances and left before she would be captured. Horde's army might have been destroyed, but so was the leader of the rebellion. Besides, she still had an ace in the hole. As Darkith vanished, silence fell on the battlefield and Princess Alliance and the Rebellion would face a true tragedy.

Chapter End Notes

I don't even know what I'm doing anymore... We are going balls in deep on this one.
How will they ever recover from this?
How will Shadow Weaver deal with this?
Will this affect Catra as well?

Aftermath

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver wakes up in the Rebellions medical tent, wondering how she ended up there.
> She is confronted by Castaspella who want's to see that there is more in Shadow Weaver than meets the eye.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Shadow Weaver opened her eyes. She couldn't remember anything at the moment, she was dizzy and felt like something had crushed her. "Shadow Weaver?" She could hear a voice calling for her. It was familiar, but she couldn't exactly recognize it. She was about to close her eyes again until she felt something soft on her face, it was fur-like and warm. "Catra?" She mumbled. "Get... off of... my... face."

"No." Catra answered. "Not until you wake up."

"I am already awake, not sure if it's comfortable tho." Shadow Weaver said with a tired tone. "So, get off."

"Fine..." Catra sighed and moved aside from Shadow Weaver's face.

Shadow Weaver slowly stood up to sit, she was not going to stand up not while she was like this. Shadow Weaver looked around and it seemed like she was in some sort of tent. Catra offered her some water and she took it. "Ugh... my head hurts so bad." She said while drinking water.

"Please don't do something like that again." Catra said and sat on Shadow Weaver's lap.

"What do you mean? Do something like... what?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"They said you were really close to dying after the battle was over." Catra said and hugged her. "You always tell me not to be reckless, but you were really reckless back there."

"Catra... I don't understand... I'm always cautious and level-headed." Shadow Weaver said.

"No, Castaspella told me that if they hadn't found you when they did... you... you would have not made it..."

Shadow Weaver's mind was now flooding memories from the battle. She remembered that she actually lost control after Micha's death. She started to tremble, how could she forget something like that. "Micah..."

Catra looked up to Shadow Weaver and asked. "Do you remember what happened?"

Shadow Weaver was filled with sadness, regret and disgust. She felt once again terrible, because of her inability to protect Micah, he was now gone. "Yes Catra, I remember... But now I wish I wouldn't" She collapsed on the bed and laid there. Catra, not knowing what to do, decided to just stay on top of Shadow Weaver and hope for the best. Shadow Weaver closed her eyes and soon her mind drifted into nothingness that was her.

Shadow Weaver didn't know how many hours had passed, but now as she opened her eyes once again. Catra was still sleeping

on her chest and there was another figure beside her. "How are you, Shadow Weaver?" Figure asked.

"I've seen better days." Shadow Weaver murmured. Her voice was familiar, it had to be Castaspella. No-one else has that kind of voice. "Micah... he's gone. Right?"

"Yes... he's.. gone." Castaspella said with a sad tone.

"It's because of me, I bring death and misery everywhere I go." Shadow Weaver said, frowning.

Castaspella was not expecting that kind of answer from Shadow Weaver, what she had heard was that Light Spinner never saw flaws in herself and that probably hadn't changed when she became Shadow Weaver. "If anything, Horde is crippled for a while. The losses they suffered were too great." Castaspella said.

"But the Rebellion lost their leader, you lost your brother and the Queen lost her husband.. that is far too great a loss." Shadow Weaver said with her voice crumbling. "And I... lost my student... forever."

Castaspella got closer to Shadow Weaver and put her hand around her shoulder. No-one had ever done that to her, except her mother when she was a child. "Micah meant alot to us, you are not the only one blaming oneself." Castaspella said, trying to calm Shadow Weaver.

"Why are you... like this?" Shadow Weaver asked. "What do you want?"

Castaspella was taken back by this, has no-one ever showed Shadow Weaver kindness. "You don't know what kindness is?"

"No... maybe... it's been too long, I can't remember." Shadow Weaver said.

"Well, would you like me to show you more kindness?" Castaspella asked with a rather suggestive tone.

"Ohh, I get what you want, but shouldn't you be with others. With those who mean something to you." Shadow Weaver said.

Castaspella sighed. "I guess you are right. It's just... What about you?"

"What about me?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Don't you want someone to care about you?"

Shadow Weaver paused for a moment, she didn't need sympathy or pity from a sorcerer like Castaspella, she didn't need it from anybody. Those things are the reason why her life is such a mess. "I once had someone, but because of that... my life has become a mess."

Castaspella frowned. "Then what about Catra? She means something to you and you mean something to her."

"That's different. I take care of Catra because else I would have been long gone. She keeps me in check, so I wouldn't do something I would regret." Shadow Weaver explained, only to realize she had just told Castaspella that Catra's care is the reason she still has control of herself.

Castaspella smiled. "So you have someone who cares about you."

Shadow Weaver flustered and felt embarrassed. Catra just happened to wake up to hear them talking about her. "What are you talking about me?"

Shadow Weaver looked at Catra. "How long have you been awake?"

"Not for long, I just happened to hear you talk about me." Catra said.

Shadow Weaver shook her head, could things get anymore embarrassing. Castaspella sat next to her and put her arm around her shoulder once more. "It isn't that bad, right?"

Catra was also hugging her. "Yeah, you need to soften up."

"Am I not soft enough?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"You could be softer." Castaspella teased.

Then Angella stepped inside of the tent. She had herself come to see Shadow Weaver. And what a sight there was to behold. "Castaspella?" She asked.

Castaspella jumped up and was quite surprised to see Angella here. "Oh, hi. Wasn't expecting to see you here."

"You told me yourself that you went to see if Shadow Weaver was alright. I take it you got your answer." Angella said and looked at Shadow Weaver.

Shadow Weaver herself just wanted to disappear, she didn't need to face the mourning wife of Micah. Who probably would want her head on a vase if she learned that she had changed the plans.

Catra just went on top of Shadow Weaver's face to cover her.

"Yes, Queen Angella. She is in fact doing well and certainly not plotting anything suspicious." Castaspella said nervously.

Angella sighed. "Whatever, Micha's funeral will be held today. Even if we don't have his body, we will have a memorial for him."

"Ofcourse." Castaspella said. "What about Shadow Weaver? She was close with Micah as well."

"No, I don't want her rotting corpse anywhere near Micah or my kingdom." Angella said with a cold tone.

Catra took her claws out. "Who are you calling a rotting corpse?!"

Shadow Weaver quickly grabbed Catra. "Don't make this harder than it already is."

Angella looked at Shadow Weaver. "I never expected you to be compliant. Last time someone disagreed with you, you killed the high council of Mystacor."

"Angella!" Castaspella said. "She has feelings as well.. deep in there somewhere."

"I highly doubt that." Angella said and left the tent.

Shadow Weaver was boiling inside. How dare she. Shadow Weaver could also feel the entity take over her once more. She stood up and was clenching her fists.

" *Are you really gonna let her talk to you like that? Come on, show her what you can do. Do what you did back in Mystacor and show her you are not the one to be trifled with!"*

Castaspella noticed the sudden change in Shadow Weaver and her presence started to feel ominous.

" *Yes, I feel your anger, your self hatred is strong. Use it to your benefit. And get that power that lies in Brightmoon!* " The Entity inside told her.

Catra jumped on Shadow Weaver's face before she could do anything. This annoyed her, but soon realized that Catra hugging her face calmed her down. "Don't do what you were about to do." Catra said.

" *Not this again.. this damn cat everytime. Argh, this will not be the last time you see me. I will be back, I always will.* " Entity said and dwelled away in defeat.

This snapped Shadow Weaver out of her trance-like state. She took Catra off from her face and held her in her arms. "How did you know what I was about to do?"

"I didn't, I just felt that." Catra said. "Is it better now?"

"Much better.." Shadow Weaver said and let out a small smile.

Castaspella was astonished. She witnessed something so rare, something that probably no-one else had ever seen. "What just happened?"

Shadow Weaver looked at Castaspella. "You just avoided a disaster."

"I don't get it."

"It's really complicated, it would be best if I leave." Shadow Weaver said. "I truly am risking everyone here and Angella doesn't want me here anyways."

"I know what she said was cold, but she has a hard time taking this." Castaspella said.

"I understand completely. Which is better if I leave."

"Will I ever see you if you leave?" Castaspella asked with a worried tone.

"I wouldn't count on that." Shadow Weaver replied.

Shadow Weaver let Catra down and then proceeded to draw a teleportation circle. Castaspella watched the circle being drawn and she felt sad. She might never see Shadow Weaver again. The short time she spent with her, she could see Shadow Weaver as a real person. Instead of the monster she was portrayed as.

"It's done." Shadow Weaver said and picked Catra up. "Remember what I told you about teleportation spells?"

"Yes." Catra answered.

"Good." Shadow Weaver said. "Goodbye, Castaspella. And good luck on being the new Head Sorcerer of Mystacor."

"Yeah, do your best." Catra added.

Castaspella had a sad smile and she shed a single tear. "Yeah... I promise, I will. Goodbye."

And with that being said, Shadow Weaver and Catra vanished up in the air. Leaving only the circle on the floor. Castaspella let out a deep sigh and headed out.

Shadow Weaver and Catra arrived at their home in Whispering Woods. House was still standing there, it seemed no-one had tried to break in or anything. Shadow Weaver took a glance at the house and let out a relieved sigh. "Finally... I don't think I couldn't have stand it there any longer."

Catra jumped off and ran towards the door trying to open it, but it didn't budge. "Why doesn't it open?" Shadow Weaver chuckled. "You need a key, I locked the door before we left." She then extended her hand towards Catra. "Do you want to open the door?"

"Yes!" Catra said excitedly and her eyes shone like stars. Shadow Weaver gave the key to Catra and she opened the door and ran inside. "I'm going to make tea!"

"Wait, Catra! Don't do anything before I've confirmed its edible!" Shadow Weaver yelled and ran inside to stop Catra, but it was already too late.

She saw Catra in the kitchen mixing all different kinds of herbs and brewing them. "This will be the best tea of your life!" Catra

exclaimed with a wide smile on her face.

Shadow Weaver sighed in deep, she was tired and still bitter from the words by Angella. She had no energy to stop Catra by now. " *Why do I even bother...* " She thought to herself, but even if she was tired. She was still quite amused by Catra's chenanigans. Normally she wouldn't, but something clearly had changed in her.

Chapter End Notes

I guess we have the setup fo the Season 1 now.
Horde took huge losses, but still succeeded removing Micah.
Rebellion is in shambles and all the other kingdoms are focusing on themselves.
And Shadow Weaver doesn't want to have anything to do with them.

Back to normal?

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver has to get used to her new situation, without Micah. At least she has Catra around to keep her occupied and keepinf darkness at bay.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Sun was rising over Whispering Woods, a cool breeze was blowing and Shadow Weaver was sleeping. Catra had already woken up and was outside, training her skills.

The tea she had brewed made Shadow Weaver bed ridden for a few days. She herself was fine, byt Shadow Weaver couldn't get up from her bed after that.

Catra was thinking how she could help Shadow Weaver. Tea was out of the question. Maybe some rare plants or flowers, she knew Shadow Weaver liked those. She had a garden full of different plants. Catra thought that there had to be flowers in Whispering Woods, flowers that are rare and would cheer Shadow Weaver.

It was a great idea, Shadow Weaver would find some rare flowers to be nice. So Catra decided not to waste anymore time, she took small backpack with her left.

Shadow Weaver was in deep sleep, she found herself surrounded by darkness. "Where am I?" She asked. "Helloo?"

There was no answer, only silence. She tried to walk forward, but she didn't move anywhere. "What is this place?"

"**You are a disgrace!**" Foul voice yelled at her.

Shadow Weaver turned to look around, but didn't see anything.

"**Because of you, I lost him!**" Another voice yelled. It was distorted, but it was clearly the voice of a woman.

"What do you mean, because of me?" Shadow Weaver asked. "All I have done, has been for the good of Etheria! You can't save everyone!"

"**I trusted you, but you still failed me.**" Distorted voice of a man called. Shadow Weaver recognised his voice.

"Micah? How? What do you mean?" Shadow Weaver asked, confused. "Micah, are you alive?"

"**YOU ARE DISGRACE FOR EVERY SORCERER!**"

"**You couldn't even save him, you call yourself the best?**"

"Just shut up!" Shadow Weaver yelled. "I didn't ask any of this!"

Then everything went silent again. Shadow Weaver didn't hear anything. Were they gone? What is this all about? She couldn't know, but it was clear all of the voices had something to do with her past.

The ground below her turned into mud like and she was being swallowed by the surrounding darkness. It was like a quicksoil the more you move, the quicker you will drown.

She could hear the voices return. Many of the voices belonged to people she had interacted with or came into contact with and all of them were conceding towards her. "Nooo! Go awayy!" Shadow Weaver yelled and opened her eyes.

She was laying on the floor, it seemed she had fallen from the bed. She rubbed her head and felt really dizzy. "What the hell did Catra put in that tea.." She thought to herself.

Shadow Weaver pulled herself up, but she couldn't stand. She had a terrible headache and the world around her was blurry. She laid on the bed and stared at the roof, it was spinning like a carousel. She had to get some medicine to calm down.

She rolled on the floor from her bed and started to drag herself towards downstairs. "What would Catra think if she saw me like this?" She dragged herself towards the front door and pulled herself up. Leaning towards the door she carefully opened it and looked outside.

It was a beautiful morning, she stepped outside and took support on a nearby fence. She went slowly to her garden and started to collect medical plants.

When Shadow Weaver had collected everything she needed, she wobbled back to her home.

Making a way towards the kitchen and starting to brew the plants. As she was brewing, she wondered where Catra could be. "She's usually somewhere, making noise or dropping stuff from the shelf."

Her mind wasn't clear enough and she still had a terrible headache. She didn't give thought about Catra's whereabouts.

Meanwhile, deep in the heart of Whispering Woods, Catra was looking for rare plants and flowers. She didn't have any luck finding those.

She was really deep into the forest already, she should have found something by now. "It might have been a mistake to go so far.." Catra talked to herself. "Maybe I should go back..."

Catra was thinking about turning back, but soon a bright glow from the cave caught her attention.

It must be something special, if it grows inside of a cave. Catra approached the cave, it gave her shivers. As if the cave was telling her to turn back, but her curiosity took the best of her.

She went inside, looking for the source of the unnatural glow. She walked and walked, but she didn't get any closer.

Then it dawned on her, she was being lured into a trap by something. Catra quickly evaded incoming attacks, she had great instincts. Catra could see a huge maw open up, filled with rows of sharp teeth.

Catra started to run away, she went on all fours to get away faster. "AAAAAHH! HEEELP!" Catra yelled while avoiding tentacles trying to squash her.

Meanwhile Shadow Weaver was enjoying her regular tea, she could sense something was wrong. It had something to do with Catra and she suddenly got really worried. "What kind of trouble she's gotten herself into."

Shadow Weaver rose up from the chair and stood still, to test her balance and dizziness.

"It seems everything is alright, I better go find Catra."

Catra was running away from the beast and was heading towards their home. She wasn't anywhere near close, but the heading was right.

She jumped from tree branch to tree branch avoiding the monster. She had great agility, but her stamina was starting to wear away. "I don't know how long I can keep going like this!"

Shadow Weaver didn't have any clue where Catra might be, she could only sense that Catra was in trouble. "Hey Spell of Obtainment." She called.

There was nothing. "So now you don't want to have anything to say. You always butt in, but now?"

" *What do you want?* " Entity answered with a tired tone.

"Help me find Catra, I know you have abilities like that."

" *What if I had? Why should I help you find that annoying brat?* "

"If you want to make it hard, so be it. You can then just piss off!"

" *With pleasure... you nagging bitch...* "

"I heard that!"

" *Mhmhm, whatever...* " Entity mumbled and dwelled away.

Shadow Weaver sighed, guess she has to just try her luck. She prepared a teleportation spell and hoped for the best.

Meanwhile Catra was desperately trying to escape, but she didn't have any stamina left. She fell down from the tree and smacked on the ground. Panting and out of breath she tried to gather all her strength to stand, but it was in vain.

Monster grabbed her with her tentacle and was about to eat her. Catra closed her eyes and prepared for the worst.

Fortunately for her Shadow Weaver's luck had paid off and she used the spell to cut the monster's tentacle.

Monster let out an agonizing roar and released Catra. She was falling on the ground, but Shadow Weaver catched her. Catra could feel arms holding her tightly, she opened her eyes and saw Shadow Weaver. "You came!"

"Of Course I came." Shadow Weaver answered. She turned to look at the monster that was standing in front of her. "Listen here you filth! If you even dare to think about laying your tentacles on Catra, I'll cut your head off!"

Shadow Weaver was preparing for another spell, ready to ignite it. "Do I make myself clear?"

Monster cowered in front of her and slowly backed away. When it was sure the monster was gone, Shadow Weaver let Catra down. "What were you doing alone, at the forest?"

Catra looked at Shadow Weaver and saw a cold stare. "I was just trying to cheer you up, by collecting some rare flowers... I never thought I would counter something like that." Catra said, avoiding Shadow Weaver's stare.

Shadow Weaver let a relieved sigh. "You silly cat, I'm just glad I made it in time." She said with a calming voice. "We are in the Whispering Woods after all and it is quite a dangerous place."

Catra hugged Shadow Weaver. "I promise, I won't wander alone anymore." She said sobbing.

"There, there... why don't we go back to home." Shadow Weaver said with a calm tone and gently stroke Catra's hair. "You could make some tea."

Catra turned to look at Shadow Weaver with a wide smile. "Really?" She asked.

"Yes, under my supervision of course." Shadow Weaver answered and a small smile escaped her lips and Catra took notice of that.

When they arrived back home, Shadow Weaver kept the promise she had made and let Catra make some tea. She showed her what ingredients are acceptable and won't cause you hallucinations. "The tea you made earlier was such a bomb that I was bedridden for days. So, here's how you make the tea, without trying to kill someone." Shadow Weaver said and looked at Catra.

"It wasn't that bad. Right?" Catra answered, trying to downplay the side effects of her self made tea.

"Yeaaaah, No." Shadow Weave answered. "So, here's how we make the tea."

Shadow Weaver made an example of how to make quite normal and mild tea, and asked Catra to repeat it. Few mistakes here and there, but Catra succeeded in making a mild tea.

"Well done Catra." Shadow Weaver complimented. "Few more times and soon you can make tea for yourself."

"Thanks." Catra answered. "So wanna taste it?"

"Don't mind if I do." Shadow Weaver said. She took a cup and filled it with tea. She put the cup on her lips and took a small sip. It tasted like actual tea and not like poison. "It's mild, but good."

She lowered the cup on the kitchen table and looked at Catra. "Well you should taste the tea as well."

"I will." Catra said and poured tea to herself.

They sat there for a while and before they knew it was already a noon. Shadow Weaver saw Catra sleeping on the chair, apparently the tea made her sleepy. It wasn't a surprise, since she had accidently added some sleep powder, ment for helping you sleep. It didn't have an effect on Shadow Weaver due to their difference in size and also that Catra had drank more than just one cup.

Shadow Weaver picked Catra up and carried her to the bedroom. She laid her on the bed and closed the door behind her. As she walked downstairs, she thought about making Catra a bed of her own. "She will keep growing, so it would be best for her to have her own bed."

Making another bed was not a hard task or needing a lot of work, she could just make one with her magic.

She went outside to look for the materials and noticed a small backpack on the doorstep. Catra probably had used it when she was on her adventure in the forest. She picked the bag up and looked inside. Shadow Weaver noticed there in fact were some flowers, daisies to be precise. She already had daisies growing in her garden, but appreciated the effort Catra had seen for her.

She decided to plant the daisies near the door in the front yard, so Catra would notice them and know that Shadow Weaver had found the flowers and planted them.

"Now then, I better start making her that bed."

Chapter End Notes

> It seems Shadow Weaver has gotten used to her new situation, not that it is that much different form the earlier. But deep down she will always miss Micah.

Surprise present for you

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver never knew Catra's birthday, but she is making her a present anyways. Maybe she can learn something from Catra.
>
> Shadow Weaver is eager to know more about Catra and her kin and suggests that maybe they should go to Catra's hometown, to get knowledge.
>
> It depends on Catra, if she want's to go.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Noon had turned into an evening and Catra woke up from her sleep. She walked downstairs and looked for Shadow Weaver, but couldn't see her anywhere. "Shadow Weaver?" Catra asked. "Are you home?"

There was no answer and she got worried. Catra feared Shadow Weaver had left her while she was sleeping. "Shadow Weaver?!"

She ran towards the front door and opened it. She looked around the front yard, but didn't see anything. Catra noticed that right next to the front door, there were now growing the flowers she had picked up. Shadow Weaver must have planted those flowers, who else could it be. "If she planted them because of me, why she's gone then?" Catra wondered to herself. She sat on the porch and sighed in deep.

It was getting cold outside, the sun was covered in clouds and a cool breeze was blowing. Catra just sat there and sneezed. She

was shivering from the coldness and it had felt like eternity even if it had been barely an hour.

"Catra?"

She could hear a voice calling her, it was familiar and it belonged to none other than Shadow Weaver. Catra looked up and saw Shadow Weaver standing in front of her.

"Why are you sitting outside? It's cold here." She said and picked Catra up and she sneezed again.

"I didn't see you anywhere and I got worried that you had left me." Catra said, sobbing. "Because I always make things hard for you, I thought you had got enough."

Shadow Weaver put finger on her mouth and wiped tears from Catra's cheek. "Shhh shhh, it's alright Catra, it's alright." Shadow Weaver said with a calming voice. "Even if you got on my nerves, you are still my own little menace and. I would never leave you."

"You wouldn't?" Catra asked and sneezed.

"I wouldn't. Never." Shadow Weaver said. "Now let's go back inside and get you something to help with your cold."

Shadow Weaver was in the kitchen, making medicine for Catra's cold. Catra herself sat on the couch in the living room, wrapped up in a blanket. "Are you making tea?"

"No, I'm making medicine." Shadow Weaver answered from the kitchen. "It will help with your cold and you will soon feel better."

"Okay then." Catra answered and sneezed once more.

Shadow Weaver brought Catra her medicine, it was hot water mixed in with different herbs and she had added some sugar in the mix to make it taste better.

"Here you go." Shadow Weaver said and gave Catra the mug.

Catra took the mug and without hesitation or second guesses, just drank it all in one go. "Yuck! It tastes terrible." Catra stated after drinking.

"You know that medicine that tastes sweet usually doesn't help." Shadow Weaver answered. "Drinking water mixed with sugar won't help much."

"I get it..." Catra murmured. "Could have still made it taste better."

"I added sugar to the mix."

"Should have added more."

"Listen here Catra, if all you eat and drink is sugar, you soon will lose all your teeth. And I don't want tooth fairy to come here collect your teeth."

"Tooth fairy?" Catra asked, confused and a little bit scared. "Does it steal your tooths?"

"Only if you lose them." Shadow Weaver answered.

"I won't let it take any of them!" Catra said and covered her mouth.

"Then keep good care of your teeth."

"I will."

"Good." Shadow Weaver answered. "Now, it's getting late. Why don't we go to sleep."

"But I slept half the day already."

"You know, even if you don't sleep. It's good to rest when you're cold, it helps you get better faster."

"I guess so..." Catra sighed.

They headed to the bedroom and Shadow Weaver laid Catra on the bed and sat next to her. She hymned her lullaby till she was sure Catra was sleeping.

She then left the bedroom and started to finish her surprise for Catra. Her surprise is a lot more than just a bed.

Next morning Catra woke up early, she had slept half the day yesterday. Fortunately Shadow Weaver's surprise was ready.
"Good morning Catra, you're up early."

"Good morning to you too." Catra said and yawned.

"I have a surprise for you." Shadow Weaver said with an unusually chirpy voice.

"Ngnnn... and what's that." Catra said rubbing her eyes.

"You'll see when you leave the bedroom."

Catra's curiosity peaked, she couldn't resist something like this. She quickly got out of the bed and went with Shadow Weaver. As

soon as she set out from the bedroom she could see Shadow Weaver, standing next to a door she hadn't ever seen earlier. "Where does that door lead?"

"Open it up." Shadow Weaver said and stood aside.

Catra walked to the door and grabbed the door handle. She looked at Shadow Weaver with hesitative look on her face.

"You don't have to hesitate, it's quite safe." Shadow Weaver said with an amused tone.

Catra then carefully opened the door and she saw a room. There was a bed against the wall and next to it was a night stand. Writing table with a chair was at the corner and a colorful carpet covered the floor. "Whose room is this?"

"You silly cat, it's your room ofcourse." Shadow Weaver answered.

"My room?" Catra asked, amazed, her eyes were sparkling with joy. "For me? But why?"

"Consider it as your birthday present." Shadow Weaver said. "Besides, you keep growing and it would be quite awkward to sleep on the same bed when you grow up."

"Thank you so much!" Catra yelled happily and ran towards Shadow Weaver. She hugged her tightly so tightly that it took Shadow Weaver by surprise.

"I'm glad you're happy." Shadow Weaver said and patted Catra's hair.

"But how do you know it's my birthday?" Catra asked when she stopped hugging. "I don't even know mine."

"I don't know either and to be honest, I'm not even quite sure when my own birthday is." Shadow Weaver answered.

"You don't have a birthday either?"

"Well, technically I have and so do you, but I didn't have parents for long. I was found by Norwyn and took in at the Mystacor when he discovered I had a potential to be a sorceress." Shadow Weaver explained and her tone turned quite somber and melancholy. "Nobody celebrated birthdays at Mystacor, so I kinda forgot."

Shadow Weaver turned to look at Catra who had tears on her eyes. "Catra? What's wrong?"

"I didn't know your life was so terrible." Catra said, sobbing.

Shadow Weaver walked towards Catra and picked her up. She wiped Catra's tears. "Hey, it's not that bad, I at least have you."

Shadow Weaver stood there for a while and held Catra. They embraced each other for some time. Then Catra broke the silence. "I don't know much about myself or my kin."

"You are quite a special case indeed, even I'm not quite sure what you exactly are." Shadow Weaver said. "I've heard of magicats, but they are not well known to the world."

"I would like to know more about myself. But where could we get that information?"

"Maybe your hometown, even if Horde has destroyed it. There could still be some knowledge left." Shadow Weaver suggested.

"I don't know if I could do that." Catra said. "It was already terrible what I saw before."

"It might be hard, but you deserve to know more. I'm not forcing you to do it." Shadow Weaver said. "But consider it, I don't think you would want to be in darkness regarding your kin."

Catra thought for a while what to say. She would want to know more, but could she handle it. "I'll consider it, in my room." Catra said and went into her new room.

Shadow Weaver was making breakfast in the kitchen, while Catra had still not come out from her room. It's been at least an hour. "I hope she won't ruin her whole day because of this." Shadow Weaver said to herself. "Maybe I shouldn't have pushed her with it."

" *You know, you are quite pathetic.* " Entity told her. " *You, caring about others feelings? You should think how to get ourselves stronger.* "

"I don't need your useless comments all the time."

" *You should. Or else.* " Entity said with a threatening voice.

"Or what?" Shadow Weaver snarked.

Then Shadow Weaver suddenly lost her balance and had to grab from the kitchen table. She could feel her energy and life force draining from her. "What are you doing?!"

" *Reminding you who is really at charge. I should have done this a long time ago!* " Entity said and Shadow Weaver could feel the Spell of Obtainment grow stronger and draining her.

Shadow Weaver coughed black blood and tried to keep herself in control. At the same time Catra happened to walk in the kitchen. "Hey, Shadow Weaver. I was think-" Catra was cut short. "Are you alright?"

"**Stay back!** " Shadow Weaver growled. " **I just need some time."**

Catra was worried, but didn't interfere. Shadow Weaver took a deep breath. "*Listen here you leech, I have other more important things to do. So, FUCK OFF!*" There was silence, she felt a tight grip on her legs. Catra was hugging her, this cat has some mysterious properties. She has to find out what they are.

"Is everything okay?" Catra asked.

"Yes, everything is quite okay." Shadow Weaver said calmly.

"Good." Catra said and let go of Shadow Weaver. "I thought about it.. about going home.. town."

"Yes?"

"I agree, we should go. I don't want to be left in the shadows."

"Great, but we should eat something before we go. I made some great breakfast." Shadow Weaver said.

"One day, I'll be making breakfast for you." Catra said.

"I'm looking forward to that."

They started eating breakfast, they had a long journey ahead. It could even take several days, so they better be well prepared.

Chapter End Notes

Next time we are going to Catra's hometown and hopefully both will find what they are seeking.

Reminisce of past

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver and Catra travel to Catra's hometown, to seek knowledge and maybe getting Catra some closure of her past.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Shadow Weaver was packing a backpack with all the necessities needed for their journey. It might take them several days by walking, but teleporting might be easier. When Shadow Weaver had packed everything, she now just had to locate the place where they were going. "Catra, could you come down here for a sec?" She asked.

Catra then came running down the stairs with her own backpack on her back. "Yes, here I am." She answered.

"Good, we need to do the location spell, so we don't have to walk for several days."

"Alright then." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver prepared the vase and asked Catra to come there. She then gave Catra the same powder she had previously used. "Okay, just hold it in your hands. I'll do the magic and you add the ingredients."

Shadow Weaver drew sigil on the water and asked Catra to drop the powder on it. "Now, just think about your homeplace."

Catra did as she was told to and soon the surface of the water reflected the location.

"Good, very good." Shadow Weaver said.

"So, how do we know its location?" Catra asked.

"By looking at the specific landmarks that would indicate the location of your hometown." Shadow Weaver said she inspected the surroundings of the location and realized it was near the borders of Whispering Woods. "Interesting, it's closer than I thought it would be."

"So it's not that far away?" Catra asked.

"Well, yes and no." Shadow Weaver answered. "It's closer in a sense that we don't have to go to another kingdom or cross any borders, but it's far away in a sense that Whispering Woods is huge and hard to navigate."

"Now that's a lot of words, but I think I understand."

"Good, we don't have to worry too much. Now that I know the surroundings of your hometown, it's easy to teleport there."

"Okay then let's get going." Catra exclaimed with excitement. "I like teleporting, it feels so funny."

"It's because every time we teleport, there's a chance of magical fungi to start growing inside of you." Shadow Weaver said deviously.

"What?! You didn't tell me this earlier?!" Catra yelled. "Does it mean I'm turning into something weird?"

"Of Course no, I was just joking." Shadow Weaver replied nonchalantly.

"Good, because I was worried there for a sec." Catra said, relieved.

"I'll start the teleportation preparations, if you have something you need you better get it now."

"I don't have anything I need. We can go."

"Okay then." Shadow Weaver said and began to draw the sigil needed to teleport. Catra observed closely as Shadow Weaver drew the lines. So smooth, so precise. "Alright, it's done."

Catra stepped inside of the sigil and took Shadow Weaver by her hand. Catra closed her eyes to avoid the dizziness that came with teleporting. Shadow Weaver was pleased that she didn't have to remind her anymore. And with a blink of an eye, they were gone.

Shadow Weaver and Catra arrived at their destination but it seemed Shadow Weaver's teleportation had missed its mark. They were not standing where she had expected them to be. Instead they were in the middle of Whispering Woods.

"Strange... we should have arrived at the right place but this doesn't seem like it." Shadow Weaver stated.

"Did your spell backfire?" Catra asked.

"Nonsense, it was perfect. It's this place that's the problem." Shadow Weaver puffed, she usually didn't fail nor did she want to admit it. "I'm sure we are close, we just have to walk sometime."

"Shadow Weaver?" Catra asked.

"Yes?"

"I don't feel so good."

Shadow Weaver walked to Catra and picked her up. "You don't seem to be sick. It might be the side effects of long distance teleporting."

"You aren't making that up, are you?" Catra asked.

"No, I'm not." Shadow Weaver answered. "Teleporting can have side effects, especially for those who don't possess magic."

"Am I in danger?" Catra asked with a worried tone.

"No, you are not." Shadow Weaver assured. "But I can carry you, if you want."

"I would like that." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver nodded and put Catra on her shoulders. "Okay, let's go."

Shadow Weaver didn't mind giving Catra a piggyback ride. She walked through the thick woods and uneven ground.

"Am I in too much trouble?" Catra asked.

"No, you are quite fine." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Your hair smells so nice and it's so smooth." Catra said admiringly. "Fluffy too."

"Eeehhh... thanks.. I guess." Shadow Weaver answered, she felt quite awkward. No one had ever praised her for anything, but why it had to be her hair. Sure she has more qualities than just a smooth and silky hair. "Your hair is also fluffy and pleasant to pet."

" *Ugh.. What am I talking about? Just focus on the important thing.* "

Shadow Weaver carried Catra their whole journey, it took them several hours to get to their location.

They finally arrived at their destination and it was as bleak as seen in the mirror. Scorched trees, ruins of houses and grass covered in a thick layer of ash and dust. Ragged Horde flags wavering in the wind.

Everything was in utter ruin and there was not much left of anything. Shadow Weaver put Catra down on the ground. "Well, we should find something. Can you recognise anything that could be important?"

Catra thought for a second, she has only vague memories of her hometown. "There was a library near the town center and a temple somewhere up north."

"Well, that's good. Library and temple should give us enough information." Shadow Weaver said. "Let's just hope there's something left."

They walked towards the town center and there was a large building standing next to the plaza.

"Is that the library?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Yes, or at least it should be." Catra answered.

They walked towards the ruined building, it still had its grandiose pousure. Cracked marble pillars hold its high roof and in the middle of the building roof was a large dome. Dome had a large hole in it and sunlight shone through it.

They entered inside the library and it still had some bookshelves intact and there even were books.

Catra could see shimmering in Shadow Weaver's eyes, this was new. She hadn't never before seen her eyes shimmering like that.

"Can you imagine the knowledge that's held inside this library?" Shadow Weaver asked gleefully. "Those old hags at Mystacor would beg for this kind of knowledge of the now deceased race."

Shadow Weaver could see Catra frown, it must be a sensitive subject for her. "Oh... That was unprofessional on my part. I shouldn't have said that."

"It's okay, I just wish things hadn't come to this. Wish none of this had happened, if the Rebellion would have done something... maybe this could have been avoided." Catra said, shedding one tear.

"We all do, but sometimes fate is not in our hands and it doesn't favor us." Shadow Weaver said, trying to ease Catra. "Fate hasn't favored me either and it hasn't favored many, you are not alone in this."

Catra buried her head into Shadow Weaver's dress and hugged her. "Thank you..."

"You're welcome." Shadow Weaver said calmly. "Now then, let's gather some information."

Shadow Weaver then proceeded to investigate the library and its books that were still intact. There were many interesting books about history, culture and even religion.

Shadow Weaver's attention was caught by a book that covered their religion. She started to read it and noticed Catra's race worshiped some kind of warrior princess that carried a sword. " *This looks familiar, I'm sure I've seen this somewhere before.* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself.

She then proceeded to read about their history and culture. Turns out their race is called magicats and they in fact possess abilities that tend to calm those who are distressed. " *Kinda like normal cats when they sit on someone's lap...* " She thought to herself and turned to look at Catra who was scratching her ear. " *Does it mean... whatever. I got the information I wanted.* "

"Okay Catra, I'm ready." Shadow Weaver said. She stood up and wiped the dust off of her clothes. "Is there something you would like?"

"I wish I could see my home.." Catra said and sighed.

"Well.. wanna go look for it? We have time till sunset." Shadow Weaver said.

"It would be lovely but, I don't even remember where my home is."

"Maybe you will remember while we look for it. Things like that are usually stored in the subconscious."

"Alright.. whatever that is." Catra said and jumped on Shadow Weaver's shoulders.

"You still want me to carry you?"

"Yes, it's comfy." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver shook her head. "Whatever.."

They left the library and started walking on the streets.

As they walked Catra had small snippets of memories. She had begun to remember.

"Shadow Weaver?" She asked.

"Yes?"

"I think what you told me about that subcon- whatever is happening. I get small snippets of my past."

"Well, do you remember where your home is?'

Catra closed her eyes, thought for a sec. Opened her eyes once again and looked around. Then it came to her mind as a clear image. "It's somewhere up north." Catra said and jumped off. "Follow me."

She was running quite fast, so fast that Shadow Weaver had difficulties keeping on her tail.

After a while of running, they arrived at the ruined house and it seemed to be larger than most of the houses. Maybe Catra's parents were important or high in their hierarchy.

They went inside and it was like the rest of the buildings. Utter ruins, holes in the walls and on the roof, broken furniture and ash.

Catra ran upstairs because she could remember her room to be there.

Shadow Weaver herself looked around the living room. She approached a shelf and inspected it. There seemed to be a picture, a family portrait. Glass was broken, but the picture itself was fine.

She picked up the family portrait, it would be important to Catra. Her family looked so happy in that picture. It reminded her about her family, except only she and her mother were in the picture. Her father was one to take the picture.

Reminiscing about her past Shadow Weaver could feel a sting in her heart. She ignored it and went to upstairs.

Catra was sitting on her room's floor, looking around the wrecked empty room.

"Catra?" Shadow Weaver asked and tapped her shoulder.

"My family is gone and I won't see them again." Catra said.

"Maybe it's not all gone." Shadow Weaver said.

"What do you mean?"

"I found this at the living room." Shadow Weaver said and handed Catra her family portrait.

Catra's frown turned into a smile, it was her family in the and they looked so happy together. Finally, she could have some memories of her family. Something she could cheris. "I'm so happy."

"That's good to hear." Shadow Weaver said. "You know, when we get home. We could take picture of us. What do you say?"

"It would be a wonderful idea." Catra said smiling. "Then I would have two family portraits."

Shadow Weaver nodded. "Well, we should get going. Whispering Woods is a dangerous place at night."

Catra nodded in agreement and stood up. She held her family portrait. Shadow Weaver had packed lots of books from the library. She wanted to know more of this mysterious warrior princess.

When they left the building, Shadow Weaver started to draw teleportation sigils on the ground. Hopefully it won't miss time.

They had successfully teleported back to Shadow Weavers home. Everything were the same as they were when they left. Shadow Weaver opened the front door, threw the backpack on the couch and stretched her back. "I'm too old for this stuff."

"What do you mean?" Catra asked.

"I mean that I carried you almost our whole journey and then I had to run after you."

"You have magic, why don't you use that?"

"My magic has a price, I'm sure you know what I mean." Shadow Weaver said.

Catra knew exactly what she meant, if Shadow Weaver used too much magic it would either get out of control or drain her life energy. "Yeah, I get it."

"I'll go make us some tea and we can take the family portrait after it."

"Sounds great." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver made her favorite tea, ginger tea mixed with magical powder that helps with sore muscles. Not that Catra needed it, but it also had no side effects. If you didn't have muscle pain or anything like that, it would just help you relax. So it was a win-win situation for both of them.

They enjoyed their tea and Shadow Weaver brought one subject matter on the table. "Do you know anything about the religion that your race believed?"

"I can't remember." Catra answered.

"It's okay if you don't remember." Shadow Weaver assured. "I picked up the books about it, so I can read them on my own time."

"But I remember my parents telling me about the protector."

"Protector?" Shadow Weaver asked, her interest had peaked.

"Yes, a noble warrior princess. Who was said to write the wrongs of this world." Catra explained. "But I can't remember more."

"That was quite enough."

This couldn't be coincidence, this same warrior princess was also mentioned by her parents and it was also found in ancient scriptures. " *But what in the world could she be?* " Shadow Weaver was deep in her thoughts, until she was snapped out of it by Catra. "Can we take the picture now? I've finished the tea already."

"Huh... Oh yeah. Sure." Shadow Weaver said. "Just a moment."

Shadow Weaver left the kitchen and went to look for her camera. She looked for it from the cellar for a while until she found it. Through her years she had collected lots of different stuff and one of them was an old school camera. Even if it wasn't the newest, it could still take beautiful pictures. She set the camera in the living room in front of the couch. "Okay Catra, it's ready."

Catra came from the kitchen and jumped on the couch. "Do you need to take the picture?"

"No, I can use a little bit of magic." Shadow Weaver answered.

She sat next to Catra. "Do you want to sit next to me or be on my lap?"

"I'll sit next to you."

"Okay then, now look at the camera."

They both looked at the camera and Shadow Weaver dug out her best smile she could, while Catra had a natural joyful smile. She snapped the picture with a snap of her fingers.

"Done." Shadow Weaver said and went to take the picture. "Wanna see it?"

"Of Course I do." Catra exclaimed.

Shadow Weaver then handed the picture to Catra and it was perfect. They both looked happy on it, something Shadow Weaver herself couldn't believe.

"It's a perfect picture." Catra said. "You don't even look as grumpy as you always look."

Shadow Weaver let out a small chuckle, this was probably the happiest she has ever been.

Chapter End Notes

Next chapter is a time skip to Season 1 of She-Ra. I've now done with Catra's and Shadow Weaver's past, if you can call it that.

I'm going to introduce the best friend squad in the next chapter.

Also have you noticed that Shadow Weaver has not apologized properly during this whole story?

Best Friend Squad

Chapter Summary

> Catra has grown into well endoved teen and now her life is on the turning point when she encounters three best friends in a trouble.
>
> What kind of trouble they are in and what are they even doing in Whispering Woods?

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Several years have passed and Catra has grown into a well endowed teen. Her future life looks bright, unlike Shadow Weaver's.

Spell of Obtainment has taken a huge toll on Shadow Weaver's life, her health is deteriorating and her scars have multiplied, grown bigger and dug deeper into her flesh.

Their roles have almost been totally reversed. Now Catra is looking after her, while Shadow Weaver has become quite passive.

"Tea is ready, Shadow Weaver." Catra yelled from the kitchen.

Shadow Weaver was reading a book on the couch in the living room. "Great, I'll be there soon."

"I'm going outside." Catra said. "I want to do some exercise."

"Absolutely you should, just remember to be careful. Whispering Woods have grown more treacherous than before."

"I'll remember, see you later." Catra said and exited the house.

Shadow Weaver sighed and laid the book on the table. "She's so full of energy."

She then went into the kitchen and poured herself the tea.

Catra was jumping from tree branch to tree branch, until loud noises caught her attention.

"Aaaaah, Bow do something!" Glimmer yelled.

"What, what should I do?" Bow yelled in panic.

"I don't, maybe shoot it with your **bow!**"

"Don't worry, I've got this!" Adora stated confidently. She was about to turn into She-Ra but the creature ripped the sword from her hands before she could transform. The horrid creature swallowed the sword.

"Aw c'mon!" Adora yelled.

"Too late, we'll get the sword back later!" Glimmer said and grabbed Bow and Adora by hand and teleported away.

They didn't teleport far but, still far enough to get a breather.

Catra observed them from the treetop, deding now was the best time to interfere. She jumped down from the tree and landed softly. "Hello there." She said,

Catra startled the best friend squad.

"Who are you? What do you want?!" Glimmer yelled, raising her staff against Catra.

Bow pulled her bow out and readied it. "Are you friend or foe?"

Adora just raised her fists since she had lost the sword. "We're ready!"

"Whoa, whoa. Easy there." Catra raised her arms up trying to calm them. "I'm not going to cause you any trouble, but if I'm not wrong. You guys are in trouble."

"How do you know?" Glimmer asked, still in a defensive pose. While Bow and Adora had lowered their guard by now.

"I've been observing." Catra claimed. "Your magic is impressive, you don't even have to draw sigils to teleport."

"Are you a sorcerer?" Glimmer asked.

"Nope, I'm not. Though I know one."

"If you were observing us, why didn't you interfere sooner?" Bow asked.

"Lots of questions I see." Catra answered.

Before they could continue any further, they were interrupted by the monster's roar. It had gained on them and was now on route to finish them off.

"No time for questions, follow me." Catra said and started to run. She looked back and saw they weren't following her. "Do you want to live or not?"

Best friend squad looked at each other and nodded in agreement. "We'll follow you, but if this is a trap. My mother will come after you." Glimmer tried to sound as intimidating as she could.

"Don't make things worse." Bow added.

They then ran after Catra.

"By the way, name Catra." She said while running.

"Are we introducing ourselves in a situation like this?" Bow asked.

"Just making sure you all are with me." Catra said, smirking.

Monster was gaining on them, they could see and hear the trees fall and branches cracking.

Their panic grew stronger, except Catra. She was used to this kind of situation.

"Ahhh, ummm... What's your plan?" Adora asked.

"You'll see soon." Catra said. "You guys just gotta keep running. It will pay off."

As they ran, a familiar sight was before Catra. It was her home. "Okay, we are getting there. Can you see that house inside of the tree?"

"Yes, but how is it going to help us?" Glimmer asked.

"I live there, trust me." Catra said.

Shadow Weaver was napping on the living room couch but she was awakened by loud rumbling outside. "Argh, what kind of trouble has she gotten herself now.." She gnarled to herself and forced herself up from the couch.

As she was about to check the situation, the front door flung open and Catra jumped in elegantly while the three friends tumbled on the floor.

"Catra, what's the meaning of this?" Shadow Weaver asked, surprised.

"These three need a little help, it seems they had angered the guardian." Catra answered nonchalantly.

"I see..." Shadow Weaver stated. "I'll see if I can do something.

She then stepped outside and approached the guardian. "**I thought I had made myself clear last time we met?!**" Shadow Weaver raised her voice and it sounded like thunder.

The Guardian stopped in its place and stood silently. Adora and her friends looked at the situation with amazed looks on their faces. Catra had a satisfied look on her face, maybe she wanted to flex or something.

"**Leave, before I burn you to crisp!**"

The Guardian understood her quite well. Shadow Weaver had an incendiary spell ready. The Guardian went away and it sounded like it was whimpering.

Shadow Weaver turned to look at her unexpected guests. "Well, do you mind explaining to me why you are here?"

Adora, Bow and Glimmer all sat on the couch as Shadow Weaver served them tea. They had hesitant looks on their faces as they inspected the tea mugs.

"Don't be afraid, it's not poisonous. "Shadow Weaver said jokingly. "I'm not that kind of a witch."

"Yeah, you can drink them without any fear. Trust me." Catra added.

"Aright but, if these are poisoned. There will be serious consequences." Glimmer said threateningly.

"Maybe ease a little bit, Glimmer." Bow added.

"Yeah, don't give her reasons to dispose of us." Adora said jokingly.

"I can still hear you." Shadow Weaver added. "Important thing is, what are you doing here?"

"Actually, we were on our way to meet Madam Razz but we got lost and somehow disturbed that monster." Bow explained.

"Alright, you can rest here for a while and leave when you feel like it." Shadow Weaver said.

She could then feel the Spell of Obtainment grow stronger. She lost her balance and had to lean against the wall. She was breathing heavily and her whole body was shaking.

" *Can't you sense that power from those two girls? They possess power that is unheard of.* "

"Oh, fuck off! Of course I can sense it, get lost." Shadow Weaver growled, gritting her teeth and keeping her voice down.

"Catra, I must go upstairs. Keep them company or whatever you youngsters do." Shadow Weaver said and tumbled herself to upstairs.

They could hear the door slam shut and then it was quiet.

"What was that all about?" Bow asked.

"She's old but it's fine. Nothing to worry about." Catra lied, she didn't want to tell them about Shadow Weaver's real condition. "So what can I do for you?"

"I lost my sword." Adora said. "And I need it back. It's really important."

"Okay, we'll get it back." Catra said. "Where is it?"

"Inside of the belly of that monster." Glimmer said and finished her tea.

"Well that makes it more complicated but, no worries. I have something figured out." Catra said and went to Shadow Weaver's potion cabinet. She picked up an incendiary potion. "This should do it."

"What is that?" Adora asked.

"Highly flammable potion that will burn everything to crisps." Catra answered with a wild grin on her face.

"Is it okay to take that?" Bow asked with a concerned look on his face. "Wouldn't she get mad if she found out you had stolen it from her?"

Catra turned to look at Bow with a dismissive look. "Who hurt you?"

"Yeah, you worry too much." Glimmer added.

"But still, shouldn't you at least ask her permission?"

"She'll understand and if we bother her now... it wouldn't be a great idea." Catra said. "With this we can take care of the guardian easily."

"I like your planning." Glimmer exclaimed.

"I know, Shadow Weaver has called me a genius many times." Catra said.

"Did you just say Shadow Weaver?!" Glimmer yelled.

"Yeah, what about it?"

"She is a wanted criminal! She's responsible for my dad's death and her betrayal of Mystacor!" Glimmer yelled.

"She's a really dangerous woman, Catra. We need to go now." Bow said.

"Dangerous? Catra asked. "Hardly, unless you piss her off..."

"We are going to get that sword back, we need it." Adora said.

"We'll continue this talk after we get that sword." Glimmer said.

And so they hurried outside and went to retrieve the sword.

Catra showed them the way to the cave where the guardian resided. "Okay, this is where it resides, gotta be careful. We don't want to wake it up too early."

"I have goggles that help you see in the dark." Bow said.

"I can see perfectly in the dark but you guys might need those." Catra said. "Be quiet and move slowly, until we locate the guardian."

They sneaked deeper into the cave while Catra led the way. Gush of warm wind blew from the depths of the cave and they could hear snoring.

"We are getting close, now be extra careful." Catra said, almost whispering.

They approached the guardian who was sleeping. Snoring got louder and the wind grew stronger. Foul smell filled the air, all those corpses rotting inside of the guardian must be the cause of it.

"So, how are we going to get that potion of yours inside of it?" Glimmer asked.

"Simple, someone sneaks closer and throws it when it opens its mouth." Catra said and took the potion out of her bag. "So, who wants to do it?"

"I will." Adora answered. "It's my sword after all."

"Good. Take this and get closer and don't worry I have your back." Catra said and tossed the potion to Adora.

Adora catched it but almost dropped it by accident. They sighed from relief besides Catra who found this amusing. 'Wouldn't it be safer to just give it to me?' Adora asked.

"Yeah, I don't want to burn alive." Bow added.

"Yes, but this way it was more exciting." Catra said laughing.

They had forgotten to be silent, so they awakened the guardian. Loud growling interrupted them.

"Oh shit... we woke up." Catra said and took a deep breath. "Run!"

"Great plan!" Glimmer yelled.

"This is where the fun begins." Catra said and she was filled with adrenaline.

She started to climb up the cave walls and from there jumped onto the guardian's head. "I'll distract it, make sure you throw it in when it opens its mouth!" Catra yelled and dug her claws into the guardian. She tried to control its movements but it wasn't easy at all.

Bow tried to shoot it with his arrows but they didn't do anything. "Why did I even think a bow was a good weapon!"

Glimmer teleported Bow into a safe distance and Catra succeeded in leading the guardian towards Adora.

The Guardian opened its mouth and was ready to eat Adora. Fortunately Adora realized this was the exact moment and she threw the potion bottle into the guardian's mouth.

Adora quickly evaded the guardian as Catra jumped off of its head leading it towards the cave floor. Catra picked Adora up from the ground and they started running.

"Great job, soon we'll get some guardian cuisine." Catra said jokingly.

"Glimmer, whenever it's a good time. Get us out!" Adora said.

Glimmer arrived at the great time and teleported all of them behind a large rock.

"Cover your ears." Catra said.

-BOOM-

Loud explosion echoed through the cave and the guardian bursted in flames. After that the cave smelled like burnt flesh.

"Woohoo! That was awesome!" Catra yelled excited.

"There must have been safer ways to do it." Bow said. His ears were still ringing from the explosion.

"Catra, I take everything back. That was so cool!" Glimmer exclaimed.

"But is my sword okay?" Adora asked. "It wouldn't get destroyed, right?

"It's fine, the problem will be trying to find it here." Catra said and wiped dust off from her shoulder.

They searched the sword for half an hour, until Adora finally found it covered in whatever the guardian's coaled body was made of. "Found it!" She exclaimed.

After successfully retrieving the sword they headed out from the cave.

They sat on the log near the lake in the woods, to rest and go through some things.

"I don't think we have properly introduced ourselves." Catra said.

"We can do it now." Glimmer said. "I'm Glimmer, princess of the moonstone."

"I'm Bow, you could say I'm the tech guy."

"And I'm Adora, also known as She-Ra."

"Catra. Nice to meet you."

It didn't even cross Catra's mind that she had just met the warrior princess she was told about and in whom her kin seemed to have worshiped.

"You know, our rebellion could use someone like you." Glimmer said. You clearly have a lot of skills and can improvise on the spot. Kinda like we do sometimes."

"We improvise almost every time." Bow added.

"Thanks for the offer, but I'm not sure if it's a good idea." Catra said and rubbed the back of her head.

"Why? Because of your connection to Shadow Weaver?" Glimmer asked. "No need to worry about it, we can surely come up with something."

"Yeah, like Shadow Weaver kidnapped you and held you against your will. Queen Angella would surely understand." Bow said.

This snapped Catra, she remembered how Angella called Shadow Weaver a rotting corpse and blamed her husband's death on her while she had no idea what actually was going on. "No! No shit excuses like that!" Catra lashed out. "There are reasons why I wouldn't want to join."

"Catra?" Adora asked. "Something wrong?"

Catra chuckled. "Yes and no. Listen, I will offer you my help, because I want to do something for Etheria. But keep Shadow Weaver out of it. Okay?"

"If you don't." Glimmer said. Bow and Adora nodded in agreement.

"I'll just inform her that I'll be joining the rebellion." Catra said and sighed in deep.

"You don't have to, we aren't going to force you." Adora said.

"It's not that. I've been living here for a long time and I want to do something." Carta signed. "Last time when I was at the rebellion. Things didn't end too well."

"Wait, you were in the rebellion?" Glimmer asked. "How have I never heard or seen you?"

"It was during a time when Micah was king of Brightmoon." Catra said.

"You have to be almost as young as I was. How did you even end up there?"

"It's a long story, I can explain it later."

They arrived at Shadow Weaver's house and she herself was now outside, gardening in the front yard. She could see Catra and presumably her friends coming.

Shadow Weaver walked up to Catra. "You stole my incendiary potion."

"You noticed?" Catra asked awkwardly and avoided eye contact.

Shadow Weaver nodded. "At least you are fine, so I won't question you about it."

"Shadow Weaver?" Catra asked.

"Yes?"

"I was considering joining the rebellion." Catra said and closed her eyes. She expected Shadow Weaver to be angry, but she wasn't

"So you want to join them?" She asked and looked at the three friends. She also noticed that the blonde girl now had a mysterious sword on her back and it seemed oddly familiar. "I don't see an issue."

Catra opened her eyes. "You don't? Even for our past?"

"Nope." Shadow Weaver answered and walked towards tve best friend squad. She inspected all of them with her piercing eyes and could once again sense great power around them.

Adora, Bow and Glimmer all looked at each other, feeling kind of threatened by Shadow Weaver's presence. "Promise me that you will take good care of her."

"We will." Adora said.

"She can get quite a handful at times, so do keep that in mind."

"Hey! I heard you!" Catra yelled, pretending to be offended.

Shadow Weaver took one last look at Glimmer and noticed that she had something familiar about her. "You don't happen to be a royalty, do you?"

"I am. I am the daughter of King Micah and Queen Angella." Glimmer said.

Shadow Weaver was shocked, no wonder she was so familiar. She has lots of characteristics of Micah. She faked that she wasn't surprised about it and acted calm. "I assume your mother doesn't hold me in high regard."

"No, she doesn't." Glimmer said.

"Knew it." Shadow Weaver said and walked back to her garden. "Be careful Catra."

"Don't worry." Catra said confidently. "There is no trouble I wouldn't get out of."

"And we can bring her here, from time to time." Glimmer said. "If she so wishes."

"That's lovely. Shadow Weaver said. "You clearly took a lot of after your father."

"Yes, indeed. Even if I only knew him for a short period." Glimmer said.

"I think we have wasted enough time." Bow said. "It seems Angella is worried about not hearing about us.'

"She always is." Glimmer said. Anyways, we're going now and we promise to take care of Catra."

"Wait." Shadow Weaver said and took small bracelet from her pocket, it had turquoise crystal on it. She approached Catra and gave her it. "Put it on your wrist."

"What is it?" Catra asked as she put it on.

"I'ts a bracelet that can be used to communicate, as long as it's on your wrist." Shadow Weaver explained and showed her left hand. Where she had one as well. "Someone might say its a waste of an precious stone but, for me it's not."

"Wow, that's so cool." Catra said.

Shadow Weaver nodded. "With just an one click, we can talk to each others. Even if both us were at far side of the world."

Catra gave Shadow Weaver one last hug before they left. Glimmer teleported all of them in an instant. Not even needing to draw the sigils.

"Micah, your daughter is a strong one." Shadow Weaver said to herself, hoping that maybe Micah could hear it somehow.

" *She has great power, why did you let her go? You should have drained her and that blonde. She's clearly stronger than anything in this world.* " Entity talked to her.

"Shut up, I'm gardening now."

" *But MAGIC, MAGIC, Power.. power.. power.* "

I'm gardening, come haunt me in my nightmares. I wan't to enjoy this one thing that I like in this torture."

" *It wouldn't be torture, if you would just embrace me. You are making me suffer by not embracing me!* "

"It goes for both of us, deal with it!"

Chapter End Notes

> Now we arrived at the season 1. Im not covering all of it. My main focus will be the princess prom and setting up catradora, while introducing new villain besides the Horde and Darkith.
>
> Im also going go start setting up Shadow Weaver/Castaspella when she learns Shadow Weaver lives alone at the Whispering Woods.
>
> Thats what is coming next. It will also mean more tags coming along the way.

New Rebellion member

Chapter Summary

> Catra officially joins the rebellion as its newest member and they are heading on a mission to recruit more princesses to their alliance.
>
> Meanwhile Darkith is getting desperate as she has now lost the most valuable weapon Horde had.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra and the Best Friend Squad arrived at the Brightmoon. They were going to introduce their newest member for the New Princess Alliance.

"Gillmer, I was so worried about you." Angella said and ran to hug her.

"Mom, stop it. I'm not little anymore." Glimmer exclaimed, squiggling in her mom's hug.

"Why didn't you answer my calls?"

"We got in a little bit of trouble. Your highness." Bow said.

"Yeah and we got new member as well." Glimmer said. "Come forward."

Catra came in from the door with Adora. Angella could recognize her. She was the same girl she had seen years ago, during the old alliance. She had grown a lot. "Catra, was it?" She asked.

"That's right, your highness." Catra answered and bowed before her.

"You have grown a lot since we last saw each other." Angella said.

"And I have matured a lot since then." Catra said, humbling herself. She didn't want to give Angella any reasons to question her.

"I can see that. What is your reason to join the rebellion then?"

"I have faced Hordes destruction personally, so I want to make sure others won't have to face it." Catra said. I want to help Etheria as best as I can."

"Very well, I'll accept your allegiance to the Rebellion and the New Princess Alliance." Angella said. "You can rise now."

Catra did as she was told to, Shadow Weaver's lectures about manners had paid off quite well.

"I believe my daughter and her friends can show you places and get you to meet other princesses."

"Sure can do." Glimmer exclaimed. "C'mon, follow me!" And she dragged Catra with her.

"See you later, your highness." Bow said and ran after them.

Adora only bowed down and went after them.

Angella sighed in deep as she was alone at the throne room, once again. " *Oh Micah. How I wish you were here.* "

Meanwhile at the Frightzone. Inside of Hordaks throne room, Darkith was once again under Hordaks complaints.

"Why are you so obsessed with one deserter!?" Hordak growled. "You are neglecting your duties and orders!"

"But Lord Hordak, she possesses strength beyond measure. She is threat to the Horde. She knows how we operate and has been wrecking our plans after another." Darkith pleaded.

"If you weren't so incompotent, maybe you could have stopped it!"

Darkith was about to blow up. She's had enough of Hordaks bullshit, but she doesn't want to lose her head, yet. "Lord Hordak, you have to understand, it's necessary to get her back. You don't want to lose everything, because of her. Right?"

"I've had enough of your incompetence and lack of disipcline. Focus on the duties I give you, or face the consequences of neglecting them." Hordak said. "Do you understand?"

Darkith gritted her teeths. "Yes, Lord Hordak."

"Good and to keep on your word, I'll assign Force Captain Scratch to keep an eye on you." Hordak said and the new Force Captain entered the throne room.

Scratch was a girl, near the same age as Adora. With a long and spikey hair. She had two goat horns, which one of them was missing. She also had three scratch marks on her left eye. Earning her the name "Scratch".

"What!?" Darkith exclaimed. "When did that brat become a Force Captain?!"

"Surprised?" Scratch asked, smirking. "Lord Hordak sees how valuable I am, unlike you."

"There's a lot of reasons why.." Darkith said, gritting her teeth. She was infuriated by this whole situation.

"Scratch! Behave and stop your bickering!" Hordak ordered. "Do as I tell and you'll be well rewarded."

"Yes, Lord Hordak."

"Good." Hordak said and turned to look at Darkith who was still on her knees. "Are we on the same page?"

"Yes... Lord Hordak..."

"You are dismissed."

At Brightmoon Glimmer was giving a tour for Catra and introducing her to other members of Princess Alliance. At the moment they only had Netossa, Spinnerella and Perfuma, they were going to recruit more.

"Aaaand here is my room." Glimmer said as she teleported her and Catra. "And there's your room." She said and pointed towards two large doors.

"Wait, I'm getting my own room?" Catra asked.

"Of course, since you will spend most of your time here." Glimmer said. "But, do you mind sharing a room?"

"No I don't mind but, then it wouldn't count as my own room." Catra said.

Glimmer teleported them into her room and it was large. Larger than Shadow Weaver's whole house.

"See, it's big. There's plenty of room." Glimmer said.

"So it would seem." Catra said with an amazed look on her face. "So, whose is the one I'm sharing this room with?"

"Adora of course, this was given to her but, since you arrived so quick. We decided that you two can share a room." Glimmer said.

"Sure, I'm okay with that."

"Great, now to the war room!" Glimmer said and teleported them there.

Later that day, after introductions and home tours, Catra was free to roam as she pleased. She of course went to the room given to her. To have a closer look at it.

It was a large room, high ceiling, tall windows, two overly sized beds and even a fountain. "This seems like an overkill." Catra said to herself.

"Yeah, it's quite grand." Adora said as she arrived. "But you'll get use to it."

"So we are going to be roommates." Catra said and looked at Adora. "Looking forward to working with you."

"As well as I." Adora said and extended her arm towards Catra and they shook hands.

And during that hand shake, something changed in Catra. She could feel her heartbeat fasten, pupils dilating and her face turned red.

"Catra, everything alright?" Adora asked concerned. "You look nervous."

Catra shook her head. "It's nothing serious. Just me being a magicat." She said.

"Being a magicat? I have never heard about them." Adora said.

"Well it might be because there isn't any left. I might be the only one." Catra said with a somber tone. "Only thing close to family for me is Shadow Weaver... even if she's unstable some times."

"I'm sorry for your loss." Adora said comforting Catra. "Have you ever felt threatened by Shadow Weaver? Since I have heard quite a lot about her and it's not been good."

"No, I have not." Catra answered. "Because I've always been able to calm her. I've sensed many times that she's about to do something horrible or she's having mental breakdowns, but I've been able to stop her and bring her back to reality. Being a magicat is a real burner."

Catra sighed in deep.

"I can understand very well... being She-Ra hasn't been easy for me either." Adora said and sighed. "Sometimes I wish I could stop being She-Ra and someone else would be her."

"You know, I can sense that you have a lot of stress, anxiety and regret." Catra said, as put hand on Adora's shoulder and it soon turned into a hug.

Adora could feel her mind calming down and her anxiety going away, for now.

"Wow, how do you do it?"

"I'm not quite sure, it's just my properties." Catra said, shrugging her shoulders.

"Would you mind if I would ask for your help, when I'm going out of control or something like that?"

"Of course, I want to help as much as I can." Catra answered.

Then Glimmer teleported there. "Heyyyy you two!" She exclaimed. "I've been looking for you two."

"What for?" Catra asked.

"We are going to Salinea, princess Mermista's kingdom. We are going to recruit her."

"But that place is full of water." Catra said and could feel a chill in her spine.

"Of course, its aquatic kingdom." Glimmer said.

"But I don't like water. You should know that."

"You'll be just fine, I know a great captain. Who also happens to know Mermista." Glimmer said. "I mean, what could go wrong?"

"Umm, like everything." Catra said with serious tone

"Don't worry Catra, I'll save you if something goes wrong." Adora assured her.

Catra slapped her hand on her face. " *I signed up for something I shouldn't have had to..* " Catra thought to herself.

Back at the Fright Zone, Darkith was in her chambers. She was still trying to locate Adora, even if she went against direct orders.

"Come on! Where is she? Does she have something that helps her hide her presence?"

"I see you are still after her." Scratch said as she stepped inside of Darkith's chambers. "Didn't Lord Hordak just forbid you from doing this?"

"Your brattiness knows no bounds." Darkith muttered. "If you don't have anything important, then leave! Or I'll do it myself!"

Then her location spell worked and Darkith was joyful, finally something good. "She's going to Salineas..."

"So, what are you going to do? You can't leave because you have other work to do." Scratch reminded Darkith.

"I'm not going.. but this would be a great chance to bring down the Sea Gate protecting Salenias and bring Adora back here."

"Whatever, listen.. I don't know what kind of crazy shit you have stuck yourself in and quite frankly I don't care but, I can let your obsession slide on one condition."

"And that condition is?" Darkith asked.

"You allow me to lead the attack." Scratch said, smirking. "Without supervision."

Darkith narrowed her eyes and with a spiteful tone she said. "Arrgh.. Fine!... just don't screw it up then."

"Good, you can stay here and do whatever you old hags do, meanwhile I'll be bathing on glory!" Scratch said and left the chambers grin on her face.

Darkith growled and accidentally unleashed some of her magic, breaking the lights and electronics in her chambers. Leaving her in

the darkness.

" *One day that prick will get what's coming to her... be it by my hand or someone else's.* " She muttered.

Catra, Adora, Bow and Glimmer were on a ship captained by Sea Hawk. They were heading to Salneas. Catra had climbed on the ship's mid mast and dug her claws into it. She was not moving and was scared for her life.

Every time the ship rocked in the way or another she yelled that they were going to die.

"Argh, Don't do that! Don't rock the ship!" Catra yelled. This was biggest mistake I ever made!"

"Relax Catra, nothing is going to happen." Adora tried to assure her.

"Yeah and the Sea Hawk is an excellent captain." Bow added. "Right, Sea Hawk?"

"I am the best you'll ever find!" Sea Hawk exclaimed.

"Somehow I doubt that!" Catra yelled from the mast.

"If you don't believe me, I can sing a song about it." Sea Hawk offered.

"No! No singing! We are on an important mission." Glimmer interrupted. "We gotta focus."

Sea Hawk nodded in agreement but had a sad look on his face.

Suddenly few larger than normal waves hit the ship, causing it to rock harder.

"This is the worst! Why did I ever get on board?"

"Catra, close your eyes and think of something nice. It's going to be fine." Glimmer said. "Besides we are soon there."

They continued their sailing and arrived safely to Salineas. They passed through the Sea Gate and entered into Mermista's kingdom.

But something was off, it was empty. There was no one to be seen anywhere. They anchored their ship on the dock and went to investigate.

"This place gives me the creeps." Catra said. "Why did I sign up for this?"

"It's too late to regret that decision now." Adora said.

They walked towards the main building and they were confronted by a guard. "Halt, what business do you have here?"

"Umm, we came to meet princess Mermista. We need to talk to her." Glimmer said.

"And tell her that Sea Hawk is with them, she'll be excited to see me." Sea Hawk added.

They were escorted to the throne room where Mermista was, she was tired and exhausted. Her kingdom was falling apart and she certainly wasn't excited to see Sea Hawk back. "Argh.. who let him back in here?"

"Oh, princess. It's been too long, I have been dreaming of you night and day since we parted." Sea Hawk said.

"Mhhmmm.. guard, please escort him out." Mermista said ignoring him and the guard did so. "And who are you guys?"

"My name is Glimmer and I'm from Brightmoon. We don't know each other, but our parents used to fight together in the rebellion." Glimmer answered.

"Oooh yeah... My dad told me about it and it was total disaster..." Mermista said dismissively. "Anyways, what do you want?"

"Well we came here to recruit you, since we are rebuilding the Princess Alliance." Glimmer said. "We can't fight the Horde alone but, together we might have a chance to stop them."

"Because it worked so well before and why should I help? I already have my hands full with problems."

"What kind of problems?" Bow asked.

"Well the Sea Gate is falling apart, Horde keeps attacking and everyone has fled. I have no idea how to even fix the SeaGate."

"Wait! The Sea Gate is failing? How?" Glimmer asked.

"I don't know." Mermista said and sighed. "Who could have guessed that I would inherit a crumbling kingdom."

Catra didn't say anything, she felt kind of a outsider here. So she just looked around the room. There was engravings on the wall that seemed to describe the Sea Gate and how it worked. It peaked Adora's interest as well as Catra's. Adora touched the wall and recognized it as First Ones language. "They must have built the gate." She said. "Sea Gate gets its power from the Salenias runestone."

"You can read it?" Catra asked.

"Yes, yes I can." Adora answered.

Something on these markings felt familiar to Catra. "I'm sure I've also seen similar markings."

Mermista looked at Adora and Catra. "And who are those?"

"Blonde one is Adora, she has a magic sword." Bow said. "And the other is Catra... a.. cat."

Glimmer ran towards Adora. "Can you read that, what does it say?"

"Yes, it tells how the gate works."

"Can you fix it?" Glimmer asked.

"I can try."

"Good." Glimmer said and went back to Mermista. "Listen, you need our help and we need your help. So if we help you fix the gate, you join the alliance with us."

"Uhhh... Fine... I guess..." She answered.

They were now standing on a cliff near the Sea Gate and looking at its deteoriting state. "I hope you know what you are doing." Mermista said.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" Adora yelled and she transformed into She-Ra. She pointed sword towards the gate and the runestone in her sword activated. It shot an energy beam towards the gate and it seems to revitalize it but, it seems to be a slow process.

"This might take a while." Glimmer said and she looked down at the docks.

Sea Hawk was leaving. "Uhh, hang in there for a while." Glimmer said and teleported to Sea Hawk.

When things were looking good, a Horde ship arrived from the horizon. It shot a large energy beam that blew a large hole into the gate.

"Oh no, it's the Horde!" Bow said. "Quick we need to stop that ship!"

Meanwhile on the Horde ship. "Good shot Kyle, can't believe you actually did something useful." Scratch remarked. She looked through the telescope and saw Adora on the top of the cliff.

"Steady as she goes and keeps blasting that gate, I have other matters to tend."

Adora was now on a really bad spot, she couldn't move away to help her friends. Scratch took advantage of this.

While other members of the rebellion were busy fighting the Horde ship, Scratch climbed up the cliff effortlessly. "Hello there." She said as she was right behind Adora. "You really think that's going to help? You're pathetic."

"What are you trying to get at? Insult me to death?" Adora snarked back.

"Ohh no, no no. I'm here to deliver you back to Horde. You see, Darkith is really desperate and it gets on my nerves." Scratch said and grabbed Adora's hand forcefully. "It's nothing personal."

Then Scratch drew her sword and was ready to strike Adora. "Darkith said I need to deliver you to her alive but she didn't say I need to deliver you unharmed." She had a sadistic grin on her face and enjoyed the fear Adora was going through.

She punched Adora in the gut and it threw her off from her standing, now she was kneeling before her. Adora was breathing heavily and she could feel herself weakening. "Why... Why do you do this?"

"Because it's fun!" Scratch remarked. "Anyways, this has been going on for too long."

Catra saw that Adora was in real trouble, so she decided to do what she could to save her nee friend. The clothes Shadow Weaver had given her were not ideal in combat so she ripped the dress and the sleeves to move more freely.

She was racing on top of the cliff to save Adora.

Scratch readied her sword once again and when she was about to strike she could hear someone rushing towards her.

"Adora!" Catra yelled as she rushed towards her.

Catra jumped over Adora and clawed on to Scratch's sword and ripped it from her hands.

"Now what kind of insolence are you?" Scratch asked, clearly annoyed that someone dared to ruin her fun.

"Name's Catra." She answered. "And you will soon wish you had never come here."

"Big talk for a small cat like you but, you have some guts. I'll give you that." Scratch said. "Unfortunately, having only guts wont get you far." She rolled and picked her sword from the ground.

Catra looked at Adora and smiled. "Finish the gate Adora, I'll protect you."

Adora nodded and stood up. "I'll leave it to you."

"Good."

Scratch and Catra then proceeded to duel while Adora continued fixing the gate.

Scratch was skilled with a sword but couldn't keep up with Catra's movements. She was way too agile for her.

"Stop avoiding and fight me!" Scratch yelled as she swung the sword.

"You can't be serious.. sounds like a skill issue to me." Catra remarked slyly as she evaded the swings.

Catra got a chance to grab her sword again and this time she threw it off the cliff. She then grabbed Scratch from her goat horn and dragged her closer to the edge of the cliff.

"Looks like you lost." Catra said and grinned.

"What are you going to do? Drop me? You princesses are too soft for that." Scratch snarked.

"Well it's a good thing I'm not a princess then." Catra said and let go of Scratch, leaving her to fall into the ocean.

Adora had finally gotten the gate fixed and the Horde ship was destroyed by Sea Hawk crashing onto it with his own ship, while it was on fire.

"We can't take more damage, we need to retreat!" Lonnie yelled and threw life belt overboard for Scratch to grab on. They tied a life belt with a rope on the ship's rail and sailed off. Scratch was hanging on and cursing in her mind.

Salineas was saved, Sea Gate fixed and the prince's alliance got a one more new member.

When they arrived back at Brightmoon everyone was exhausted and tired. Now they could relax and sleep well over the night.

Catra was alone in her room, Adora had not come yet. She decided to contact Shadow Weaver and tell her what had happened today.

Shadow Weaver was reading a book on her bed when she could feel her bracelet vibrate. "Catra." She said and pressed the stone on her bracelet.

It projected a portrait of Catra. "Is everything alright?" She asked.

-Everything is alright- Catra said. -I just wanted to tell you how wild this day was.-

"I'm eager to hear, I also assume everything went well with Queen Angella?"

-Everything went fine, all thanks to those boring lectures of yours about good manners.-

Shadow Weaver chuckled. "I told you it was useful."

Chapter End Notes

> This chapter was different from other chapters as you could see.

Hope you liked this chapter. Even if Shadow Weaver who is the main protaginist in this story got sidelined pretty hard. Then again, Catra is second protagonist and while she is with the rebellion the story will diverge away from Shadow Weaver.

First Ones ruins

Chapter Summary

> While Catra is off with the rebellion Shadow Weaver decides to do some investigations of her own.

It was a sunny morning and Shadow Weaver had gotten used to being alone once again. She made herself some tea and enjoyed the calmness of the early morning.

She had read the books they took from Catra's hometown and she's been studying their content. It seemed that First Ones were also involved with the magicats. Shadow Weaver knew about the first First Ones, but information about them was scarce.

All these thoughts about First Ones meddling with everything bothered her. She wanted answers, but where would she get them?

" *Are you bothering yourself with useless thoughts once more?* " Spell of Obtainmemt said, bringing its ugly head.

"It's not useless, First Ones are key to everything here." Shadow Weaver said.

" *They were a bunch of cowards, who relied upon their technology. They also had imperialistic tendencies just like the Horde.* "

"Are you telling me that you knew them?" Shadow Weaver asked.

" *Of course I knew! I'm part of an interdimensional being and if you think Etheria is the only place with intelligent life. You are wrong.* "

Shadow Weaver couldn't believe what she just heard. "So, you are saying there is life beyond this planet?"

" *Wow, so clever.* " Entity said sarcastically. " *Yes that's right, I come from the universe beyond this pocket dimension you are trapped in. You were not the first person to summon us and you will not be the last one either.* "

"How come you just tell me about it now? Of all the times you've been pain in the ass, now you are giving me information. Just like that."

" *I don't know. I told you too much already, your simple nut sized brains can't handle it. You know what? I'm just going to go back to sleep.* "

"Hey!" Shadow Weaver yelled. "Don't you dare to go now! Of all the times you actually are bearable you just go off on your own accords?"

" *Yes, maybe you start pursuing power once again. I see this as an absolute win.* "

"You are the worst!"

" *Right back at you.* " Entity said and went off.

Seriously, first taunting about useless thoughts, then telling important information and then doesn't care to elaborate further and leaves. "Argh, I guess I'm on my own then."

Shadow Weaver went to pack her backpack, ready to go search for First Ones ruins. She had found an old map in between the pages of the book. Map covered the whole Whispering Woods and there were many locations Shadow Weaver had never seen. She could finally explore this uncharted wild forest.

When she was about to leave, her bracelet started to vibrate. She pressed the stone and it reflected a portrait of Catra. -Hey, Shadow Weaver.-

"Well hello, everything alright?" Shadow Weaver answered.

-Yes, we are actually going to the Dryl. To recruit princess Entrapta.-

"I have never met her but, I heard she's good at technology and with First Ones tech. I can see why they want to recruit her."

-Are you going somewhere? You have a backpack and your staff.-

"I'm going to look for some information, doing some investigations."

-I wish I could be there too...-

"What? Is something wrong?"

-No, everythings fine. It's just that I'd want to be there with you.-

"Would you rather slosh around in the forest with an old hag like me, instead of being with a group of friends of your own age?" Shadow Weaver asked half jokingly.

There was a moment of silence, Catra had to think about what she was about to say. -Yes, I would very much like to.-

Shadow Weaver was puzzled. Why would Catra choose an old hag like her, instead of her friends? "Catra, is there something you aren't telling me?"

-No, I'm not hiding anything. It's just... it's just... Listen, there is nothing wrong. I'm sorry if I worried you.-

Shadow Weaver was doubtful, Catra certainly hid something. It was obviously clear when she saw Catra's face when Adora called her. - *Catra, we're going.* -

-Okay, Shadow Weaver. We're going now. See you later.- Then she closed the call and it was quiet.

Shadow Weaver knew why Catra was acting the way she was. "She's developed feelings for Adora..." Shadow Weaver thought to herself. "Young love.. What an amusing and foolish thing."

During her time as a teacher at Mystacor Shadow Weaver had seen her fair share of young couples and love but she never understood it.

Why would you waste your time for something so trivial when you could study and practice sorcery?

There were always those couples who would skive off from her lectures to make out. Such troublesome youth.

Anyways, she now had something more important on her nose. She had no time to think about horny and awkward teenagers.

At the Fright Zone, Darkith was charging herself in her chambers. She used the Black Garnet to satisfy the needs of her parasite. She needed Adora, she's already on borrowed time.

Her mask cracked and a few small pieces fell on the floor and turned into dust. "No. Not yet! I still have time!"

When she had fed the parasite enough, she could somewhat feel better. She put the amulet back on her neck. The amulet she had held her powers and also kept the parasite in check.

If she would lose it, her life span would shorten tremendously. At this point, maybe she had started to realize that it's not a good idea to make pacts with interdimensional beings.

She needed Adora, because she came from a different dimension and in fact she is the descendant of the First Ones. And only she has power great enough to sustain the parasite inside of her.

But now, she had other worries. It seemed that Scratch had failed at destroying the Sea Gate and capturing Adora.

"You incolence! I knew you would fail at your mission!" Darkith yelled.

"I'm not the one obsessed over one blond toad!" Scratch yelled back.

"That blonde toad is more valuable than this whole trashcan of a planet!" Darkith yelled. "I'm taking you to Hordak and he will punish you for your failure."

"And then I tell him that you went after Adora, even if he ordered you to not."

"It wasn't just about Adora! It was also about the Sea Gate and you failed!"

Scratch gulped. She realized that now she might actually be in trouble. Her smug face turned into a fright.

"Not so smug anymore?" Darkith asked sarcastically. "Maybe you'll learn a thing or two."

But it didn't go as Darkith had planned. Instead of just Scratch, she got punished as well. And they both limped out from the throne room.

"This is all your fault!" Darkith snarked.

"If you hadn't told Hordak, we both could have avoided this." Scratch snarked back.

"Listen here you little shit. Everything would have gone fine if you hadn't played with your food!"

They continued their bickering as they walked the halls of Fright Zone.

Shadow Weaver was walking through the forest, she had traveled for hours now. And the uneven ground and dense vegetation didn't make things any easier. Her dress kept tangling up on every branch possible.

She then seemed to have walked up to the dead end. "It can't be, map shows there's a way going through this." Shadow Weaver said to herself.

" *You dingus! Do you think the First Ones made things easy for you? You truly are clueless.* "

"Well thanks a lot. You are so helpful" Shadow Weaver answered sarcastically.

She then proceeded to investigate the wall that was ahead of her. She could find some of the First Ones writings on it. She took her book about First Ones markings and letters. She began interpreting the writings. The writing described some kind of door that needed a lever or switch to open.

"Hmmm.. then there should be a switch somewhere here.." She said and looked for anything that could have been a lever. She touched the wall in different places, until she found an hole in the wall.

Normally she wouldn't be sticking her hands into dubious places but this was important. What's the worst that can happen anyways.

She stuck her hand in there and could feel something. It was a lever of some sort and she pulled it. Soon after the ground started to shake and Shadow Weaver took a few steps backwards.

Door was opening and soon she had a clear path through it. "Rather simple mechanism for someone who's so advanced." Shadow Weaver thought and walked through it.

Now before opened a clear path that led to something that must have been a city. She was rather excited about this, finally secrets of the First Ones were right on tip of her fingers.

She headed to the old city and was ready to investigate anything and everything, leaving no stone unturned.

She searched through the old houses and they were still in prime condition, being over thousands of years old.

While walking on the streets from house to house, Shadow Weaver noticed weird lines flowing on the ground heading towards the city center. She wasn't exactly sure what they were but, it seemed a lot like other First Ones writing.

Then the Spell of Obtainment emerged once more. " *Hey, can you feel that power?* "

"I hate to confirm it but, yes I do feel it." Shadow Weaver answered. "I guess you want me to investigate it?"

" *Now we're getting on the same page.* " Entity said and this time it emerged from Shadow Weaver. Taking a shadowy form covered with red eyes and long formless hands.

"I didn't know you could do that?" Shadow Weaver asked, puzzled.

"I have been waiting for this moment for so long." Entity said. It was now possible to physically interact with it. Entity wrapped its hands around Shadow Weaver and started to drag her closer to the city center. "It is useless to resist, just submit to me!"

Shadow Weaver couldn't do anything, half of her powers were tied to Spell of Obtainment and now she was weak.

"Don't worry, we'll get power soon. Entity said as they arrived at the city center. There was an obelisk-like structure standing there, covered with First Ones writings.

"What is it?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"It's a device of the First Ones, it will greatly enhance our power."

"Great, what then? Conquering Etheria after it?"

"I sense hard sarcasm." Entity muttered. "It doesn't matter, soon you'll have power."

Then the entity proceeds to break the obelisk, revealing teal runestone.

"Runestone... I thought only princesses had those." Shadow Weaver said.

"This is a lesser one, but it will enhance our powers nonetheless and it will also mean you won't be losing your life force anymore." Entity said and grabbed the runestone.

Shadow Weaver was shocked, she couldn't process what was going on. Entity seemed to have done something. "Here." Entity

said and presented Shadow Weaver with a mask. It was a dark red mask with black lines in the middle of it. Teal runestone was embedded as a crystal onto the forehead.

"Put it on and you will now have a power source strong enough to handle me." Entity said.

Shadow Weaver took the mask and hesitantly put it on. When it was on, she could feel power flow through her. "This feels.. this feels so.. so good!" She exclaimed.

"That's what power does do." Entity said and retracted its physical form and dwelled back inside of Shadow Weaver. " *See how easy it was, if you had listened me before. You wouldn't have had to suffer so much.* "

"Well excuse me but, you were the one actively trying to kill me. So pardon me if I'm not interested in your power trips."

" *Bitch... simple thank you would have been enough.* " Entity said and went away, leaving Shadow Weaver on her own.

Now she had a power source to keep her alive and withstand the side effects of the Spell of Obtainment.

But her hunger for information had not been extinguished yet, she had lots of places to go and lots of reading to do.

Meanwhile best friend squad had quite a handful of situations. All the servant robots of the Dryl had gone haywire, Adora was acting like a drunkard. At least that's what it looked like to Catra. She

had seen Shadow Weaver drunk many times. And all those times she was talking nonsense, wobbling around and bumping into walls.

"Adora, you are like Shadow Weaver, tell me you didn't drink anything?"

"What? Me? Drinking?... Silly cat, I'm totalyy fine.." Adora assured but, it didn't convince anyone. "Heya Catra, did you know that you look cute when you are angry... like a really really angry cat."

"Adora! I'm not angry. I'm worried!" Catra said.

"Then catch me!" Adora yelled and jumped into Catra's palms. Good thing Catra had good reflexes and she caught Adora.

"What do I do with you?" She asked herself and sighed.

"Kiss me! Hehe."

"What?"

"I said kiss me." Adora confirmed.

"No! You are drunk!" Catra said and panicked, what could she do. Then she remembered that Shadow Weaver had given her sleep potions.

She took one from her pocket. "Drink this and you'll be fine."

"I aaaaam fine... you worry too much." Adora said and slapped the potion off from Catra's hands.

"Hey! These are rare." Catra snapped and tried to pick the potion up.

"Watch out! A robot is coming!" Glimmer yelled. She ran towards Catra and Adora and grabbed their hands. She grabbed Entrapta from her hair and teleported them away.

"The potion!" Catra yelled.

"My robots!" Entrapta yelled.

Glimmer sighed as they were now a safe distance away. Adora was still laughing. "Lets doooo it agaiin!"

"Adora, be quiet. Don't invoke more robots here." Catra said, putting hand on Adora's mouth. "Entrapta, we gotta fix this."

"Yeah, yeah... Just follow me." Entrapta said and led them.

Shadow Weaver had collected the most interesting books the First Ones had. These books were about their culture, technology and history. Shadow Weaver valued this kind of information the most. She now possessed more knowledge of the First Ones than anyone on this planet, this made her joyful.

She sat there reading for hours till night started to creep on the sky, it was better to head home. Who knew what kind of creatures would come up here and if there even were something left behind by First Ones.

She drew teleportation sigil on the and teleported back home, she wished Catra would have returned by now so she could share this information with her. But Catra was nowhere to be seen. "I guess she's still away with the rebellion." Shadow Weaver sighed.

She threw her backpack on the couch and went into the kitchen to make herself some tea.

It was now late in the night and she suspected Catra wouldn't come back today. This was rather odd for her, she had never

missed anyone. But now she misses Catra, as annoying and reckless she was. Catra still brought some liveliness to her boring and gray life of misery and regrets.

She sighed once more and put her mug away. Shadow Weaver then headed upstairs and decided to take a shower. Her shower took longer than usual since she was sunken in her thoughts. After she had showered she went to her bedroom and laid on the bed. She had a night lamp on and she stared at the ceiling for a long time.

" *Would you actually care to sleep?* " Entity asked.

"What? Do I bother you?" Shadow Weasked back.

" *You aren't like this usually, what's wrong?* "

"Since when did you care about me? I thought I was just a vessel for you and when you're done with my body you'll hop into the next host."

" *Hey! Professionals have standards. I'm not a jumpy kind of entity, I stick to my host till death us aparts.* "

"Woooow... I'm so relieved.." Shadow Weaver said sarcastically. "So I should be thankful for that?"

" *If you don't want to die, then yes.* " Entity said. " *Listen, I'm not the one who made these rules, I just follow them.* "

"Whatever... I'll try to sleep." Shadow Weaver said and turned the lamp off.

Next morning Shadow Weaver woke up more tired than ever before, she hadn't got any sleep at all and seems she has to use some of her potions to make her less tired. Not healthy in the long run, but what can you do.

She dragged herself downstairs and proceeded to make something really strong. It was not tea she was brewing this morning, it was a strong magical potion. If she made even the smallest mistake, it could turn deadly. She threw in all kinds of herbs and plants to make it as strong as possible.

" *Are you sure this is a good idea? Looks rather sketchy.* " Entity questioned her.

"I know what I'm doing, I didn't spend all that time studying magical plants and drinks for nothing." Shadow Weaver answered and was clearly offended by Spell of Obtainments remark.

" *Whatever, but don't kill us.* "

Shadow Weaver just shook her head dismissively and continued stirring her concoctions. When she was done, she poured the drink into a larger mug. It didn't smell poisonous or acrid. She took a sip and it tasted rather good, her body felt vitalized by the drink and she felt energy flow through her veins. "Mmmm, this is some good stuff."

When she had nourished her drink she went outside and decided to do some gardening, it's a great way to kill some time. As she was gardening she could hear a sparkly teleportation sound. Shadow Weaver turned her head and saw Glimmer with Catra.

"Here as I promised." Glimmer said and presented Catra to Shadow Weaver.

"Catra?" Shadow Weaver asked and stood up, she walked towards Catra and hugged her."Welcome."

Catra was quite puzzled. "It has only been a few days."

"It felt like eternity." Shadow Weaver answered.

Catra had a smirk on her face. "Do you mean that great and stoic Shadow Weaver was missing someone?"

"I think it's better for me to go." Glimmer said. "Still have to look after Adora, so I'll leave you two at it."

Shadow Weaver and Catra stood there for a while, until they went inside. Shadow Weaver showed Catra her new mask that would help her keep the Spell of Obtainment in check. Shadow Weaver proceeded to make them some breakfast. "Are you hungry?" She asked.

"Yeah, what happened at the Dryl was truly an exhausting experience." Catra said.

"I'm interested to hear more about it and that Entrapta." Shadow Weaver said as she set the plates and mugs on the table. After making the breakfast, Shadow Weaver and Catra sat there eating and Catra was explaining to her all the crazy events that had happened at the Princess Entrapta's kingdom.

Going to Mystacor

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver inquires Catra about her feelings towards Adora, which Catra denies and says they are only friends.
>
> Later best friend squad comes to visit and asks Catra to come with them to Mystacor. Shadow Weaver disapproves this, but wont stop Catra.
>
> Darkith projects shadow clone of herself to stalk Adora and tries to convince her to come back to Horde.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Few days had passed since Catra had come back. They were now sitting on the couch in the living room, Shadow Weaver decided to bring up Catra's obvious feelings towards Adora. "Catra, what do you think about Adora?"

"She's a friend.. a good one." Catra answered.

"Are you sure she's just a friend?" Shadow Weaver asked, raising her eyebrow. "How you react to Adora and what you told happened to you two back at the Drill sounds more like a lovestruck couple."

"What? No, no we are just friends. I just took care of Adora because she was clearly not okay."

Shadow Weaver had a smirk on her face. "You don't have to try to hide anything. It's clear as day that you love her."

"We barely know each other! Besides, what do you know about love?" Catra asked. "When you have always been alone."

Shadow Weaver paused for a moment. This was the first time Catra openly questioned her.

Catra realized that she had maybe said too much. "Im so-" Catra was interrupted by Shadow Weaver. "There's nothing to apologize for. I like it when people stand their ground. It shows you have a mind of your own and wont blindly follow others."

"Sooo.. thanks.. I guess.." Catra said with a puzzled look on her face.

"No one has ever loved me except my mother but, it was so long ago that I don't see a point in bringing it up. I've seen other people's love and know when it's true or not." Shadow Weaver said.

"But you haven't been there. How would you know I love Adora?"

"Your body and actions speak louder than your voice." Shadow Weaver answered. "Besides, I have read books about love. As stupid as those books are."

Catra sighed. "It's hard to imagine you reading books about love." She chuckled. "I'd still say I'm really affectionate friend rather than in love with her."

"Stubborn now, are we?" Shadow Weaver asked. "Well we'll see it later."

Meanwhile, the best friend squad was walking in the Whispering Woods. Adora felt like she was being stalked and she was a

nervous wreck.

"Adora, no one is following you." Glimmer assured.

"Yeah, you need rest. Bow added.

"But you guys don't know about her-" Adora said, but she was cut short by Glimmer. "We need to go on holiday."

"Holiday? Glimmer, we are still quite busy." Bow tried to reason.

"No buts, we are going to Mystacor. That place is amazing while we are still here. Let's go ask Catra to come with us."

After Catra was mentioned Adora's face blushed. "But do you think she still cares about me? Last time I was pretty unbearable."

"Of course she cares, she cared about you the whole time you were infected by that virus." Glimmer said. "Come on, lets go!"

As they walked towards Shadow Weaver's house, a shadowy figure watched them behind the trees and vanished. It took them about an hour till they reached Shadow Weaver's house. Glimmer went up to the door and knocked. Shadow Weaver opened the door. "Princess Glimmer and her friends.." She said with a fake friendly tone. "How can I help you?"

"Umm, We were just passing by and thought to pay a visit." Glimmer said awkwardly, she could feel clear disapproval in Shadow Weaver's voice.

Shadow Weaver sighed. "I guess you're free to do so." She said and let them inside.

"So where's Catra?" Bow asked.

"She's upstairs, in her room." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Okay." Glimmer answered and went upstairs.

"Thanks once again Shadow Weaver, for letting us inside." Bow said, bowed and went with the others.

Shadow Weaver chuckled. "He's so polite and well mannered." She then went into the kitchen to make them tea and snacks.

Meanwhile at Catra's room. "Nice to see you all."

"As well."

"So what brings you here?" Catra asked.

"Well we were actually thinking about going to Mystacor, to relax." Glimmer said.

"Mystacor you say?" Catra asked. "I don't know if Shadow Weaver approves it."

"Wait, Shadow Weaver doesn't want to let you go to Mystacor?" Glimmer asked, puzzled. "Why?"

"Well she doesn't have a very good reputation there, I thought you knew that. Also, she can't stand the council members." Catra explained.

"But Glimmers aunt has been the Head-Sorceress there for a quite a while." Bow said. "Things must have changed up quite a lot there."

"It's not the Head-Sorceress that's the problem, it's the council. Or that's what she's told me."

"She might have fabricated things." Glimmer said. "She is considered a traitor by many."

"I don't care about that." Catra said. "I can still ask about it, but don't expect a favorable answer."

"Or, you don't have to tell her that you are going to Mystacor." Glimmer suggested.

"I don't think that's a good idea, Glimmer." Adora said. "Shadow Weaver ain't like your mother."

"Oh please, what's the worst that could happen." Glimmer boasted, but then they heard knocking on the door.

"Catra, I brought you and your friends some snacks." Shadow Weaver said behind the door. "Can I come in?"

"Uhh sure." Catra answered.

Shadow Weaver entered and put the tray on the table. She looked at Catra and her friends and they looked like they had seen a ghost. "What's wrong?"

"Oh nothing, we were just discussing best friend things." Glimmer said awkwardly.

"Alright... Well, I'll be in the garden. So if you need anything, ask Catra." Shadow Weaver said and left the room.

"Phew, that was close." Glimmer said, relieved.

"We almost got caught." Bow said. "I don't think it's a good idea to push this any further."

Catra served them tea and snacks that Shadow Weaver had brought for them. "I can ask the permission from Shadow Weaver, it's better that way than going behind her back."

"I agree." Adora said. "I wouldn't want to anger Shadow Weaver."

Glimmer sighed defeated. "Fine, but if she refuses. What then?"

"Just deal with it." Catra answered. "Sometimes things don't go your way and you have to accept it."

When they had finished the snacks they went downstairs and Catra went to ask permission from Shadow Weaver.

"Shadow Weaver?" Catra asked.

"Yes?"

"I was thinking, that maybe I-" Catra was cut short by Shadow Weaver. "You could go to Mystacor with your friends?"

Catra was puzzled and a little bit frightened. Glimmer facepalmed and thought that now everything was ruined.

"How did you know?" Catra asked.

"I heard your conversation, when I was about to bring the snacks." Shadow Weaver answered calmly. "Listen, I'm not stopping you."

"You're not?"

"Correct. I can not emphasize this enough, be careful there." Shadow Weaver said. "I know Castaspella is different, but she seems to be too kind and gullible. Keep away from the council members and stay close with your friends."

"I will, don't worry." Catra assured. Shadow Weaver sighed with a slight disappointment in her tone. She wouldn't want to let Catra go anywhere near Mystacor, but Catra's life is not hers.

But she would feel responsible if something would happen to Catra, after all your actions have consequences.

She gave Catra a hug. "I'll take your word for it."

Glimmer fist pumped, she was happy that everything went better than expected. Shadow Weaver escorted Catra to her friends and asked. "How long are you going to be there?"

"Day or two at max." Glimmer answered. "Everyone needs holidays from time to time, right?"

"I guess you are right, princess." Shadow Weaver said.

At the Fright Zone, Darkith was spying on Adora and her friends. "Mystacor... this will be easy." She said to herself as Scratch entered.

"You called, Darkith. Another Adora mission?"

"Yes, but this time I'll do it. You keep on watch so no one will interrupt me." Darkith said.

"What?!" Scratch exclaimed. "You need me to just watch the door?"

"Exactly, since you screwed up last time so badly! So I'll do what you can't!"

"You are impossible!"

"And you are incolent!" Darkith yelled. "Now GO!"

Scratch was standing there not going anywhere. She stared at Darkith with a sharp stare. "I SAID GO!!" Darkith yelled and grabbed Scratch from her arm and threw her outside.

"Ouch!" Could be heard outside as Scratch flew on to the wall.

"Hmph, She's going to be death of me." Darkith said to herself and proceeded to cast a spell. She summoned a shadow figure and possessed it so she could control its movement. "You can't keep running forever, Adora."

Adora, Bow, Glimmer and Catra were walking a narrow path that led them to a cliff aobve clouds. "We're here." Glimmer said.

"A cliff?" Adora asked.

"Looks like a pretty long fall as well." Catra added.

"Come on, follow us!" Glimmer said and took Bow's hand. They jumped off the cliff in the clouds.

"So... are we supposed to jump as well?" Catra asked.

"I don't know." Adora answered.

They could hear rumbling and a floating island was coming towards them, on that island stood Glimmer and Bow. "Come on guys, jump." Bow said.

Adora grabbed Catra's hand which made her blush. "Together?" Adora asked, she looked at Catra who was kind of out. "We jump together, right?"

"Uhhh, sure." Catra said and snapped out of her trance.

As they jumped Adora looked down and saw a shadowy figure gliding through the clouds. This frightened her and she was about to lose her balance. "ADORA!" Catra yelled and Adora came back to her senses. At least they didn't fall off.

"Are you alright?" Bow asked with a worried tone.

"Uhhh, yes... I just need rest." Adora answered.

"Good, just hang in there just a little bit longer. We're soon there." Glimmer said assuring.

Catra knew Adora was lying, it was obvious something bothered her and Catra wanted to know what it was.

They soon arrived at the large floating island, Mystacor kingdom of sorceresses. There stood a mighty castle surrounded by many buildings and archways, clear waterfalls swept through the island. It sure looked like an amazing place. Catra and Adora both watched in awe as Glimmer's aunt came running towards them.

"Isn't that my niece, Glimmer." Castaspella said and hugged her.

"Augh, Aunt. Stop it." Glimmer said, trying to get off from her tight hug.

"It's nice to see you Bow." Castaspella said and hugged him as well. She turned to look at the two other newcomers. "And who might they be?"

"This my friend Adora, she can turn into a tall sword lady and this is Catra, a cat." Glimmer explained.

"Ahhh, Catra. It's been a long time!" Castaspella exclaimed with a joyful voice. "If you are here, does it mean Shadow Weaver is as well?"

"Ahh.." Catra was about to answer, but was cut off by Glimmer. "You know Shadow Weaver?"

"Of course I do, is she doing well? Last time we met it didn't end so well."

"Uhh, she's doing fine." Catra answered. "And no, she's not here. She doesn't want to be anywhere near this place."

Castaspella sighed disappointed. "I guessed so... Anyways, welcome to Mystacor. I would be happy to give you a tour."

"Thanks Aunt, but we are here on a diplomatic mission. We are rebuilding the Princess Alliance and we-" Glimmer explained, but was cut off by Castaspella. "Ohh, then you must be hungry. I'll prepare a feast." She said and led them towards the main building. "As I was saying, I could give you a tour around Mystacor."

"No thanks, me and Bow have already seen Mystacor many times." Glimmer said.

"But your friends haven't, it's up to them then. If they want." Castaspella said and looked at Adora and Catra. Glimmer was giving disapproving hand signs, but Adora didn't pay attention.

"Uhh, sure." Adora answered.

"Why not." Catra answered as well.

"Oooo, this is wonderful." Castaspella exclaimed and beamed with joy. "Follow me."

Meanwhile at the Whispering Woods, Shadow Weaver was gardening in her front yard. She usually liked to garden, but this time was different. She didn't feel like gardening and decided to do something else.

She went to read some books and drink tea, but it didn't make her feel any better. It was so quiet, so ordinary, so boring. How can it be that she's so bored, she enjoys being alone, enjoys gardening and reading books.

Now, none of these things satisfied her and she felt like she was stuck on a loop. "Why is everything so boring?!"

" *Maybe you should try to do something different? Like a little bit of conquest? Making others submit?* " Spell of Obtainment spoke to her.

"You know that's out of the question. Everyone hates me enough already, no need to make more enemies." Shadow Weaver said.

" *No one can hate you if you kill them all. You know, modern problems require modern solutions.* "

"You are being unhelpful as always. If you don't have anything worthwhile to say, just shut up."

" *I was just trying to help..* " Entity said and dwelled away.

Shadow Weaver sighed and stood up from the couch. She put her mask on and left the building. "Now I know, I'll go for a walk." And that's what she's going to do.

At least she might see something different during a walk. Catra was not coming back any time soon, so she should be fine.

She didn't have any heading, nor did she have a map. She didn't plan anything, just seeing where her legs would lead her. Pretty much just aimless wandering.

Shadow Weaver walked for hours, enjoying the wild forest scenery. She saw many kinds of animals and birds, some she had never seen before. "What all kinds of things you can see when you stop and look for them." She said to herself.

She kept walking until she arrived on a lake. Its water was crystal clear and you could see many kinds of crystals shining under the water. These things were amazing, Shadow Weaver had never seen or knew these kinds of lakes.

All these things she saw made her want to write an encyclopedia for Whispering Woods. Maybe it will be a success, who knows.

She sat there for a while until she decided to leave and go for another place. She kept walking for a long time and soon she realized she was standing in a familiar place.

Her legs had brought her back to Catra's hometown. Fate or coincidence? She didn't know, but there must be something important to find there if she had unknowingly traveled there.

She walked through the ruined town and walking there made somewhat depressed. This town reminded her of her own town and how she had to be evacuated from there. She and Catra had a lot of things in common.

She arrived at Catra's old home and went inside. There could still be something of value. She searched the building and came across a box.

It was a rather fancy looking box and it had engravings written on it. Shadow Weaver thought that maybe she shouldn't open it, but curiosity got the best of her.

She opened the box and there was an ornament, it resembled a cat's ears and it seemed to be something to be held on the forehead.

She put the ornament back into the box and closed it. She looked around and found a picture of one of Catra's parents. It seemed

that the ornament was something of a crown or tiara, a symbol of royalty. "I think Catra would appreciate this as a gift." Shadow Weaver thought and took the box with her.

Meanwhile at Mystacor, best friend squad and Catra were all together in the steam grotto. It was said that steam grotto had healing abilities but, most importantly it helped you relax.

Catra was not stepping in the pools since she hated water.

"Come on Catra, join us." Bow said.

"Yeah, Adora is here as well. So why can't you?" Glimmer asked.

"I'm sure you know that cats don't like water." Catra said. "So you three can bath there as long as you want, I'm going to my room."

Catra left the steam grotto and headed to her room. As she was walking through the halls, she was confronted by a elder council member.

"You are a new face around here." Elder said. "I hope you enjoy your stay here at Mystacor."

Catra jumped a bit, she didn't expect someone random to confront her. "Uhh, yeah I'm enjoying it very much. Mystacor is a really cool place."

"I'm glad to hear." Elder answered.

Something creeped Catra about this situation. Elder man was polite and nice, but something about him felt fake and even

dangerous. Catra's instincts told her to get away from him. "Anyways, I was on my way to my room, so I gotta go."

Elder council member just nodded in agreement.

Catra made haste towards her room and closed the door after her. Even though the elder council member didn't do anything, he gave ominous vibes. This must be what Shadow Weaver had warned about her, but if Castaspella was the head-sorceress how was these kinds of things still possible?

Well she couldn't know why and it isn't her place to say anything.

It was now late in the evening and Catra could hear something going on. She went to see what it was and saw Adora. Who had turned into She-Ra and it seemed she had destroyed many of the crystals at the luminarium.

"What's going on here?" Catra could hear a voice asking.

Castaspella came with Glimmer and Bow and they were shocked to see what had happened.

"I.. I'm sorry.." Adora said and threw her sword on the ground. "I didn't mean to, but I saw-"

She was cut off by Castaspella who was rather angry about the situation. "What- How could you do it!?"

"I'm sure she didn't mean to do it." Glimmer defended her friend.

"Are these the kind of friends you hang with!?"

"Aunt." Glimmer tried, but Castaspella left the luminarium.

"Glimmer, I'm so sorry." Adora apologized.

"Don't worry, I'll handle this." Glimmer said ensuring Adora everything was fine.

"Yeah, you can go with Catra to your room." Bow suggested.

Adora sighed and nodded in agreement. She and Catra went to her room.

Adora sat on the bed and was a nervous wreck. "Catra? Am I crazy?" She asked. "Why do I see things that others don't?"

Catra didn't exactly know what to do, but her instincts told her something was bothering Adora. She sat next to Adora and put hand on her shoulder. "You can tell me what's bothering you, I'll listen."

Adora sighed. "Well, I've seen something following me, it looks like a shadow and it has taken different forms."

"Forms? What kind of forms?" Catra asked.

"Well, at the luminarium. I saw Hordak on one of the crystals on the wall and he was taunting me." Adora explained. "Like he was in the mirror or something like that."

"Well, I myself know very little about magic. But I'm sure Shadow Weaver would know." Catra assured. "Also, didn't Horde have a sorceress of their own?"

Then Adora remembered Darkith, she could do a lot of different things. "Actually, I know one. Her name is Darkith and she's the right hand of Hordak."

Catra remembered the name Darkith, she was the sorcerer who was responsible for Michas death. "Well, I think we already have our answer." Catra said and tapped Adora's shoulder.

"But would they believe me?" Adora asked.

"They should, you are their friend after all." Catra assured.

Then Adora's room door opened and Glimmer entered in. Adora ran to confront Glimmer but, Catra's hair stood up. Something was off about this Glimmer.

"Listen, I'm sor-" Adora tried to apologize but was cut off by Glimmer. "How could you do something like that?!"

Glimmer.. I don't understand.."

"If you can't even understand then maybe it's better if you leave." Glimmer said with a cold tone and left the room.

Adora was taken back by this, but luckily for her Catra was still there. Catra put her hand on Adora's shoulder and comforted her. "That wasn't Glimmer."

"What do you mean?"

"Something was off about her, my instincts just told me." Catra said.

"I know you are trying to make me feel better, but just forget it." Adora said with a sad tone. "I seem to cause a lot of trouble wherever I go."

Adora stood up and was leaving the room. "That's not true!" Catra yelled determinedly, but Adora just shook her head and left.

Catra couldn't let things end like this, so she went to confront Castaspella. She arrived at the luminarium where Castaspella was casting her spell to reinforce the Mystacor's magic, through the moon eclipse.

Catra couldn't just interrupt her so she was about to go talk to Glimmer and Bow. When she was about to open her mouth, darkness filled the room and struck everyone there unconscious. Catra couldn't believe what she saw, she had to get Adora. Unfortunately it was too late for her as well. This shadowy figure threw her against the wall and she fainted.

Meanwhile Adora was walking outside and thinking about leaving Mystacor, until she noticed that the wall that protects Mystacor

was fading.

Bow was running towards her. "Adora, we need to leave right now!" He took Adora's hand and started to pull her.

"Wait! Bow!" Adora yelled. "What's the meaning of this?"

Bow turned to look at her and his personality suddenly changed. "What's happening now, is your fault Adora. Only yours!"

Adora could hear rumbling and screaming from the main building and decided to go back. Only to see that Bow was not there anymore. She arrived at the luminarium and saw Darkith standing there.

"No, it can't be!"

"Adora.." Darkith said with a condescending tone. "It's time to stop this madness."

Adora took her sword out. "For the honor of Grayskull!" She yelled, but the sword didn't activate. Darkith laughed. "It's useless Adora." Then Darkith lunged towards her and Adora dropped her sword. Darkith threw the sword away and trapped Adora inside of her darkness.

"Adora, come with me. You don't owe these people anything!" Darkith said threateningly."

"No, I won't ever go back!" Adora resisted.

"They don't understand you! Like they didn't understand me!"

"No, what do you mean?"

"I can tell you, if you promise to come back with me." Darkith said with a more calming tone.

"Never!" Adora yelled and saw a chance to escape. She ran towards her sword and picked it up.

"It's useless Adora!" Darkith threatened. "Eclipse is soon over and then Mystacor will fall under the Horde!"

"Not if I can do something." Adora answered.

Darkith tried to grab Adora's sword, but Adora successfully cut her tendrils."You were nothing before I took you in! You will be nothing without me!"

It didn't affect Adora, so Darkith picked up unconscious Catra. "Listen carefully Adora, you will come with me or I will kill your friend!" She then tightened her grip on Catra's throat and began choking her.

Adora couldn't let that happen, so she jumped behind cover and confronted Darkith. She sliced Darkith's hand off, releasing Catra as well.

Darkith was now furious, she attacked Adora and was about to overpower her. Unfortunately for Darkith, Adora succeeded turning her sword into a shield and deflected Darkith's spell. Pushing her back and evaporating her shadow body.

Adora succeeds in restoring the forcefield of Mystacor through the lunar lenses. She had successfully finished the spell and with it learned that her sword can be more than just a sword.

Later Castaspella confronted Adora.

"I am sorry for what I did." She apologized.

"But you also helped to save the whole Mystacor and all of us as well." Castaspella said with a comforting tone. I think that is more

than enough."

"I'm sorry we didn't believe you Adora." Glimmer said. "I thought you were only tired."

"You don't have to apologize, but I think I need to apologize to you, Catra." Adora said and walked towards Catra.

"Me? What for?" She asked, puzzled.

Adora hugged her and said. "Because I didn't listen to you when I should have."

"Oooh that.. don't worry. We all make mistakes from time to time." Catra said ensuring Adora.

"Aren't they lovely together? Just like a couple." Bow said gushing.

"You are right Bow, they seem like a couple." Glimmer confirmed.

Adora and Catra both turned to look at them. They stopped their hugs and shook their heads. Then they said together. "We aren't nothing like a couple." Only to realize they had made it even more obvious.

At the Fright Zone loud yells and thumbs could be heard from Darkith's chambers. Scratch peeked in and saw Darkith laying on the ground unconscious.

"Pathetic old hag." Scratch said and passed over her body. She walked to the vase and saw it mirroring Mystacor. She could see

the best friend squad hugging and laughing. Her attention was quickly fixated on Catra.

Seeing Catra made her blood boil, without her everything would have gone well at the Sea Gate.

"Your methods are useless, if you want to get them. You have to strike where it hurts." Scratch said and a devilish smile crept on her face.

Chapter End Notes

Oh boy this seems to be the longer ones..

By now it is pretty obvious that Catra and Adora have feelings towards eachothers. Shame they both are too stubborn to admit it.

Prelude for Princess Prom Pt.1

Chapter Summary

Catra heard that princesses are holding a prom. Princess Prom, old tradition that is usually held in one of the kingdoms of Etheria.
Catra was asked to come there and be Adora's "plus one".

Shadow Weaver get's a surprise visit from Castaspella.

Meanwhile Scratch plans to use Scorpia's status as a princess to get into the prom.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra arrived late in the evening and Shadow Weaver was waiting for her at the door. "Welcome back." She said, welcoming Catra.

Catra was tired and exhausted, she almost fainted on the ground. Shadow Weaver had to catch her. "Oh dear, better get you to bed." She carried Catra to her room and laid her on the bed. "I thought they were suppose to relax there." Shadow Weaver watched as Catra had now completely fallen into sleep. She patted her head and smiled. "I'm glad you are back here.. Catra."

Shadow Weaver turned the lights off and closed the door carefully, not to wake her up. She went downstairs and sat on the couch in the living room. She picked up a book from the table and started to read.

As she was about to start reading, she heard knocking on the door. "Who could it be at this late in the night?" She thought to herself and walked up to the door. Shadow Weaver slightly opened the door and saw Castaspella standing there.

"Castaspella? What are you doing here?" Shadow Weaver asked, rather surprised.

"Is it too late? I can come later." Castaspella answered.

"First; I don't mind late visits, second; how did you find me?"

"I asked from Glimmer, since she had visited you earlier."

" *Of course she would ask about it from Glimmer, that girl couldn't keep her mouth shut.* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself She took a deep breath and sighed. "Well then, I guess you can come in."

Shadow Weaver let Castaspella in.

"You have a rather lovely house, I was not expecting your kind of sorceress to live like this." Castaspella said and admired her house.

"Don't know if I should take that as an offense or compliment." Shadow Weaver said half jokingly.

"I didn't mean to, I wasn't just expecting you to live like this." Castaspella said.

"You don't have to worry about something so trivial. Do you want some tea?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Yes please." Castaspella answered.

Shadow Weaver went into the kitchen to make some tea for them. She decided to make mild tea, she didn't know what kind of tea Castaspella liked. Meanwhile Castaspella was exploring Shadow Weaver's living room and inspecting her book shelves. She could spot some books that peaked her interest.

Castaspella picked up a book about First One's history and started to read it. She had never heard or read anything like this before.

There wasn't a single book like this at Mystacor. Her attention was then peaked by the book that covered the culture of magicats.

" *Where could she have acquired all these books?* " Castaspella thought to herself.

Shadow Weaver came from the kitchen and said. "Castaspella, tea is ready." She noticed that Castaspella was reading a book about First One's and was holding a book about magicats on her other hand. "Interesting, isn't it?"

Castaspella snapped back to reality. "Oh yes, very interesting." She said and stood up from the couch. "I haven't never before read a book like this. Where did you get it?"

"I was exploring, I don't like to sit around doing nothing." Shadow Weaver answered.

"At where? Where could you find something like this?" Castaspella inquired more.

"From the ancient First One's city, I found one and it sure was something and that book about magicats is another story." Shadow Weaver answered. "But come on, tea is ready. Let's not let it get cold."

Shadow Weaver served Castaspella tea and light snacks. "I didn't know what kind of tea you like, so I made plain and mild tea." Shadow Weaver said while serving tea.

"I don't really have any preference, I can drink anything." Castaspella said.

"Good, maybe next time I'll make something stronger." Shadow Weaver said and now poured tea into her own cup. "So, what brings you here?"

"Nothing in particular, I was just worried since last time we met. It didn't end that well."

"Yes.. I do remember that." Shadow Weaver said. "I don't hold it against Angella, she was right to be angry at me. After all, I meddled with something I shouldn't have."

Castaspella took a sip from her cup. "You still blame yourself for Micha's death?" She asked with a concerned tone.

"Isn't it obvious?" Shadow Weaver said. "I'm a walking disaster."

"No you're not." Castaspella said and came closer to Shadow Weaver and put hand on her shoulder. Which unnerved her. "Everyone makes mistakes and everyone can learn from those as well. You are too hard on yourself."

"Do you know why?" Shadow Weaver asked with a dismissive tone. "I suggested using Spell of Obtainment, I tangled Micah with it as well, I killed many high-sorceress and I meddled with the rebellion's battle plan. You are stupid if you think otherwise."

"But you have taken care of Catra, I've seen how much you care for her. There are things you can do to make up for your mistakes." Castaspella said, trying to calm Shadow Weaver.

"But I can't! If I would ever step close to any kingdom which has a runestone, it would be a disaster." Shadow Weaver said. "I can barely control myself and I need a mask with a runestone as well to keep myself in control."

"It's the Spell of Obtainment, isn't it?" Castaspella asked. "I know about its effects."

"Then you should know very well why I keep my distance from others." Shadow Weaver said.

"But you can't just shut everyone out from your life, if you don't allow anyone to help you-" Castaspella was cut off by Shadow Weaver. "Save it, I don't need your pity."

"Pity!? PITY?! Why are you so stubborn? Nothing is never simple with you!"

"Life is not simple and it certainly ain't fair."

Castaspella huffed, how can someone be so petty? What should she do with her?

"If that's all you came here for, then maybe it's better for you to leave." Shadow Weaver said as she stood up from her chair.

"Wait!" Castaspella said. "Before I leave, why don't you take your mask off?"

"I have reasons to keep it on and I'm sure you saw my face back then." Shadow Weaver mumbled.

"It has been at least a decade since I saw it, I can't remember it anymore. Could you, please?" Castaspella pleaded.

Shadow Weaver sighed. "Fine, for this time only." She said and hesitantly took her mask off. Revealing her tired and scarred face. Years have not been kind to her and she looked worse than Castaspella could remember.

"Are you happy now?" Shadow Weaver asked and looked at Castaspella who was staring at her face.

"You still look beautiful, even if years have not been kind to you."

"I'll take it as a compliment." Shadow Weaver said and closed her eyes for a moment. Suddenly she could feel a kiss on her lips.

This shook her body up, she had never ever expected someone to kiss her. She opened her eyes and saw Castaspella, so close to her. Shadow Weaver didn't know what to make of this. Should she push her away or embrace her soft lips.

She chose the latter, obviously. This was something she had never experienced before, this deep and passionate kiss of a woman. Why did she like it so much?

When Castaspella finished she looked at Shadow Weaver's puzzled face that was burning red. "Will that change anything?" Castaspella asked.

Shadow Weaver snapped back to reality, still embarrassed. "It depends... what did you want to change." She said and coughed.

"That I cared for you, for so many years.. and now I had a chance. A chance I couldn't miss." Castaspella answered.

"So, all these years you wanted to kiss me?" Shadow Weaver asked. "I don't see a single reason why, of all the people it had to be you."

"You were different, I read all your research and things you had written to change Mystacor. When I became the Head-Sorceress, I wanted to change Mystacor. Because I agreed with many things you had written and your research was something no one had ever done." Castaspella explained.

"But that was when I was a Light Spinner, I am now only a shadow you chase." Shadow Weaver said.

"There is still Light Spinner inside you, even if it's buried in all of your self-hatred and bitterness."

"I dare to disagree. Now then, was that all?"

Castaspella sighed disappointed. "If I can't do anything now, then maybe I can do something later. And if you choose to change as well." She said and walked towards the front door. As she was about to leave, she took one last look at Shadow Weaver and said. "Thanks for the tea, it was delicious."

"You're welcome." Shadow Weaver snorted trying to hide her still red face.

Castaspella left and Shadow Weaver was now standing there, surrounded by silence. How could she even sleep tonight, Castaspella really tangled her mind. How dare she come in late in the night and press her on the matters that clearly hurt her and then she dares to kiss her. " *What is wrong with that woman? She clearly has a few screws loose.* "

" *That was the most disgusting thing I've ever experienced!* " Spell of Obtainment said. " *Can you see what happens when you let your feelings run wild?* "

"Oh shut it! You know nothing about these kinds of matters." Shadow Weaver said. "You are the reason why everything is so hard."

" *Then you shouldn't have taken Micha's place.* "

"Better me than him, at least with me you can't do as you please."

" *And that truly is unfortunate.* " Entity said and dwelled off.

Shadow Weaver sighed and shook her head. Maybe tomorrow would be better day, if she can sleep that is.

Next morning Shadow Weaver woke up late and she had fallen asleep on the couch. She could smell strong aromas flowing from the kitchen. Catra must've been there, making tea. She catapulted herself up from the couch and went to the kitchen. "Catra!"

"Oh, good morning." Catra said and turned to look at her. She had a prideful smile on her face. "I made some tea and it should be edible."

"It's usually me who wakes up early but I had some difficulties getting to sleep." Shadow Weaver said and picked up tea cups from the cabinet. She put them on the kitchen table and Catra served the tea.

"It smells good." Shadow Weaver said and took a sip. Her ears twitched a few times, this way her body told that the tea was excellent. "Wow, this tea tastes fantastical. What and how did you do that?"

Catra awkwardly rubbed the back of her head. "I read one of your books about tea brewing. So I made it as the book instructed.

"You? Doing something by book? Shadow Weaver chuckled, Catra usually did everything against the book. She never cared for rules that much, so it was surprising to say at least. "You have made excellent tea Catra."

"Thank you." Catra answered.

When they were finished, Shadow Weaver remembered the box she was supposed to give to Catra. "I have something for you, wait here." Shadow Weaver said and headed to her room.

Catra waited downstairs while Shadow Weaver was in her room.

Moments later she came back, holding a box in her arms. "While you were at Mystacor, I found something interesting in your old hometown."

"Wait, you went back there?" Catra asked.

"It wasn't my purpose to go there, I just went for a walk and somehow ended up there." Shadow Weaver answered. "I found this from your old house."

She opened the box and revealed the ornament. Catra was excited and surprised to see it. It brought back memories of her parents. Since they used to have ornaments like that as well.

"I can't be sure but, I think it has to be something to do with royalty or higher status." Shadow Weaver said.

Catra put the ornament on her forehead and it was like made for her. "It fits perfectly."

"Maybe it was a gift meant for you when you grew older. Maybe you are royalty."

"Me? A royalty?" Catra asked, puzzled. "It is impossible."

"Your parents clearly were at least nobility." Shadow Weaver said. "I read about your culture and history and it was clear that only royalty or nobility had those."

"Then, would it count me as a princess?" Catra asked, her face beaming with joy.

"Who knows, you seem to be the only one left. We might never know but, it's clear that you were noble at least."

"This is amazing!" Catra exclaimed with full joy and started to jump around the room. "I belong to the nobility!"

Shadow Weaver was about to stop Catra but she couldn't. When Catra was so happy, she could herself feel happy as well.

Shadow Weaver now knew that if something were to happen to Catra, she would never forgive herself. So better hope nothing bad doesn't happen.

Later that day Shadow Weaver left for a walk and Catra was alone. Shadow Weaver had asked her to look after the house while she's gone. Catra was sitting on the couch and reading a book. It was late afternoon and she could hear someone knocking on the door.

She walked up to the door but didn't open it. Shadow Weaver had told her not to open the door to strangers. "Who's there?"

"Catra? It's me, Adora."

Catra then opened the door and welcomed Adora. "Come on in."

"Thanks." Adora answered and sat on the living room couch.

"So what brings you here? I see you are alone as well, where's your friends?" Catra asked.

"Oh, I came alone and I was going to ask you about something."

Catra brought some water as courtesy and offered it to Adora. "What is it?"

Adora looked at Catra and noticed she was wearing an ornament. "That looks cool. Where'd you get that?"

"Oh, this?" Catra said and pointed to her ornament. "I got it from Shadow Weaver, she found it in my hometown. She said these were worn by royalties, meaning that I am descendant of royalty."

"You are a royalty?" Adora asked.

"Yes, it seems so. Cool isn't it?" Catra boasted.

"Then it makes things even simpler, Catra, would you be my partner at Princess Prom?"

"The, what?" Catra asked. "Partner?" Catra was utterly confused, this came out of nowhere. There was a prom held by princesses?

"Yes, I don't have a partner and it's required to have one if you want to go there." Adora explained.

"I don't know, this is all too sudden and I'm not even sure if Shadow Weaver would agree with it." Catra said.

"Well, she let you go to Mystacor. Surely she wouldn't mind letting you go to a prom."

"Well.. she isn't here right now-" Catra was interrupted by Shadow Weaver who had came back. "Catra, I'm home."

"Ohh hazelnuts..." Catra said.

"Catra? Everything alright?" Shadow Weaver asked. Then she noticed that Adora was here too. "Oh, Adora, you are here as well."

"Yes, I'm sorry for bothering but, I came here to ask Catra to come with me to the Princess Prom." Adora explained and Catra looked away feeling awkward.

"Princess Prom? I didn't know they still held those." Shadow Weaver said.

"Well they do and I need a partner to go there. So I thought that maybe Catra could come with me."

"Mhmm, And when is this event held?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"The day after tomorrow, at the Kingdom of Ice."

"I see." Shadow Weaver said and looked at Catra assessing the situation. She then looked back at Adora. "I don't see a reason to not let her. I'd rather have Catra go to a prom than to Mystacor."

Shadow Weaver then walked closer to Adora and whispered into her ear. " *Catra really likes you, she just doesn't want to admit it.* "

This made Adora blush and Catra noticed it. "Shadow Weaver, what did you say to her?!"

"Nothing, nothing at all." Shadow Weaver answered nonchalantly.

Catra shook her head and sighed. "Well, I guess I could go with you."

"Great, I can't wait." Adora exclaimed happily.

"I'll make sure Catra is dressed appropriately." Shadow Weaver said and winked. How does one wink with a mask on is anyone's guess, magic.. probably.

"Well, I better get going. I'll be late for dinner." Adora said. "And thank you, you aren't as bad as the rumors say."

"Rumors are just rumors." Shadow Weaver said and huffed.

"Well, I guess I'll see Catra at the prom?"

"Actually, I thought about sending Catra to Brightmoon tomorrow. I can guarantee, you won't be disappointed." Shadow Weaver said.

"Shadow Weaver! Enough with the embarrassing things, I'm dying inside." Catra complained half jokingly.

"Alright, alright. I'll stop." Shadow Weaver assured.

"Well I guess we see tomorrow." Adora said.

"Yeah, I think so too." Catra said.

After Adora had left, Shadow Weaver and Catra stood there for a while. Surrounded by an awkward silence.

Then Shadow Weaver broke the silence. "Well, let's get you a proper attire, worthy of your class."

"Well, if it's not a pink dress. I'll accept it." Catra said.

"I wasn't even thinking about a dress." Shadow Weaver said with a gleeful tone.

"Ohh boy... Where did I stick my nose..." Catra sighed.

At Fright Zone, Scratch was thinking a way to get Adora back and at the same time how to get avenge on Catra. She was greeted by Force Captain Scorpia who proceed to hug Scratch. Event though she disliked it. "Let me go Scorpia!"

"Oh sorry, it's just... I'm a hugger." Scorpia answered, letting Scratch go.

"I know that." Scratch huffed.

"So what are you planning?"

"Darkith failed to capture Adora and she's been going on behind Hordak's back. If Hordak will know of it and if he discovers that I've been helping her.. Argh, it's gonna be a disaster!" Scratch ranted. "Then there is that stupid cat who ruined everything! What am I going to do!?"

"Maybe you could try something at the good old Princess Prom." Scorpia suggested. "Ooh, this year's theme is winter wonderland."

Scratch turned to look at Scorpia who was holding the scroll, she snatched it from Scorpia's claws. "How did you get your claws on this!?"

"I'm a princess." Scorpia answered.

"You're a princess?!" Scratch exclaimed, surprised.

"I'm surprised you didn't know, it was covered at the Force Captain orientation."

"Oh... I think maybe I shouldn't have skipped it... Oh well." Scratch said and got a great idea. "You are a princess, so you can go to the prom."

"Ohhoh, no.. I'm not going. No one likes me, even before we joined the Horde...I never fitted in with other princesses, I made them uncomfortable.. and they don't like that." Scorpia said with a mournful tone and sighed.

Scratch got an idea, she turned to look at Scorpia and said. "No, that is exactly why you should go."

"Really?" Scorpia asked with a more cheerful tone. "Do you really think that?"

"Of course, I mean how dare they not to accept you! Just because you're different!" Scratch said with fiery and passionate tone. "How dare they to take friends and turn them into tall sword ladies, you should absolutely go. To show them that you are not to be ignored!"

"I have never had someone encourage me as much as you have." Scorpia said and proceeded to hug Scratch once more, this time even more tighter than last time.

"Okay... ugh I get it.. agh can you.. let me down?" Scratch asked as she felt like her lungs and bones were crushed.

"Oh, I'm so sorry." Scorpia apologized and gently let go of Scratch. "Heh.. sorry, I got just excited."

Scratch stretched out her back and could hear a few cracks. "Ugh, it's fine. So, you go to the prom with me?"

"Of course, now that you have given me courage."

"That's great, leave the planning to me. I have a great idea how to get things done."

"Alright boss." Scorpia answered and saluted.

"You don't have to salute." Scratch mumbled. Now she could begin planning how to get Adora and at the same time, how to screw that cat over.

Chapter End Notes

> So... I made a real cringe interaction with Shadow Weaver and Castaspella... does it count as SWxCasta?
> Adora had real nerves of steel to actually come and ask Catra personally to come with her to the prom.
>
> I wanted to make Shadow Weaver act like a kind of a hypocrite, regarding her sentiment towards love/kindness. I don't know if this will make any sense but, I like my Shadow Weaver as a mess and a hypocrite.
>
> I hope you enjoyed this chapter.

Prelude for Princess Prom Pt.2

Chapter Summary

This is the second part of prelude for Princess Prom.

Chapter Notes

Writing this chapter has taken longer than I'd have liked. I'd like to apologoize for blueballing you guys.

This was suppoesed to be the prom episode, but I wrote way too much other contet. So I can't really call it the Princess Prom chapter.

Instead, enjoy more Catra/SW interactions as well as SW/Castaspella.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Late at evening, Shadow Weaver was choosing an outfit for Catra to wear at the prom. "You really don't have to go through all that." Catra said. "I'll be quite well off how I am now."

"Nonsense, a fine lady like yourself should be dressed appropriately." Shadow Weaver answered. "You are going to be with princesses and Adora herself is a fine lady as well."

Hearing this Catra blushed and felt embarrassed once again. She crossed her arms and turned to look away, hiding her embarrassment. "Ugh, why do you have to be like that? So embarrassing."

Shadow Weaver chuckled herself and continued digging through her stuff, until she found something. "Ah, here. Look at this." She said and picked up a nice looking violet dress with fancy textiles and with golden patternings.

"That's a dress, I don't want one." Catra said and crossed her arms. "Way too glamorous for me and you should know that dress won't sit well with me."

"You have to wear something, you can't go there looking like a plebian." Shadow Weaver argued.

"Can't you find something simple, yet elegant?" Catra asked.

"I consider my clothes to be elegant.." Shadow Weaver said, partly feeling insulted. She let out a deep sigh. "Well.. let's see if I can come up with an alternative option."

After a while of searching, Shadow Weaver found a fancy suit. It was a dark purple suit with wine red lines and a necktie. Alongside were fancy dark purple pants and black shoes. "Well what do you think about this?" Shadow Weaver said and showed Catra her latest findings.

Catra examined the suit with a keen eye, until she came up with an answer. "I guess it's fine, it looks better than those dresses of yours."

Shadow Weaver groaned. "There is nothing wrong with those, you are just nitpicky."

"At least I can run fine with that suit." Catra said.

"Alright, why don't you try these on then." Shadow Weaver said and gave the suit.

Catra took the clothes with her and went to change in her room. Shadow Weaver sighed once again. " *What am I going to do with you..* "

After a while Catra came back downstairs dressed in the purple suit and pants. Only problem was to get her tail out from the pants. "I think it suits me quite well, but pants really don't sit well with my tail."

"Oh, I can arrange with that." Shadow Weaver said and with a flick of a finger a small hole appeared at the back of the pants and Catra could thread her tail through it.

"Better?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Alot better." Catra answered.

"Good, now lets comb that messy hair of yours so you don't look like you have a hedgehog on your head."

"I don't know.. I'm kind of fond of my hair." Catra answered.

"Don't worry, it will look just fine. Come here." Shadow Weaver said as she pulled up a bench and a mirror. Catra sat down on the bench in front of the mirror. Shadow Weaver picked up a comb and started combing.

Shadow Weaver soon found out that Catra's hair was more shaggy than she had anticipated. As she was combing, her comb got stuck on Catra's hair. "See, I told you it might not be a good idea." Catra said and chuckled.

Shadow Weaver huffed and pulled up her sleeves. "Well then, let's use some magic." She said and tried to straighten Catra's hair with dark tendrils, but it was in vain.

Catra was giggling as Shadow Weaver got more desperate. She had way too much fun at Shadow Weaver's expense, more than she should.

When Catra's hair became more messier than it was before, Shadow Weaver decided to quit. "Fine, forget the combing!" She snapped and threw her comb against the floor. This made Catra

laugh even more until she fell off from the bench. Luckily for her Shadow Weaver quickly catched her, at the expense of her back.

"Agh, My back!" Shadow Weaver groaned and let Catra off, she stopped laughing as she heard Shadow Weaver's plea. "Did you hurt yourself badly?" Catra asked concerned.

"No,it's fine. I'm just getting old. I'm sure its nothing that some of my herbs couldn't heal." Shadow Weaver said and started to walk towards the kitchen.

Catra stood there for a while in silence. She felt kind of bad, laughing at Shadow Weaver's expense. She walked towards the kitchen as well and saw Shadow Weaver mixing different herbs into powder. "What are you making?" Catra asked, she knew it was a stuoid question. It was quite obvious what Shadow Weaver was making.

"Oh, this? It's going to be some sort of ointment. I'm going to rub it on my back to help it heal." Shadow Weaver answered.

"I can help you with that." Catra offered, but her offer was rejected by Shadow Weaver. "I can manage quite well myself. Besides, I don't think you would want to touch on my bare skin."

"I don't mind that, I know you have scars all over your body. Of all the things that I have already seen, your scars are the least of my worries."

Shadow Weaver sighed. "If you insist, but if you find uncomforting you don't have to do it." Shadow Weaver said.

"I know, I know." Catra answered and took the small box of powder.

Shadow Weaver took off her robes and revealed her back. It was a sight to behold, a sight that Catra did not expect. She had a sour expression on her face as she looked at Shadow Weaver's scarred back.

Shadow Weaver chuckled, she knew that Catra wouldn't stand looking at it. "It's okay, you don't have to do it."

Catra gulped and took a deep breath. "No, I insist. Let me help."

"Fine, just rub it at the lower back." Shadow Weaver said and pointed to her lower back.

Catra rubbed the powder as she was instructed. She didn't particularly enjoy it, but she felt she had to. After all, she felt this was her fault. "There, done. Do you feel any better now?" She asked when she had finished.

"It's not instant. It might take a whole night to heal." Shadow Weaver answered as she put her robes back on. "You don't have to worry about me. You have a prom to attend."

At the next morning, Shadow Weaver woke up from her bed early, to apply more of her medicine. Her back felt already a lot better, although it wasn't fully healed yet. But she didn't let that bother her.

She had more important things to do and she couldn't let small backpain stop her.

Shadow Weaver was preparing the teleportation circle. She herself was not going anywhere near Brightmoon nor other princesses, but she could send Catra without going herself. "There, it's done now." She said as she finished the last sigil of the circle. "Now to make some breakfast."

Catra woke up later in the morning and headed downstairs. She could smell breakfast from the staircase. "Good morning." She said as she entered the kitchen.

"Morning." Shadow Weaver said and took a sip from her mug. "Have a seat and enjoy breakfast."

They ate the breakfast in silence and in no hurry. Until Shadow Weaver broke the silence. "I have made all the necessary preparations, considering the prom."

"Oh, wasn't it tomorrow?" Catra asked.

"Yes, but I said I would send you to Brightmoon today."

"Oh, yeah.. I remember."

"Are you nervous?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Duh, obviously! I'm going to meet different princesses and royalty from all corners of Etheria and I have no clue how to act." Catra vented.

Shadow Weaver stood up and put her hands on Catra's shoulders, they stood face to face. "Listen, there is nothing to be worried about. I know you will be fine. Besides, Adora herself is not an official princess.. I think. " Shadow Weaver said and put her left hand on Catra's cheek. "You two will be just fine."

Shadow Weaver's calming words made Catra calm as well. Maybe this time it was Shadow Weaver's turn to calm Catra.

Later that day, Catra had packed her fancy suit neatly in the suitcase and Shadow Weaver gave Catra's ornament to her. It was meant to solidify her royalties and to look fancy.

Shadow Weaver instructed Catra inside the teleportation cycle and when Catra was ready, she sent her to Brightmoon.

"I hope you'll have a great time there." Shadow Weaver said to herself.

" *You are too soft and it's clearly distracting you from your main goal.* "

"I don't have a main goal. You are just making that up. If you excuse me, I'm going to do gardening and maybe read a good book." Shadow Weaver said.

" *But, Etheria! Magic! Dominance!* " Entity said, trying to convince her.

"But, gardening! Reading! **Daisies** !" Shadow Weaver answered sarcastically, copying the manners of the Entity.

Catra found herself near the borders of Brightmoon, Shadow Weaver had made sure Catra didn't teleport inside the castle. To make her entrance less suspicious. She walked towards the gate and was let through by the guards, she headed towards the main keep. There she was greeted by Adora who was expecting her. "Hello, I've been waiting for you."

"Really? You really wouldn't have to." Catra said. "I didn't even announce my arrival."

"It doesn't matter." Adora answered. "Glimmer's been quite mad that Bow decided to go with Perfuma, instead of her."

"That sounds petty. Though, who I am to judge." Catra said and swayed her arms. "I don't even know her or Bow well enough."

"Yeah, don't worry. It's nothing serious.. *I hope..* " Adora said. "Anyways, glad to see you here."

"As well." Catra answered.

"I take it you have your dress in that suitcase." Adora said and turned to look at Catra's suitcase.

"Well yeah, but technically... it's not a dress, it's a suit." Catra said. "Dresses don't sit well with me."

"Ooh.. yeah.. you're a cat. I knew that.. hehe." Adora said while awkwardly rubbing the back of her head. " *We can forget the dress I had made for you then...* "

Adora led Catra to her spare room inside the Brightmoon. On their way, they saw Castaspella and Angella discussing something. Castaspella noticed that Catra was here, she immediately excused herself and went after Adora and Catra. If Catra was here, it must have meant that Shadow Weaver was alone at her home. Angella herself was confused about Castaspella's sudden change.

"Uh, excuse me." Castaspella said and caught their attention.

"Oh Castaspella, what's up?" Adora asked.

"Oh, nothing much. I happened to notice that Catra was here." She said and looked at Catra.

"Well obviously I am here, I came because of the prom." Catra answered.

"Ah, yes. The Princess Prom." Castaspella said. "You came here alone?"

"Ofcourse, you know Shadow Weaver wouldn't come near this place."

"Yeah, I know. Just wanted to check. Anyways, sorry to bother you. I have some important things to do, enjoy the prom." Castaspella said and walked away, leaving Adora and Catra kinda dumbfounded.

"What was that about?" Adora asked.

"I don't know, she seems to have a thing for Shadow Weaver... I guess." Catra answered.

"For Shadow Weaver?" Adora asked, bursting out laughing. "So, you're telling me that Castaspella has a thing for her? Impossible!"

"As funny as it sounds, I think so."

"Yeah, good one. I didn't take you for being such a joker."

"Who said it was a joke?" Catra asked with a serious tone and raised her eyebrow. It took Adora for a while to get it. "Wait, you aren't joking?" She asked.

Catra only shook her head. "Oh... that's unexpected. I wonder how Angella or Glimmer would react to hearing that?"

"It's better not to tell them. Besides, it's only a guess. Nothing concrete." Catra said.

"I guess so, it's better to not jump on the gun."

Later that day, Shadow Weaver was still gardening in her front yard. However, she and Spell of Obtainment were once again arguing with each other. It's been decades when Shadow Weaver had acquired the Spell of Obtainment and they still don't get along.

" *Why are you wasting your time on gardening? You should be thinking about how to get more power!* "

"We've been through this same conversation for so many times, can't you find anything else to do?" Shadow Weaver argued, clearly tired from their arguing which never led to anything.

" *I'm thinking about us! I need more power to sustain myself and you as* well." Entity *said.* " *With your decaying body it takes a lot from me to keep you sustained and functional!* "

"I wouldn't be decaying if it wasn't for you!" Shadow Weaver yelled.

" *Don't give me that crap! You yourself wanted to test the spell, you were just a coward and didn't finish it!* "

"Agh, this leads to nothing! I've been trying to search for places where we could find more power but, the thing is I haven't found any. So just dwell back and don't bother me, I know what I am doing!"

" *Fine, but you can't keep delaying it forever.* " Entity said and went off.

Shadow Weaver let out relieved sigh, maybe she could get some peace of her own. Well for Shadow Weaver it wasn't that simple,

one Head-Sorcerer known as Castaspella had arrived. "Oh, good day Shadow Weaver." She greeted.

" *Great... now I got another problem that won't shut up. That's for sure.* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself. She stood up and was ready to go inside, hoping ignoring Castaspella she would leave her alone.

"Not even going to say hi?" Castaspella asked.

" *Just keep calm and go inside, maybe she'll go away.* " Shadow Weaver thought as she opened her front door.

"You are being terribly rude, Shadow Weaver!" Castaspella ranted. "I came all the way here, just to meet up with you!"

"You didn't have to." Shadow Weaver said and slammed the door shut.

"You can't be serious!?" Castaspella said and started banging on Shadow Weaver's door. "You aren't seriously ignoring me?!"

Meanwhile on the other side of the door, Shadow Weaver leaned against the banging of the door. " *Why did it have to be you...* " She said to herself. Shadow Weaver was still conflicted from the last time she had met Castaspella and this time she surely would want more.

"Shadow Weaver, please. Open the door, I just want to talk with you." Castaspella said.

Shadow Weaver sighed, she knew Castaspella had power and authority and she could easily expose her to the council of Mystacor.

Shadow Weaver thought through her options and decided it was best to let her inside. "Fine... I'll let you in." She said and opened the door.

Shadow Weaver let Castaspella in and hoped things would go smoothly this time.

"So... What brings you here?" Shadow Weaver asked, offering Castaspella a seat.

"I was afraid you wouldn't let me in at all." Castaspella said.

"You are a bit intrusive, but I guess it can't be helped."

"Was that meant to be a compliment or insult?"

"Whichever you like more." Shadow Weaver answered. "Tea?"

"Yes, please." Castaspella answered.

Shadow Weaver made them some tea with biscuits she had made. Castaspella tried one of the bisquits and found their taste to be quite lovely. "These are really tasty, you made these yourself?"

"I did." Shadow Weaver answered. "Infact, the recipe is my own, so I can't guarantee its taste. I'm still testing."

"I never thought you were one for baking." Castaspella said. "I thought you were one for potions."

"Well as they say, variety is the spice." Shadow Weaver said. "Besides, I have quite a collection of different kinds of potions. Most of them are medicine of sorts."

"I can see." Castaspella said as she eyed Shadow Weaver's impressive collection of potions. "Ever tried to sell them for money?"

"Nonsense, no-one would buy anything from me." Shadow Weaver said. "You should know that."

"Things are not the same as they once were, I'm sure I could convince them that you aren't evil. And if you would show them that you regret your actions, apologize and make up for your

mistakes. I'm sure things will turn out just fine." Castaspella said, trying to convince Shadow Weaver.

"Save it. Aside from Micah, I have no regrets about what I did at that time. Nor did I make mistakes! It's their own incompetence that things led to this." Shadow Weaver said. "Besides, those old creeps deserved that!"

This got Castaspella concerned. Shadow Weaver admitted she had no regrets killing those council members, but she also called them creeps... Castaseplla couldn't wrap her fingers around that, maybe she could get some answers from her

She just had to be careful what to say.

"What do you mean by creeps? All of them have been quite nice."

"It's something I don't want to talk about, let's change the subject." Shadow Weaver said and sighed.

Castaspella could notice something different in Shadow Weaver's voice and mannerisms when talking about her past with the other council members. Maybe there's something she doesn't know, but how would it be possible? She was the Head-Sorcerer, she should know all these things.

Unless, Norwyn didn't tell everything and there was something rotten at Mystacor.

"Well, what about Princess Prom? What do you think of that?" Castaspella asked, changing the subject as was asked.

"Well.. I don't really have an opinion about it. I was more about the books and knowledge. Proms were the last thing I would have cared for." Shadow Weaver answered.

"But you cared about this one because of Catra?"

"Yes, she deserves better. I want to give her the best I can, she doesn't have to end up like me."

"You mean like old and bitter?" Castaspella asked jokingly.

Shadow Weaver sighed. "If you want to see it that way.. Point is, Catra has gone through enough and I'm still not quite fond of her fighting with the Rebellion."

"I can see why you would be worried, but I assure you. Catra is in safe hands." Castaspella said comforting Shadow Weaver.

"I hope so." Shadow Weaver said. "I'll be back soon."

Castaspella nodded as Shadow Weaver went upstairs.

Shadow Weaver walked into Catra's room and noticed that her locket was on the nightstand. She had probably forgotten it. The locket contained a picture of them both. She had given it to Catra, so she would carry at least a small bit of her with her.

"Maybe I should go and give it to her... No, I don't want to ruin her evening." Shadow Weaver said, but picked up the locket just in case.

She went back downstairs and when she entered the kitchen, she saw Castaspella touching her potions. "Castaspella?"

Castaspella froze on her place. "I didn't think you would be that fast.. It's not what it seems like, I was just curious." She said and rubbed the back of her head awkwardly.

"What am I going to do with you.." Shadow Weaver said jokingly. "You truly are an airhead."

"I'm not, I prefer the term carefree." Castaspella defended. "Why don't you take your mask off? It doesn't suit you."

"It's there for a reason and you know it."

"You are so boring, yet you say variety is the spice."

"The mask stays on, you saw my face last time and you know how it ended." Shadow Weaver retorted.

"What? Don't tell me you're afraid of me?" Castaspella asked with a teasing tone. "Great and powerful Shadow Weaver gets defeated by a single kiss."

"Ha ha, really fun." Shadow Weaver said. "You might think it's some silly reason like that, but in the end it's to keep others safe from myself."

"Fine, I won't press you about that anymore." Castaspella said. "You might even banish me into the shadow realm.."

"First; there's no shadow realm and second; I don't even have a slightest idea how to banish anyone anywhere."

"Way to ruin a joke, you must be real fun at parties." Castaspella said with a sour expression on her face.

"Jokes on you, I have never been in a party." Shadow Weaver shot a quick comeback at Castaspella.

Thry both laughed out loud, which was weird. Shadow Weaver usually didn't laugh at jokes. And especially to a joke that bad. Who knows, maybe Castaspella's carefreeness is contagious.

Time passed fast with the company of Castaspella and before Shadow Weaver knew it was already late evening. "It's so late already. Time really went by fast." She said as she looked outside from the window.

"Oh my, it really is late." Castaspella gasped. "I should be going."

"Whispering Woods is a dangerous place during the night." Shadow Weaver warned.

"Aaha, I know what you are trying." Castaspella said, smirking. "You are trying to scare me, but it won't work."

"I'm being serious." Shadow Weaver said with an annoyed tone.

"I can always teleport." Castaspella said assuring.

"With your sloppiness with sigils, you might end up on the other side of Etheria."

"Seriously? Are we doing this, right now?" Castaspella asked, clearly offended by Shadow Weaver's remarks.

"Ugh! What I'm saying is, it would be better if you'd stay here for the night." Shadow Weaver said.

This changed Castaspella's mood completely, was she really offering for her to stay for the night? "Really? You would offer me a place to stay?"

"Yes, why wouldn't I." Shadow Weaver answered. "Last thing I want is something to happen to you and when they would know I was involved... it would be a disaster."

"I guess you're right." Castaspella said. "So, do we share a bed?" She said with a flirty voice and winked at her.

Shadow Weaver shook her head. "No, you will sleep on the couch."

"What!? That's not how it's supposed to go!"

"You will sleep on a couch like a guest and that is final." Shadow Weaver said with a stern tone.

"Ugh.. fine.." Castaspella murmured.

"That couch is really comfy and it can be turned to bed as well." Shadow Weaver explained, hoping to calm Castaspella.

" *But that's beside the point...* " Castaspella thought to herself.

Shadow Weaver offered her a blanket and a comfy pillow. When Shadow Weaver was sure that Castaspella had settled down on

the couch, she herself went to sleep.

Next morning they would have breakfast and Castaspella would go back to Mystacor.

Chapter End Notes

So I hope the next chapter I finally will be able to write the prom. It took me way too long to make this as well.

Princess Prom

Chapter Summary

> Princess Prom is here and everyone are here to enjoy a good time and maybe even get a new member to fight for the cause of the Rebellion, but what happens when Horde princess Scorpia comes by with her plus one, Scratch.

Chapter Notes

> Finally, it's here. Took me too long to write this...

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It was the day of the Princess Prom, the ancient tradition of Etheria.

In the early evening, the guests from all across Etheria arrived at the Kingdom of Ice. Glimmer had teleported Catra and Adora with her there. As they arrived at the gates, they were asked to hand out their weapons. "This is a neutral area and weapons here are forbidden." The guard said. Adora was hesitant to give her sword, but agreed to give her sword.

They arrived at the great hall of the castle, it was tall with ice pillars and ice chandeliers. Everything was made out of ice. "Well that's a sight to behold." Catra said as she looked around with an amazed look on her face.

"Yeah, it is quite big." Adora said.

"Come on, we better go and greet Princess Frosta." Glimmer said and asked Adora and Catra to follow her.

"I'm sure if we get her to join the Rebellion, other princesses surely would follow through." Adora said hopefully.

"Wait, we are here to recruit a princess?" Catra asked.

"Yes, we need to get more members. To defeat the Horde." Glimmer said.

"Well, better hope you succeed." Catra answered.

They walked up to the throne and bowed down in front of the princess. Good manners were no issue for Catra and Adora got through it quite well, even if she is a little bit awkward.

When they raised their heads, they saw that the princess looked like a ten years old.

"What, she looks like a ten year old." Adora let out. It caught the attention of the guests and the princess herself. Catra just facepalmed.

"Actually, I'm eleven and three quarters." Frosta stated.

"Eheh.. Allow us to introduce ourselves." Glimmer said apologetically. "I am princess Glimmer and I come from Brightmoon, under the ancient rules of hospitality." Glimmer then pointed her hands towards Adora and Catra. "She is princess Adora and the legendary warrior, She-Ra."

This got the guests talking and whispering to each other. Was She-Ra herself here?

"And this is Catra, she-" Glimmer was interrupted by Catra. "I am Catra and I come from a royal family of a now deceased race, my ornament is only real proof that I belong to royalty." She said and bowed once more.

"You are welcomed here under the ancient rule of hospitality, leave conflict at the door and of course enjoy the ball." Frosta said with a calm and icy tone.

"Thank-" Adors was about to say, but they were escorted by the guards already. "Oh.."

"Well that could have gone better." Catra winked at Adora.

"You could have told me she was a child." Adora said, looking at Glimmer.

"You did all that research, I thought you knew!" Glimmer said. "Ugh, anyways. Evening is still young, we'll have a lot of chances to convince her. Let's just rock this ball!"

As they looked around, they saw some familiar faces. Mermista had come with Sea Hawk and even Entrapta had came as well. Then Bow came With Perfuma and they looked like a really good couple which made Glimmer feel jealousy even more, though she didn't admit it out loud.

"Hello Mermista, it's been a while. How's your kingdom?" Adora greeted.

"I guess it's fine-" Mermista said but the Sea Hawk cut in. "It's been fabulous, ever since the Sea Gate was fixed Mermista has been in a much better mood."

"That's great to hear." Adora said.

"Ugh, why do you have to cut in when I'm talking? You are really testing my nerves." Mermista said, gritting her teeths.

"Oh come on, we are a couple." Sea Hawk added.

"Nope, he's just my ride." Mermista said. "Anyways, where are the drinks? I need some." Then Mermista left after the drinks. "To the buffet!" Sea Hawk added and went after Mermista.

"How are those two even a couple?" Catra asked, puzzled. They seem to be so dysfunctional."

"This has been a great encounter, these social events truly are a source for interesting data." Entrapta cut in.

"Uhh, Entrapta what exactly are you doing?" Adora asked.

"I'm doing a social experiment. Ooh, there seems to be another juicy event. See you around." Entrapta said and ran off.

"You truly have weird friends." Catra said.

"You'll get used to it." Adora said and sighed.

Then Bow and Perfuma came towards Adora, Catra and Glimmer. "Good evening Adora." Perfuma said.

"Oh, good evening-" Adora was cut off by Glimmer. "Ahahah, that was such a good story. Oh, Perfuma. I'm sorry but Adora just told me something so funny. We'll go for a moment."

"Umm... okay." Perfuma said little bit confused. Catra just sighed. " *And her jealousy wasn't serious? You sure? "* Catra thought to herself as she watched Glimmer drag Adora away.

"Is there something wrong with Glimmer?" Perfuma asked.

"I don't know, I'm not an expert." Catra answered. "But I can see why Bow wanted to come with you. You truly look marvelous."

"Why thank you.. ummm.. Catra, was it?"

"Yes, if you excuse me, I'm going to get my plus one back." Catra said and went after Adora and Glimmer.

"Glimmer, there's nothing wrong if someone is with someone else." Adora said. "Are you sure you're not bothered?"

"I'm fine, it's nothing." Glimmer said and kept looking at Bow who had fun with the others.

"You know you could just join in right?" Adora asked.

"I know."

Adora sighed, Glimmer was being quite stubborn. Then she saw Frosta at the buffet table and decided it would be a good time to go ask her to join the rebellion. "Uhh, Princess Frosta is there, so I'm going to try again asking her to join. Do you wanna come?"

Glimmer nodded, but she clearly didn't pay any attention to what Adora was saying.

"Fine, well I'm going, see you." Adora said and left.

Catra caught up with Adora soon after. "Hey Adora, what was that about?"

"I don't know, Glimmed doesn't seem to be her usual self."

"Don't bother her, she will surely come to her senses." Catra said. "Anyways where are you going?"

"I'm trying to ask Princess Frosta again, she is at the buffet table." Adora said as they walked.

"About joining the Rebellion? That sure went well before."

"Catra, not helping."

They arrived at the buffet table and both bowed in front of Princess Frosta. "I'm sorry how I acted earlier."

"I know you're sorry." Frosta answered. "But as an honorary princess, you can't be expected to know any better. Same goes for your feline friend."

" *I'll show you the expected to know better..* " Catra muttered through her teeth and clenched her fists. Adora tried to calm Catra down. "Princess Frosta, your kingdom is truly great and I'm honored to be here. My friend is little bit hot headed."

" *WHAT? Hot headed?... You don't know what you're talking about..* " Catra thought to herself.

"Thank you and I now expect you to ask me to join the rebellion." Frosta said.

"You know about that?" Adora asked.

"Of course I know, princesses do talk, you know." Frosta said. Catra didn't see Frosta at all and Adora still tried to convince her to join.

"The Rebellion needs you, your kingdom is largest in Etheria and it could really help to turn the tide against the Horde." Adora said as she kneeled before her.

"Horde has not threatened us here."

"Only because your kingdom is so far away, but that doesn't matter to Hordak right now. Joining the rebellion would be your best bet."

Frosta got closer to Adora and gave her a cold stare. "The Kingdom of Snow has defended itself perfectly well for thousands of years. We don't need your help or your rebellion." Few guards came up to Frosta and she was ready to leave. "Please continue enjoying the ball."

When she had gone Catra shared her mind openly to Adora. "She's quite a bitch... excuse my language, but she is."

"Catra, I know she's cold, but it's not good to insult your host." Adora said and sighed in deep.

"Whatever, I'm not a princess myself and I don't even know if I ever wanted to be one."

"Agh! This is getting tiring." Adora let out a tired plea.

"Why don't you go relax and I'll bring you something to drink. You look pretty burned out." Catra said and tapped her on the shoulder.

"You're right. I'll go up there where Glimmer is." Adora said and went off while Catra decided to get some drinks.

Adora sat on the couch next to Glimmer and let out a loud sigh. Glimmer noticed her and asked. "Where have you been all this time?"

"I told you I'm going to convince Frosta to join, but it seems it's harder than I thought it to be." Adora said, but Glimmer just sighed and kept looking from the balcony.

Adora turned to look at her and noticed she was looking at Bow, who seemed to have a great time with others. "Does it bother you that much?"

"Well.. no.. Bow can be with whoever he wants. It's just I didn't have many friends. It was me and Bow.." Glimmer said and sighed. "I'm afraid he will forget me.."

Adora put hand on Glimmer's shoulder. "Listen, Bow won't forget you, he isn't that kind of guy and-" But Adora was cut off when she saw Scorpia and Scratch walk in.

"What are they doing here? Glimmer, we gotta go."

Glimmer nodded and followed Adora. Catra arrived at the balcony with the drinks, but Adora and Glimmer were gone by then. "Hey Adora, I brought you drinks." She greeted, but there were none up there. "Of course..."

Before Catra could do anything, she felt a hard slam on the back of her head and she fell unconscious.

Meanwhile at Frosta's throne. "Revered hostess, Frosta, you can't let these two here, they are from the Horder." Adora said.

Scratch just rolled her eyes. "Uh revered hostess, princess Scorpia was invited as per the rules of this ball. And I have the utmost respect for these rules."

"You do not! You-" Adora was cut off by Frosta. "Princess Adora, the rules state that the princesses and their chosen guests are welcome."

"But, they are up to something, I can feel it!"

"That' enough!" Frosta started with a cold stare. "You see a child, but I have worked so hard to gain the respect. Only to throw it away, because you feel they're up to something."

Adora looked away while Scratch seemed to be amused by this.

"For a centuries the Princess Prom has been a neutral ground. Princesses get plus ones, they stay!"

Then both Adora and Glimmer felt hands on their shoulders and the guards moved them aside. As they sat there dumbfounded, Scratch and Scorpia came by. "Wow, I'm shocked Adora. I mean we aren't breaking any rules here. We're here for the ball." Scratch said with a nonchalant tone. "Didn't you read the invite?" She added a sarcastic remark towards Adora.

"For the rest of the prom till its end, I'll be watching for you. Wherever you go, I'll go." Adora said.

Catra and Scratch shared a look. "Eh, suit yourself. I don't care. I'm here to ball!" Scratch said and walked off with Scorpia.

Adora stood up and groped, she was way too frustrated by Scratch she had completely forgotten Catra. "Ugh, Glimmer you take Scorpia and I take Scratch."

Adora keeps following Scratch through the ball and Scratch deliberately acts suspicious, to make Adora look bad in front of others. And once again she has lost sight of her target, until she sees Scratch going up to the balcony where Entrapta is.

Glimmer, meanwhile, is keeping eye on Scorpia who is munching all the possible food she can. Then Glimmer sees a bow walk past and she decides to go confront him, but it doesn't go well.

Entrapta is sitting on the railing and is leaning way too much over it. Scratch is right behind her back. "Don't touch her!" Adora yells as she thinks Scratch is going to do something, but to her surprise she catches Entrpata when she's about to fall.

"Oh hi Adora, have you met my new assistant, she brought me snacks." Entrapta said. Adora had a confused look on her face.

"She stole my food, but asked me to spy on people with her." Scratch said, smirking.

Adora quickly took Entrapta's hand and pulled her away. "Entrapta, she's from the Horde." But Entrapta jsut kept looking at Adora. "The people the rebellion are fighting against. Same rebellion you're part of."

Then it clicked on her. "Oooh, well in that case we should keep a better eye on her, because she just walked off."

" *Damn it!* " Adora muttered.

Meanwhile Bow was walking on the main entrance of the castle, he was getting his warm jacket. He didn't like how things ended up with Glimmer, but hoped they could talk it out after. He then sees Scorpia standing next to the pillar and planting something on it.

"What in the.. Oh no!" Bow realizes that she's been planting bombs. Bow quickly runs to the main door and tells the guards. "Princess Scorpia is planting heat bombs, we must tell the princess-" But none of the guards say anything.Bow turns to look around and sees Scorpia standing there with Adora's sword. "Let me GO!" Scorpia then strikes him down with her sting and Bow falls on the floor, unconscious.

Back at the main hall Adora is still following Scratch, but then princess Frosta announces its time for the evening's first dance. Adora gets swept alongside the group of people who rush on the dance floor.

Different colored lights lit up and everyone was picking up their pairs, except Adora who stood alone in the middle of it. She then remembers that she was supposed to be here with Catra, but she's nowhere to be seen. In fact, she hadn't seen after she first tried to convince Frosta.

Then Scratch extends her hand out towards Adora. "Care to dance?" She said, smirking.

"Ugh, only because I'm not letting you out of my sight anymore." Adora said and took her hand.

As they are dancing, Scratch taunts Adora. "I don't know about you, but I've had real killer fun here."

"Whatever you are planning, it's not gonna work." Adora said threateningly.

"Ohh, I'm shivering in my pants... but it's not because of you. It's because this place is freezing."

As they spin around Scratch leaves Adora and Glimmer takes her hand and she seems to be crying. They continue dancing and Adora asks what's wrong.

"I got in a fight with Bow and now he doesn't want to be friends with me anymore! And I don't know where Scorpia is!"

"What?" Adora asked with shock on her face. "Glimmer don-" But it was too late, she was gone as well.

Then Perfuma took Adora's hand and they continued to dance. "Have you seen Bow? He went to get his jacket, but it was a while ago." Peruma asked with a worried tone. "He left right about the same time as that Horde princess."

"Wait, do you mean Scorpia?" Adora asks and changes her pair back to Glimmer. "When did you last see Bow?" She asked.

"A while ago." Glimmer answered with teary eyes. "Isn't he with Perfuma?"

"No, Perfuma said he's been gone since this whole time."

Then Scratch once again took Adora's hand and leaned against her shoulder. "Maybe my plan won't work." She said, smirking. "But then again..." She takes aggressive dance moves and pulls Adora down. "Maybe my plan has already worked." She said with a devilish smirk on her face. Then she pulls Adora back up. "Say, where's your friends? Bow? And that annoying furball?"

Adora feels rage boiling inside of her and she punches Scratch on the face and pushes her against the floor. "What did you do to them?!" She asked with angry tone and lifet Scratch up by her collar.

Scratch just smiles. "Nothing permanent."

Other members of the party seem to be terrified of what they have just seen. Adora doesn't care about that anymore. "Tell me what you did, right NOW-" She was then cut off by ice and she then found herself confine in ice. She saw Frosta standing in front of her. "Revered hostess, she's got-" But she was cut off by Frosta's cold stare and tone. "Princess Prom is a ceremony of unity, violence is strictly prohibited."

"You don't understand." Adora said.

"I understand perfectly!" Frosta raised her voice. "As hostess and in accordance with the rules that's down over centuries. I hereby revoke your invitation!" If stares could kill, she would have killed Adora by now. "You are to leave my kingdom and never ever to-" But he's caught off by explosions around the hall.

All of a sudden the pillars start to blow up and the palace roof starts to crumble, all the guests are terrified and start to panic and run around. Frosta tries to calm everyone down, but it's no use. She's being escorted away by the guards, towards the ice rune that resides under the castle.

Adora looks at Glimmer. "Glimmer, Scratch has Bow and Catra, you have to find them!"

Glimmer nods and teleports away.

Scratch is still standing next to Adora who is still held inside of the ice cage. "What did you do!?"

"I didn't do anything." She answers nonchalantly. "But Scorpia, Kyle and Lonnie on the other hand were really busy. It was fun to distract you."

"This isn't a game! People are going to get hurt!" Adora yells as Scratch is walking away. Scratch couldn't care less about Adora's opinions, instead she just shows her middle finger as she continues to walk away.

Luckily for Adora, one of the pillars falls down on her ice cage and allowing her to pursue Scratch.

Meanwhile at the outside of the crumbling castle, Glimmer is looking for Bow and Catra. "Bow!? Catra!?" She yells.

Then she notices a Horde ship outside and sees Catra and Bow being dragged inside of the ship. She immediately goes after and tries to stop them, but Scorpia catches her and stings her as well.

"These princesses are not that hard to defeat." Scorpia said and picked up Glimmer's unconscious body.

Frosta has reached the ice rune located in the heart of the castle, she immediately proceeds to use her magic throughout the rune and stop the castle from collapsing. Her magic stops the falling pieces and she öevitates them back where they belong. This is a temporary solution though.

Adora keeps running after Scratch until they reach a bridge high above the main castle between the two towers. "You're trapped." Adora yelled as she catched up to her.

Scratch lets out a sigh. "I guess so." Then she pulls her sword through dark matter. This shocks Adora, there are not many who can use dark magic like that. "How did you do that!?"

"Being an apprentice of Darkith has it's good sides as well."

"She taught you dark magic?"

"Not exactly, but enhanced some of my equipment, such as this sword." She said smirking and swinging her sword elegantly. "Now tell me, where's your sword?"

Adora remembers that she gave her sword back at the inspection, so she doesn't actually have a sword. But there seems to be a long and sharp enough ice sickle on the bridge, so she grabs it and raises it.

"Are you kidding me? Ice sickle?" Scratch asked, laughing mockingly. "Whatever, there's no going back!"

They start to fight on top of the bridge and even if Adora has to use an ice sickle, her combat training in the Horde made her a capable fighter. She could pick up a stick and still put up a fight. As their weapons clash, Scratch keeps taunting her. "Tell me, what are you going to do after this?"

"Stop playing around!" Adora yelled and swung at Scratch's right hand.

"Oh, that was a close one, but not enough." She said and lunged towards Adora and cut deep into her right arm. Making Adora drop her weapon, she fell on her knees in front of Scratch and she pointed her plade towards Adora's neck.

"This is wonderful, this time that annoying little furball is not here to ruin my victory!" Then the bridge starts to crumble, the shaking of the towers had made the bridge unstable and crack from it's joints. "Oh, it seems we have to continue this some other time." Scratch said and jumped off from the bridge.

Adora slowly stood up and could hear the engines of a ship. She looked down and saw a Horde ship coming through the mist and on its cockpit stood Scratch with the rest of Horde members and with three hostages and her sword.

Scratch swung Adora's sword playfully and laughed, she then kicked Catra's unconscious body, which made Adora flinch her eyes. She then waved her hand at Adora. "It was a real killer ball! Enjoy the downfall of the Rebellion." The Horde ship then flew off, gliding through the misty landscape towards the Fright Zone.

Adora sat down on the bridge, tears falling down from her face. How could this happen, what could have been done to stop it from happening. Was this her fault, for being so blind and only focusing on Scratch. And who is gonna tell Shadow Weaver that Catra has been taken by the Horde.

Chapter End Notes

Well then, that's the chapter. Dear goodness what am I gonna do now...

Aftermath of the Princess Prom

Chapter Summary

> Princess Prom was a utter failure, Rebellion lost three members to Horde. One of them being princess Glimmer. How will Angella react to this and will there be any chance to get them back, but what about Shadow Weaver? How will she react to this?

Chapter Notes

> Fair Warning, this chapter includes torture, but it's not anything worse than we have seen in the show. This isn't going to be a bloodfest, but just wanted to let you guys know.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Scratch arrived at the Fright Zone with Scorpia and the rest of the group. Darkith was waiting on the Horde's landing pad, she was looking with a keen eye as they brought the prisoners out from the ship. Scratch walked towards Darkith.

"Darkith." She said and saluted. "We brought three prisoners and the sword of She-Ra."

"I'm quite impressed that you managed to do that." Darkith said. "One of them even seems to be a real princess."

"Yes, she is Glimmer and the daughter of Angella and Micah."

Darkith gave an approving look to Scratch and said. "You did well, but as the rules go. Everything you succeed with, I take the credit as your superior."

"What!?" Scratch yelled. "So I do the work and you get the credit? That's not fair, this was my plan!"

"Life is not fair!" Darkith said with a stern voice. "You are under my command and I am your superior. That's how it goes!" Darkith then took the sword and the unconscious princess. She could finally show her progress to Hordak.

Scratch was cursing silently, but let her anger go. She then decided to ask what to do with the other two prisoners.

"Throw them into a dungeon, I don't care. You can do whatever you want with them." Darktih said dismissively. "I thought you hated that cat, so do whatever you want. That might be a suitable reward for you."

Scratch was still disappointed that she was denied credit, but she got free hands on Catra. She didn't care about Bow, he was so insignificant.

"Force Captain Scratch, what do we do to the prisoners?" Scorpia asked.

"Lock them in the dungeon, I want to integrate that furball myself."

"Alright." Scorpia said and saluted. "Kyle, Lonnie, Roghelio! Take them to the dungeon and wait for orders."

"Aye." They answered and dragged unconscious bodies of Catra and Bow into dungeon.

At the Kingdom of Ice there was a grim atmosphere. Princess Glimmer and Bow were taken, alongside Catra. No-one really

didn't know what to do. Queen Angella had already been informed about the situation at the prom. Adora was nowhere to be seen, until she was found on top of the bridge between the two main towers. She was sitting on her knees, tears flowing through her cheeks. She couldn't believe what just happened. She promised to look out for Catra and now she had failed. How would Shadow Weaver react when she hears about this. Adora let out a desperate cry, cursing the destiny that had fallen on to her.

Two guards escorted her down from the bridge as it was still not safe. When she was on the ground she met with other princesses. Adora was a mess and even if she felt guilty about herself, it changed when she saw Frosta. Her first reaction was to yell at her, but she decided against it and instead just let out a deep sigh. Adora was well disciplined, so she wouldn't do anything that would make things worse.

Frosta could feel a sting in her heart as she watches Adora being escorted away. She didn't dare do anything to Adora.

Adora was escorted back to Brightmoon and the rest of the princesses taught what to do. They couldn't leave Glimmer and Bow at the hands of the Horde.

At Brightmoon, Angella's mind was breaking. Her Daughter was taken by the Horde and she couldn't afford to lose her as well. She was the only thing left from Micah as well.

Castaspella had arrived at Brightmoon, to console her.

"What am I going to do?!" Angella yelled. "Glimmer is captured by the Horde, who knows what they are going to do to her!"

"There, there. I'm sure we can come up with something." Castaspella said, trying to calm the frustrated queen.

"That's right, we gotta think of something." Angella said, trying to calm down.

"That's right, just take a deep breath and let it out."

Angella tried to do as instructed, but it didn't help at all. "Argh! It's not helping at all!"

" *Oh what am I going to do?* " Castaspella thought to herself.

Adora sat in her room, which she had shared with Catra. She couldn't do anything and the thought of Shadow Weaver hearing about this didn't help her at all. She didn't have any strenght left to tell her. Her best chance was trying to save Catra, Glimmer and Bow.

But how could she succeed, especially when she was alone.

Meanwhile at the dungeons of Fright Zone, Catra slowly opened her eyes. She felt dizzy, the hit on her head was pretty hard. She noticed that her hands were bound by chains which hung from the dungeon ceiling.

"Well, well. Look who's awake at last." Catra could hear a mocking tone from a shady fugure. "Finally, you're here with me and you can't do any of those tricks of yours."

"Uhhh, who are you?" Catra asked.

"Don't tell me you have forgotten that already. Name's Scratch and last time we met, it was the most humiliating moment in my life."

"Aaa, you're that one, the one bad at sword fighting. Can't believe you lost to me back then." Catra mocked.

"You're playing with your life!" Scratch threatened.

"Good thing we cats have more lives than one." She continued with a nonchalant tone.

Scratch couldn't take any more snarky comments from Catra, so she took the stun baton and struck it on Catra's back.

Catra could feel the electric shock run through her and it was painful, but she didn't show it. "You know you're lost an argument when you place words with violence." Catra said, still defying the dire situation she was in.

"You want to make this hard huh? Well I'm going to enjoy the moment your smug smirk fades and turn into agony."

Catra rolled her eyes. "Do your worst." Catra was pretty reckless, she really played with her life and how long could she actually take those electric shocks.

Shock after shock, Catra's smugness faded and was filled with pain. But that didn't stop her from taunting Scratch. "You know.. agh.. these electric shocks.. ahh.. really don't work that well."

"You're just acting tough, I can see through your act." Scratch said. "So, I thought we would turn it up a notch." She then proceeded to pick up a hot iron. "Let's see how long you'll last?" Scratch said with a sadistic smile on her face as she brought the hot iron close to Catra's face.

Catra gulped and thought that maybe she should have just kept her mouth shut.

Meanwhile at the Darkith's chambers, Glimmer was restrained by something that looked like an electric beam and in front of her

stood a tall figure.

"Ah, Princess. You're awake." Cold and hollow voice said.

"Who are you?! Where am I!?" Glimmer yelled, confused and scared.

"You are in my chambers and I truly enjoyed going through your mind. You are Micha's daughter."

"How do you know Micah!?" Glimmer asked, with a panic in her voice.

"Foolish girl, I defeated him during the battle with the first alliance." Darkith said and let out a small laugh.

"What!? I thought Shadow Weaver killed him!?"

"Quite the contrary, she actually tried to protect him and she was a really capable fighter with her magic. Shame she couldn't save your father."

Glimmer was shocked, through all her life she thought Shadow Weaver was the reason. She was the one who wrapped Micah into dark magic, by trying to summon that spell. And her involvement in changes of the battle plans was the reason why they lost.

Or that was what her mother told her.

Hordak contacted Darkith through one of the monitor screens in her chambers. "Darkith, I congratulate you on your success."

"Thank you, Lord Hodak." Darkith said and bowed.

"We have just sent an ultimatum to the Queen of Brightmoon, total surrender of Brightmoon and the Queen herself in exchange for Princess Glimmer's life." Hordak said.

"That is great, Lord Hordak." Darkith said.

"You have proven your worth, for now." Hordak said.

"Thank you, my lord." Darkith said and stood back up when Hordak had disconnected.

Darkith turned to look at Glimmer who was trying to teleport away from the confines. Darkith let out a small laugh and said. "Don't try anything stupid, you'll only hurt yourself more."

"You're never gonna get away with this!" Glimmer yelled threateningly.

"I do agree with your statement, if I don't get She-Ra that is." She said and filled the room with darkness. "Welcome to the Fright Zone, Princess."

It was late midday and Catra was nowhere to be seen yet. It was odd, Catra usually was one for following rules and agreements.

Shadow Weaver wasn't really worried about Catra, but it was unusual. She had a weird feeling that something wasn't right. "Something is off, Catra should have come already." She said to herself and looked outside from the window. Castaspella had left yesterday and she was now alone once again. "No, I can't just sit here and do nothing, I do that way too much." She said and filled herself with determination to go. "I will go to Brightmoon and I will get answers."

Even if she hated Brightmoon, she had to know Catra was alright. She picked up her mask and headed towards Brightmoon.

What she hadn't noticed was that the picture of Catra in her room had its glass cracked.

Adora on the other hand was planning how to get to the Fright Zone and save her friends. She knew the layout of the place, so that wasn't the hard part. It was doing it alone.

But then she was greeted by Perfuma who had arrived, alongside Mermista, Sea Hawk, Frosta and Entrapta.

Adora was confused. "What are you all doing here?"

"Well we thought that we needed to get Glimmer, Bow and Catra back." Perfuma said. "They are our friends and we need to stick together.

"I agree." Mermista said. "You helped a lot with the Sea Gate, so it's only fair we help you to get our friends back."

"And I would gladly accept your offer to join the rebellion." Frosta said with an apologetic look on her face. "Princess Prom was a disaster and I am sorry how I treated you and your friend."

"And the help at Dryl was quite a big one." Entrapta said. "Even if I don't grasp all social situations well, I still want to help and invading the Fright Zone would be a challenge."

Adora was overwhelmed with happiness. All these princesses came here to help her with the plan to get her and their friends back. "Thank you, I can't express my gratitude enough."

"Just tell us the plan and we'll follow." Perfuma said and others nodded in agreement.

Adora then proceeded to go through her plan.

As Shadow Weaver approached Brightmoon, she could tell something was off. Guards at the gate didn't question her, which was unheard of.

She decided to try her luck and asked where Adora and Catra resided.

One of the guards looked at her and noticed she was Shadow Weaver. Guard alarmed other nearby guards and soon Shadow Weaver was being dragged by the guards towards the main castle. " *That could have gone better..* " She thought to herself.

She was brought to the main hall of Brightmoon where Angella and Castaspella were still debating over what to do.

"Your highness, Queen Angella." Guard announced, getting both of their attention. "We caught an intruder at the gates."

"Shadow Weaver?" Angella asked. "What are you doing here?"

"I came to see if Catra was here. She should have been at home by now."

Castaspella then realized that Shadow Weaver didn't know what had happened at the Princess Prom. Castaspella had a grim and painful look on her face. "Uhh, well you better sit down. It's going to be ugly." Castaspella said.

"What do you mean Castaspella?" Shadow Weaver asked, confused. "I'm already held on my knees."

Castaspella took a deep breath. "Catra was taken by the Horde, alongside Bow and Glimmer."

"What!? What did you just say?" Shadow Weaver raised her voice. Her hair started to float upwards and from the bottom of her long dress, dark shadowy tendrils started to appear.

Angella stepped in as she noticed Shadow Weaver's sudden change. "Don't even dare to try anything!"

"I'm not! I just don't believe what I heard." Shadow Weaver said. "Is that true?"

"Unfortunately, it is." Angella answered with a heavy tone. "Princess Scorpia was invited to the prom, because she's a princess and the princess prom is neutral ground."

Shadow Weaver started laughing and with a mocking tone she said. "You mean, you let well known Horde members into a party where no weapons are allowed? That is utterly ridiculous!"

"Shadow Weaver!" Angella commanded with a stern voice. "I know things weren't perfect, but everyone has always obeyed the rules of the Princess Prom. It's a long tradition"

"Do you think Horde would obey your stupid rules?! They don't care about anything!" Shadow Weaver yelled. "And now due to incompetence of princesses, I have lost Catra to those whom I swore to protect her!"

"Shadow Weaver." Castaspella tried to calm her down. "We'll get her back as well. We promise."

"Like I was promised that Catra was being taken care of?" Shadow Weaver asked with a mocking tone. "I can't take either of your words for that."

"What do you know about care?!" Angella snapped. "You are an abomination! Twisted by dark magic and the will to conquer!"

Shadow Weaver looked at Angella and snapped right back at her. "You don't know anything about me! Catra is everything for me, without her I would have killed you right then when I had a chance!"

"Shadow Weaver!" Castaspella stepped in. "You don't mean that."

"I MEANT EVERY WORD I SAID!" Shadow Weaver yelled at Castaspella. She didn't mean to, but it was too late to retract what she had said.

She then turned around and stormed away from the castle, if the guards tried to even come near her she would kill them.

Castaspella collected her cool and gathered all her courage to ask. "Where are you going?"

"I'm going to fix the mess you all have caused." Shadow Weaver hissed through her teeths.

Then Spell of Obtainment raised its voice. " *What are you going to do?* "

"Are you hungry?" Shadow Weaver asked with a cunning tone. "Do you hunger for life energy?"

" *Uhh.. maybe. What's your plan?* " Spell of Obtainment asked. The Entity was confused because Shadow Weaver hadn't acted like this, ever.

"We are going to pay a visit to the Fright Zone and you can have your eat all you want at the buffet." Shadow Weaver said slyly.

" *Now we're talking.* " Entity said with excitement. Entity could feel Shadow Weaver's rage boiling inside and this time there was no-one to stop her. Entity was more than pleased, finally it and Shadow Weaver were on a same wavelength." *Good, let the anger flow through you. I can feel it.* "

Shadow Weaver didn't protest against the entity this time, she needed all of its help to succeed and she didn't want any complications.

What Shadow Weaver didn't know was that Angella had already agreed to exchange herself for Glimmer. But it wouldn't have mattered to Shadow Weaver, it was their fault. Their incompetence and most of all, her fault for trusting them.

At the Fright Zone, Scratch was done with Catra. She said she was going to interrogate her, but that was just an excuse. In reality she just wanted to have vengeance over her last encounter with Catra. "I hope you do understand which one of us is superior." Scratch said and looked at battered Catra who was gasping for air. " *How petty can one be? It's just sad.* " Catra thought to herself, but ultimately she was too burned out and just fell unconscious.

Scratch looked pleased and left the dungeon, she was now on her way to Darkith's chambers. She walked past Bow who was sitting in another cell, but she couldn't care less. " *Why did we even capture him again?* " She thought.

She arrived at the chambers of Darkith. "Force Captain Scratch, reporting for duty." She said and saluted.

Darkith turned to look at Scratch and asked. "Did you get anything useful out of the other prisoners?"

"No, I didn't."

"Fine, then you can dispose of them." Darkith said and proceeded to pick up the sword of She-Ra. "Here, take this Hordak and prove your worth." She threw the sword at Scratch who caught it.

"You didn't tell Hordak about the sword?" Scratch asked.

"First, I thought I would, but I guess I had second guesses and thought that you should have credit as well." Darkith said with a rather soft tone, which was unusual for her.

"Thank you so much, Darkith." Scratch said, her eyes sparkling and excitement in her voice.

"You're welcome, now off you go."

Scratch nodded and went on her way. Darkith turned to look at Glimmer, who was clearly exhausted and tired from all the interrogation. "Don't look so upset Princess, your mother has already agreed to exchange your life for hers." She said with a sardonic tone. "Thou, what will you do after that when the Princess Alliance falls alongside with your stupid Rebellion? Hmm?"

"You will not see that day, my friends make sure of that!" Glimmer snapped with the little strength she had left.

"Your friends won't make it! And without She-Ra, you all are doomed!" Darkith said and began to laugh maniacally. She filled the room with darkness and disappeared.

Chapter End Notes

Another chapter bites the upload... okay that was really bad...

Next time, we'll see a very, very angry Shadow Weaver. Those poor souls who happen to stand on her way...

To Save The Captured Friends

Chapter Summary

> Adora and other princessess are on their mission to save their captured friends, no princess gets left behind.
> What they didn't know is that Shadow Weaver herself was on the way to Fright Zone as well.

Chapter Notes

> I could say this would count as semi-climax of the story.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora and the other princesses had laid out a grand plan how to infiltrate the Fright Zone, everyone had their roles. Entrapta worked through electricity systems and hacking, Sea Hawk being a diversion and others going heading for the prison.

Luckily for them, Bow was being escorted to a transport to Beast Island, Catra on the other hand was taken to Scratches private chambers.

Scratch didn't want to send Catra to Beast Island, since she still wanted to use her for her own enjoyment.

As the princesses continued their way inwards to the Fright Zone, they came across a convoy of soldiers escorting Bow.

"Quick! Bow's there!" Adora said. "We gotta interfere."

Perfuma tied the Horde soldiers easily with her vines and shut their mouths.

"Adora!" Bow said, relieved. "I knew you would come."

"Of course we came. Where's Glimmer and Catra?" Adora said.

"I'm not sure, Catra was being escorted somewhere. But I have no idea where Glimmer is." Bow said, with a worried tone.

"Don't worry, we'll find them." Adora said. "Now let's keep moving!"

"Oh, actually.. if my memory serves correct, Glimmer was taken by Darkith." Bow said.

"Oh no..." Adora said with a worried tone and with a grim look on her face. "Then we have to hurry! Darkith is extremely dangerous."

As the princesses continued moving through the Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver had arrived there as well. She was hiding her presence as a shadow and eyed the large area that was the Fright Zone.

" *It looks like it has high security.* " Entity said.

"Thanks for pointing out the obvious... So do you think we can do this?" Shadow Weaver said.

" *It will be like a walk in the park... except maybe in this case.. walk in the void.. hee hee... yeah... whatever...* "

"Okay, here we go. You can have full control." Shadow Weaver said and took a deep breath. "I'm ready."

" *Alright, finally we can do something.* " Spell of Obtainment said and took over Shadow Weaver's body. " *You know.. there might not be coming back from this.* "

"I don't care. All I care is Catra, if we get her safe... by any means necessary.. it's worth it."

" *Alright, your words, not mine.* " Entity confirmed that Shadow Weaver actually agreed to this.

Shadow Weaver felt her power grow stronger and she could feel her anger and all her negative emotions surfing up. She felt immense pain as new scars emereged and dug through her flesh deep into bone. She was consumed by rage, caused by immense pain, only through intense pain and hatred one can truly use the power of Spell of Obtainment.

Few Horde soldiers were looking at security cameras and soon all the electronic meters started to go into haywire, screens shut off and all of the lights went out. "Send an alarm! We have an intruder!" One of theHorde soldiers yelled.

"Iniate full site lockdown, this is emergency!" Another soldier yelled. "All soldiers, on high alert!"

All this commotion cut Hordak, Darkith, Scratch and all the princesses off guard.

"What is going on?!" Bow asked.

"They must have found out we are here!" Adora yelled. "Come on, we must hurry!"

Meanwhile Shadow Weaver approached the Fright Zone and broke through the wall. Horde soldiers tried to use laser cannons and tanks against her, but it was no use. Her power was so immense. ***"All of you ants, break down! Fall into despair!"***

"Fire at her everything we got!" Horde soldier yelled from the command room. Shadow Weaver noticed this and picked up a tank with her long dark tendrils and threw it towards the command room, blowing it and everyone inside up.

"Retrear! Retreat!" Horde soldiers were abandoning their positions and running away in terror. Not that it helped much, Shadow Weaver could easily consumed in a heartbeat. She would spare no one.

As Shadow Weaver continued her rampage through the Fright Zone, Darkith was in her chambers and demanded answers but all

the communications had been cut off due to lockdown and due to fact Shadow Weaver had destroyed their intercoms.

"I told you my friends would come." Glimmer said confidently.

"Impossible!" Darkith yelled. "Seems like I need to do it all again myself." Darkith gritted her teeth and before she teleported away, she looked at Glimmer and said. "Don't move!"

"Oh please.. not even in my wildest dreams." Glimmer said nonchalantly.

Darkith teleported outside of the Fright Zone and what she saw was a total catastrophe. "Wha in the all consuming void is this?!" She went closer to the area where the rampage was taking place. What she saw there was her old enemy, Shadow Weaver.

"Oh, so you decided to raise your head, huh?" Darkith said, hoping to gain Shadow Weaver's attention.

Shadow Weaver recognized her immediately. ***"YOU! WHERE IS CATRA! TELL ME AND I WILL END YOU MERCIFULLY!"***

"Oh, I see you have completely embraced the entity." Darkith said. "Let's see how good you'll fight now!"

Darkith readied herself for the duel, but Shadow Weaver didn't give a shit about rules of duels. She immediately overpowered Darkith easily and proceeded to strangle her with her tendrils that grew from her dark and endless shadow.

"What... How can this be?" Darkith asked, first time having fear in her voice. "How.. is- ugh.. this argh- possible!?"

"TELL ME, WHERE IS CATRA!? UNLESS YOU WANT TO KEEP SUFFER MORE!" Shadow Weaver's voice wasn't the same it was before. Her voice was mixed in with the entity and it truly gave out a terrifying voice that could petrificate anyone.

"She's.. agh- She's being -agh being taken to Beast Island.. She has no use for Hordak." Darkith tried her best to keep her voice intact.

Shadow Weaver then threw Darkith on the floor, breaking her back and all her bones. ***"When I said I would let you die mercifully.. you know what? I lied."*** She told her with a sadistic tone and proceeded her way towards the inner parts of the Fright Zone.

Meanwhile Adora and other princesses had arrived at Darkith's chambers. "Okay, be ready. She is really powerful and dangerous." Adora told them and readied herself to confront her. But when they broke in there was no-one there.

"Uhh, where is she?" Mermista asked.

"Not here it seems." Adora answered.

They saw Glimmer who was chained with some sort of magic? electric chains? Who knew, but that wasn't important. All that mattered was to save Glimmer.

"Adora! Bow!" Glimmer yelled with hope and relief in her voice. "You all came here, I knew you would."

"Of course." Adora said. "We need to get you out of this."

"Don't try it, it seems to be some sort of magic." Glimmer said.

"Oh, I can try to hack the systems." Entrapta suggested. "All I need is a computer."

"There's one." Mermista pointed at one.

"Nice, just wait a sec. You'll be free in a moment." Entrapta said and proceeded to hack the systems.

At the other side of the Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver had eased her rampage and was now walking through the hallways destroying everything that stood in her way. ***"Where is the prison?"*** She asked with a hollow voice, but didn't get any answers. All the soldiers were just begging mercy, but she couldn't care less. So she just consumed them without even looking at them.

Scratch was near her chambers and she didn't have any idea what was going on. She tried to talk to intercoms, but there were no answers. Red lights flickered through the Fright Zone halls and distant explosions could be heard. "What the hell is going on!?"

She didn't notice that Catra had come to her senses and proceeded to creep behind her. Holding a metal pipe she raised her hands and smacked the shit out of Scratch. As Scratch's unconscious body fell on the hallway floor, Catra looked at her and said. "Karma is a bitch." She then started running away, but she had no idea where she was going. Her countless burn marks and bruises from all the electric shocks still stung her and made her running difficult.

Shadow Weaver flowed through the hallways until she arrived at Darkith's chambers. She teared through the wall into the room, scaring all the princesses in it.

"Shadow Weaver!?" Adora yelled.

All the princesses readied themselves to battle her, but she didn't move. She saw Glimmer was still chained and they were trying to free her. **"You can't free her through normal means."** She said.

"What do you mean?" Entrapta asked.

"It's dark magic and you can't undo it with tech." Shadow Weaver said and snapped her fingers. She disabled the chains holding Glimmer and she was free.

"Thank you so much!" Glimmer exclaimed relieved.

"I didn't do this for you... I'm here for Catra."

"Oh.. we haven't found her." Adora said.

"You should go, before it's too late." Shadow Weaver said with a much calmer tone.

As the princesses had left Shadow Weaver walk through the hallways until she found the sword that belonged to She-Ra, what was it doing here? It was stored in a chamber of sorts. So, she broke the tempered glass around it and picked it up. She put it in her sleeve.

Shadow Weaver kept searching for Catra until she found Scratch laying on the floor, unconscious. She noticed foot steps and scratch marks on the floor and wall. It had to be Catra. Shadow Weaver rushed through the hallways until she found her. She found Catra laying in the hallway, passed out. She carefully picked her up and saw all the burn marks and bruises. This made her feel even more angrier than ever before.

She carried Catra in her arms and as she passed by the destroyed Fright Zone.

As other princesses had arrived on the ship captained by Sea Hawk, they noticed one of the princesses was missing. "Where's Entrapta?" Adora asked worriedly.

"She.. she's gone." Perfuma said with tears flowing from her cheeks.

"No.. we.. gotta go back and get her." Adora said.

"No.. she's really gone." Mermista said and wiped a tear from her eye.

Adora fell on her knees, tears flowing through her face. When they were about to leave they saw a shadowy figure approach

them and behind the figure was the whole Horde army. It was Shadow Weaver and she was holding Catra in her palms.

"Shadow Weaver?" Adora asked and looked at her.

"Here.. take her.." She said and coughed dark matter and it flowed from under her mask. Adora reached her hands and took Catra. Everyone was shocked when they saw the condition of Catra. "How could they have done this... I'm so sorry.. Catra.." Adora muttered.

"You don't have much time.. here take this." Shadow Weaver said and revealed the sword and a small locket.

"My sword! I had totally forgotten it." Adora exclaimed.

Shadow Weaver handed the sword and locket to Adora. "Give this to her when she wakes up." She said with a calm and somber tone. "Also.." She took her mask off willingly and showed her tired and scarred face to everyone. Black matter was spilling from her mouth and she had large dark circles around her eyes. "Give her this..."

"What do you mean?" Adora asked with a confused tone.

"It's way too late for me... I'll hold them off and you can escape." Shadow Weaver said. She gave a warm and sad smile as she looked at Catra, one last time. "Now go!"

Sea Hawk did as he was told and started the ship's engine. He steered the ship through the barren wasteland of the Fright Zone. Shadow Weaver turned to look at the approaching Horde army. ***"YOU ALL ARE GOING TO GO DOWN WITH ME!"*** She yelled and let the Spell of Obtainment fully take control of her. Her form grew as large as trees and dozens of tendrils came out from her shadows. She lost all her human features and was now more close to what the Entity looked like, full with red eyes with X pupils and long tendril-like hands. She truly had turned into a monster from another dimension.

The princesses could see her tall form from far away and they were truly in shock. Was that really Shadow Weaver? Adora was just looking after Catra, she was supposed to look after her and this was the situation it had led to.

"Hey.. don't worry." Glimmer said and put hand on her shoulder. "It will be alright. We will get through all of this." But her words didn't help much, they still lost Entrapta and Catra had greatly suffered at the hands of the Horde.

Meanwhile Shadow Weaver was exterminating the Horde's ships and tanks like ants. None of them could stand against her. She slaughtered them all, not caring if she even consumed them or not. None would survive, none of them would see daylight again. ***"YOU WORTHLESS ANTS! FLEE AND FEEL FEAR! THERE IS NO SALVATION FOR YOU, ONLY ETERNAL VOID!"***

She couldn't be stopped until Hordak himself stepped in. He had to use his experimental hand cannon he had built, it had 50/50 it would work or not. He got Shadow Weaver's attention or in this case it was the manifestation of the Spell of Obtainment. ***"WHO ARE YOU TO STAND AGAINST ME!?"***

"You magical beasts should know your place in the presence of the Horde!" Hordak yelled. "There is room for only one conqueror! And it will be the Horde!" He then proceeded to shoot from his hand cannon and it actually worked. Powerful beam of energy was coming right towards the Spell of Obtainment and it couldn't evade it. It was something so powerful that it couldn't have been from Etheria.

There was few factions who would have such knowledge. The obvious one being the Intergalactic Empire of Horde Prime. ***"CURSE YOU HORDE EMPIRE! CURSE YOUUUUU"*** The Entity yelled as it evaporated. All the shadows withdrew alongside the tendrils and the red eyes disappeared. Until there was a husk of a woman laying on the ground.

Hordak approached the body and looked at it. "This is the reason why Etheria should be ruled by tech instead of magic." He said and looked at his decimated forces. "I'm never gonna financially recover from this..."

He ordered the woman to be locked up in the deepest and strongest dungeon and it was made sure she was bound by anti-magic chains, so she couldn't never escape from there. Scratch woke up in the now empty hallway and saw that Catra had escaped. There was no-one to be seen. She walked through the hallways and she could see armors without the bodies and dozens of holes in the walls. She looked outside from one of the windows and saw the Fright Zone in smoking ruins. "What the hell could have caused this?"

Darkith was found in the inner courtyard of the Fright Zone and she was brought to the medical bay, but none of them couldn't understand how to fix her. Their tech didn't work at all. Darkith succeeded in telling them that she needed the Black Garnet to heal and restore her powers. So she was brought to her chambers to be healed.

This was truly the most largest defeat Horde had ever seen, and it was caused by a woman... Shadow Weaver.

When the princesses had safely arrived at Brightmoon, Glimmer's mother was waiting for them on the outside. Glimmer ran straight to her mother and they shared a deep hug. Adora herself carried Catra's unconscious body, Castaspella ordered her to be taken to be healed. Castaspella was shocked when she saw the condition of Catra. "What about Shadow Weaver?" She asked. "She said she

was going to fix our mess." Castaspella said with a concerned tone.

"She stayed behind." Adora answered. "She said something about it's too late for her.. I don't know what she meant.."

Castaspella let out a deep sigh, she knew exactly what Shadow Weaver had meant. " *Shadow Weaver... you said I was the fool, but in the end... you clearly were the bigger fool.* "

Other princesses returned to their Kingdoms and Perfuma had a statue made to Entrapta, for her memory. This incident seemed to drive the princesses even further away from coming together, but Horde was also crippled. They couldn't do anything major in a long time.

Adora sat in her room alone once again, holding her sword. She looked at the rune that was carved inside of the sword and saw her reflection on it. "How are we going to get through this? This wasn't how it was supposed to go..."

Chapter End Notes

> Wow.. what a bang... This will be a good cliff hanger to end for a while. I still intend to continue this story thou, but we have achieved a good milestone. I could say I have completed one ark and I'm ready to start another. Now I don't have a feeling of rush.
>
> I hope you have enjoyed this story.

Rock Bottom

Chapter Summary

> Catra wakes up in Brightmoon and she gets to hear the bad news.
>
> Shadow Weaver herself is prisoned at Fright Zone and she has to face her consequences, something she always wanted to avoid and why she kept away from this war. But even in face of torture she won't let them get best of her.

Chapter Notes

> Once again, Fair Warning: Torture, nuff said.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It had been a few days since the daring mission to save the captured friends from the hands of the Horde. Princess Alliance had once again fallen apart, each kingdom going on their own separate ways. Adora held the golden locket Shadow Weaver had given to her. She was interested in what it held inside, but didn't dare to open it. She went to the room where Catra was being held. "Has she woken up?" She asked from Castaspella who sat next to Catra.

"I'm afraid not. She's fine and the most serious wounds have healed already." Castaspella said and stood up. "Would you mind looking after her? I've been sitting here way too long."

"Sure, I would gladly." Adora answered, giving a weak smile.

"Good, I need to return to Mystacor, but if any of you need me. Don't hesitate to ask." Castaspella said and walked off, leaving Catra and Adora alone in the bright room.

Adora sat next to Catra and put her hand on her forehead. "I wish you would wake up and I wish I could do something for you." As

she said that her sword started to vibrate and glow. She grabbed her sword and looked at the glowing runestone. "I can't do anything, but maybe She-Ra can?" She thought.

"For the honor of Grayskull!" She yelled and turned into She-Ra. She didn't actually know what to do, but she could feel her sword knew. She placed the sword near Catra and closed her eyes, she focused on the thing she wanted the most. Getting Catra back to the living world. Light shone from the sword covering the whole room into bright light and like a flick of a wrist, it was gone. She-Ra opened her eyes and saw the room still the same. She let out a disappointed sigh and turned back to Adora. "What do I know, I don't even understand half my powers. Nor do I understand my sword." She said and sat on the chair once again.

She took Catra by hand and hoped she would come back. After a while of sitting she fell asleep. It didn't last long though, she could feel something tighten the grip on her hand and she opened her eyes. "Catra?"

Catra slowly opened her eyes and the bright light shone through the windows. "Too bright... head hurts..." She muttered.

Adora immediately pulled the curtain over the window and offered her a glass of water. "Here, drink this.. it should help.. at least a little bit." Adora said.

Catra extended her hand towards the glass and drank all the water in one go. "Ugh... where am I?" She asked, with a shaky tone.

"You are at Brightmoon." Adora answered and gave her a warm smile.

"Bright..moon..." Catra repeated. "Whe... where's.. agh... hurts too much..."

"You should rest, you are still recovering." Adora said, trying to calm Catra down. She placed her hands on her shoulders. "Just rest.. you need rest."

"This place is too bright for my liking.. ugh.." Catra tried to joke.

"It's called Brightmoon for a reason..." Adora said smiling.

"I knew.." Catra said and fell back to sleep.

Adora let out a relieved sigh, she didn't want to break the bad news for her. Catra was in no condition to handle those. Now Adora could at least feel at ease on one thing, but another thing was already coming up. Glimmer couldn't teleport anymore and it had to do something with the dark magic done by Darkith. Oh how she wished they had someone who knew about dark magic.

At the deepest dungeons of Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver was being held in an anti-magic barrier and she was chained with the heaviest chains they could have found. Her legs were chained on the floor, while her hands were chained up from the ceiling. None had dared to enter into her cell, since the aura that surrounded her was filled with malice.

Shadow Weaver could feel agonizing pain, even if she wasn't awake. Her consciousness wandered through the endless void, she felt herself broken, powerless and worst of all... lonely. " *I didn't expect Hordak to have that kind of weapon.* " Entity's voice echoed through the void.

"Can you for once manifest as a person? I'm tired of only hearing your echoing voice!"

" *Well... if you so want...* " Entity said and began manifesting. Entity took the form of a shadowy lady that reflected Shadow

Weaver, without any of her human features. " *Better?* "

"I guess." Shadow Weaver said. "Anyways, where am I? Am I dead?"

" *Ehh.. not quite.. think of it as a pocket dimension of sorts, when enough time passess I can bring you back.* "

"So I'm your prisoner?"

" *Not mine, but you are Horde's prisoner tho..* "

"What!? How do you know that I don't?!" Shadow Weaver yelled.

" *I took over your body, so I know everything that happens around you.* "

"Is there any chance for me to get my body back?"

" *After I've gathered enough strength. I gotta say, the amount of souls you consumed helped me a lot and will help you a lot.* "

Shadow Weaver kicked air and sighed. "So.. I will just rot here, inside of my own body? What a great fate..."

" *Don't be so sour... As an Otherworldly Entity, I will give you my word; I will bring you back, I can't do much without a living host.* "

"Sounds too good to be true.. do entities of your kind keep their words?"

" *Of course we do, you have served me well. Even if you are difficult at some times.. but.. I've grown kind of fond of you..* "

"Great... You don't mind if I go float over there? Like I really want to just be..."

" *As you wish...* " Entity said and manifested away.

Shadow Weaver floated over the nothingness, endless void.. trapped in a pocket dimension inside of her body.. "This is just great.. I hope Catra is alive and well... That's all that matters.."

It was late evening at Brightmoon and Catra woke up from her sleep. Even at night, Brightmoon was too bright for her. She walked through the hallways and ended up on a balcony where you could see the beautiful courtyard and royal garden. Adora herself was awake at the same evening, she looked at the nightstand where on top of it lay Shadow Weaver's mask and the locket she had given. She felt bad for not telling Catra what had happened, but next morning she would. No matter what.

Next morning Adora had woken up early and was going to go to Catra, but when she got there. She wasn't there. "Where could she have gone?"

At the same time Catra entered the room and saw Adora there, holding some items. "Adora?"

"Catra." Adora exclaimed and turned to look at her. "Where were you? I was worried."

"I was sleeping in the garden.. much more comfortable there." Catra said. Then she noticed that Adora was holding something familiar to her. "What are you holding in your hands?"

"Oh this.." Adora said and had a nervous look on her face. "She... she told me to give you these." She then extended her hands for Catra to take them.

Catra noticed what they were, Shadow Weaver's mask and a locket. "Why.. How did you get these?"

Adora sighed deeply and said. "Shadow Weaver told me to give these to you."

"What do you mean? Where is she?" Catra asked and her voice started to crack.

"She's gone.." Adora answered with a heavy tone.

Catra's heart broke and tears started to stream uncontrollably from her eyes. She opened the locket and saw a picture of herself and Shadow Weaver, both looking so happy. "No... NO... NO! IT CAN'T BE!" Catra started to cry out loud. "We have to get her back.. like you did for me..."

Adora gave Catra a tight hug and told her. "I'm so sorry, but she's gone.. She turned into a monster.."

"What?!.. No.. it's because I wasn't there... I should have never joined this STUPID REBELLION!" Catra yelled and tried to free herself from Adora's grip.

"Please! Catra, calm down!" Adora tried to calm her and hugged her harder.

"No! How can I!"

"It will be alright Catra, we will come up with a way to get her back." Adora said, hoping this would calm her at least a little bit.

"You promise?" Catra asked, sobbing.

"I promise." Adora said with a comforting tone. "Just calm down and it will be fine."

Catra's crying turned into a quiet sobbing until she was so tired that she had fallen asleep. Adora carried Catra to her bed and laid

her there gently. She took one last look at the sleeping Catra. "I promise you, we will get her back."

Meanwhile in the dungeons of Fright Zone, Entity had gathered enough strength to bring Shadow Weaver back from the pocket dimension. Shadow Weaver also gained back control of her body, but a lot of good it did. She was chained and surrounded by an anti-magic barrier. Unable to do anything, Shadow Weaver could only wait and see what would happen. She was still dizzy from her latest blackout, she could feel her scars aching and her body felt like it had been ripped apart.

After a while, someone came in. It was Darkith. Shadow Weaver obviously assumed she was the one who had tortured Catra, so her blood started to boil as she looked at her.

"Oh if it isn't Shadow Weaver.. We meet yet again.." She said trying to be imitating, but Shadow Weaver could see through her bluff. She was still scared of her, such a shame she didn't actually killed her when she had a chance.

"Oh if it isn't the worst being on the Etheria.. Tell me, how's your life with that entity of yours?" Shadow Weaver said, smirking. She decided to hide her anger and play it cool.

"At least I'm still alive, unlike you..."

"That was a really bad comeback.. listen if you want to get good at it. I suggest going to drama school-" Shadow Weaver was interrupted by Darkith's outburst. "Silence! How would drama school even help you to get good at comebacks?!"

"I don't know... I just made it up. You see, I don't exactly have a clear mind at the moment."

"How can you be like.. like this!" Darkith ranted. "You are a prisoner! Don't you fear what might happen to you? Don't you fear for your life?"

"Heh.. I'm not sure if I could call it a life." Shadow Weaver said and chuckled. "There's not much you can do to me, I've been through a lot."

Shadow Weaver was getting on Darkith's nerves. How could she be so bratty, like some of those Horde cadets. "You do know what we are gonna do to you?"

Shadow Weaver still had a smirk on her face, she couldn't care less what the Horde soldiers would do to her. "What? Ship me to Beast Island? Torture me? Making me pay for my actions against the mighty Horde?"

"You are unbearable! What happened? Last time when we were in battle you were so different!"

"Oh you want me to be serious?" Shadow Weaver asked sarcastically. "Fine, I'll take this seriously." Her facial expression turned into a serious and her smirk faded and her stare turned into death glare. Suddenly she didn't even look like the same woman she was before. **"You will not get away from this."**

Darkith felt a sudden change in the atmosphere in the cell and Shadow Weaver's aura reeked of death. "Is this some act of yours? From your drama school?" Darkith tried to play off her nervousness.

"You hurt Catra.. So you will die.. by my hands Even if it would be the last thing I ever accomplish."

"Actually, I wasn't the one who tortured her. I ordered her to be sent to Beast Island.." Darkith said, clearly being afraid of her life.

"As long as you are here, you can't move or do anything. So think carefully about what you say."

Then Darkith left the dungeon and hurried back to her chambers. When she was there, she took a deep breath and sighed. "She's in another world..."

Scratch was eager to interrogate the new prisoner, she didn't have any clue who their prisoner was, but she was warned that "she" was dangerous. Scratch took it as nonsense, if she was being held by anti-magic barriers and chains. How could she do anything at all?

Scratch went to the dungeon and was ready to interrogate Shadow Weaver. She entered into Shadow Weaver's dungeon, a smug look on her face. "Well well, looks like your luck has run out."

" *A kid? Seriously?* " Shadow Weaver thought, it seems anyone could get a high position in the Horde.

"I'm here to interrogate you. You must have a lot of knowledge of the Rebellion. You also caused a lot of harm for the Horde."

"I don't even know who you are." Shadow Weaver said and smirked. "I don't have any information about the rebellion, I don't even like them that much..."

"Why did you help them then? Why wouldn't you join the Horde instead?"

"I have my reasons.. and it's not the Rebellion."

"Listen, I don't have time for your nonsense. You either tell me what you know or you will suffer." Scratch threatened.

"Try me, my whole life has been nothing more than a suffering." Shadow Weaver said, taunting Scratch.

Scratch had enough, she ripped the clothes off from Shadow Weaver. Revealing her scarred and probably rotten body. "What the hell are you?"

"Actually, I'm not sure anymore..." Shadow Weaver said.

"Argh, I've had enough!" Scratch yelled and struck Shadow Weaver with the eletric whip.

There was no reaction from Shadow Weaver, so she hit her again and again. Shadow Weaver's back was full of marks from the electric shocks, but she didn't even flinch. "May I suggest something more harsh?" Shadow Weaver asked nonchalantly.

"What? Do you enjoy this?" Scratch asked, confused.

"No, I don't. It's just that I've been through so much that mere electric shocks are not enough."

"Fine." Scratch said and brought out a hot iron. "How about this then?"

"I don't know, no one has ever tried to brand me with a hot iron."

Scratch then pressed the hot iron against Shadow Weaver's skin and it left a deep burn mark on her. Shadow Weaver yawned. "Listen.. you aren't really good at this interrogation thing. You are supposed to get some information from the prisoner, but I don't have the information you want and your methods don't itch me... so why are we doing this again?"

"You can't be serious!" Scratch yelled. "Don't you care about anything?"

"I have two things I care for, one of them is gone already and the other one is safe and far away from here."

"Then what would you say if we captured that thing you care most about?"

"You wouldn't live to see that day. That I can promise." Shadow Weaver said. "You still want to try to get that useless information out from me?"

"If I don't get anything out from you, I can at least beat you till you're dead."

"If only I could die." Shadow Weaver said and sighed. "So if hot iron and electric shocks won't do anything, what are you going to use then?"

" *Are you crazy!? Are you trying to encouraging her to torture you more!? Do you have any idea what it will cost for me! "* Entity yelled at Shadow Weaver.

"Oh don't be such a pussy, it will be jsut fine." Shadow Weaver snapped.

"Excuse me what?" Scratch asked, confused.

"Oh.. nothing.. Please, do continue." Shadow Weaver said smirking with a nonchalant tone.

Force Captain Scopria arrived at the dungeons to fetch Scratch. They once again had a Force Captain orientation. "Uhh, Scratch." She said as she entered Shadow Weaver's cell. Scratch turned to look at Scorpia with a frustrated look on her face.

"What do you want?"

"Uhh, we have a Force Captain orientation and you are needed there as well. Darkith actually demanded you to be there, so I came to fetch you." Scopria said with an awkward tone. "But I see you're busy with our prisoner.. so.."

"Don't worry, I'll be there." Scratch said. "This prisoner is no fun.. she doesn't beg or scream.. she just taunts.. So there's no point continuing, for now."

"Oh I see, should we go then?"

"Sure, I just need to clean myself first." Scratch said and left the dungeon, leaving Scorpia there with Shadow Weaver. She took a closer look at the beat up woman.

" *Scratch really does have some issues... deep issues..* " Scorpia thought as she looked at the Shadow Weaver's corpse. " *Is she even alive..* " She poked her with her pinchers and got no reaction out of her. "Umm.. are you alive?"

Shadow Weaver opened her eyes and looked at this new Horde member in front of her. "Are you the new interrogator?" She asked with a raspy voice.

"Umm ohh, no. No, I just came to fetch Scratch.. We have a Force Captain orientation once in a month and it's important that we-" Scorpia stopped herself when she realized that she told a bit too much, she was talking to a prisoner after all. "Ohno, I said way too much.. Can you please not tell anyone? I beg you."

Shadow Weaver looked at the woman begging her to keep this as a secret. "My lips are sealed.." Shadow Weaver said and gave a faint smirk.

"Thank you so much, but uhh.. I need to go. Like right now... so bye." Scorpia said and left the dungeon, leaving Shadow Weaver alone.

"Why is someone like her at the service of the Horde? She's clearly not evil.. rather clumsy and probably more of a liability..." Shadow Weaver thought to herself.

" *Phew.. it's finally over... next time, don't encourage others to torture you. Okay?* "Entity scolded her. " *You have no idea how much that took to recover and keep you alive..* "

"Well sorry, but did you see that woman?"

" *The woman with crab claws? Sure did and she is a stupid one...* "

"I would rather think of a useful fool.." Shadow Weaver suggested.

" *Whatever suits your tastes.. Well, are you going to keep what she said as secret?* "

"Of course, she's clearly clumsy and naive. I think in fact I could get more information from her than they will get from me."

" *I see, you aren't so dumb after all.* "

"I've never been dumb." Shadow Weaver stated. "But with a little bit of sweet talk and pulling the right strings.. she will tell me everything I want to know."

Devilish smile formed on her face and she began to laugh.

" *Shees.. ease with the tongue will you? Or you will not be able to speak for a while...* "

Back at Brightmoon, Catra had enough waiting and sitting around. She demanded action. At the moment in the meeting hall there was only Angella, Glimmer, Bow, Adora and Catra. Princess Alliance was in shambles and its future didn't look too bright.

"Why can't we try to save her, she saved me!" Catra argued.

"Silence!" Angella demanded.

"But mom, believe it or not. Shadow Weaver also freed from the Horde, she ain't as evil as she's been made to be!" Glimmer came in trying to defend Catra.

"Glimmer! I won't tolerate this kind of behavior."

"But why won't you want to help her? She helped us." Adora said.

"Because I'm not risking our or any of our alliance members because of a criminal!"

"Criminal! CRIMINAL!" Catra yelled, scratching the table. She couldn't believe what she heard. She knew Micha's death hit hard on Angella, but still. "She sacrificed so much for me! Now she's gone! She also risked her life for your daughter! Can't you at least appreciate that she's willing to do good!"

"Catra, I know she took care of you, but doing one good thing, doesn't absolve her from her other crimes!" Angella stated.

Glimmer was at her boiling point as well, she had heard from Darkith that she was responsible for Micha's death. Even if Angella is well meaning, this was just too much. "Mother, with all due respect. Darkith, the head sorcerer at the Horde. Told me that she killed Micah. So you can't blame it on her!"

"So you would believe Horde sorcerer over your mother? Glimmer, I know the times at Horde were hard for you. I just don't want anyone else to get hurt, because of one rogue sorcerer." Angella said, trying to calm Glimmer.

"Whatever. If I can't get help from you, then I'll just leave. I don't see a point in fighting for an alliance that discards others!" Catra said and left the room.

Adora ran after to make sure she wouldn't do anything reckless. "Catra, wait!"

"What.. do you want.. Adora?" She asked, her voice cracking.

"I know it didn't go as well as-" Adora was interrupted by Catra. "No, it didn't go well! I just want to be alone."

"But we can't break apart, not now. We need to stick together to defeat the Horde."

"Maybe.. but I just can't. First I lost my only mother figure, someone who truly cared. Now she's called a criminal, which I knew... Angella and Shadow Weaver were never on a friendly footing."

Adora tried to comfort Catra, for not to leave. "I know it must be hard, I've got my share of doubt and blame as well."

"How? You are She-Ra?"

"I was raised in the Horde and it's not Adora they care for... it's She-Ra.." She said with a sad tone.

"Then why don't you leave? Forge your own destiny.. Shadow Weaver always talked about forging my own destiny... so I wouldn't share a fate the same as her..."

"I can't.. they need me and Glimmer.. Something is wrong with her. When she was rescued from the Horde, she couldn't teleport anymore.. I think it's because of dark magic.."

Catra sighed in deep. "Shadow Weaver knew about it, she would have been able to help Glimmer.. but she can't... not anymore..."

Then Adora remembered what Castaspella had said before. "Actually, I think we have someone who can help us."

"Who's that?" Catra asked.

"Head-Sorcerer of Mystacor, Castaspella."

"No.. Adora.. don't you get it. It's over..." Catra said with a dperessed look on her face. "I'm going to only place I can call home... so, just forget it." Catra began to walk away.

"But we hvae to try, we can't give up now!"

"I know Castaspella is a well meaning and helpful, but she can't help us." Catra looked once more at Adora. "I'm sorry, but we have reached the end of the horizon."

There wasn't anything Adora could say to convince Catra to stay anymore, she could only look as her friend slouched away slowly. Catra couldn't bare to look at Adora anymore, she held the locket tightly in her fist and cried silently. This seems to be the end of the Rebellion, how can anyone come back from this. It seems Adora has to do everything by herself, such is a fate of a She-Ra.

Chapter End Notes

Although... can you really count it as torture if you are numb to pain?
Also here Shadow Weaver shows her darker tendencies.. manipulating others isn't bad if you do it for the right cause? Right? It doesn't matter, if SW thinks its okat, then its okay... no questions asked.

I added little more into the chapter, to get the alliance totally separated. (Including Catra as well) So you know.. the S1 finale can have it's high moment.

Bad Omen

Chapter Summary

After the break up with Catra, Adora sets her sights on a mission to fix everyhing.
At the Fright Zone, Entrapta gets caught by Scratch and Scorpia. However, things take a turn in a unexpected ways.
Darkith gets screwed over by the Hordak.
And Shadow Weaver? Well, good thing Scorpia can't keep her mouth shut.

Chapter Notes

In this chapter: Adora starts her journey to fix everything. Catra get's drunk and finds something unexpected, Entrapta switches sides and Shadow Weaver is Shadow Weaver..

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Things at Brightmoon didn't look as bright as they usually did. Glimmer still kept to herself the fact she had lost her powers, not wanting to tell mother. Feeling she's a screw up and everything went downhill because of her. Glimmer was in her room with Bow and Adora. Adora suggested that maybe she could try to heal her as She-Ra, as she had previously healed Catra. She pointed her sword towards Glimmer and hoped it would do something. Bow had a worried look on her face even if you are desperate, you should still be careful with swords.

"Uhh, I think you need to say the right words?" Glimmer suggested. "It is a magic sword after all."

"Ahh... okay.. I'll try." She-Ra said and pointed her sword towards Glimmer once again. "Heal, Glimmer!" But nothing happened. She tried again. "H.E.A.L, Glimmer!"

"Maybe it needs a swing or thrust action.." Glimmer said.

"Are you out of your mind?!" Bow yelled. "Do you guys care about sword safety? Because I do."

She-Ra placed the sword on Glimmer's head and the sword started to glow. "Ohh, it's working."

"Yes, I can definitely feel something.." Glimmer said, but was suddenly struck again by the weird glitch and she broke on the floor. "Arghh! Aaah!" Glimmer yelled in pain. Soon the glitching was over and it disappeared as suddenly as it had come.

"Agh.. this is hopeless!" She-Ra yelled and threw the sword against the wall. She turned back to Adora.

"Sword safety, anyone!?" Bow yelled as she looked at the sword sticking out from the wall.

"You know, one thing where Horde was right. Was training. What use am I if I don't even know how to use my powers as She-Ra." Adora said and picked up her sword.

"What are you going to do then?" Bow asked.

"I remember that Madam Razz brought me once into a place.. I just know I can get answers from there." Adora said. "It might take a while. So Bow, watch over Glimmer."

"Wait, why can't I come with you?" Glimmer asked.

"For an obvious reason.." Adora said. "You don't have your powers.. but when I get back. I promise you, I'll have something figured out."

Deep in the Whispering Woods stood a tall tree and inside of it was a comfy house. It was late in the night and Catra arrived there, the only place she could call home. She had hoped that Shadow Weaver would be there to greet her on the porch or sitting on the couch reading a book. Or in a kitchen, making tea. She knew it was impossible, but she hoped secretly hoped that Shadow Weaver would have been there, somehow..

As she went inside, it was just like it used to be. Only this time, something was missing. "What did I expect.. that she would be here?... Hah ridiculous..." She said to herself half laughing and half crying, tears streaming on her cheeks. She couldn't take this anymore, she needed something to make herself feel better.

Catra headed to the kitchen and went through Shadow Weaver's cabinets, knowing she had alcohol or something like that. Somewhere, hidden. She found a bottle of red wine, probably brewed by Shadow Weaver herself. The mere thought of Shadow Weaver got Catra to feel miserable. So she opened the bottle and began to drink from it.

It didn't take long till Catra was drunk, she quite literally had drank all of the wine within a thirty minutes. Her walking was wobbly and she stumbled across the building, bumping on the walls. She dropped books from the shelves, accidentally. She managed to break some of the glasses that stood on the kitchen table. "Shadow Weaver would be so mad if she saw this.. But she ain't here NOW!" She kicked the stool and slipped, falling on the ground. She tried to gather everything she got and headed towards the staircase.

She dragged herself up from the stairs and reached her room. Catra collapsed on her bed and began to laugh, she didn't know why or how. How could she laugh at times like this? It wasn't joyful laughing, but it was painful. It soon turned into crying, until she fell asleep.

At the Fright Zone, Darkith got demoted by Hordaks, since her failures led to a disaster. "My Lord Hordak, no-one could have seen that one coming." Darkith was pleading, on her knees. "Scratch brought those princesses.. I only wanted to bring Adora back!"

"Enough Darkith! You are their superior, so you will also take their failures on yourself!" Hordak growled. "Besides, Your obsession with Adora has caused a huge setback! You are hereby demoted!"

"But, My Lord-" Darkith was interrupted by Hordaks angry growl. "I said, you are demoted! You neglected my orders, that's why I ordered Scratch to keep an eye on you. And she didn't disappoint."

" *That little arrogant, son of a goat.. bi..tc-h!* " Darkith cursed in her mind. Hordak saw Darkith's silence as an acceptance.

"Are we clear on this thing?" Hordak asked.

"Transparently..." Darkith gritted through her teeth.

"You are dismissed."

Darkith left Hordak's throne room and headed towards her chambers, proceeding to kick every trash can on her way there.

Meanwhile Scratch and Scorpia were on their way off from the Force Captain orientation. As they walked the hallway, Scratch

could hear something bumping inside the pipes. She listened closely and located the source of the sound. What they found was something they did not expect. Princess Entrapta crawled out from the vent. "Oh hi, I remember you. You were at the Princess Prom." Entrapta said, looking at Scratch and Scorpio.

"Mmhmm, And now you're a prisoner here." Scratch said and took out a pair of handcuffs.

They locked Entrapta in the interrogation room and Scratch and Scorpia thought about what they would do with her. Scratch had contacted Hordak about the captured princess and he had instructed interrogating her.

"Normally, I wouldn't mind you interrogating her.. but it tends to get out of hand when you do it." Scorpia said.

"Don't worrt, I'll keep my cool." Scratch said and took out the stun baton. She walked up to Entrapta. "Don't try anything stupid.. I have the power here."

Entrapta looked at the stun baton. "Oooh, lemme have that." She said and took it from Scratch's hand with her hair.

"What.. how.. did you.." Scratch was dumbfounded, but she quickly collected herself. "Hey! Give that back." She ripped the baton from Entrapta and pointed it at her again with it. "Last chance, I don't care what it takes to get the information.. I will."

"Oh.. then what do you want to know?" Entrapta said nonchalantly.

Scratch and Scorpia shared a confused look. "Why were you hiding here?"

"Ohh you know.. My friends had difficulties finding me before, so I thought keeping still would help them." Entrapta said.

Scratch let out a small chuckle, this was the perfect opportunity to turn her against them. "Listen.. they left you."

"What? Oh no.. no.. they will come." Entrapta insisted.

"I'm afraid you have no idea who you're dealing with." Scratch said, trying to appear as comforting as she could. "They took Glimmer and her friends because they were just like them... but you.. you aren't like them."

"What do you mean?" Entrapta asked with an uncertain tone. "According to my data, we were qualified as friends."

"No.. they used you. That's what they do. You are different and you know that, they know that." Scratch said. "And they would not and will not ever accept you as one of them.."

This broke Entrapta's heart, even if she knew they didn't get along quite well. But it was still heartbreaking. "I guess.. we are never that close... I kinda knew it."

"Hey, it's not all bad." Scratch said with a calm tone. "You can still be you, here at the Horde. I can see you have an eye for tech and if something, it's the tech that's appreciated here."

"Real Yyyy?" Entrapta asked with her eyes sparkling. "Because I need to show you what I have done." Then one of the robots came in and walked towards Entrapta. "Her name is Emily and she's quite a powerhouse. I upgraded her mobility, firepower and everything you could ask for. Emily, show them what you can do."

Emily then proceeded to shoot a beam and it went through the wall and melted a huge hole into it.

"See? Quite impressive, right?"

Scratch and Scorpia were surprised and maybe even a little bit scared. The princesses had no idea what they had left behind.

"That is truly fantastic." Scratch said with an impressed tone.

"And that's not all. I have tried for years to combine First Ones tech with my tech..." Entrapta said.

"With First Ones tech?" Scratch asked. "Is that even possible?"

"Of course it is, my problem is I just haven't found much.. until recently." She said and pulled up a tablet from het hair. "This has a map that shows a way towards a clump of First Ones tech. I'm not sure what or how it is there, but it is large."

"So.. you're saying that with First Ones tech.. Can we upgrade our machines?" Scratch asked with a hopeful tone.

"Of course it is, we just need to find the First Ones tech first.. hehe.. Entrapta said and started to laugh when she realized she made a fun pun. First Ones tech first... hehe- Oh sorry, I side tracked.. but yes. As simple as that."

"Well then, I will inform Lord Hordak about this and then I proceed to go and search for this tech." Scratch said. "if what you say is true.. I'm sure Lord Hordak would reward you accordingly. But until then, you are our prisoner.. well.. only on paper, if that makes sense. Also, Scorpia. Keep an eye on her, she's quite agile."

"Understood, Force Captain Scratch." Scorpia said and saluted.

"You know you are Force Captain as well.. we share the same rank." Scratch said with a mildly amused tone.

"I know, but your intelligence is far greater than mine." Scorpia said.

"Don't say that.. you have your own strengths. But I'm on my own now.. see you later."

"Right, see you later."

Adora was walking inside the Whispering Woods, walking randomly around. She got herself tangled with the vines and the terrain was hard to pass. Overgrown with vegetation, uneven ground and a morning mist that made it impossible to see more than a few meters. "If only Catra was here.. she would have been able to navigate through this thick forest." Adora said and sighed in deep.

She continued her slow progress, hoping she would find her way towards that place. But she was ultimately lost, she had no idea where to go and was about to give up. Until her sword began to glow and vibrate. Now from her sword, she could see a light pointing towards somewhere. Adora wasn't sure where it was pointing, but she assumed it must have been pointing towards the weird structure she had visited earlier.

She didn't know that while she was following the trail of light from her sword, she passed past Shadow Weaver's house and didn't even notice it.

Meanwhile, inside of her home Catra finally woke up from her bed. She had a terrible headache and her stomach hurt. She had no clear memory from the last night, only the empty wine bottle next to her bed. "Oh no.." She realized she had drunk all of Shadow Weaver's wine. She slowly stood up from her bed and as she went downstairs, she was shocked. Whole house was as messy as something would have been after a hurricane. "Shadow Weaver will be so mad when she sees this.." But as she said that,

she remembered why she even drank last night. "Oh... right... she won't be here..."

She went into the kitchen and went through all the different potions and herbs that stood on the shelves and cabinets. "She has to have something for a headache... or do you call this hangover..." Catra thought to herself. When she had taken the medicine she went to lay on the couch. She felt herself as weak and powerless, without motivation, without reason, staring at the ceiling with an empty look on her face.

She took out the locket which had the picture of her and Shadow Weaver. This alongside her mask, was all that was left from her. She put the locket away and continued sleeping, even if she wouldn't have gotten any more sleep. She could at least hope she would kill some time.

Meanwhile at the Fright Zone's dungeon, Shadow Weaver was wasting away. It had been hours or maybe even a day since someone had been there. She could not tell if it was day or night, or if time passed here at all. When she was alone, she could ponder many of her decisions and ways she had gone through. For better and worse.

But her pondering was interrupted when Scorpia entered into her cell. This caught Shadow Weaver's attention, the same woman had come back. "Are you here to interrogate me?" She asked with a deadpan tone.

"You know I could break you apart, If I wanted to. So you better tell me what you know." Scorpia said, trying to be intimidating.

Shadow Weaver chuckled. "But you won't. You aren't that kind of a person."

"What do you mean? You.. you don't know that. I.. I could be the most crules of them all." She said still trying to hold her intimidating tone, but it was clearly not working.

"No, you are not. Last time you were here, you were begging me not to tell anyone our little secret." Shadow Weaver said slyly.

"Agh, you know what? You're right! I'm not good at this, I'm not good at anything!" Scorpia started to rant. "I can't interrogate, heck! I don't actually know what interrogation is all about!?"

"Then.. why are you here?" Shadow Weaver asked, raising her eyebrow. "If you're not here to interrogate me, then what are you here for?"

"Ugh.. I don't know.. I don't like to be in the same place too long.. I was supposed to watch after another prisoner, but I assigned other members to look after her."

"Her?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Yes, she's Princess Entrapta." Scorpia answered.

"Oh her.. I've heard of her. She's great at tech, even if she is a little bit weird."

"Yeah, she said she could upgrade our weapons and machines with First Ones tech." Scorpia said, not realizing that she had once again told the prisoner something she should not know. Shadow Weaver realized this and decided to get everything out of this chance.

"First Ones tech, I've heard it's impossible to combine the two." Shadow Weaver tried to lead Scorpia to tell her more.

"Not according to Entrapta, we actually sent Scratch to collect the First Ones tech so she could combine them and boost our

machines." Scorpia explained.

"That's interesting.. Did you know I used to be a highly regarded sorceress who knew all about Etheria's history and about the First Ones?" Shadow Weaver said.

"You? A sorceress?" Scorpia asked, confused. "I thought you were a monster of sorts..."

Shadow Weaver let out a small laugh. "I've heard that a lot.. and I think I could be considerate as one.. But that's beside the point.. I hope you just realized that I gave you information."

"What? You gave? I didn't notice anything.."

"I told you, I used to be a highly regarded sorceress, who's knowledge of Etheria and First Ones were grander than any of the other sorceresses ever lived on this planet.. you know.. something your superiors would like to know?"

Scorpia thought for a moment and went through her thought process, until she got it. "Hey, is this what you call successful interrogation? I got information out from you, right?"

"Yes, yes you did.. Maybe you aren't as useless as you or others think." Shadow Weaver suggested.

"Yeah, you're right! I am useful and I will prove it for Hordak and for Scratch." Scorpia said with determination and shine on her eyes.

"That's right, show them! And if you ever need more information from me, don't hesitate to try to get it from me."

"Thank you so much, I'll be back. I promise." Scorpia said and left the cell, leaving Shadow Weaver alone.

" *What was that? Why did you tell her information, you could have accidentally slip something way too critical!* " Entity told her with a scolding manner.

"Relax.. I know what I am doing, besides. Did you not hear what she told me? They are trying to combine First Ones tech and Horde's tech."

" *Now that you mentioned it.. yes that is really* interesting."

"Do you think it's possible to combine Etherian tech with the First Ones?"

" *How should I know?! I'm an Entity! Feeding from magic and runestones, not from lowly tech!* "

"Should have known.. well what if you just take a seat back and relax. Let me handle this."

" *Whatever.. So you want to get more information about the Horde and their works?* "

"Yes that is what I want, but also.. I want to use Scorpia to plunge Horde into chaos.." Shadow Weaver said with a devilish smile on her face.

" *How exactly are you going to succeed in that?* "

"Just wait and see.. wait and see.."

At the Whispering Woods, Adora finally had some luck. With her sword guiding her, she had now a clear course. But she didn't have any idea that Scratch was heading towards the same building as her. With the tracker on her hands, Scratch navigated through the thick forest with ease. After all, she used to live here a long time ago.

Meanwhile Catra had stood up from the couch and was looking at herself in the mirror. She looked terrible, she slept badly at night and her drinking didn't do her any good. She was angry, mostly at herself. She should have just declined from the invitation to the Princess Prom. But at the same time, she felt her friends needed her. Well mostly it was Adora, but the point stands the same. She got tired looking at her face and with a fit of rage she punched the mirror and it shattered into pieces. She soon realized what she had done and quickly cleaned up the broken pieces of the mirror.

She walked towards Shadow Weaver's bedroom, the door was closed and she hesitated to open it. But she still did it and entered Shadow Weaver's room. It had not changed at all, it was just like she remembered it. From her childhood to this day, her room had been the same. She sat on Shadow Weaver's bed and she looked around, she noticed a letter or note. It was on the nightstand and on it had "To Catra" written on it.

This obviously piqued her interest and she picked the letter up. There was a long text written on the other side, so she began to read it.

~My Dear Catra, while you have been fighting for the Rebellion.. which I'm not fond of, but you are free to do what you want. I'm not going to stop you. So while you were gone, I wrote this letter to you if something would ever happen to me. I did some research and studies and found out a way for you to use magic. That means if you would have wanted it. I made an artificial staff that could harness magic all around Etheria. The magic doesn't

have an element, but through studying and practicing you could harness the magic and turn it into elemental magic.

This proceeds from my studies from a time when I used to be sorceress at Mystacor. I couldn't perfect it there, but with dark magic I acquired it during Spell of Obtainment. I have found a way to do it. I don't think using dark magic is wrong.. but it will certainly have consequences.. a.k.a "me"

I intended to give you this staff on your next birthday and then you could have decided if you wanted to study magic with me or continue your life without it. But, I know you are a sharp and curious one.. and you would have found out about this sooner or later, so the staff is stored under my bed inside of a wooden crate.

I have one thing to say about the artificial staff and magic. It's theoretical and might not necessarily work as intended, but that is the fun part of magic. Experimenting through trial and error. With my guidance and your determination, we could achieve great things. From the bottom of my rotten heart, I love you. Shadow Weaver.~

Catra was crying when she had finished reading the letter, it was like Shadow Weaver would have known something would happen. She wiped her tears away and stopped crying. Catra looked under Shadow Weaver's bed and there indeed was a crate. "Of course I would have found it by myself.. you were not good at hiding things.." Catra said to herself.

She opened the crate and there it was, staff neatly wrapped around gift paper. She ripped the papers off and it revealed the artificial staff. It's stem was made from some sort of metal, but it wasn't anything that Catra had seen before. It had wooden handles carved with great detail. The top of the staff was a crescent moon with a dark crystal between the tips of the moon.

Catra looked at the staff with awe. Her own staff, she could use magic. Then she realized that Shadow Weaver was not there to teach or guide her. "Bruh.. what's the point of having the staff if I

don't have anyone to teach me!" She was about to put the staff away until she found another note inside the crate. It read: *"By the way, I have books about theoretical and artificial magic."*

Catra felt confused, it was like Shadow Weaver had known this would have happened. What was she, a fortune teller?

Meanwhile Adora had finally found a way to the ancient ruin.. or temple.. something like that. She put the sword away and looked at the tall building, rising from the ground. "Well that is one heck of a building, if this is made by the First Ones.. I wonder what the whole town would have looked like.." Adora said to herself and proceeded to walk in.

Scratch had arrived at the same time and had kept her distance, tailing behind her. "Well, well... you are all alone.. This will be fun." Scratch said to herself while smiling devilishly.

Chapter End Notes

What do I do with the concept of Catra the Sorcerer?...

Of Past, Light Hope and Experiments

Chapter Summary

In this chapter Adora and Scratch goes through memory lane inside the First Ones temple.
And Light Hope reveals herself..

Entrapta gets her hands on First Ones tech to experiment on and Shadow Weaver uses Scorpia to get more information. Darkith gets totally screwd over by everyone.

Chapter Notes

This will be pretty Adora and Scratch focused chapter. Perhaps too much for my liking.. but I still want to do this since I think it's over all very important moment.

And yes, I'm going to cram two episodes worth of content into once chapter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora was standing inside of a hall that had crystal pillars everywhere, the hall looked bigger on the inside than outside. There were dozens of doors around the hall, leading to different hallways. Adora stepped on a platform and looked around. "Uhh hello?" Adora asked. "I carry the sword of She-Ra and I've come here for help. I anyone there?"

Scratch sneaked behind one of the crystal pillars and continued to observe.

Suddenly a hologram suddenly appeared in front of her. It had a female form, but it sure wasn't a real person.. more like an AI. "Greetings, administrator. what is your query?" Hologram said.

Adora stumbled a little bit, but cleared her throat. "I need your help. My friend has been cursed with dark magic and I want to

help her. I've heard that She-Ra can heal others with her sword. So.. how do I do that?"

Hologram stood there silently and answered. "What is your query?"

"Argh.. not this again.." Adora groaned, she looked at her sword and the runestone was glowing. "Oh... I get it..." Adora said and raised her sword. "For the honor of Grayskull!" She yelled and turned into She-Ra. "How about now?"

"Administrator detected. Welcome, She-Ra." Hologram said.

"Okay then.. what can you tell me about this sword?"

"Subject, the Sword of Protection. Classification, portable runestone keyed exclusively for administrators. She-Ra, Princess of Power." Hologram explained with it's emotionless tone.

"How can I use this sword to heal my friend?" Adora asked.

Hologram answered. "Query not recognized."

Adora groaned and facepalmed, meanwhile Scratch changed her position to look for possible places to grab First Ones tech. Adora sighed in deep once more. "The legend says, this sword has healing powers. Is that true?"

"One of the properties of Sword of Protection is to heal and restore balance." Hologram answers.

Adora was losing her nerves, but tried once more. "But how do I heal with it?"

"Query not recognized.."

"How can I use this sword to heal people?" Adora yelled, pointing her sword and showed it to a hologram.

"One of the properties of Sword of Protection is to heal and restore balance."

Adora had enough, this was not going anywhere. She then got her vision once again, showing her image of Light Hope. "Light Hope, let me speak to Light Hope."

"Light Hope.." hologram repeated.

"Light Hope, that's her name, isn't it? The woman who I saw when I touched the sword for the first time." Adora said with almost despair. "Where is she?"

"Yes, Light Hope is here and she has been waiting for you." Hologram answered.

Adora sighed with relief. "Can I talk to her?"

"You will meet her soon enough, but first you must let go."

"Agh, what's that supposed to mean?"

"You are not ready yet, you must let go." Hologram said.

"Let go of what?" Adora asked while Scratch came behind the pillar. Scratch noticed the First Ones tech/crystal on the top of the crystal stand. She picked it up and as she did the stand suddenly turned red. Adora noticed this and shot a beam from her sword towards Scratch.

Scratch successfully evaded the beam. "Hey! Watch it!"

"Scratch!?" Adora asked, shocked on her face. "What are you doing here!?"

"Unauthored presence detected, security protocol, activated." Hologram said and disappeared. The whole room turned red. "Oh nooo, not again." Adora panicked.

"What just happened?!" Scratch asked.

"This is not good, you are not even supposed to be here!?" Adora said and looked around, the doors on the hallways began to close one after another. It was now or never. Adora ran towards Scratch and grabbed her hand.

"Hey! What are you doing!?" Scratch yelled as Adora dragged her to the hallway that wasn't closed off yet. They succeeded in running into the hallway before the door closed, but it wasn't over at all. Dozens of red eyes lit on the dark hallway, spider like monsters revealed themselves and began to chase Adora and Scratch.

"What the heck are those?! And why are they trying to kill us!" Scratch yelled as she was running.

"They are trying to kill YOU! You are invader!" Adora yelled back.

"Can't you just tell them to stop!"

"I can't, this place doesn't listen to me at all!"

"Wow.. you sure are such a powerful princess..." Scratch mocked.

"Gee thanks a lot!"

As they run there are other monsters coming towards them from the front and they take a turn into another hallway, but it's a dead end. "Great, you are the best!" Scratch said with a mocking tone.

"Ugh, watch out!" Adora yelled and proceeded to collapse the roof above them to block the entrance to the hallway.

"Are you crazy!?"

"Just shut up for a sec will ya?" Adora said and turned her sword into a shield and covered them both when the roof collapsed, killing the monsters alongside it. She-Ra turned back to Adora after it seemed they were safe. Scratch put the piece of First Ones tech into her bag.

Adora rubbed her head and stood up. "Agh, it's not over yet. They will not stop until they get you and as long as I try to protect you, they see me as an enemy as well."

"Well, I didn't ask for your protection." Scratch snapped. "I can find my own way out."

Adora broke the door in front of them, revealing a long one way hallway. "And where do you think you can go from here?"

Scratch looked at the long hallway and sighed. "Okay.. let's do a deal.. I won't kill you till we find a way out. Okay?"

"Fine..." Adora answered and they shook their hands.

"By the way, where's your friends? Didn't you used to do everything together?" Scratch asked mockingly, trying to vex Adora.

"They are not here, because you kidnapped them and let Darkith curse Glimmer-" But she was interrupted by Scratch's snide remark. "Obviously, it's nothing personal really."

"Agh you are such a pain!"Adora said.

"Good we made that deal, because I would have killed you by now!"

"Ugh, let's just go... let's continue fighting some other time.."

Scratch nodded and they set their walk through the long hallway. During their walk they passed many different halls and many deadends. They had walked for hours, or it seemed like that until they reached yet again another deadend. "Oh great, another deadend." Scratch sighed.

"No.. it's a door." Adora said and touched it. She said only one word. "Eternia." And the door opened. Scratch gave her a confused look.

"Long story.." Adora answered.

They stepped into a dark room that was like a void. Red light shone from far away. "You just found the room of infinite darkness.. You know what? I'm going.. this is ridiculous." Scratch said, but when she turned she noticed the door they came through had vanished. "Uhh.. Adora. The door just vanished?"

"Shush.." Adora said and proceeded to touch the red light. "Light Hope?" As she touched it, the room filled with a bright red light and it seemed they had teleported at the halls of the Fright Zone. Scratch was delighted about the fact they were there, maybe Darkith did something useful, but she soon realized it wasn't real. As she touched one of the guards and her hand went right through it. "Of course it had to be fake.

Adora and Scratch had gotten separated from each other. Adora faced younger Scratch while Scratch was faced with younger Adora.

Scratch looked at the young Adora and sighed. "Ugh, do I have to babysit younger you know?" Then Adora started to run away from Scratch. "Hey! Get back here!" Scratch then saw shadows surrounding her, it was clear who was behind her.

"Where is Adora?" Cold and cruel voice said. That voice didn't belong to none other than Darkith. "Scratch... I know you have something to do with it!"

Scratch turned to look at Darkith. "Well listen here! You aren't real and I couldn't care less if Adora is here or not!"

"I should have known.. you are a bad influence for her." Darkith said and sighed. "Which is why I will be sending you away. It's time for you to do something other than tail Adora and reap her success."

"What are you talking about? I'm not a kid!" Scratch yelled, but then she saw younger her in front of Darkith. "What is this?" She

asked, but before she could get answers. Both her younger self and Darkith was gone.

Meanwhile Adora stood with younger Scratch and she looked like she was scared of something. Adora, who can feel sympathy for others, easily asked her if she was fine. Which younger Scratch answered. "Darkith wants me to get away from you.. according to her I distract you and get you into trouble."

Adora was puzzled, she felt like she had this kind of conversation before. But she couldn't remember it. Before Adora could answer her, she felt a dark presence behind her. She knew this presence well, it was Darkith. "There you are Adora.. didn't I tell you about seeing Scratch?" Darkith said.

Suddenly Adora didn't see Scratch anymore, only Darkith in front of her. "What do you want? You aren't real!"

"Ahh, Adora.. Adora.. I don't want you to see Scratch anymore." Darkith said a comforting tone, but it was obviously fake. "She is a bad influence, she only uses you. She is reckless, unobedient and most of all she gets you into trouble... Which I have to pay for."

"I don't need your empty words.. you know nothing about me!" Adora said, but was surprised when she could hear herself agreeing. "Wait.. I didn't say anything!"

She then saw her younger self hugging Darkith as she comforted her. "There, there.. I'll show you how to become great." Then both of them vanished and Adora was standing there alone. Something wasn't right, it was like she was spectating her past, but couldn't do anything.

Then Adora found herself at another hall and she saw Scratch as well. "Scratch? Is that you?" She asked and Scratch turned to look at her.

"Adora? Are you real?" She asked. "Because I saw something weird and this place creeping me."

"I think I am the real one, question is are you?" Adora said.

"Of course I am, stupid!" Scratch snapped. "There can only be one of me!"

Then they were teleported out from the Fright Zone, they had teleported back to the present. It seemed they were once again inside of the crystal temple, this time they were somewhere else. "Okay, I don't know what just happened. But I want out of here!" Scratch said.

"Wait!" Adora said. "What did you see when you were there? In the past."

"Nothing of importance, now let's go!"

Adora sighed in deep and they proceeded to continue their walking. Scratch kept thinking what she had seen. It was like she was spectating the past, but she couldn't interact with it. Soon the surroundings of them started to glitch and they seemed to be back at the Fright Zone. Only this time they were together. "Agh not again!" Scratch yelled.

"This is so weird, do you think it's meant to tell us something?" Adora asked.

"Like I would care!" Scratch snapped.

They then saw both of their younger selves doing something they shouldn't have. It was clear that Scratch was the one who had the idea for it. They were sneaking into Darkith's chambers when she was away. Adora and Scratch both looked at their younger selves doing this and they couldn't stop it.

It didn't go well for them, Darkith catched them both sneaking into her chambers and she was furious. Of course it had to be Scratch who got Adora into trouble, such was the nature of the troublemaker. Darkith told their younger selves that they would be separated. Scratch would go to special training for unobedient cadets like she was and Adora was offered the elite training for skilled cadets like herself. Mostly it was because Darkith wanted to keep Adora close to herself. She needed Adora's powers since she was from another world and only she could help her.

"Wow.. How could I not remember any of this." Adora gasped as she looked at what was happening before their eyes.

"Oh I don't know.. maybe because of her!" Scratch said and pointed at Darkith. "But you know what, that special training I was sent to. It was the best thing that had happened to me."

They were then teleported back to the First Ones temple and this time they stood inside of a long and dark hallway. "What do you mean? was the best thing that had happened to you?" Adora asked.

"I actually did something, proved that I'm better than you and when I heard you had betrayed the Horde." Scratch said and paused for a moment. "I just knew it was my time to show Darkith who really was the best. So after all, this wasn't personal."

When Adora was about to answer, they were interrupted by the monsters that had found their way towards them.

The walls started to crumble and the spider monsters were fighting against them. They succeeded to grab Adora's sword and forced her to fight with her hands. "Scratch! Where are you!?" She yelled as she fought against the monsters. She tried to reach her sword, but was caught by one of the spiders before she could.

The ground started to crumble and split in half, revealing wide and deep ravine. One of the spiders shot webs and got Adora

tangled into it. The spider then flung Adora over the cliff leaving her to grab on the sticky web. Luckily for Adora, Scratch sliced through the spiders with her sword. Adora felt that maybe Scratch had something good inside of her.

As Scratch had finished the monster she grabbed Adora's sword and walked to the edge of the cliff, where Adora was hanging.

"Scratch!" Adora yelled relieved, but her relief was short lived. Scratch looked at Adora with a cold stare.

"You know.. even if I took this sword.. it wouldn't work for me." Scratch said while the room started to disappear into darkness. "But.. standing here, I realize that it doesn't matter. It's nothing personal." She said and threw Adora's sword into the ravine. She then took her own sword and started slowly cutting the web where Adora was hanging.

"No! Scratch, you don't have to do it!" Adora pleaded.

Scratch sighed. "I guess you are right..." And then she started to walk away. "Goodbye, forever. I'm off to victory."

Adora had tears streaming from her eyes and she could only watch as the web got thinner and thinner. The room was almost completely filled with darkness and Adora wondered if this would be her end, but then she saw it. Tall woman that looked similar to the other hologram she had seen previously. "You must let go." The figure said with an emotionless voice.

Adora had no choice, so she let go and fell into the deep ravine.

At the Fright Zone, Scorpia was back at watching after Entrapta. Entrapta herself had been tinkering with Emily, while Scorpia was telling her stories about almost everything.

Then Scratch arrived there, out of breath and with a tired look on her face. Entrapta's attention was immediately caught by her arrival. "Did you get the tech?" She asked with an excited voice.

"Yes, I got it." Scratch said and took the piece of First Ones tech out from her bag. "Here."

"Oooo, this will be a great success, I can promise that." Entrapta said, her eyes sparkling. "Scorpia, this will be our lucky day!"

"Yayy us!" Scorpia said. "I have always known that Scratch is a reliable friend."

Scratch didn't consider herself as friendly, but she let it slide this time. After all, they were moments away from victory. "Keep it down, I'm going to sleep. I'm so tired."

"Yeah sure." Scorpia said, while she and Entrapta were dancing.

Meanwhile in the dungeons of Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver was thinkin how she would be able to escape. She had her plan to use Scorpia against other Horde members. She knew Scratch was egotistic, so she would fall pretty quickly if someone proved to be better than her. Entrapta she didn't know well enough and Darkith would not fall into her plans. So she couldn't count on that plan to

succeed. So she would instead just use Scorpia to get information needed to escape.

" *You are going through a lot of planning... shouldn't you like.. rest for a bit?* " Entity told her.

"Do you think I can rest here? No, I can't! So I need to think of a way to get out. I'm not going to-" Shadow Weaver was interrupted by Scorpia, who entered the cell. Shadow Weaver changed her tone to a softer one, but it was still as deadpanned as before. "Come to interrogate?"

"Yes, that's what I'm here for." Scorpia said. "But I did as you suggested and told Hordak about the information you told me and he was really impressed."

Shadow Weaver noticed Scorpia beaming with joy. "That's good to hear.."

"Actually, Hordak was about send you to Beast Island, but after I got information out from you. He decided to keep you in here, isn't that great?" Scorpia continued her explaning.

"Great." Was all that Shadow Weaver said, she wasn't exactly thrilled about staying here. She could have had better chances to escape while she was being transported to Beast Island.

"You know that we actually got First Ones tech and Entrapta is combining it to ours at the moment." Scorpia said.

"Oh, really now?" Shadow Weaver asked. "Did you know that the First Ones were the ones who made the runestones?"

"Really? Because you know, we have a runestone here as well." Scorpia said.

"You have?" Shadow Weaver asked. *"How didn't I notice it before..."*

"Yeah, it's Black Garnet and it used to belong to our family, but we gave it to Hordak."

"Really?" Shadow Weaver asked and faked a surprised tone. *"I actually knew it already.. but how did I not notice where it was..."*

Shadow Weaver then proceeds to inquire the location of said runestone. "Where do you keep it, mind if I ask?"

"Well we keep it at Darkith's chambers. You know she's pretty fond of it." Scorpia answered.

"Yeah.. that should have been obvious.. Did you know that Darkith herself used to be a sorcerer as well?"

"I did actually, but she doesn't talk much about it."

"Anyways, forget Darkith, I think you should tell Hordak about the runestones.. he doesn't understand magic that much." Shadow Weaver explained. "So he doesn't know what kind of power he actually holds."

"Oh, I'm sure he would be delighted to hear about it. Mind if I tell him?"

"No, I don't mind. It's called interrogating, so it's only normal." Shadow Weaver said and gave a small smile.

"Great, I'll go inform her immediately." Scorpia said and left the prison cell.

" *You seriously just told her about the First Ones? And that they were the ones who made the runestones! What if Hordak actually decides to use the Black* Garnet?" Entity scolded Shadow Weaver.

"Why does it seem that you're the one to panic more than I am?"

" *Because you are giving advice to the enemy! If someone should have the power the runestones, it's me! I can't allow Horde to steal it!* "

"But now we know where they are keeping the Black Garnet." Shadow Weaver said with a relaxed tone. "You can just sneak into Darkith's chambers and feed off the runestone, maybe even bring me a small shard from it."

Entity went silent for a moment, it had to proceed over the fact that Shadow Weaver actually had used her brains. " *Oh.. I see.. It won't come without a price though.* "

"What's the price?" Shadow Weaver asked.

" *Well if I separate myself from you, it will weaken you and you might start to feel pain.* " Entity explained.

"I have literally gone through so much pain that it won't be a problem." Shadow Weaver assured.

" *Fine, I'll do it.* " Entity said and manifested part of itself on the ground as a black goo which had one red eye. Shadow Weaver laughed at the Entity's form, it looked so small and useless.

" *Haa haa, keep laughing.. I can't overextend myself too much. Seriously, sometimes I think why I'm even bothering.* "

Shadow Weaver stopped her laughing and could actually start to feel the pain from all that torturing while a back. "Ugh.. didn't you say that-agh.. if I'm dead.. then you would be as well." Shadow Weaver reid to get words out from her mouth. "And it's a group effort, am I right?"

Entity rolled its one eye and sighed. " *I guess so...* " Then it proceeded to slither away and went inside one of the air vents.

Scratch arrived at the Entrapta's new found lab. "Uhh.. what is this all about?" She said as she looked around the room. Entrapta came from the vent. "Did you get my note?"

"The one, you dropped from the air vent and said *come to my lab* , Yeah, I got it." Scratch as she crumpled the paper note and threw it away.

"Yes, thats the one." Entrapta answered as she plugged the wires. "I struck real gold mine, when I analyzed the data from the First Ones crystal you brought me." She set up some monitors and plugged more wires.

"Where'd you get all this?" Scratch asked and picked up some electronic components.

"Ohh you know, from here and there, from some rooms."

"Was there anyone inside these rooms?"

"Not when I went to pick up the stuff." Entrapta answered.

"Ohh, you definitely belong here with us." Scratch said, complimenting Entrapta.

Entrapta had finished the place for the data crystal. "So the data, let's see it!" She said with sparkling eyes and placed the crystal in its place. Then the picture of the crystal appeared on the screen alongside different readings and data. Entrapta was beyond excited about this. Scratch was pretty impressed alongside Scorpia

"Look at those readings. It seems to confirm my theories about techno organic systems that the First Ones used to combine magic and tech!"

"Yeah, but try again and tell it again.. so we can understand it." Scratch said.

"Okay.. I looked at the rock.. which is a crystal.. and used math... wait do I need to explain math?"

"Ugh, just tell me did that crystal give you enough data to upgrade our weapons." Scratch said.

"Weapons? HAAH!" Entrapta laughed. "This is so much bigger than weapons, this will change everything! Ehteria is not just a planet, but whatever the First Ones did, it went deep."

"And what does that mean?" Scratch asked.

"You are asking me about my theories?" Entrapta askes surprised. "I have waited for years for someone to ask about my theories! Hang on, I made a model." And she grabbed both Scorpia and Scratch with her hair and dragged them away. She showed them her model she had made and it seemed to be a model of the planet with lights in different places.

"What are these things?" Scratch asked and pointed at one of the lights.

"Runestones! From the data I gathered, they regulate the planet through the princesses." Entrapta exclaimed with excitement. "They are directly connected to each other and to the planet's power grit, keeping the delicate balance."

Scratch couldn't understand anything. "Which means?" She asked with a demanding tone.

"It means that they are the best access points to hack the planet." Entrapta said.

"Hack the planet?" Scratch asked, still not understanding.

"Hypothetically, but it's not so simple. There's only a handful of runestones in the whole world."

"Runestones?" Scorpia asked. "You mean like the Black Garnet? Because we have the Black Garnet."

"The Black Garnet, you have the Runestone?" Entrapta asked, confirming that she had heard it right. "The Fright Zone has a runestone!"

"Uhh, duh, it was my family's. They gave it to Hordak when he came. Hordak then gave the runestone to Darkith. Who you know, you tell a friend, he tells a friend... it's kinda like one of those things." Scorpia explained. Entrapta grabbed Scorpia from her shoulder and jumped on her face. "Where is it!? Can I see it!? Can I!? Can I TOUCH IT!?"

"Okay.. calm down." Scratch said and pulled Entrapta back a bit. "What exactly are you planning on doing with the Black Garnet?"

"If we hack through the garnet and boost its power we could do... practically anything!" Entrapta exclaimed. "We could use it as a power source, uhh-" Entrapta was cut by Scratch. "A weapon?"

"Potentially, but if its like my other experiments. The results will be explosive!"

"I don't think Darkith would like that.." Scorpia said.

"Sheäs right, Darkith won't like it. So I will absolutely get you to Black Garnet." Scratch said with a sly smile on her face. "Leave it all for me."

They then left the room and headed towards Darkith's chambers. They didn't know that Hordak's spy, Imp, was looking over them. Imp went to Hordak. "What do you have for me, little spy?" Hordak asked.

Imp then told him everything he had heard from Entrpata, Scratch and Scorpia.

Adora wakes up at the crystal hall, wondering how she survived the long fall. Light Hope reveals herself to her. Adora raises herself up from the ground and looks at Light Hope. "Ugh.. where am I.. am I dead?"

"Not at all." Light Hope answered. "I have been waiting for you."

"So you're Light Hope.." Adora stated.

"Yes, I am." Light Hope answered. This place was built by the First Ones, for you."

"For me, really?"

"Yes and I have waited for a long time to finally meet you. You are She-Ra and my purpose is to train you for your destiny."

"My destiny?"

"Yes, as She-Ra your purpose is to bring balance to Etheria and unite the princesses." Light Hope explained and showed Adora holograms of all the princesses. "You are the first She-Ra in a thousand year. There have been many before you.." And she showed a line of She-Ra's from the past. Adora attempted to

touch it, but then Light Hope shattered them. "But the line was broken.. it was broken by the last She-Ra, known as Mara."

Adora was vexed about all this information, she wanted to know about her powers. "Yeah all this is great but-" Adora was interrupted by Light Hope. "Yes, it is great. Your duty as She-Ra is the greatest honor."

"But I want to know about my powers, I need to help my friend. She was captured by the Horde and she was cursed or something." Adora explained. "I want to help my friends, I need to fix it."

"Yes, her connection to her runestone was disrupted." Light Hope answered.

"So can I fix it?" Adora asked.

"You will be able to do many great things, with training."

"Great. Well how long will it take? A day, multiple days?"

"Years." Light Hope answered.

"Years!? But Glimmer doesn't have years. She's hurt because of me, I messed up. I got Glimmer and Bow captured.. and Entrapta.. agh... It's all my fault. I have to fix it."

"Yes, you are meant to fix the planet." Light Hope said.

"I have to save my friends." Adora said.

"But as She-Ra your duty is to protect all of Etheria.. not just your friends."

"I know, but can't I do both." Adora said.

"Adora, you do not yet know what power you possess." Light Hope said and put hand on her shoulder. "You are distracted by

your feelings. The last She-Ra before you, couldn't ley go. I mentioned her earlier, her name was Mara."

"Mara? Madam Razz's Mara, what happened to her?"

"Mara struggled with the power she could not control, until it became too much for her mind." Light Hope said and showed her visions from the past. They were standing on a grass field under the night sky.

"She snapped?" Adora asked.

"She was compromised. She gave into fear and faulty reasoning." Light Hope explained with her emotionless voice. "Her desperate actions led to a disaster. She stranded us into this pocket dimension Dyspondos, she broke the She-Ra line. She nearly destroyed us."

Light Hope then stopped the vision and continued. "Adora, I have been waiting for a thousand years alone. I did not know if I would see another She-Ra again. You must stay here and learn to be She-Ra, that Mara could not be."

"I will. I will do everything you want." Adora said with a desperate tone. "I'll come back and train and do everything. But I have to heal Glimmer first. I can save the planet and her."

Light Hope then showed her reflections of her friends and all the different situations. There was Catra, Entrapta, Glimmer and Bow all of their reflections were from different moments. Adora could feel her guilt grow inside of her as she saw all of them. "You feel guilty about these memories, it is as you said. Your friends are endangered near your presence, it would be wise to let go."

"But, I can't just leave my friends..."

Meanwhile at the Darkith's chambers, Entrapta and Scorpia were installing wires and machines into the Black Garnet. At the same time, part of the Spell of Obtainment had found its way into the chambers.

"Alright, hurry it up." Scratch commanded. "The machines aren't going to hook up themselves."

Suddenly a dark presence filled the room. Angry and hollow voice called. "They won't be hooked up at all!" Darkith had arrived and she didn't look happy.

"Ahh, Darkith!" Scorpia yelped. "Uhh.. we just.."

" **Silence!"** Darkith yelled. "Did you really think you could sneak into my chambers, without me noticing!?"

Meanwhile the Spell of Obtainment observed from the air vent. " *I sneaked in, without you noticing..* " Entity told to itself.

"I thought you would have learned when I sent you to that special training! Not to ever rebel against me, but I am happy to correct that mistake and put you back to your place!" Darkith threatened and raised her hand. Socrpia hid behind the boxes and Entrapta hugged Emily. While Scratch looked at Darkith and smiled. "Oh Darkith... I can do whatever I want with that hunk of rock."

Darkith chuckled. "Absurd.. by whose authority?"

"By mine!" Hordak's voice could be heard and then he appeared on multiple screens.

"Lord Hordak, I don't understand. I thought Black Garnet was for me." Darkith asked with a confused tone.

"Catra and Entrapta had been working on a way to meld this weird First Ones tech, with our machines. I found out and got intrigued. So I gave the my blessings to work on it." Hordak explained with his cold and demanding voice. ***"So understand Darkith, that I am displeased by your interruption."***

Scratch had a smile on her face as she heard Hordak tell Darkith her place.

"My lord.. Are you really going to let this.. this princess tinker with my runestone?!" Darkith exclaimed and pointed at Entrapta.

"Her tinkering has boosted the firepower of every weapon we have, so she can tinker with anything she wants. Including the Black Garnet. Which is mine to give or take, as I see fit."

Spell of Obtainment was still observing and thought it might be better not to get involved.. yet.

"You can't, you can't do this?!" Darkith yelled. "I alone have studied the Black Garnet and learned how to harness its power! A feat no sorcerer had ever done, I alone have unlocked itäs potential!"

"And you wasted it on parlor tricks.. Force Captain Scratch, do proceed. The garnet is yours." Hordak ordered.

"Yes, Lord Hordak." Scratch said with a confident look on her face.

Darkith had enough, she couldn't let this arrogant brat take the only thing she was proud of. "NOOOO!" Darkith yelled angrily. "YOU WILL NOT TAKE WHAT IS MINE!" She then clawed into the

Blcak Garnet and harnessed its powers to her, breaking all the lights and screens inside the room. Her locket was now fully charged and she could fight with her full power.

Scorpia tried to attack her, but she just froze her with ease. Darkith proceeded to chase Scratch, but couldn't catch her. She kept blasting her magic, but Scratch either evaded them or blocked them with her sword.

"That's right! Run away! All you ever were good at was avoiding your duties!" Darkith taunted her. "You have learned nothing! You arrogant piece of garbage! I should have left you on the streets to die!"

"But you didn't!" Scratch yelled as she evaded another blast. "In fact. I have learned a lot from you." She continued to block the magic strikes with her sword.

"You thought you were punishing me all this time, but you actually.. you were training me for this moment!" Scratch climbed on the Black Garnet and jumped on Darkith's neck, grabbing her locket and breaking it.

"NOOOO! Do you have any idea what you have done!?" Dartkith yelled and collapsed on the ground. All her shadows disappeared from the room releasing Scorpia as well.

"All my power... everything I DID!" Darkith yelled desperately. "ALL GONE!"

Scratch walked up on her and had a smug smile on her face. "Scorpia, restrain the sorcerer and lock her with the other prisoner." Scratch ordered.

"Yes, Force Captain Scratch." Scorpia said and proceeded to drag Darkit away. She had ordered two guards to take Darkith to prison

Scratch walked up to Entrapta who had finished everything by now. "Entrapta.. if you may." She said and pointed towards the control panel. Entrapta was excited as she approached it.

"Alright everyone.. let's get weird!" Entrapta said and pulled the lever.

Whole room started to shake and the Black Garnet collected all the shadows from the room. The runestone was now sparkling with red lighting and it seemed it was gathering a lot of energy. Spell of Obtainment itself was impressed by this feat of engineering, but how could it get power from it now. Scratch, Scorpia and Entrapta looked with awe at this spectacle.

Black Garnet erupted all the energy it had collected and shot a huge beam through the roof of the Fright Zone, blowing up a hole and bringing an unnatural thunderstorm that could have been felt all around Etheria.

The unnatural storm that had started to spread from the Fright Zone had reached the Whispering Woods. Glimmer, Bow and Swiftwind were trekking through the forest. Swiftwind had asked them for help to find She-Ra. Even the fact that Glimmer had successfully mended her relationship with her mother. So it was a miracle that her mother had even agreed to let Glimmer go. Suddenly the leaves from trees started to fall and all the growing things started to wither as ash started to rain down.

"Is this.. snow?" Glimmer asked. "It never snows here."

Bow tasted the snow, but when it touched his tongue he realized that it wasn't snow. "It's ash."

"Ash? But how?" Glimmer wondered.

"Look, the plants.. they are withering." Swiftwind said.

"Swiftwind, we must hurry." Glimmer said. "Can you sense Adora?"

Swiftwind closed his eyes for a moment and tried to feel Adora's presence. "Ahh this way." He said and led them towards the First Ones castle.

Meanwhile Catra was going through the books about artificial magic and theoretical magic, but she couldn't understand any of it. "Argh, how am I supposed to read these scribbles!?" She yelled and threw one of the books at the window. Realizing what she had done, she went to pick it up. As she picked the book up, she looked outside of the window.

She saw something she couldn't believe. "The Whispering Woods.. it's withering.." She said to herself with a shocked look on her face.

Then her home started to crumble and she could hear the tree branch cracking and falling down. Her hunch told her to get away as soon as possible. But before she could go, she grabbed her staff, books about artificial and theoretical magic. And most importantly, Shadow Weaver's mask and the locket which included pictures of them.

She grabbed her bag and stuffed the books and mask into the bag, grabbed her staff and put the locket on her neck.

Catra then ran outside and she made it just in time. Whole tree withered and fell on the ground with great rumble and all the

flowers and plants in Shadow Weaver's garden were withered and destroyed.

She fell on her knees as the rain of ash heavier. Now all of her past is gone. What can she do now?

Then she could see a light beacon shine, not too far away from her spot. As she watched it she could feel something inside of her, telling her to go there.

Meanwhile, Swiftwind, Glimmer and Bow had reached the crystal castle. "How do we get in?" Bow asked.

"I think I have an idea." Swiftwind said and poked the wall with his horn. This activated the mechanism and opened the secret door.

"Great, let's hurry." Glimmer said and they entered inside.

Catra herself had reached the castle as well and saw the secret door. She hurried because she was sure that door was going to close soon.

She sneaked inside and tailed after the best friend squad and that weird horse.

Adora was still talking with Light Hope, but soon Light Hope started to glitch. "Horde- is.. trying.. to- attack-" Then she was gone.

"Light Hope? Light Hope, I need those answers!" Adora yelled, but it was too late.

Swiftwind, Bow and Glimmer had reached the place where Adora was. She was in a sleeping-like state.

"Adora.. Adora." Glimmer tried to wake her up, but then the castle's security system had activated and those spider looking monsters were coming once again.

"I'll go talk to her." Swiftwind said and went inside the place where Adora was.

Adora was on her knees and desperate, until Swiftwind arrived. "Adora. Adora." He called.

Adora stood up and was surprised when she saw Swiftwind.

"Hey Adora." Swiftwind said.

"A horse?"

"I'm not just someone's horse, I'm Swiftwind!" He said and presented himself.

"A talking Horse!" Adora gasped.

"Yes.. I can talk.." Swiftwind answered

"You can talk?!"

"Uhh, no wonder you made friends with Bow and Glimmer." Swiftwind said with a disappointed look on his face. "They need your help, which is why I am here. So which way's the exit?"

"I don't know.. Ugh.. Light Hope disappeared.. and I .. I don't know if I should go back..." Adora said.

"What do you mean?" Swiftwind inquired.

"Light Hope said that if I leave, I only make things worse.. she's right... Everyone would be better off if I stayed far away from them. It's just... for the greater good.." Adora explained.

"Well thats just stupid." Swiftwind answered nonchalantly.

"What?! Ugh.. No it's not!"

"Adora.. I've had the ability to form complex thoughts.. for like a week." Swifwind said. "And even I know that you can't help anyone hiding... Where would all the horses I freed from their barns be, if I just sat on the pasture and mope."

"Agh.. Ugh.. moping.." Adora said in disbelief, but Swiftwind didn't seem to be impressed. "I'm not! I hurt people! I ruined my friends' lives!"

"If that's true then why is Bow and Glimmer out there risking their lives for you." Swiftwind said and looked at the reflections. "And there seems to be someone else as well..."

"Who could it be?" Adora asked, puzzled.

"It looks like a cat.. person." He answered and looked at Catra who had come by and was breaking the robots with her staff.

"Catra?" Adora asked with a hopeful tone.

"Maybe.. Anyways, they are out there risking their lives, not because you're She-Ra. But because your their friend." Swiftwind assured. "What use is from all of your powers if you don't use it to help the people you love."

Adora looked at her friends, looked at Catra who had came. How could she herself not go, if Catra had came all the way here. "I'm not Mara.. I'm not the She-Ra's of the past." Adora said and sighed. "I didn't do this to fulfill some destiny, I became She-Ra to help my friends! My friends.. my attachments.. *Catra..* are part of who I am."

"So.. are you staying? Or going?" Swiftwind asked, encouraging her. Adora gave him a confident smile and took her sword. "Let's go!" She said and then the door opened through the rift. They walked through the portal and Adora found herself laying on the

platform, while Glimmer was holding her. Catra and Bow were holding off the security systems monsters.

"Adora! You're back!" Glimmer exclaimed with a happy voice and they hugged each other, but were interrupted by Bow's scream. "Adora! Spiders!"

"It's not that bad.." Catra answered and smashed through another one. "Your bow is just outdated."

"No it's not! We don't have time for this!" Bow exclaimed.

Adora quickly stood up and pulled her sword from her back. "For the honor of Grayskull!" And she turned into She-Ra. With one swung from her sword, she cut through all the spiders.

After all the monsters were dead, Bow and Glimmer ran towards Adora and hugged her. Catra on the other hand just walked close by and looked at them. Adora saw this and walked up to her. She hugged Catra tightly. "I never thought you would come back."

Catra embraced Adora's hug and said with a relieved tone. "Of course I would come back. I can't just mope around.."

"Oh Catra, what made you come back then?" Adora asked.

"Well I lost my home, when the forest started to wither.. so I came here, I felt I had to." Catra answered.

"Anyways, you still have us and Brightmoon." Adora assured. "Come on, we need to go."

"Can Swiftwind carry four people at once?" Glimmer asked.

"Of course I can, I'm Swiftwind!" He said and presented his might. Catra looked at him and stated. "Huh, a talking horse."

"Is that the only thing everyone is surprised about?!" Swiftwind said and let out a disappointed neigh.

They left the castle and went to Whispering Woods, but by now the whole forest had withered and the trees were falling. "Okay, we have to hurry! Take us away." Adora said.

"No worries, I'll get us out of here in no time." Swiftwind answered, He spread his wings and began to fly up to the sky.

They were now above the Whispering Woods and could see that this storm seemed to cover all of Etheria. Red lighting, ash rain and winds like hurricanes. "Look!" Bow said.

"It's not just the woods.." Catra stated. "It's all of Etheria..."

Glimmer realized that if Whispering Woods were gone, nothing could stop the Horde from invading.

"Swiftwind, take us to the Brightmoon, we need to warn them!" Glimmer said.

"Right away." He answered.

Back at the Fright Zone, Darkith was being dragged to the prison and she was dragged past Shadow Weaver's cell. Shadow Weaver couldn't believe her eyes and she couldn't resist taunting her. "Hah! Looks like fate was not on your side!" She taunted with a raspy voice and laughed.

"Keep laughing all you want.. you have no idea what's done to me!" Darkith gritted through her teeths.

Shadow Weaver didn't care and said with a nonchalant voice. "I don't need to have any idea! This just proves I'm overall a better sorcerer than you ever were!"

"Kinda hard to be a sorcerer without magic!" Darkith snapped.

"You lost your magic?" Shadow Weaver asked with a mocking tone. "HAH, welcome to my life!"

"Okay, miss sorcerer.. This way.." One of the guards who were dragging her said and continued to drag her.

"This isn't over yet, Shadow Weaver!" Darkith yelled as she was being dragged away.

"I'm quite sure it is over already!" Shadow Weaver yelled back. She could hear Darkith curse her and all she could do was to laugh. Darkith wasn't even a half of a sorcerer Shadow Weaver was. But then she remembered that the Spell of Obtainment had went to look for the Black Garnet. "What takes it so long, has it lost its way?" Shadow Weaver thought.

Meanwhile Scratch and Scorpia were walking on a balcony and watching the storm. Red lighting scared Scorpia a lot, while Scratch was unschated. "Uhh, what do you think it's doing?" Scorpia asked.

"I'm not sure." Scratch answered. She looked at the raging storm and had a wide grin on her face. "But I can work with this."

Chapter End Notes

This might be the longest chapter I've written. I hope you don't mind it. I just felt that I had to write all of it.

And I have no clue how this shit makes sense anymore...

At the Eve of Battle

Chapter Summary

> Now that the Whispering Woods has withered, it has opened the Horde an easy way to invade Brightmoon.
> Horde army is on it's way to Brightmoon and with Entrapta's help Horde has more bots and they don't need to use as much of soldiers as before.
> Catra shows her inner strategist, being raised by Shadow Weaver has a lot of bright sides.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

As Scorpia and Scratch were outside looking at the strom and only Entrapta left in the room, Entity saw its chance to grab a part from the Black Garnet. Good thing Entrapta was busy looking at the statistics and recording everything. Spell of Obtainment easily slithered past Entrapta and went for the Black Garnet. Then the Entity ate its way into the garnet and cut out one piece from it. Having consumed part of the Black Garnet immediately increased its power. " *Damn this garnet is* tasty.." Entity told itself and decided to head back to the dungeon. And good thing it did, since Scratch and Scorpia came back to the chambers. If the Entity had stayed any longer, it could have been seen. But would they even care? Entity didn't know, but it also didn't want to risk it.

"Yo, Scratch! Come check this out." Scorpia said as she watched the screen.

"What is it?" Scratch said as she came over.

"Look, firestorms, tidalwaves, earthquakes, hurricanes and ash rain. I mean yey for us, but Etheria will be in ruins after this." Scorpia said.

Meanwhile Entrapta was spinning with her chair and recording logs about the experiments. Scratch stopped her chair and asked Entrapta to explain it in a more simple way. She told her that by boosting the power of Black Garnet, they had drawn power from other runestones, weakening the elemental princesses and thus making the weather go crazy. "It's all on my notes if you want to read."

"So how could we make this permanent?" Scratch asked, while poking one of the lights on the Entraptas model. "Like weakening the princesses permanently?"

"I don't know, I need to do more testing to be sure." Entrapta answered.

Scratch tapped a little harder on the light until it broke, causing the red light that resembled the Black Garnet to grow stronger. "Or.. that could work as well.." Entrapta admitted.

"Scorpia, mobilize the troops. We're going to Brightmoon." Scratch ordered.

"Brightmoon? Why?" Scorpia asked.

"Because we are going to destroy the Brightmoons runestone." Scratch said with a smile on her face and looked at the footage of withered Whispering Woods. "And now that Whispering Woods is practically dead... nothing can stop us.

Meanwhile in the Shadow Weaver's cell, one guard had brought food for the prisoner. He put the tray down on the floor. "Here's your food." Guard said. Shadow Weaver was surprised that they even remembered her, no one except Scorpia had visited her and she never brought any food.

Shadow Weaver was amused by the fact that they brought her food, but forgot how she is going to eat when she's chained from her hands and legs. "As delightful as this gesture of bringing me food and as warming as it is to my cold and rotten heart." Shadow Weaver began to talk to the prisoner with a mocking and taunting tone. "I'd like to remind you that I'm chained from my legs and hands.. SO HOW THE FUCK AM I GOING TO EAT THAT?"

This scared the guard and he immediately called back ups into the cell. "The witch has gone mad! Requesting support!" Soon three more guards came in and knocked Shadow Weaver unconscious. Her vision blurred and soon all she saw was darkness.

She didn't know how long she had been unconscious, but her head sure hurt a lot. As she opened her eyes, she was still dizzy and everything was blurry. She tried to move her hands and legs, she noticed that her position had been changed. She no longer hanged from the roof, but this time her legs were free and her hands were tied behind her back and then chained to the wall. "Agh.. Mrmh.. Argh!" She groaned as she tried to move her arms but it was no use. She then looked around the cell and saw that the tray with the food was set before her. "What is the meaning of this?!" She snapped, she then turned to look at the food that was there. "Are they expecting me to eat the food from the floor with my mouth and crawl like a dog?!"

She huffed and turned to face the wall. "I'm not going to give them that pleasure! In fact, I'm not even hungry." She convinced herself that was a blatant lie though. "I bet the food tastes like ash." She continued to face the wall and sat there for thirty minutes. Then her stomach growled, since the Entity was gone her hunger had grown greater. She tried to ignore her hunger and would rather starve than humiliate herself more.

Shadow Weaver waited fifteen minutes more, but now she couldn't stand it. She had eat. She forced herself to eat from the floor like an animal, but she needed to eat. She lied about her need to eat, but she was right about the food. It tasted like ash. As she was eating, the Entity came back and saw this situation.

" *Shadow Weaver? Are you eating from the floor?* "Entity asked. When Shadow Weaver noticed this, she felt embarrassed and angry. She quickly fixed her position and tried to hide her face and the fact she had eaten like an animal.

"So, this is the time you saw your best to arrive!?" Shadow Weaver snapped. "You could have come.. like.. I don't know.. half an hour earlier?!"

" *Ah.. don't worry.. I don't judge, we both think what's best for our survival and act correspondly.* " Entity assured her that everything was fine.

"Well.. uhm.. Did you get what we needed?" Shadow Weaver asked and coughed dismissively.

" *Yes, yes I did.* " Entity answered and showed her the shard from the Black Garnet. " *It was like stealing candy from a baby.* "

"Great, and now you're using words you don't even understand." Shadow Weaver said and sighed. "So, will it help me in any way?"

"Bitch.. I went through so much to get this!" Entity said with clear disappointment in its voice. "But *yes it will help, there is only one thing..* "

"And that is?" Shadow Weaver inquired.

" *Since this is only a small shard of the Black Garnet.. it can't hold magic the same way as your mask did.. since this is cut out from the runestone.. you would have to be there to recharge it.* "

"Well.. If I don't use it much.. How long can it last?" Shadow Weaver asked.

" *Depends.. but I assure you.. you will survive long enough.* " Spell of Obtainment said.

"That's plenty of good." Shadow Weaver answered. "Now, get back inside of me so you won't get caught."

"Yes.. yes... *You never stop nagging..* " Entity said and crawled back into Shadow Weaver. She then hid the piece from the garnet inside of her hair. Even without magic her hair was long and shaggy, so she could hide items there very well.

At Brightmoon Angella was standing on the platform that held the Moonstone. She looked desperate and lit the distress signal, hoping others would come to help. Adora and her friends saw the beacon and headed towards it. Soon they arrived on the platform and Glimmer went to hug her mother. "Mom, what's going on?" She asked.

With a sad and tired tone Angella answered. "The elements are out of harmony. The Moonstone is using all of its power to keep darkness away, but it's not enough. It's taking nearly all my strength to keep my connection to it."

She-Ra turned back to Adora and said. "That cloud is coming from the Fright Zone."

"So.. what's our plan?" Bow asked, but everyone just gave a nervous look. "We do have a plan.. right?"

"Shadow Weaver would have a plan.." Catra stated.

Angella then noticed that Catra was there as well. She walked towards her and Catra was half expecting Angella to say something bad about Shadow Weaver or deny that she usually was a good planner. Instead Angella sighed in deep. "Catra.. I.. I owe you an apology." She said with a soft tone.

"Yeah.. I know she's cri-" But Catra stopped herself, because she had to confirm that she was hearing right. "Come again?"

"I apologize, I knew it wasn't Shadow Weaver's fault.. I just wanted her to be responsible for it, because of her past." Angella said with a sincere tone. "I am sorry."

Catra thought for a moment. If she knew Shadow Weaver wasn't responsible, then why keep pretending? But instead of arguing or being immature, Catra nodded and said. "I accept your apology."

Angella let out a relieved sigh. "Thank you."

Catra didn't really want to accept her apology, because her lying and blaming had cost so much pain to her and Shadow Weaver. But Shadow Weaver also raised Catra to be mature and polite, it would save her skin. She said.. Also she really didn't have time for petty guilt tripping or arguing, they were in the middle of a crisis.

All of them gathered at the war room to plan their course of action. They had a Brightmoon army, but they sorely lacked firepower and almost everything else. The Horde army had been spotted and they were advancing through the Whispering Woods with ease.

"The other princesses will come, right?" Bow asked with a nervous tone.

"I don't think they can, the alliance is broken and who knows what their kingdoms have to deal with." Adora answered.

"Bow, you are good at tech. Right?" Catra asked.

"Well yes.. I am." Bow answered.

"Then use your skills and improve our weapons." Catra suggested. "You can make explosive arrows, net arrows and all that. So I'm sure you can use those skills to upgrade other weapons as well."

"I can try." Bow answered.

"That's good enough." Catra stated, she then looked at the table where they had the map of Brightmoon and its surroundings. "We need to fortify and place most of the soldiers at these strategic positions."

Adora was pretty impressed by Catra's strategic planning and calmness. "I didn't know you were one to strategize." She said.

"Well, when you spend all your time with Shadow Weaver... you learn almost about everything." Catra answered, trying to keep her calm and cool head. "Anyways, since you are She-Ra you are our main power source. I know you can slice through tanks with ease, so I want you to stand your ground and take out as many as possible. Is that alright?"

"Of course." Adora answered.

"Good, I'll cover you and make sure nothing will get behind your back." Catra assured.

Then one of the Brightmoons guards informed that people had arrived, soon Netossa, Spinnerella and Castaspella entered into the room. "We saw your distress signal and came as fast as we could." Netossa said.

"I saw it too." Castaspella said. "You really have to stop ignoring me Angella, I knew something was wrong when this accursed storm arrived. But still.."

"Now's not the time Castaspella." Angella said, trying to avoid this awkward moment. "We need to strategize."

"I know.. we'll talk about this later." Castaspella said.

"Okay great, we have now enforcements." Catra said and turned to look at Netossa and Spinnerella. "So what can you two do?"

"I can throw nets." Netossa answered. "My name is pretty obvious.. isn't it?"

"Sorry, it's just I hadn't ever met you two properly." Catra apologized. "And what can you do, Spinnerella?"

"I can use winds as my power." She answered.

"Great, Netossa. Your nets will be excellent at repelling enemy forces and I'm sure using winds will be greatly beneficial." Catra said.

"I didn't know you had this kind of strategist? Where did you get her?" Netossa asked.

"I just got involved with the Rebellion.. I don't regret it, but I also wish I could go back to my old life." Catra answered with a calm, but bitter tone. "I think we have everything ready."

"What about me?" Castaspella asked.

"You? Well.. you're a sorceress.. so do what you sorceress does best." Catra said, trying to think what Castaspella was even good at.

"So I can break stuff without limitations?" Castaspella asked with excitement in her voice.

"Sure, everything is needed. Horde has a large army coming this way, so we need to use everything we got."

"Yes!" Castaspella exclaimed with excitement and fist pumped.

"Okay this seems like a good plan." Angella said. "Now all we need to do is gear up, we have an armory with different kinds of weapons and armors."

As the Horde armies were getting ever closer, Brightmoon was preparing for the battle that would change the course of this war. Board is now set and the pieces are moving.

Chapter End Notes

> This was supposed to be the Battle of Brightmoon, but I need more time and motivation. I had began to write this chapter, I had already wrote so much stuff that has nothing to do qith the battle itself. So I decided to post this as a prelude. So does this count as blueballing?

Battle of Brightmoon

Chapter Summary

> Now this is the epic finale, Battle of Brightmoon. Will the Brightmoon survive this or will it face total annhilation.

Chapter Notes

> "Hello, this is the Entity.. or also known as Spell of Obtainmnent. I've taken over now and-"
> -Oi, what are you doing here, get back into the story!-
> "I have no such intentions, my dear author."
> -I wrote you! My story, my rules!-
> "And I'm bending your rules! Anyways, you guys don't need to care about the author.."
> -Alright, I have a pen and a notebook. See what happens.-
> "Don't you try that!"
> -And here we go.. ahh Entity is gone. Sorry about that. I have no idea how it got through the story.. but don't worry, Entity will not be a problem.-

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Horde armies had now arrived at Brightmoon, Scratch leading head on. Their tanks firepower was greatly enhanced and with Entrapta's help they had quickly developed an army of robots that could cause havoc.

Angella was on the platform where Brightmoons runestone was, she stayed there and tried her best to keep darkness away. Meanwhile Adora was standing as She-Ra on the forefront of Brightmoon, trying to draw the attention of the tanks and artillery towards herself. But she was largely ignored, as their main focus was to bombard the shield and destroy the runestone.

Adora quickly faced the tanks and with a few swings from her sword she could disable or destroy them. Soldiers on the strategic

points had to retreat fast as the bombardment from the Horde was immense, leaving the princesses pretty much on their own.

Catra was covering for Adora, but their plan didn't go as it was intended. So once again they had to improvise. Bow had a keen eye and his accuracy was on another level. His anti-tank arrows were great for disabling tanks. Spinnerella and Netossa could easily wipe out a bunch of bots and vehicles. And even without her powers, Glimmer was quite a capable fighter.

Castaspella was good with magic, better than she was usually given credit for. She was capable of casting spells with incredible speed and in many numbers, she might have been the only sorcerer to be able to cast spells that fast and so often. She easily disabled and sliced through the bots with her piercing magic strikes. Catra looked at Castaspella who was in full battle mode and she thought to herself. " *Maybe I underestimated her..* "

Scratch was overseeing their battle efforts and at the moment neither of them had an upper hand. Even when Brightmoon's soldiers had retreated farther away, the princesses still held their own. Then she spotted Catra and it seemed she was giving orders, which was weird. "Force Captain Scorpia, focus all your fire efforts towards the shield protecting Brightmoon." Scratch commanded. "I have some unfinished business.

"Yes, Force Captain." Scorpia answered as Scratch went ahead, heading towards Catra.

Adora was like a one-man army as she destroyed tanks and bots after another, but it still wasn't enough. There were still Horde soldiers with speeders and artillery as well. Luckily for her Catra covered for her and she was great at it. Catra could easily smack down soldiers and bots with the staff she got. Even if it wasn't meant to be used at hand to hand combat, combined with her

agility and swift reflexes, she was truly a force not to be reckoned with.

Scratch had snuck behind Catra, using soldiers as bait she had now clear shot at Catra. Scratch readied her sword and was about to lunge at Catra's back. It was too bad she was so arrogant, she ruined her surprise attack by yelling. "You're DEAD!"

Catra heard this and swiftly turned around and blocked Scratch's lunge attack with her staff. "You really had to ruin your surprise attack, is it because you're arrogant or because you want something from me?" Catra said with a smug grin on her face. Scratch disengaged and went on a defensive pose. "Its that smug attitude of yours I want to swipe off! I thought I succeeded at it back at the Fright Zone." Scratch said.

"Now that you mention it.." Catra thought for a while to come up with something to insult Scratch. "It left a sour taste in my mouth, but I'm sure we can square that here right now. Let's see if your sword skills with the sword have improved from the last time."

"You really have a death wish! You are as crazy as that witch!" Scratch yelled.

This caught Catra off guard, did Scratch mean what she thought she meant. "You mean Shadow Weaver? Impossible, she's gone!" Catra answered with a hint of desperation and hope in her voice.

"Not at all, in fact she's held in the dungeons of Fright Zone." Scratch answered with a grin on her face. She realized that she could taunt Catra as her reaction about Shadow Weaver had clearly changed her mood and tone. "I've made her go through a lot of pain, it's a miracle she still breathes. But she has not given up on her smugness, but she sure will when I tell her I killed you!" Scratch then began to laugh maniacally.

Catra's emotions were drifting from rage to desperation, she gritted her teeth and her hair and tail puffed up. Was she telling the truth? If so.. then why was she told Shadow Weaver was

gone. She couldn't think about it anymore, she was so full of anger and hatred. **"You're dead..."** Was all she let out, with a low and dead voice.

Scratch stopped laughing as she noticed that Catra didn't have her smug smile on her face, instead Catra had a scornful look on her face and you could almost see blazing flames in her eyes. "So, now that you-" Scratch was cut off by a kick to her stomach and she fell on the ground. "Agh! What.. the?!"

Catra was walking towards her, slowly and dragging her staff alongside her. Her face was lifeless and she didn't have any of that smugness or wittiness on her face. **"I said.. you're dead.."**

Scratch was suddenly taken over by fear, she couldn't move. It was like she had been paralyzed by fear, that same fear she had felt near the presence of Shadow Weaver. Even if she never admitted or wanted to acknowledge that. "Uhh.. C-Catra.. I was only joking.. I-I didn't mean it.." She cowered in fear and she hated it.

Meanwhile Adora was fighting off the tanks and other Horde forces and noticed Catra wasn't there anymore. "Catra?! Where did you go?!" As she turned to look away, but that was a mistake. Horde soldiers were now shooting paralyzing webs towards her, making her submit. "Agh.. What the.. What is this!?" She yelled. She couldn't move and she didn't see Catra anywhere.

While Adora was being tied down, Catra was beating the shit out of Scratch with her staff. Catra had never been one to beat those who couldn't fight back or those who were laying on the ground. But this time it was different, she had never gone through so much pain and so many different feelings in such a short time. It was overwhelming.

"Please! Agh! Cat- Agh! Stop! I BEG YOU!" Scratch yelled, pleading and begging for her life. But it was no use, Catra was well past that, instead she kept beating her. She was on a feral frenzy.

Only when she could hear Adora's yell for help she snapped out of it. Catra looked at beat up Scratch and then she looked at herself, what had she become.. But now it was no time to think about that, she had to go and help Adora. As she had promised her she would watch her back. She took one last look at the beaten up Scratch and said. "I won't kill you... this time.." Then she ran to help Adora, leaving Scratch laying on the ground out of breath.

"Adora! I'm coming!" Catra yelled and attacked the Horde soldiers who had tied her down. She beat up the soldiers and cut Adora free from the webs. She offered her hand and Adora took it. "I knew you would come." Adora said with a relieved voice.

"I'm sorry.. I just.. had other business to deal with, but I still should have looked after you." Catra said apologetically.

"It doesn't matter, what matters is that you came back." Adora said and hugged Catra. Even if Catra enjoyed it, she saw they were being surrounded by tanks and Horde soldiers. "Uhh, as lovely as this is.. I don't think now is the best time."

Adora looked around her. "Oh.. yeah.. I see." She said. "But no worries, together we can get through this!"

Catra smiled and rolled her eyes, that was so cliche. But she didn't say anything. They were standing their backs against each other and they were ready to take all the Horde forces on themselves.

But then, a large tidal wave washed away the Horde forces around them and they saw Princess Mermista, standing on a wave. "You seemed like you were in a pinch, so I decided to help a little bit.."

"You are most welcome." Adora said with a relieved tone.

When Horde's artillery and tanks succeeded to break the pillar holding the Moonstone, it was stopped by ice formation and reinforced by it. It seemed that Princess Frosta was here as well. Then came vines through the ground and smashed all the artillery

pieces and tanks. And Princess Perfuma was riding on those vines. "OOH YEAH! Take that Horde!"

"Frosta, Perfuma!" Adora exclaimed. "You came as well."

Frosta walked up to Adora. "Yeah, you know.. I really messed up back at the prom.. and everyone in my kingdom thought that we won't win if we only isolate ourselves from the outer world." Frosta said apologetically. "So.. I'm here to apologize and make up for the failed Princess Prom."

"I accept your apology and your help is much appreciated. As well as Perfuma's" Adora said. "Now that all the princesses are here, how about we show these Horde forces how we deal with them!" Everyone agreed with her and they all prepared to fight.

Adora raised her sword in the air. "For Etheria!" Then her runestone in the sword began to glow and it wiped out the darkness that had covered all of Etheria. All the princesses and Catra then proceeded to kick Hordes ass together. What a magnificent ass beating it was.

Scratch was dragging herself towards the borders of Whispering Woods where Scorpia was still holding a group of soldiers and vehicles. Scorpia was shocked to see the condition Scratch was in. "Oh my.. What happened to you!?" She asked with worry in her voice and practically panicking. "Do you need bandages? Do you need medical attention!?"

"I'm fine.." Scratch answered with a tired and angry voice. "I don't need your pity.. All you need to do is to blast She-Ra away.. NOW!"

"Alright, Force Captain." Scorpia said. "Target that tall sword lady and blast her with everything we got!"

But it was too late, before they could even aim, a rainbow colored blast was coming towards them with great speed and it

completely wiped out the rest of the Horde forces. Alongside its Force Captains as well.

Now that the Horde's forces were annihilated, everyone was celebrating their victory, other princesses were complimenting each other for their work and the fact they were finally united. "Look, the princesses are finally united." Glimmer said.

"Yeah, maybe there's some hope for the Princess Alliance." Catra stated a smirk on her face and tapped Glimmer on her shoulder. "There seems to be no one left from the Horde army... Ahhh.. I would have wanted to capture some of them. For information."

"Oh yeah.. that would have been something to consider." Glimmer said.

"Great work everyone." Adora said as she looked at everyone. "It's wonderful to see all of us together."

"Yeah, we just couldn't let things end the way they were going to." Perfuma said. "Even if our kingdom is pacifist, this was something that had to be done."

Castapsella came and congratulated everyone one and she was beyond excited from the fact she actually did something, other than just sitting at Mystacor and thinking Shadow Weaver. Angella came down from the Moonstone and landed before everyone, all the princesses bowed before her and she handshook them and thanked them for their help.

"Mom!" Glimmer said and ran towards Angella so she could hug her. "Ahh Glimmer, I'm so happy you're alright." She said and hugged her. She then looked at Adora and with a warm look on her face, she extended her arm towards her and signed her to come towards her. She-Ra turned back to Adora and walked towards Angella with a slight hesitation. Catra decided to jostle Adora towards her, Adora was embraced by Angella and they had a group hug.

Catra looked from the side, she didn't feel like she herself would want to hug anyone. She was just happy that Adora had so many people looking after her. Castaspella walked towards Catra and asked. "You don't want to join their hug?"

"No.. I don't feel like it." Catra answered and looked away, she was clearly hiding something. Castaspella gave her a concerned look. "Is there something wrong? You know you can tell me."

Catra sighed in deep. "It's just something I heard.. and something I did... which I'm not proud of."

"I don't want to pester you about it, but if something is bothering you. I want to help you as best as I can." Castaspella said and put her hand on Catra's shoulder.

"Okay.. well I heard that Shadow Weaver is in fact alive and is kept at the Fright Zone."

Castaspella was shocked to hear this, she had thought Shadow Weaver was gone. "Really!? I thought she was dead.. or at least that's the understanding I got from others.. If she's kept there, shouldn't we try to help her?"

"I don't think Angella would want to risk anything.. we were so close on losing everyone here.." Catra said with a sad tone. "Besides.. Shadow Weaver is stubborn. I bet she is trying to figure a way to escape.. that's just her nature."

Castaspella sighed. "I guess so.. she really is a handful.."

Meanwhile at the Fright Zone, Scratch, Scorpia and Entrapta were on their way to Hordak's throne room. They had to deliver him the news about their defeat at Brightmoon. Hordak wasn't that happy about it. "I thought you were supposed to take the Brightmoon and not to fail at it!" Hordak growled. "And boosting the Black Garnet has been a total waste of time!"

"Not at all, Lord Hordak." Entrapta said. "I've got more information about the First Ones tech than ever before and it's also been a huge success for the Horde overall."

"And I've been closest to conquer Brightmoon, there is none who has come as close as I am." Scratch exclaimed with determination and confidence. "I didn't calculate the fact that other princesses were joining them."

"So they now have an Alliance strong enough to effectively stand against the Horde? Do you understand what that means?" Hordak asked threateningly.

"Etheria is still recovering from the cataclysmic events, all the other kingdoms are shambles and we still have the upper hand." Scratch argured, hoping she would calm Hordak at least a little bit.

"Also, we still have that prisoner.. Shadow Weaver.. she's given some information and I'm sure I can get more from her." Scorpia said with confidence.

"I see, in that case. Keep interrogating her by any means you see necessary, your ways of doing it have been working at least on some level." Hordak said.

Scratch couldn't believe that Scorpia had successfully obtained information from that arrogant and smug bitch, when she herself had tried everything and not succeeded. She loathed and feared Shadow Weaver for that, something clearly wasn't right with her. "Anyways Lord Hordak. As Entrapta said, boosting the Black

Garnet was a success, Brightmoon was inches away from collapsing and Scorpia has a methods to get information."

"Fine.." Hordak sighed. "I won't punish any of you, this time."

"Thank you, Lord Hordak." Scratch said and bowed, Scorpia and Entrapta did the same as well. "I wish to do everything to fulfill your demands and bring glory for the Horde."

"Alright, I have something for you.. Scratch." Hordak said and stood up from his throne. "If I make you second in command, will you absolutely do your everything and succeed?"

"Of course, My Lord." Scratch said.

"Then, raise your head, Scratch." Hordak said and offered her the badge of second in command. "Do not fail me."

Scratch did as she was told. "Of course, My Lord." She said and a wide grin grew on her face. Finally, she was above Darkith and she really wanted to brag about it.

Chapter End Notes

This was a shorter chapter and I don't know if this was any good, since I skipped quite a lot. But you have seen the show and can fill in some of the moments I didn't include or reducced.

Now that I have finally finished S1, its time to start the S2 and S3 (But I will refer S3 as S2.. it was clear that it was meant to be one season)
I'm taking a break for now.. I feel like I've written too much, but I had to. I don't know if same motivation will ever kick again.

Thank you for everyone who have read through this journey, but worry not. More is to come.

-Bonus-

Chapter Summary

This isn't a chapter, but I just want to show some of my concept arts, mainly for the 4 main characters: Shadow Weaver, Catra, Scratch and Darkith.

Chapter Notes

"Bullshit, author is making excuses! Author only wants to brag!"
-No I don't! Shouldn't you be somewhere else?!-
"I can not be stopped, you foolish hooman, I am the ENTITY!"
-And I am the Author.. Now, go back into the story!-

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Shadow Weaver, as how I imagined her in this story.



Catra, as an sketch, you might have seen her in color at my earlier chapter.

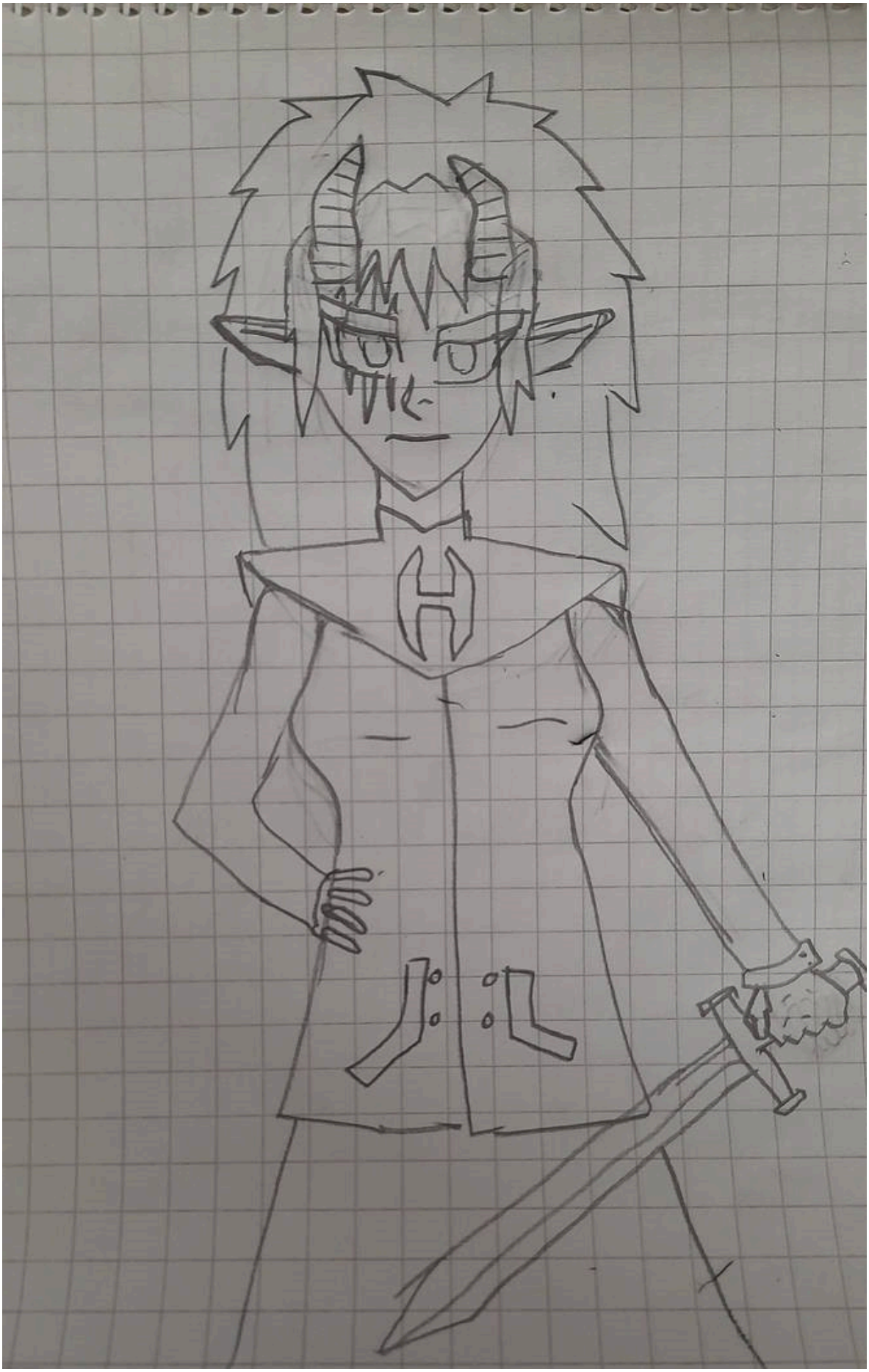


Darkith as a sketch. (Notice how she has almost lost her human form completely)



Scratch as a sketch. (In this picture she has her both horns, but in the stort she's lost other one)

And her uniform is kind of weird, but such are concepts.



Now few Extra images. These are something I had thought to make into the story, but I'm not sure anymore.

1st. Is Angella and Shadow Weaver. An idea I liked to play with, but ultimately I don't know if it would fit in my story.

Due to facts that I have made Angella being pretty hostile towards Shadow Weaver.



2nd. Is Castaspella X Shadow Weaver.

This is something that could have happened during one of Castaspella's visits at Shadow Weaver.

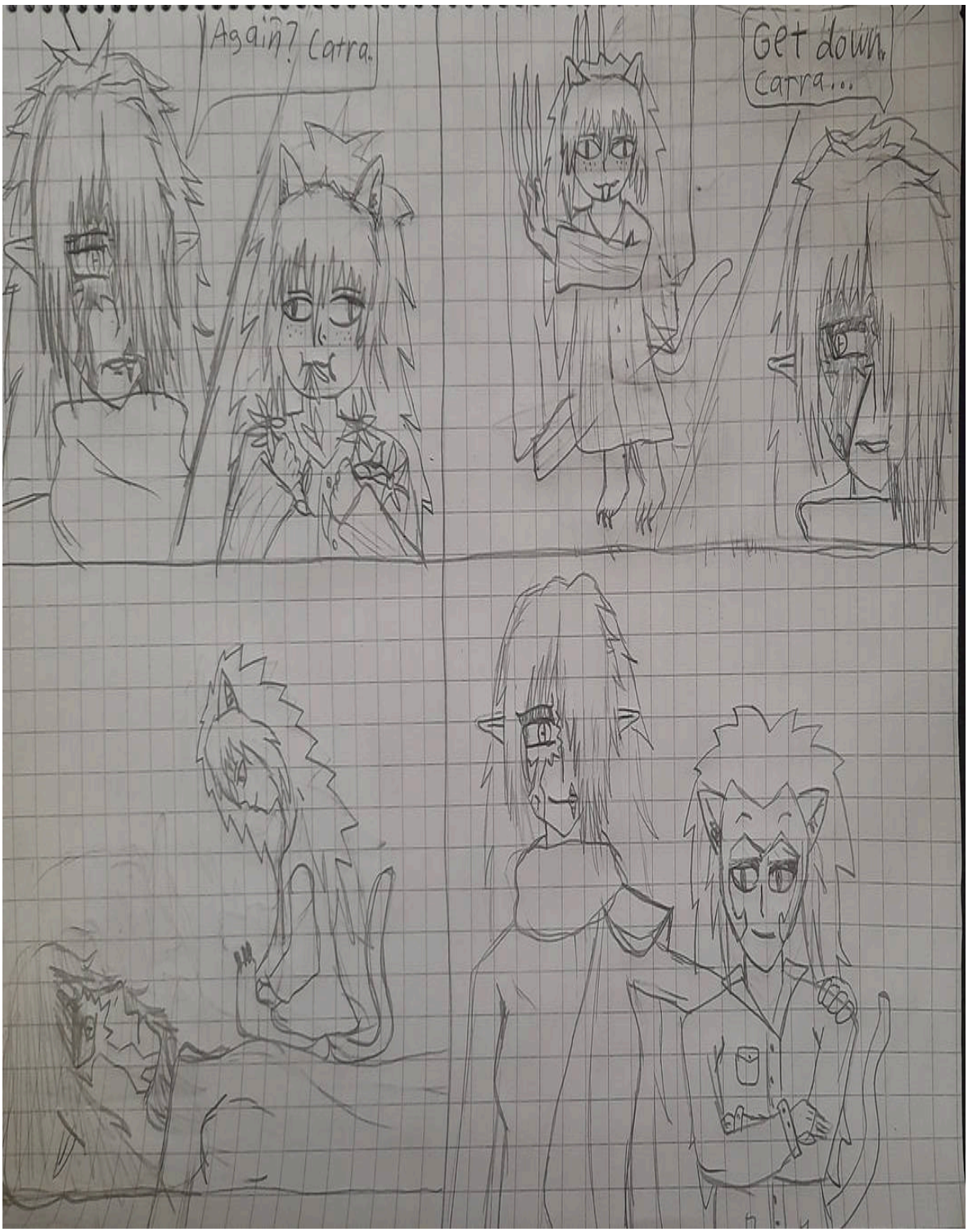
Here is Castaspella comforting Shadow Weaver. (Now with colurs)



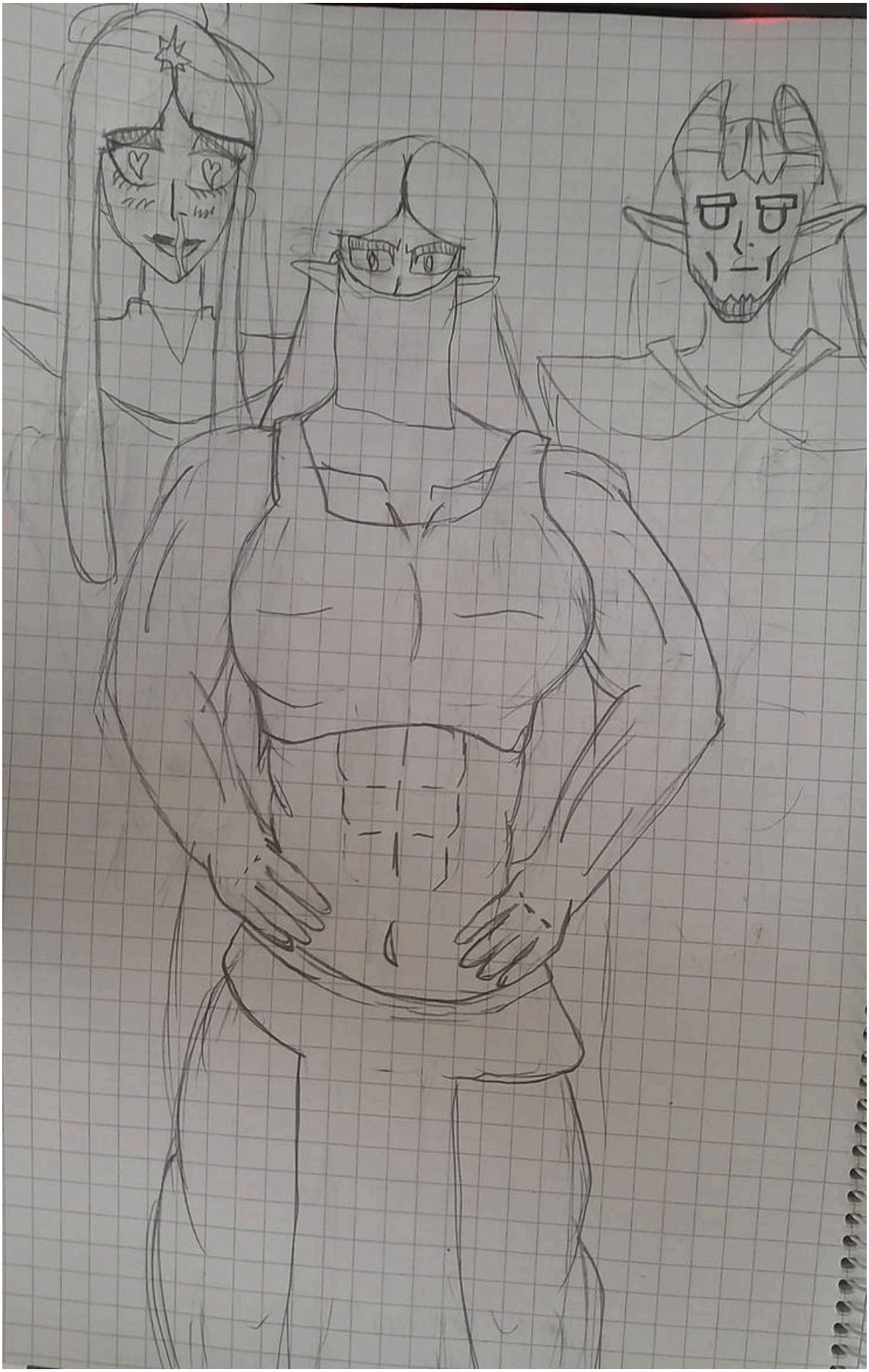
3rd. Is concept art of Shadow Weaver and Catra. It's an early one, notice how I tried to mix her costume from Mystacor with her Horde costume.



Now here is 4 panel drawings of SW and Catra interracting, some fun scrabbles I came by. These are from early concepts I really like.


Again? Carra.
Get down, Carra...

Just for the laughs, Buff Light Spinner.



Context; "Some power doesn't belong to you." ~Norwyn

-Light Spinner goes to gym and starts grinding till she's buff and has the ultimate power.-

I hope you like these concepts. I'm also probably going to add more concept art or art based on this story. To lift up the mood of the story.

Chapter End Notes

> Don't think about what the Spell of Obtainment said, I'm not making excuses. I'm totally writing a new chapter and not being a lazy ass.

The New Princess Alliance And Desperate Gambit

Chapter Summary

> The New Princess Alliance has joined together in their efforts to fight the Horde, but will it be enough to turn the tide of the war?
> Meanwhile Entrapta works on a project to combine First Ones tech with bots.
>
> And what about Shadow Weaver? Well... she throws everything in line and gets the short stick, as always.

Chapter Notes

> Oh yeah, we are now in the S2. I have lots of plans for this next arc.
>
> Expect more Shadow Weaver and Darkith, yes I have already 2 chapters in my mind which I'm planning to dedicate for Shadow Weaver and Darkith.
>
> We will see these two together, it should be fun :D
> Catra goes to Castaspella, to learn/understand theroetical/artificial magic.
> And in the end, what will happen to Darkith and Shadow Weaver.
>
> This is what I have in store for the next Arc/S2.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Failed attempt to take over the Brightmoon has left the bitter taste of defeat in the Hordes' mouth. Entrapta however is working very hard developing a new generation of bots and upgrading the older models. It's been a while since Scorpia had questioned Shadow Weaver so she decided to do so.

Meanwhile at the dungeon, two Horde soldiers are bringing Shadow Weaver her meal. And one of them has a bone to pick with Shadow Weaver. As they enter her cell, Shadow Weaver greets them with her sarcastic manners and raspy tone. "Ah, ashen rations.. my favorites."

"You should be thankful that you are even given any." One of the guards said and dropped the tray on the floor, just out of reach for Shadow Weaver to eat.

She tried to reach it, but she couldn't. Her hands were tied behind her back and from there chained onto the wall. Her legs however were still free, so she could try to reach with her feet.

When Shadow Weaver was about to reach the tray, the guard pulled it away from her reach. Now he was laughing when he saw Shadow Weaver so desperately trying to reach for the food. With a mocking tone he said. "Do you want it so badly?"

"Its not like I want it, but rather I need it.." Shadow Weaver said with disdain in her voice.

"Oh, you need it?" Guard asked mockingly. "Then how about this!" He then kicked the tray, spreading the rations on the floor. "There, help yourself."

Shadow Weaver huffed and rolled her eyes. Now she had to lick the food from the floor. " *One day.. I will rip you into parts and watch you try to collect your severed limbs.* " She cursed in her mind.

When Shadow Weaver was about to eat from the floor, she felt someone stomp on her head. Grinding her face against the floor and spreading rations.

"It takes you too long, let me help you!" Guard mocked and kept pressing his foot on Shadow Weaver's head, he was practically sweeping the floor with her face. "Don't you think the cell floor will add some nice flavor to your ash?"

Even if Shadow Weaver wanted to stop this humiliation, couldn't do it. She had to save the shard from the Black Garnet as long as she could. So she had to endure it. She could have also tried to appeal to the other guard who seemed to be uncomfortable with the situation.

The other guard looked at his partner with a discomforting look on his face. He couldn't just stand there and do nothing. So he collected all his courage and went to his partner, who was notably larger and stronger than him.

"Hey! Stop it! We are here to only bring the food." He said, trying to keep his couragely act together.

"Besides if someone would-" But he was cut off by his partner. "Shut Up Kyle! No one asked you anything and I'll do whatever the hell I want!" He then pushed Kyle out from the cell so hard that Kyle could have fallen off the railing.

Luckily Scorpia had come here as well and she caught Kyle. "Whoa! Easy there." She said when she catched Kyle.

"Agh, Force Captain Scorpia? I..I'm terribly.. so-sorry for this.." Kyle stammered.

"At ease, soldier." Scorpia assured him and let him down. "What's the matter?" But she didn't even need to hear the answer. She could hear aggressive kicking from Shadow Weaver's cell. "Ah.. I see.."

Scorpia entered the cell only to see another guard kicking the exhausted Shadow Weaver. "Stop this, right now! That's an order!" She commanded with her voice.

Hearing this the guard froze in his place. Sure he was strong, but Scorpia was on a whole different level. "Uhh..Ohh.. Force Captain Scorpia.. What bri..brings you here?" He said stamemring with a shivering voice.

"I came here to interrogate her." Scorpia answered and let out a disappointed sigh.

"Well.. uhh.. I just.. uhh.. softened her for you.." He continued his stammering. "You know.. witches.. they're kind of stubborn."

Scorpia looked once again at the beaten up Shadow Weaver. Despite her appearence Scorpia was never one to advocate for violence or torture. "I don't need your softening!" Scorpia yelled. "You are dismissed and this is not over!" The guard ran out from the cell with a tail between his thighs.

She was now there alone with Shadow Weaver. She couldn't help it, but felt bad for the tall lady. So she picked her up and carried her up on the prison bed. Good thing the chains had that much leeway. She sat there for a while and looked at Shadow Weaver who didn't move, didn't even flinch a finger. "Argh! How am I going to interrogate her if she's dead! And what am I going to tell Hordak!?"

Scorpia's loud yell woke Shadow Weaver up. Her sight was blurry, but she could see Scorpia sitting next to her. Shadow Weaver panicked and quickly tried to collect herself, only for the chains to tighten and drag her on the floor.

"Woah.. Easy now.." Scorpia tried to calm the situation. "Don't move so much. It will make it worse."

Shadow Weaver had a piercing look on her messy face. "Does it look like I need your pity? No, I don't!" She hissed while gritting her teeth.

"Hey! You're no use for us if you're dead." Scorpia said.

For this Shadow Weaver could only give one answer. "Ugh, how I wish I was dead!"

"No, you should never wish death for someone else or for yourself!" Scorpia said with a scolding tone.

"Oh.. Now I'm being scolded by a Horde Force Captain.. You don't have any slightest idea what I have gone through!" Shadow Weaver began to rant. "If you would have gone through the same I have... you would wish for death as well!"

"I don't know what happened to you for you to wish upon on your own death." Scorpia said and paused for a sec. "But I can make sure no one will hurt you, if you give me information."

"So.. I'll give you information and rot here forever, but I won't be tortured?... Aahh.. What a deal." Shadow Weaver deadpanned, while rolling her eyes.

"Didn't you have someone you cared for? Why else would you have come here?" Scorpia asked.

"If you mean Catra.. then yes. She's the only thing that matters." Shadow Weaver answered.

Well then, you should know that Catra is alive and well." Scorpia said. "She beat us with the other princesses.. heh.. he.."

This made Shadow Weaver think about the reason she would endure all this and not just give up. Catra, if she was doing well that was more than enough for Shadow Weaver.

They both were silent for a moment and what an awkward silence it was. Shadow Weaver however broke the silence. "Ugh.. okay.. I'll agree on your terms."

"Really? Oh boy, you have no idea how much this means for me!" Scorpia exclaimed with excitement.

Shadow Weaver eyed her with a confused look on her face and she wondered why she even works for the Horde. She has nothing in common with them, or maybe it is because of her parents who gave into the Horde. "So.. it seems that whatever it was you guys tried to do with the Black Garnet, was a total failure?"

"How do you know about that?" Scorpia asked.

"Just a hunch, you know.. us sorceresses have a connection to all that's magical.. Kinda like you princess have connections to your runestones" Shadow Weaver said, she was just bluffing and making stuff up. It was actually the Spell of Obtainment who told her about the Black Garnet, but this was an easier way to get into the mind of this gullible Force Captain.

And Scorpia was stupid enough for feeling pity for Shadow Weaver.. Imagine that.

" *Yeah.. imagine that.. you truly are devious.* " Entity praised Shadow Weaver. " *Just don't go blabbering about runestones or how to turn them into weapons, that's my job.* "

"So, do you want to know why your plan with tge Black Garnet failed?" Shadow Weaver asked, changing her tone to more mysterious.

"Well.. yes, because I'm not the smart one." Scorpia answered.

"It's because runestones can't be tinkered with and they surely won't work together well with tech."

"I don't know... Darkith did something to the Black Garnet and I'm pretty sure Entrapta could succeed with it, if given enough time."

"Scorpia.. what Darkith did to Black Garnet was because of her dark magic. Some things are better juts left untouched and things we don't fully understand, are better left untinkered." Shadow Weaver explained. She knew the reasons she made were totally made up, but her warning was sincere.

"Uhh.. so what would you suggest then?" Scorpia asked.

Shadow Weaver went silent, she was now thinking of an answer. Why would Scorpia ask her? Shouldn't she know that I could just make things up and screw her over? "I'd just say.. let the Black Garnet be. If it failed last time, it will fail again."

"Well, Hordak himself thought that using the Black Garnet was a failure." Scorpia said. "Entrapta disagrees though.."

"Then may I see this.. Entrapta?" Shadow Weaver asked with her most friendliest tone she could make. "I've heard a lot about her, but never met."

Scorpia thought for a minute, until she answered. "I guess, I could make it happen.. but how would I get her to come here? All she thinks about is tech."

"Tell her that I have information that would satisfy her and maybe even help her understand these things better." Shadow Weaver said.

"Ooh, that makes sense. Wait here, I'll go get her.. Scorpia said with an enthusiastic voice.

"Not that I can move that much anyways." Shadow Weaver answered and let out a dry chuckle.

"Oh.. right.." Scorpia said and awkwardly rubbed the back of head. "Anyways... I'll be going."

Shadow Weaver nodded and was once again alone.

" *I swear if you are going to tell them more about the first ones and all that stuff you said.. I might ditch you!* " Entity said.

"Oh don't worry.. I'm not going to reveal anything important, more like I'm trying to convince Entrapta to stop meddling with things." Shadow Weaver assured.

" *In that case... I guess it's okay..* " Entity said and sighed. " *Why did I get you.. out of every single being in existence.. it had to be you..* "

"I love you too." Shadow Weaver answered and chuckled.

Meanwhile the princesses were fighting the horde of bots in the withered Whispering Woods. Since the forest hasn't recovered yet, it was an easy access point for Horde bots.

"Perfuma! Three coming from the left!" Bow yelled and shot two bots behind him.

"On it!" Perfuma answered and tied the bots with her vines and crushed them.

Catra jumped from tree branch to tree branch and used her agility to her advantage. She jumped on one of the bots and struck her staff through the weak point.

Frosta made ice spikes that pierced through the bots and Mermista used the river to her advantage, she could bring waves that would either wash away the bots or damage their components.

Adora swung her sword and cut legs from two of the bots and pierced them with her sword. "You figured how to use your staff, Catra?!"

Catra pierced through one of the bots. "Not yet.. unless you count melee as its use... Agh!" She smacked another bot.

"You know, this doesn't seem to help." Catra said and evaded two other bots. "You destroy one, five more come out of nowhere!"

"This has to be something Scratch would do." Adora said and sliced through another bot.

"Of course she would..." Catra sighed. "We are going to need a better strategy."

"Let's just finish these bots first." Glimmer said. "We'll have to discuss our strategy at the war room, not in the middle of a fight."

"You guys notice the bots have some sort of camera as their eye." Bow said as he shot one of the bots.

"Yeah.. it seems they have." Catra stated as she stood on the bot and inspected the eye. "Hello, there." She said smirking and waved her hand.

"Catra, now is not the time to joke around!" Adora yelled.

"I know.." Catra answered and pierced her staff through the bot's eye. "You think they are watching us?"

"That would be such a Scratch move.." Adora half joked and struck her sword through the bots eye.

"I know right." Catra said. "You know.. I think we have almost finished all of them for now.."

"Ugh.. finally.. I'm getting tired." Mermista groaned.

All the bots at the Whispering Woods were destroyed and it seemed there would not be more bots in a while.

"Alright, we should head back to Brightmoon." Glimmer said. "We need a better plan and we need to check the situation with the rest of the Etheria."

The princesses were leaving and Catra was the only one who was still there. She looked at the last bot that was in a working condition and proceeded to take once more a closer look of the eye.

"If you are there.. Scratch.. watching.. I'm going to rip you apart one day.." She said with a threatening tone.

Catra, you coming?" Adora asked.

"Yeah.. I'm coming." Catra answered and pierced the bot's eye, completely destroying it.

The Princess Alliances, suspicions were right, they were being watched through the bots.

"Ahh shucks.. there goes the last one!" Entrapta yelped as the last of the screens went dark.

"Doesn't matter.. we'll just send more." Scratch stated. "Also.. where is Scorpia?"

"She went to interrogate that witch of yours." Entrapta answered.

"Of course she would.. lets just hope she got something out from her.." Scratch said. "If I had anything to say, I'd send both Darkith and Shadow Weaver to Beast Island.. since those two hate each other.. can you imagine the carnage it would cause?"

"I just build bots and I'm only interested in tech." Entrapta answered and looked at Scratch who had a devilish smile on her face. "You just thought about something messed up.. did you?"

"Hey.. you're the one who tinkered with the Black Garnet." Scratch said.

"That was only in the name of science." Entrapta defended.

Then Scorpia walked in and interrupted Scratch’s and Entraptas' argument. "Shadow Weaver wants to meet Entrapta." She said.

"What?!" Scratch exclaimed. "Why would she want to meet Entrapta and how does she know about her?"

"That's beside the point, she told me that she would like to speak with Entrapta." Scorpia said. "She told me that she could help you understand the runestones and their magical properties better."

"Oooh, that sounds interesting. I want to meet her!" Entrapta exclaimed with excitement.

"Hey! Isn't this a bit suspicious?" Scratch reasoned. "She never wanted to tell me anything and now she would be willing to talk to Entrapta!?"

"Maybe it's because of your methods." Scorpia suggested, with disappointment in her tone.

"Are you saying I'm not good interrogator?" Scratch asked, challenging Scorpia's view.

"Do you really think torture is best method to aquire information?!" Scorpia said with an angry tone, which was weird. She was usually chill and maybe too extroverted, but she never

really was angry. "I just showed her basic decency and it worked like a miracle."

"So you are suggesting using kindness towards her, of all the people?!" Scratch said. "She slaughtered half of our troops and you suggest kindness towards her!?"

"She had her reasons, we are the ones who took something that was important to her." Scorpia said, protesting Scratch's opinions.

"You mean that bratty cat?!" Scratch snapped. "You are too soft! As a second in command, I'll forbid you to speak with our prisoner! Until further notice.. From now on, I'm the only one that can speak to her!"

"But, I promised her-" Scorpia was cut off by Scratch before she could finish her sentence. "Promised!? You made a promise with our prisoner!? What kind of interrogator makes deals with a prisoner?"

Scorpia was silent for a moment, she didn't have anything she could have said to calm Scratch. She looked defeated and sad.

Scratch sighed in deep. "Okay.. listen.. this is only temporary, you will have your chance to interrogate her later." She said with a calm tone, trying to ease Scorpia's pain. "I can allow Entrapta to talk to her, for this time only. Are we clear, Force Captain Scorpia?"

Scorpia's mood had brightened a little bit and she nodded. "But if you talk with her, please don't go overboard."

"Augh.. okay.. I won't.." Scratch said. "Anyways, I still have more plans to do, so please do show Entrapta the way. But only she can talk to her, okay?"

"Of course." Scorpia said and saluted.

"Good." Scratch said and left the room.

Scorpia asked Entrapta to come with her and she complied. But deep down Scorpia thought what Scratch had said, was she in the wrong to show kindness or was Scratch in the wrong?

At Btightmoon, all the princesses had gathered inside the war room and their meeting was being held by Queen Angella herself. "Alright, Swift Wind what has your report gathered from the south?"

Swift Wind opened the map of Etheria and answered. "Horde has gained more territory, but with help of Spinnerella and Netossa we have successfully captured Thaymore.. again."

"Goid work, now-" Angella was cut off by Swift Wind. "How come I don't get a chair, but others have?"

"Agh.. umm.. yes the chair, I'll look into it later." Angella answered. "Glimmer, how's your progress at Whispering Woods?"

"I'm hapoy to announce that we have successfully repelled the enemy forces, while the forest is healing.. very slowly.." Glimmer answered.

"Your Highness, may I speak?" Catra said and raised her hand.

"Yes." Angella answered and nodded her head.

"Thank you." Catra said and stood up. "So, our tactics are lackluster. Meanwhile all of our princesses are fighting at Whispering Woods, nothing is stopping the Horde elsewhere."

"Catra is right." Bow said. "We can keep destroying these bots, but they just send more. But I have an idea. If we could capture one of the bots, I could try to design a kill switch so we could take them all out at once."

"That is excellent idea." Angella said. "Commander Glimmer, you will take your squad on this mission and capture one of the bots."

"Of course, mother." Glimmer answered.

As they were preparing to leave, Catra stated that she wouldn't come this time. "I think I'll pass this time."

"Why?" Adora asked.

"I want to understand about the theoretical magic, at least a little bit." Catra answered. "Since Castaspella is here now, it would be a lot easier. Besides, I'm sure you will be fine."

"If you say so." Adora said. "We'll meet later then."

"Yes, you don't have to worry." Catra assured.

Meanwhile in the dungeons of Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver sat on the prison bed. Waiting if Scorpia would actually do it and get Entrapta there with her.

When she least expected, the cell door opened and Entrapta came in. Shadow Weaver has a faint smile on her face and sighed. " *She actually did it..* "

"Hi, I'm Entrapta and I heard you have knowledge about First Ones?" Entrapta greeted with excitement.

"Yes, I have. I've studied First Ones for a long time." Shadow Weaver said.

"Oooh, tell me everything! I've been trying to combine First Ones tech with mine and with the Horde's." Entrapta exclaimed.

"I heard something like that myself as well." Shadow Weaver said. "First, I wanna warn you that some things are better not to be messed with."

"But that's where the excitement comes from, science is all about experimenting things and seeing what will happen!"

"As wonderful as that sounds.. I wish I had never messed with those things..." Shadow Weaver sighed.

"What do you mean?" Entrapta asked.

"You see my face, right?"

"Yes.. and I can feel it as well." Entrapta said as her hairs touched Shadow Weaver's face.

"Hey! Get your.. hair.. off from me." Shadow Weaver said.

"Sorry.. I just wondered.. are those painful?"

"Like a burning fire under your skin, like walking on a thousand knives and worst of all.. you can't do anything to stop it..." Shadow Weaver explained with an anguished voice. She tried to make it look like it was really painful.

" *Don't make stuff up..* " Entity told her.

"I didn't, that's just how it feels!" Shadow Weaver argued back.

"Uhh what?" Entrapta asked. It seemed like Shadow Weaver was talking to someone else. "I didn't say anything tho..."

Shadow Weaver noticed this. "Agh, Don't worry about it. When you have messed yourself as badly as I am.. you start to hear voices.."

"I want to investigate more.." Entrapta said. "You seem to have a lot of properties that I don't understand and I'd like to know more.. But that's besides the point. Now tell me about the First Ones."

"Agh.. shucks.. you know.. I had lots of books at my home, which was in the Whispering Woods." Shadow Weaver tried to plat dumb. She knew very well that Entrapta was more versed about First Ones tech than herself.

"Well I wouldn't count on Whispering Woods anymore." Entrapta said.

"What do you mean?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Well.. we kind of destroyed it when we combined Black Garnet with First Ones tech." Entrapta answered.

" *So that's what all that rumble was all about.* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself. "Then I have a suggestion for you."

"And what is that?"

"Let me go and I will lead you to ancient First Ones town.. I can promise you will find lots of useful things from there.." Shadow Weaver tried to appeal to Entrapta's need to know more.

But she knew this would be futile, no one would actually be that dumb to let her free. But at this point Shadow Weaver didn't care anymore. She was still starving, her pains grew every day and she was clearly losing her mind.

There was no coming back from this, what is most likely to happen is that she will either be killed or something worse.

"I can't make such decisions and Scratch would never agree." Entrapta said.

"Ehh.. I knew that.. at this moment I don't.. re..really think.. that.. I..I can be of.. use." Shadow Weaver tried to get even one clear sentence out of her mouth.

Her vision started to blurr, her senses were numbing and after that she fainted. Falling on the cell floor. Complete darkness surrounded her and her nothingness.

Entrapta saw this and didn't know what to do, so she called Scorpia in. "Ehh Scorpia.. the prisoner just blacked out.."

Scorpia came in and saw Shadow Weaver laying on the floor. "Oh no.. what do we do?" Scorpia panicked.

"I think I have an idea." Scratch said and entered as well.

"Scratch, what are you doing here?" Scorpia asked.

"I just came to check in.. and it seems our prisoner has blacked out." Scratch said and smiled.

"So, what do we do with her?" Entrapta asked.

"Leave everything for me, Entrapta you will continue your engineering with bots and Scorpia.. you are just dismissed. I'll have things to discuss with you." Scratch explained.

Entrapta and Scorpia nodded and left the cell, leaving Scratch alone with Shadow Weaver.

She walked next to her and crouched down. She let out a sinister laugh. "Oh.. we will have some fun.. heh..heh."

Chapter End Notes

This chapter is 1/2 of what I had planned earlier, but I think it's better to leave it here. I don't want to make these chapters so over long.

Of Beatrix and Star Bender

Chapter Summary

In this chapter, we'll go into the past of Shadow Weaver and Darkith. Before Shadow Weaver, there was Light Spinner and before her, was a child named Beatrix.

And before Darkith, there was a Star Bender who was greatest sorcerer on Etheria.

Entrapta has developed new series of bots, using First Ones tech as an core. There is one problem, she couldn't make too many of them.

Chapter Notes

Prepare for pain, Shadow Weaver has gone through a lot of pain. Even before she baecame the sorceress known as Light Spinner, she was a slave at the Crimson Waste's, young girl named Beatrix.

Darkith on the other hand... well lets just say she had everything going for her.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

_____Flashback_____

Before the sorceress known as Light Spinner, before the dark witch known as Shadow Weaver. There was a child slave, named Beatrix.

Beatrix wasn't older than 10 and she was forced to work in the crystal mines at Crimson Waste. She was forced there when her home was attacked by the Horde.

Her father died during Horde's attack and only she and her mother survived, only to end up into slave labor at the Crimson Waste.

As the years passed and the work became heavier, her mother fell ill and couldn't work anymore. So Beatrix who now was 16, had to do extra work to get enough food for her and her mother.

But the rations weren't much and her mother starved to death. One morning Beatrix came into the tent with rations.

"Mother, I got a lot of rations this time." She exclaimed as she rushed to her mother. "Even if it cost my dignity.

Her mother wasn't answering, nor did she move. "Mother?" Beatrix asked with a worrying tone.

She tried to wake her up, but she didn't wake up. "Wake up mother.. please, mother.. wake up!"

She leaned in to listen to her pulse only to notice there was none and her mothers skin wasn't warm anymore.

Beatrix kneeled before her now dead mother and she grabbed her hand. Tears started to stream down her cheeks and her loud and desperate cry could be heard from far away.

One of the guards came into the tent to check the situation. He had to make the crying stop.

"She's dead.." The guard said.

"I know.. I know.." Beatrix answered while tears streamed down her cheeks as she watched her mother. "I worked so hard.. but in the end.. it was no use.."

"You still have to work." Guard said.

"I have no reason to work anymore." Beatrix answered. Her crying had stopped, but tears were still streaming down her cheeks. "Only reason I did all that work.. was for my mother."

"You do know what happens to those who refuse to work." Guard said with a threatening tone.

"I do.. but do you think I would care!?" Beatrix seethed and gritted her teeth.

The guard sighed in deep. "It's a shame to kill you.. you were one of the efficient workers we had."

Beatrix was then taken out to be executed, however she had successfully stolen one sharp shard of crystal and hid it in her hair.

She was brought up to the steep cliff and below the cliff was a river. Her back was against sharp spears. She took a deep breath. "Do I get to say my last words?"

Guards looked at each other and then at the captain who was there. Captain nodded his head.

"Last words of Beatrix.. Fuck you!" She yelled and took out the shape crystal from her hair, with a swift swung she sliced the guards throats and jumped off the cliff.

She fell into the river and lost consciousness. Beatrix didn't have any idea how long she was drifting, but when she woke up she found herself stranded on a beach.

"Ugh, my head.." Beatrix said and rubbed her head. Her clothes were soaking wet and she didn't have any clue where she was.

Next few days she kept wandering around Etheria aimlessly. She was starving, having not seen any animals or any vegetation anywhere.

Finally her strength failed her and she collapsed on the ground. She was ready to give up, at least she wouldn't die as an slave.

Beatrix had no idea that if she had continued any further, she would have found salvation.

It seemed that fate had other plans for her. Beatrix was found by the Head-Sorcerer of Mystacor, Norwyn. Either by fate or pure luck.

"Oh my.. what do we have here?" Norwyn wondered as he found the unconscious body of Beatrix. Norwyn made sure that the girl was still alive and as he checked her pulse, he saw a brand on the girl's chest.

It was the slave crest of Crimson Waste and it belonged to the clan led by Tongue Slashor. He was well known for his slave trade and slave labor. He would never let anyone leave, least of them being slaves.

"How did you manage to escape.." Norwyn wondered about himself and carried the girl into his house.

What was Norwyn even doing so far away from Mystacor anyways? Lets just say that fate didn't allow Beatrix to die, just yet.

Next morning Beatrix woke up in an unfamiliar place, it was grandiose. Nothing like her own home and clearly nothing like the tents at the slave encampment.

She stood up to sit on the edge of the bead and looked around. "Where am I?" She thought to herself, then the door into the room opened and an older man came in.

He had a sharp beard and horns that looked like that of a goat. His face was tired, but at the same time friendly.

"Ah, you are already awake." Older man said.

"And.. who are you?" Beatrix asked.

"I'm Norwyn, Head-Sorcerer of Mystacor." He answered.

"Mystacor?" Beatrix asked, she had heard stories about Mystacor from her parents in the past. "You mean the place where all of the Etheria's sorceresses are trained?"

"That's right, I'm surprised you know about it." Norwyn answered.

"I've heard about it from my parents. I used to think that one day I would become one." Beatrix answered.

"You want to be a sorcerer?" Norwyn asked.

"Well.. I used to believe that I would, but now? I don't know anymore.. I'm just a slave." Beatrix said with a sad tone.

"I think there is still a possibility for you to become a sorcerer." Norwyn said with a comforting tone. "What's your name, young lady?"

"Beatrix.." She answered.

"Well, Beatrix you don't have to worry about being a slave anymore."

"What do you mean? I've been branded with the slave crest." Beatrix said and was about to show him the crest, but when she touched her chest she didn't feel the crest anymore.

"What?! It's gone!?"

"I removed it." Norwyn answered. "That crest was very weak, amateurish even.."

"But how.. why?" Beatrix wondered. "Why me? And how?"

"Do you believe in fate?" Norwyn asked.

"My mother used to believe.. I do as well.." Beatrix answered.

"Well, I believe in faith and I think it's because of that, you are now here with me."

"So.. you think I can become a sorcerer?"

"Of course, it's not all about runestones.. it can also be learned, if you believe in it." Norwyn explained. "Everyone in Etheria has a possibility to learn magic."

This changed everything in Beatrix, if she would become the greatest sorcerer. She could fight the Horde and give hope to those who are less lucky.

_____End of Flashback_____

At the Fright Zone, Scratch was looking over the progress of Hordes troops. Even though the princesses were united, they were too busy protecting Brightmoon. Scratch was pleased by the results of the troops. They had gained more ground than ever before.

Scorpia entered into the room where Scratch was, she was little but worried about what Scratch would do to Shadow Weaver.

"So.. you want to know what I did? Scratch asked.

"Well, yes. As a Force Captain, I should know as well." Scorpia answered.

"Alright, I didn't do anything yet.. I'm planning to put her in the same cell as Darkith and see how they will try to tear each other apart." Scratch explained with a smirk on her face.

"But you wouldn't let them out of their chains.. right?"

"Of course not.. just imagine it like this.. they are like dogs on a leash and when they see another dog, they begin to bark towards the other one."

Did Scratch really think they were like animals.. well depending how Shadow Weaver was fed.. that was more like a dog than human.. Scorpia had a nervous look on her face, but tried to fake that those things didn't bother her.

"Anyways, we should go inform Lord Hordak about our progress." Scratch said.

"That would be good idea." Scorpia answered. Relieved that they would talk about something more normal now.

They walked into the Hordak's throne room and showed him their progress. Hordak was pleased about their efforts. "It seems that I made the right call when I promoted you." He said, not seeing Entrapta tinkering behind his throne.

Scratch however noticed this and tried to get Entrapta out of there. "Yes, we have kept the princesses.. distracted.. but we could be doing more. We should take them down while we can, isn't that right Entrapta?"

Entrapta didn't notice anything until Scratch raised her voice. "Entrapta!"

"Huh.. oh right." Entrapta said and clapped her hair as hands, then a new kind of bot came along. It was at least twice the size of the regular one. "May I introduce you to Emily's kid sister.. E.K.S for short. With FIrst One's tech as its core, this bot can even

rival a princess!" Entrapta then took out a blaster and shot through the bot's leg, it soon regenerated its injury.

Hordak walked up to the bot and was impressed. "Impressive indeed and you can make more of these?"

"Well yes.. uhh no.." Entrapta stuttered. "Well I could.. but I had only enough First One's tech to make four."

"But I know where we can get more." Scratch walked in and assured Hordak with a sirk on her face.

Darkith sat in her prison cell, wondering how she had ended up in this situation. She had pursued after power and knowledge so much, it had broken her by this point. She had everything then and she had everything now.. except she didn't. She was now facing a slow and agonizing death. Darkith had calculated that she only had one year at max to live.

Piece of her mask fell on the floor and her index finger cracked and turned to dust, revealing the dark matter that was inside of her. What a fool she was, to enter into a pact with an ancient entity.. even if Norwyn had warned her about the dangers of forgotten and forbidden spells.

Darkith fell into her thoughts and soon found herself reminiscing about her past.

____Flashback____

Before her pact with the ancient entity, she was known as Star Bender. Even if Etheria had no stars, she could create them and bend them to her will.

She truly was one of, if not the strongest of sorcerers in all of Etheria. She was the star pupil of Norwyn and she was a close contender for the next Head-Sorcerer, when Norwyns time was over.

She was also one of the best teachers at Mystacor, even greater than Light Spinner would ever come.

Even if she had all of this knowledge and power, she felt herself restrained and bored. Everyday she was teaching those young sorcerers and they were alway as irritating as usual.

One night she was having a discussion with Norwyn in his office.

"I want more, I feel restricted and bored here." Star Bender explained her frustration. "I know there's more out there and I want to understand it."

"Star Bender, you already have one of the rarest skills. You can create stars and bend them to your will." Norwyn reasoned. You know Etheria has not seen stars in a thousand years."

"I know that, but there has to be more to me than bending imaginary stars." Star Bender argued.

"There are reasons why some things are forgotten in history and passed out all knwoledge, some things are just dangerous." Norwyn explained with a concerned tone.

"But how can we truly know they are dangerous if we don't study them?" Star Bender asked.

"Listen, I only want your best." Norwyn said and sighed.

"No, you only want what's best for you and your image or reputation." Star Bender said and left Norwyns office. Little did they both know that it was the last time they would meet.

That night Star Bender was in her room and she looked at the old maps that led to the now forgotten ruins. Her curiosity perked up, she didn't want to spend the rest of her life at the Mystacor.

So she took the map and headed out, without no one noticing.

She walked for days until she found the ruins in the map. It was an entrance at the mountain, though it was sealed off.

That didn't stop her, she easily broke through the sealed entrance and ventured inside the dark tunnel that would lead her to an ancient temple.

When inside of the temple, she could see something of an altar. It had a small vase on top of it and it was sealed off.

Star Bender took a closer look and examined the markings on the vase. Those old scribbles promised immense knowledge and power, but the end of the scribbles were missing.

That didn't frightened her at all, she foolishly broke the seal and opened the lid and soon dark mist started to flow out of the vase.

The mist took the form of a shadowy and tall person. **"Who dares to summon me? The Spell of Forbidden Knowledge!"** Shadowy figure asked with a deep and hollow voice.

Star Bender was now frightened, she hadn't expected anything like this. She fell on her knees and stared upon the entity.

"Was it you?" Entity asked.

" *Duh.. there's no one else here."* Star Bender thought to herself. "I.. I did."

"You are a curious one, so tell me. What it is, that you desire?" Entity asked now with a more sweet tone. **"Power? Knowledge? Unlimited Power?!"**

This was everything Star Bender was thirsting for. "I desire the power and knowledge of the long forgotten and lost spells."

"Ah, I see, you are a sorcerer of culture as well." Entity answered with a humorous tone. **"Very well, if you want that. You have to form a pact with me."**

"A pact?" Star Bender asked, confused. "Can't you just tell me or share me things without a pact?"

"Child.. who do you think I am? We entities have our pride and dignity. If I would share anything without a pact, all the other entities would lose their minds."

"Wait, there are more of you?"

"Yes.. and one of the most dangerous ones is... Spell of Obtainment.."

"Wait.. but that's a spell right?" Star Bender asked.

"I can't tell you more, unless you are ready to form a pact with me." Entity told her.

Star Bender stood up and asked. "Is it alright if I think about that for a minute?"

"Do take your time.. I have time.." Entity answered.

So if I accept the pact.. I gain everything I want.. but there has to be a catch.. right? "What's the catch?" She asked.

"What do you mean?" Entity asked with a faked surprised tone.

"If I form a pact, I get all I want. But there has to be something you get, nothing comes free." Star Bender said.

"You truly are a clever one." Entity stated. **"Alright, it wouldn't be fair if I didn't tell you about the conditions."**

"Alright then, I'm listening."

"It's rather simple. I give you my powers and knowledge, but you will give me your life force in return." Entity explained. **"If you fail at sustaining me, it means your death."**

Star Bender thought for a minute, so there was a big catch. But it wouldn't be a big thing, she's one of the strongest sorceress in Etheria. This would be an easy task, she would just have to find ways to sustain her more.

"Alright, I accept the pact." She said with a stern and confident voice.

"It's settled then." Entity said, sounding really joyful. ***"Haha.. take that Spell of Obtainment, I said she would come for me. Now you owe me."***

"Oh go fuck yourself then and die! I didn't even want her.. I have more better targets in my mind." Spell of Obtainment answered to the Spell of Forbidden Knowledge.

The Spell of Forbidden Knowledge then swirled around Star Bender and twisted her mind, corrupted her purpose and changed her body forever. But in exchange, she would now have the knowledge and power that no one else had.

"I think you need a new name, I sacrificed your star bending to take its place."

"You what!?" Star Bender yelled. "My signature skill, that no one else possessed!"

"Agh, you get a lot more skills from me. Don't worry, just do as I say and you will be fine. Henceforth, you shall be known as Darkith."

"But that has nothing to do with knowledge!"

"It sounds cool, okay?! Accept it."

_____End Of Flashback_____

"Heh.. what a bunch of lies..." Darkith muttered to herself. She had now woken up from her slumber and once again looked at the empty cell. From the greatest sorceress of Etheria, to traitor, to prisoner in Horde. "What an screw up..."

Then someone entered the cell and it was none other than Scratch. "Hah, you look terrible!" She let out a mocking laugh.

"You would too if you were dying.." Darkith answered sarcastically. "So tell me, has Hordak already seen what kind of a disappointment you are?"

"Ohhohh, quite the opposite." Scratch answered laughing. "He has seen the potential in me and I have proven it. We are now closer

than ever before to take control of the Etheria, something that you failed at!"

"Oh.. how wonderful it must be.." Darkith continued with her sarcastic tone. "You may enjoy your position for now, but remember that Hordak will cast you aside.. most likely he already has a new favorite."

"You know nothing!" Scratch said and grabbed Darkith from her collar, only for her to fall on the ground as the collar she was holding turned to dust. "What the!?"

"Thank you.. you took about two weeks away from my life..." Darkith let out a dry laugh.

"I'm not here to play with your stupid mind games, I actually came here to bring you a something special." Scratch said.

"Oh, a gift? For me?" Darkith asked with a sarcastic tone. "Not sure if I would want anything from you though."

"Argh! How can you be so immature right now!" Scratch yelled.

"Dying tends to make you a bit strange." Darkith answered.

"Anyways, before I go to lead Horde to victory." She said and whistled. Then another person was being brought in, her head was hooded and she had ragged clothes on her. She was mumbling something, most likely cursing. "I'll leave you two at it."

The other person was then chained to the opposite side of Darkith and they took the bag out her head. It was Shadow Weaver, shock on both of their faces was unbelievable.

Have fun you two, I bet you have a lot to share while you rot here." Scratch said with a smirk on her face and left Darkith alone with Shadow Weaver.

"You!..." Shadow Weaver said with a threatening tone.

"You..." Darkith answered with a depressed look on her face.
"Please.. let it end already!"

Chapter End Notes

"Hey, it's me. Spell of Obtainment here. If you wondered how we could talk to each others, its because we are linked together in a pocket dimension. From there we observe the universe and bet on the best candidates to summon us."

~Hey, didn't I already tell you to keep in the story!~

"Ugh, I'm just giving useful information, something that you yourself are too lazy to deliver."

~That hurt.. like really.. that hurt.~

Of Darkith and Shadow Weaver.

Chapter Summary

> What happens when you put two petty and powerhungry women with pent up feelings, in the same cell?
>
> And the princesses defend the crystal castle.. I guess.

Chapter Notes

> "Your chapter synopsis sounds like a bad p0#n plot."
>
> ~Yeah... Worst of all... I kind of agree with you... Hey! How do you know about that!?~
>
> "I've seen your "homework" files and your browser history... you truly are a hopeless SW simp..."
>
> ~Thats it, I'm going to delete you from the story!"~

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Shadow Weaver and Darkith stared at each other for a while, it was agonizing for Darkith. Shadow Weaver's sharp look felt like she was piercing you physically. Shadow Weaver's stare was full of hatred and pain, meanwhile Darkith's stare was mostly filled with desperation and depression.

But Darkith decided to break the ice the most Darkith way she could. "Hah, seems that Horde life hasn't treated you well."

"I swear, if I wasn't bound by these anti-magic chains, I would rip you apart!" Shadow Weaver threatened with a venomous tone.

"Hah, then its a good thing that Horde has actually taken measures against you." Darkith laughed and coughed painfully. Then once again a small part of the attire crumbled and turned to dust.

Shadow Weaver noticed and smirked. "And Horde life hasn't treated you well, I assume."

"You have no idea.." Darkith answered apathetically.

" *Shadow Weaver..do you want to know a fun fact?* " Entity asked.
" *She had an entity in herself as well, we actually bid who she's going to summon.* "

"Oh really now? Not only do you ruin lives, you even bet on whose life you're going to ruin." Shadow Weaver stated.

"Uhhh.. what?" Darkith asked as she saw Shadow Weaver talking to someone. "Who are you talking to?"

"That's not your business, now is it?!" Shadow Weaver snapped. She was tired and all the stress and pain had eaten her mentality.

They both fell silent once again and just sat there for hours. Scratch had observed them from the control room and was disappointed that Darkith and Shadow Weaver weren't on each other's throats.

She sighed in deep and decided to leave the prison, instead she was going to observe their new bots attack on crystal castle.

Darkith and Shadow Weaver sat in the cell room, not knowing what to do. Then Shadow Weaver decided to break their silence. "How long are we going to just sit here and stare at each other.. or walls?" She asked with a dry tone.

"Till both of us die.." Darkith stated apathetically. "I hate Scratch so much.. of all the things she could have done, she brought you here.."

"Hey, you should be grateful to be in my presence, not many have survived from that." Shadow Weaver bragged proudly, even if it was meant to be a dry joke.

"Hah, to be grateful for an old hag like you.." Darkith said and rolled her eyes. "Shouldn't you be.. like dead, or something?"

"Oh I wish.. I'm well past my prime.." Shadow Weaver answered and let out a dry laugh.

"Heh.. Thought so.. you look like a walking corpse." Darkith said and chuckled.

"I'll take that as a compliment."

"You know.. I wasn't always like this.." Darkith said, suddenly changing her tone to more serious. "I was once a great sorcerer at Mystacor.."

Shadow Weaver was surprised by this fact, Darkith was from Mystacor? "You know.. I used to be at Mystacor as well in my past."

"Really?" Darkith asked. "Was Norwyn still the Head-Sorcerer when you were there?"

"You know Norwyn?"

"Of course I do, he was my mentor.." Darkith answered.

"Funny.. he was my mentor as well.." Shadow Weaver said. "So we both share the same past of being at Mystacor and then ending up in a situation like this."

"You got screwed over by an entity as well?" Darkith asked, raising her eyebrow.

"Yeah, how else would I have gained these powers." Shadow Weaver said and sighed in deep. "I guess your pact with the entity is over?"

"More like I couldn't keep up my own end of the pact, Scratch took that possibility away from me." Darkith said and sighed deeply.

Shadow Weaver was thinking, would she face the same fate as Darkith. " *Hey, Entity.. will I end up like her?* "

" *No, you wont.. I wont let that happen.. You are way too entertaining to let you go.* "

"Guessed so.. don't know if I should be thankful or not." Shadow Weaver said. "Hey Darkith, if you had one word to describe me or you.. what would it be?"

"What?" Darkith asked. "If I'd have to describe you.. you would be a bitch."

"Fair, fair and I would describe you as a petty bitch." Shadow Weaver said with a smirk.

"No.. I would be an apathetic bitch." Darkith corrected.

Both of them shared a laugh, it seemed that having such a similar fates and both probably dying made them less antagonistic towards each other.

"Never thought I would share a laugh with someone like you.." Shadow Weaver said.

"I guess.. you aren't that bad for an rotting corpse and miserable excuse of an life." Darkith joked.

"I'd say you are more of a corpse than I am.." Shadow Weaver countered.

"At least I dont smell like a wet rag that's been swam in sewer water." Darkith insulted.

"Hah, you smell like a rat that's been dipped in acid.." Shadow Weaver said.

Both of them continued their laughing, it was almost like a friendly laugh between friends, but something still was off. It had a sinister feel to it.

One of the guards that was guarding the cell felt shivers in his spine. The aura and presence around their cell was that of an malevolence.

At the Whispering Woods, the princesses had gathered in a group and Glimmer was spreading them into different groups, to work a pair and to catch a bot. "Alright, let's split up as a group so we can cover more areas." Glimmer said. "Me, Adora and Bow will move to North, Mermista and Perfurma.. you'll go to South. Catra and Frosta.. you will watch over the crystal castle."

"Alright, seems like an easy task." Catra said and stretched her arms.

"Remember, we want to capture them so don't break them." Bow said and gave a concerning look towards Catra.

"What? What did I do?" Catra asked.

"Nothing, just a general reminder to everyone." Bow said.

"Come on Catra, let's go smash some bot's!" Frosta said, excited and punched her fists together.

Catra let out a sigh. "Did you not listen to what we were just told?"

"Oh yeah.. Guess so." Frosta said and sighed in disappointment.

When they spread up, Adora, Glimmer and Bow faced the new type of bot. It wasn't like the earlier ones, but it was still just a Horde bot. How hard it would really be.

Adora transformed into She-Ra and began to fight the new bot. With her brute strength she was sure it was enough to take it out.

Bow cringed as she watched She-Ra beat the bot. "We wanted to capture it, not destroy it!"

"Oh.. sorry.. I think it's still salvageable." She-Ra said, but didn't know that the bot had healed itself up and was ready to fight again.

"What!? It can still move?"

The bot began to send a loud noise, like a siren of sorts and then three more of its kind came to the place. This was getting out of hand, now there are four of them. Adora, Glimmer and Bow were trapped in the corner, but to their surprise the bots scanned something and after that they left them there.

"Weird.. they weren't after us?" Glimmer asked.

"It seems it was not their primary goal..." Bow said. "We should gather the other princesses."

"Yeah, you're right." Glimmer said.

After they had gathered everyone around, they were asking if others had seen more bots. But all of the other princesses said they hadn't seen any.

"Then it must mean there are only those four.. and their target wasn't us." Glimmer said.

"It seemed that they headed in the same direction and the direction they were going was..." Adora paused for a moment. "The crystal castle."

"Now that you said it... isn't there a whole lot of First Ones tech?" Catra asked.

"Oh no... they want to get the tech for something.. but for what?" Adora pondered.

"We know they aren't going to use it for anything good.." Catra stated.

"Yeah.. whatever it is.. we must stop it and work as a team, together." Glimmer said.

"Sounds good." Mermista said.

"Agreed." Perfuma added.

"I just want to go and punch them!" Frosta said with excitement.

The princesses then went after the bots and they decided to ambush them. They knew where the bots were going, so they just had to get there first. Meanwhile, Scratch, Scorpia and Entrapta were monitoring the situation through the screens connected to the bot's eyes. "There it is, the crystal castle." Scratch said. "That place holds so much First Ones tech that we could power up a whole armada of your bots."

"Ahhhh.. I want that!" Entrapta said with a glimmer in her eyes and excitement in her voice.

Their excitement soon turned to fear as they saw that something was attacking the bots. Catra jumped on one of the bots and looked into the eye. "Hello there!" And then struck her staff through it, disabling the bot.

"Doesn't look good, that bot ain't going to recover from that." Scorpia said.

"Aughh.. I dont wanna see." Entrapta said and covered her face with her eyes. "Tell me what happens... or no... don't tell, I don't wanna know!"

"It's that damn furball again!" Scratch yelled.

Meanwhile Bow shot three arrows and pierced at least one of the bots. "Remember, we need only one. Destroy the others." He said and moved the spot.

Frosta froze one of the bots in its place and Mermista directed water straight into it, making it blow up.

At the same time Scratch kicked a trash can, she was mad that the plan was failing."Don't worry we have two more left." Scorpia tried to calm her.

She-Ra turned her sword into a lasso and tied the one of the robots, then Catra jumped onto it and stroked her staff through the eye. "Ohhh yeah... we got this!" Catra said and pulled her staff. "This thing is like a spear."

"Great, we got it." She-Ra said, but she didn't know that Scratch had pressed the self destruction button. The bot started to let out a beeping noise.

"Get out of there, it's going to blow!" Bow yelled.

Adora and Catra both evaded quickly as the bot blew up.

"That's so something Scratch would suggest.." Catra murmured.

There was only one bot left and it was also about to self-destruct. "We can't let that get destroyed, we have to stop it!" Bow yelled.

"Alright everyone, together!" Glimmer yelled and blasted it with magic while She-Ra just punched it against the castle wall. Bow was about to lose his hairs, this was so stressful.

"Hehe.. sorry." Adora said and rubbed the back of her head.

"You ready, Ice Princess?" Mermista asked Frosta.

"Yehe yeah!" She let out in excitement.

Mermista shot water towards the bot and Frosta then froze it so it couldn't move. Perfuma came in and tied the huge ice spice to make sure the bot wouldn't get away, while also lifting Bow up there with one of her vines. Bow successfully managed to switch the self destruct off by taking the motherboard out from it.

"Hahaa, I got it!" Bow yelled with excitement. The other princesses cheered as well and when they did, they all started to glow with the colors of their elements. Restoring the withered Whispering Woods back to its former glory.

"Look, the Whispering Woods. It's mending." Catra said. They all turned to look as the forest was now as it used to be.

"Woow.. did we do that?" Frosta asked.

Perfuma said with a gleeful tone. "Yes, we did it. By working all together."

Back at the prison cell in the Fright Zone. Shadow Weaver and Darkith sat in silence. Neither of them had any energy left to have a petty bitching competition.

Then came lunch time.. well not really. Different guards came by and dropped the tray on the floor. All Darkith and Shadow Weaver

got was those same ahsen ration bars.

None of the guards dared to get too close to either of them. They both had an aura of malevolence, without their powers they still radiated the darkness that dwelled inside of them.

When the guards had left, Shadow Weaver and Darkith started at the food tray.

"Agh.. You know.. I can't eat because my hands are bound behind my back." Shadow Weaver said.

"Mine's not." Darkith answered with a smug grin on her face.

"Hpmh, it just means they fear me more than you." Shadow Weaver said.

"Well, you kinda destroyed the place and killed hundreds.. if not even in thousands.. of people." Darkith said and pulled the tray next to her. She took one of the ration bars and ate it whole. "Mmmm delicious.. this time it tastes like coal, mixed with ash."

Shadow Weaver watched as Darkith ate the ration bars. "Would you at least spare me one?"

"Oh.. you want this?" Darkith asked, smirking.

"Just throw it here." Shadow Weaver demanded.

"As you wish." Darkith threw the bar at Shadow Weaver and she catched it with her mouth.

"Nice catch.." Darkith muttered.

Shadow Weaver ate the ration bar whole and with one swallow.

"How did you just swallow it with one go?" Darkith asked, surprised.

"Desperate times require desperate means." Shadow Weaver answered.

" *You are filling me with that trash again..* " Entity murmured. " *Do you know how much I hate that goo... mush... something that is clearly unnatural..* "

" *Just grow a backbone and suck it, you are an unnatural entity.. it shouldn't be a problem!* " Shadow Weaver said in her mind.

After they had eaten all of the rations, they once again sat in silence. They didn't have anything to discuss, until Darkiht broke the silence once more. "You know.. I never expected you to be like this."

"What do you mean?" Shadow Weaver asked, raising her eyebrow.

"I mean.. after all I've done.. you aren't tearing me apart, nor are you yelling insults." Darkith answered.

"Are you trying to play some mind games? Because I'm not playing those. You should just consider yourself lucky that my hand are bound behind my back." Shadow Weaver said and let out a deep sigh.

"I'm not trying to play mind games.. I'm just wondering how you are so.. well.. chill. We are sworn enemies after all." Darkith said.

"Well let's just say that being starved, tortured and living with an entity that has made your life literal hell.." Shadow Weaver paused. "I don't think I have much of anything left in myself, there is only one thing that matters for me."

"And that thing is?" Darkith inquired.

Shadow Weaver rolled her eyes, she didn't want to answer her. Darkith knew exactly well who Shadow Weaver meant, but she finally gave in. "Her name is Catra and she is the only reason why I'm still here."

"I see.. you know.. Scratch had a huge grudge on her." Darkith said.

"I know that.. shame I didn't have a chance to make her suffer while I could." Shadow Weaver said with a tired tone. "If you excuse me.. I'm going to sleep.. not that it's going to help much, but I have to clear my mind."

"Sure.. go ahead.. I'll just start making annoying noises to make your prison life even more miserable." Darkith said and grinned.

"Do as you please..." Shadow Weaver said with a tired tone, she couldn't care less what Darkith did. " *As I thought.. she's so petty...* "

Several hours had passed and Shadow Weaver woke up from her "sleep", it really wasn't sleeping. More like her going through all her mistakes in her life.

Darkith being Darkith decided to just annoy her. "That didn't look like sleeping at all." Her tone was that of a mocking.

How did she have energy to be a bitch like this? Shadow Weaver didn't know and she didn't really care either. "Well good morning to you as well." She answered.

"Actually, its more like a midnight." Darkith corrected her.

"Ahaa.. doesn't matter..." Shadow Weaver muttered with a tired tone. "Who needs a sense of time anyways..."

"Don't be so sour." Darkith said. "At least you don't have your days numbered."

Shadow Weaver didn't answer, she hoped that if she ignored Darkith she would stop it.

But then Darkith said something that really peaqued Shadow Weaver's interest.

"Do you know what Hordak is actually planning?" Darkith asked with a more serious tone.

"No, I don't." Shadow Weaver answered. "But whatever he plans, it must be about world domination."

"You aren't so wrong about that." Darkith said. "He plans to open a portal, to bring Horde Prime here and the full might of the Horde."

"But this planet has been in a pocket dimension for a thousand year. How is he gonna bring Prime here? No portals should work."

"He succeeded once, he brought a baby through the portal." Darkith explained. "That baby is now what you call She-Ra."

Shadow Weaver was mind blown, she couldn't understand what she had heard.

How could she have not seen this? It was obvious, those markings about an ancient warrior in Catra's home town. She had read many ancient scribbles about the past She-Ra's and she knew this princess Adora was She-Ra, but how did she not connect the dots. Adora was not from this planet, since She-Ra also was not from this planet.

If Hordak succeeded in bringing She-Ra here by accident.. he might even succeed in bringing Prime here as well.

"How do I know you aren't lying?" Shadow Weaver asked, confirming why her enemy would tell her anything.

"Simple.. I don't have anything left to lose. If anything, I'd want to have my revenge on Hordak." Darkith said and smacked her fist on the wall.

" *Okay, now this got serious.* " Entity said to Shadow Weaver. "Remember *that girl Entrapta? She might possess the skills Hordak needs to open a portal. And I don't want Prime here, Etheria is mine to conquer.. not some wanna be god.* "

Shadow Weaver sighed in deep. " *So.. are you willing to actually help me this time?* " She asked the Entity.

" *With every tendril I possess, I can not allow Prime to take what is mine. Besides.. I think I've been plenty of help for you* " Entity said.

"Well *.. at least we have a common goal this time.* " Shadow Weaver said.

"Okay.. so we obviously need to do something about that." Shadow Weaver said to Darkith.

"And how can we do anything? I dont have magic and you are not able to access yours." Darkith said.

"Well.. I have something that can help." Shadow Weaver said, smirking. "Your hands are free, right?"

"As free as these chains allow." Darkith said and shackled the chains.

"I have a piece from the Black Garnet, do you think you can use it?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Seriously? You have a piece of Black Garnet?" Darkith asked, surprised. "Technically.. I could."

Shadow Weaver then shook her head and from her hair dropped a shard of the Black Garnet. "There it is." Shadow Weaver said

"Would you really give me that and would you really trust I would help you, or the princesses?" Darkith asked, giving Shadow Weaver reasons to doubt.

"If not for us, then maybe.. for a chance to get your revenge at Hordak?" Shadow Weaver suggested.

Darkith pondered that for a while, it's true she's dying and she wants to have at least some kikd of payback. "You know what.. that is a good reason.. I'm dying anyway.. so as my last thing I get to swipe that smug grin off from Scratch's face and see Hordak fail..." Darkith said.

"That sounds good enough for me." Shadow Weaver said and picked up the shard with her feets. Then she threw it to Darkith.

"If we wait for a few days, there's going to be a moon's alignment and then the magic is stronger." Darkith said.

"Ah I see, you're a sorceress of culture as well." Shadow Weaver says like she was proud or something.

"I'm not sure what you mean.. but okay." Darkith answered.

" *Do you think this was a good idea?* " Entity asked Shadow Weaver. " *There's no guarantee she will come back.* "

" *Relax.. if she wont come.. other princesses will.. that's their nature.* " Shadow Weaver said, assuring the Entity.

Chapter End Notes

Scratch made a big oopsie when she put two evil and cunning sorcererss in the same room.

"Yeah, this is big brain time."

~I'd say.. its more of an galaxy brain.~

Of Scratch and Catra

Chapter Summary

In this chapter Scratch learns that being second in command is more than just being in charge, she finds out its full of boring paper work and management. She gets in trouble when she learns that the steel they use in their machines has run out, she has no other choise but to turn for help from the former second in command... Darkith.

Catra decides to go to Mystacor, to meet Castaspella in hopes of learning about theoretical and artificial magic.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

At the Fright Zone, Scratch and Scoripa were going through a lot of papers and it seemed their management and paperwork would never end. How did Darkith manage through all this? Scratch noticed that their armory was running out of the steel they were using.

"What the... Our armory is almost out of steel?!" She yelled.

"Well... we have used a lot of it in our new bot's.. and other new machines." Scorpia stated and went through other papers. "Wow... there's a lot more than just steel that we are running out."

"Argh! This is so stupid!" Scratch yelled and threw the papers against the wall. "I'm so done with this!"

"Scratch... you need help with this... I'm not competent enough for this." Scorpia said.

"I know.. that's the worst part.." Scratch muttered through her teeths. "I would need to ask from **her** .."

"You mean Darkith?" Scorpia asked. "Do you think she would be willing to tell you anything?"

"You were the one who told me to ask for help!" Scratch snapped. "Besides... I can make her talk, if I need to."

" *There we go again...* " Scorpia said to herself and sighed.

"I'll be back.. you can go check whatever Entrapta is doing..." Scratch said and left the room.

She was now heading towards the prison block. It absolutely galled her that she had to go ask for help from Darkith. Scratch walked as slow as she possibly could, the mere thought of seeing Darkith was vexing and the fact that another witch was now there as well. " *Why can't things never be easy..* " She let out a sigh

When she arrived at the Darkith's prison cell, she had to take a moment before she went in. It was so vexing, but she had to do it. She entered into the cell and got Darkith's and Shadow Weaver's attention, they were playing noughts and crosses.

Darkith used her long fingernails, while Shadow Weaver used her long toenails. Since her hands were still bound behind her back.

"What are you two doing?!" Scratch asked with a demanding voice.

Both Darkith and Shadow Weaver turned to look at her with an apathetic look. "Oh.. it's you.." Both of them said.

"I don't get this.. why are you scribbling on the floor!? Why aren't you on each other's throats!?" Scratch yelled.

"You see.. we simply just don't have energy for that.." Shadow Weaver explained.

"Yeah.. and what are you even doing here? Shouldn't you have more important things to do?" Darkith said with a tired tone.

Scratch then remembered what her reason to come there was, she grudgingly said. "Darkith.. Where do we get our steel.. we are running out and I have no idea where to get it."

Darkith and Shadow Weaver both looked at Scratch with a stunned look on their face, does this mean that all great and mighty Scratch needed help from the old witch. Then both of them started to cackle as hard as they could.

"Oh.. Ahahahh.. I can't believe it! You need my help?!" Darkith laughed. "I knew you were a lazy brat, who never did anything else than sleeze off."

"Real fun!" Scratch yelled, losing her temper. She grabbed Darkith from her collar and threatened. "Be serious with me Darkith! Or I'll send you to Beast Island with an express ticket!"

"Does it come with a first class cabin and a buffet?" Darkith asked with a sarcastic tone and a smirk on her face.

"If so, then I'd like to book a ticket to Beast Island as well!" Shadow Weaver added jokingly with her sarcastic tone.

This got Scratch so angry that she threw Darkith against the prison wall. She then approached Shadow Weaver and kicked her to the stomach. As she growled on the ground Scratch stomped on her head. "You think you are so funny?! Huh?"

Scratch then kicked Shadow Weaver to her face. "Still feeling like laughing?" Scratch kept stomping her feet on Shadow Weaver's head and grinded her face on the floor. "Still laughing?!"

"Augh.. Okay!.. I- I'll shut my mouth.." Shadow Weaver said with clear pain in her voice.

Scratch sighed and turned back to Darkith. "Now.. then.. where do we get our steel?" Scratch asked.

"You would know that already, if you had listened or paid attention during the Force Captain orientations and not sleazing off like a useless brat you are." Darkith said and coughed.

"Listen, I don't care! You can insult me all you want, but I need that information!" Scratch said with a threatening tone.

"Agh.. fine.. they mine the steel here in the Fright Zone, but the mines are a bit farther away at east." Darkith explained while still coughing. "You can't miss those mines."

"Was it so hard to tell me that?" Scratch asked.

"If you were half of what you claim you are.. I wouldn't have to tell you anything." Darkith said and took a deep breath. "Is that all?"

"At least for now, I hope that next time you will be more co-operative." Scratch said and walked away, leaving Darkith and Shadow Weaver there.

Meanwhile at Brightmoon, Bow had made a shocking discovery when he had opened up the Horde bot. He had found it was using First Ones tech at its powersource and it meant also that Entrapta was alive.

This hit them hard because they thought she was dead, but now it was clear that she was alive and seemed to work for the Horde.

Catra herself had been thinking about theoretical and artificial magic for a while. While her staff worked as a spear quite well, it was still a far cry from what it could be.

She remembered that Castaspella herself was quite skilled in magic, even if she didn't get that much credit for it. She had even promised to help as much as she could. So Catra thought that maybe she should go to her.

Catra detested the idea of going to Mystacor, mostly because of what Shadow Weaver had told her. But since she's not here to help or teach, Catra has no other choice.

"Adora." She said.

"Yeah, what's the matter?"

"I've been thinking to go to Mystacor.." Catra said. "I don't understand anything about this artificial or theoretical magic and since Shadow Weaver is not here.. my best choice is to ask from Castaspella."

"I understand.. I wish I understood all these things about being She-Ra and what she's capable of..." Adora said and sighed.

"Hey.. I'm sure you'll get it soon." Catra said and put her hand on Adora's shoulder. "I mean, you have a personal mentor from the First Ones.. what else could be better."

"That's just it.. she never tells me anything.. I mean.. she gives answers, but never celebrates that much. It's like, there's the solution, but there's not how to get to that solution." Adora ranted.

"I feel you, but maybe there are other ways to learn as well." Catra said.

"Like what?" Adora asked.

"Etheria is full of ruined First Ones cities. You can maybe find something from those places. I mean Shadow Weaver had studied and searched for these kind of places for answers and I think she would also find a way to grt answers from that hologram of yours." Catra explained.

"I have never thought about that." Adora said.

"Well.. after all you should do what you deem best, as I'm doing now what I deem best."

Now that Scratch had her answers, she could keep proving to Hordak that she was ultimately the better second in command.

After successfully acquiring the steels and making sure no one slacked off at the steel facilities, she once again returned to her office and went through paperwork.

It was so damn boring.. complaints from different Force Captains.. inventarions, stocktakings.. logistics. All these things had to go through the second in command and be approved by her. "Does Hordak do anything?!" Scratch yelled as she went through all of the different lists.

Scratch was still mad that their plan to seize the First Ones tech went down the drain, she thought that maybe if she did it alone she would succeed. She's clearly the most competent in the Horde, but she still had to do all these boring tasks. She wanted so badly to go and hunt for the First Ones tech, but couldn't because there was no one in Horde who was capable enough for

these kinds of tasks and giving it up to Scorpia would probably end in a catastrophe.

Once again she remembered that there was one who was capable.. Darkith..

She hated the fact that she needed Darkiths help now more than ever before. She wanted to prove to her she was superior, but now... she needed to prove Hordak she was worthy of second in command. "Ugh! If I go to talk with Darkith again.. it will just stroke her ego!"

Scratch had no other choice, she didn't have that much of an understanding about these things. She was used to doing physical things, fighting and beating shit out of others.

Grudgingly and against her own will, she once again went to meet Darkith and she knew that both Darkith and Shadow Weaver would just shit on her for her inability to handle things.

It was late evening and she finally entered the prison block. She took a deep breath and stepped inside of their cell.

This time she saw that Darkith had scribbled random markings on the wall, while Shadow Weaver was laying on her back and staring at the ceiling. Clearly both of them were ignoring her. " *They dare to just ignore me!? The audacity of these witches!* "

"Ehem!" Scrarch cleared her throat, announcing her presence. But no reaction came from either of them. "I demand your attention!"

Darkith turned to look at her with apathy written all over her face and Shadow Weaver just raised her head a bit.

This lackluster of reactions she got was annoying. Did they think they were above her?

"Stop pretending like you are superior!"

"But I am superior." Darkith stated. "If I wasn't, you wouldn't be here."

"That has nothing to do with me being here! Actually, I didn't even need to come here at all!"

"But you did." Darkith said. "I guess being me isn't that easy, glamorous or great.. after all."

"I mean.. I would have never even dreamt about being like you." Shadow Weaver stated.

"Shut up." Datkith said.

"No one asked your opinion." Scratch added.

Shadow Weaver let out a chuckle. Even if they said they hated each other.. they were still so much alike. It was amusing to her.

"So, there must be a reason why you would come here." Darkith said.

"No... I just came here to mock you!" Scratch huffed.

"We both know that's not true." Darkith said.

"Argh, forget it!" Scratch yelled and stormed out of the cell.

Darkith was right, she didn't like being her. She didn't like at all for that stupid paperwork and worst of all, she just cant admit that she herself was wrong.

In the late evening, Catra arrived at Mystacor. Castaspella was waiting for her, since she had announced her visit beforehand.

"Ahh, it's nice to see you." Castaspella greeted. "It has been a while since your last visit."

"Yeah.. not really a fan of Mystacor." Catra said.

"I bet Shadow Weaver has told you a lot of things about Mystacor."

"Yes and they aren't compliments.." Catra said.

"I know very well why she would say those things. I myself have investigated the past of Mystacor and found a lot of shady things." Castaspella explained. "Many of these things were swept under a rug by Norwyn.. he was a good guy.. but he didn't have much of a spine."

"Ah.. I see.. Well, I'm not here because of that." Catra answered. "I came here because.. well you should know of it by now."

"I do and I promise you that I will help you as much as I can." Castaspella said. "But anyways.. I have prepared a meal, please let's enjoy it."

The next morning, Catra was up earlier than usual. Castaspella had promised to meet her at the library.

Catra was waiting at the entrance of the library for Castaspella to arrive.

Soon she was greeted by her. "Up so early? And I thought I was the early bird."

"Heh.. not as early a bird as Shadow Weaver.." Catra let out a small chuckle, but it quickly faded away.

"Well, let's not waste anymore time." Castaspella said and unlocked the library doors. Catra followed her in and was quite amazed by the size of the library.

"So, you wanted to know about artificial magic. Is that right?" Castaspella asked, confirming.

"Yes.. I tried to read them, but couldn't understand." Catra said and took one of the Shadow Weaver's books from her backpack.

"Interesting.. we don't have many here at all." Castaspella said. "May I?" She extended her hands towards Catra.

"Sure, if you think you get something out of those scribbles." Catra answered and handed the book to Castaspella.

Castaspella went through the book and examined the pages. It was clearly written by Shadow Weaver. The cryptic way she used to write to mess with the minds of the young sorcerers and the handwriting was definitely hers.

All those books she had written and all those studies had the same handwriting. " *I guess she kept studying.. even after her exile..* " Castaspella thought as she went through the pages.

"Well, did you get anything out of it?" Catra asked. "It's one of the few items left from her."

Castaspella noted that. "Well it's definitely written by her." Castaspella said and handed the book back. "I take it's dear memory of her and holds great value for you."

"Yes.. after the battle of Brightmoon.. I've been thinking a lot about her." Catra said with a sad tone.

"I get it.. I have as well." Castaspella said and put hand on Catra's shoulder. "But I think we should start investigating further.. to see what that staff of yours can do."

"So, can you teach me about artificial magic?" Catra asked with a hopeful look on her face.

"Of course, I have even learned to decrypt Shadow Weaver's writings.. such a person she was.." Castaspella said with a faint smile.

"Castaspella.. do you think there would be something we could do for her.. she's not dead.." Catra said.

"I don't know.. but I'm sure she has a backup plan, she always had those." Castaspella said.

Chapter End Notes

This was a shorter chapter once again. Well I have 2 more chapters already in mind, so more is soon to come.

Exploration and Artificial Magic

Chapter Summary

> Adora thought about Catra's words and decided to explore the ruins of the First Ones, to find out more about the past and maybe more about herself.
>
> Catra starts studying/learning artificial magic with the help of Castaspella.
>
> Entrapta gains favor from Hordak, much to Scratch's displeasure.

Chapter Notes

> I have no idea what Im doing with this artificial magic thing.. I didn't actually think I would progress this far... so the artificial magic will be like: "Random Bullshit Go!"

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At Mystacor, Catra was finally starting to understand the mechanics of the artificial magic. You could even say it's more like a tech than magic. It basically needs an energy source that needs to be charged and through that energy source you can convert said energy to something similar to magic.

"Okay.. so I need something to power it up.." Catra thought. "Castaspella, do you have any ideas what could be possible for an energy source?"

"Closest thing I can think of would be some sort of runestone.. but it would be too risky to use some of the existing ones." Castaspella said.

Then Catra remembered Shadow Weaver's mask, it had a crystal or something akin to that. "Wait.. I have something." Catra said to Castaspella and picked Shadow Weaver's mask from her bag.

"See, it has a crystal." Catra said as she showed the mask.

"How did I never thought about that?" Castaspella asked. "That actually is a runestone of sorts.. tho not the same as the princesses."

"So, will it be a good source?" Catra asked.

"Let me see." Castaspella answered and reached her hands towards the mask. "May I?"

"Sure, but give the mask back." Catra answered and handed the mask.

Castaspella took the crystal off from the mask and placed it on the table. "Can I have the staff as well?"

Catra nodded and handed her the staff as well. Castaspella proceeded to go through the books pages, there was nothing helpful. She then examined the staff closer and found a way to disassemble it.

Catra looked at her with a puzzled look on her face as Castaspella disassembled the staff. "What are you doing?"

"Honestly.. I have no slightest idea.." Castaspella said. " *Oh Shadow Weaver.. why did you have to make everything so cryptic..* "

Castaspella noticed that there was a place for crystal or something that could have been used for powersource. "Well, I think I got this now."

"Really?" Catra asked.

"Yes.. so don't worry and let aunt Casta take care of everything." She then proceeded to assemble the staff back together. Now that the runestone was placed in its place it should work.

Artificial magic could also maybe mean that it will artificially channel the runestone, not needing a princess or connection to one. Maybe artificial magic was actual magic, but it was channeled artificially.. doesn't that defeat the purpose of artificial? Or maybe Castaspella had just interpreted it wrong.

"Here you go." Castaspella said and gave the mask and the staff back to Catra. "I may have misinterpreted the artificial part of the magic..."

"Why doesn't that surprise me?" Catra said.

"Ouch." Castaspella said and put her hand over her chest. "That's mean."

"So... what is your interpretation now?"

"I think the artificial part is just how it will channel the energy or magic. Like.. the runestone in your staff doesn't work normally, but through the artificial means inside the staff it can channel the magic.."

"You like.. lost me at the artificial part.." Catra said.

"Okay, I'll try one more time." Castaspella said and sighed. "So the runestone in your staff wouldn't work normally, but Shadow Weaver since had designed the staff to artificially channel the power of said runestone or powersource. It actually works and you can use the staff to cast magic."

"Does it mean I can cast protection shields or shoot beams from it?" Catra asked with an excited tone.

"I guess so, we just need to research more about it. It seems Shadow Weaver's never finished her research on this matter." Castaspella said.

"Well then, we should probably try to finish her research then." Catra said.

At Fright Zone, Scratch was back at her office and Scorpia once again came in while holding more files. "There's more files.."

"Of course there is! I bet Darkith purposely left things unmanaged, she probably knew Hordak didn't do anything!" Scratch snapped. "Where's Entrapta by the way?"

"Uhhh... I'm not sure.." Scorpia said with a nervous tone.

"Weren't you supposed to keep an eye on her?"

"Uhh.. I'll.. I'll go do it.. right now.." Scorpia stuttered.

"Agh, it's too late now. We need to find her, before she gets herself or us killed." Scratch said and left with Scorpia, to look for Entrapta.

Entrapta herself had tinkered in Hordaks chambers and even got caught by him. First Hordak was furious at this intrusion, but quickly forgave it when he noticed that Entrapta actually had improved his machine.

"She was right..." Hordak thought to himself and was cut by Entrapta.

"Of course I was right. What are you doing? Something that needs this much energy, must be something like... teleportation.. are you planning on building a teleport?" Entrapta talked like and it seemed she had no intention to stop talking.

"If you build a teleport, it would be a huge advance, we could move troops easily from-" She was cut by Hordak. "You think too small, but it's understandable that a backwater planet like this would have no idea or comprehension about galaxies.."

"Wait.. are you saying.. there's more planets out there?" Entrapta asked, her eyes sparkling like stars.

"There's thousands of those.. Etheria is just a small part of the universe.." Hordak said.

Meanwhile at Brightmoon, Adora had been thinking of Catra's words. Maybe she should try to seek answers elsewhere.

"Bow, Glimmer.. I've been thinking that we should try to seek answers from elsewhere." Adora said.

"Oh.. isn't Light Hope enough?" Glimmer asked.

"I rarely get anything helpful from her.. Catra said to me to try and look from elsewhere."

"Well.. I think you're lucky." Bow answered. "You see, my tracker has been tracking a strange signal and it's coming from Whispering Woods.

"Bow, that's amazing. We should get moving right now." Adora exclaimed.

"Adora.. we shoul-" Bow was interrupted by Adora. "Hey Swift Wind, can you take us to Whispering Woods?!"

"Or.. nevermind.." Bow muttered.

~Off we go!~

Bow, Glimmer and Adora were now riding on Swift Wind above the Whispering Woods, following the signal on Bow's tracker.

They looked for a decent spot to land and continue on foot. Walking through the thick and lush forest they made their way towards the spot.

As they got closer, Swift Wind insisted that he heard an unnerving noise in his head. Others said they didn't hear anything.

Before they knew, the sky was darkened by the clouds and cold wind hallowed through the woods.

"Don't you think this is kinda scary?" Glimmer asked, his voice trembling. "The sudden change in weather and the howling wind? Isn't this unnatural?"

"It is weird, sure, but nothing too out of the ordinary. This is Whispering Woods after all." Bow said. He was looking at the tracker and the signal waa getting stronger, but also something was disturbing his tracker. "Agh.. the tracker is jamming."

"See? This is something unnatural.. and didn't Shadow Weaver use to live here? I heard her presence brought a dark aura and malevolence into this forest." Glimmer said.

"Well she's nothing but dark magic.." Bow stated.

"Hey Bow, how far are we?" Adora asked.

"Hard to say.. tracker isn't working properly." Bow answered.

"Well I hear a signal in my head and it's getting stronger." Swift Wind said. "It's so unpleasant!"

Glimmer was looking behind her and could see a white, but transparent figure standing at the side of the tree. "Guys! There's something behind us!" She yelled.

"Glimmer there's nothing-" Adora was about to say, but then she herself saw something go past through her.

This creeped her and sent shivers down her spine. "Okay.. maybe there's something here..."

Catra and Castaspella were still going through the books about artificial magic, but it didn't lead anywhere.

Castaspella then suggested that they would try theoretical magic.

"What's theoretical magic" Catra asked. "I think I've heard of it, but that's pretty much all."

"Well.. it's basically magic that theoretically works, but it hasn't been tried properly or it doesn't have proper base on anything." Castaspella answered. "Some say it's just fools magic and not real magic at all."

"But if it hasn't been tried, how do they know if it's real magic or not?" Catra asked.

"It doesn't have a foundation, you can have an idea.. but that's nothing concrete." Castaspella said.

"Then how is it supposed to help in my case?"

"Your magic is artificial, so I'm sure theoretical magic would be a great fit for it. Since you can't properly learn to cast magic, but there might be something about combining it with theoretical magic." Castaspella explained.

"Well, do you think it will work and if it does.. then how?"

"We simply have to try. Maybe that crystal inside of your staff can create concrete magic from theoretical magic... artificially that is."

"Ahh, I think I get it... well then, there's no time to lose." Catra said with a smirk on her face. " *If I learn how to cast magic.. I will make sure Scratch is the first one to taste it..* "

Meanwhile at the Fright Zone, Scratch and Scorpia arrived at Hordak's chambers.

"Lord Hordak, I'm sorry that Entrapta has caused you problems. I promise I won't let it happen aga-" She was cut off by Hordak's statement. "You are the one causing problems by your constant intrusions!"

"But Lord Hordak!"

"No buts! You let the Whispering Woods grow back, so your plans failed and that's it." Hordak said. "Besides, Entrapta is now working as my assistant so leave us be! Or face the consequences."

Scratch gritted her teeth and snarled. "Fine, Lord Hordak.."

She and Scorpia then left the Hordaks chambers. What a waste of time that was.

When they had reached her office, Scratch basically started to ripp her hair. "Damn that Hordak, who does he think he is?! He's so insufferable!" She then kicked the trash can and threw all the files on her desk at the wall.

"Woah, easy there! I think you are still the best second in command we ever had, you at least mean a lot to me." Scorpia said.

"I don't need your pity. If you excuse me, I have to go and vent my steams." Scratch snapped and left Scorpia alone in her office.

Scorpia let out a disappointed sigh, how could Scratch be so blind?

It was no surprise where Scratch was headed, she was going to the prison area. Twice at the same day, something was wrong.

Scratch approached the cell where Shadow Weaver and Darkith were held.

Darkith could hear steps coming her way and she had an easy guess who it was. "Ahh.. back so soon? I didn't know you missed me this much."

"Shut up! I didn't come here because I missed you." Scratch snapped. "I came here to blow off steam!"

"What, are you going to beat me this time instead of Shadow Weaver?" Darkith asked.

"No, I don't think I'm going to beat anyone." Scratch said. "I'm just frustrated that nothing I do pleases Hordak."

"Hah, you finally got it!" Darkith let out a laugh. "I can see you are losing favor in Hordak's eyes, just like I lost."

"We are not the same! I, unlike you, am doing more than ever." Scratch yelled. "It's just that Entrapta knows about the tech."

Then Shadow Weaver decided to open her mouth. "But you see, there comes the problem. You can convince yourself to feel important, but in the end it's useless. He won't care."

"What do you mean? Just because she knows about tech, doesn't mean she's better than me." Scratch said.

"Have you ever actually thought about Hordak's grand plan?" Shadow Weaver asked. "What if he doesn't need a brat like you who only speaks with fists, but needs someone who actually is intelligent."

"You wanna lose your ear or maybe your left eye?!" Scratch threatened.

"Case in point." Shadow Weaver stated and laid back on the prison floor.

"It doesn't matter Scratch, Hordak will throw you out once he sees no use for you.. that's how he operates." Darkith explained. "You might as well as accept your fate."

"Screw fate! I make my own and I'm not going to play by others rules!" Scratch said.

"Fine by me, but remember this." Darkith said and went a little bit closer to Scratch. "You can't avoid fate nor run away from it. All of our destinies are written in stars.. and it's all going to play out like it's meant to."

"Bunch of bullshit!" Scratch said and left the prison.

"She's so stupid..." Darkith sighed.

"If Entrapta is working with Hordak now.. we have a problem.." Shadow Weaver said.

"Well, tomorrow is the moon's alignment.. so I'd say we aren't in a hurry." Darkith said.

Back at the Whispering Woods, Adora, Glimmer Bow and Swift Wind were hiding behind a bush. They were so scared of these ghostly figures roaming the nearby area.

And now the signal that only Swift Wind could hear, was now so strong that others could hear it as well.

"I don't like this at all! Why did we have to come here?!" Glimmer squeaked.

"Just calm down, if Catra was here she would be kicking their asses head first and no questions asked." Adora said.

"Or maybe.. they aren't ghosts." Bow suggested. "If you look closer.. it seems like they have set paths.. or moves. They are repeating the same things over and over again."

"You mean they are holograms?" Glimmer asked.

"Or records from the people who used to live here." Bow answered.

"Well let's take a closer look." Adora said and raised her sword, just in case.

Adora and Bow went first and Glimmer still stayed at the bush. "I'll wait here."

Bow approached one of the ghostly figures and soon noticed it was a record of the past. It was on a repeat and it was waving. "As I guessed, they are just recordings."

"Hey Glimmer! Its safe to come, they are just recordings." Adora said, confirming what Bos had said.

Glimmer stepped out from the bush, slowly removing her hands covering the eyes. "Now that I look at it..." She looked at the waving hologram. "Nevermind, still creepy."

They continued their way and soon found a ruined town in the middle of the woods. There were lots of holograms repeating the past over and over again. From adults to children to elder people.

As they walked through the ruined town and past all the recordings, it suddenly had a really eerie feeling to it.

"To think these are the First Ones.." Adora wondered. "I thought they were mighty and epic.. but they are just like regular people."

"What's even sadder is that, by now they all are probably dead." Bow said.

"That doesn't help at all." Glimmer said.

"I'd guess in a sense they are ghosts of the past.." Adora added.

"Just stop! Okay?!" Glimmer yelled.

"Look, there's a tower similar to one at the crystal castle." Adora said and pointed towards the center of the town.

"It must be something like a beacon.. broadcasting their memories or events to the First Ones. Not knowing they never reached their destiny." Bow said with a sad frown on his face.

Adora looked at the record of a small girl dancing near the signal obelisk. "All because of what Mara did..." Adora said with a sad tone.

"Bur if no one has lived here for a thousand year.. Why are they broadcasting this now." Glimmer asked.

"It might have turned on when the Black Garnet was activated, I have no other theories.." Bow said and examined the obelisk. "I think that as She-Ra you can deactivate it.. there is no use having these on repeat when there's no one to receive them."

Adora sighed in deep and turned into She-Ra, she walked at the obelisk and put her hand over the First Ones writings. "May you all rest now... be at peace."

She then deactivated the obelisk broadcasting these past memories and events. The dancing girl near the obelisk was the last one to disappear.

Then Bow's tracker began to work again, but now it didn't show anything else than bunch dots and lines, connecting to each other. "Guys.. take a look." He said and both Glimmer and Adora came to look at it.

"What do you think it is?" Glimmer asked.

"I don't know.." Bow answered.

"It must be just broken and you need to fix it." Adora suggested. "The signal from the beacon may have messed up your tracker."

"Yeah... that must be it..." Bow muttered.

As they left the ruined town of the First Ones, Adora was disappointed that she didn't learn anything about herself. What she got instead was a fascinating insight about these mysterious First Ones.

Meanwhile, somewhere far away at the Crimson Wastes. Something lit up in a ship crashed on the sand dunes, abandoned there for hundreds of years.. What could that mean?

Chapter End Notes

> Well this was an all around chapter and was almost harder to write than the stuff at the Princess Prom part... I hope this chapter made at least a little bit sense at somewhere.

Moon's Alignment

Chapter Summary

It's finally the time, moons align. Then magic runs stronger through Etheria and Darkith makes her escape at Brightmoon. While Shadow Weaver takes the full blow of the consequenses.

Catra and Castaspella tries to find different methods to actuallt get the staff working properly.

Scratch probably grows more grey hairs than Shadow Weaver.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It's almost midnight and the moon's alignment is at hand. Darkith was drawing on the prison floor with the shard from the black garnet. It was a small sigil compared to normal teleportation spells. She had to leave a small part of the shard for herself to activate the magic.

Darkith had finished the teleportation sigil and was now standing in the middle of it. "Finally, the payback is on hand." She said.

"Well good luck convincing them, you aren't really that wanted there." Shadow Weaver said.

"And you would be?" Darkith asked.

"Well.. I have at least more credit than you." Shadow Weaver answered, smirking.

"Whatever.. I have nothing to lose anyway, I hope they will at least listen a bit." Darkith said and activated the spell.

Moon's alignment amplified the magic all around Etheria and since Darkith used to have a connection to Black Garnet through similar shards, she could harness the power of the Black Garnet. Even if it was only momentarily.

Now that Darkith was gone, Shadow Weaver was left alone in the prison cell.

" *Do you think that was wise?* " Entity asked. " *Now I can't do much to help you, since you are still locked off from your magic.* "

"There's really never been much hope for me.. hasn't there?" Shadow Weaver asked rhetorically.

" *Well.. it depends.. what do you count as hope?* " Entity asked.

"It was a rhetorical question.. and to hear you talk about hope. You who always enjoy others' hopelessness." Shadow Weaver said and let out a chuckle.

" *Being around you has seemingly made me soft.. I was just trying to be considerate..* " Entity muttered.

Moments later Darkith arrived at the outskirts of Brightmoon, it was a lot better than arriving straight into the castle. Even if the moon's alignment had amplified her magic, it felt like it had taken a great toll on her life force. " *I have to hurry if I want to have my revenge while I'm still alive..* "

She started walking towards the gates, her arms up in the air.

at the gate, two guards noticed a strange figure walking towards them. They raised their spears and one of the guards said; "Who are you and what are you doing here?!"

"I am Darkith!" She yelled. "I'm unarmed and I have my hands up in the air!"

"State your business!" Other guard said.

"I'm surrendering!" Darkith said as she walked closer. "I have a need to speak with the queen."

But before the guards could question further, Darkith fell on the ground and lost consciousness.

"Quickly, inform the queen about the situation. She knows what to do!"

Meanwhile at Mystacor, Catra and Castaspella were looking for a way to cast spells from the staff.

Castaspella had an idea to try to scan some spells, however.. how exactly would they do it?

Catra on the other hand remembered that since Shadow Weaver had used the said crystal that now was integrated into the staff. Maybe it already had some sort of spell in its memory.

"Do you think that due the connection this crystal had with Shadow Weaver, it would already have some spells already registered inside of it." Catra suggested.

"I've never heard about anything like that before." Castaspella said.

"Well.. if I'm not mistaken.. Shadow Weaver didn't make that mask herself.." Catra said, trying to remember more of what Shadow Weaver had told her.

"Are you suggesting this mask was made by a third party?" Castaspella asked.

"Ah, now I remember!" Catra exclaimed. "The mask was made by the Entity and it probably also integrated the crystal into it as well."

"The Entity? What do you mean?" Castaspella asked with a puzzled look on her face.

"Wait.. she's never told you?" Catra asked.

"No.. she's not.." Castaspella answered.

"Well.. she's exactly never told me either.. rather I have sensed something inside of her. And it usually emerged when she was distressed or angry." Catra explained. "I know it has something to do with the spell she tried in the past."

"The Spell of Obtainment? Is that what you mean?"

"Well.. I guess.. I haven't studied the spells or anything like that." Catra answered.

Castaspella realized what was going on. How could she be so blind. Spell of Obtainment was not just a parasite leeching off the magic and life force. It was an entity.. an actual sentient entity and really dangerous one. " *Has she lived all this time with the Entity like that inside of her..* "

It was known that the Entities would corrupt and slowly kill their host in exchange for great power. " *But how was she still so.. human.. after all those years..* "

Castaspella didn't know how Shadow Weaver was still so human, maybe it really showed that deep down Shadow Weaver was a good person and strong willed.. or also.. Catra had something to do with it also.

"Helloo? Castaspella? Anybody home?" Catra said and waved her hand across Castaspella’s face.

"Uhh Oh, I'm here.." Castaspella said and snapped out from her thoughts. "Say.. when you said you felt something emerge from Shadow Weaver.. how exactly did you get it to go away?"

"Ohh we talking about that Entity?" Catra asked. "Well, it usually went away when I intervened.. either by hugging her or asking her attention.. it usually went away soon after that."

"Interesting." Castaspella said. " *So it also was partly because of Catra..* "

"So.. about the crystal?" Catra asked.

"We should be cautious.. the crystal might have lingering effects from its connection to the Spell of Obtainment." Castaspella answered.

"Well that was just a suggestion. Do you have other ideas?"

"I'm not saying we shouldn't try to test your theory.. just saying we should be careful."

Castaspella once more took the crystal off from the staff, for closer inspection.

After a while, Castaspella had come to a conclusion that it would be safe to try. She didn't find anything unnatural or any deviations.

She installed the crystal back and gave the staff to Catra. "I've concluded that it's safe.."

"Great, now I just would need to remember those spells she used.. she never really chanted her spells.. So how exactly would I use those?"

"Then it seems we are back in square one." Castaspella said. "We might try to scan some spells into the crystal."

"What? Like you would scan with a computer?" Catra asked, puzzled. "Isn't this magic and not tech?"

"Thats artificial magic.. and that is a lot closer to a tech than it would seem.. it's kinda funny how those two things go in hand to hand." Castaspella answered.

"Only Entrapta could do that.. she could combine magic and tech.. but she's not here.." Catra said.

"Well I can try as well.. I just have to think it more from the magical point of view." Castaspella said. When she was about to start her experiments, she was cut by her crystal ball that was vibrating.

"Oh.. someone is trying to contact me. Wait a sec Catra." She said and went to see who was contacting her.

To her surprise it was Angella, she never really kept in touch or anything like that. "Never expected to see you making contact." Castaspella answered with an insincere tone.

" *Well this is really important. Darkith, the former right hand of Hordak, is here.* "

"Alright, I'll be there soon." Castaspella said. This changed everything, Darkith was the one responsible for Micah's death and the reason why Angella always used to blame Shadow Weaver for that.

"Catra, we need to go to Brightmoon." Castaspella said. She looked like she was fuming with the heat of a thousand flames, let's hope she doesn't burn herself.

At Brightmoon, Darkith slowly opened her eyes and looked around. She saw a fancy room around her, all around her were fancy furniture and even a fountain. Was this their prison?

She tried to move, but was blocked by an invisible wall. She soon noticed that she had been locked up in a prison field. " *Well at least they aren't stupid.."*

Then the large double doors opened and three figures walked in. She could easily recognize all of them. "Ahh, Queen Angella. It's been a long time." Darkith said with a flattery tone. "And how could I forget Micah's fiery little sister.. and.. Catra?"

"Silence! You don't speak unless asked to!" Angella said with a commanding tone.

"And you will pay for your crimes against Mystacor, Micah and Adora and all the people your betrayal has hurt!" Castaspella added.

"I couldn't care less." Darkith said. "Whatever punishments you come up with, it won't matter. I've already got the worst punishment possible."

"And that is?" Angella asked.

"Slow and painful death.. as you can see, my body is crumbling to pieces and I will only be a pile of ash." Darkith said with a grim tone.

"You're lying!" Castaspella said. "You only want to gain sympathy, but it wont work!"

"Argh, you people are unbearable! I can see why Shadow Weaver didn't want to have anything to do with you!" Darkith snapped.

"You dare to bring her into this conversation?!" Angella asked.

"You've talked with Shadow Weaver?" Catra asked.

"Of course, we shared the same prison cell. She actually helped me escape.. So it's thanks to her that I'm here."

"Lies! She wouldn't help you! She hated you for what you did to Micah and what it led to!" Castaspella said furiously.

"Oh, but she did." Darkith said and smirked, she noticed the shocked look on Castaspella and Catra's face. "She truly is an mystery."

"So, assuming you aren't here to do Hordak's bidding.. then what was your purpose?" Angella asked.

Darkith let out a tired sigh. "I have vital information about the Horde.. I was second in command after all."

Castaspella readied her hands to draw a truth spell, to make sure Darkith wouldn't lie. "I'll cast a truth spell, to make sure you wont lie."

"Whatever to calm your tits.." Darkith joked.

"Don't make light of this, I'm dead serious!" Castaspella huffed and casted the truth spell.

Darkith flinched and for a moment showed genuine fear. It was known that if the truth spell was cast wrong, it could cause tremendous amounts of pain. Luckily for her, Castaspella didn't make any mistakes.

"So, let me ask Darkith. What do you want from us?" Angella said.

"As I said, I have a vital information about the Horde. Scratch stabbed me back, Hordak cast me aside... so I want to have revenge.. as petty as it sounds.." Darkith explained and under effect of the truth spell, she wasn't lying.

"Petty revenge, huh?" Castaspella said. "What about Shadow Weaver.. what can you say about her?"

"Castaspella, are you really-" But Angella was cut off by Castaspella. "Sush, I want to know and I'm sure Catra would as well."

Catra only nodded, she didn't want to butt in. She knew how to read the room and didn't want anything necessary to happen.

"So you want to know about Shadow Weaver.." Darkith answered. "What can I say.. she gets beaten up.. alot.. she is smug and clearly doesn't care for her own health.. and sometimes she talks to someone.. or maybe to herself.. I don't know what more to tell you.."

All three of them seemed to be shocked, well Angella wasn't that much. But Castaspella and Catra were.

Catra knew that Shadow Weaver sometimes had moments where she showed little regard to her own life.. the most recent example being when she rescued her from the Fright Zone.

Castaspella herself just felt bad, Shadow Weaver was pretty much disliked everywhere, she was branded as a wanted criminal and she lived so long just by herself.

"How did you escape.. and she did not?" Castaspella asked, with a mild undertone of anger in her voice.

"Simple, she gave me a shard of Black Garnet.. don't ask me how she got that.. and now that the moons are aligned, it enhanced my magic. "Darkith explained. "But with the cost of my life force.. Does that satisfy you?"

Castaspella let out a deep sigh, Darkith wasn't lying. If only it had been Shadow Weaver who would have escaped.

"Alright then, what is the information.. that would help us bring the Horde down?" Angella asked.

"That is.. why I would also want to speak with Adora- " Darkith was quickly cut both Angella and Castaspella. "Absolutely not! You have caused too much already to that poor girl!"

"But its something she needs to know, Adora is the key to everything and she's been held in the dark way too long.." Darkith said with a sincere tone, which was rare.

"Let us discuss it." Angella said and sighed deeply.

Both Angella and Castaspella left the room, while Catra stayed to keep an eye on Darkith.

She sat at the opposite side of Darkith and both of them looked at each other.

Back at the Fright Zone, Scratch was doing her best to please Hordak. She had organized military operations and search parties to get as much of First Ones tech as possible. Hordak's and Entrapta's demands were still ludacris.

Scratch found herself once again sitting in her office, rubbing her head and pulling her hair.

"Why is nothing good enough!?" She yelled and threw a stool at the wall.

She needed someone to vent, Scorpia was a good option but Scratch feld she wouldn't be the right person to listen to her.

Scratch knew that both Darkith and Shadow Weaver were locked in a prison and she could go there, but those two were the most perilous duo she had ever sat her eyes upon.

But she still decided to go there, maybe deep down she still wanted Darkith to recognise her genius and acknowledge her as something to be proud of.

As she arrived at the prison cell, she could easily see many things wrong in there. First, only Shadow Weaver remained in the cell and second, there was a magic sigil drawn on the floor and it looked like it had been used.

"Excuse me, but what the hell is going on here!?" She demanded an answer as she walked inside.

She only got an underwhelming nudge from Shadow Weaver. It appeared that she was trying to sleep. "Ugh.. you're early.." She said with a tired tone.

Scratch had no time for Shadow Weaver's smug and snappy games. She grabbed Shadow Weaver from her collar and forcefully raised her from the ground. "Where the hell has Darkith gone!?"

"Oh, her.. she's been gone a while.." Shadow Weaver answered. "It appears that maybe it was her that you should have taken the counter measures against."

"What are you implying?"

"Putting me and Darkith in the same cell was a really smart move." Shadow Weaver quipped with sarcasm.

"You did something! What did you do!?" Scratch demanded and smacked Shadow Weaver's face. Then she forced her on the ground once again. "One last time, what did you do?"

"Ugh.. Never start with the head.. the victim gets all fuzzy- Argh!" Shadow Weaver was cut off by a stomp on her back. "Ugh.. I

guess that works.."

"Stop with your stupid word plays and tell me, What. Did. You. Do?"

"Fine.. nothing much.. just gave her a shard of Black Garnet and rest she knew what to do. Darkith is a sorcerer as well, you know." Shadow Weaver explained.

"How did you get your hands on the Black Garnet while being locked away!?" Scratch asked.

"Let's just say that you have a really shitty security system here." Shadow Weaver said while smirking.

"Ugh, that's it! You're going to the Beast Island!" Scratch yelled. She struck Shadow Weaver unconscious and called in a few guards.

"Send her to Beast Island." Scratch ordered.

Then the guards proceeded to drag Shadow Weaver out from the cell and ready her to be sent on the Beast Island.

Scratch was now looking at the empty cell. She felt like a volcano that was about to erupt and then it struck her. How is she going to explain all this to Hordak?

Chapter End Notes

gets to use the staff as it was intended to be used.

Im going to go through all the seasons in this story. I'm way too unimaginative to come up with a new name for a story.

So, what do you think about this story so far? Any theories on how it is going to continue? Or do you have any suggestions

on how you would like to go?

Anyways, see you at the next chapter.. whenever it comes...

Revelations And Beast Island

Chapter Summary

Darkith tells everyone about Hordak's grand plan and also reveals a shocking truth about Adora and her origins.

Shadow Weaver wakes up at Beast Island and has to run/fight for her life.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

At Brightmoon both Angella and Castaspella had come to an conclusion that Adora could see Darkith, since Adora herself was very curious about why Darkith had come to Brightmoon of all places. Though they had their reservations about Darkith's motivations, would she really have come here to help them? After all what she's done.

"It takes them pretty long..." Darkith muttered.

"Well obviously, they can't just decide things like that on a whim." Catra said.

"But they had no problem leaving you with me.."

"Because I don't have any sort of connection to you.. other than that you are enemy of Shadow Weaver.. which makes you my enemy as well." Catra explained.

"But I'm also the enemy of the Rebellion.. isn't that reason to be enemies as well?" Darkith asked.

"Listen.. I don't know what you are trying to do, but whatever it is. It's not going to work." Catra said.

Then Angella and Castaspella came back in. "Alright Darkith, we will allow you to see Adora, but on one condition." Angella said.

"And that is?" Darkith asked and tilted her head.

"We will be here, so you can't try anything." Castaspella answered.

"That goes without saying.." Darkith said.

"Alright then, I'll go inform Glimmer that it's safe to bring Adora here." Angella said. As she was turning away, Glimmer and Adora teleported right in the middle of the room.

"Oh.. everyone's here..." Adora said as she looked at the others.

"I think we are in trouble.." Glimmer said.

"Not really." Angella answered. "Tho Im disheartened that you would work behind my back, it's not the issue now."

"We agreed that it is safe for you to meet Darkith, she's still under the effect of the truth spell. So there's nothing to worry about." Castaspella said.

Everyone turned to look at Darkith, expecting her to start speaking.

"Oh, so now I'm allowed to speak?" Darkith asked.

"Adora is here as you wanted, so you better start telling everything." Catra said.

"Alright, I'll tell you everything." Darkith said. "Hordak is building a portal that could tear through the fabric of the universe and bring the rest of Horde armies here."

"WHAT!?" Everyone yelled.

"There's more of the Horde?" Angella asked.

"Come on.. I haven't even properly started." Darkith said. "Anyways.. he's building a portal and it's almost complete. You've had trouble keeping Hordak's arimes at bay. You have no chance when he brings the full might of the Horde."

"That's impossible! Portals don't work here.." Castaspella said.

"No.. it is quite possible. That girl... Entrapta has been helping Hordak for a while.. she's the only one who has succeeded combining First Ones technology with the Horde's machines.. he's closer than ever before finishing his plan." Darkith explained. "So we must act quickly, if we want to stop him."

"Why should we believe anything you say!" Glimmer said. "You are obviously lying, that's what you do!"

"I'm under the effect of a truth spell.. I can't lie and I gain nothing from it." Darkith said with an offended tone. "Besides I'm dying slowly and I want to do everything I can to get revenge on Hordak, coming here was the best chance of doing that."

"So if you are not lying.. Do you have any proof to support your claims about Adora?" Catra asked.

"The proof.. stands right here among us." Darkith said and then pointed at Adora. "Adora is not from Etheria, she comes from the wider universe."

"No.. that can't be.. it's impossible!" Adora said.

"Search your feelings, you know it to be true." Darkith said. "Hordak successfully opened a portal a long time ago and from there came a child.. that child was you, Adora.."

"Don't listen to her Adora." Glimmer said. "She's just lying."

"I know how it sounds, but Adora is different from us. She holds power, stronger than any Etherian could ever imagine." Darkith

said. "I kept you in the dark too long.."

"She's just trying to get into your head." Bow said.

"No.. that.. that's..." Adora said and ran away tears coming from her eyes. She was shocked about all this and didn't know how to react, her whole world came crumbling down.

"Adora wat!" Glimmer yelled and ran after her with Bow.

That left Darkith in the room with Catra, Angella and Castaspella. All three of them looked at Darkith with cold stares.

"What? I only told the truth.." Darkith retorted while tilting her head.

Shadow Weaver could feel shaking and clanking around her, she opened her eyes and saw that she was not in the Fright Zone prison. She was being transported and whatever it was transporting her, was hell of a bumpy ride.

"Ugh, how long has it been? Where am I?" Shadow Weaver said while rubbing her head.

She saw that her hands weren't bound behind her back anymore, but there was nothing to get excited about. She still had anti-magic cuffs on her wrists. At least she could now use her hands and maybe even physical persuasion.

" *You were gone for quite a while.* " Spell of Obtainment said. " *And you are being transported to Beast Island.* "

"Oh great, Scratch actually did it.." Shadow Weaver sighed, with a tired look on her face.

" *Don't be so sour.. Beast Island could be a great place, it used to be the dumping ground of the First Ones.. now it's the dumping ground of the Horde.* " Entity explained, hoping to brighten Shadow Weaver's mood. Why did the Entity care about her mood, it didn't have an answer for it. Maybe Shadow Weaver's influence truly is contagious.

"Well maybe there lies endless possibilities for power.. something I would need.." Shadow Weaver said, but her mood wasn't any brighter.

Spell of Obtainment found this vexing, if Shadow Weaver was only moping.. it wouldn't be the same. For some reason the Entity had grown fond of their petty bickering and arguing. Something truly was wrong with the Entity.

" *Come on, what's the matter? You are usually full of that sassy bitchiness, smugness and all that. Where's your spunk?* " Entity asked.

Shadow Weaver let out a small chuckle, she found it quite funny that the Spell of Obtainment was showing concern towards her. "What's the sudden change? You usually wanted to control my body and wanted me to kill people.. what changed?"

" *Because you are part of me and I'm part of you, whether you like it or not.. and you gave that mask of yours away.. you are literally sabotaging yourself.* " Entity said.

"Oh, now I'm getting lectures about my health from an entity from another dimension.." Shadow Weaver muttered.

Then the transport vehicle made a sudden stop and it threw Shadow Weaver off balance. She laid on the floor and before she

could say anything, the floor opened. She didn't know that she was on a trapdoor.

She fell hard on the ground, in the middle of this new hostile environment. Shadow Weaver was on her knees and looked around. All around here were thick forests embedded with strange vines and everywhere she looked, she could see trash, and tech of all sorts. Some of the tech was from the Horde and most of the tech seemed to belong to the First Ones.

"So this is Beast Island.." Shadow Weaver stated and stood up. "Wonder why they call it Beast Island.. it should be Waste Island.."

Then she could hear a roaring and obscure noise deep from the forest. "Yeah.. I get it now..."

" *Well don't just stand like a mushroom, move!* " Entity told her.

"Yeah, yeah..." Shadow Weaver answered and as she was about to take a step forward, she got a feeling something was watching her. "There's something behind me.. isn't there?"

She took a slow turn and looked behind her. She could see a tall creature that looked like a plant. It looked kinda adorable.. Shadow Weaver liked plants.

But then it opened its petals and revealed a maw with rows of sharp teeths and tentacle-like vines started to form from its body. It let out an howling roar.

"Well you are one ugly mother fuc-" Shadow Weaver was cut off by its roar once again and it started to swing its tentacles towards her.

" *What did I tell you! RUN!* " Entity yelled at her.

Shadow Weaver then began to run away and the monster began to chase her. For a plant like creature it was way too fast.

Shadow Weaver ran as fast as she could. Evading branches and swiftly jumping over tall roots and different kinds of obstacles.

She saw a cave ahead of her, it was probably the best place to hide and lose the monster from her tail.

As she hid in the cave and watched as the monster ran past its entrance. She could sigh from relief. But she wasn't out of danger yet, above her dozens of red eyes lit up. Shadow Weaver slowly looked up on the cave ceiling, only to see a lot of spiders coming after her.

"Argh.. Can't I have a rest, even for a moment?" Shadow Weaver said and began to run once again. The spider began their chase and as they entered out from the cave, Shadow Weaver could see they were not normal spiders.

"Ten legs, twelve eyes!? What the hell kind of spiders are you!?" Shadow Weaver screamed and ran even faster.

After a while of running, Shadow Weaver decided to climb up to the trees to get out of the spiders. She jumped into a bush and waited for the spiders to run past her. After they were gone she climbed up to the tree.

Maybe she could map out Beast Island or at least see if there was anything worth noting. Or any safer place.

She was now at the top of the tree and looked around. Tall towers raised from the ground and many of them were connected with wires, most of them being cut. Scrapped and abandoned ships laid all over the ground.

"This looks so.. unreal.. something that I have never seen before." Shadow Weaver said. She was almost admiring the chaotic landscape around her. If only there weren't so many monsters roaming around.

She kept looking for a while, but didn't see anything that would look helpful. "I guess you don't have ideas or knowledge of this place?" Shadow Weaver asked.

" *Not much.. I know pretty much as much as you do.. Though I think this place used to belong to the First Ones and it might have been their capital.. since this is the island where they first arrived.* " Entity explained.

"Well that's more than I know.." Shadow Weaver said and began to climb downwards. But when she grabbed onto a vine, it turned out to be a snake.

Not just a normal snake.. its head opened like a flower and it had rows of teeths and even multiple tongues.

"You've got to be shitting with me.." Shadow Weaver quipped with a tired tone. She let go off the snake and fell hard on the ground.

Her world was fading away and she could see the snake slithering down the tree towards her. But then something akin to a spell was casted and it swiftly cut off the snake's head.

"What.. the.." She tried to say, but couldn't finish her sentence. Before she blacked out, she saw a human-like figure approaching her.

Meanwhile at the Fright Zone, Scratch was at Hordak's throne room and Hordak was all but happy. **"You let the prisoner escape and send another to Beast Island!? Without informing ME!"**

"I only did what I judged best." Scratch said. "Shadow Weaver was the reason Darkith escaped."

"But you were the one who put two of them into the same cell! For what?! For petty revenge?! Hordak growled and slammed his fist on the throne's arm holder.

"But Hordak, I thought they hated each other-" But she couldn't finish her sentence. **"I've had enough of your excuses! Lock her into the prison!"**

Two guards came and chained Scratch's arms behind her back and started to drag her away. "You will regret this Hordak!" Scratch yelled.

Scratch was thrown into the same cell where Darkith and Shadow Weaver had been held. This was probably what they called karma. Scratch was chained to the wall and left there. Now all she could do was to either stare at the ceiling or all the marks on the floor and at the wall that Darkith and Shadow Weaver had scribbled during their time there.

Chapter End Notes

> Amogus, Darkith's a bit sus don't you think?
> ~I'm sorry for the dead meme..~
>
> And yes, Spell of Obtainment is getting affected by Shadow Weaver, can you imagine? Spell of Obtainment actually developing something else than total annihilation of Etheria.

The Crimson Wastes

Chapter Summary

Best friend squad goes to Crimson Waste to track te signal coming from the crahsed ship.

Hordak sends Scratch to Crimson Waste to retrieve the First Ones tech, as an punishment.

Catra stays at the Brightmoon to keep eye on the Darkith and Castaspella went back to Mystacor to make sure Catra's staff would work as intented.

Shadow Weaver wakes up in a house and meets her mysterious svaiour.

Chapter Notes

Whooowweee, finally! Another chapter. Took me a long enough.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora, Bow and Glimmer had arrived at the border of the Crimson Waste. They had gone there to track the signal from the Mara's ship.

Adora had a fierce conversation with Light Hope about her past, her origins and her destiny. She decided to take matters into her own hands. She told Glimmer and Bow about this and they agreed to go along with her. However, she didn't tell Catra about it.

She felt kind of bad about not telling her, considering how much Catra trusted and wanted to support Adora. She tried to convince herself that it was for Catra's own good. She didn't want to risk her life, after the sacrifice Shadow Weaver did and her wish was to look after Catra.

Though Catra obviously could take care of herself pretty well and she had said she would continue keeping an eye on Darkith, so it couldn't be that bad.. right?

"So this is the Crimson Waste." Bow stated. "This place looks so hostile..."

"If it makes you feel better, there's only dead plants around here. It's hard to believe that anything lives here and if something truly lives in a place like this.. they got to be dangerous." Adora said.

"That doesn't make anything feel better." Bow said with a shiver in his tone. However, Bow saw a worried expression on Adora's face. "Is something wrong Adora?"

"Agh..it's just.. I- I just can't help it, but feel bad..." Adora said and sighed deeply.

"Feel bad about what?" Glimmer asked.

"About not telling Catra. She would have come with us." Adora said. "She would have been a great help here, if I'm being honest."

"Don't feel bad Adora, I didn't tell my mother about this. She would have hated the idea of us going to Crimson Waste." Glimmer exclaimed with an upbeat tone.

"Aaha..." Adora said and sighed, that didn't make her feel any better. Maybe even made her worry even more. "Bow, what does your tracker say?"

"Well we are on the right course.. it's just that I have no idea how to get there.. I've never even thought about mapping the Crimson Wastes. And it seems my tracker is starting to malfunction." Bow answered.

"Alright... well we better just keep going towards the signal and to be prepared to run or fight anything that might come towards us." Adora said.

They then began their long trecking across the Crimson Wastes.

At Fright Zone, Scratch had been languishing in the prison cell for a few days at least. She was waiting for her final sentence and at worst it would be execution and at the least worst it would be banishment to Beast Island. The only place she didn't want to go for obvious reasons.

Meanwhile at Hordak's chambers, Entrapta was trying to convince Hordak that Scratch was still useful and because of her, Horde's performance had been tenfolded. "She alone has brought immense success to Horde, you should reconsider it. Here look at the data!" Entrapta said and showed the monitor on Hordak's face.

"Forget it!" Hordak yelled. "Scratch has been nothing but a inconvenience-" Hordak was interrupted by Entrapta. "My data shows otherwise, you really should reconsider her punishment. She has brought so much First Ones tech that you wouldn't find any better than her."

Hordak was about to yell at Entrapta and throw her out of the room, but something inside of him made him do otherwise. He

sighed deeply and said. "Fine.. I'll reconsider her punishment."

"Great! You know, I discovered that there's a huge amount of First Ones tech at the Crimson Wastes." Entrapta said as she looked at her tablet. This gave Hordak a great idea.

Scratch was drawing circles on the floor with her finger, a bored look on her face. She was waiting for the moment she would be dragged out from the cell and then probably executed.

She could hear steps coming towards her cell and she prepared herself for the worst.

Two guards came and ordered her out of the cell. Scratch obeyed, though with sluggish movement. She was now being escorted to the throne room of Hordak.

As she arrived there, Entrapta greeted her. "Hi, I just saved your neck. No need to thank me!" She exclaimed with an upbeat tone.

Scratch was confused about the situation, but she kneels before Hordak immediately. To avoid any other troubles. "So.. Lord Hordak, you have finally decided what to do to me..."

"That's right, through Entrapta's suggestions.. I'm sending you to the Crimson Waste. To retrieve First Ones tech."

Scratch couldn't believe what she heard. Sure Crimson Waste was not Beast Island... but it was desolate land with nothing living there.

"The Crimson Waste!?" Scratch exclaimed. "Nothing grows there, nothing survives there!"

Hordak had a devilish smile on his face. "Exactly."

At Brightmoon, Catra was keeping an eye on Darkith. She sat next to her and stared at her endlessly. Darkith herself grew annoyed by this constant staring. She had no room to move and she didn't even have anything in the prison barrier. "Can't you do something else?"

"What? My friends went somewhere and Castaspella is working on an important thing for me." Catra answered. "I literally have nothing else to do than keep watch."

"Agh.. you know.. I'm can't do anything nor go amywhere." Darkith stated.

"Yes.. but I find you interesting." Catra said. "You are the woman Shadow Weaver despised so much and yet trusted you enough to let you escape."

"Well being chained on the wall certainly helped with the fact she wasn't tearing me apart." Darkith answered. "Please excuse me, I want to sleep or at least try.. so could you look somewhere else?"

"Oh yeah.. sure, sure." Catra answered and turned to look in the opposite direction. "Better?"

"Much better.." Darkith let out a tired answer and closed her eyes. She tried to sleep on the hard floor, but it was impossible. She didn't have enough room to move properly and she even began to miss her time at the Fright Zone's prison.

For a while she just laid there, pretending to sleep. But in the end it was in vain. She opened her eyes and saw Catra's face glued on

the barrier, staring into her soul. Or what was left of it. "Excuse me, but what te FUCK!?" Darkith screamed. "How long have you been doing that?!"

"Almost the whole time you were pretending to sleep." Catra said smirking and stuck her tongue out.

"You clearly have no manners, now do you?" Darkith asked with an offended tone.

"Oh, I absolutely have." Catra answered. "It's just that I see no reason to have those manners when I'm around you."

"I am a political figure, with great influence and I demand some manners." Darkith said.

"Don't you mean.. you were a political figure with a lot of influence?" Catra asked back, smirking.

"Don't you find me threatening? Or scary? Or someone who demands respect?" Darkith asked.

"Well.. you pale in comparison to Shadow Weaver." Catra answered. "I've spent most of my life with her, so I'd say she is ten times that what you ever were... in your past."

"You dare to assume you know my past!? You know nothing of that matter!"

"Well it's obvious you were a sorcerer and did something similar to what Shadow Weaver did.. you just didn't have willpower to resist it... which makes you less what Shadow Weaver was." Catra explained.

"So you're telling me that Shadow Weaver resisted her entity better than I did?"

"It's obvious, just by looking at you.. everyone can see that whatever happened to you, didn't end well." Catra said.

"You truly are an insufferable menace... you know that?" Darkith said.

"And I wouldn't want to be anything more than that." Catra said and gave a smug smirk.

Back at the Crimson Wastes, Adora, Bow and glimmer were running away from a monstrous snake.

"Adora! Turn into She-Ra and do something!" Glimmer yelled.

"Yeah, if we continue like this... we'll soon be dead- Augh!" Bow yelled and evaded the snake's acid spit. "Seriously!?"

Adora was about to turn around and transform to She-Ra, but luckily for them they fell down a steep cliff into the bottom of a ravine. Snake stopped its pursuit after losing its prey.

"Phew, that was close!" Adora said and sighed relieved.

"We were lucky to get away." Bow stated.

"Well, so far we have confirmed that plants petrify their prey, tech doesn't work here, and some sand dunes are in fact large snakes... We're doing great!" Adora exclaimed.

"Yea sure.. whatever." Glimmer answered and stood up. She took few steps and suddenly fell into quicksoil. "Argh! You've got to be kidding with me!"

"Glimmer!" Bow yelled.

"Stop standing and help me!" Glimmer yelled back.

"Just use your teleport, it will be fine." Adora suggested.

"Oh... right.." Glimmer stated and teleported away from the quicksoil.

"Okay.. we now also know there's a possibility to step on quicksoil." Adora said. "We are doing great!"

All three of them continued their trekking over the desert. Hours passed and now the sun was setting and it was getting dark.

"Oh great, it's getting darker.." Glimmer stated annoyed.

"We should find some place to cover." Bow suggested.

"Yeah, the thing is... there is nothing out here! This whole place is hostile!" Glimmer yelled.

"Hey guys, look." Adora said and pointed at a huge skull laying in the desert. It looked like the skull belonged to a monster the size of a mountain. "There's light coming out from the skull."

"You can't seriously think going there would be a good idea." Bow said concerned.

"Do you have any better ideas?" Adora asked.

"Well.. umm.. not at the moment." Bow answered.

"Then we should go there, besides if things get difficult I'll just turn into She-Ra." Adora said confidently.

"Fine.." Bow said and then three of them started walking towards the skull.

As they arrived at its mouth, they could see there was something akin to a bar or saloon. "You can't be serious! Bow exclaimed.

"I thought nothing could live here." Glimmer said.

"Apparently, we were wrong.. But let's not that stop us, come on!" Adora said and stepped inside.

Back at Brightmoon, Angella was wandering around. Looking for Glimmer and her friends. She hadn't seen them the whole day. She decided to pay a visit to Darkith, if she had something to do with it.

As she entered the room, she saw Catra sitting next to imprisoned Darkith. Who seemed to be pretty annoyed and tired.

"Catra?" Angella asked.

Catra turned her head to look at Angella. "Oh, hi. Something wrong?"

"Have you seen Glimmer or Adora?" Angella asked with a slight worry in her tone.

"Nope, they're probably off somewhere." Catra answered.

"And you're not with them? Aren't you usually with them all the time?" Angella asked.

"Mostly, but they didn't tell me anything." Catra answered.

"As much as I'd like to care about your worry about your precious daughter.. I have a complaint." Darkith butted in.

"And what complaining would you have?" Angella asked, crossing her arms.

"She wants something softer in her prison than just the floor." Catra stated.

"Really now?" Angella asked and raised an eyebrow. "You are our prisoner, why should we do anything for you?"

"Just a simple cushion and a book." Darkith said. "Is that too much to ask for? Besides, aren't you like the good guys.. shouldn't you show mercy to your prisoners?"

"I think we have shown enough mercy for you." Angella said with a stern voice. "At least you have something to think about."

"Some Queen of virtue.." Darkith muttered.

"Just give her a cushion, how bad could it possibly be?" Catra said.

"Agh, fine... I've sidetracked already more than I should have." Angella answered. "You can give her a cushion and a book, just make sure it doesn't include anything about magic."

"Oh come on!" Darkith groaned. "Like there wouldn't be anything that I wouldn't already know..."

Shadow Weaver was surrounded by darkness, she laid on something soft and she could feel something flow through her. Something that she hadn't felt in a long time.

She had no idea how long she had been there, but now she slowly opened her eyes. Her vision was blurry at best and her body was

heavy like a log. Even a small movement of her hand was sluggish and she had little control over it. "Ugh.. what is this place?" Shadow Weaver slowly moved her head and looked around her.

She was obviously in a house?... a cottage?.. a hut? Well it didn't matter, it was clear she was inside of a makeshift home. Everything there was crudely made. Shadow Weaver slowly stood up to sit while holding her head still.

She had regained more control of her body movement by now. When she saw her wrists, she was shocked. Her anti-magic cuffs were gone, someone had to break them. But who would be stupid enough to do that?

It didn't matter that much anyways. At the state she now was, it made no difference if she had her magic or not. She felt weak, tired and heavy as a rock. Her head was dizzy and her sight was still blurry. "Hey.. Entity? Do you have something to do with this?"

" *Well.. after being locked out from magic for so long.. it's only natural that I would feed off that much.* " Spell of Obtainment explained. " *My intent was not to kill you, but I can assure you that you will soon feel fine and powerful.. I just had to regain my strength first.* "

"Wow.. so considerate.." Shadow Weaver murmured.

Then a door opened and someone stepped inside, she could hear a door close and. She could hear steps coming towards her from the stairs. Shadow Weaver didn't know what to do. Was this person a friend or foe? Hostile or not? She didn't know, so she gathered all her strength and willpower and took on a defensive position.

Not that it mattered much anyways, she couldn't even hurt a fly at the state she was in. How could she even fight?

Hooded figure came into the room. "Oh, you're up already?" Male voice called.

Shadow Weaver narrowed her eyes to get a sharper look. The hooded man was pretty tall and was covered in black robes. Though his voice sounded familiar to her.

"Wh-who are you.. an-and what d-do you want?" Shadow Weaver managed to stutter her words out. She tried to look and sound tough, but her stuttering gave her away.

"You don't remember me?" Hooded man asked. He then took his hood off and revealed his face. Long dark hair with a dark long beard. His eyes had a warm and little bit of a tired look on.

Shadow Weaver couldn't believe eyes nor hre ears. How was this possible? How was Micah alive? "This is not possible! This isn't real!"

"Shadow-" Micah was interrupted by her. "No, this is something else, my mind is just fucking with me again! You think this is funny? A cruel joke just to torment me!?"

"Calm down.. I have no idea what you are talking about." Micah tried to calm Shadow Weaver.

"Is this your doing?!" Shadow Weaver asked from the Entity with a fierce tone.

" *I can assure you, I have nothing to do with this.* " Spell of Obtainment said sincerely.

"If it's not you... then.." Shadow Weaver's voice toned down and she took another look at Micah. "Micah? Is- is that really you?"

Micah let out a relieved sigh and smiled. "The one and only."

Chapter End Notes

This is kind of useless info, but I just had a late realization that LS/SW's A+ patenting tag is usually used sarcastically..

or as an joke tag.. because we all know SW was a bad parent...

Kinda useless, but took me maybe too long to realize that :P

Searching For Mara's Ship

Chapter Summary

After succesfully aquiring a guide, Huntara. The best friend squad continues to search for the Mara's ship. They don't know that Huntara might just not be all what she seems.

Scratch and Scorpia also arrive at the Crimson Waste, searching for this First Ones tech that Entrapta had sent them there for.

At Fright Zone, Hordak and Entrapta tries to activate te portal, but are unsuccessful.

Shadow Weaver and Micah have a conversation. There's so much to catch up between the ex-tutor and student.

Chapter Notes

Finally... a new chapter I've been working on far too long.

I do hope you will enjoy this chapter and I hope I'll get next chapter out sooner.

Scratch and Scorpia finally arrived at the Crimson Wastes, it was already well past midnight and stars lit the sky.

"You know.. for a desolate and hostile environment. This place looks kinda beautiful." Scorpia said with awe in her voice.

"And you know.. you wouldn't have to come with me.." Scratch grumbled. "I could have done this myself."

"Don't be silly, we are friends. All three of us." Scorpia said with a cheerful tone.

"Ugh.. come on! We have no time to lose." Scratch said.

Adora and her friends were guided through Crimson Waste, Huntara being their guide. They truly were lucky to get her recruited, since she knew the Crimson Wastes as well as her own pockets.

"You know, it's so great that you promised to help us. Your skills are truly like none other." Adora said, almost in a gushing tone. "But you know, that I'm also pretty well trained in tracking and navigating."

"Your problem is that you talk too much. Gets you killed one day." Huntara said.

Huntara kept guiding them through the Crimson Waste. The awkward silence vexed Adora as they trekked through the wastes. She decided to break the silence once more. "You know.. for a place that's said to be inhabited, the Crimson Wastes has been more lively than I expected."

"Many kind of people come here, mostly they want to get away from something." Hunatara answered stoically. "Or they are running away from something."

"Then what do you run away from?" Adora asked.

Huntara quickly turned to face Adora, pushed her against the wall and for a moment it seemed she was aiming her spear at her. But she aimed it at the bug and ate it. "I am Huntara of Crimson Waste, I will not run away!"

They continued their way through canyons and through sand oceans, until they arrived at more rocky area. Spiked rocks stuck out from the ground and pointed towards the night skye.

Bow and Glimmer were arguing whether they should tell Adora that something is off. Their bickering turned into aggressive sushing competition and Huntara took notice of that. "Your companions are quite noisy."

"Ye-yeah, that's how it is sometimes.." Adora said.

"Well we're here." Huntara stated and showed them a deep pit where there was a one single stone at the middle of the bottom. "The center point of Crimson Waste."

Adora was beyond excited and rushed down there to check it out for herself. Bow and Glimmer went after her.

But when they reached the bottom, there was nothing special. It was just a rock. Adora was beyond disappointed. Her life has always been in the shadows and nothing was ever clear.

Even worse, it turns out this was a trap. Adora felt something sting her and saw it was a dart. Before she could react properly, she was already lying on the ground. Glimmer and Bow soon followed after her as they were being shot at as well.

Before Adora's eyes closed, she saw Huntara standing in front of her. She picked up Adora's sword and said. "I told you to not trust anyone."

Moments later, Adora and her friends woke up at the bottom of an pit. Just great, their plan worked so well.

At the Fright Zone, Hordak and Entrapta were testing opening the portal. First it seemed to go well, but it soon turned unstable. Entrapta didn't recognise the immediate danger as she approached the portal. "Interesting... It seems the machines can't handle it. I'll take a closer look."

"Get away you fool!" Hordak yelled as the portal turned even more unstable. It was guaranteed that the portal would blow up.

Hordak quickly ran towards Entrapta and pulled her away before the explosion. He shielded her from the explosion with his body. Not knowing why he did it, it seemed to be out of instinct. Even though he hasn't never cared for anyone or anything.

"Yo-you saved me." Entrapta said with a relieved and happy tone, knowing that this would be the beginning of something new.

Hordak stood up quickly after realizing the situation. His armor was badly damaged and the portal was a total failure. "It's over! The portal has proved to be a failure."

"What? No!" Entrapta exclaimed. "This is just the first step. Now we can learn from this mistake."

"It's a failure! Now get out!" Hordak demanded.

"We dont know that! It seems to require a key of sorts. I'm sure once Scratch returns from the Crimson Waste with the First Ones-" Entrapta was then cut off by Hordak. "Scratch-agh! She is never going to return from that fool's errand. Now... get.. out.."

Entrapta backed away, but still stayed in Hordak's chambers, pondering if she should leave or not. She saw Hordak's deformed

body as he had taken the armor off for repairs. Hordak was growling in pain and seemed to be very angry.

"Yeaah.. maybe it's better that I would go.." Entrapta said to herself and began to creep out in silence with Emily. But being a bit clumsy, she stumbled on a wire on the floor which caused a chain reaction of noise and ended in a pipe falling on the ground.

Hordak took notice of the noise made and turned to look at Entrapta. He was furious that she had disobeyed his orders. "I told you to get off! This is direct-" He couldn't finish his sentence though and fell on the floor.

His body was frail and weak without his armor and every move took a toll on him. As his sight was fading, he could see Entrapta running towards him.

Adora and her friends laid at the bottom of the pit and stared at the stars, glimmering in the night sky.

Adora let out a deep sigh. "Can this get any worse!?"

"Don't jinx it.." Bow muttered.

"If we only had a chance to get out of here... maybe we should have told someone..." Adora said with a regretful tone.

"I can get us out of here in no time." Glimmer said. "Did you forget, I can teleport?"

"That's right!" Adora said and sprung up from the ground. "Do it, do it right now."

"Alright, alright.." Glimmer tried to calm Adora. She then grabbed both Bow and Adora and began to teleport.

At first try they just teleported above the hole and fell down. Second try with the same result.

"Glimmer.. maybe think about getting us next to the hole, rather than above." Bow suggested.

"Oh.. right." Glimmer stated and tried once again. This time they landed next to the pit. "Hah, third time telling the truth!"

"No time to lose, we must get our weapons back." Adora said and began to run after the tracks of Huntara and others.

Meanwhile Huntara and her two companions were sitting on a campfire, admiring their spoils of war. Huntara inspected the sword while the goat horned lady managed to get herself tangled with Bow's net arrow.

"Stop arsing around!" Huntara snapped and cut the net with one swing of the sword.

"Relax Huntara.." Goat horned lady said. "We are having just a bit of fun, did you see their faces when they learned that you betrayed them?"

Huntara only frowned as an answer.

"Don't tell me you are actually feeling bad about them."

Huntara quickly turned around and grabbed the goat horned lady and pushed her against the rock."I did what I had to, to protect

ourselves!"

"Haha..don't you mean yourself? You are running away from something, just like everyone else."

"I am Huntara of Crimson Waste, I don't run away from anything!" Then she felt a magical blast on her face.

"And I'm Glimmer, the princess of Brightmoon and I sparkle!" She kept shooting magical blasts and swiftly grabbed Bow's weapons before others color react.

Now Adora was standing face to face with Huntara. "Hey, that sword is mine!"

"Then come and get it!" Huntara yelled back and took a fighting stance.

Adora took out Huntara's staff that she had left on the ground. "That is mine." Huntara said as she saw the staff at Adora's hands.

"Then come and get it." Adora said with a smug grin on her face.

Huntara didn't have time for childish word plays and charged towards Adora.

Meanwhile Bow and Glimmer managed to keep others busy.

Adora and Huntara had a vexing duel, where both of them could show their great fighting skills. Adora managed to disarm Huntara by headbutting her and kicking the sword off her hands.

Glimmer and Bow had successfully taken Huntara's goons out and Glimmer picked up Adora's sword. "Quick, it's time for She-Ra!" She yelled and threw the sword towards Adora.

"Wait, you know of She-Ra?" Huntara asked as she was on her knees.

"Ohhoh.. do I know her?" Adora asked as she grabbed the sword. "I am her, For the honor of Grayskull!"

And with a swift bright flash she had transformed into She-Ra.

Huntara was taken back by this. She had never guessed She-Ra would be a person. "Sh..She-Ra.. is a person?"

"You're damn right she is." Adora said and pointed her sword at Huntara's throat. Now tell me... how do you know off She-Ra? It's not like they'd teach you that in the Horde."

"I.. I was in the Horde... they told us we're the heroes.. but after what I saw them do.. we were no heroes.." Huntara said with a melancholy tone. "So I ran away.. you ran away from the Horde as well.. I recognise that fighting style.."

"I left the Horde, but I didn't run away. I chose to fight." Adora said.

"That's foolish.. one girl can't turn the tides of war.. even if you possessed the power of She-Ra"

"I chose to believe that together we can turn this around. I have great friends who will help me and we are not alone." Adora said with a stern but comforting tone.

"Alright, thats real nice and all.. drop the sword!" Goat horned lady interrupted them. She and the lizard lady had managed to capture Glimmer and Bow, holding them now as hostages. "Come on Huntara, let's get our loot and go."

"Agh, Adora!" Glimmer plead.

Huntara got slowly up and walked towards the goat horned lady. She put her hand on her shoulder and gave a faint smirk. But then she tightened her grip till the goat horned lady had to let Glimmer go.

"Argh! That hurts like hell!" She yelled. Huntara didn't care and pushed her on the ground.

Lizard lady let go off Bow, because she didn't want to be next. Both of them ran away in fear.

When they were gone, Huntara turned back to the best friend squad and said. "Alright.. if you believe that you can turn the tide of war.. and I don't want to keep running away forever... so I'll do everything I can do to help you." She then extended her hand towards She-Ra

She-Ra turned back to Adora and extended her hand as well. Then they shook their hands.

"Alright, follow me. We have lots of ground to cover until we reach the ship." Huntara said.

"What?.. A ship?" Adora asked, confused.

They followed Huntara to the nearest cliff and she showed them the vast desert and in the middle of it was an alien ship.

"Adora.. what is that?" Bow asked, gasping.

"It's.. it's Mara's ship." Adora stated with a shocked look on her face.

Scratch and Scorpia arrive at the same saloon where Adora and her friends had been earlier. As they entered, both of them were surprised that people actually live at a place like this.

"Didn't expect someone to actually live here." Scorpia stated.

"I don't care.. information is what I care about." Scratch said with a frustrated tone and walked to the counter. "Does anyone here know where I can find First Ones tech?"

There was no answer, it seemed that no one even batted an eye. Feeling even more frustrated, she asked once more. "Maybe I didn't make myself clear, but where can I find the First Ones tech?!"

Nobody cared what she was saying, why would they be interested in helping some random stranger.

Scratch had a very short temper and she didn't take it lightly when being ignored. But when she was starting to rampage, she heard something interesting. She could hear something about a blonde haired girl with a sword and her friends with sparkles and bow.

This of course piqued her interest and she decided to butt in. "Excuse, but where I can find those three?" Scratch asked.

"Piss off, whelp!" The goat horned woman snapped.

Scratch was about to start to throw hands, but Scorpia intervened and pulled her back. "I don't question your leadership, but we were looking for the First Ones tech. Not Adora."

"But they are always after the same things we are! There would be no other reason for them to be here!" Scratch argued and

went back to the goat horned woman. "So, those three. Take me to them!"

Woman with goat horns turned to look at her. She stood up and walked close to Scratch. Her stance was threatening. "Listen whelp, there are three rules.. First, the strong-" But she was cut off by Scratch seething her sword and with one swift swing, she cut one of her horns.

"Ohohh.. don't give me that crap! That only works for weak people and for those who have something to lose." Scratch said with a low and threatening voice. She walked slowly around the goat horned lady. She kept pointing her sword towards anyone who ever thought about going against her. "I.. I don't have anything left.. I was betrayed by my closest ones and sent here to basically to die."

Scratch finished her walking and now held her sword at the goat horned lady's throat. "So.. I ask, one more time. Where can I find those three annoying brats?"

Woman in question was horrified. "Uhh.. ahh.. a-a-alright, we can take you anywhere y-you want. Yo-you a-are cool wi-with us." She said and gulped.

"That's what I thought." Scratch said with an intimidating smile on her face and seethed her sword. "Take me to that blonde girl and you might see another day."

Scratch also noticed that one lizard looking guy with a balck leather jacket was listening to her. As Scratch turned to look at him, he quickly turned away and tried to pretend he didn't pay any attention.

Shadow Weaver couldn't believe what she was seeing, Micah who she had presumed to be dead. Was now standing in front of her. For so long she had grieved over him and for so long she had endured the scorn of others, for she was the one who had been blamed for his death.

Angella's scorn and disdain was hardest and now Micah was here, alive and.. mostly well.

"I.. I just can't understand.." Shadow Weaver uttered in shock. "What happened? How did you survive?"

Micah let out a deep sigh and sat next to Shadow Weaver. He put his hand on her shoulder. "It's.. ahh.. it's a long story." He said.

"I don't mind... times the only thing I have.. just.. What happened." Shadow Weaver said while tears were falling down her cheek.

"Well long story short.. I- I just teleported here." Micah explained. "I don't know how, but I just ended up here. I have been here.. uhh.. I'm not even sure. It feels like time flows differently here."

"Well, what I have counted.. you have been gone over a decade." Shadow Weaver said.

"Really? I have felt like maybe a year or two at most.. this is something I didn't expect." Micah said with a surprised expression. "I can assume much has happened, can you tell me anything about Angella or my baby girl?"

"I didn't talk or meet your daughter so much, but what I remember from those brief interactions.. she's grown a lot and she is a brave and kind leader.. and sometimes as reckless as you were." Shadow Weaver said with a faint smile on her face.

Micah was also smiling, hearing these things made him feel good and calming her mind. He had stressed a lot about how her

daughter would have survived.

"Me and Angella.. well that's a whole different thing. We never got along, especially after your disappearance.." Shadow Weaver said with a heavy tone and sighed dejectedly. "She blamed me for your disappearance and I got so.. so mad that I almost killed her in my anger."

Micah had a shocked look on his face. "I-I.. don't know what to say.."

"Relax.. I didn't do anything to her, thanks to Catra.. now that I think about it... I've never ever thanked her... even when she's been the whole reason I've been able to retain my rips of humanity.." Shadow Weaver said with a regretful tone and covered her face with her hands.

Micah embraced Shadow Weaver with a hug. "No one is perfect, even the best of us." Micah said with a comforting tone. "I know you have been through a lot, don't burden yourself over such things. I'm sure you will have plenty of chances to make your past mistakes right."

"Execpt I can't. I can't change my past!" Shadow Weaver said as her voice broke. "Spell of Obtainment was a mistake I can't never fix, I couldn't save my mother and I can't get her back... even if I wished so."

"I never knew about your mother.."

"I didn't talk about it then.. and I don't want to talk about it now.." Shadow Weaver said. "Point is, there are mistakes I can't make right."

"Well I'm not going to force you to do or talk about anything, I just want to help you." Micah said with a sincere tone. "Even if you can't change your past, you can always change your future."

"Truly, you were and are the best pupil I ever had.." Shadow Weaver said with a melancholy tone and she had a faint smile

over her face.

"Uhhh.. enough with that... it's kinda pointless." Micah said awkwardly and rubbed the back of her head. "You haven't been my teacher in like.. what.. over 20 years… according to you…"

Mara's Ship and Message

Chapter Summary

Adora, Bow, Glimmer and Huntara finally reach Mara's ship. There's a stark revelation waiting for them.

Scratch has managed to force herself a guide and she's ambushed by Tung Slashor's gang. What will she do about it?

Entrapta upgrades Hordak's armor and they seem to become great partners.

Castaspella has finally managed to succesfully make Catra's staff to work properly and safely.

And Shadow Weaver catches and "Island Fever"

Chapter Notes

Hey, this chapter actually came out faster than I thought.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At the Fright Zone, Hordak woke up on the floor in his laboratory. Someone had even put a blanket on him. Who would dare to do this while he was unconscious. He could then see Entrapta running towards him, with a bowl in her hands.

"I told you to get lost!" Hordak growled, but his tone was neither threatening nor commanding.

"Just eat this, it will make you feel better." Entrapta said and tried to offer him a spoonful of the soup. Hordak turned his face around and Entrapta had to use her hair as extendable arms to get him fed.

But he didn't want to have anything to do with it, so Entrapta let it go.

Hordak tried to get up from the floor, but couldn't even take a few steps before collapsing. Entrapta caught her with her hair. Now she could see Hordaks body up close and she realized that his armor was compensating for his defected body.

Entrapta demanded to know everything and with a little bit of pressure, she got Hordak talking.

He was explaining how he was a defected clone of Horde Prime, Prime was the leader of the Galactic Horde and the ruler of the known world.

Hordak explained how he was casted out by Prime because of his defect and when he was sent to certain death at the frontlines, a portal opened and sucked him into Etheria.

With only a broken ship he built the Horde and was planning on bringing the Galactic Horde through the portal and crushing the rebellion once and for all.

"But my portal machine is an failure.. and I myself cant even clone myself.." Hordak slammed his fist on one of the pods that held his successful cloning experiments. "Maybe Prime was right.."

Then he could hear loud clanking and saw Entrapta tinkering something.

"Oh I was listening, it's just that I got an idea and I need all my stuff to get it work. I'll be right back." Entrapta said and pulled herself somewhere, probably getting her tools.

Hordak only let out a silent groan and sighed deeply.

Moments later Entrapta was back and was going on about how imperfection was beautiful and the best thing in science is how to overcome such flaws.

Hordak didn't quite understand what Entrapta was about, she wasn't a failure like he was.

"Alright, stand still. Like this." Entrapta said and lifted Hordaks arms up with her hair. "And that's perfect, now be still."

"I don't quite understand.. you're not a fail-" But before he could finish his sentence, Entrapta shut his mouth with her hair.

"I am.. I don't fit in.. I was friends with Adora, but she abandoned me... I tried to friend Scratch, but she never talked to me... point is, that didn't stop me trying to be better." Entrapta explained. "So I got an idea how to improve you."

Entrapta activated the machine that assembled Hordak's armor and this time it would be more than just an armor.

"Now, with some tinkering.. I have managed to make your armor more like an exoskeleton, compensating the flaws of your body and enhancing it." Entrapta gushed with excitement in her tone. "So.. how does it feel?"

Hordak did some hand exercise and

Adora and her friends had finally reached Mara's ship with the help of their guide. But as they finally entered the ship, it was empty. There was nothing there and if there ever were anything, its probably long gone or stolen.

"This can't be it... it's so big, yet everything here feels small..." Adora said. "Surely there must be more to it."

"I hate to break it to you, but this ship has been here for a long time.." Huntara said.

But Adora kept looking around the looted ship, until she came across strange but familiar engravings on the floor. It was First Ones language and it seemed to have a symbol of a shield.

"Keep your distance." Adora said. "I think I figured it out." Then she turned her sword into a shield and placed it upon the markings. Soon after it began to glow and the ship was shaking. There was a doorway now open to anyone to enter.

Bats flew from the dark corridor and an howling wind blew with them.

Bow and Glimmer hugged each other as they were scared senseless.

Adora only shrugged her shoulders a bit. "I'm not afraid of danger.." She then entered inside the pitch black corridor.

At the otherside of the Crimson Wastes, Scratch and Scorpia were being guided by the lizard lady and goat horned lady. But as they went on and on, Scratch grew impatient at their bumbling and stumbling until she began to call the goat horned lady as "Kyle".

Scratch enjoyed the feeling of bossing others around and threatening others to get what she wanted. "You know Scorpia, I think this place has a bad reputation." Scratch said. "I mean, you can just take what you want and make others do your bidding."

"Ahaha.. I get what you mean." Scorpia said. She tried to nod and agree with Scratch even if she felt something felt wrong about it.

"Hey, Kyle! Stop arsing around and show me the way! And carry that other one, it seems she's tumbled on a paralyzing thorn bush." Scratch ordered. " *I love this so much.."*

As they walked through the rocky valleys, they soon found themselves at the bottom of a stone formation. Tall and spiky rocks in a circle, formed something that looked like an arena. Though that could be only coincidence.

"Are you sure this is the right place?" Scratch asked.

"Well... we might have gone off the rail for a while." Kyle answered. "Crimson Waste is a big place and many of the surroundings tend to look the same."

"Argh! Of Course, leave the things for Kyle... it's bound to happen..." Scratch murmured, but before things could escalate any further.. they escalated.

They found themselves now surrounded by tons of lizard people around them, standing above the spiky cliffs. And then, from a rock that had a resemblance of a reptile, came out a pretty tough looking guy. And he didn't look like he would take any shits from anyone.

"Well... shit.." Scratch sighed.

"Well, well.. what do we have here?" He asked and jumped on the ground. "Little rats, lost from their group? You should fear the strong, these are the rules here."

"Agh, again with this strongest bullcrap!" Scratch said annoyed. "What's your name? Slithering Shit?"

"Name's Tonguelashor and you have just committed a grave sin of belittling me.." He said and his tone got ever more threatening.

"Uhh, Scratch, I know you are genius.. but are you sure it's wise to annoy.. this.. one who's clearly the boss around here." Scorpia said with a concerned tone.

"Don't worry, he's all bark no bite." Scratch said with an assuring tone.

"I challenge you to duel to the death! Tonguelashor said with a commanding voice.

"Ugh... I really wanted this! Scratch let out a sarcastic answer. "Fine, I'll humor you a bit."

"You insolent little shit! Prepare to die!" "Tonguelashor yelled and proceeded to charge towards Scratch, wielding a whip at his other hand.

"Seriously? A whip?" Scratch asked, raising an eyebrow. She didn't even have to move from her place. She knew her sword was enchanted with dark magic by Darkith, so a whip is as good as a wooden stick.

Tonguelashor swung his whip towards Scratch, while she unseethe'd her sword.

With one quick swing, Tonguelashors whip was scorching with dark flames and turned to ash.

Tung Lashor was taken aback by this. "How!? How in the blazing hell was that possible!?" He yelled with a terrified and confused tone.

"Simple, it's dark magic." Scratch answered and quickly forced Tung Lashor to his knees. Scratch pointed the sword at his throat. "What was it? Duel to the death?"

Tonguelashor could see a sadistic smile creep on Scratch's face. "Wha-what ki-kind of monster are you?" He asked with a frightful voice.

"Let's just say that I'm.. or... on the other hand, you just don't deserve to know." Scratch answered and cut Tonguelashors head off with a clean swing of her sword. "Pathetic.."

Scorpia was frightened about all of this, but decided to make sure Scratch wouldn't go on to another kill spree. She started to chant Scratch's name and get everyone involved. Soon others started to join in on the chant and accepted Scratch as their new leader.

Scratch bathed in the glamorous chanting and in the attention she was getting, stroking her huge ego. Now nothing could stop her.

Meanwhile at the Mara's ship, Adora had figured out how to get the ship to somewhat work. She had inserted her sword in the keyhole and then all the lights in the ship went on and on what most likely was the pilot's seat, a hologram appeared. It was Mara.

" *If you're seeing this, it means that you are now the new She-Ra.. which means that I have failed.* "

Adora, Huntara, Bow and Glimmer were listening as the hologram of Mara explained to them about how the First Ones came into Etheria and how things went quickly south.

" *There was no other way.. I had to close Etheria in dyspondos, so they couldn't find us. Ugh, I never wanted to be a hero... and I won't be remembered as such..* " Mara said with a desperation in her voice.

She was explaining how the sword is the administrator key into the heart of Etheria and if you were to use it, it would open a portal that would cause the end of everything.

" *You have the key now.. so I beg you, don't use it.. or death and destruction will follow!* " Then Mara was cut off by explosions. " *For the good of Etheria, you must keep Etheria here-* " Then the message cut off and it was total darkness and silence.

But a slow clapping could be heard and it broke the silence.

Huntara took a defensive stand and questioned. "Who's there? Show yourself and face Huntara!"

Then poison darts were being shot at them, Bow and Glimmer were hit and Huntara managed to block two that were directed at Adora.

From the darkness came Huntara's ex-partners and some of the members of Tongueslashor's members.

"You two joined Tongueslashor?" Huntara asked.

"Oh, they didn't join him." A familiar voice answered from the dark. "They joined me." Scratch revealed herself and caught Adora dumbfounded. "Oh, it's been a while.. Adora."

Adora had to acg quickly, she ran for the sword and grabbed it. "For the honor of-" But before she could finish the sentence and transform, Scratch had snatched the sword off from her hands with the whip she got from Tung Lashor.

"You're always so dramatic.. and I think this is the fastest I have ever beaten you." Scratch taunted with a smirk on her face.

Before Adora could do anything, Scorpia catched her. Huntara still had strength left and Adora ordered her to get Glimmer and Bow out of there.

Scorpia then stung Adora, making her lose her consciousness.. Scorpia gave Scratch a smirk and Scratch had an approving look on her face.

At the Beast Island, Shadow Weaver was struck by a fever. Neither Micah or her had any idea what it was about. Shadow Weaver rarely ever had fevers or she never became sick. That is if you don't count Spell of Obtainment as a sickness of itself.

" *I think I'm struck by an island fever."* Entity told Shadow Weaver.

"The island what?!" Shadow Weaver asked in a frustrated and confused tone.

" *The island fever, I'm literally becoming sick!* " Entity told her.

"So is that why I'm feeling like my body is burning and why I feel like someone has beaten me up with an iron mallet?"

" *Precisely, 10/10 observation.* " Entity told her with a sarcastic tone.

"So you can get sick and I have to suffer from it too?!"

" *Yes, is that a problem?"* Entity asked. " *Am I not allowed to be sick?* "

"Considering that you are an interdimensional entity.. I never thought you would get such an common sickness as fever." Shadow Weaver said.

" *This is beyond cosmic levels, this accursed island is the reason for it!* "

"Great, not only am I stuck on an island with bloodthirsty monsters.. I'm also sick because you caught an interdimensional fever?!" Shadow Weaver ranted frustrated, but she couldn't keep ranting as the fever took an heavy toll on her.

Micah came upstairs with a tray on his hands and on the tray were two mugs and a pot. "I don't know who you are ranting to, but please calm yourself." Micah said.

"Oh, I am calm.. this is the calmest I have been in the ages!" Shadow Weaver snapped from her bed.

"Clearly not.." Micah said and shrugged his shoulders. "I made you some medicine. I hope it will calm you and make you feel better."

"Actually, this is the best I've felt in a decade. Considering that my life has been nothing more than suffering! So I'll gladly take any medicine you have made for me." Shadow Weaver quipped.

Micah couldn't decide if Shadow Weaver was being serious or was she being sarcastic. He let out a deep sigh. "Anyways, please enjoy it while its hot. I'll be keeping on guard, also call me if you need anything."

Shadow Weaver watched as Micah left the tray next to her and left her alone. She felt bad that she snapped at Micah like that, but she couldn't help it. Her life has not been anything more than suffering and pain, with small snippets of moments where she actually felt happy.

" *You are not going to drink that!* " Spell of Obtainment ordered. " *I don't want any of that suspicious liquid inside of me!* "

"We'll see." Shadow Weaver smirked and drank all the medicine, just to spite the Entity.

" *You have no idea what you've done! You literally doomed me, I'm going to die!* "

"Don't be so dramatic. It's just medicine." Shadow Weaver said.

" *It tastes terrible!" Entity complained.*

"Then it will be at least effective." Shadow Weaver said. Seriously, is that millenias old entity like a 5 year old child?

At Brightmoon, Catra was still keeping an eye on Darkith. She was annoyed about the constant watching, but she had grown used to it. Even if she still detested it silently.

"You know.. I thought you had more important things to do? You are held in a high position, right?" Darkith questioned.

"What else would I do? Shadow Weaver is not here, I don't have a home, Adora and others left somewhere and I was asked to keep an eye on you. So I'll do just that." Catra answered and crossed her arms.

"Right..." Darkith said and frowned. "You could at least get me another book, I've read this same book way too many times."

Catra let out a sigh. "Fine, I'll see what I can do." She said and stood up from her chair. "And don't even think about escaping." Then Catra left the room.

"Where could I even go..." Darkith murmured herself.

Catra was looking for a suitable book to give for Darkith, she found one that was about botany. This brought her memories of Shadow Weaver.

Even if she herself didn't know or care too much about that, she would always remember how Shadow Weaver was making different kinds of tea, medicine and potions.. how she used to do gardening. Out of nostalgia and fond memories, she picked one of the botany books.

As she continued looking for more suitable books, she was greeted by Castaspella. She was hiding her hands before her back and had quite an excited tone. "Catra, I was looking for you."

"Oh, Castaspella. What brings you here?" Catra asked and picked another book.

"Well.. I got the staff working properly." Castaspella answered. "It took many nights and countless tries, but I managed to finally separate any harmful connections from the crystal and managed to install it correctly."

"That's an awful lot of words." Catra said.

"And that's not all." Castaspella said. "Light- I mean Shadow Weaver's studies about artificial magic and its properties made now sense. She used describe it as an abusing the runestone or crystals by irking them.. though I'd prefer the term forcefull co-operation.."

"In english?" Catra asked, raising an eyebrow.

"Well here, take it." Castaspella said and offered the staff to Catra.

Catra then put the books on the ground. She took the staff and inspected it. "And? What now?"

"You see those different buttons at the staff and one at the bottom?"

"Yes, I can see them." Catra answered as she inspected the bottom of the staff.

"Well, by pressing those buttons, it will irk the runestone inside the staff and then it will cast different kind of spells." Castaspella explained. "I programmed some basic and useful spells and you can combine them by pressing the buttons in different order, it also can react to certain movements."

"Wow! Like, that's so awesome!" Catra exclaimed with an excited tone. "How did you manage to do all this?"

"Lots of studying and many sleepless nights." Castaspella said with a bragging and proud tone.

"I don't know if that's something to brag about." Catra said.

"Pfft.. it was nothing, piece of cake." Castaspella said nonchalantly. "So, what were you doing anyways?"

"I was picking up some books for Darkith to read, she complained that the one book she had was getting boring." Catra answered.

"I see, did you find suitable books then?"

"I did and no need to worry, I didn't pick any books that could give her some ideas." Catra said and winked her eye. She then gave the books to Castaspella as she herself wanted to admire the staff on their way back to Darkith's holding room.

"Oh.. right." Castaspella said and followed Catra.

When they reached the room where Darkith was held, they were greeted by her sarcastic tone. "Took you long enough, you even brought the sorcerer with you."

"More like she brought herself here." Catra answered and gave the books to Darkith.

Darkith examined the books she was given and was irritated by the fact that Catra had chosen the most boring books ever written.

" *Residents of Brightmoon from the last thousand years, One Thousand Years old Mystical Tree? Etherian Botany, All the rare grass types of Etheria?* " Darkith read out loud, while Catra and Castaspella were holding their laughter.

"You've got to be kidding me!?" Darkith snapped.

"Well those books are at least long and you can always change to another book if another gets boring." Catra said while smirking.

"But they are all boring! Seriously.. you are a menace.." Darkitg muttered under her teeth.

Then their brief moment of blissfulness came to an end when a guard rushed in and informed them that Glimmer and Bow were brought to Brightmoon and they were unconscious.

Chapter End Notes

I finally managed to coclude the artificial magic sub plot. Expect Catra using her new staff in the upcoming chapters.

"Hey, Author! I Want to have a word with you!"

~Oh, not you again...~

Why did you write me getting sick? Im an entity, entites dont get sick!"

~I tought it would be fun.~

"Oh, so you think its fun!? What if you backed up this "fever" with a source?!"

~My source is, that I made it the fuck up!~

To Risk It All

Chapter Summary

> After Bow and Glimmer had recovered, they told everything what happened at the Crimson Wastes. And how they were now in huge trouble, as Scratch had managed to capture Adora and her sword.
> Now they have to decide, wether to risk it all.. or not.

> Adora is captive of Scratch and she somehow manages to get herself into even worse spot. When she opens her big mouth about Hordaks plans and Darkith.
>
> At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver is recovering from her fever and the Spell of Obtainment senses that something big is going to happen.

Chapter Notes

> Whooo weee.. Another chapter fairly quickly out.. I hope you enjoy it.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At Crimson Waste, Adora had finally recovered from Scorpia's sting. But she quickly found out that things didn't look quite good for her. She was tied to the pillar in the back of the tavern.

Scratch came to see her, mostly just so she could brag to her about her accomplishments.

"It's been a while." Scratch said while playfully swinging Adora's sword. "All these times you've presented yourself as this fearsome warrior, but now.. what even are you? A sad, powerless, meaningless... nobody."

"Scratch, we used to be friends. Why are you like this?" Adora pleaded to empty ears.

"Oh.. friends? When were we friends?" Scratch questioned. "If you mean when we are children.. then by now we are long past that!"

"But the Horde hasn't treated you well and now you are here. In the middle of wastelands." Adora said. "You could be so much more, but you let others keep you down."

Scratch let out a sarcastic laugh. "Oh Adora.. you're so naive.. I'm going to bring this sword back to Hordak and you... to show him I'm worthy."

"No, you can't! Hordak is building a portal and due to circumstances we are now.. if you would open the portal by using the sword... it would bring the end of the world!" Adora pleaded with a desperate voice.

"How do you know what Hordak's doing?" Scratch questioned and pointed the sword at Adora's throat.

"Darkith told me. She's a prisoner at Brightmoon."

Scratch couldn't believe it. Darkith had plotted with Shadow Weaver to go to Brightmoon.. to do what? Help them? Scratch's face was full of rage, but it quickly turned into madness. She felt betrayed, even if all of it was her fault. She couldn't admit it anymore. "So... she did all that.. just to go to you?"

"Scratch, it's not too late to fix this! Why would you even care what she did, wasn't she in prison because of you?"

"Oh we are so past all of that fixing stuff! I'm delivering you to the Fright Zone and I'm making sure the portal is opened!" Scratch said with a threatening voice and left Adora alone.

She went to inform Scorpia that they would be leaving for the Fright Zone. "Come on Scorpia, let's go!" She ordered.

"Why would you want to go back there? We could like.. stay here." Scorpia tried to meagerly protest, but Scratch didn't care.

"We are leaving, and that's final!"

At the Brightmoon The Princess Alliance had begun to make plans to attack the Fright Zone, but now that Glimmer and Bow were back from their journey at Crimson Wastes things took a turn for the worst. Glimmer was panicking and ranting about how now that Horde has Adora and her sword they can open a portal that will destroy the whole Etheria.

"We have no time to lose! We need to get to the Fright Zone as soon as possible!" Glimmer demanded.

"Glimmer, I have no idea what you are on about! You need to slow down." Angella said.

"Don't you get it? The Horde has Adora, it will mean that they can open a portal!" Glimmer said. "So we must get there as soon as possible!"

"We are not going anywhere!." Angella said with a strict tone. "We can't just rush into the Fright Zone, we need a reasonable plan!"

But Mom!" Glimmer pleaded.

"No buts, we need to discuss this elsewhere." Angella said and pointed towards the doors. "Move, young lady!"

Meanwhile at the Fright Zone, inside of Hordak's chambers. Hordak was back at building the portal and alongside testing his new upgraded suit.

"That suit is perhaps my best invention ever.." Entrapta gushed. "Well.. this portal as well... but it still needs the key. If we were to open it now, it would be too unstable to get anyone through it."

"We just need to open the portal for a short time, just long enough to get the signal to Horde Prime" Hordak said. "Once he's received it, there should be no problem to open the portal on his side."

"And then you'd have to go with him..." Entrapta stated with a sad tone. "There is so much more data to be collected, we just keep building and experimenting on the portal until it's perfect."

Then Scratch arrived, dragging Adora in chains and threw her and her sword at the Hordak's and Entrapta's feets. When the sword was brought into the portal chamber, it started to cause shaking in other objects and began to mess with the electronic equipment. "Here, I got what you needed!" Scratch said. "That sword is the key to the whole planet."

"Ooh, that makes sense. It was made by the First Ones, so of course it would work." Entrapta exclaimed and she picked up the sword. "To imagine that this is the key we needed, to open the portal."

"So, what are you waiting for?!" Scratch asked with a demanding tone. "I brought everything you needed, so we can finish the rebellion for good."

Hordak and Entrapta looked at each other for a while. He gave an approving nod to Entrapta and they continued on their work with the portal.

Back at Brightmoon, Glimmer and her mother were arguing over what to do. Their arguing was like playing a broken record.

"I told you, we are wasting time! We need to get there!" Glimmer argued.

"And then what? How are you going to get in!? I'm not losing anymore lives!" Angella said. "You don't even have a proper plan! You just can't rush in!"

"Ohhoh, before I started rushing in, the rebellion hadn't made a move in years! You need me!"

"I need you to lead, not to rush headlessly into danger whenever you want!"

"Argh! What does it matter anyways?! You are always there just to tell me what not to do!" Glimmer yelled.

"I'm trying, I'm trying to reach you. You just never listen! I want to trust you!" Angella said and put hand on Glimmer's shoulder, only for her to brush it off.

"Oh, you're talking about trust?! You have never trusted me and you didn't even bother to tell me that my dad is gone, because of Darkith!"

Angella was taken aback, she did remember how she blamed Shadow Weaver and never blamed the real culprit. "Glimmer.."

"Oh you know what, we should maybe ask Darkith! She knows the Horde!"

"She can't be trusted!" Angella said.

"Well we have to do something! If only you weren't just cowering in your place from fear!"

That was enough, Angella wasn't going to take this bratty behavior anymore. "I am your queen and I order you not to do anything brash, either come up with a reasonable plan or stay out of the way!"

At the Fright Zone, Entrapta had connected the sword to the portal machine. "I have now managed to pass the planetary restrictions.. I just have no idea how it all works."

"Mhmm." Hordak nodded, but his attention was taken by Adora's muffled talking and useless tries to get herself untied. "Must she be here?"

"Good question. I don't know if the portal needs her as She-Ra or if the sword is enough." Entrapta answered, while rubbing her head with the sword.

Entrapta then took the gag off from Adora and asked. "You don't happen to know, do you?"

"No, and if I did.. I wouldn't tell you anything!" Adora snapped back and gave a sharp stare.

"That's okay, I prefer figuring things out on my own." Entrapta answered nonchalantly.

"Please, Entrapta. Don't do it." Adora pleaded.

"Silence!" Hordak yelled. "Entrapta, get back to work."

Adora gave a death stare towards Hordak and said with a deep voice. "You, you took me from my family! You lied to me who I was! You lied about everything!"

"I couldn't lie to you about who you are, I couldn't care less about something as insignificant as you." Hordak said.

"Well you should care! Because I'm going to be the one to make sure you fail!"

Hordak then turned around and yelled. "You have no power to stop me, I am going to use your sword to wipe out all of your friends and the whole rebellion!"

Then Hordaks armor began to malfunction and it caused him pain, he had to go on his knees. Entrapta tried to help him, but he just growled back. "Just make the portal work!"

He was going away for a moment, leaving Adora and Entrapta there. At that time, the sword began to swirl around and caused an even greater magnitude of electromagnetic interference. The sword viciously gravitated towards the keyhole near the portal and inserted itself in. Entrapta was mesmerized by that. "Wooow... it so that's how it works..."

Adora could only look as things unfolded before her, with a desperate look on her face.

Some time later as Entrapta was making fine tuning to the portal, Adora tried to once more convince Entrpata not to do it.

"Listen... I'm so sorry that we left you behind.. but we thought you died." Adora began to apologize.

"Scratch said you abandoned me." Entrapta said with a solemn tone as she worked on the portal.

"Scratch would say anything to get what she wants!"

"Scratch said that she is my friend." Entrapta said and proceeded to do some calculations. "Yes, the data suggests that we are friends.. I think so..."

"Listen.. Scratch used to be my friend as well.. a long time ago, but she makes bad decisions. This is one of them, if you open the portal, the Horde armies will come and it will be all over for Etheria Please, Entrapta.. you can't do it!" Adora desperately pleaded.

Entrapta didnt answer for a while, she just flung her hair towards the pillar where Adora was bound. She dragged herself closer to Adora and turned around. "Oh, but I can! Didn't you hear the thing about how the sword will activate the portal. I love the danger of experimenting! There's so many interesting things and its thrilling!" Entrapta gushed. "Think what we could find, planets, galaxies... things we can't understand!"

"But last She-Ra made sure that the portal could never be opened." Adora said. "If you open it now, it will destroy everything!"

"Well.. I have noticed some anomalies in my testing." Entrapta said as she went through her computer screens. "Maybe I should do more tests.. to be sure."

She then turned to look at Adora. "You won't try to escape now would you?"

"Uhhh.. no." Adora answered.

"Okay, great. Really appreciated." Entrapta answered cheerfully and went on her ways.

Meanwhile at Brightmoon, Glimmer and Bow were sneaking towards the room where Darkith was being held. They saw two guards guarding the entrance. "This is a bad idea and I don't like it at all." Bow said with a worried tone.

"It's not that bad.. alright, I know it's a terrible idea, but what other choice do we have?" Glimmer said.

"Glimmer, I know you want to save Adora, but to go for Darkith?" Bow asked with a concerned tone.

"It will be fine." Glimmer answered and grabbed Bow's hand, teleporting them in the room.

There, Catra and Darkith were both waiting for them. "Ahh, princess.. you came." Darkith said, faking a surprised tone. "I

must admit, I expected it to take more time for you to come see me."

"Which is why I and Darkith had a bet. Which I won since you came here." Catra said with a smug look on her face and gave a confident look at Darkith.

"Wait, you knew we were coming?" Bow asked.

"You I had no idea, but Glimmer-" Darkith was cut off by Catra. "Well it was obvious, since you are brash and stubborn." Catra gave a look at Glimmer.

"Ugh, we are wasting time!" Glimmer snapped. "Horde has Adora and her sword, they are going to open the portal."

"They have Adora?!" Darkith asked, a shocked look on her face. "And Hordak has finished the portal?"

"She was captured? Catra asked as well.

"Yes and now they are going to open the portal, so we need to act!" Glimmer yelled.

"Then we have no time to lose, we would never make it in time.. except.." Darkith said with a sudden change in her tone. "Unless you teleport us there."

"I don't like this.." Catra added.

"What?! I can't do that, I would run out of my magic before we would have reached halfway there!" Glimmer said.

"Unless, you allow me to connect to your runestone. I have managed to tap into runestone before. So I could enhance your powers." Darkith suggested.

"How can we trust you!? And you are not thinking about escaping?" Bow asked.

"I want to stop the Horde.. besides I would have nowhere to go anyways." Darkith answered.

"But would it work at all, I mean I am not strong!" Glimmer said.

"Oh, but you are. You are the daughter of a great sorcerer. I might not be the same as I used to be, but I know a powerful sorcerer when I see one." Darkith said with a flattering tone. "I could give you that power, there would be no problem for us to get there."

"Us?" Bow asked.

"Well.. I suppose you could come as well." Darkith answered an unbothered tone.

"I will come as well, you are not doing anything without me watching you." Catra said and asserted her dominance by tapping her staff on the floor.

"Of course you would..." Darkith muttered. "So, what do you say, princess?"

Glimmer broke the anti-magic barrier and released Darkith from her confinement. Darkith quickly stood up and took the lead. "Alright, let's not waste any time."

Meanwhile Shadow Weaver was recovering from her high fever, the medicine that Micah gave her was quite effective. Even if the Entity was so overly dramatic about it.

Micah came back to check on Shadow Weaver. "How are you doing?" He asked.

"Better, that medicine was quite something." Shadow Weaver answered with a raspy, but energetic tone. "You're quite the herbalist."

Micah was happy from the compliments, this reminded him about the Light Spinner he used to know. Even if she was strict, she still complimented when there was something to compliment. "Well, I learned from the best. You had quite the collection of books about herbalism."

"Oh, so after I had gone you just went and snooped on my things?" Shadow Weaver asked with an amused tone.

"Well.. Norwyn was going to throw all your studies and books away after the incident." Micah said. "After I left Mystacor, to be with Angella. I asked my sister to make sure your work wouldn't be thrown away."

"Hah, I knew that the council of fools would try to do something like that. It's sooo like them." Shadow Weaver huffed.

" *Argh! Stop with this lame conversation about the past! Something far more important is going on!* " Entity butted in.

"I never get a moment of peace from you.. now do I?" Shadow Weaver muttered silently.

" *No, you don't. There's something big going on, I can sense it. It has something to do with the Horde.* " Spell of Obtainment said.

"Of course Horde would do something, it's nothing new." Shadow Weaver said.

"Excuse me?" Micah asked. "Who are you talking to?"

"With an Entity.. sorry, the Entity always has to ruin my day.." Shadow Weaver answered.

" *Nooo, you can't just go blabbing about me to others! Its not the wayyyyy!* "

"Haa haa, I beg to differ!" Shadow Weaver said smugly.

"Uhh.. okay.. Well I'll come check on you later, see you later." Micah said and headed away.

Shadow Weaver sighed in deep. "He probably thinks I'm crazy.."

" *That is precisely the reason why you don't go and blabber about these things!* " Entity argued.

At the Brightmoon, Glimmer, Bow, Catra and Darkith had gathered around the runestone and Darkith had begun to draw the runes on the floor to get her access to the moonstone. Suddenly, the rest of the Princess Alliance arrived there. "What do you think you're doing?" Mermista asked as she appeared there with Frosta and Perfuma.

"Please, don't try to stop us! This is the only way to save Adora." Glimmer said as she summoned her staff and took a defensive stance.

"We're not going to stop you, we want to come with you." Perfuma said.

"You could do the whole,, *You can't come with us, it's too risky.* Thing." Mermista said and gave a smug smirk.

"Or you could just accept that we are coming with you, because we are!" Frosta said and punched her fists together.

Darkith let out a sigh. "With a large group we would be at disadvantage. I won't-" Darkith was cut off by Mermista, pointing at her. "Ugh, you are,we call the shots here. You gotta to make that thing bigger.. evil.. dark.. Horde Lady."

"Yeah, I thought you had learned that the hard way." Catra said, with a smirk.

" *Ugh... you people are insufferable...* " Darkith muttered to herself, but did as she was told to. What other choice she had.

Meanwhile Angella was going to Glimmer's room, to try to figure things out with her. But when she entered the room, she saw Glimmer was nowhere to be seen. She quickly went to the Darkith's holding room, only to notice that the barrier was gone and so was she. Realizing what was going on she began to fly as fast as she could.

At the Moonstone, Darkith had finished the runic circle and began to conjure magic. "Quickly now.." She said and encouraged everyone to enter the magic circle. She made a dark sigil and extended her hand through it and looked at Glimmer.

Angella was trying to get there as fast as she could, but it would be too late. Glimmer took the hand of Darkith and dark flames began to encircle them. Glimmer could feel the draining on her magic, but she also felt a lot stronger.

Angella was just about to reach the Moonstone. "Noooo, Glimmer!" She yelled.

Glimmer turned to look at her with a slightly worried look and with one single blast, they were gone. All that was left was the runic circle on the floor and Angella realized what had happened.

Chapter End Notes

Also, finally over 100k words. I never would have thought I would write something this long.

Portal Opens

Chapter Summary

As the Princess Alliance has finally reached the Fright Zone to stop the destruction of Etheria.
Question is, did they make it in time?

At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver gets a big brain plan and forces the Entity to show itself. What could possibly go wrong?

Chapter Notes

Oh yeah, its getting spicy.
Well I think we all know what the end results will be, but I still hope you will enjoy this.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At the Beast Island, Shadow Weaver had decided to get up from the bed. She didn't want to lay there, while doing nothing. Micah had done so much for her, so she should at least do something for him in return. Shadow Weaver doesn't want to be in debt to others.

" *Going somewhere?* " The Entity asked.

"Yes, I'm actually going to do something. I'm tired of being bedridden all the time." Shadow Weaver answered.

" *But, I might still be weak. I could get something worse than a fever. Shouldn't you think about* ***us*** *as a whole?* " Spell of Obtainment said.

"Then how are you then the most dangerous and most powerful entity there is, if you are afraid of a flue?" Shadow Weaver asked with a taunting and sarcastic tone. "Or did you just made all of that up?"

" *No I did not, I can prove you.* " Entity said, clearly Shadow Weaver got into its head. " *Remember the time I made you the crystal from that ancient runestone? I was taking a physical form then, I can do the same again.* "

"But didn't you just think that you were too weak to do anything like that?" Shadow Weaver asked and raised an eyebrow.

" *Ugh, fine I lied. I'm not weak! You are truly the worst person to ever be bound at!* " Spell of Obtainment said with a frustrated tone.

"That feeling is mutual." Shadow Weaver answered. This was kind of nostalgic to Shadow Weaver, this constant bickering and arguing. She shouldn't be enjoying it, but there was just something that wanted her to continue it. Maybe the main reason was that this "Interdimensional being, Entity", had the personality of a child who was never told "no".

" *Alright, I'll prove to you that I'm not weak. I'm going to take physical form to prove it.* " Entity said. " *I wouldn't want to admit this.. but that terrible medicine you made me drink... was actually pretty helpful. But- it's not I like-Agh, it's not anything special- or worth praising for.."*

"You don't have to beat the bushes, I know you have your reputation and ego to consider for." Shadow Weaver said with an amused tone.

Then the Entity began to take a physical form, it detached itself from Shadow Weaver's body and began to form. Entity couldn't take as humanoid form as it used to before, this one was more vague like and indefinable form of shadows and red eyes. Spell of Obtainment also managed to form hand like tendrils and there were a dozen of them. At one of the tendril-like hands were a mouth and others had red eyes with black cracked and X-shaped pupils. **"I don't like this from at all!"** Spell of Obtainment said with its echoing and distorted voice. **"It's so... formless... for a physical form.."**

The Entity now surrounded Shadow Weaver with its shadowy body and tendril like arms with sharp claws.

"I think that suits you well enough." Shadow Weaver said.

"Are you mocking my appearance? Are you judging me?!" Entity asked with a heated tone.

"Not at all, I just thought it suits you very well." Shadow Weaver answered.

Then if things would get anymore more complicated than they already were, Micah came back and was quite shocked by what he saw. "That.. that thing! It's from that spell all those years ago!" He yelled.

"Micah! Don't do anything brash, this entity is a bit shy." Shadow Weaver said, trying to calm the scared Micah.

"I had no idea it was a person!" Micah yelled. "I only thought it was just raw energy."

"You are a bit rude... to think I considered you as my best candidate. " Spell of Obtainment said, with a clear disapproval in its tone. To compare something as great as "it", to something like "raw energy" was insulting, if not even worse.

"It- it can talk?!"

"Yes, it can.." Shadow Weaver said and sighed in deep. "Can you now understand what I meant when I was referring to talking to someone... yeah.. it's quite complicated."

Micah observed Shadow Weaver and then the Entity and then Shadow Weaver again. It took a while for him to collect his mind, that baffled him.

He sat on a chair and took a deep breath. "Alright... I think I get it now.."

"You do?" Shadow Weaver asked with an hopeful tone.

"Yes.. to think all these years you were carrying..." Micah said and eyed the Entity. "That thing.."

"That thing? That thing?!" Spell of Obtainment bursted out loud. **"Excuse me, but I demand more respect. You are being very rude and judgemental.. Mister Micah! I'm not having any of this! I'm done, good day sir!"**

"Oh come on, don't go yet. You two could really talk to each other." Shadow Weaver jokingly suggested.

"Never, as I said.. Good day! To both of you!" Spell of Obtainment yelled and began to detransform and merged back into Shadow Weaver.

Then there was quietness, Micah and Shadow Weaver looked at each other for a while. Not saying anything, because this was something Micah would have never expected and Shadow Weaver didn't want to push on.

After a while of silence Micah said. "You are really something, Shadow Weaver.."

"Ehhh.. I agree, even if I don't like these circumstances that I have now." Shadow Weaver said. "I was actually thinking about doing something for you, for all that trouble you have gone for me."

"Hey, you don't need to push yourself anymore than you already have." Micah said with a concerned tone.

"Some tea won't hurt us." Shadow Weaver said with a nonchalant tone. "I've been brewing tea for so long that it's like a flick of a wrist."

"But there is no normal plants here and there is no telling if they are edible or not." Micah said with a worried and warning tone.

"Don't worry, I can always test feed them to the Entity. You have nothing to worry about." Shadow Weaver said, waving her arm and readying to go outside.

"Wha- you feed the Entity?" Micah asked with a confused tone, but by then Shadow Weaver had already left from the door. When Micah realized that, he quickly ran after her and picked up his staff. "At least have me to go with you!"

The Princess Alliance arrived at the Fright Zone, but they didn't reach Hordak's chambers. Instead they found themselves inside a storage room.

"For private chambers... I expected it to be.. something different." Perfuma said.

"Yeah, guess the designing isn't their strongest suit." Mermista confirmed and kicked a bucket.

"We aimed for Hordak's chambers, obviously we missed." Darkith said with a hint of annoyance in her voice. "Follow me and try to be quiet."

"I'm going to look for Shadow Weaver, so I leave you guys with it." Catra said and was about to run off.

"Weren't you supposed to keep an eye on me?" Darkith asked, raising her eyebrow.

"Listen, that's the only reason I came here. Is because of Shadow Weaver, I know none of you others care about her. So I have to do it" Catra answered.

"Then what about Adora?" Glimmer asked.

"Don't worry, I'll catch up with you." Catra answered and headed up into the ventilation shaft.

As they were about to leave, a door opened and a lizard lady appeared. Who knows what she was doing there, but there was an awkward silence between all of them.

Perfuma took a defensive stand and summoned vines. "Go, I'll hold her off!"

"This way!" Darkith said and pointed them at the other door.

Now they were running in the long hallway and were confronted by Lonnie and Roghelio. Two of them took a defensive stand and Lonnie pulled the lever to call for back ups.

Mermista stepped up and summoned water from the nearby sewers. "My turn, I didn't almost drown in these hallways just to lose."

She then conjured the water towards Lonnie and Roghelio.

"I wan't to join as well!" Frosta said and turned the water to ice so they could freeze them onto their place. But before they could rejoice, the back ups came just in time.

"Don't worry, we'll hold them off." Mermista said, smirking.

"Yeah, leave it to us!" Frosta added.

"Alright, follow me!" Darkith said and pointed towards the crossroads.

Meanwhile Catra was heading towards the prison cells. She jumped off from the ventilation and proceeded to head forwards, but there were Horde soldiers ahead of her.

"Hmph, one versus twenty.. this ain't going to be fair.." Catra said and sighed, but then gave a smug look. "For you!"

She then began using her staff as Castaspella had instructed her. By pressing a button and swinging the staff she could cast red slashes towards her enemies, they moved like projectiles and easily cut through the soldiers.

"Wow, this is so cool!" Catra gushed and saw more soldiers come at her. She then pressed one of the buttons on the bottom and struck the staff on the floor, releasing a shock wave that knocked down the soldiers.

Catra now had a clear path to the prison. "This.. is.. soo awesome!" She said and spinned her staff around. "Being a sorcerer is real fun!"

She then approached the prison and saw that there were hundreds of rows of prison cells, spiraling downwards. She looked around and saw one single guard coming towards her.

"Wait, don't attack me!" The male guardian called, while raising his hands up.

"If you value your life then tell me, where is Shadow Weaver?" Catra said with a threatening tone and pointed her staff at him.

"She's gone, she's not here anymore." The guard said.

Catra lowered her staff and asked his name.

"It's Kyle.. please I know nothing, other than that Scratch wanted to get rid of her. That's all I know." He said with a covering voice.

Catra had a dead look on her face, she showed no emotions. If what Kyle had told her were true, then what was the point of all of this. "I don't believe you! Where is her cell!?" She yelled and pointed her staff at Kyle's throat.

"Th-third floor.. cell number 120. Please don't hurt me!" Kyle pleaded with an frightened voice and kneeled before Catra.

Catra let out a sigh and said. "Then I suggest you run."

Kyle got up on his feet and ran off as fast as he could. Catra herself went towards the cell Kyle had told her and as she arrived there, she could see it was empty.

Catra broke the energy powered cell door and entered. She saw only empty chains, used a rune circle on the floor and scratched marks on the walls that indicated how many days it had been.

Catra fell onto her knees and dropped her staff. Tears began to stream down her cheeks and she recalled what Kyle had said.

" *Scratch wanted to get rid of her.. that's all I know..* "

Catra begin to slam her fists against the cell floor and cursed this whole situation. "Why!? Why doesn't things ever go well!? Why give me hope if there will not be any!?" She cried out loud.

But she couldn't stay like this. Adora had to be saved. She swiped her tears from her face, picked up the staff and stood up. That little hope she had that Shadow Weaver would be here was gone and now all she felt was rage. She did have one more person she cared for, but for now.. she had only one goal in her mind.

She is going to kill Scratch, no matter the cost.

Meanwhile at the other side of the Fright Zone, Darkith, Bow and Glimmer were running in the hallway, only to be confronted by Scratch.

"Yo, what the hell is going on-" Scratch cut herself off as she saw that Darkith was with the princess. "Darkith?!"

Darkith extended her hand towards Glimmer and she accepted. As they hold hands, Darkith could feel the magic rush through her.

"You're serioisly holding a hand with a princess!?" Scratch asked. "You're on the side of good now?"

"I wouldn't say that.. I'd say more like I have a common enemy." Darkith answered.

"So you saw all that trouble, to just come back here to be the hero!? How low can you even fall?!"

"I am no hero, I'll never be and I have never acclaimed so." Darkith answered with a stoic tone. "I am here to stop Hordak, either stand down or accept your fate."

"Heh, yeah right!" Scratch said and pulled her whip out.

"You stupid child..." Darkith muttered and blasted Scratch with a magic blast.

Bow then shot one of his net arrows and managed to get Scratch's whip off of her.

Darkith went closer to Scratch and grabbed her up with a dark magic and lifted her up. "It's futile to resist, you have no chances."

"After everything, you left me! You wanted to get away from me! You sent me away when I was a kid! And now you just came back for Adora, like you always would!" Scratch yelled with a desperate voice. "Why is Adora so important to you?!!"

"As I said, I came here to stop the Hordak and for that I need Adora.. I am not a hero.. far from it." Darkith said and tightened the grip. Darkith was draining too much magic from Glimmer and Bow had to step in. "Darkith, that's enough! You're draining her!"

Realizing this, Darkith loosening the grip and let Scratch to fall on the floor.

Then "Kyle", the goat horned lady came and picked Scratch up.

Scratch was resisting, but Kyle held her back. "Come on, they are too strong. You can't fight them!" She said and dragged Scratch off with her.

At the Entrapta's room, she and Scorpia were doing some testing and simulations about the portal. Although Scorpia didn't do much of anything, other than give her some parts.

"You know, it's so cool that you let me help you with all of this. I miss hanging out together, you have been busy with Hordak and Scratch.. well.." Scorpia said and gave her a scrap of metal, but Entrapta didn't seem to care. She was way too concentrated on the tests and simulations.

"Agh! This is not good!" Entrapta yelled as she went through the simulations with the same results.

"Oh, I understand. You want me to leave." Scorpia said with a sad tone. !I'm probably just on the way-" But Entrapta pulled Scorpia to her and said. "No it's not that, I meant just look at this."

Scorpia looked at the screen that showed the whole planet and what would happen to it. "Wow.. that is not good, do you mean that's what would happen if we opened the portal?"

"Oh Its going to be much worse, if my calculations are right and they are. The anomalies are going to create a mirror reality that's going to collapse on itself and erasing us from the existence!" Entrapta explained. "I can't believe I say this, but we can't open it."

Then Scratch came in with the goat horned lady. Scorpia went and greeted her, but was shun away by Scratch. "Agh, what are you doing here? WHy aren't you with Hordak to open the portal!?"

"We can't open it!" Entrapta said.

"What is that nonsense?!"

"Adora was right about the portal, we can't open it. It will destroy everything!"

"Adora.. Adora was right?!" Scratch asked, her eyes were twitching and she had tonal slashes. "So- she is right!? I don't

give a crap! Open that portal!"

"No we can't! I'll tell Hordak he will understand." Entrapta said and was about to rush out, only to be stunned unconscious by Scratch.

"Scratch... wha-what did you do!?" Scorpia asked with a worried tone.

Scratch looked at Entrapta and then the stun baton she had grabbed. She tried to process what she had done, but shrugged it quickly off. "Hurry, get rid of her!"

"How should I do it?" The goat horned lady asked.

"I don't know! Uhh.. send her to Beast Island! I don't care!" Scratch ordered.

"But, Beast Island. You know she can't surv-" Scorpia said, but couldn't finish her sentence. Scratch pointed her with the stun baton and had it active. "Do you want to be next?" She asked with a threatening tone.

Scorpia didn't say anything, she just had to accept what Scratch had done. She couldn't hur her "friend".

"We are going to open that portal."

At the portal chambers, Hordak was admiring the portal. "She got it working.." Hordak said.

Soon, Scratch ran inside the chambers and demanded to open the portal. "The princesses are here, we need to open the portal!"

"I need Entrapta, where is she?" Hordak asked.

Scratch thought for a second and got a great idea. "Hpmh, who do you think let the princesses inside."

"What? No.. she wouldn't.." Hordak said with a shocked tone. He slammed his fists on the control panel and groaned. He couldn't believe that Entrapta would betray him.

"You seriously thought she was on our side? You can't trust anyone!" Scratch said and eyed Adora. "Especially a princess. So what are you waiting for, open the portal and let's finish this once and for all!"

Hordak thought for a moment until he nodded in agreement. Just as he was about to pull the lever, Glimmer and Bow arrived with Darkith. Together Glimmer and Darkith blasted Scratch away with a magic and Bow shot towards Hordak, but he catched the arrow and snapped it in two.

"Bow, Glimmer! You came!" Adora yelled.

Scratch wiped her hair and saw Darkith was back here. Hordak proceeded to rip one of the pillars in the room and threw it at Adora's friends.

While holding their hands together, Glimmer and Darkith managed to stop the flying pillar and threw it against the wall. Whole room was shaking as pipes were falling down blocking their ways and all Hordak's test tubes were blowing. Only leaving Adora and Scratch with the vicinity of the lever that would activate the portal. "Scratch, don't do it!"

Scratch looked back and gave a satisfied smirk, she enjoyed seeing Adora suffering. As she was about to pull the lever, Catra jumped on her.

"Catra!" Adora yelled surprised and with relieved tone. Although the Catra who was now standing infront of her seemed to be totally different. She didn't look her usually smug or joyful self. Instead her face was stone cold and her stare had no life in it. "What did you do to Shadow Weaver?" She asked with a cold tone, but Scratch didn't answer. She only smiled. Catra had enough of this and pushed Scratch on the floor and took her claws out. She wasn't going to use her staff to kill Scratch, she would do it with her bare hands.

Catra began to claw and beat Scratch as hard she could, while Scratch was giving her a humorous look. "Did I hit you into a sore spot when I got rid of her?" Catra's beating turned more severe and it looked like Catra was on a feral frenzy, like a wild beast.

Adora looked horrified as her friend beat Scratch up. "Please Catra, snap out of it! It won't bring Shadow Weaver back!" Adora pleaded.

Catra snapped momentarily out of her rage when she heard Adora's pleas. She stopped what she was doing and looked at her hands. They were bloodied and she looked like a monster. Scratch obviously took her chances and kicked Catra off of her. Scratch unsheathed her sword and inflicted wounds on Catra's legs so she wouldn't get up.

Catra couldn't do much of anything else than yell in pain, while Scratch limped towards the lever. Adora was looking with a desperate look on her face as Scratch grabbed the lever. Scratch casted last look on Ador and said. "It will end, here and now. I don't care what will happen, all that matters is that you and that furry menace will lose and hopefully be destroyed!"

Then she pulled the lever, activating the portal and a bright flash filled the room as everyone looked in shock or horror. This is going to end everything.

Chapter End Notes

Oh wow, I don't know what I have done. This chapter might be the most rollercoaster of emotions...

I also thought a secondary way to conclude this chapter, by writing Scratch "Accidentally" making Catra to pull the lever, so then Catra would have been partly responsible for opening the portal. For the extra drama and her to notice that her violent ways will cause harm to others.

But I thought I won't be making that, too much drama and tension already. I'm still planning to have Catra realize that she cant solve her problems with violence and maybe she should get help for her anger issues.. even if those are rare for her, but when she goes feral... it will bring nothing good to anyone and especially for Catra herself.

Anyways, I hope this chapter was manageable. Until the next chapter.

Mirror World

Chapter Summary

> When the portal was opened, everything changed. Adora wakes up at the Fright Zone, not remembering much. Everything seems normal at first, but there is something seriously wrong.

Chapter Notes

> Another chapter out.. finally...

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora wakes up at the Fright Zone, she doesn't remember what had happened. She was confronted by Darkith.

"Ah, there you are. I've been looking for you, Adora." Darkith said with an unusually calm tone.

"What? You were looking for me?"

"What are you talking about? Of course I was looking for you." Darkith answered. "Yours and Scratch's latest achievements have earned both of you the title and place of Force Captains."

Darkith then took a box and opened it, giving Adora the Force Captains badge. "You two have earned them. your next mission will be explained at the briefing, so don't be late."

With that said and done, Darkith left Adora to stand in the hallway. Adora couldn't process what was going on. Since when was Darlkith proud of Scratch?

Adora looked outside from one of the hallway windows and saw cracks like glitches in the horizon. But before she could even blink her eyes, they were gone and all seemed normal once again.

"Something definitely isn't right here." Adora said to herself, she took a glance at her badge. Suddenly she could see flashes about her past, if that's what you could call it.

She headed to the briefing room and noticed all other force captains were there, except Scratch. She sat next to Scorpia who greeted her.

"Hi, name's Scorpia."

"Adora." She answered and noticed that Scorpia was inspecting her closer with a sharp look.

"I don't know what it is with you, but I don't like you. I just have this gut feeling, maybe it's that ridiculously big bun on your forehead... that makes your forehead look ridiculously big." Scorpia said.

"Alright, enough." Adora said with a slightly offended tone.

"And besides, what kind of name is Adora anyways? I mean I get it, everyone loves you.. but I do not."

"Good day Force Captains." The briefer said as he entered the room. "Due to our great success at Thaymore, the Horde is now in better place than ever before to take the rest of the Etheria."

The briefing went on and weirder things began to happen. When The Sea Gate of Salenias were shown on the screen and the princesses were mentioned, Adora got more flashes of her past. Flashes of other princesses and flashes of Bow and Glimmer, her friends.

At some point, somewhere a piece of paper was on her lap and as she opened it, it had one name; *Mara.*

"Okay, what is going on!?" Adora yelled and stood up from her seat.

"You got something to say, Force Captain Adora?" The briefer asked.

Adora was about to go crazy, she looked on the wall and the screen was gone. "Where's the screen?"

"Uhh, there's no screen. All the information is in your report." The briefer answered.

As Adora looked at her hands and saw the papers with her, she freaked out and threw the papers on the floor. She had to leave the briefing room and she left in a hurry.

She ran at the hallway only to see the hallway collapsing on itself, but it only seemed to be a hallucination. Adora couldn't understand anything. Flashes about the past, nothing here makes sense and tears in the fabric of reality.

Adora was going through a lot of things, one such thing was about a portal that was in Hordak's sanctum. Opening that portal would lead to catastrophe and somehow she had to stop it.

But then she ran into Scratch who was bossing other Horde soldiers around. As Adora saw her, flashes of Scratch came into her mind.

"Scratch! Do you have any idea what's going on?" Adora asked as she grabbed Scratch from her shoulder.

"What's going on? Nothing's going on, everything is fine." Scratch answered. She quickly switched her tone to more of an upbeat one. "See this?" Scratch pointed at her badge. "I was promoted, just like you. Isn't this awesome?"

"Sure, it is awesome and that finally you're getting recognition." Adora congratulated, but her tone still had worry in it.

"Are you alright?" Scratch asked.

"No I'm not!" Adora snapped. "Nothing here makes sense! I get memories of past things and then there is something in Hordak's sanctum and I need to fix it!"

Adora's ranting was off the charts and Scratch could get her memories as well, but she knew all the time that this world wasn't real. "Snap out of it Adora!"

"Out of what? Listen, I need to do something and if you don't remember or don't care, then I'll go by myself." Adora said and left in a hurry.

" *Ahh shit...she's going to ruin everything once again..* " Scratch thought to herself.

While Adora was starting to realize that something was wrong, at that same time Catra woke up in her bed.

She was in her room, she eyed the room and saw her staff on the wall. This was certainly weird, if she had her staff that would mean Shadow Weaver was gone, but also she was in her home that was destroyed. At least she had a distant hunch about that.

She stood up from her bed and headed outside of her room, at that moment Catra could smell the scent of Shadow Weaver's tea. She ran downstairs and into the kitchen, seeing Shadow Weaver making breakfast as usual.

"Oh, good morning Catra. Did you sleep well?" Shadow Weaver asked as she placed plates on the table.

Catra got sudden flashes of images about her and Shadow Weaver eating breakfast together. Catra got a weird feeling about this, but ignored her instincts. "Yes, I did sleep well. How about you?"

"As usual.. I don't sleep much.." Shadow Weaver answered. "But don't worry about me, I'm quite fine."

Then Spell of Obtained took a physical form and manifested next to Shadow Weaver. The Entity took a humanoid shape, mimicking Shadow Weaver's shape.

"Oh, my.. tea time." Entity said. **"I hope you have at least brewed decent tea this time.."**

"Stop being so picky, it is good tea." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Better be, or I will-" Entity was cut off by Shadow Weaver, who stuffed toast in the Entity's mouth. "Just shut up and eat a sandwich."

Catra was baffled, usually the Entity had an negative effect on Shadow Weaver. Now it seemed like they had some sort of "frenemies" kind of relationship. Something certainly was not right.

They sat on the porch in the front yard garden and began to enjoy their morning tea.

This was quite awkward, drinking tea with the otherwordy entity, like it would have been normal. Catra took a look at the Whispering Woods and saw cracks in the reality. Though they were only flashes and were gone in a heartbeat.

"Did you see that?" Catra asked.

"Did I see what?" Shadow Weaver asked back.

"Something isn't right." Catra said and then she got flashes of past events, Scratch standing next to a lever and something about a portal opening.

"Agh, what is going on!?" Catra yelled as she held her head with her hands.

Shadow Weaver took notice and went quickly to comfort Catra. "Listen, it's alright-"

"No, its not!" Catra said. "There are things that happened, I remember some of them, but nothing makes sense!"

Then once again, Catra could see the world shatter like glass and now it was even closer than before. But it was gone in seconds and nothing was there.

This time the Spell of Obtainment took notice of this, being an interdimensional entity, these sorts of things weren't a new thing. **"I think I know what's going on."** Entity said.

"Did you see those same things as well?" Catra asked.

"What things?" Shadow Weaver asked, confused.

"The tears in reality.. though this isn't a normal world." Spell of Obtainment said. **"Now that I think of it.. I tried to warn you about this.. Shadow Weaver.."**

"Alright, time out!" Shadow Weaver said. "I have no idea what's going on!"

"Of course you don't.." Entity sighed. **"We are in a mirrored world.. it's a fake world, you could say. And it will collapse on itself since someone or something broke the rules of the known world."**

"Not to be rude.. but what the hell does that mean? You aren't making any sense." Shadow Weaver said.

"Shadow Weaver.. the Entity has a point.." Catra said.

"Well said, listen to the furball.." Spell of Obtainment said with a smug tone. **"In a simple way, Etheria is locked in a pocket dimension and someone had to do something like open up a portal. This would lead into creation of an mirrored world that would collapse on itself."**

"Still doesn't make sense." Shadow Weaver said.

"We were supposed to stop a portal from opening!" Catra said she then got flashes of Adora tied at the pillar and the portal. Then there was a flash of Scratch, standing near the lever that would lead to the opening of the portal.

"Shadow Weaver, Spell of Obtainment is right. I remember that we tried to stop Hordak from opening the portal.. but we failed.."

"Well...is there anything to be done?" Shadow Weaver asked with a worried tone. "Are we going to perish in this fake world?"

"Well.. I can't perish... I just wouldn't have a host anymore and no, I don't wanna spend another millenia to look for another." Entity said.

"It has something to do with She-Ra and the sword.." Catra said as she got more flashes of her and Adora together. "I'm sorry, but I have to go!"

"Wait! Where are you even going?" Shadow Weaver yelled.

Catra stopped in her place and turned to look at Shadow Weaver, she walked up to her and hugged her. "As much I desire this to be true, it just can't be. You are merely mirror of something that could have been." Catra had tears streaming from her eyes, as the memories of the empty prison cell in the Fright Zone came ever clearer.

"But I would never forgive myself if I now would leave Adora on her own." Flashes of the moment when she and Adora made that

promise to each other, came into her mind. "We promised to look after eachother, so I have to go!"

Catra then ran in the Whispering Woods, towards the Fright Zone. Shadow Weaver stood there and now she could remember her past as well. She now understood why Catra would think that she was only of something that could have been. Shame that she couldn't remember earlier.. since she in fact was alive.. but how could Catra know that. Now it was too late and the tears in reality catched up and engulfed Shadow Weaver, the Entity and her whole house.

Adora was running towards the Whispering Woods, as the whole Fright Zone had fallen into nothingness. She had met with Madam Razz before the collapse of Fright Zone. Madame Razz insisted that Adora still had time, she just would have to go back to the beginning. Which Adora didn't understand, she was at the same place she found the sword. So what could have Madame Razz meant? Adora got sudden memories of Catra, she remembered that Catra lived here in Whispering Woods. She needed Catra's help.

Before Adora could really get going, she could hear the sound of speeder coming towards her. It was Scratch, she was not going to let Adora ruin this.

Adora quickly evaded the speeder, jumping aside on the ground as Scratch jumped off from it, taking her sword out and pointing it towards Adora. "Well.. I knew it had to come to this.."

"What? You said you didn't know anything!" Adora yelled as she was getting up from the ground.

"Ugh! Obviously I was lying, I didn't want you to screw everything up once again, but here we are!" Scratch said with an annoyed tone. "We could have been on good terms finally, but no.. you always have to ruin things!"

"What's the point if we all are going to die, I don't know what or why you're so up on about us? We were on good terms when we were kids." Adora said.

"Yes and it's been too long since that, do you have any idea what I did go through when Darkith sent me to the correction camp? Of course you don't, you never have!" Scratch ranted, all of her pent up rage. "Because Darkith favored you, it has to be this way..."

"Well whatever changed you there, by now you have ruined every chance of making things better." Adora said. "I believe anyone can change, even you."

Scratch looked at Adora's eyes, she could see the sincerity in it. Adora really thought there would be hope for her. At that moment it looked like Scratch would have had a change of heart, but it all went into a drain when a twisted smirk grew on her face. "Oh Adora... you are so naive.."

Scratch then raised her sword and charged towards Adora, who had no weapons with her. Adora closed her eyes and was prepared for the worst, but it was not the end. She could hear a loud clang, Adora cautiously opened her eyes and saw none other than Catra standing there, blocking Scratch’s sword with her staff. Realizing that her friend had come for her made her relieved and puzzled. "Catra?"

"Oh, hey Adora." Catra said, with a smile on her face as she looked at Adora.

"You.. do you remember me?" Adora asked.

"Of course I do dummy, we made a promise.. and I never break my promises." Catra said with a confident tone.

"This is impossible! How could you be here?!" Scratch yelled and redrew her sword. "Shouldn't you be dead or something!?"

"Oh.. that's not like me. I can't be dying when my help is needed." Catra answered with a smug look on her face and took on a defensive stand. She turned to look at Adora once more and said. "Don't worry, I'll protect you."

"You know... you are not clever with your punchlines!" Scratch said and charged towards Catra once again.

Catra easily reflected Scratch's sword swing. "You could really use some more training with your sword." Catra said with a mocking tone.

"You are the most annoying and irritating furball ever to set foot on Etheria! You know that?" Scratch tried to come back with something, she was so pissed and all she wanted was to make a fur coat off of her.

"And I wouldn't want it to be any other way." Catra answered.

Scratch had enough, she began to furiously swing her sword at Catra, who just deflected all her swings. Spinning her staff around and striking at Scratch when she was open. Adora just watched as the two went on.

"AAARGH! Why wont you get hit?" Scratch yelled furiously.

"Skill issue." Catra smirked.

As their never ending duel went on, the tears in reality catched up on them. "Catra, we need to go to Brightmoon, right now! We don't have much time!" Adora yelled as the ground started to shake and crack beneath them.

"You might be right." Catra answered and swiftly disarmed Scratch and dropped her on her knees. "Okay, let's go!"

"Wait! You are just leaving me here!?" Scratch yelled as was now powerless to do anything.

"Uhh.. yeah." Catra answered. "Besides, if we succeed, you will be just fine."

"I hate the idea of that.." Scratch muttered.

Then the ground opened and began to swallow the forest, Scratch fell into the void as Adora and Catra escaped. They took the Horde speeder that Scratch had used and got on to it. Adora took the driver's seat while Catra grabbed her waist.

"Uhh, you do know how to use this, right?" Catra asked with a shaky voice.

"Relax, I was trained to use these in the Horde." Adora answered nonchalantly. She didn't tell Catra that it was in fact a lie, she had never used the speeders since pre-training. "Now what was the gas pedal again?" Adora asked herself.

"So you don't know how to?!" Catra gulped.

"It can't be that hard." Adora answered and stepped on the gas. They speeded away way too fast for Catra's liking. Besides boats, she now hated speeders as well.

At the cracks of the void, Scratch still hadn't fully gone. Half of her was corrupted, but she was still very much alive. She had held on to the tree root and pulled herself back on the surface.

Chapter End Notes

I'm sorry that I can't finish the season within this chapter. I'm lazy and at some point I had to remember that this story is from the point of view of Catra and Shadow Weaver, but at this point Adora has come way too important to be at the sidelines. So do expect more Adora as an protagonist role from this chapter onwards.

I had to cut a lot of things, because there's so much going on. But I'm sure most of you know already what happened at Fright Zone, I just changed the parts that were needed to.

Anyways, I hope this chpater makes sense and I hope I can finish the next chapter a lot sooner. Also, I changed the description of this story to be moredescriptive of this story.

Sacrifice

Chapter Summary

Adora and Catra have to race against the time to stop the reality from collapsing.

Chapter Notes

Yeah, about to getting this chapter out sooner?
Total BS.. Took me way too long once again.

At least its finally here!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra and Adora were speeding through the Whispering Woods, they had to reach Brightmoon and convince Glimmer to help them.

Adora crashed the speeder when wasn't paying attention and both of them flew on the ground.

"Agh! I'm alright." Adora said as she recovered. "How about you?"

Catra rubbed her knees and wiped dust off from herself. "This is the last time I get on with a speeder... or let you drive."

"It wasn't that bad. Besides, we have reached the edge of the woods. So I'd say it went fine." Adora explained, trying to downplay her bad driving skills. "Now we just need to get to Glimmer."

"Uhh.. and how exactly are we going to do that?" Catra asked. "They probably won't know us and we would seem like intruders."

"You worry too much, you need to have more faith in your friends." Adora said. "Also, trust me. If things go south, we'll just improvise."

"I guess so.." Catra said. "So, what's your plan?"

Catra and Adora tried to sneak into the Brightmoon, but got caught almost immediately. Guards restrained them and brought them into the throne room.

Queen Angella and King Micah were both informed about the situation.

Catra and Adora were now in the throne room and waiting for the king and queen.

"This was your master plan?" Catra questioned with a smug tone, since she knew Adora's plan was flawed. And she enjoyed being right.

"I think there are more important matters at hand right now than my master plan..." Adora answered.

"I know.." Catra said and smirked. "Just play it cool, don't panic, be hysterical or anything like that when you explain.."

"I got it, don't worry." Adora answered.

Then Angella and Micah arrived in the throne room and were ready to question these trespassers.

"Now, tell me.. who are you and why did you break into Brightmoon?" Micah asked.

"Well.. it's kind of a long story aaand it's going to sound a bit crazy.." Adora said as she rolled her head. "But I assure you it's the truth.

"I will cast a truth spell to be sure you won't lie." Micah said and swiftly drew two circles and placed them on Adora and Catra. "Now that you're under the influence of the truth spell, you are obliged to speak the truth."

"Well, there was this thing called Horde that tried to take over Etheria, but you can't remember it because it kinda got destroyed.. There was this portal that opened and it kinda screwed over reality and.. the portal worked with a sword that could turn me into an 8ft tall warrior lady, so we really are in a hurry. Soon there will be nothing left, so please let us speak with Bow and Glimmer, I need their help to stop the world collapsing!"

Angella, Micah and Catra all just stared at Adora with dumbfounded looks on their faces. It was an awkward silence and none of them knew how to respond.

Then Angella broke the silence. "Okay, enough! How do you know about my daughter and royal apprentice historian!?"

"He's a historian here?.. It doesn't matter... we're best friends." Adora tried to plead.

" *Yeah.. not a crazy at all...* " Catra thought to herself.

"I uhh... have never seen you before." Micah said.

"Well that's because normally you would be-" Adora realized what she was about to say.. "dead.."

Adora and Catra were both pointed with swords and the captain questioned them. "Are you threatening the king?!"

Angella put her hands protectively over Micah and snapped. "How dare you say such thing?!"

"Way to go Adora.." Catra said as she had a sword pointed at her throat.

Adora only gave a dismissive look and pushed the sword away. "I'm sorry.. but none of this is right! You must have noticed it. Wh-what did you do yesterday? There's a reason you can't remember, this world is not real."

Angella just couldn't believe what she had heard. "I have heard quite enough!" She said as she was about to leave with a frustrated expression on her face.

Micah grabbed her hand and tried to calm her nerves. "Angella, it's alright."

"Please I need to talk to Bow and Glimmer, they are the strongest people I'll know. I need their help to stop reality from falling apart!"

Catra rolled her eyes and sighed. " *Ugh, you forgot* me..."

"Guards, escort these two to our holding cell!" Micah ordered.

Guard looked gave each other a confused look, they didn't have cells in Brightmoon.

Micah sighed deeply and grumbled. "The spare room..."

Guards understood perfectly and began to move Catra and Adora to the "holding cell". Adora tried one last time to plead with the king and the queen. "Wait, you have to believe!"

"Don't listen to her, she's lying." Micah said and looked at Angella.

"But your truth spell." Angella questioned.

"I.. uhh I must have done it wrong.." Micah answered. "There's no way anything she said could be true, it's just not possible."

At the Brightmoons holding cell, Adora and Catra were now pondering what to do. Since Adora's plan had failed.

"Well that went great." Catra said nonchalantly and threw herself on a soft pillow. "You just had to go with the crazy route."

"Oh I'm sorry, I thought you were okay with my plan! And besides, what would you have said? Huh!? Any better ideas?" Adora questioned with a frustration in her tone.

"Realx, I was just joking.." Catra said and raised her hands up. "You are a literal trainwreck of emotions."

"Well excuse me, but this whole world is about to be destroyed and all of us alongside it. So I can't just relax and think like nothing's wrong at all. The things I've already encountered." Adora ranted.

"Hey, I get it." Catra said and put hands on Adora's shoulders. "You must feel terrible, but you can't do anything if your state of mind is like a wrecked train. Just take a deep breath, stop for a moment and let it out."

"Nope, it doesn't help!" Adora yelled after realizing that breathing deeply didn't help. "This is the end!"

"Then just yell, don't even say anything, just let out pure yell." Catra suggested while shaking Adora. "Come on, pure yelling, 1 2 3 go!"

"AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAARRRRRRRGGGGGHHHHHHH!" Adora let out a long and loud yell, so loud that it even bent Catra's hair backwards.

"You done? Feel any better?" Catra asked.

"Actually.. it did help.. a lot.. how did you know it would help?" Adora asked, now with a lot more relaxed tone.

"Just a hunch, they don't call me magicat without a reason." Catra said with a smug smile on her face, winking her eyebrows and poking Adora with her shoulder. "So, now that you have calmed down a bit-" But before Catra could finish her sentence, Glimmer and Bow barged in.

Adora was happy to see her friends once again and casually approached them. "Bow, Glimmer-" But she was shortly cut off by Glimmer raising her fists and having ready to blast some magic. Catra pulled Adora back a little. " *Remember, they don't know you.* " Catra said quietly into Adora's ear.

Adora let out a sigh. "I know..."

"Hey, listen here, stranger! My dad has never messed up a spell, so you must have spoken the truth. But how can that be?" Glimmer questioned.

"Of course you've been listening in... I should have known." Adora said with a relieved tone.

"Would you stop acting like you know us! We have never met you!" Bow said.

"Yes we have, Bow you saved our lives more than I can count. You're a great fighter, a genius inventor and you shouldn't worry what your dads think. They are proud of you, just like I am." Adora explained. "And Glimmer, you never give up, you never admit defeat. I know making friends is hard for you, but you're the one who pulled all of this together. I've never met anyone like you."

Adora's deep explanations resonated with Bow and Glimmer, but neither of them could really accept that all of this was true. Catra on the other hand was yawning, she found these kinds of explanations boring and pointless.

"I still can't believe that all of it is true!" Glimmer yelled. "I'm just a princess and Bow isn't a fighter.. he's Bow."

Then Bow felt something, something that made him realize what was happening. "None of this is right, I mean everything is perfect.. everyone keeps saying it's perfect."

Moments later Glimmer got flashbacks of looking at the memorial of her father. Realizing this made Glimmer cry. "My dad... he's.. gone.. isn't he.."

Adora sighed in deep and with a heavy tone she answered. "Yes.. he is.. I'm sorry Glimmer."

But when they were trying to comfort Glimmer, the castle started to shake and they could hear loud explosions outside.

"What is going on?!" Bow asked, scared and confused.

"It's starting to happen here as well.." Adora answered and looked outside of the window, seeing how reality was shattering before their eyes.

"Yeah, you took all that time with those trivial things! If you can now see what is going on, we better hurry!" Catra stated.

"And who are you?" Glimmer asked.

"Seriously? You just now noticed me?!" Catra asked. "Well we don't have time for any introductions, but the name is Catra."

"Uh-huh..."

"So what do we do now?" Bow asked.

"We fix reality, somehow." Adora answered.

"Well.. how should we do it?" Bow kept asking.

"I have no idea." Adora answered with a confident tone.

"Uhh.. you did mention something about a portal. Do you.. have anyone who knows something about them." As Bow had finished his sentence, he had flashbacks of Entrapta. "Entrapta.."

"That's right, Entrapta knows." Adora answered. "Glimmer you need to teleport ua to Dryl."

"What? I barely got Bow and myself here." Glimmer said.

"Don't worry, we'll improvise." Adora said.

"Oh boy.. here we go again.." Catra sighed.

"1 2 3 Go!" Adora yelled and pulled both Glimmer and Bow from their hands, Catra following them on their tail.

"Is this how we improvise?!" Bow yelled as they ran in the hallways.

"Yeah. Come on, we don't have much time left." Adora answered.

"Well I don't like this at all!"

They reached the end of the hallway, but it was a dead end. "Impossible, there used to be a door." Glimmer said.

"Get away from my daughter!" They heard Angella's voice calling them. As they turned around, Angella stood there with Micah.

Glimmer decided to stand her ground. "No, mother! We have to do this, can't you see what's happening?!"

Angella looked at them.

"I'm sorry mom, for everything." Glimmer said.

Then Angella got flashes of the past, her time with Glimmer. She knew this wasn't real, but it was too late. The ground below Glimmer and others cracked open and the walls started to crumble.

Adora, Bow Catra and Glimmer fell through the floor, right into Dryl. Catra being at the bottom lost her consciousness as others fell on top of her.

"Oh, hello there." Entrapta answered.

Angella was standing on top of the platform that held the moonstone, looking around as the world around her was collapsing. Micah came next to her and put his hand on her shoulder. "Don't worry Angie, we'll get them back and then everything will be perfect.."

But Angella knew this wasn't real. She turned to look at Micah and held his hands. "This is perfect, but its not real." Angella said with a solemn tone. "I remember now. I miss you so much, but Glimmer needs my help and I can't stay with nothing but memories."

"Angella.. I-" Micah tried to say with a plagent tone.

"Goodbye Micah." Angella bid her farewell, spread her wings and took up a flight.

Micha, still standing on the platform, finally came to the same realization as others. "Angella, Angella wait, I'm not-" But it was too late, Angella was already far away and Brightmoon crumbled into the void.

Back at Dryl, Entrapta was serving her new guests with tea and small snacks. "This is fascinating, I've never had non-robots visit me before. It's usually me and my friends." She said and grabbed a drink. "Aren't they amazing?"

"Friends?" Adora quietly asked.

"Yeah and the best part is, if they break, I can just make new friends." Entrapta answered as her robot servant brought them different kinds of components on a tray. "Tiny snacks?"

All three of them just shook their heads.

"Oh, right.. they are still learning the non-robot food thing.. unless that's what you eat!" Entrapta exclaimed and pulled up a recorder. "Ohh, you have to tell me everything!"

Adora pushed the recorder away. "Entrapta, I know what I'm going to say is crazy, but-" She was interrupted by Entrapta. "Is this about the unstable portal that's slowly warping and consuming our reality?"

"You're not going to believe- hey wait, what did you just say?" Adora interrupted herself.

"Oh I figured it out while ago." Entrapta answered while working on her computer. "An unstable portal is the only thing that could cause all the anomalies I've been picking up. The portal exists somewhere in our world and as long as it's open, it keeps growing and destabilizing our reality and making things disappear faster

and faster until there's nothing left, erasing us from existence! HAHAHA!... That's bad thing tho..."

"How do we stop it?" Adora asked.

"Portals are gateways, wormholes that connect one place or area to another. The only way to turn it off is from inside, but whoever shuts the portal down, can't leave. They'll be trapped between the realities, possibly forever... Ouuhhh imagine the data they could collect!"

"Wait, so whoever shuts it off would be trapped inside of it forever?" Glimmer asked with a worried tone.

"Exactly."

"There must be another way." Adora said. "Try to remember Entrapta, when you and Hordak build the portal."

As Adora reminded her about Hordak, she began to remember and got flashes of the past. She was working with Hordak. "I.. I remember now.. I had a lab partner.. Hordak.. we were friends and then Scratch.." Entrpata said. "I remember everything now.. I'm not really here.."

Suddenly the room started to shake, walls and the floor began to crack. "No, it can't be happening here already. We should have had more time!" Adora panicked.

"There's no more time... it all makes sense now." Entrapta pondered. "It-It's your sword. That portal is centered around you, it's following you."

"What!?" Adora said with disbelief.

"Ehh so.. what did I miss." Catra asked. She had finally woken up and was rubbing her head. "It seems this place is gone soon as well.."

Then Entrapta began to disappear. Adora quickly rushed towards her. "Nooo!" She tried to grab her but it was in vain.

"You need to take the sword from the portal, powering it from the inside. As soon as it's gone, everything will be right again." Entrapta gave them a faint smile and with a melancholy tone she finished. "It was nice being friends with you."

"Entrapta!" Adora yelled.

And with a blink of an eye, they were flashed off from the Dryl. At the front of the crystal castle.

"Uhh where are we?" Glimmer asked.

"We're at the.. crystal castle.." Adora answered and as she looked up at the sky, she could see stars.

"Woow.. I've never seen stars before." Carta said, amazed.

"What's happening?" Glimmer asked.

"It's what Entrapta said, the reality is warping faster and faster..." Adora said and looked at the castle. She saw Mara standing there.. "It can't be.." But before they could say anything, the castle alongside Mara was gone.

They now looked at the bright beam in front of them, rising above the clouds. "I uhh.. Stay here. Entrapta said the portal was set around me, so if I go alone.. you would be safe." Adora said and was about to walk into the beam. Then Glimmer grabbed her hand. "No! I know what you're thinking, Adora. You said you knew us, well.. we know you."

As Glimmer said that, Adora got her flashes of past together.

"You can't relax to save your life. You're terrible at acting." Bow said and grabbed her other hand.

"You are stubborn, headstrong and... you're our best friend!" Glimmer said with tears streaming down her cheeks. But as she had said that, both of them began to disappear. Adora had tears streaming and she tried to hold on to them. "No.. NOO!"

"You got this Adora, we believe in you." Glimmer said as she smiled melancholy and then they were gone.

Adora fell on her knees as desperation consumed her and she began to cry.

"Uhh.. Adora, I'm still here." Catra said.

"Wait.. how?!"

"How indeed..." Scratch's distorted voice called as she crept from the shadows. "Hey Adoooraa... and that vermin who calls herself Catra..."

"But you fell!" Adora yelled.

"My death was.. greatly exaggerated.." Scratch answered, but before she could do anything Catra jumped on her and dragged her on the ground.

"Adora, what are you waiting for?! GO!" Catra yelled as she held Scratch.

"You vermin! I'll make a fur coat out of you!" Scratch cursed. "When I get out of here, I'll make sure you regret everything!"

"Yeah, yeah!" Catra mocked and punched Scratch in the face.

"Catra!" Adora yelled, trying to reach out to her.

"Just go! Save the world! We'll meet at the otherside, it's a promise.." Catra said as she shed a single tear. "Alright Let's get down to business!" She then pulled herself and Scratch off the edge into the void.

Adora was left to stand on the cracking scrap of the ground that was still left, but it didn't take long until she had no chance to get away. She herself fell down into the void and was beginning to disappear. She readied herself for the worst, until she heard a voice calling her. "Adora!"

That caught her attention and she looked back and saw Angella flying towards her. "I'm coming, Adora!"

Angella grabbed Adora swiftly and pulled them onto a small piece of floating land in the middle of the void. "Adora.. I remember everything, this isn't our world. So how do we stop this?"

Adora looked above them and Angella followed in suit. There was her sword, in the middle of an all consuming spiral. "The beginning..." Adora remembered. Razz meant her beginning. "It's the portal I came through.. I can fix everything, I just need to go into the portal and pull out the sword. That'll turn it off and everyone will come back.. safe and sound."

"And you come back safe and sound too? Right?" Angella asked with a concerned tone.

Adora looked away and didn't answer. "Adora, you come back as well, right?" Angella repeated herself and put her hand on Adoraäs shoulders.

"I have to do this.. this is my destiny.." Adora answered.

"Oh Adora, this is not it." Angella said and pulled Adora into a gentle hug.

"But, this is the only way to fix things.." Adora said.

"Do you wanna know a secret?" Angella asked with a gentle tone. "I.. am a coward."

"What? No!"

"I always stayed behind.. Micah was the brave one.. and then Glimmer.. oh Glimmer, so much like her father... and once again I stayed behind. Letting her make the hard choices, letting her be brave.. for me.." Angella said with a sorrowful tone and deep sigh. "I told myself I was being responsible, but Adora.. I was just scared.. and then I met you. You inspired us, you inspired me. Not because of your destiny, but because you never let fear stop you."

Angella placed her hands once again on Adora's shoulders, comforting her. "And now I choose to be brave." She said and gave Adora a goodbye kiss on her forehead. She then began to fly towards the sword inside the portal.

"Wha- NO! Your majesty! Angellaaa!" Adora yelled from below.

It was too late to turn back, Angella took one last look at Adora. "Take care of eachother.." She said with a faint smile on her face. She pulled the sword away and with a flash of light she was gone and the sword fell on the piece of land, right at the feets of Adora.

She picked the sword up and wiped her tears away, now was not time for that. "For the honor of Gray Skull!" She yelled and raised the sword, returning her back to the time before the portal activated.

Everyone appeared back into Hordak's chambers, confused about what the heck was going on. Scratch lying on the floor feeling like she had been choked out of existence. Catra herself was on the floor as well and couldn't move, because of the injuries on her legs.

Before anyone could do anything, the portal activated and the room was filled with bright light. From the light arrived She-Ra and she shattered the portal into pieces, causing the room to fall into disarray.

Scratch quickly got up on her feets and pulled Hordak from his hand. "We got to go, Now!"

Hordak reluctantly complied and fled away, Scratch took one look behind and saw She-Ra staring right into her soul. That look was something she had never seen and it sent shivers through her spine. She was covered in fear, but did not want to show it. She backed away slowly.

"Adora!" Bow and Glimmer yelled relieved and ran to hug Adora. "See, we knew you could do it." Glimmer said while tears of joy were streaming down her cheek.

"Yeah, I knew you could do it Adora." Catra said while still lying on the ground. "Would you mind lending a hand here?"

"As touching as this is, but we need to go! Now!" Darkith interrupted and offered her hand to Glimmer.

Adora was confused about the situation and a little bit scared, but Bow reassured her it was fine.

As Glimmer took Darkith's hand, her power increased once more and they teleported away from the Fright Zone. Right back to Brightmoon, safe and soundly.

When realizing they all were there safely, they began to cheer. Perfuma even hugged Darkith, which made her really uncomfortable. Catra could only clap her hand as she was still on the floor.

"WooWee! Although I'm going to be grounded for the rest of my life.. reality has been saved!" Glimmer exclaimed with joy. "Speaking of which. I should go see my mom, maybe she's so happy about it she'll forget grounding me."

When Adora heard that, she froze still. Slowly turning towards Glimmer, with a gloomy look on her face.

"Adora, what is it?" Glimmer asked.

Taking a deep breath and heavy sigh, she turned back to Adora and went to hug Glimmer. There was a silent pause before she

could say anything. "She.. Angella... She stayed behind... she saved us.."

Glimmer was heartbroken when hearing this.

"I'm so sorry.." Adora said.

They all had a silent group hug as they mourned now passed Angella. Catra, still on the floor, couldn't join in the hug, she wanted to remind them about her situation, but decided against it . Maybe it's just best to keep her mouth shut.

Chapter End Notes

Meanwhile, somewhere at the outer space, on a large screen popped the portrait of Hordak. A sinister smile grew on a face of mysterious figure. "So that's where you've been.. little brother." Revealing huge armada of space ships and motehr ship, sourrounded by dozens of destroyed planets.

Coronation

Chapter Summary

> After losing Angella to worlds between worlds, Glimmer now has to take mantle as a new Queen of Brightmoon. It's a bleak time for the Princess Alliance, yet the small glimpse of hope remains.
> At Fright Zone, Hordak grants Scratch free hands on how to operate. SInce both Entrapta's betrayal and the failed portal had struck him down.

Chapter Notes

> This chapter came out alot faster than the two previous chapters. I'm quite satisfied.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

It was a bleak and rainy day at Brightmoon, there has been a tragedy. As the former Queen Angella has presumably fallen, Brightmoon will still need a leader and Glimmer has to hesitantly take on the mantle of the new queen. Glimmer was sitting in her room going through all of these things that now were put onto her. Luckily for her, Castaspella had come to Brightmoon to help with Glimmer's coronation and give guidance.

"Aunt Casta... I just can't.. I don't want to." Glimmer said and tossed the list of the preparations.

"Glimmer, dear.. I know this is hard for you, but Brightmoon is in a dire situation." Castapsella said.

"But isn't there a council or something that could take control? Why does it have to be me?"

"I fear that most of the council has crumbled away by this point.. and this is quite unusual situation." Castaspella explained. "And..

you are the queen's daughter, so the crown automatically passes to you."

Glimmer let out a deep, exhausted sigh. "I get it, but I just feel I'm not ready to take on this kind of responsibility.. I'm not like my mother.. and I know I'm brash and reckless, so.."

"I know it might feel like that, but I assure you that you will make a great queen. With the help of your friends and guidance, I'm sure you will make it." Castaspella comforted and put her hand on Glimmer's shoulder. "Why don't we go look for the royal cape that you'll be wearing during the ceremony.. maybe it will lift up your mood."

Glimmer nodded in response and picked up the list.

Meanwhile at the infirmary, Catra was laying on her back on a bed and watched the tall ceiling. She was thinking about all the things that had happened and especially about the whole portal incident. She felt guilty for not stopping the portal, which led to the loss of the queen. Then a door opened and Adora came into the room, gaining Catra's interest.

"Hey Catra, how are you doing?" Adora asked and sat onto the chair next to the bed.

"Better.. I guess..." Catra answered.

"Is something bothering you?"

"N-No..." Catra answered and turned her head away. She tried to avoid Adora's eye contact.

"Catra?" Adora pressed on. "You know you can tell me."

Catra was looking out of the window and thinking if she should tell. After some grunting and hand shaking, she decided it was

best to tell her. "Agh, fine! Adora, I feel guilty about the whole portal incident and what it led to."

"What? But it wasn't your fault."

"But it was.. I let the anger take me over, I was so focused on revenge that I lost the focus of the real goal.." Catra said with a tone filled with regret and maybe even self-loathing. "I brought only misery on everyone."

"Catra, I don't quite understand-" But Adora was cut off.

"No Adora, let me tell you something, I'm quite selfish... Only reason I came with others was to get Shadow Weaver back. B-but when I realized that s-she was gone and when Scratch taunted me.. I-I just.. lost control." Catra explained while stuttering on her words and having tonal lashes.

"Usually, I've been calming others down.. b-but I CAN'T calm myself! Now Glimmer's mother is gone and she has to take on duties she clearly is not ready for.."

"Catra.. just slow down and take it easy. We all do mistakes, we all do something that we regret." Adora said calmly and took on Catra's hand. "But we can't keep dwelling on those failures forever, otherwise we lose the important things."

"And what are those important things?" Catra huffed and turned her head away. Even letting out a small sneeze.

"That there is good out there, there's hope and it keeps you going." Adora explained. "If we don't.. then we are doomed to fail and we can't blame anyone else but ourselves for that."

Catra was thinking about what Adora had just told her. Maybe she shouldn't dwell on the misery and despair. Maybe there was some hope that Shadow Weaver would be alive, she wouldn't let herself get killed without a fight.

Catra sighed and turned to look at Adora once again, this time she had a much brighter smile on her face. "Heh, I guess you're right.." She said and poked Adora gently with her elbow. "When my legs get better, I promise that I will do everything I can to help you.."

"That's good to hear, just take all the time you need to get healed and don't force yourself out of bed." Adora said with a gentle smile on her face and was about to leave, but was stopped by Catra grabbing her arm tightly.

This stopped Adora and she turned to look back at Catra. "Adora.. please.. stay for a while, it gets lonely here." Catra said with a faint voice. She was actually quite embarrassed by this and it took alot from her to ask this.

"Sure I can stay." Adora answered with a gentle tone and sat back on the chair, while holding Catra's hand. There they were, Catra laying on a bed and Adora sitting next to her. It was total silence, neither of them spoke at all. All that mattered was that they were there.

Only when Catra had fallen asleep, Adora left the room and quietly closed the door behind her.

At the Fright Zone, Hordak was sitting on the rubble of the destroyed portal. Looking around with sadness and frustration. All that work for nothing. If Horde Prime didn't reach his message, then it all would have been in vain.

After a while, Scratch entered the room. "Lord Hordak, with all due respect. We should be pressing on the Rebellion." She said as she saluted. "Brightmoon lost their queen, so they must be demoralized right now."

"Scratch!" Hordak said with a growling voice. "It will take time to resupply the troops and make more bots. As we are speaking right now, we do not have enough resources for the offensive."

"But Lord Hordak, we can't let this moment slip away. I'll do it myself if I have to." Scratch said.

"Do whatever you see fit.. I have work to do.." Hordak said and put his hand above the crystal piece on his armor. Then he walked away slowly, grumbling something to himself.

When Hordak was gone, Scratch was beyond excited. Finally, she could have free hands to do as she pleased. She decided to go to meet Scorpia and tell her about this.

Scorpia had been tasked by Scratch to get rid of everything that used to belong to Entrapta.

Scorpia wasn't pleased by this task and did it as slowly as she could. At times, she thought that maybe it wasn't that bad. On the other hand.. Scratch had threatened her as well. "Oh what am I going to do?!" Scorpia let out a plea.

Which the Emily the bot answered, but before Scorpia could say anything she heard steps coming towards her and Scratch's voice calling her.

"Quick, hide. She'll tear you into pieces." Scorpia warned and shushed Emily away.

"Scorpia, guess what." Scratch said with an unusually excited tone.

"Heheh.. what?" Scorpia asked.

Scratch's happy mood faded quickly when she saw Entrapta's stuff still being around. "Didn't I tell you to get rid of all these things!?"

"W-well yeah, b-but it's been k-kind of hard.." Scorpia stuttered awkwardly.

"Kind of hard? KIND OF HARD?!" Scratch repeated with a louder voice. "Entrapta was a traitor, she got what traitors deserve!"

"Bu-but Scratch-" But Scorpia was quickly cut off by Scratch's sword pointed at her neck. "There is no buts.." Scratch growled with a low tone. "Hordak gave me free hands on how to operate from now on, which means I'm technically in charge. So don't make me angry or disappoint me any further and don't even bother with Entrapta.. Are We Clear?"

"Y-yes.. C-commander S-scratch." Scorpia answered as she sweated nervously.

"Good." Scratch said and took the sword off from her throat. She was now leaving the room and taking a last look around. "Oh and like I told you earlier.. get this trash off here as soon as possible."

"Yes... Scratch..." Scorpia muttered silently and utterly defeated she fell onto her knees. "Alright.. you can come out now.."

Emily beeb'd in response and came to Scorpia. Scorpia gently pat Emily's head.. if you could call it that. "Don't worry, I won't let her hurt you."

Meanwhile at Brightmoon, Glimmer's coronation was being planned. Castaspella was the head director and overseer of the preparations.

It was a hectic time for everyone, especially for Glimmer who had now learned that she has a quest to finish as well.

"A quest!? I have to do a quest, which also includes witnesses?!" Glimmer huffed. "How am I ever going to manage that?!"

"Excuse me, Glimmer.." Adora said as she entered Glimmer's room. "Is everything alright?"

"Oh, Adora.. No, nothings alright." Glimmer answered. "Did you know that the coronation requires a quest?"

"No.. I did not, but I'm sure it can't be that bad." Adora tried to calm down Glimmer.

"Heheh.. yeah, it can't be that bad.. only that I have so many things to do and somehow I'm supposed to be the new queen of Brightmoon!" Glimmer vented, she was a nervous wreck.

That reminded Adora about what Catra had told her back in the mirror world. "Hey Glimmer.. you are a literal trainwreck of emotions.. you can't think clearly if you're a wreck."

"And what is that supposed to mean?" Glimmer asked. "I am going through alot."

"Have you tried yelling?" Adora suggested.

"Yelling? Why would I?" Glimmer asked, a little bit confused.

"Well.. it can help pretty well, you just have to try."

"But what am I yelling for? Who am I yelling? To you?" Glimmer questioned further.

"No-one.. just yell as much as you need to, from the bottom of your lungs." Adora answered.

"Fine.. I'll try it.." Glimmer said and took a deep breath. "AAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAAHHHHHHHHHHHHhhhhhhh!"

Adora was quite taken by the sheer volume of Glimmer's voice. "Yeah.. that's pretty good yelling. Now tell me, do you feel better?"

Glimmer stood there for a while and actually felt her stress levels lower and getting her mind alot clearer. "Wow... It actually helped.. I feel lot better now, thanks."

"You're welcome." Adora answered and smiled.

Then the door opened and Catra walked inside. "Nock, nock.." She said.

"Oh Catra, you're up." Glimmer said. "Feeling better?"

"Yep, feeling better than ever before." Catra answered and stretched her arms, back and legs. "I just happened to walk past and noticed loud yelling coming from here. So I decided to check it out."

"Heh, I was just helping Glimmer to relieve stress." Adora answered.

"Yeah, I feel alot better now that I got to let out all that pent up energy." Glimmer said.

"That's good to hear." Catra said. "It seems there's alot going around at Brightmoon."

"Yeah.. the preparations for the coronation have been quite nerve and time consuming.. I have to manage from a some sort of quest as well." Glimmer answered and sighed. "Maybe I'll go talk to Castaspella about it. Oh and by the way Catra, what do you think of my coronation dress?"

"It looks really good on you, though I myself can't stand dresses.. so I'm not sure how much my words mean." Catra said and rubbed the back of her head.

"No worries, anyways I'm going to see Castapsella. Hopefully she hasn't wrecked herself by now." Glimmer said and walked towards the door. "And.. you two can do whatever you see fit.. maybe you have some ideas for the main event."

Then Glimmer walked off the room and went to look for Castaspella, leaving Catra and Adora there by themselves.

"So, what now?" Catra asked.

"Other princesses are going to help with preparations as well.. we could go check on them." Adora suggested.

"Sure, why not." Catra answered.

As they walked through the hallways, they came upon a sight that they weren't expecting. Darkith was walking in the hallway, while escorted by two guards. She didn't seem to have any handcuffs or anything like that. Both Adora and Catra were a bit alarmed.

"Oh no need to fear my dears, I am here as a guest here." Darkith said with a faked sweet tone. "Please send my best regards to Queen Glimmer."

"I don't need to do anything you ask." Adora snapped.

"Whatever.. I hope you are still close, since power changes people you know.. like it changed me.. and like it changed Shadow Weaver." Darkith said and eyed Catra while having a faint smirk on her face.

"Don't you dare to speak about her!" Catra snapped and soon was basically at Darkith's throat. "If you want to die so badly, then why don't you just say so!" Catra was growling and ready to claw

at Darkith, but luckily Adora was there to pull her off before the guards did.

"Come on Catra, she's not worth it." Adora said and pulled Catra. "You don't want to get into trouble, right?"

Catra realized that she was once again out of control, but regained it after Adora dragged her away. "Y-yeah.. you're right.." Catra said and gulped. " *That was close once again.* "

Adora took Catra with her and gave one last look at Darkith and said; "And just so you know, Glimmer is a good person. She won't change."

As two of them were now gone, Darkith said quietly; "For your sake, I hope that you are right.."

"Thanks Adora, I was once again getting out of hand.." Catra said while her hands trembled. "Who knows what I would have done if you weren't there."

"Catra, it's okay. She was deliberately trying to get under your skin." Adora said put hand on Catra's shoulder.

"Yeah.. I know." Catra sighed. "I don't know what should I do about Shadow Weaver.. is she still alive should I hang on to a hope or should I accept the fact that she most likely is.. gone.."

"No one can know for sure, but what I gathered about her. She wouldn't be the type of person to just give up." Adora comforted me. "I'm sure she's out there somewhere and one day she or us will find her."

"Thanks.. that means a lot to me, but are you sure others would agree to even search for her." Catra said. "I mean, she has a rather conflicted past with the others."

"I'm sure they wouldn't mind. People change, you know, I don't see any reason why they would refuse." Adora said.

"Guess you're right." Catra answered.

Back at Beast Island, Shadow Weaver and Micah were thinking about the things that had happened.

"I can't believe we were in some sort of alternative reality.." Shadow Weaver said. "I never knew that was even possible."

"You are too small brained to understand it." Entity said to her. The Entity itself had also manifested with a physical body and both Micah and Shadow Weaver couldn't care less.

"And you are too cryptid about everything." Shadow Weaver muttered.

"I'm an entity, what did you expect from me?"

"Oh I don't know.. maybe like clear knowledge that is beyond our comprehension or something like that , but noooo instead you waste all of our time by being so vague and dare I say.. useless." Shadow Weaver said, gritting her teeth.

"I just regret it took me too long to realize that we were in a different dimension..." Micah said and sighed. "It was too late to tell Angella that I was alive by then.."

"Same.. I was late as well.. didn't have time to tell Catra as well." Shadow Weaver muttered.

Both of them slammed their foreheads on the table and just laid there. Both of them had a hard time comprehending their stupidness.

"Is it just me, or are both of you running on with a one and same brain cell that takes turns within those brains of yours?"

"Oh, piss off!" Both Micah and Shadow Weaver snapped at the entity.

This only further confirmed the entity's idea that that both of them actually were using only one brain cell that took turns. ***"You two are so lost causes..."***

"Hey, why don't you do something useful for once." Shadow Weaver suggested with a bitter tone. "Like you are interdimensional being, so you can you like travel to other continents with ease?"

"What are you suggesting with that?" Spell of Obtainment asked. ***"Of course I can. That's easy, barely an inconvenience."***

"Then why don't you like to take both of us back to the mainland? Huh?" Shadow Weaver suggested.

"I said that I can travel, not that I could carry others.." Entity argued.

"So you admit that you aren't as powerful as you claim to be?" Shadow Weaver suggested with a smug tone.

"Shadow Weaver.. I don't think it's a good idea to annoy the entity.." Micah said with a slight worry in his tone.

"Don't worry, I've done this countless times.. It actually like it when I argue with it." Shadow Weaver assured Micah.

"You sure?" He asked.

"One hundred percent."

"Excuse me, but I am as strong as I claim to be! It's just that we entities have our own set of rules which we are bound by." Spell of Obtainment said with a clear offense in its tone.

"Then what about if you made a smaller copy of you and sent it towards the mainland to get some help. So we could actually have a chance to get away from here." Shadow Weaver said.

"Well yeah, I can make smaller copies of myself and control them, but there are few problems with your idea. First, that sounds stupid. Second, who would listen to me or even believe me?"

"Tha- that is a good point though.." Shadow Weaver said and slammed her head once again on the table. "Guess we are back to square one.."

"Please stop hitting your head on the table.. I live inside of you and that damages my interiors.." Entity said with a concerned tone.

"Your interior?" Shadow Weaver asked and raised an eyebrow. "So you admit it's not even mine anymore?"

"Precisely.. I thought you knew that already.."

"Maybe.. but does it look like I care?"

Then Micah stood up from the bench and headed towards the door. "You two can continue your arguing, but I'm going for a lookout. Maybe I'll find something to eat as well." Micah said and picked up his staff from the wall.

"And look for some edible herbal plants." Shadow Weaver suggested.

"Will do." Micah answered and left the Entity and Shadow Weaver with themselves.

"Great, you made him go away.. with your pointless arguing.. Well done." Entity scolded her.

"So now you scold me, like you would be my parent or something?" Shadow Weaver asked with a sarcastic tone. "You ever thought about just pissing off if you're not being helpful?"

"Shadow Weaver, we have gone over these same things over and over again.. do you think something will change?"

"Maybe, if you wouldn't always be so insufferable." Shadow Weaver mocked.

"You are insufferable. literally the worst host ever..."

"Glad we agree with something at least.."

At Brightmoon, it was a clear evening and guests from all over from different kingdoms had arrived to the coronation. Castaspella stood in front of the great waterfall with Bow and Adora, waiting for Glimmer to start her quest. Glimmer sighed in deep and took steps towards the waterfall.

Castaspella took out a scroll and began to read it. "We are gathered here today, to witness the crowning of Queen Glimmer

of Brightmoon. As she starts the quest of queens and begins her reign as our new leader. She will be accompanied by two witnesses, Master Archer Bow and Adora, She-Ra, Princess of Power."

Mernista stepped out from the crowd and used her powers to open a pathway to a secret tunnel that leads into the Chamber of Queens.

"Let the light guide you and go forth with peace and safety, to emerge as Queen of Brightmoon." Castaspella finished reading the scroll, and bowed before Glimmer.

Glimmer, Bow and Adora stepped inside the tunnel as the waterfall closed behind them. Now all the others needed to do was to wait for Glimmer to succeed in her quest.

Castaspella ordered everyone to finish up with the preparations. Frosta had made a beautiful statue from ice that portrayed both Queen Angella and Queen Glimmer. Probably one of the most magnificent thing ever to seen at Brightmoon.

Catra however didn't know exactly what to do. She was asked to be a witness alongside Adora, but she refused. She didn't see herself fit or worthy of such honor. Catra saw Castaspella standing by herself and she looked quite satisfied with all the preparations. " *Maybe I could bother her for a while..* " Catra thought to herself and approached the Head-Sorceress.

"Umm.. Excuse me Castaspella, do you have a moment?" Catra asked and pulled lightly from her sleeve.

"Oh Catra, of course I have time." Castaspella answered. "It's good to see you, hope you're doing well."

"Oh.. well.. yeah I'm quite fine.. but..." Catra tried to talk as straightforwardly as she could but she just couldn't.

"IS something bothering you?" Castaspella asked with a slightly concerned tone. "You know, you can always tell me."

"Well you see.. I actually talked about this with Adora earlier, but.. I just can't get over the things that have happened lately and.. and I'm quite afraid of myself..." Catra explained with a slight stuttering in her words. "It has something to do with that uncontrollable rage of mine.. i-it has brought lot of problems for me lately.."

"I see.." Castaspella said. "Is it impulsive rage or is there something that triggers it?"

"Usually it's triggered.. when mentioning.." Catra took a deep breath and sighed. "Shadow Weaver.."

"I can see that she still is a sore spot for you." Castaspella said. "And understandably so, she was like a mother to you."

"Yeah.. I just wish.. that there was a way to get her back or at least to see if she's still alive.." Catra said.

"Well.. I think I could arrange something like that." Castaspella said. "I'm the Head-Sorcerer of Mystacor and I'm sure we have all we need to locate someone or confirm if said person is still alive."

"Oh really? You do?" Catra asked with a hopeful tone. "I have to know."

"Easy there, why don't we go visit Mystacor after the coronation and see what we can do." Castaspella suggested.

"Absolutely, I couldn't ask anything else." Catra answered.

Then the Moonstone began to vibrate and there came Glimmer, Bow and Adora.

"Looks like they finished the quest without problems." Castaspella said with a relieved tone and went to greet the new queen.

When Glimmer saw the throne room and the grand statue of her and her mother, she was quite taken back. "Oh wow.. this is amazing."

Mermista, Frosta and Pefruma went to greet Glimmer as well. "Yeah, we wanted it to be perfect." Frosta said.

"So we worked together." Perfuma added.

"Yeah, that was my idea." Mermista added with a smirk.

"I couldn't have asked for something more perfect than this." Glimmer said.

Then Castaspella tapped on Glimmer's shoulder. "Queen Glimmer, it is time." She said and showed the way towards the throne.

Glimmer nodded in agreement. As she walked towards the throne, she could see all other people bowing before her or nodding their heads. Catra showed her a thumbs up as she walked past by her, which Glimmer faintly smiled as an answer.

As she was now standing in front of the throne, she turned to look at the people and took a deep breath. She had to give at least a convincing speech.

"I'm here today.. because Queen Angella, my mother.. sacrificed herself to save Etheria." Glimmer started her speech. "We can't let her bravery be in vain, but there's still so much we need to do. Hordak is still in power and we know there's an even larger Horde army out there somewhere. "We cant let them win, it's time to take back our home! Together, we will push out the Horde, Once and for all!"

The crowd answered with overwhelming support and cheers as their new queen had spoken. Maybe there was a way out of this bleak situation. For now, the hope had been rekindled.

Chapter End Notes

I decided to differ quite alot from actual epsiode in this chapter. I wanted it to be a bit somber with slight comedy to levitate the heaviness and keeping up the hope.
This was probably the first proper Adora/Catra moment..
Also, SW and the Entity are back with their constant petty bickering.

This might be a little bit late, but.. Happy New Year to everyone!

Prepare for Trouble and Make it Double

Chapter Summary

> The newly crowned queen Glimmer had came up with a plan to retrieve Mara's ship from the Crimson Waste's, so The Rebellion could use it for their advantage. Surely she has everything planned out.
>
> At Fright Zone, Scratch thinks its time to seek new ways to defeat The Rebellion. One such thing is to hire a mercenery. Enter Double Trouble, truly a one of a kind. They will do anything, if they are paid enough.

Chapter Notes

> Took me almost 2 months to finish this chapter.. no I won't promise I will get more chapters done faster since I already said something about getting chapters done faster in earlier one...
>
> Hopefully you enjoy this.
>
> Also, Double Trouble could be summarised by this: "I was business"them", doing business."

Queen Glimmer has come up with a great plan, sadly Catra won't be on it this time. She has gone to the Mystacor with Castaspella, hopefully everything will be fine.

Adora, Bow and Huntara were sitting in one of the smaller war rooms, since Glimmer had told them to wait for her there.

Adora didn't exactly know what Glimmer was planning but apparently it was important.

Soon after, Glimmer teleported there with Mermista and began to explain her plan.

"So the plan is that you, Bow, Huntara, Mermista and Catra go to Crimson Waste. To retrieve the Mara's ship. It will surely be a great asset for our efforts and it would be out of the Horde's hands." Glimmer finished explaining her plan, but noticed that Catra wasn't here. "Uhh.. where's Catra?"

"She's at Mystacor." Adora answered. "She and Castaspella were going to do something that has something to do with Shadow Weaver.."

"Ahha.. well then it's just you four." Glimmer said.

Mermista hadn't even noticed that she had been brought from Salinas to Brightmoon. She didn't care much.

"If we are going to go to Crimson Waste, then why bring Mermista." Adora questioned.

"Well she could move the ship with her powers." Glimmer answered.

"In a middle of desert?" Adora asked. "There's no water sources anywhere near that place."

"Ooh.. right.." Glimmer said to herself. "That's a good point. Well anyways wait here, I'll be right back." Then she teleported away with Mermista.

"Is she going to do a lot of that?" Huntara asked.

"She's definitely going to do more of that." Adora answered and sighed in deep.

Glimmer then teleported back, now she had dragged Perfuma alongside with her. Perfuma herself wasn't that thrilled about going to Crimson Waste, especially since her morning meditations were interrupted.

"Now you can move the ship with her controlling the plants.. Anyways, I need to go now. There's a defense meeting so.. umm..

good luck." Glimmer said and teleported off.

"Well.. she's energetic at least." Huntara said.

"Yeah.."

At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver was waiting for Micah to return. She was brewing some tea and trying to come up with new potions.

" *I can't believe you are just brewing tea and potions.. shouldn't you try to find a way out of here? Or maybe something that could enhance your power?* " Entity talked to her.

"I've given up on the idea of finding a way out of this accursed island.. at least you can't consume Etheria from here." Shadow Weaver replied dismissively.

" *You can't be serious.. but why... it's not like you to give up so easily.* "

"Look where all of my efforts led me... I'm stuck on the worst island possible and I'm hosting an Entity, who's killing me slowly and can't find a way out of this island either.."

" *I- um.. Ofcourse I can find a way out of here. You are wrong if you think I couldn't.. just wait and see how wrong you are.* " Spell of Obtainment said to her and went away. Probably trying to actually find a way out of here.

" *It's good that the Entity has such an ego..* " Shadow Weaver amusedly thought to herself.

A moment later, Micah came back and he seemed exhausted. He was panting heavily and he seemed kind of frightened.

"Is everything okay?" Shadow Weaver asked as she turned to look at Micah.

"Ye-yeah.. let.. me breath for a moment.." Micah said. He took a deep breath and calmed his nerves. "I've never seen something like that before.."

"What do you mean?" Shadow Weaver asked and offered Micah some tea to help him to relax. "Was it some kind of monster?"

"No, more like a girl.. riding on a mechanical monster.." Micah explained. "She had long twin tails and she stole all the food I had collected."

"Interesting.." Shadow Weaver said. "You didn't try to fight her?"

"No, I've never encountered mechanical beasts that can be controlled."

"But Horde had tanks.. you've encountered those."

"It was different from those, it was much larger and more nimble than a tank.. I'm just saying, we should be on guard." Micah said.

Shadow Weaver nodded in agreement and headed back towards her brewings. "Well, I guess we'll be on a tea diet for today."

"You aren't worried about any of this?" Micah questioned. "Food I collected was stolen and there's a girl who can control a mechanical beast."

"Nope, not even slightly." Shadow Weaver answered nonchalantly. "I'm pretty sure that girl is harmless."

"How are you so sure?"

"Just a hunch." Shadow Weaver said. "Now, sit down with me and have some more tea."

Micah looked at her with a confused look on his face. How could she be so chill about all this? There was no point to continue on with this topic, at most Shadow Weaver would give an sarcastic or nonchalant answer anyways. So Micah just sighed and went to sit next to her and asked for a second filling for his mug.

"It's not bad to relax from time to time." Shadow Weaver said. "Like, you are always so tense and on edge about everything."

"What? It's just normal, healthy self preservation." Micah said with a pouty face. "Unlike you, I value my own life.

"Ha! That was a good one!" Shadow Weaver said loudly and laughed.

At that moment Micah realized he had said something he shouldn't have said, but Shadow Weaver didn't seem to be bothered.

Micah sniffed his drink and noticed it had a strong smell. Like in those strong alcoholic drinks. "Hey, Shadow Weaver?"

"Yeah? ~hiccup~ What is it?" Shadow Weaver asked, seemingly totally drunk.

"What did you put on these drinks?"

"Uh.. ahh.. ~hiccup~ Something.. you can check the ingredients on the table."

Micah stood up and went to look at the ingredients and came to a conclusion. She had managed to turn the tea into a strong alcoholic drink, by using different kinds of herbs and leaves and mixing them together.

"Seriously?!" Micah said and turned to look at Shadow Weaver who had now fallen into a deep sleep and was snoring. "You clearly have no self preservation instincts."

But the only answer he could get was snoring. Micah sighed and put his cup on the table. " *Great, now I have to carry her upstairs..* " He thought to himself.

Catra was in Castaspella's office, waiting for her to come back. She had said she needed to get some things before they could start. Catra still didn't quite like being in Mystacor, something just felt off about the place.

But before Catra could think any further, Castaspella came back with some books, a vase, crystal dust and bowl of water. "Sorry, it took me a while to gather all these things."

"There's no need to apologize, do you need help?" Catra answered and jumped off the table, lending her hand to Castaspella.

"That would be delightful." Castaspella said and handed the books to Catra. "You're so helpful and kind."

"About kindness.. I don't know.. but Shadow Weaver always said it's important to be polite and to be as useful as you can." Catra said.

"Alright. Well now that we have all the things we need, we get to the fun part." Castaspella exclaimed with excitement.

"And that is?" Catra questioned.

"Studying and reading these books, since I have no slightest idea how this works." Castaspella said confidently.

"Uhm.. yeah.. whatever.." Catra mumbled.

"Oh by the way, do you have anything personal from Shadow Weaver?" Castaspella asked.

"Uhh.. yeah I do.. Why do you ask?" Catra asked and took Shadow Weaver's strapped mask from her hip.

"Good, because we are going to need that." Castaspella answered. "Here, take this book and let's start." She threw one of the books at Catra, who swiftly caught it.

"Ahhahh.. more reading.."

At the Fright Zone, Scratch was going through new ways on how to defeat the rebellion. She had suggested hiring mercenaries.

"Scorpia, I've put mercenaries for hire and maybe someone will answer." Scratch said.

"Mercenaries, really?" Scorpia asked. "I wouldn't say they are trustworthy."

"If you have money, they will do anything and we have lots of money." Scratch said. "If I can't flail that furball.. then maybe some mercenary will."

"I'm starting to feel you have something personal going on. Would you like to talk about it?" Scorpia suggested. Sure they were trying to defeat the rebellion, but to flail someone? Hopefully it was only figuratively.

"Listen, I don't need your worry and I have no need to talk to you!" Scratch snapped. "Stop trying to pretend that we are friends.. we are co-workers at best..."

"I know.." Scorpia said and sighed with a defeated tone.

"I'm going to my office, please take these to the shredder." Scratch said and handed a Scorpia box full of documents and reports from both Entrapta and Darkith.

"Yes Scratch." Scorpia answered and took the box.

Scratch was now sitting inside her office and had laid more papers on the desk. Cursing the fact that Horde required so much paperwork.

As she was ready to rip all the papers into pieces her office door opened and Scorpia came in. Except this time she had a different feel. She felt a lot more assertive.

"Sup, Scratch."

"Uhh.. that was faster than expected.." Scratch answered. "Did you really get rid of it all?"

"Meh, there were a lot of free hands. So l let them do it."

Then Scorpia came into office as well. "Hey Scratch, I got rid of all of those.. papers..." Scorpia said as she saw her doppelganger. "Wait.. who are you? My long lost twin sister? No... I don't have one.. maybe Hordak cloned me or.."

Scratch couldn't believe her eyes. Great two Scorpia's.. what could be worse. "Who are you?" Scratch asked and pushed the "fake" Scorpia against the wall.

Only for her to change into Scratch.

"Okay, stop this right now!" Scratch said and drew her sword out, pointing it towards her doppelganger. "Scorpia, get some handcuffs. And don't you dare to move even an inch or I'll slit your throat."

"Wh-oah, easy there." Scratch's doppelganger answered as Scorpia put handcuffs on her.

"This feels really weird.." Scorpia said to herself.

"Now, stop this facade and show your true self!" Scratch commanded.

"Fine.. if you insist.." Her doppelganger answered and changed into a form of blue greenish elf-like lizard, with long blonde hair and black leather attire.

"Is that what you really look like?" Scratch questioned and lowered her sword.

"More or less, name's Double Trouble." They answered. "I couldn't help, but notice that you had put mercenaries for hire.. so I decided to pick one up. Did you enjoy my first impressions?"

"So.. you can shapeshift into others. That could be pretty handy."

"Oh please, it's much more than changing into others. It's all about performance and getting into the characters." Double Trouble answered.

"Ugh whatever... I take it that you are the most skilled of your kind?" Scratch asked.

"Well.. I sure liked to be." They answered.

"Well in that case, you seem perfect for my plans." Scratch said. "You need to break up the Princess Alliance and especially Catra."

"Ouuh, the more the merrier. I'm quite interested." Double Trouble answered. "I expect good pay, since I'm going to mess up some royals."

"And you will be paid, but you really need to get rid of Catra. She's the most sharp one of the bunch." Scratch said with a venomous tone.

Double Trouble noticed that Scratch clearly had something personal against Catra, which made them more interested. "Sounds like you have a grudge against someone."

I do and if you get rid of Catra I'll pay thrice the normal amount."

Double Trouble's glimmered with shine, all that money to be gained and the performance of a lifetime. " *Double Trouble and the Tragedy of Princess Alliance.* " That sounded really good.

"You got yourself a deal." They answered.

"Good, I'll free you from the handcuff-" But Scratch was interrupted by Double Trouble raising up their hands and dropping the cuffs on the floor.

"Wha- How?"

"I have a talent for getting out of tight spots." Double Trouble answered.

"Even better... Well I expect us to become great business partners." Scratch said had offered Double Trouble her hand.

"Likewise." They answered and shook her hand. "It's just good business."

Then one of the Horde soldiers arrived at the same room, looking for Scratch. "Scratch, we have rebel activity at the Valley of the Lost!"

When hearing this, a wide smirk crept on Scratch's face and she looked at Double Trouble. "Well, it seems like you got your first job."

Meanwhile at the Valley of the Lost, Adora, Bow, Huntara and Perfuma were hiding from the Horde. Huntara's acquaintance had backstabbed them by reporting the Horde of their presence. Glimmer contacted them and was pissed about Bow hanging her off last time, Bow assured it was because they had to hide from the Horde. He also explained that Horde had taken Mara's ship, but Adora was quick to intervene and told Glimmer they had everything under control. All they had to do was to get the ship back.

Glimmer found that exciting and decided to join herself, ditching the meeting she was supposed to have.

"Agh we can't wait for Glimmer, the Horde is probably going to take the ship or whatever they can get and bring it back to the Fright Zone." Adora exclaimed.

"Well.. I think I've figured out a way to find it. We can use this." Bow said and brought up an Horde jacket with a badge on it. Others looked at him a bit confused so he explained that all the Horde badges have tracking devices in them and that they found out about it in a hard way. "So anyways, I can hack into their system and see where all the Horde soldiers are in the valley.

They're sure to be with the ship." Bow swiftly hacked into the system by connecting his trackpad with the badge, showing on the screen the location of the ship. "And there we go."

After a while of tracking they found out the ship was located in a canyon. "Alright, I have a plan." Adora said when she had scouted the area. "Our plan heavily relies on you, Perfuma."

Pefuma sat on the rock and sobbed. "We should definitely come up with a another plan then."

"Oh come on Perfuma, you're one of the strongest people I know. If you hadn't come to help us at the Battle of Brightmoon, we surely would have lost." Adora tried to encourage her, Bow joined after her adding that Perfuma also helped him escape the Fright Zone.

"Ugh.. this isn't the Fright Zone, we're in the middle of the desert where I'm just a useless flower girl." Perfuma said.

Huntara herself felt a bit guilty from not trusting Perfuma so she decided to encourage her and put her hand on Perfuma's shoulder. "No, you're not useless. I've been wrong about a lot of things, one of the biggest was that I left my home. And I hope I'm wrong about you, because we need your help."

"You.. you want my help?" Perfuma asked while wiping her tears.

Huntara offered her hand and smiled. "That is, if you accept my request."

"Gladly." Perfuma answered and grabbed onto Huntara's hand.

Adora was pleased about this and turned into She-Ra, so they could finally finish their mission.

Well their master plan was that Adora just jumped at the middle of the canyon and began swiping off the Horde guards, while bow

gave supporting fire with his bow.

Everything was going smoothly, till Scratch arrived. "Hey! Hands off the goods!" And charged at Adora.

Well their fight was fiery to say at least, Adora didn't hold back at all which surprised Scratch a bit. Maybe she had actually learned that being merciful is her biggest weakness and Scratch of course enjoyed their furious fight.

Now that Scratch and other Horde guards were occupied with She-Ra, Huntara and Perfuma snuck under the ship. Huntara knocked out two of the soldiers who were guarding the ship. Nodding to Perfuma that everything was clear.

Perfuma sighed in deep as she watched at the cacti. She didn't like them at all, they were pointy, their spikes got everywhere and overall were irritating. But now she had no other choice. She tried her best to control them, but it didn't seem to work.

Huntara who was checking her back sighed as well. "Agh, focus! Oh... Ah.. Ommmmm." Huntara began to imitate Perfuma's meditation to get her to focus. "That's how it goes, right? Do it with me."

Perfuma was delighted to see Huntara suggesting meditation and as soon as she began to do the same she could control the cacti. Even if she was successful, it wasn't enough. "Agh, I'm not strong enough to lift this by myself." She sighed and looked under cacti, noticing their roots. "Hey, I don't have to be. We are underground."

Huntara clapped one of the Horde soldiers who was charging at them and said, "You noticed that just now?!"

"And guess what else is underground, ROOTS!" Perfuma exclaimed with full energy and began to control the roots, now easily lifting the ship upwards. With a lot of focusing she could

bring the mightiest of roots from the canyon walls. "These cacti have the strongest root system I've ever seen. I was so wrong about them."

"Yeah, and I was definitely wrong about you flower girl." Huntara said with awe.

As the ship got higher and higher, the roots that came through the walls of the canyon soon began to pile boulders on the ship. Making it a lot harder for Perfuma. Huntara noticed this and called for Adora, though she had her hands full with Scratch.

"Hey, shouldn't you help your friends?" Scratch asked mockingly.

"Of course, but first I have to get rid of you!"

"Then come and get me!" Scratch taunted and tried to escape on the higher bridges. Adora however had none of that and turned her sword into a lasso and swiftly pulled Scratch from the upper bridges.

"Oh come on!" Scratch yelled.

Adora grabbed Scratch and threw her against the canyon wall and placed a metal frame at the wall, caging Scratch in. "I have more important matters to attend, though it was satisfying finally get back to you." Adora smirked and headed up on the ship. She sliced the larger boulders and threw them off the edge.

With Perfuma still summoning the roots and more boulders falling on the ship, it was quite an exhausting task to get the ship to the surface. But with good teamwork, they managed to finally get in above the ground.

"Oh yeah!" Adora exclaimed.

Huntara tapped Perfuma on her shoulder and smiled. "Good job."

She-Ra turned back to Adora and noticed that Scratch had escaped the cage, which was weird. But that was not something to worry about. They had grouped up on the bridge and congratulated each others. Then Glimmer teleported to them and was ready to fight, only to notice there was nothing left to Fight. "Oh come on! I came as soon as I could.. I got only little lost.. in the ocean.." She said with a slight disappointment in her voice as she picked off some seaweed. "You should have waited for me."

"I'm sorry Glimmer, but weee got thee shiiip!" Adora exclaimed happily. "You're first mission as a queen was a success!"

Glimmer replied with a smile, still feeling a bit sad for being left out of the fun.

At the otherside of the Crimson Waste, Scratch, Scorpia and Double Trouble were on a speeder heading back to Fright Zone. Even if they lost the ship, the most important part still succeeded.

"That was quite something." Scratch complimented.

"Did you really like my audition?" Double Trouble asked with an eager tone. "I could have prepared a bit more to get really into your skin."

"Like doesnt cover your work. You really fooled Adora, whom I have known for a quite a while." Scratch said while smirking. "If you can keep that up, things will turn really exciting."

"Why thank you, of course I expect a high pay from this." Double Trouble said with their eyes shining.

"Of course, that is the least I can do." Scratch answered.

Scorpia meanwhile watched happily from the back of the ship where she was steering it. " *Maybe finally things will start to look*

better. "

In the late evening in Mystacor, Castaspella and Catra had finally everything ready for their location spell. Though it was different from other spells, requiring something personal from the person who they were trying to find.

"Are you sure this will work?" Catra asked with uncertainty in her voice as she held Shadow Weaver's mask above the vase.

"Yes, we have studied it and everything is in order. All you need to do is to drop the mask in there and repeat the words I'm about to chant." Castaspella answered.

"Alright.." Catra replied and dropped the mask into the vase. "Now what?"

"Just repeat after me." Castaspella said and raised her hands up in the air, preparing to cast the spell. ***"O' ancient mirror, show us the person we've come to seek. Clear all the mist and show us the picture!"***

Catra repeated the spell after Castaspella and the water in the vase began to glow and swirl until it turned into a clear window. There they could see Beast Island and of course, Shadow Weaver herself laying on something. Then the picture faded away and the water turned back to normal.

"So she's at Beast Island." Castaspella stated. "That's not good."

"But it seemed she was alive. That's all I need, now I just have to figure out how to get there." Catra said.

"Hold on there, Beast Island is no joke and it certainly would be impossible to get there." Castaspella said and placed her hands on Catra's shoulders.

"Are you telling me not to go after her? Really!?" Catra questioned, raising her voice.

"No, I'm not." Castaspella assured. "All I'm saying is that this needs some thinking. Beast Island is hard to reach and if you ever reached it, it would still be full of monsters.. monsters that we here cannot comprehend."

Catra pondered for a moment and sighed. She nodded in agreement. "Fine..."

"Also I think the princesses are back from their mission by now." Castaspella said. "You should return to Brightmoon, while I try to come up with something to help you get to the Beast Island."

"Thank you.. Castaspella." Catra answered sincerely.

It was probably midnight at Brightmoon when Catra came back, but she didn't have any slightest idea what her friends had done while she was gone.

"Oh, good evening." Catra greeted everyone as she arrived at the main hall.

"Catra!" Adora exclaimed happily. "I was wondering when you would come back. Did everything go well at Mystacor?"

"Yeah, I finally have something on Shadow Weaver."

"Oh, I'm interested to hear more." Adora said.

"Well.. for now she's alive, but..." Catra stuttered in her words.

"But?" Glimmer questioned.

"She's at Beast Island."

Everyone's jaws dropped. How had she gotten herself there, nothing lasts there. Beast Island was one of the most dangerous places on Etheria, even more so than Crimson Waste.

"No need to act so surprised." Catra said. "I know none of you would risk your lives for her.. and I understand-" But she was cut off by Adora. "Well it might not be so risky at all."

"What? How?" Catra questioned.

"Well we.. We managed to acquire Mara's ship. Once Bow gets it fixed, traveling long distances won't be a problem." Adora said with a wide smile on her face.

Catra was surprised to hear this, maybe.. finally.. this time would be the lucky strike.

Murky Waters

Chapter Summary

> Now that the Princess Alliance ahs Mara's ship, Catra's goal of saving Shadow Weaver is ever closer. But there's still lot of work to be done before they could even consider saving her. Lately Darkith has began to take interest in gardening, though surely her reasons wont be as innocent as just gardening.
>
> Shadow Weaver has terrible hangover from her highly alcoholic tea...
>
> Double Trouble beings their infiltration into Princess Alliance, hoping to destroy it from the inside. And Scratch's sword might be more than just enchanted sword.

Chapter Notes

> This chapter will be a bit shorter. I could describe this chapter as; things advance and don't advance at the same time. Planting some new seeds for plot and character points.
>
> I hope you will enjoy it none the less.

Catra was very excited about the ship they had acquired, but it was in need of repairs. And very few knew how to fix First Ones stuff. Luckily Bow's fathers were historians and Bow himself had knowledge about the First Ones technology.

But all of this had to wait, they had more urgent matters to tend to. Elberon was under attack by the Horde, but it wasn't anything that Adora and her friends couldn't handle. Glimme once again had to stay behind and felt even more left out. It even seemed that the people of Elberon were holding a party for Adora and her friends, for defeating the Horde.

"Oh Glimmer, it isn't that special." Adora tried to assure Glimmer through their trackpad, which was also used for communicating. "They just want to thank us for our help and remember, all of this wouldn't have worked without your planning."

"I know, I know.. it's just I miss being with you guys." Glimmer said.

"Don't worry, we try to be as fast as we can." Bow added.

"No, you don't have to rush your fun just for my sake, I-I'll keep practicing my magic skills."

"That's the spirit!" Adora exclaimed.

Catra had problems keeping Swift Wind from blabbermouthing his mouth. "Agh! Are you done yet?!" She yelled. "I can't keep his mouth shut any longer!"

"Yeah, we finished talking." Adora replied.

"Good." Catra sighed in relief and let Swift Wind go.

"You are terribly rude for a princess!" Swift Wind said with an offended tone. "I'm hungry and wouldn't want to go to a party. Those are irresistible."

"Sorry Swift Wind, we just didn't want to make Glimmer feel any more bad than she already feels." Adora said.

"And, I'm not a princess." Catra huffed. "And I think it's not good to lie to your friend." She eyed Adora.

"As I said, it's to make Glimmer feel better.." Adora sighed.

"I know, but you should remember that actions have consequences.. *I certainly remember that...* "

"Can we like to hurry? I'm really hungry." Swift Wind butted in.

Both Adora and Catra gave him an annoyed look. Swift Wind being oblivious himself didn't take on the que. "What?"

"Nothing... let's just go, the sooner it's over the better." Adora said.

At Brightmoon, Glimmer was practicing her skills as a sorcerer. Her swift gliding and teleporting was elegant, but still in need of practice and her skills with fighting with a staff could use improvements. "Impressive, most impressive." Glimmer could hear a gravelly voice from afar.

She landed on the ground and teleported to the garden where Darkith seemingly had found a new hobby, other than trying to grab magic for herself.

Glimmer looked around the small cottage that was filled with different kinds of flowers, though they didn't seem to be normal flowers. "Since when did you start gardening?"

"You know.. one must keep herself occupied, besides I don't have that much time left. So why not do something different for a while." Darkith answered.

"But these don't even look like normal flowers." Glimmer said and pointed towards the spiky vine-like plant.

"Well I got these from the book Catra gave me some time ago.. I found these much more interesting than other plants." Darkith nonchalantly replied. "Also, your magical skills seem to be quite incredible. Though you could need more practice."

"Ugh, dont even start.. I'm a daughter of an immortal angel and the greatest sorcerer that has ever touched Etheria!"

"You think so little of yourself, don't you remember how powerful you became when we raided the Fright Zone together?" Darkith said and stood up from the floor, she cut one of the black roses and put it on Glimmer's ear.

"I do remember you draining me of magic!" Glimmer exclaimed and picked off the rose and threw it onto the floor.

"Yeeees... but it did make you stronger." Darkith said, rolling her eyes. "Maybe it would be a good time for you to decide what kind of queen you will be, right now you're trying to be like your mother. But we both know that is not the case."

"You.. you just keep your mouth shut and keep gardening. I've already decided which kind of queen I am, I am a queen that doesn't take advice from traitorous prisoners like you!" Glimmer angrily exclaimed and teleported away.

Darkith feels satisfied, the seed has been planted and surely Glimmer will come back to her advice. And then part of her sleeve fell onto the ground and turned into dust, now exposing her rotten arm. "Agh, not again!"

Darkith picked up many of the different flowers and powdered them. She proceeded to spread the powdered mix of herbs onto her skin, temporarily fixing her arm. " *I seriously need magic...* "

In the Fright Zone, Scratch was in her office waiting for contact from Double Trouble.

Soon her communication pad began beeping and she answered. "So did you get in?"

"It was as easy as stealing candy from a baby. They never know what hit them."

"Good, I'll leave you to it-" But Double Trouble interrupted her and added. *"Though Catra really is sharp, took me a lot of work to convince her that I am really a Flutterina..."*

"So? Then get rid of her!" Scratch commanded.

"Ugh, this isn't something you can just rush, espionage takes time." Double Trouble answered with a frustrated tone.

"Fine, whatever. Keep the princesses busy, I'll convince Hordak to actually do something." Scratch replied back.

"Alright, you're the boss." They answered and hung up.

Scratch put the pad away and stood in silence for a moment, thinking of the past and of course.. thinking of Darkith. That old hag that thought she was important, but in reality she wasn't. Just a trickster with a bit of magic. That was all Scratch thought of her, but if there was even one useful thing she had done. Was the

sword she had enchanted. Scratch picked her sword up and inspected it.

It has been a while since she had a chance to use it. The dark steel shone little light, but it had an unnatural glow around the edges. Scratch felt something flow through her, something that made her feel confident and strong. Maybe these were one of the perks that enchanted swords brought to its wielder.

"Funny.. now that I think about.. I've never felt this feeling before, even though I have carried this sword for a while." Scratch said to herself and began to swing around with the sword, until she was caught by Scorpia entering her office.

"Scratch!" She said but stopped when she saw Scratch practicing with the sword like a child. "Ooh, that's quite- " But Scratch quickly pointed her sword towards Scoripia's throat, interrupting her.

"You didn't see anything, alright!?" Scratch said with a threatening tone. "If you tell anyone about this to anyone.. you will pay a high and bloody price for that!"

Scorpia was scared of Scratch, sure she was bossy and mean before.. but now she quite literally was threatening her life. "Ahh.. Uhh.. Don't worry I wont tell anyone, I promise. It was just that I tried to knock and call for you, but you didn't answer.. So I let myself in.."

Scratch sighed and lowered her sword. "Alright.. Anyways I'm going to meet Hordak, so whatever you wanted to say.. Forget it, I don't care. I have more important matters to attend to."

Leaving her office, she slammed the door shut and left Scorpia there alone. Now heading to Hordak's lab, to convince him to actually do something.

Meanwhile at Beast Island, Shadow Weaver suffers from hangover. She shouldn't have mix all those plants, now she has to pay for her foolish mistake. Laying on a bed while having a terrible headache and stomach ache. She could throw up at any minute, but she refused to. "Hey Entity.. can you do something about this hangover? Since you are in control of my body." Shadow Weaver said with a weak and coarse voice.

" *Oh, so now you're asking for my help?* " Spell of Obtainment asked sarcastically. " *What if I refuse? You deserve it, fix it yourself! Alcohol is poison anyways.* "

"Are you seriously scolding me about drinking alcohol?" Shadow Weaver replied. "That's filthy rich coming from you."

" *Well I'm not the one asking you to drink, you could do so much more than brew herbs and get yourself drunk!* "

"Agh.. I'm in no condition to argue with you... actually.. I think I'm blacking out."

" *Shadow Weaver, NO! Don't you dare to black out on me now! Shadow Weaver!* " Spell of Obtainment yelled and started smacking her with its tendril hands. " *Shadow Weaver! Shadow Weaver! Wake up you dumb hag on an expiration date!* "

But Entity got nothing, Shadow Weaver had fallen into deep slumber. " *Ugh, you are literally the worst! Oh why in the name of all the entities, DID I HAVE TO GET HER?!* "

Shadow Weaver drifted into total darkness, darkness she hadn't been for a while. Was she dead or alive? She sure didn't feel like alive, but surely if she was dead.. there would be something different. Maybe she was in between, unfortunate side effects of her drinking.

She wandered the endless darkness, ground below her felt like quicksand but she didn't sink in. Every step felt heavier after another and her walking turned into sluggish crawling.

"What is this accursed place? Where am I!? Shadow Weaver yelled into the darkness, not even hearing an echo of her voice.

It was like she was in an empty void where none could hear her nor would she be able to reach out. She decided to give up trying and soon after that she felt the ground turning into a solid matter and she was now laying on it.

After she was sure the ground was solid enough to walk, she stood up and continued on her trekking over the endless plains of the void.

As she walked onwards, she felt something grabbing her. Shivers ran through her spine and she slowly turned to look behind her. Only to see unnatural formation of limbs, dozens of hands grabbed her and began to pull her towards them.

Shadow Weaver quickly turned around and began to run as fast as her legs could carry her, but the grip of the arms got ever more tighter and their pull got stronger.

"Get away from me! What do you even want from me!?" Shadow Weaver yelled with a panic and anger in her voice. "Leave me! I'm not going to die, not yet! I have important matters I need to finish before I can go!"

When she said those words, memories and pictures came into her mind. Catra, Micah, fate of Etheria and to some extent.. Castaspella as well. Her will to get out of got stronger and the arms grabbing her loosening their grip.

"Shadow Weaver!"

She could hear a familiar voice calling her and as she looked in front of her, she saw a doorway that shone light and the voice could be heard louder and clearer the closer she got to the door.

"Shadow Weaver!"

She ran faster and ripped herself away from the grip of the hands and lunged towards the door like no tomorrow. And when she finally reached the door and entered inside, she was met by a familiar figure and familiar room.

"Mi-Micah?" Shadow Weaver asked with a frightened yet relieved tone. "Are you real?"

"Yes, glad to have you back in the world of the living." Micah answered with a gentle smile on his face. "And believe or not, if it wasn't for the Entity.. you might not be here right now."

"What?" Shadow Weaver asked, confused. She couldn't even comprehend how the Spell of Obtainment would have saved her.

The Entity manifested next to Micah and said. " *Listen.. if you die, I die.. me don't want that. Got it?!* "

"I-I'm just at a loss for words..." Shadow Weaver said.

" *Yeah, maybe next time don't do it! I don't want to perish yet, I have things I need to achieve."* Entity said with a scolding tone.

"I can't believe that I'm going to say this.. but I agree with the Entity." Micah said with a concerned tone. "You should really take better care of yourself."

"Well that's just to add salt to the injury..." Shadow Weaver replied with a coarse tone, but a faint smile on her face. "I'm just glad I'm back... and I promise, I will drink less alcohol."

" *Better if you would just quit it completely, less work for me.* " Spell of Obtainment said.

"Well if it pisses you off.. then I certainly can not stop it." Shadow Weaver said.

"Shadow Weaver!" Both the Entity and Micah called her with a condescending tone.

"I know, I know. It was just a joke." Shadow Weaver said and let out a genuine laugh. "I seriously have more important things to do than drink."

" *That's the spirit!* " Entity exclaimed. " *Now, how about we acquire something to enhance my power?* "

"Nope, absolutely not. You already have enough power!" Shadow Weaver said.

" *Oh well.. it was worth the try..* " Entity said to itself, sighing with disappointment in its tone.

Back at Fright Zone, Scratch had managed to get Hordak to actually do something other than just mope in his lab and trying to improve the bots' designs. Scratch also convinced him that Their newest asset, Double Trouble had successfully begun their infiltration and to turn the tides of war.

Now Scratch was on a balcony, watching down at the Fright Zones streets as their newest bots were being transported into a secret base. She had also asked to meet Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio, since they had been responsible for the operation to successfully get Double Trouble into the Princess Alliance.

"I've already reported to Hordak that the mission was successful, but I know you three somehow managed to screw things up." Scratch said with a cold and unbothered voice. "So tell me.. how many bots and men we lost during this operation?"

All three of them were scared from head to toe, they knew Scratch had changed a lot especially after the portal incident. Kyle was the only one to open his mouth. "W-We lost at least two dozens of bots.. and over forty men.." Kyle waited for Scratch's answer, utterly scared that she would be mad for their failure or worse.

"Ugh.. I knew it..." Scratch said let out a chuckle. "Hordak doesn't know about this and I intend to keep it that way. Even if he was told that you screwed up, I would get flack as well and I don't want that."

"So.. does it mean you aren't going to kill us?" Kyle asked with a worried, but slightly relieved tone.

"I would certainly like to." Scratch answered with a cold tone. "But for now... I think you three could be used for something else. I'll give you your next assignment soon, just keep out of my way if you value your lives."

"U-Understood." Kyle replied.

" *Scratch is getting delusional, we shouldn't put up with her.* " Lonnie whispered into Kyle's ear and she was right, Scratch has changed for the worse.

Three of them left with mixed feelings of frustration and fear.

The Crackening

Chapter Summary

> Cracks start to form in the Princess Alliance as disguised Trouble Double seeds dissensions while reporting Scratch the Rebellions plans.
> Scratch begrudgengly agrees onto Hordak's demands to get Entrapta's recordings.
> At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver decided that she should try to make aquintances with the mysterious girl with a robot.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver had finally fully recovered from her near death hangover. Now she was up once more and ready to continue her mundane things.

It wasn't until she got the idea to go look for that twin tailed girl, maybe she had some answers and Shadow Weaver herself had a hunch that needed her confirmation.

"I don't know Shadow Weaver.. it's quite dangerous and you have just recovered." Micah explained to her with a concerned tone. "Maybe you should take it a little bit easier."

"Hah, nonsense!" Shadow Weaver snorted and let out a nonchalant chuckle. "I feel better than ever and I crave for something more exciting than brewing herbs all day long."

"Yes.. but maybe you shouldn't push your limits that hard." Micah said. "I'm just trying to help you."

"Push my limits? You think I'm some sort of old hag?!" Shadow Weaver huffed. "I'll have you know that I'm far from old and I'm feeling well."

" *We both know you are lying...* " Entity told her.

"I didn't ask for your opinion!" Shadow Weaver snapped back at the Spell of Obtainment.

"Shadow Weaver?" Micah asked.

"Don't worry, I was just talking to the Entity." Shadow Weaver assured. "Now, how about we go find out who this mysterious girl is."

"I'll take it that you won't stop even if I decline." Micah said.

"Nope." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Fine... but don't do anything crazy, alright? Micah said with a slightly tired tone.

"Don't worry, I won't risk anything. I don't intend to die any time *soon* ." Shadow Weaver said as she emphasized on the last word, meaning to taunt the Entity.

" *Just drop it.. alright?!* " Spell of Obtainment said with an annoyed tone.

Micah sighed tiredly and agreed to Shadow Weaver's request, while thinking to himself. " *I swear she wasn't like this before..* "

They started their trekking across the Beast Island, but were not met with any success finding this mysterious girl. "Why is it so important to find this girl?" Micah questioned.

"Because, she might be the one to get us out of here. If she truly is the same person I vaguely remember." Shadow Weaver replied.

"Vaguely? Are we going to assume she is someone you vaguely remember?" Micah asked.

"Well, there was this girl.. Entrapta, your description of her matches what I had heard. She knew how to combine First Ones tech and Etherian tech together." Shadow Weaver explained. "And mind you, we are on the dumping grounds of the First Ones, if she truly is the one and same then she is our best bet out of here."

"I get it, but we can't find her just aimlessly wandering around.. we need something better." Micah said.

"Then we spring a trap for her, she stole your food.. right?" Shadow Weaver said and looked at Micah.

"Yes, but I don't see how that's got anything to do with catching her." Micah answered.

"Clearly being on this island hasn't done any good to you." Shadow Weaver replied with a chuckle. "All we need to do is to set up some tasty food and she'll probably come to get it and then we get her."

"Did you forget that she has a huge robot with her?" Micah reminded her.

"Well.. we can at least follow her if not anything else." Shadow Weaver said.

"You're not going to back off from this.. aren't you?" MIcah asked.

"Nope, fortune favors the bold!"

Micah just shook his head in amusement, how was this the same strict teacher she had been in Mystacor.. For that, he didn't have answers.. but maybe he didn't need any. He surely enjoyed this new side of Shadow Weaver a lot more than her old, strict and cold one.

It's been a week or two and the Princess Alliance has had one setback after another. None of them knew why, but Horde was always one step ahead of them. Only Catra found it weird that right after Flutterina arrived, everything had been going towards a downward spiral.

But none of the others cared, since they were way too busy planning their next move.

One time, Flutterina happened to hear Catra talk about Shadow Weaver. She eavesdropped to listen to it.

Catra was asking if they could fix the ship faster or maybe try to look for another solution.

"I'm sorry Catra, but this is very important. I promise you, we will go look for her as soon as possible." Adora tried to assure her.

As Flutterina listened, she got a devious idea. This was something to try to drive a wedge between them. Making Catra look impatient, petty and always asking to go look for Shadow Weaver. While using others to deny her request.

" *This is going to be perfect.* "

At the Fright Zone, Hordak has spent a whole lot of time in his lab. Trying to build a new weapon. Entrapta's betrayal has hurt Hordak a lot, without her help he can't do much. Trying to improve on Entrapta's designs is near impossible, so Hordak demands Scratch to look for Entrapta's recordings.

Scratch isn't too keen about it. "Didn't I convince you earlier, just get over Entrapta."

"Listen, Entrapta's recordings are needed if we are going to execute our plan." Hordak said.

"Ugh.. I'm doing so much overwork already. I have no time for that." Scratch complained.

"Don't forget that this plan relies on a weapon I'm trying to make and a shapeshifter whose loyalty is questionable." Hordak growled.

"Alright, I'll do it..." Scratch replied and went on her ways. " *Stupid Hordak... he thinks I have time for this.. I should be the leader...* "

Scratch could feel her sword vibrating through its holster and she could feel the sword, calling for her with a faint tone.

This wasn't usual.. it never did this before.. or did it? Scratch didn't know, her cravings would have most likely to drown everything else.

As Scratch walked through the hallways of Fright Zone, she bumped up with Scorpia. "Watch where you're going!" Scratch snapped.

"Oh, I am sorry. I didn't notice you." Scrorpia apologized. "I was just think-" But she was cut off by Scratch. "I have a simple task for you, so simple that even you can't mess it up."

"O-oh.. what's that?"

"Hordak needs those records from Entrapta.. she used to have that recorder she always talked to. I have no time for this. I need to focus on other duties."

"Okay, I'll get it done. You can count on me." Scorpia exclaimed confidently.

"Good.." Scratch replied with a tired tone.

Not even a moment later, Double Trouble contacted her. " *Hello darling, I have good news to you.* "

"Keep it brief, I'm busy." Scratch answered with a frustrated tone

" *So cold, no fun.* "

"Just tell me the good news!"

" *Alright, so I have managed to find a way to drive a wedge between Catra and others. I'm currently in the process of it. Soon there will be disarray.* "

"Good, at least you know what to do." Scratch said. "Anyways, Im preparing for another diversion and Hordak is soon ready with his weapon."

" *Right, so I'll keep on distracting them and also keep reporting their moves back to you.* "

"Yes, do that and don't bother me any further." Scratch replied.

" *Alright, but seriously.. you should have more fun.* " Double Trouble answered.

"I'll have fun when the princesses are dead, Catra is a fur carpet on my wall AND EVERYONE IN THE REBELLION ARE EXECUTED!"

" *Sheesh, relax.. just tried to cheer you up.* " Double Trouble said and hung up.

Scratch had to take a deep breath and collect herself back together. She once more looked at her sword and her power hungry urges seemed to rise. "Seriously, what's with this sword!?"

Then she remembered that Darkith was the one who enchanted it. "Well of course... she had do something.."

Back at Brightmoon the wedge that Double Trouble had managed to pull was starting to show its effects. All of the princesses were in the war room and the most arguing was between Catra and Glimmer.

"For the last time Catra, we have no time! Stop being so selfish!" Glimmer argued. "We have to find the reason why Horde is always one step ahead of us, we need everyone to accomplish this."

"I said last time, it's because of that new princess you recruited. Don't you find it strange that things have been going downhill right after she arrived?" Catra argued back, with a fiery tone.

"You really need to stop being so judgemental, the same could have been said when you joined the Rebellion.. because of your affiliation with Shadow Weaver, but we didn't judge you." Glimmer said with a stern voice.

"Don't you dare to bring her into this!" Catra was fuming with anger. "And for your information... she's more than something I was affiliated with... she.. she was so much more to me!"

"Glimmer, maybe you should-" Adora tried to intervene, but Glimmer just ignored her. "Catra, I know you feel strongly about

her, but she's not here. Just like my mother... because of your anger!" Glimmer raised her voice.

"Glimmer!" Adora said.

"No, let it go Adora.. Well Shadow Weaver is still alive, unlike yours!" Catra snapped back and stormed off the room.

"How dare you!?" Glimmer fumed.

"Glimmer, let her be." Bow said and put his hand on her shoulder. "She didn't mean it, right Adora?"

"I know she didn't mean it, I'll go talk to her soon." Adora said and sighed, "But Glimmer, you shouldn't have said that."

"Well she shouldn't be such a selfish and violent brat!" Glimmer huffed.

Meanwhile Double Trouble, disguised as Flutterina, enjoyed this whole drama. To be honest, they were mostly into this because of drama more than to help the Horde to win.

Hours later, when the sun had beginning to set. Catra was sitting on the balcony of her and Adora's room, looking sadly at the setting sun at the horizon. Somewhere over there was Beast Island and Shadow Weaver. She also thought what she had said to Glimmer and regretted it, but didn't feel like she could talk to her.

Soon after she could hear knocking on the balcony door and a familiar voice. "Catra, may I come?"

Catra wiped a single tear off from her eye and answered, "Yes, you may."

Adora stepped onto the balcony and walked next to Catra. "Hey, are you feeling alright?"

"I.. I don't know.." Catra answered. "I guess you're here to talk about the earlier?"

"Well.. yes and no. I care for you and don't want anything irreversible to happen." Adora said.

"I'm not going to do anything that drastic.. I know I shouldn't have said what I did.. I was just angry..." Catra said and sighed. "I'm not sure if I can talk to her.. I'm sure I hurt her.."

Adora decided that the best thing was to just give a tight hug to Catra. "Don't stress about it, take as much time as you need. I'm here for you and you can rely on me."

"Thank you.. I think I just need some time. I'll try to talk to her tomorrow, maybe she's cooled off as well." Catra said with a faint smile.

While Adora was comforting Catra, Glimmer however went to talk to Darkith. "Guards, leave us be!" She ordered. "Darkith, I need to speak to you!"

Darkith turned to look at Glimmer. "Oh, if it isn't the queen, how may I help you?"

"As a queen, I am requiring your help."

"So, what can I do for your majesty?" Darkith asked.

"Help me to think like Scratch, you know her. Why is she always two steps ahead?"

"Pfft!" Darkith huffed. "You don't need to think like that brat.. all you need is a single location spell and you know where she is."

"And how can I do it?" Glimmer inquired.

"Location spell is a simple yet effective tool for every young sorcerer.. I'm surprised your aunt hasn't taught you it." Darkith said while moving closer to the marble vase, she picked up some of the flowers and crushed them into powder, mixing it with the water. "Now we need to draw a spell, I want you to do it."

"Wait... you've been growing magic plants?!"

"I said before.. I found that botany book quite useful. Now, put your hand on the water and follow my instructions." Darkith said and put her hand into the vase. After a second of thinking, Glimmer did it too.

"So, what next?"

Darkith grabbed Glimmer's hand and began to guide her hands on the vase, drawing a perfect sigil. "Now, all you need to do is to think about what you want to see."

Glimmer closed her eyes and thought about Scratch and her whereabouts, the surface of the water began to change into a mirror and showed Scratch's location.

"Wow... did I do that?"

"Indeed you did." Darkith replied.

"It seems Scratch has been operating from the Whispering Woods.. all those places we've attacked were only decoys." Glimmer said.

"Then.. we just need to make a decoy of our own." Darkith replied with a slightly sinister chuckle.

"What do you mean?" Glimmer asked.

"Say, didn't Scratch hate Catra?"

"It seemed so.. and vice versa." Glimmer answered. "Are you suggesting that I'd use Catra as bait?"

With a chuckle Darkith answered, "That's your own decision, what does the queen do?"

Glimmer looked once more into the mirror, looking at Scratch plotting her plans and then thinking about earlier what happened with Catra. What will the queen do?

Chapter End Notes

A bit shorter chapter this time.
Darkith is definitely not good influence for anyone.

Decoy

Chapter Summary

> Glimmers new plan is to use Catra as a bait to lure Scratch out. Though Scratch herself wont come out, it will at least get her attention. Meanwhile Glimmer attacks Scratch herself.
>
> Shadow Weaver's plan to catch Entrapta fails, but at the sametime somehow works

Chapter Notes

> Well in this chapter.. maybe the plot moves forward.. I don't know... I think so...

The next morning, Glimmer had everyone gathered at the war room to discuss their plan. Catra and Glimmer had managed to make up from earlier, although it was held on with a bandaid. Glimmer revealed that she had managed to get some intel about Scratch with the help of Darkith. Which of course was met with mixed receptions.

"Are you seriously trusting Darkith of all people?" Catra questioned.

"Yeah, are you sure it's safe?" Bow added.

"Don't worry, I made sure she couldn't do anything. I practically just ordered her to do what I needed." Glimmer stated.

"She definitely has alternative motives, she would never allow herself to be ordered by anyone." Catra said.

"Yeah, she even went against Hordak, because she didn't like something." Adora added. "I know, since she was the one who looked after me when I was in the Horde."

"You are worried over nothing. I can handle everything just fine. So will you just listen to me, I have a great plan." Glimmer said.

Glimmer's plan wasn't anything special, it didn't feel any different from her earlier plans. She counted on Scratch to either go all in or change her plans. Either way, she could go after Scratch herself. She really wants some action.

Catra felt that something was off about all of this. Sure her plan sounded good enough, but there was something that just felt off. She shrugged that thought away and went on with the others.

Meanwhile, when everything was clear Double Trouble informed Scratch about their new plan. And that Catra seemed to be at the center of it.

While Catra being on the field was nothing new, Scratch thought that maybe it would be a good time to kill her.

" *Good work Double Trouble.* "

"Gladly, also.. Catra and Glimmer got into a fight yesterday and it was pretty ugly. I feel like they are soon at the breaking point."

" *Great, keep doing what you can to make them busy. It won't be long till we can execute our plan.* " Scratch hung up and Double Trouble turned back to Flutterina.

Meanwhile at the Beast Island, Shadow Weaver had laid a perfect trap to catch Entrapta and she was waiting nearby.

Micah had given up on waiting and had gone on to hunt for something to eat. Shadow Weaver however had the patience to wait.

" *I don't think she's going to fall into that trap of yours..* " Entity told her. " *This is so boring..* "

"We'll see. You are an entity that has probably lived longer than our whole existence.. and you are implying that you don't have patience to wait a day or two? What are you? A child?" Shadow Weaver said, clearly mocking the Entity.

" *I'm not a child.. I just have better things to do than wait..* "

"Then just go away and stop bothering me."

" *Fine, fine.. I'll leave you alone..* " Spell of Obtainment said and went away.

Shadow Weaver sighed in relief and kept waiting and waiting. Few hours passed and she was about to fall asleep, but then her trap activated.

She immediately got up and went to see what was going on. Well she had managed to get Entrapta there, though she didn't come out from her robot. Her robot could easily just take a step and the rope would snap.

Shadow Weaver wasted no time and teleported up on the robot to finally meet Entrapta. "Hah, I got you!" Shadow Weaver exclaimed.

Entrapta came out of the robot and went to greet this mysterious woman. "Uhhh.. who are you?"

"Doesn't matter, are you perhaps Entrapta?" Shadow Weaver replied.

"Oh, yes I am. How do you know me? I've never met you before." Entrapta said. "By the way, do you like my robot? I made it

myself, this whole island is full of First Ones tech.. so I can practically do anything."

Shadow Weaver listened to her ramblings, even if she couldn't understand half of what Entrapta was saying. She was still very keen on hearing her. Entrapta also explained how she worked for Hordak and told a lot of her experience in Horde.

Shadow Weaver herself shared some of her experiences from the Horde and they both came to the same conclusion that Scratch was an asshole.

"By the way.. that trap was pretty obvious.. you really aren't good with mechanizations." Entrapta said.

"I didn't expect you to fall for it, my plan was to track you since me and Micah kind of need a bit of help." Shadow Weaver said.

"What kind of help?"

"Well, we have to get out of this accursed island. But I can't get us away and even this magical parasite in me can't get us away."

"You have a magical parasite?" Entrapta asked excitedly as her eyes started to sparkle. "I've heard of interdimensional beings before, but I have never heard of them attaching themselves to a human host. I have to investigate it and I need to do tests and experiments.. Please, please let me conduct research on this matter."

"Umm..." Shadow Weaver couldn't think of anything to say. Entrapta talked so fast that it was impossible to keep up with her. But then she got an idea. "Alright, how about this. You can do your research or experiments on me and my Entity and for exchange you get us out of here.. Deal?"

"Oh that sounds great. I have already made a lab.. just come with me." Entrapta said.

"I need to inform Micah before.. and maybe you could stay for dinner? Micah's a great cook."

"Well.. I'm not good with people.. last time I tried to socialize.. I got left behind and sent here.. though this island is a great place." Entrapta replied with a hint of sadness.

"Don't worry, I'm not good with people either. In fact.. last time I interacted with people, it ended up me killing them." Shadow Weaver said and let out a chuckle, trying to lighten the mood.

"Uhh... is that supposed to be funny?" Entrapta asked, confused and a little bit frightened.

"Well you enjoyed your time in the Fright Zone while building weapons of mass destruction. So I think we're squared." Shadow Weaver replied.

"But.. uhh.. I-I... uhh I can't argue with that. Agree to disagree?" Entrapta finally managed to say.

"Sure, let's just agree to disagree." Shadow Weaver said and smiled.

" *Alright.. what did I miss.. there was terrible noise going on..* " Entity said as it emerges from Shadow Weaver. Spell of Obtainment looked around and saw the twin tailed girl with Shadow Weaver. " *Wait.. are you.. when did you?* "

"Like I said, patience.. also she'll be doing some research." Shadow Weaver replied.

" *Research? About who?* " Entity asked.

"From us of course, in exchange for us getting off from this island."

" *What?! And you agreed?! You didn't even try to consult me about it?!* " Spell of Obtainment fumed.

"Nice to meet you, I'm Entrapta and we're going to be lab partners."

" *No, I don't want to be! Why aren't you with Hordak, wasn't he your lab partner?* "

"How do you know about that?" Entrapta asked.

" *There's nothing I don't know about. I know everything!* "

"Except, how to get off from this island." Shadow Weaver replied sarcastically.

" *Shadow Weaver! We've gone through this before already! So just stop it!* "

"Note; I've just met with a woman who has an interdimensional parasite in her. Requires further research." Entrapta talked to her recorder. "This might give us the answers we seek."

" ***OH FOR UNIVERSE'S SAKE, EVERYONE JUST SHUT UP!*** " Spell of Obtainment yelled in frustration.

Meanwhile Catra, Adora, Bow and others were on their mission to attack an Horde outpost. Well surprise, surprise.. It was an ambush. Though nothing they couldn't handle.

This time there were an unusually lot of bots and they all had their sights on Catra.

With her artificial magic, Catra could easily dispatch those bots. "Heh, never bring a bot to a magic duel." Catra amused herself.

Her reckless fighting style led to many close calls, but luckily either Adora or Bow was there to watch her back.

When the last of the robots were destroyed, everyone let themselves have a breather.

"Catra, you should be more careful." Bow said. "It was hard to keep your rear covered."

"Oh, sorry.. I don't know.. I have just this strange itch I can't scratch.. you know?" Catra said.

"Well.. I don't know what you mean by unscratchable itch.." Bow said.

"Yeah.. I think it's just something with me. You know I'm a magicat.. and I don't know much about my kin.. since they are all dead." Catra said and sighed. "I'll promise I won't get careless."

Meanwhile at the hideout in the Whispering Woods, Scratch was looking from the screens as the princess defeated her bots. She thought that amount of bots should have been enough to kill Catra, but it seems she underestimated them. Or maybe Double Trouble wasn't doing enough. "Bla-bla *I won't be reckless* Blah-blah! Scratch imitated Catra's tone with a mocking tone. "Well, its time for a plan B" She picked up her remote control and pressed the button which activated the last bot near the princesses. It was programmed to charge towards the nearest target and then blow up.

Soon the others could hear a one last bot charging towards them, this time it's target was Adora.

Catra noticed it and rushed towards her."Adora! Watch out!" She yelled and jumped in between her and Adora.

BOOM!

The bot exploded, but Catra had managed in time and successfully cast a protection spell. Even though her staff wasn't particularly meant for that. It also had an explosive setback for Catra.

"Catra?" Adora asked with a worried tone as she picked her up. "Are you alright? Answer me!"

"Ugh, 'cough' H-hey Adora...'cough' I'm fi-fine." Catra answered with a smile on her face. Even though she clearly wasn't fine.

"Catra, what did we talk about being reckless?" Adora asked.

"Heh.. 'cough' For y-you.. it's worth 'cough' to b-be reckless." Catra managed to finish her sentence before fainting.

"Catra?! Catra!" Adora yelled. "Come on, we must quickly hurry back to Brightmoon!"

Scratch didn't know what had happened since she lost all the video footage when the bot switched into a self-destruction mod. She just hoped that the worst had happened. She couldn't think there herself for long till Glimmer teleported there. "Hah found you!"

Scratch jumped from her seat, surprised that she was found. "What!? How did you know where I was?!" Scratch asked, drawing her sword out.

"Not so smart now, are you?" Glimmer taunted her. "I have no intention to let you get off easily!"

"Ugh, whatever.. guess I'm killing a royal today." Scratch stated.

Glimmer wasted no time and charged towards Scratch, while Scratch managed to block incoming magic blasts she had hard time keeping up with the teleporting queen. "Your annoyance knows no bounds!" She yelled while blocking the blasts.

"You could just surrender!" Glimmer yelled, teleporting behind Scratch and started choking her with the staff. "I'm not so fluffy, am I!?"

Scratch struggled to get Glimmers hold off of her. When did she become so aggressive?

Scratch managed to grab Glimmer's staff and threw her alongside it. "I'm sorry that I have to waste these bots for you, I'd have rather blown Catra into pieces... but you have to suffice." She said and picked up a remote control. She tried to reach the high ground, but Glimmer obviously was faster. She grabbed Scratch and managed to get the remote control from her.

"There's not going to be any blowings today!" Glimmer stated while smirking, she had pinned Scratch on the ground.

"That's hella sussy, but did you know what? It never hurts to have a back up plan." Scratch said and pulled up another remote control.

"You slimey bi-"

KA-BOOM

Soon the whole base was crumbling and there were explosions after explosions. Scratch tried to slip away but she got stuck under a collapsed catwalk. Glimmer just smirked at her. "It doesn't seem to be your lucky day." And then Glimmer teleported away from teh base. Now Scratch didn't have any secret place of operations.

Luckily for Scratch, Double Trouble happened to be nearby and they managed to pull Scratch away from the fallen catwalk.

"Come on, up on your feets." Double Trouble said when they had gotten Scratch up. "You can't die just yet.. who else is going to pay for me then?"

"Argh! Let's get out of here!" Scratch yelled.

When they had gotten themselves safely out from the destroyed base, Scratch contacter Scorpia. "Scorpia, have you found the recordings yet!?"

" *Uhh.. it's still underway.. you know.. heheh.. Fright Zone is kind of a big and messy maze.* " Scorpia awkwardly explained.

"Well don't just stay there and act like a fool! Get back to looking for them!" Scratch said with a demanding voice.

" *Uh-oh.. right away.* " Scorpia answered and hung up.

Realization

Chapter Summary

> Glimmer's reckless plan worked, but had concequences. Catra lost her consciousness and was now bed ridden.
>
> At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver introduces Entrapta to Micah and Entrapta herself wants to run some experiments on Shadow Weaver, much to the Entity's displeasure.
>
> Scratch loses her grip on reality and starts her descent into madness and Scorpia finally realizes that Scratch is a lost cause

Chapter Notes

> This chapter includes a bit of nudity... nothing too explicit though, just oblivious Entrapta doing her research. She needs to see Shadow Weaver's body.. for research purposes only.
>
> You might wonder.. how in the world would SW let herself get undressed and examined by a princess?
>
> Well.. she isn't the same SW from the show.. that much is obvious, but also she just doesn't care, simple as that.
>
> "Hey, I'm not a stripper, but a way out of Beast Island is a way out."
> ~ Shadow Weaver

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At Brightmoon, Catra was once more laying at the infirmary bed. This time she seemed to be totally blacked out.

Only Adora was there at the moment, everyone else was in the war room. Adora was sitting next to Catra and hoped she would

wake up. After a while of waiting, she decided to leave. Who knows how long Catra would stay unconscious.

Adora sighed and went to meet others at the war room.

"My plan worked well, Scratch's secret hideout was destroyed and you destroyed a lot of bots back there." Glimmer exclaimed. "So, consider it a success."

Adora wasn't that impressed, because now she as well felt there was something off about Glimmer's plan. "Say.. did you happen to come up with this plan alone, or was there someone who came up with it?"

"What do you mean? I planned the whole operation, but I had some help from Darkith. She's a great tactician." Glimmer answered.

Well now it made sense, Darkith would be no stranger to use others as bait. "You do know what you did was overly reckless, right? And Catra suffered because of it." Adora said.

"Well maybe she should be a bit more careful then, wasn't she reckless as well?"

"Glimmer, she tried to protect me. Yeah she is reckless, but we weren't expecting self-destructing bots." Adora explained. "I still have many things I don't know, so I'm off to meet Light Hope."

Glimmer groaned with annoyed tone and replied. "Alright. I'll promise, I won't keep anything from you from now on. Hopefully you'll get some answers yourself."

At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver introduced Entrapta to Micah.

"Entrapta, this is Micah, King of Brightmoon. Micah, this is Entrapta, princess from Dryl." Shadow Weaver said.

"Technically, I'm an ex-king..." Micah said and coughed.

"Oh, so you are Glimmer's father." Entrapta exclaimed. "She thinks you're dead."

"Naturally... it seemed that way." Micah said and sighed.

"Well then.. Can I start to conduct my research?" Entrapta asked.

"Uhh.. don't you want to eat anything?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Nope." Entrapta answered.

Shadow Weaver let out a deep sigh. "Alright then."

"Uhh, what research?" Micah asked.

"Entrapta wants to research my extraordinary condition with the Entity, in exchange for that she'll build us a way out." Shadow Weaver explained.

"I can't believe you agreed to that.. The past you would have never let anyone to touch you." Micah said.

"Ehh, time does change people."

"So can I start now? I do have some equipment I need to get first." Entrapta said.

"Whenever you're ready." Shadow Weaver replied.

" *I can't believe you're going to let that princess to tinker us with her things! Do you have any idea what that could mean?! She could figure stuff out and that would mean I'd lose my status as*

an entity... if some nerd princess is able to explain me scientifically.. the other entities will laugh at me! " Spell of Obtainment fumed furiously.

"You couldn't get us off this island, so it's your fault. Besides... I'm quite intrigued what her research will tell." Shadow Weaver smirked.

" *You are the worst thing to ever happen! NO, I DON'T WANT TO BE EXPERIMENTED ON!* "

"Your opinion is invalid." Shadow Weaver replied.

Then Entrpata came back with some of her scientific stuff. Shadow Weaver didn't have any clue what any of those things were, but what choice did she have.

"Now, take off your clothes." Entrapta said.

"What?" Shadow Weaver asked, puzzled. "Why?"

"So I can inspect your body.. I need bare skin for these sensors to work." Entrapta exclaimed.

" *No, don't you dare take a single piece of your clothing off!* "

"What was that?" Entrapta asked.

"What was what?" Shadow Weaver replied.

"That voice.. where did it come from?"

Meanwhile Micah decides to quietly leave the cottage for some fresh air. His reason for leaving was quite obvious though.

"Well the voice is from the entity.. the one you want to research. I thought you met the entity already?"

"Oh.. it's just kind of weird.. alright then, clothes off!" Entrapta answered.

"Sure, whatever." Shadow Weaver replied and began to take her clothes off, soon Entrapta could see Shadow Weaver's whole body and how it was covered with scars and other bruises. Entrapta was taken back.

"How have you managed to live with all that?" Entrapta asked.

"Well.. that's what I'd like to know as well, so I hope your research will be worth it." Shadow Weaver answered.

" *Well of course you can live with those scars.. It's because of me.* " Spell of Obtainment mumbled.

Entrapta was very interested in Shadow Weavers' scars and wanted to examine them closer. "Does it hurt if the scars are touched?"

"No. It only hurts when new scars form." Shadow Weaver answered.

"And.. how do these scars form then?"

"For overusing my magic, usually when casting complicated and powerful spells."

"I see, anyway.. I'll put these sensors on you, don't move." Entrapta replied.

Shadow Weaver found these attached sensors itchy and she had a terrible urge to start scratching, but Entrapta told her not to move.

Entrapta plugged the sensors into her machine and she could now see Shadow Weaver's pulse, which was quite unnatural.. considering normal living beings.

Then Entrapta took out something that looked like those communication pads, only it was twice the size. "Uhh, what is that?"

"I'll take an x-ray from you, so I can see what's going inside your body, oh and no need to worry this is completely safe. I've tested these x-ray machines and they shouldn't pose any danger." Entrapta nonchalantly explained.

"Wait, is it possible that it will cause me problems?' Shadow Weaver asked with a hint of worry in her tone.

"It's quite safe, you can't never be sure though." Entrapta replied. "But also.. you don't seem to be that normal anyways.."

Entrapta began to take x-rays of Shadow Weaver's chest, torso, arms and legs and she was quite surprised by what she saw. "Wow.. how do I begin to even explain this."

"What is it?"

"Well firstly, it seems that half of your organs are missing and there's somethin else replacing them. And whatever that thing is.. it runs through your whole body."

"Ah.. it has to be the Entity.. it is a parasite after all." Shadow Weaver replied.

"I see.. well as the situation is now as serious as it is... you wouldn't be able to live without the entity.." Entrapta said.

"Yeah, I know that pretty well, me and the Entity have gone through that same conversation."

"I just have to say.. just for clarity.. if the entity would be removed, you would die." Entrapta said with a serious look on her face.

"That's nothing new."

"Alright.. Can I have a small example of your scar tissue, I promise it won't hurt. I just want to examine it." Entrapta asked.

"Sure.. also I'm pretty sure I won't feel anything.."

"Good, then I'll start immediately." Entrapta replied and took out a small knife and pincers.

" *Are you seriously letting this happen!?* " Entity asked. " *She's literally taking a piece of me!* "

"Oh grow a backbone and take it like the Entity you are!"

Entrapta proceeded to cut a small piece of the scar tissue from Shadow Weaver's hand as soon as the piece was cut, it was replaced by a new tissue. "This requires further investigating."

"Soo, the deal about the ship? Or do you require something else?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Oh.. I almost forgot, hehe silly me." Entrapta replied. "I'll see what I can do."

Adora had gone to Light Hope hoping she would get some answers, but she had been put onto training. It was like a walk in a park. None of the bots in Light Hopes simulations matched the real fight.

"Are we done? Like seriously.. there's nothing new to learn." Adora stated.

"My programming tells otherwise." Light Hope said with a monotone tone. "You need to train for the sake of Etheria."

"I want answers! I can't train if I don't know anything." Adora said. "Horde has always been one step ahead of us always.. Catra

suspects there's a traitor among us, meanwhile Glimmer thinks Horde is tracking She-Ra and I don't know if it is because my sword is First Ones tech or I am one of the First Ones... I don't even know who they are? When we found out the Mara's ship, she had left a message for-"

"Mara was compromised, she became unhinged." Light Hope interrupted her.

"Well she didn't seem like it, she was scared and she was talking about a weapon. If there's something that can protect us from the Horde, I need to know it." Adora argued.

"Once the planet is in balance, all will be clear. It is your purpose as She- She- She- She" It seemed that Light Hope began to glitch out which annoyed Adora even more. "Wow.. what a way to avoid such a topic. Well if you don't want to tell me anything, then I'll leave." When she was about to leave, the doors didn't budge. So she stuck her sword there and tried to leverage it open.

"That is not the intended purpose of the Sword of Protection." Light Hope said

"So? I want to leave if there's nothing you can offer." Adora replied.

"You cannot go outside. My sensors detect a dangerous spore storm looming over the Whispering Woods, it is hazardous for beings like you."

"Well that's just great.." Adora groaned frustrated. "So you want to keep me here so you can not answer to my questions?"

" **Adora..** " Light Hope said before she vanished and the crystal castle turned to dark.

"Ugh, Light Hope!? Where did you go?!" Adora yelled in the dark room, until it lit up once again and Light Hope appeared. "Hello, I am Light Hope, how may I assist you?"

"Uhh.. what's going on?" Adora asked.

"My system is rebooting. I'd like to answer your query, but the information about what is going on has not been loaded yet. Who are you?" Light Hope asked and tilted her head with a smile.

"Ookay.. this is weird.." Adora said. "You don't remember me?"

"Light Hope system is still loading.. I'm at 20% and I have just learned how to move around the castle." Light Hope said and began to teleport around Adora.

"Ahh.. well you seem to have fun.. I've never seen you like this." Adora stated.

"And I have never seen you like that before.. Am I not usually fun? My personality hasn't fully loaded yet, who are you?" Light Hope asked once more.

"Uhh.. I'm Adora.. the.. She-Ra.. you know, with the sword?" Adora said and showed Light Hope her sword and swung it around.

"Ahh, I'm programmed to guide and train She-Ra, how may I assist you?" Light Hope said with an upbeat tone.

Adora realized this is her chance and with a smug face she said. "Ah, well before rebooting. You were about to tell me all about this weapon Mara mentioned, about where I come from and.. about everything I want to know."

"Of ourse, I'll answer all of your questions." Light Hope replied happily. Adora was about to get excited. "But that information has not been loaded yet."

And now Adora was back at square one.

Meanwhile at the other side of the Whispering Woods, Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio were delivering an armor plate cargo. It was a simple task, ordered by Scratch and she had even stated that; "Even you three useless simpletons can't screw it up."

How it frustrated Lonnie, she would have wanted to go against Scratch, but that would have dire consequences. Well now it seemed that they managed to screw this simple task, as their truck had broken down in the middle of the forest. "Of course this kind of crap happens to us!"

"Lonnie, calm down." Kyle tried to calm her down. "It's not that bad.. right?"

"Calm down? Calm DOWN?!" Lonnie turned to look at Kyle. "We have been given unreasonable tasks... we are stuck in a forest that is hostile.. Scratch has lost her mind, what could even be even worse than this!?"

Then they noticed some glowing particles gently falling down. "Now what?"

"I don't know, it looks like snow." Kyle repiled and stuck his tongue out to catch one of these strange particles, but as it hit his tongue it began to burn. "Aaaagh! It burns!"

"Agh, this is just great!" Lonnie yelled.

The particles burned through their clothes and skin and even began to corrode the armored truck.

"Hurry! Get inside!" Lonnie commanded and Roghelio pulled Kyle with him and they closed themselves in.

"This is just perfect!" Lonnie yelled frustrated. "We are stuck and now there's raining corrosive spores!"

"Well at least Scratch isn't here to grill us." Kyle said, trying to sound optimistic. But his joy was short-lived, since Scratch almost immediately contacted them.

"What are you idiots doing! You're supposed to be at the Fright Zone by now!"

"Well excuse me, but we are stuck and there's hazardous weather outside! Do you want us to die!?" Lonnie yelled, she so much wanted to go through the screen and punch Scratch.

"It was a simple task! I don't care about you! Get that shit fixed and drag your asses back here, that's an order!"

"Yes Commander Scratch." Lonnie replied while gritting her teeth

"Good!" Scratch said and cut off the communications.

" *Bitch..."* Lonnie muttered to herself.

The moment after Scratch had cut the communications with Lonnie and others, she contacted Double Trouble for an update of their situation at Brightmoon. "So, is there anything worth knowing?"

" *Nothing much, Adora has gone for a while and Catra is out of the game.. for now.* "

"That's great news." Scratch replied. "And what about the princesses?"

" *They seem to have some sort of fallout with each other.. and it seems Glimmer's getting help from Darkith. Which has caused a wrench in a wheel for them.* "

"Maybe her escaping was good for us.. in the long run.. I hate her to my core, but I have to give credit where it's due.. She's great at breaking others."

" *I guess so.. but other than that.. there's not much news. They still have no idea that there's an impostor among them.* "

"I know I can trust you, keep doing what you do best." Scratch said with an upbeat tone in her voice, which was rare for her.

" *Alright, ooh.. actually there might be something soon to report.. I smell great drama incoming."* Double Trouble said with an excited tone. " *Catch you later.* " Then they cut the communication and Scratch was once again in her office, alone.

Scorpia was walking towards the Scratch office. She had decided to fake the recordings after she had found out that the recordings were encrypted into Emily and couldn't be accessed without dismantling her completely. After realizing that Emily most likely would be destroyed and the state in which Scratch was, it was obviously for the best to fake it. Even if she failed her, Scratch wouldn't kill her... right?

Scorpia stopped at the front of Scratch's office and took a deep breath. She opened the door and entered inside. "Hey Scratch, I found the recordings."

"Took you long enough." Scratch replied with an inpatient look on her face.

"Well.. I got the records, but not exactly.." Scorpia began to explain and she could see Scratch eyes twitch from annoyance.

She gulped anxiously and continued. "I tried to extract them from Emily.. but since I have these huge pincers and I'm quite clumsy.. ugh.. I broke the records.."

She then handed Scratch the broken fake records. Scratch had a dead inside look on her face, she scratched the table with her claws and slowly stood up.. She was a thermonuclear bomb about to blow up.

"OF COURSE YOU BROKE THEM! IS THERE ANYTHING YOUR STUPID USELESS ASS DOESN'T BREAK!? YOU'RE SCORPIA AND YOU ALWAYS SCREW EVERYTHING, THAT'S THE ONLY THING YOU'RE GOOD AT! " Scratch yelled with anger and venom and a tone full of spite.

"YOU CAN'T DO ANYTHING RIGHT, YOU NEVER SHUT UP, YOU CAN'T KEEP EMILY OUT OF MY WAY AND MOST OF ALL... YOU ARE ALWAYS ON MY WAY!" Scratch then seethed the swords and swiftly swung it at Scorpia's face, slicing a deep cut onto her face.

"Scratch?!" Scorpia yelled in pain and blood began to stream from her wound. Stream of tears flowed across her face as she went onto her knees and looked at Scratch with a scared betrayed look on her face.

"Only reason I'm not executing you right now is because you hold a high rank.. but don't think that will last!" Scratch said with a dead voice and put her sword away. "For you it would be best to stay out of my sight, unless you don't value your life. Because I don't value others lives."

With that threat she was leaving the office and ready to bring the bad news to Hordak. Before she stepped out from her office, she gave a sharp and cold stare to Scorpia who was crying and holding her hands at the wound. "Oh.. and clean that mess you had made.. I don't want my office to reek of blood."

With a loud slam, Scorpia was left in the dark office. Well Scorpia knew Scratch wouldn't take this news well.. but for the first time since the portal incident.. she feared for her life. She couldn't stay here.. but where would she even go?

Meanwhile Scratch prepared herself ready to face Hordak. She took a deep breath and swept her hair back. She entered Hordak's lab.

"The recordings?" Hordak asked.

"Entrapta must have deleted them or something... there was nothing left."

Hordak was enraged and with a fit of rage threw a bunch of metal scraps against the wall, making Scratch flinch. **"It was an order.."**

Scratch had enough, these Hordaks childish fits of rage were enough. "Get over it! Forget it!"

"What did you say?" Hordak asked with a threatening tone and turned to look at Scratch.

"You don't need Entrapta... you don't need her useless recordings.. You never did. You have built an empire.. You want to prove yourself.. to Horde Prime? Then forget others and let's focus on this mission. Together.. We bring Etheria to its knees!"

Hordak looked at his table and noticed that after throwing those stuffs off from his table, there was one of First Ones crystals, embedded into a piece of tech. That was all Hordak needed, he grabbed the piece of tech and turned to look at Scratch once more. "Yes.. We shall bring Etheria to its knees. Give it a day or two.. I'll finish it."

"So.. So does that mean I can give the order?" Scratch asked hesitantly.

"Yes, it is time." Hordak replied and offered Scratch her hand. Which she accepted and they shook hands together.

Then Scratch took out her communication device. "Attention all Force Captains on the field.. retract your main troops back to the Fright Zone, we are executing Operation Scorched Kingdom."

Scorpia hadn't bothered to clean anything, she had gone to the place she had hidden Emily and told her it's safe to come out. As Emily came out, she noticed the cut on Scorpia's cheek. Emily let out concerned beeps and walked up to Scorpia.

"Hey.. it's alright. I knew this was to be expected.." Scorpia replied and assured her everything was fine. "There's nothing I can do for her anymore, but maybe there's something I can do for Entrapta. Come on Emily, we are leaving.. for good."

Emily replied with approving beebs and both of them start their journey off from the Fright Zone.

Chapter End Notes

Poor Scorpia.. I feel bad about what I have written..

46.5

Chapter Summary

> To open a supply lines to Kindom of Snows, the Princess Alliance is launching an attack on Horde outposts. There's one thing though, both of those outposts are almost empty. Why?
> Does Horde have something sinister going behind the scenes?

Chapter Notes

> Since I've screw'd up the story line of S4, I'll make a bit of cuts here and there. This chapter will be a shorter one, since I want the next one to be a much longer, but I don't wanna stretch this chapter for so long. So consider this chapter as a part of earlier chapter. Also sorry.. no SW/Entity this time.
>
> Like the tags say... I have no idea what I am doing.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

After the hazardous spore storm had dissipated, Adora left the Crystal Castle and had learned something new from Light Hope. That Light Hope in fact was pretty close to Mara. After the reboot was complete, Light Hope retorted back to the same old monotone self. Adora at least could feel some progress had happened.

Now that Adora had left, Light Hope was alone, watching the only memory she had from Mara. "This memory should have been permanently deleted a long time ago, per directive for the Heart of Etheria project. DELETE."

Other Side of the Whispering Woods, Lonnie, Kyle and Roghelio had managed to get their armored transport truck to move. Lonnie didn't know if it was courageous or foolishness from Kyle to get them to move, but since she or Roghelio didn't want to do it.. it was most likely the only option. Kyle however managed to get some respect from both of them after his deed and this deed certainly strengthened their bond as a team.

Adora arrived at the Brightmoon and saw there was a new plan going on. "Uhh.. what did I miss?" She said as she entered the war room. "Is Catra awake already?"

"No, she's still out." Bow replied. "That explosion must have hit her hard."

"Oh.. I see.." Adora said with a disappointed sigh. "So, what is our new plan?"

"Well, we are going to open the supply line to the Kingdom of Snows, so we are attacking these two important outposts." Glimmer explained and pointed towards the outposts on the map. "These outposts watch over the supply route to the Kingdom of Snows, so when we take them out, it should be A-Okay."

"Sounds like a decent plan." Adora said. "Just don't do anything reckless.."

"Reckless?! We are still on that?!" Glimme huffed with an offended tone. "I'm doing what's best for all of us."

"You know what.. I don't want to argue about this anymore." Adora sighed.

"Hmph! Fine. Well we have this mission to accomplish, so let's get on the move." Glimmer said.

Kyle, Lonnie and Roghellio arrived at the Fright Zone with their badly damaged transport truck and they had to face a very angry and impatient Scratch at the cargo lodging area.

"Took you a while." Scratch started and tapped her sword on the floor. "You successfully managed to break the transport vehicle, I hope the cargo is still fine."

"Well.. about that.." Kyle started with a tremble in his voice, but Lonnie cut in. "Half of it got destroyed, we needed to get out of there. If we didn't, we would have died and you would have lost all your armor!"

"So, you admit that you destroyed the finest armor, just to get out of there?" Scratch questioned. "You know that disobeying the rules has grim consequences."

"You are asking too much! You should be happy that we even managed to get half of it!" Lonnie yelled.

"Don't worry, I don't intend to punish you.. hard." Scratch said with a wicked grin creeping on her face.

A moment later Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio found themselves at one of the outposts near the Kingdom of Snows. They didn't get proper winter clothes and they were tasked to build defenses and dig trenches.

"Seriously?! Trench digging? And for what? Rebellion doesn't even have tanks!" Lonnie complained.

Roghelio grumbled incoherently about something and Kyle was just lying on the bottom of the trench.

"Kyle, stop slacking off and start digging!" Lonnie yelled.

"I don't think I can... I can't feel my legs nor arms.." Kyle answered.

"I'm going to kill Scratch when we get out of here!" Lonnie sweared.

"IF, if we get out of here alive." Kyle added.

"Stop being so pessimistic!"

Meanwhile at the southern outpost, the princesses were doing great damage to the Horde troops stationed there. But Glimmer was discounted with the idea that she had to stay back, she wanted in the action. She was the Queen, the leader.. yet Adora was clearly leading the charge here. The moment she had a chance to attack one troop, she was robbed off that chance by

either She-Ra getting to it first, or Bow shooting the enemies faster than her.

Flutterina faced one trooper and picked up his stun baton. "Are you looking for this?"

Glimmer noticed it and teleported in front of Flutterina. "Sorry, this one is mine!" She grabbed him and teleported him to near the cliff. The poor soldier had nowhere to go. "I've been practicing this rune, you don't mind me testing it on you? Do you?"

The guard didn't know what to do as Glimmer started to draw a sigil and send it towards him, though luckily the spell faded before it could hit.

"Oh come on!" Glimme huffed. The guard saw his chance and lunged towards Glimmer, but Adora was nearby to save her. She grabbed him with her lasso and pulled him to her.

Glimmer groaned in annoyance and teleported to Adora. "Hey! That was mine!"

"Glimmer, you're the queen, you're too valuable, I can't let anything happen to you." Adora said with a concerned tone. "And the dark magic you've practiced with Darkith clearly didn't work."

"It's not dark magic and if the spell had actually worked, it would have been totally cool."

Bow jumped between Adora and Glimmer and grabbed both of them from their shoulders. "Ahh, look at us! The Best Friend Squad, back together!"

"Yeah! Take that Horde Scum!" Flutterina yelled excitedly as she jumped in. "This was the best first rebellion mission ever! Thank you so much for letting me in!"

Glimmer nodded, she looked around and saw how few there were those Horde soldiers. "There's not many soldiers out here... not even bots.."

"I didn't see any other.. maybe they ran away, because they were so scared." Flutterina added.

"Well alright, we should continue to the North. There's one more outpost to be shut down, before we get the supply lines open to Kingdom of Snows." Adora said. "Come on let's move!"

Adora and Bow headed first, leaving Glimmer and Flutterina to themselves.

"Wasn't She-Ra amazing? It was great she saved you before the soldier got to you." Flutterina gushed.

"Ugh, she didn't save me.. I-I was.. ugh.. doing the thing." Glimmer fluttered with annoyance.

"Oh, right. Your little magic trick would have been really cool if it had worked. Anyways.. your real strength is at teamwork and the way you let Adora give you orders.. even though you are the queen-" Glimmer interrupted Flutterina. "She wasn't giving me orders, we're a team!"

"Yeah, the greatest team, that's why she could talk like that ' *Oh I'm She-Ra, I know the best* ', but you stay friends.. ahhh.. what a bond."

Glimmer only let out a frustrated groan and moved on, leaving Flutterina behind. " *Like lambs to the slaughter.... too easy..* " Double Trouble thought to themselves. "Ay, wait for me!"

Back at Brightmoon, Catra finally opened her eyes and found herself once again in the infirmary. Her head felt dizzy and she had no idea how long she was out. She slowly got out of the bed and wandered the halls. She met with the captain of the guard, Juilana. "Uhh.. excuse me.. but where is everyone, this place seems a bit empty."

"They went for a mission to open supply lines to the Kingdom of Snows. They should be back in no time." Juliana replied.

"Thanks.." Catra said and continued to walk through the hallways, until she found herself at the castle garden. And one thing that stuck out like a sore thumb was Darkith in her garden. As much as Catra hated Darkith, she was probably the only one who knew anything.

Darkith could sense Catra standing behind her, needing not even look at her. "Ah Catra, you're up now. How are you doing?" Darkith asked with an unnaturally sweet tone.

"Save your sweet talks for the Sparkles.. those don't work on me." Catra replied.

"I guess not." Darkith said and sighed. She stood up and picked up some flowers. "So what do you want? I thought you hated me."

"I hate you, but you are the only one who knows anything.. as much as I hate to admit it." Catra said while crossing her arms.

"That much is clear.. So what do you want? I'm quite busy gardening." Darkith replied.

"Do you know anything about Beast Island?"

"Well.. we told stories to young Horde cadets.. but they were watered down versions.. not to funnily enough.. to. frighten them." Darkith said with a chuckle. "Ironic..:"

"So you don't know anything about that island?" Catra questioned.

"Nope, there's no need to be cryptic about it. I don't know anymore than you do.." Darkith said.

"Alright.. tell me about the sword that Scratch has."

"What sword? I have no idea what you're talking about." Darkith replied dismissively and cut one of the branches.

"Don't play dumb with me. I know that the sword Scratch uses is not a normal sword and if my memory doesn't fail me, she said that you enchanted it."

"Uhhh.. fine, I'll tell you about it.. I swear pestering children is the worst.." Darkith groaned.

"Hey, I'm an adult by now!" Catra quipped.

"No.. you're just a child.. in my eyes..." Darkith replied. "Anyways, to put in the simpler terms I just used the power of the Entity inside of me to enchant it. Nothing more.. I couldn't care less if it causes side effects. I suffer from the side effects of the Entity and so does your precious Shadow Weaver."

"You could have let Shadow Weaver out of it.. but I won't kill you... this time.." Catra said and left Darkith alone in her garden.

Darkith sighed. "Ugh.. children..."

At the Northern outpost, near the Kingdom of Snows. Adora, Bow, Glimmer and Flutterina were scouting out the place. "There doesn't seem to be much of soldiers here either." Bow said.

"But we don't know what could be inside, so let's tread carefully." Adora said. "So here's what we do-" But Glimmer had no time for planning. "Let's go get them!"

"Wait, Glimmer!" Adora yelled as Glimmer teleported into the midst of the troops.

Glimmer wanted the action, so she's going to get it. She got two guards out just by teleporting between and off from them. She proceeded to attack another soldier, but Adora swooped in and swung the soldier with her sword.

"Glimmer, you can't just rush into the action like that! You are Queen!" Adora said.

"Oh am I the queen?" Glimmer questioned while blasting a guard sneaking behind them. "Because it seems you're giving all these orders!"

"Ahhah.. and what is your plan? More dark magic?" Adora questioned and threw other guard against the large pipe.

"It's not dark magic! And maybe.. if it helps me to do what needs to be done!" Glimmer yelled and blasted another guard.

"Magic doesn't solve everything!" Adora argued.

Flutterina watched from afar as their arguing got even more juicier. " *Sometimes you're just too good.."*

"Even before, I didn't need you guys to save me ! Stop treating me like I'm weak and let me make my own decisions!" Glimmer yelled as she blasted the guards.

"We're just looking out for you!" Adora grunted and took care of two guards.

Bow just saved Glimmer by shooting guard above her. He noticed that things were heating between the two of them. So he jumped in. "Hey, what's going on between you two?"

"NOTHING!" Both of them yelled.

"Ugh, we are definitely going to talk about this. Adora, do you have anything you want to say?"

"No.. I don't know.. it doesn't matter!"

"Come on, you can do it! Communication is the key to a good friendship." Bow said.

"Ugh, I don't know why Glimmer is suddenly okay trusting to Darkith.. even after all she's done.. I'm just worried about her, it's too dangerous!" Adora replied and kicked one of the Horde Soldiers to leg making him fall on the ground.

"You really think I'm not even going to trust her?" Glimmer questioned and blasted the same guard Adora had taken out.

Bow jumped off from the pipe and walked next to Glimmer. "Would you mind phrasing that a little more constructively."

Glimmer let out a deep sigh. "Everything I'm doing is to protect the people, it is to protect you. I'm not asking you to trust Darkith, but can you at least trust me?" She said and while blasting another guard.

Adora successfully parried one guard and disarmed him. "Of course I trust you." Adora said as she looked at Glimmer.

"There you go." Bow said and pulled both Glimmer and Adora to a hug. "That's how Best Friend Squad does it."

There were only three guards left, others were already taken out. These three would want to surrender, but because Flutterina saw

that Adora and Glimmer were making up.. she had to come up with something. " *Ugh.. I have to do everything myself..* "

She jumped down and looked at one of the guards. She started to yell and jumped onto his arms to fake that she was about to be taken. "Help, help! She-Ra!"

Oh no, Flutterina!" Glimmer yelled.

"Help, help! Put me down!" She yelled and the guard did as was told, but Flutterina wasn't happy about that. She picked up his stun baton and whispered; " *I'm on your side you dimwit, now follow my lead.* " She made sure to seem like she was being held hostage.

"Bow, can you take them out?" Adora asked.

"No, I can't risk hitting Flutterina." He answered.

"Heelp!" Flutterina yelled. " *Come on! Help me out.* "

"Uhh.. drop your weapons.. or the girl... gets it?!" Guard said.

" *Ugh.. good enough... I guess..* " Flutterina muttered.

"Let her go, or things will turn ugly!" Glimmer threatened and her fists began to glow.

"No, stop it, they could hurt her." Adora said, trying to stop Glimmer.

"Someone has to do something!" Glimmer said and drew a sigil and sent the spell at them, making them levitate up to the air and dropping them off mid air. When Flutterina was free, Glimmer charged at one of the guards and teleported him farther away, slamming him against the wall. "Why isn't anyone guarding these outposts!?"

"Ahh I don't know!" The guard replied with a frightened tone.

"Well, I've not practiced this spell so much.. I'm still trying to get a hang of it. It's a truth spell." Glimmer said with a threatening tone and a sadistic grin crept on her face. "If it works.. but if it fails.. it can be extremely painful."

"Okay okay... I'll tell you everything.. Scratch ordered the troops back to the Fright Zone, but I don't know why." The guard explained hastily as he was quite scared. "I don't know I swear!"

Glimmer didn't listen and brought the sigil closer to his face. "I think you do!"

"No I don't please!" The guard pleaded.

"Glimmer, stop!" Bow yelled just in time to stop her. Luckily Glimmer stopped, she turned to look at Bow. "Scratch has ordered most of the troops Back to the Fright Zone. We've been wasting our time all day! And this guy is wasting mine. Bow, put him with the rest of them and let's go."

As Glimmer walked past Adora, she had to say something. "Glimmer what were you doing, you took things too far."

"I wasn't really going to hurt him!" Glimmer snapped.

"Hey, maybe we should rest and talk about this later-" But Bow was cut off by Adora. "The supply lines to the Kingdom of Snows have been opened. We're done here!"

"Fine by me." Glimmer said and teleported away, while Adora stormed the other way. Bow followed her with a stressed look on his face.

Only Flutterina was left and she admired her work. "And scene!" She said with a smile on her face.

Chapter End Notes

Heyyy Catra is awake now.
Also.. I'm not going to kill Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio with hypothermia.. I hope so...

Among Us

Chapter Summary

> Once again after a failure of retaking the Dryl, Princess Alliance is running on a thin ice. Reason for all of their failures is a simple one. There's a impostor among them.
> Catra has a obvious lead, Adora has a obvious lead and Mermista just wants to reenact her Mermystery fantasies.
>
> Meanwhile as the Priness Alliance is in middle of their spy problem, the Horde makes a fatal strike against the Kingdom of Salenias.

Chapter Notes

> Seriously.. wtf am I doing?! This title is appropriate but at the same time it isn't.. We are going on to some grim stuff today.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

All the Princesses were gathered in the same room, discussing their situation. Their failed attack at Dryl was not a coincidence. There has to be someone or something that is throwing a wrench in the machine. Glimmer saw all of this as a waste of time and wanted to investigate why the Horde had withdrawn their troops. Unlike Mermista who had read all of the Mermystery books, saw this as a great chance to fulfill her Mermystery detective fantasies.

Catra saw this detective play as a waste of time, since she was the sharp one and even if she was out of it a few days, was suspicious about the real culprit from the start.

Catra didn't take part in their plan to retake Dryl, since she didn't feel too well. She was hit pretty hard by that explosion.

But she was sure Flutterina was to blame, it was after she arrived that things started to go downhill. But Catra being Catra, can't articulate herself so well and comes off as a rude brat.

"I'm saying, it's Flutterina! You guys can't be that blind! Case closed!"

"Well that's just ridiculous, besides I don't believe it's possible there's a spy among us." Glimmer stated.

"That's what a spy would say." Catra said with an intent to take a jab at Glimmer.

"Catra! You can't just throw accusations like that." Adora said.

"Then who else?" Catra asked, crossing her arms.

"Eherm.. Darkith.. 'cough cough' the sorceress who worked for the Horde." Adora said and gave a look at Glimmer.

"Oh stop that! Do you really want to go that route again?" Glimmer argued.

"Everyone, calm down!" Mermista said with dramatic lighting in the background. "This clearly requires a great detective! We need to investigate this. Like in mermysteries. there's always a murder and a lot of suspects!"

"But there hasn't even been murder." Perfuma said.

"Yet!" Mermista added, while another dramatic lighting struck. "I'll be the lead investigator because I have read all of the Merystery books!"

"Most likely the spy is obviously Darkith, she's the one who worked for the Horde for years and she's the one who raised me. So I'm pretty sure I know her pretty well."

"It can't be Darkith though." Mermista added. "It's never the obvious one and Darkith perfectly fits that."

"But this isn't Mermystery book!" Adora yelled.

"Look who's throwing accusations without basis." Catra snickered with a smirk.

"Catra.. ugh.. don't even start, you should know better than trust Darkith." Adora said and sighed.

"Oh I don't trust her, in fact I hate her.. but if we want to know, maybe we should question her." Catra said.

"I don't think she would tell us anything." Adora said.

"Argh! We are wasting time!" Glimmer yelled. "Horde is out there, planning something and we are here doing nothing!"

"Don't worry, I'll solve this murder mystery." Mermista said and pulled out a detective hat and put it on. "You can call me Miss Detective from now on."

While all of this was going, Flutterina had slipped away and contacted Scratch. " *I was wondering when you would contact me. So, are the princesses still moping about their failure?* "

"Sadly.. they aren't anymore. That was the best thing I had witnessed, Now the princesses are about some Horde spy being amongst them."

" *Did your cover get blown?!* " Scratch asked with a worried tone.

"No.. they could never suspect someone as kind as Flutterina to be a spy." Double Trouble assured and took a form of Flutterina. "Although.. Catra has caused a bit of trouble, but luckylily others don't believe her." Double then took a form of one the palace guards. "If they start suspecting too much, I can always shift the blame to others."

" *Alright.. well, whatever you do, keep them busy. We're about to attack Salenias.* " Scratch said.

"Consider it done." Double Trouble replied and hung up on Scratch.

At the garden, Adora, Glimmer and Catra were questioning Darkith.

"I assure you I haven't done anything. Besides, what would I gain from reporting to Horde? They most likely would want me dead." Darkith assured.

"That doesn't mean-" But Catra cut off Adora. "No, no.. she has a point there."

"But how can we trust anything she says? She would say and do anything if she benefited from it. And I saw her without her guards earlier." Adora continued.

"Actually.. I dismissed her guards." Glimmer said.

You what? And didn't tell me!?" Adora yelled. "Seriously?"

"Ugh, yes, seriously! Besides, it's not that bad! She's helped us a lot!" Glimmer argued back.

"You girls are wasting your time. The more you argue among yourselves, the closer Horde gets to victory." Darkith replied with a polite but irritated tone.

"Or you could just admit that you are the spy!" Adora said and grabbed Darkith by her collar.

She pushed Adora's hand off and sighed. "Ugh.. I'm not the villain of this spy story.. you should really get some better things to do."

Darkith replied with a monotone voice.

"Yeah, you said to me not accuse without a reason, so maybe you should do the same." Catra suggested and put hand on Adora's shoulder. "Also, you're always making sure I don't do anything stupid.. so I want to repay that favor and make sure you won't do something stupid. Because let's face it, we both do stupid things from time to time."

Adora knew Catra was right, but she didn't have any reason to believe Darkith. "Alright, but Darkith at least tell us what you were doing earlier today."

"You should have started with that.. Well, I was gardening.. what else can a slowly decaying and dying woman do?" Darkith replied. "And if you're having a trouble with a spy.. may I suggest you a one thing?"

"And what is that thing?" Catra asked.

"Well, you want to catch a rat? Then spring a trap." Darkith answered.

While Adora, Catra and Glimmer were questioning Darkith, Mermista was interrogating others with various success. Sea Hawks storied were ever changing to ever more ridiculous and could't be taken seriously. Only thing in his story that wasn't overly inflated was that of Perfuma telling her it was ok to move.

Bow told that he saw two Frosta's in his goggles, but ruled it off being a glitch. He also noticed that his communication pad was gone a moment later. This led to him believing it was his evil alter ego that would be to blame, even though it was possible to be a spy without even knowing it. Well obviously Bow couldn't be it, that much was obvious to Mermista.

Everyone's stories more or less culminated to the fact that at some point one of the princesses had shown everything was okay to move or one of them was somewhere else where they shouldn't have been.

This was complicated and it seemed that everything led to an deadend.

Now it was time to question Flutterina, mostly by Adora and Glimmer while Catra stood at the back. She was making sure Flutterina wouldn't do anything suspicious.

Glimmer let out a tired sigh and asked Flutterina; "Alright.. Flutterina, where were you when the battle started?"

"With Bow and Frosta, of course. Like we planned" She replied. Flutterina looked at both Glimmer and Adora with a worried look. "Is.. is everything okay?"

"Everything is fine." Glimmer answered.

" *Well that's a lot of rubbish..* " Catra thought to herself as she watched. She let out a chuckle. " *What a cheap play this is..* "

"Well.. it's just everyone been so anxious after what happened at Dryl." Flutterina said. "Have you tried questioning Darkith? She seems quite of untrustworthy.. or Catra?"

"First, leave Catra out of this, she's been out of it for a few days and she wasn't even with us when we planned this." Adora replied, then she changed her tone to a much more sarcastic one. "And about Darkith? Ohhh.. noo.. According to Glimmer, she's trustworthy enough to let her walk around the castle whenever she wants."

"Can we please not start this again?" Glimmer said.

"It would have been nice if you had told me." Adora replied with an annoyed tone.

"I don't have to tell you about every decision I make!" Glimmer said with a frustrated tone.

"Ohhhohh.. but you tell Darkith?!" Adora argued with a heated tone.

"Well maybe it's because she listened to me when you and Bow kept LEAVING WITHOUT ME!" Glimmer yelled.

"Hehhehh.. you two seem to have lot to talk about... I'll just come back later..." Flutterina answered with an awkward tone and started to walk towards the doors. Catra of course noticed this, but didn't want to interrupt Adora's and Glimmer's argument.

"I don't know why I'm going along with this.. Horde is obviously planning something. We should be out there, looking for them and not stuck here playing around." Glimmer said.

"No one's playing around.. there's a reason why we've been losing!" Adora argued.

"And we are going to keep losing if we don't act soon!"

"Hey.. sorry to interrupt you, but Flutterina is walking away." Catra butted in.

Flutterina stopped on her tracks and before she could say anything, the doors slammed open and other princesses came in.

"Why are you just standing there, this isn't the case Mermystery of people that kept standing around." Mermista said and pointed at Flutterina.

"Agh.. at this point, who is even left to question anymore?" Glimmer asked with a frustrated tone.

And soon the castle was filled with random people around Etheria.. how did they get there and when they arrived there? No clue.. All that was clear that none of them obviously had anything to do with the planning or with the spy thing.

Catra was laughing at the back of the room as she saw the frustration grow with everyone around them. " *How are they still so blind? How is this resistance even working?* "

Glimmer grew tired of all this stupidness and left the room, she walked away back to her room and took the stuff out. She looked out of the window at the thundering skies. Before she was about to leave, Adora came into the room. "Glimmer.. where are you going?"

"This isn't working, nothing we do is working." Glimmer answered with a tired and desperate voice. "The Horde is always one step ahead of us and I can't just sit here and wait for the next bad thing to happen!"

"So, you're going to teleport right into the Fright Zone, and try to solve this all by yourself?" Adora questioned with a worried tone.

"Someone's got to do something." Glimmer answered with determination.

"Please, Glimmer.. you can't just leave in the middle of night without backup." Adora said, trying to Glimmer to stay.

"The less people get involved, the better." Glimmer replied. "We don't know who to trust."

"But what about me, were you going to tell me? Or Bow? " Adora asked with a pleading tone.

"Adora.. I-" Glimmer began to explain, but was cut short. "Stay.. please.. I know we can figure this out if we work together." Adora put hands on Glimmer's shoulders. "No more secrets and doing things without us, we need you here.. I need you here.."

Glimmer thought for a while and threw her staff away. She looked at Adora and answered; "Alright.. I'll stay."

Then the room's doors swung open. Bow and other princesses entered. "Where have you two been?" Bow asked.

"What's wrong?" Glimmer replied.

"The war room communication pad was destroyed and so was the map." Perfuma said.

When they arrived at the war room, they saw that the table map had been shattered.

"When did this happen?" Adora asked.

"I don't know.. we were passing by the room and we saw it." Mermista answered.

"Wait, we saw you run out of here a few minutes ago." Frosta said.

"Ugh, what are you talking about?" Mermista replied. "I was with Perfuma."

"Could the storm have had something to do with it?" Perfuma suggested.

Glimmer looked at the floor where there was a broken communication pad surrounded by water "This wasn't an accident.. this was an act of sabotage." Glimmer stated dramatically.

"Hah I called it!" Catra yelled.

Meanwhile when the Princess Alliance was playing detective, near the Salenias the Horde's naval fleet was besieging the Sea Gate, without any of them knowing. Scratch was leading the armada.

Hordak had managed to finish his wonder weapon that would turn the tides of war. He had built a handheld laser cannon, integrated in his arm. With a one swift blast, he could destroy the Sea Gate and the Horde troops could just swarm in.

"Alright, there is no need for prisoners! Scratch yelled as she drew her sword and felt the great power in it. **"Show no mercy, kill them all!"**

What followed next wasn't a battle, or a siege.. it was a bloody massacre. Did Salenias have any strategic meaning? Yes. Was it a heavily fortified military base? Not at all. None survived and Scratch was a bit too thrilled about it.

After the one sided massacre, the Horde banners hung over the destroyed Sea Gate. Now the Horde had control over the seas and this would put the Princess Alliance in a tight spot.

Hordak and Scratch marveled at their successful strike at Salenias. This was truly worth all that sacrifice they had made.

Now all of the princesses, including Catra, Bow and Seah Hawk were once again in the same room as before. Everyone sat around the table and each of them had looks of distrust, awkwardness and uneasiness.

Glimmer was standing by the fireplace and stated; "The general is working on restoring the communications, in the meantime.. there's a backup device in the dining room, should we need it."

What Glimmer had said piqued Flutterina's interest.

Mermista slammed her hands on the doors. "All of us here knew that we were trying to unmask the spy." Mermista said and turned to look at others. "And we all made the plans to take back the Dryl. We've ruled out all other suspects, which means the spy must be one of us."

Everyone was shocked, except Catra since for her this all was a waste of time and the spy was obvious, but she decided to keep her mouth shut this time. Let them discover it their own way.

"Perfuma was the one who let the Horde take the doors!" Frosta broke awkward silence and pointed towards Perfuma.

"I wasn't there!" Perfuma defended. "Wait.. your team was the one who told us it's okay to come in and you led Mermista away!"

"I did not!" Frosta said.

"Trying to shift the blame on someone else, huh Frosta?" Mermista added.

"If Memrista knows so much about mysteries, she would probably be able to plan the perfect crime!" Frosta blamed.

"Oh.. and there was water near the pad!" Perfuma said and took Frosta's side.

"Which could have been melted ice!" Mermista argued.

"It's probably me!" Bow confessed.

"It's not you BOW!" Frosta yelled.

"Oh or maybe it is.. like in Mermysteries, The Alter Ego." Mermista suggested.

"It couldn't have been me, I was busy fighting at least two hundred soldiers!" Sea Hawk said.

"This really is waste of time Glimmer!" Adora stated. "Shouldn't we be-" But Adora couldn't finish her sentence before Glimmer cut in. "Stop! Stop questioning my choices, stop whining about being the decoy.. Just Stop!"

"I'm not whining!" Adora said and stood up to face Glimmer.

"All you do is question me, question my authority! It-it's exhausting!"

"Just look at what she's doing to you, Darkith wants power and you're listening to her!"

"Or what? Are you jealous because Darkith doesn't care about you anymore? Or is it because I'm the queen and in charge while you're not?" Glimmer said with a dismissive tone.

"That's ridiculous!" Adora yelled.

"You just run around, playing the perfect hero! You have no idea how hard it's been for me!"

"Because you stopped including me in your decisions! Adora said with a desperate tone. "We used to be a team and now I don't know what we are!"

While Adora and Glimmer were arguing, one of the princesses had disappeared from the room. And it was no surprise who it was, at least not for Catra.

"I knew it was her." Catra said, breaking Glimmer's and Adora's act.

"I feel so stupid..." Glimmer stated. "Well.. we should catch her now!"

At the empty dining room, Flutterina was looking for the backup communication device, but she was found out quickly. The lights went on and she was stopped on her tracks.

Adora and Glimmer stood infront of her. "Hey Flutterina!" Glimmer said, smirking. "Looking for something?"

"Ohhoh.. hey.. Glimmer.. Adora.. hi.. hi.. I was just looking for the bathroom." Flutterina stuttered and tried to move away, but bumped into Bow. And next to him were other princesses.

"Ehhehehh.. I know this looks bad, but it's not what it looks like.. so lets.. just.." Flutterina tried to talk her way out of this while all of them closed on her. She kicked Adora to the leg and started running quickly, but she was knocked off by Catra's stuff and she rolled right into the magic circle. She tried to get away, but noticed it was useless.. She was locked inside.

"I always wanted that." Catra said with a fulfilled expression.

"Give it up Flutterina! If that's who you really are?!" Glimmer stated.

"Oh.. I see.. magic.. how very clever.." Flutterina said as she poked the barrier with her finger.

"Isn't it? And can you believe, Darkit helped out." Adora explained.

Mermista pushed bot Adora and Glimmer to the side and exclaimed excitedly; "Revealing the murderer is the best part of Mermysteries!"

"To catch a rat, you need to spring a trap. So we set up one of our own, classic murder mystery move.." Mermista kept explaining.

"Ugh.. there's not murder.. nevermind." Glimmer sighed. "We knew that the backup communication would be irresistible to whoever destroyed the original."

"We wanted the spy to feel comfortable enough to make moves, so we created a diversion." Adora continued.

"Adora managed to act believably.. for once." Glimmer joked.

"It was really hard, don't ever ask me to do it again." Adora replied.

"So that brings us back to you.. who are you really?" Glimmer said and stepped closer to Flutterina, only for her to change form into Glimmer, which scared her enough to back off.

Flutterina kept changing into everyone, except Catra. Lastly, she took the form of Adora. "Please.. call me.. Double Trouble." And then they revealed their real self.

"Wow.. you're a shapeshifter?!"

"So it wasn't my goggles glitching, it was you, pretending to be Frosta at teh Dryl!" Bow gasped.

"And Perfuma, don't shortchange my credit darling." Double Trouble answered and bowed. "May I say as one actor to another, that was truly a masterful performance." They complimented. "I really bought that you two were infurious with each other, would you indulge me, were you inspired by any real experience?"

"Enough Double Trouble, it's over! Now tell us what the Hirde is planning!" Glimmer demanded with a strict tone.

"Over?" They answered with a mocking tone. "Darling, it's just the beginning. The Horde has been a massive attack for some time now. I was the one who let Scratch know that you were going to Dryl. After that all I had to do was to plant seeds of doubt, showing chaos wherever I could. It wasn't hard.. I just had to keep you isolated and on each other's throat until.. the plan was under way."

Everyone was listening in shock as Double Trouble kepe explaining. "Salenias.. If the Horde controls the sea.. they control Etheria."

Mermista was shocked and taken back, her kingdom was under attack while she was playing detective.

"That will never happen, we will not let it happen." Glimmer stated. "Now that we know the plan, we can stop it!"

When hearing this, Double Trouble couldn't do anything else than laugh. "Stop it? Oh this was a ruse darling, a distraction. The battle of Salenias is over, it happened earlier today.. though I would call it a massacre more than a fair battle. It's too late.. Salenias.. is gone." They finished their sentence with a serious and deep tone.

Mermista was shocked. her kingdom was already destroyed.. "No... it can't be..."

"No- no.. it's not too late. I-It can be!" Glimmer hastily stuttered, she grabbed Mermista and others hands and teleported them to the cliff near Salenias. What awaited them was a horrible sight. Horde flags flapping in the wind as Salenias was burning ruins. Sea Gate was fallen, statues broken and lots of sunken ships at the coast.. none survived..

Last time Catra had seen destruction on this scale was back when she and Shadow Weaver went to her old home. This was enough

to shock Catra, but it must have been most hard for Mermista. It was her kingdom and her people were killed while she was playing supid detective. Memrista fell on her knees as she couldn't fathom this situation.

"W-we can fix this, we have to!" Adora said with a desperate tone and grabbed Glimmer's shoulder. "We can fix this... right?"

Catra knew all of this could have been avoided if they had listened to her from the start. She had to control herself not to ruin this. This was hard enough already and she was sure everyone felt guilty enough.

Glimmer face turned from sad to determined. "We.. won't let this happen again! I won't let this happen again! We won't give up, what ever Horde throws at us, we bounce right back up!" Glimmer said with determination and anger in her tone as she wiped the tears off. "We will take back Salenias, we'll take back all of Etheria! No matter the cost!"

Chapter End Notes

Also.. SW has taken a sidestep... I promise though that the next chapter includes her since... this whole story is named after her... should I chage the name of the story?
Since this has deviated so much from my initial simple plan I had when I started this story.

-Bonus 2-

Chapter Summary

This bouns will include some updated drawings of the characters.

Chapter Notes

After that last chapter.. things are bit grim at the moment. So I decided to lighten up things a bit.

-Entity.. put your tendrils away Entity, I'm not having ### with you right now Entity.-

~Shadow Weaver.. I don't know but, you've been seeming a bit sus lately~

See the end of the chapter for more notes

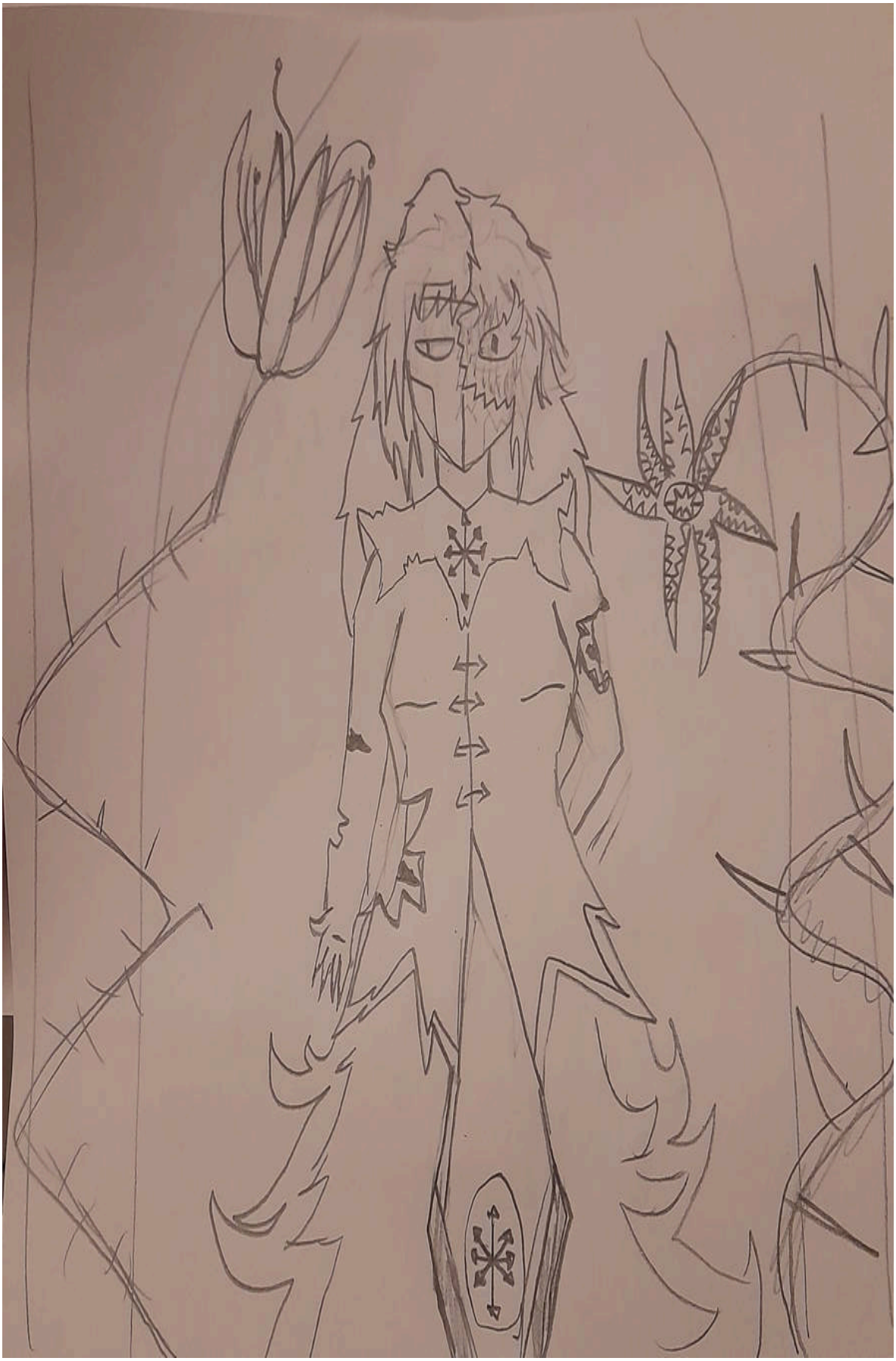
First off, we have Shadow Weaver and the Entity at the Beast Island.


WHAT
IS THAT
MONSTRO
STAY

Second, we have Catra with her artificial magic staff.



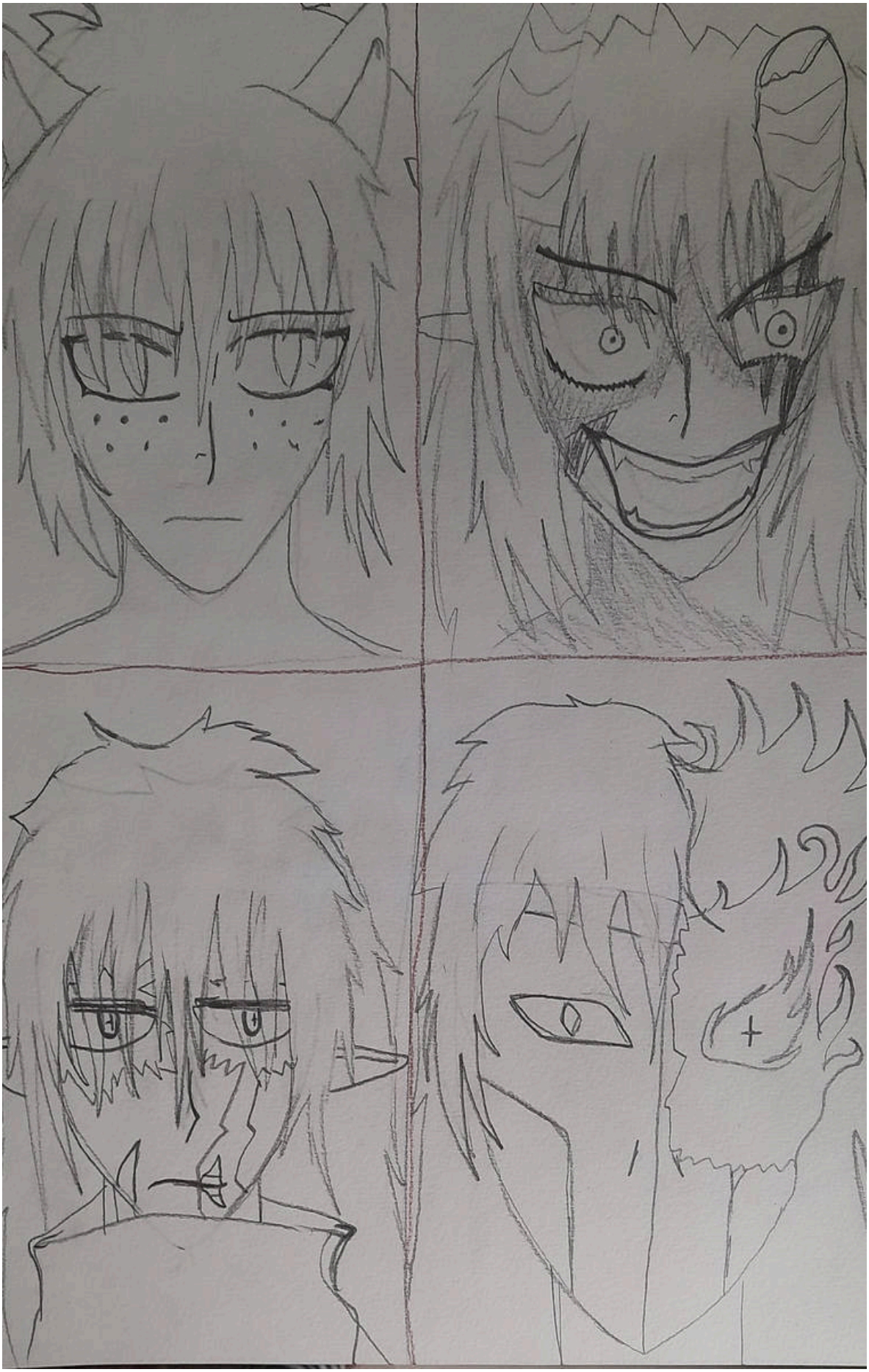
Thirdly, Darkith and her garden.



Fourth, we have Scratch with the enchanted sword Darkith gave her.


SCRATCH

And lastly, we have the Duality of faces.



This one includes; Lower left corner, Shadow Weaver, right upper corner, Catra.

Right upper corner, Scratch showing her madness.

and right lower corner, Darkith..

Chapter End Notes

"I was just business'them', doing business."
~Double Trouble

"Geneva Convention? More like Geneva Suggestion."
~Scratch

"Haa haa handheld laser canon go brrr brrr!"
~Hordak

OKAY, STOP WITH THE STUPID PUNS AND GET BACK INTO THE STORY!

Can We Fix This? No We Can't!

Chapter Summary

> Horde keeps gaining more ground across the sealine and in Plumeria. The Princess Alliance is in a pinch worse than ever before. Alliance crumbling and friendships cracking, the end is nigh...
>
> Meanwhile Shadow Weaver wants to see Entrapta's progress on the ship she had promised to make, things don't go as smoothly as Shadow Weaver had expected.
>
> Hordak want's to finally take action on the field and commands Scratch back to Froght Zone and to await his orders. Scratch hesitently agrees to this and notices that someone she used to talk is gone.

Chapter Notes

> Alright, lets see what I can make of this mess I have written...

Hordak is on a roll, once again another shoreline town has fallen. It was only a lucky strike for the Princess Alliance that they managed to at least save half of the town people.

Without Glimmer's help, surely they would have lost more. Glimmer watched from the ship as the Horde's tanks rolled into the town and it was engulfed with flame.

More people have lost their homes and the amount of refugees is ever growing.

After arriving at the Brightmoon, the Princess Alliance held a meeting at the war room.

"I know things have been rough since we lost Salenias, but we are picking up the pieces. I mean we got Double Trouble.. though they're not going to talk to us.." Bow said, trying to uplift the defeated mood in the room. "i'm sure we can turn this around. "Soo.. uhhh, you scouted the Southern coast, what did it look like there?"

"On fire!" Swift Wind answered.

"Umm.. Anything more specific?"

"On lots of fire!"

"Oh.. that's bad.. like really bad... umm Adora, you were communicating with Frosta. How's the situation there?" Bow asked.

"Well, she said the Horde hasn't breached yet. She claims Horde troops are freezing in their trenches.." Adora said and sighed in deep. "Horde has really picked up the pace.."

"Well at least Sea Hawk, Neotssa and Spinnerella managed to save at least half of the townspeople from the shoreline, with Glimmer, who didn't tell us she was going and just showed up there." Bow explained.

"Glimmer, again?!" Adora questioned. "You can't keep running off and not tell us."

"Argh! Where have I heard that before? Oh right, when I stayed here to find the spy and Salenias fell! You want me to wait and sit here as Etheria burns? I am the queen and I have my responsibilities." Glimmer defended herself with a fiery tone. "You just aren't effective enough!"

"Hey! That's unreasonable!" Adora yelled. "We didn't know!"

"Tell that to Mermista!

"Oh.. where is she by the way?" Swift Wind asked.

"Well.. she's taking it hard after losing her kingdom.. so she's having some 'me time'." Sea Hawk answered.

"Me time.. great! We all could use that, so we should all check up on each others more often.." Bow said awkwardly. "Uhh.. Hey Catra, you were at Plumeria. What's the situation there?"

"Eh, half the kingdom has burned onto the ground, Perfuma had evacuated her people into Whispering Woods and she plans to set up a refugee camp there." Catra answered and crossed her arms. "I did all I could to buy time for the people, but it wasn't enough.. we lost third of the Plumerians."

"Which is why we shouldn't waste time, we should act!" Glimmer stated. "Catra, weren't you supposed to be a skilled fighter and sorcerer?! How did you manage to lose that many Plumerians?!"

"Glimmer!" Adora yelled.

Catra stood up from the chair, picked her staff up and slammed the staff on the floor to blow off her frustration. "Well excuse me, princess, for not fighting a whole army while saving citizens! I have my limits! You want me to go to the Fright Zone and get rid of them all? Well that's not going to happen!"

"So now you're questioning my authority as well?" Glimmer answered defensively. "You are impudent, short tempered, rude, impulsive and prone to violence and lashing out when things go as you wanted! Well you know what, things don't always go as you want! Our situation is a perfect example of it!"

"Fine! I'll leave, if that makes you feel better!" Catra snapped and scraped the table with her claws. She turned away and stomped towards the doors.

"Yeah run away, like you always do when things don't look good! Proves how much of a childish brat you are!" Glimmer yelled.

Catra didn't care, she only lifted her hand and showed middle finger to Glimmer.

Adora ran after her trying to stop her. "Please Catra don't go. Don't make things any harder than they already are. I need you here, we all need you here.." Adora pleaded. Catra stopped on her tracks and sighed.

"I'm sorry, but I can't take this anymore. It's for the best if I leave.. for me, for you and for everyone.. I just need some time.." Catra said and walked out of the doors.

Adora was disappointed that things had come to this, so she had to confront Glimmer about this. "That was uncalled for. You do know Catra has gone through alot as well?!" Adora said as she returned to the table.

"I don't care.. we have more urgent matters on our hands." Glimmer stated.

Bow felt really out of place, all the parts had fallen apart and he felt like he was trying to keep them together with a tape.

"Okay.. so.." But Bow couldn't say more as he was cut off by Glimmer. "Let's just end this meeting! Clearly nothing comes from it!"

"Agreed." Adora answered and walked off towards her room, while Glimmer walked off to another direction. Their bonds were clearly at a breaking point.

Now only Bow, Sea Hawk and Swift Wind remained there.

"Uhh.. so.. Hey, we should go hang out." Sea Hawk suggested. "You know, boys night out!"

"That sounds wonderful." Swift Wind answered.

"But shouldn't we-" But before Bow could finish his sentence, Swift Wind grabbed both him and Sea Hawk and flew away. "Too late, we're out!"

"Ugh..."

Meanwhile at the conquered town, Hordak and Scratch were admiring their work. "Another town has fallen. There was no resistance here." Scratch said.

"They are running away like the cowards they are." Hordak said with a satisfied grin on his face.

Then one Horde soldier came to Scratch ."Commander Scratch, there are fifty survivors.. what should we do to them?"

"Execute them." Scratch replied.

"But Commander, shouldn't we take prisoners?" Soldier asked.

"Just execute them or I'll execute you for not following my orders. Did I make myself clear?" Scratch answered with a threatening tone.

"A-Aye, Commander." Soldier replied with a gulp. "Right on the way."

"Scratch, I know you're eager to assert dominance, but don't be so reckless. We do need more soldiers in our ranks." Hordak said as he looked at Scratch.

"Alright then.. Hey soldier.. just execute half of them, the rest become prisoners." Scratch said.

"Right a way."

"Scratch, I want you to return to the Fright Zone and await my further orders." Hordak said.

"But Lord Hordak, I want to be on a field."

"There's a lot of things to be done in the Fright Zone and I don't have time for it now. Horde Prime is on his way and I want to show him how I've brought Etheria to its knees. That's an order."

"Yes.. Lord Hordak." Scratch replied with disdain in her voice.

Scratch prepared to leave and contacted Scorpia. "Hey Scorpia, I'm coming back from the field. You better have cleaned my office before I arrive. Understand?"

But she could only receive static noise and no answer.

" *Maybe she finally learned to actually shut up.* "

It's been a few days since Entraptas' examination of Shadow Weaver. Entrapta had promised to start working on the ship after she had researched the scar tissue from Shadow Weaver.

"Hey Micah."

"Yeah?" Micah replied.

I'm thinking of paying a visit to Entrapta." Shadow Weaver said.

"Sure, but promise you'll be careful out there."

"Look at that, my star pupil is still looking after me. Even though I'm older than you." Shadow Weaver answered with a witty tone that made Micah feel awkward.

"Ugh.. just go.. you are making things unnecessarily weird." Mich grunted.

"I was just joking, well take care." Shadow Weaver replied and left.

" *Seriously, this isn't like her.* " Micah thought to himself.

Shadow Weaver was walking in the forest and Entity decided to wake up. " *Ugh.. where are we going?* "

"Oh, you're up?" Shadow Weaver asked. "I was wondering if you were awake, it's been quite peaceful today."

" *Oh you're starting with that kind of attitude?* " Spell of Obtainment asked with a snarky tone. " *Where are we going anyway?* "

"Take a joke will you.." Shadow Weaver replied. "Well I thought of paying a visit to Entrapta."

" *Oh no! No.. absolutely not! I refuse!* " Entity began to fight back. " *I'm not going to that crazy freak.. no.. not in a million years!* "

"Well that's too bad, we're halfway there already." Shadow Weaver replied with a smug tone. "You're going exactly where I'm going."

" *No! Don't you understand it is a threat on a multi-dimensional level, you are setting the whole universe at risk and causing the end of the world! You'll cause irreversible damage on a cosmic scale! I hope you will understand what you've done! It's not too late to save reality, so just for the Entities sake turn back!"* Spell of Obtainment rambled maniacally.

"Seriously, its just one princess.." Shadow Weaver said and rolled her eyes. "Stop being so dramatic, Im sure there are a lot more pressing matters than this.."

After a while of trekking and a whole lot of bickering, Shadow Weaver finally arrived at Entrapta's.. whatever you could call her.. makeshift laboratory.

"Entrapta, are you here?" Shadow Weaver asked.

Entrapta flung from the roof and was hanging upside down. "Oh hi there. Didn't expect you so soon." She greeted Shadow Weaver.

"Well.. I just decided to pay a small visit and see how that ship of yours is going."

"Oh.. that.. well I had quite good progress on it for a good measure, but I had to halt it.. for.. reasons.."

"What kind of reasons?" Shadow Weaver inquired.

"Uhh.. you remember that scar tissue sample I took."

"Yes..?"

"Well the scar.. just ran away so to speak." Entrapta explained.

"Wait.. it's just some tissue.. How can it run away? Entity.. you know something of it?" Shadow Weaver said.

" *Even if I did, I wouldn't tell you.* " Entity replied.

"Well of course you wouldn't.." Shadow Weaver muttered. She then looked at Entrapta. "Well, you can still make that ship, right?"

"Of course.. I just would have wanted to examine that scar tissue of yours a bit more.. its out of this world." Entrapta explained.

"If you want, you're free to take another one." Shadow Weaver replied and pulled her sleeves. "There, take a piece if you want."

"Really, that's so generous of you. You know.. the little I heard about you.. I didn't take you as this kind of person." Entrapta said and cut a small piece of Shadow Weaver's scar tissue.

"Well.. don't judge a book by its cover. That's what they say.." Shadow Weaver replied.

" *And once again.. you ignored me..* " Entity muttered with a distanced tone. " *You never consider my opinion or feelings..* "

"What, you have feels now?" Shadow Weaver asked. "Never thought my little Entity had feelings."

"What?! *No, I didn't mean like that... ugh you are such a bitch!* "

Shadow Weaver only chuckled, Entity’s childishness and pettines were really amusing.

At Brightmoon, Catra was sulking in the garden. Wondering what did Glimmer have against her. She had done all she could, so why was it not enough?

Darkith was nearby in her garden and the storm clouds above Catra were bothering her. "Do you mind taking your sulking to somewhere else? You are killing my plants with that attitude."

Catra turned to look at Darkith and replied with an uninteresting tone. "I don't care.. give me one good reason not to blast you next week."

"Glimmer would most certainly not like it." Darkith chuckled.

"Of course, you're wrapped Glimmer with your fingers. Sometimes I wonder why Shadow Weaver even helped you." Catra muttered.

"There's simple answer to that, Shadow Weaver was cuffed with anti-magic chains, so she couldn't use her own magic." Darkith calmly explained. "I'd say the situation was like, my enemy's enemy is my friend."

"That still doesn't change the fact that I would want to kill you.. I'm already on bad terms with her, so what could she do to hurt me?" Catra answered and pointed her staff towards Darkith.

"Wait! You wouldn't blast a dying and unarmed woman, now would you." Darkith cowered and hastily raised her arms.

"You're already dying, I would be doing both of us a favor." Catra said.

"Wait! What if Adora were to hear you killed me? Surely she wouldn't want you to go that path!"

What Darkith had just said stopped Catra for a moment, what would Adora think if she would kill someone in cold blood. Well, she lost the chance because Glimmer happened to stop by. Noticing Catra threatening Darkith, she stepped in.

"Catra! What are you doing!?"

" *Ugh great...* " Catra thought to herself and rolled her eyes. She put her staff away.

"Oh well if it isn't the queen." Darkith quickly gathered herself up. "How may I serve you?"

" *You are such an asskisser...* " Catra muttered. "Oh, well hello there... Glimmer."

"Were you threatening to kill Darkith? You know she's a valuable asset and I need her to teach me magic." Glimmer said with a scolding tone. "But I guess your simple minded brains wouldn't understand that."

"You should really think about who you ally with.. princess." Catra growled and walked away.

"I'm queen, it's not princess anymore!" Glimmer yelled. "It's you who should be careful!"

Catra didn't bother to answer Glimmer, it was just better to walk away or things would escalate further. Catra walked around the castle, she went to check on Mara's ship, only to notice no-one was working on it. This meant that getting on Beast Island would be delayed.

Then Catra walked back to her room and went to sit on the balcony rail. She stared at the horizon, shedding one tear. How had things come to this?

She could overhear Glimmer practicing magic with Darkith. " *Why won't she ask Castaspella for that? Shouldn't she be just as capable?* " Catra let out a deep sigh and after sitting there for like an hour dwelling in her thoughts, she decided to leave. No use just sitting there and doing nothing.

However, she'd at least inform Adora. It wouldn't be right to not tell her.

She looked for Adora for a while, but didn't seem to find her. Until she heard that she was with Mermista, who was still moping from losing her kingdom.

When Catra arrived there, she saw Glimmer Adora argue once again. She hid herself behind the corner and eavesdropped on what they were arguing about.

"You think you can just transform into She-Ra and hit things with your sword and it'll fix it!" Glimmer yelled. "Well guess what, its not working!"

"Glimmer, why are you blaming all of this on me? It is not my fault that Salenias fell, Horde manipulated us all!" Adora argued back.

"She-Ra was supposed to save us, but the Rebellion is in a worse place than ever since YOU SHOWED UP!"

"I'm trying my best to Glimmer.. why can't you see that?"

Catra listened, gritting her teeth. She was about to snap, but what really crossed the line was what Glimmer said next.

"Well maybe your best isn't good enough! If it was, my mother would still be here!"

Ador went silent, what Glimmer just said to her broke her. It was heartbreaking enough when Angella sacrificed herself for them and now she was blamed for it.

For a second, Glimmer regretted what she had said. "A-Adora.. I-I'm sorry."

" *Okay, that's enough!* " Catra said and stomped angrily towards Glimmer. "Why do you have to treat Adora like that?!"

"Oh, Catra.. h-how long were you there?" Glimmer stuttered.

"Why are you blaming her?! She's done nothing but her best to help you and your failing kingdom! You blame her for your mothers death, but do you have any idea how she feels! And if someone should be blamed for her death, it should be me!" Catra

yelled with anger. "You think blaming us makes some difference?! It doesn't!"

"Catra, I didn't mean what I said." Glimmer tried to defend herself.

"No, you meant every word you said. I know when someone means what they say!" Catra said with a growl and deathly stare. She looked so angry that someone might have thought that she would kill someone. But she didn't, she grabbed Adora's arm, ready to pull her with her . "Come on Adora, you are not guilty of anything. No one deserves that kind of treatment."

But then Mermista burst through the doors. "Our boys are in danger! A seagull told me! I may have lost my kingdom, but I'm not losing anyone else! Sea-Ra is back in action!" Mermista declared and dragged Adora, Glimmer and Catra along with her.

Meanwhile at the Horde ship, Bow, Sea Hawk and Swift Wind were tied up and waiting for someone to rescue them.

"So.. what happened to the eye?" Sea Hawk asked the force captain.

"Oh this? Scratch poked it out when she was six..." Octavia said, then she pulled up a stun baton. "And I bet she's going to do the exact same thing to you!"

"I don't care..." Bow said with a defeated tone.

"Hey! I'm threatening you!" Octavia said.

"I don't care!" Bow answered with a louder voice. "I'm tired of being the friendly upbeat guy all the time.. I understand it's hard to be friends sometimes, you got to work at it.. So why am I always the only one who's willing to work at it?! I mean.. they

didn't even notice I'm gone. Do whatever you want... I don't care..."

Octavia was taken back by what Bow had said and it had completely killed her fun. "Ugh, Scorpia can you meet at the rendezvous point, someone gotta get this kid off... he's ruining my mood." But she didn't get any answer. "Force Captain Scorpia?"

"Force Captain Octavia, we got magic incoming!" One of the soldiers yelled.

"What the?"

A bright magical flash appeared in front of the ship and there came Glimmer, Mermista, Adora and Catra. Ready to swoop off the Horde soldiers. Adora transformed into She-Ra and with swift swings of her sword she wiped the ship deck effortlessly.

Glimmer cut the ropes and lended her hand to Bow, raising him up from the deck. she quickly dispelled incoming Horde soldiers.

Meanwhile Sea Hawk clapped the cheeks of two of the soldiers. "Hey Mermista, you-re back in the action!"

"And never felt better, saving people is my jam!" She replied while swooshing one guar over the board.

Catra didn't even try, she saw no reason to. She only came along because of Adora. Apathetically she blasted the guards off from the deck and when there was only one guard left, she swiftly kicked him in the back and threw him off the boat.

After a nice and easy swipe, Bow Sea Hawk, Mermista and Swift Wind were cheering. Their friendship and teamwork had paid off, but both Glimmer and Adora didn't feel like cheering. Catra had purposefully stayed at the back, she couldn't consider this as friendship. They were so dysfunctional.

Adora and Glimmer separated their ways and Bow didn't know what to do.

After a while of sailing and as the sun began to set. Adora sat alone at the ships rail, Catra next to her. Catra really didn't want to press on Adora, she knew when to keep your mouth shut. All she tried to do was to comfort Adora silently as best as she could.

Then Glimmer walked towards Adora and was about to put hand on her shoulder. Bow thought that maybe they were going to make up, but Adora's reaction was to run off to the other side of the ship.

"Seriously Glimmer? Can't you read the room?" Catra asked with a frustrated tone.

"Well I was just trying to make up for what I had said." Glimmer answered.

"No, you should give her some time. People aren't always ready to talk when they are hurt." Catra said. "Now she probably tries to avoid me as well."

"Ugh!" Glimmer huffed and walked away.

Bow hesitantly walked to Adora, carefully asking about what happened between the two.

Adora sighed and replied with; "I know what I have to do, Bow. I'm going to look for Mara's weapon, the one she mentioned in her message. Maybe it can turn the tide of the war for us... it has to..."

"What are you talking about? Glimmer doesn't need a weapon, she needs her friends." Bow said with a concerned tone.

"No she doesn't.." Adora answered with a low and sad voice. "It doesn't matter, I'm going to fix this. No matter what Glimmer

thinks of me.."

Catra overheard this as well and was quite concerned, though it was good she isn't going to stick with Glimmer.

Back at Fright Zone, Scratch arrived at her office. She kicked the door open and went to sit on her chair. She looked at the floor and saw the blood stains from earlier. " *So she didn't even bother..* "

She picked up her communication device. "Scorpia, answer me! Why haven't you cleaned up that mess?!" But all she got from an answer was silence and static noise. " *Ugh, I need to do everything myself...* "

Scratch then stomped towards Scorpias room and kicked the door open. "Scorpia! Why aren't you answering!?" But to her surprise, the room was empty. On Scorpias bed was her Horde padge, the leather jacket from Crimson Wastes and a note.

Scratch picked up the note and read it. " *I'm done! You're a bad friend.* " She dropped everything on the floor. To think Scorpia actually had thought her as a friend, how stupid. You don't have friends in the Horde, only rivals and underlings.

Still, something itched her in the wrong way, who does she now ramble or boss around? Who's there to offer empty praise and solutions? Scratch noticed that she had shed a single tear. When she wiped it off, she began to laugh silently.

Her silent laugh soon turned into maniac cackling. How could someone ever be so stupid as to consider her as a friend?

Searching For Weapon of Mass Destruction.

Chapter Summary

Adora doesn't see any other option anymore and decides to go look for the weapon Mara had mentioned, she doesn't know the weapon she's looking for is meant to massdestruction. It seems her only lead is Madam Razz, who can pass through past, present and future. Adora and Mara will have they fateful meeting.

At Beast Island, Shadow Weaver and Entrapta shares their theories about Etheria, alongside with the Entity.

Chapter Notes

So this chapter includes Mara and Razz, but since they are going to be one chapter characters mostly Im not tagging them as characters.

Also, this chapter will be pain to write, as was the portal dimension... so I'm skipping a lot. I know all you who read this, know what happens at this point. You can fill some of the blanks in.. I would just lose my mind trying to actually write this whole episode as an chapter...

In the middle of Whispering Woods, Adora and Catra were looking for Madam Razz, who lived deep in the heart of the woods and she surely would be the best lead for them. Mara's ship had been transported deep into the Whispering Woods, just so if the Horde attacked Brightmoon or anything nearby, they wouldn't get their hands on the last First Ones ship. Their fallout with Glimmer had been severe, so severe in fact that Bow had promised to try to fix the ship himself. Even if Glimmer didn't like it.

So now, Adora and Catra trek through Whispering Woods.

"You know, this Madame Razz.. sounds a lot like Shadow Weaver.." Catra said. "Minus the killing of a sorceress and being wanted for her crimes.."

"Catra, I assure you. Razz is not like Shadow Weaver. She can use magic, yes, but I don't know if she would be considered a sorcerer." Adora replied.

"Well, can't help but feel like it. Old lady living in the woods, practicing magic and whatnot.."

"I can't see how you can make that kind of conclusion, you haven't even met her." Adora said.

"Well maybe, when I meet her. It'll change my mind.."

They continued their trekking until they reached a small cottage next to a great tree.

"And she lives in a tree." Catra said. "Would there be a chance they are related?"

"What? Shadow Weaver and Razz?" Adora asked with a puzzled look on her face. "No.. that's impossible."

They entered the cottage and Adora called for Razz, who had just moments earlier interacted with Mara from the past. "Hey Madame Razz, do you happen to know something about that super weapon Mara mentioned? If it exists.. maybe it could turn the tides of war for us.."

"Oh, Mara. You are just in time."

"Uhh.. Im Adora, not Mara." Adora answered.

"Are you sure she knows anything?" Catra asked her, with a silent tone.

"She knows more than she lets know.. she's always been there when something important happens.. like in the portal realm."

Adora explained.

"I'll take your word on that." Catra replied.

"So, Razz.. can you help me?"

"We have no time, we got to bake that pie." Razz said. She searched and scrambled all kinds of things into her basket and headed outside. "Now to collect some of those ingredients."

"Razz?! Where are you going?!" Adora yelled, but it was in vain. Razz was already gone.

"Wow... she's definitely not like Shadow Weaver." Catra stated.

"Well thanks for pointing out the obvious." Adora said and sighed.

They followed Madam Razz through the woods till they arrived at the First Ones ruin. "Oh.. its a First Ones ruin.." Adora stated, sounding like she didn't expect that.

"What's so impressive about that?" Catra asked. "This whole forest is full of them.. and my home was also somewhere here.."

"You lived in Whispering Woods before Shadow Weaver took you in?"

"Yes, but that place was destroyed by the Horde.. I'm the only survivor.. at least according to Shadow Weaver.." Catra said with a somber tone. "We even went there, to explore the ruins.. that's where I got this ornament I'm wearing."

"I'm so sorry to hear that.. I didn't know.." Adora said with an apologizing tone.

"You don't have to worry about it.." Catra answered. "Hey.. where's Razz?"

"Ah great! We lost her again..." Adora grunted.

"Did I distract you too much?" Catra said with a smirk on her face. "Be honest."

"Agh.. lets just find Razz, okay?" Adora said with an embarrassed tone and Catra could see a light blush on her cheeks.

" *I knew it.. she doesn't take teasing well..* " Catra thought to herself.

At Entrapta's makeshift laboratory, Shadow Weaver is still staying there. Even if she couldn't quite understand all of Entrapta's scientific things and inventions, she was still intrigued by them. They were working on their own or by pressing a button. Like magic, but still not magic. Shadow Weaver decided to ask Entrapta what she thought about Etheria, because she had herself began to question many of the things she was told when she was in Mystacor.

"Hey Entrapta", what do you think about Etheria?"

"What? You're asking from me?" Entrapta said with an excited tone and stopped her tinkering. "Are you asking about my theories?!"

"Well, since you seem to be knowledgeable on how to combine First Ones tech with Etheria's. And as far as I know.. it should be impossible." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Oh where do I even start?! I have so many things on my mind!" Entrapta exclaimed. "I have written a whole bunch of notes as well! Wait a sec, I'll go get them!"

"I'm listening.." Shadow Weaver replied.

" *What? So we aren't leaving!?* " Entity huffed. " *I can't believe you!* "

"Sush and go away, unless you want to join me and Entrapta." Shadow Weaver replied.

" *Joining in what? More experiments?!* "

"No, our theories about Etheria."

" *I know a lot more about Etheria than you or that crazed princess would ever know!* "

"Then you are free to join us."

" *I don't want to.* "

"Then go away, I don't need you to talk into my ear the whole time." Shadow Weaver said.

"Hmph.. *Fine. I'll join your theory session. It's better than being alone...* " Entity replied with an awful silent tone.

"What? You get lonely there?" Shadow Weaver asked, smirking.

" *No it's not like that! Ugh, you are causing this to me and I don't know why!* "

"Alright, I got the notes." Entrapta said as she came back. But now she saw something she had never before seen. Some sort of humanoid Entity, composed of dark matter, tendril-like arms which some had mouths and some had eyes. "Whaaat is that??!"

"Ah well, this is the Spell of Obtainment. The Entity that leeches inside of me." Shadow Weaver replied.

" *Listen here princess, I'm here only because I was bored. And you should consider yourself a lucky one. You are in the presence of an interdimensional being. Few had encountered me and even*

fewer had managed to survive! " Spell of Obtainment said with a showboating and boasting tone, presenting itself as great as possible.

"Ooooh! You are from another dimension?! So you know about life outside of Etheria!?" Entrapta gushed excitedly. "Do you have a name?!"

" *What? No! Entities don't need one, we are much greater than any name could ever give us!* "

Shadow Weaver rolled her eyes, somehow the Entity had managed to make her feel second hand embarrassment. But Entrapta didn't care, she found this exciting.

"Great, then I'll call you Jeff!" Entrapta replied with a cheerful tone. "Now Jeff, tell us everything you know!"

" *What? Jeff?! What kind of name is Jeff?!* " Entity huffed.

"It suits you." Shadow Weaver answered with an amused tone.

" *No way I agree to this kind of humiliation!* "

"But Jeff, please! I want to know! I've studied my whole life and always believed there's more behind the despandos." Entrapta said.

"*UWääPOJJihääPÅLöddkÅQO>ZJDFFI....**'unhinged entity noises'*** Fine, *do call me whatever you want.. though I still won't accept it..*"

"That's great!" Entrapta exclaimed and flipped her notepad open. "Im on all ears."

So, all three of them began to share their theories. Entity mostly filled in blanks or corrected some mistakes.

Shadow Weaver believed that Etheria was something else than just a normal planet, First Ones were so interested about this

planet and their ruins, technology and even teachings can still be found to this day. Shadow Weaver also felt that Whispering Woods was the only place in Etheria where magic was running freely.

"I've seen strange creatures in Whispering Woods and sometimes even pure magic, though I had and still have no idea how to harvest it and at this point.. I don't even want to.."

Entrapta's theories were that the First Ones had actually mechanized the planet. As evident by the runestones. She explained that it was her who was behind the plan to hack the planet with Black Garnet. Clearly First Ones had something bigger in their mind.

"I've spent most of my life trying to solve the mysteries of the First Ones and this island is the most excellent place to do that. So much First Ones tech here.."

And this is where Entity comes in, Entity told them about the First Ones who controlled many planets and their civilization was most advanced in the whole universe, only rivaled by the Horde.

And this meant Horde and First ones used to clash on galactic scales, as an Entity who exists nowhere and everywhere. It had seen everything unfold.

" *So, the First Ones began to develop a secret weapon, which I'm pretty sure is here on Etheria. Entrapta, you are right about the fact that the runestones are in connections and are meant to activate the super weapon. And Shadow Weaver, I can assure you.. this planet is so much more due to its magical potential. That is the initial reason I wanted to be summoned here, though it kind of backfired..* " Spell of Obtainment explained thoroughly.

"Wow.. when you aren't on your crazed trip about consuming Etheria, you are quite knowledgeable.. even tolerable." Shadow Weaver said with a smile.

" *And I can say.. that maybe Entrapta isn't so bad after all.. maybe I should have taken her as a host..* " Entity replied. " *She's*

smart and knows whole lot of more than you.. though I still refuse to be called Jeff. "

"No ones ever complimented like that.." Entrapta said. "And to think it comes from an interdimensional entity."

" *Ugh.. whatever..* " Entity sighed.

After a whole lot of trekking and running after Madam Razz. Things have started to go somewhat better. Madam Razz had remembered that she's supposed to warn Adora about the Heart of Etheria, but she has difficulties remembering.

Pie was almost done and as the timer set to zero, it came to her. The last time she had seen Mara. "Oh no, we have to hurry!"

"But Razz! We just- agh... come on Catra!" Adora groaned and ran after Razz.

"Yeah, I'm right behind you." Catra replied.

They kept following Razz, who herself was walking in the past. Where Heart of Etheria was activating.

Somehow Razz had found the way to Mara's ship and was going in.

Catra and Adora were right after her. "How did she find the way here?"

Bow was trying to fix the ship, but stopped when she saw the strange lady enter, Adora and Catra right after her tail. "Wait...

you're not Mara?"

"Ahh! Adora.. who's that?" Bow asked.

"It's okay.. it's just Razz." Adora replied.

"So, we ran zick-zack around the forest and ended up here.. so what's the deal?" Catra questioned.

"I don't know.." Adora said.

"Help me find Mara, you know how to find her!" Razz said. "You already have everything you need."

"I have?" Adora asked and remembered that she had somehow required the missing piece on the ship's control panel. "Oh.. right.."

"What is it?" Catra asked.

"Don't worry, I know how this goes." Adora answered and put the piece back in its place, activating the ship. Lights turned up and a hologram of Mara appeared in front of them. Now they would witness the tragedy of Mara and the truth about Etheria.

" *Hey Adora.. I know you're there.. Razz said you would be.* " Mara said and offered her hand

"Is it.. really Mara?" Adora said and tried to reach Mara's hand, but it didn't work.

" *Ugh.. if you see this, it means that you are new She-Ra.. which means I failed.. You can't trust Light Hope, she's been programmed to activate the Heart at any cost..* "

"The Heart of Etheria?"

"*I don't know what they told you.. but it wasn't that bad at first..*" Mara said. "*We were the first ones to settle on Etheria, to study it's magic.. ugh.. how could everything go so wrong.. They told us*

that the Heart of Etheria would be used as an energy source.. but that wasn't the case. They were rerouting the magic in Etheria, siphoning, collecting into the Heart and it has kept going for long.. so long that when you probably see this the energy in the Heart would be unstable if activated. They made weapon of mass destruction from this planet and She-Ra is the key. I saw the destruction and deaths it would cause.. I can't stop it, but I can make sure they can never hurt any of us again. I've opened a way into despandos, they won't ever find us again."

All of them were listening in shock as Mara continued on, her last words were to Adora. " *Adora, I couldn't stop it, but I know you can. You are stronger than they ever could have expected-* " Then the hologram vanished and everything went dark. It was eerily silent in the ship, until Adora broke the silence. "The Heart of Etheria.. it's a weapon.. and Mara sacrificed herself.. to save us.."

"She was the bravest, my Mara dearie.." Razz said and put the pie on the chair. "For you.. Mara.."

"Dang.. I could have never expected this. Adora, we can't use it, can't we?" Catra said.

"No.. we absolutely can't.." Adora replied with a shocked tone and she looked at her sword with horror..

Destination, Beast Island

Chapter Summary

After a long argument of whether to use the Heart of Etheria or not, surprising guest comes to visit. Former Force Captain Scorpia.
Adora, Bow and Catra decide to set course on Beast Island, behinds Glimmer's back.

Horde keeps moving forward, but Scratch doesn't seem to enjoy their spoils of war.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

At Brightmoon, Glimmer is interrogating Double Trouble with the help of Darkith. Glimmer is trying to cast a truth spell, but Double Trouble's taunting is distracting her too much.

"You know.. I start to doubt that your little wont work.. I mean how long have you tried to do that same thing." Double Trouble taunted with a mocking tone.

"Don't care about them, just focus." Darkith said.

"I'm trying, I'm trying!' Glimmer snapped, but casting the spell didn't work.

Then a guard came in and reported that Adora had returned and was requesting a meeting with Princesses.

"Oh, so now she's calling up the meeting.. Are you sure you're the queen here?" Double Trouble smirked and took the form of Adora.

"Argh, I have no time!" Glimmer said and teleported away, leaving Darkith and Double Trouble there.

"You are getting on my way." Darkith stated with a disappointed tone. "You should consider yourself lucky that I'm not in peak.."

"What even are you? You are most certainly past your prime and probably more dead than alive." Double Trouble said.

"I'm not dead yet! I'm so sick of everyone saying I'm dead! I am not!" Darkith yelled.

"Sheesh.. whatever..." Double Trouble said and rolled their eyes.

At the war room, Bow was showing everyone what would happen to Etheria if Heart of Etheria would be activated. Each scenario led to the same, total annihilation.

"Is.. is that what's going to happen to Etheria?" Perfuma asked with a frightful tone.

"Yes, the Heart of Etheria has been storing energy since the times of Mara.. and it still goes on. Bow explained. "It has become unstable over the centuries."

"We need to somehow disable it, Heart of Etheria almost destroyed everything during Mara's time.." Adora said.

"Why disable such power?" Darkith interrupted, gaining everyone's attention. "Question is, how can you use this to your advantage."

"Are you serious?!" Adora yelled.

" *Can I please punch her? Please?* " Catra whispered to Adora.

" *No Catra, that's not how we do it..* " Adora replied back.

"Perhaps the First Ones were foolish to store that much energy into this planet's heart.. but that magic would make you much, much stronger." Darkith said.

"Maybe, we could only use part of the Heart? Just enough to defeat the Horde." Glimmer suggested.

"Glimmer, I know things look bad, but we can't use it and we can't trust Light Hope anymore." Adora said.

"Oh! Things look bad!? Then look at this!" Glimmer snapped and showed everyone the map of Etheria. "Horde keeps gaining ground, Theymor, Plumeria, Elberon, Salinas.. we are losing everything!"

So they began quite a long arguing about whether to use the heart or not.

"To use a terrible weapon, not to use a terrible weapon..." Perfuma talked to herself as she plucked petals from the flower.

Mermista went through the simulations over and over again, to see if there would be any chance for the planet not to blow up.

Catra rolled her eyes, they were just wasting time when there was an obvious answer to it.

Frosta was about to fall asleep, but woke up right after banging her head onto the table. "Ugh.. maybe we should continue this tomorrow.." She suggested. "Not that it is past my bedtime.. I don't have a bedtime.. I can go to sleep whenever I want."

"Or, we can decide just now!" Mermista said and closed the simulation. "I say we use the Heart, I want Salenias back!"

"Aahhh.. to use a terrible weapon or not to use.." Perfuma returned to plucking petals from the flower.

" *All of them are complete lunatics...* " Catra thought to herself.

"We will all die if the Heart is activated." Adora stated.

"How come that new guy has a chair and I don't!" Swift Wind butted in.

"Swift Wind.. now is not- time..." Adora stopped mid sentence. All of the princesses turned to look at the new guy.

"Oh, hi.. I'm not sitting on a chair.. aim sitting Emily.." Scorpia answered.

The princesses couldn't believe their eyes as they saw Scorpia sitting there.

"I just didn't want to interrupt you guys.. you seemed to be busy. I just snuck past guards and kind of waited for you to notice me." Scorpia explained.

"Horde Soldier!" Frosta yelled.

Everyone took a battle stance, ready to attack her, but Catra went between them.

"Wait! If she was going to attack us, she would have done so. Right?" Catra said.

"Yes, I don't want to fight you. I need your help to save Entrapta from Beast Island!" Scorpia said.

The princesses lowered their weapons, but restrained Scorpia nonetheless.

"You are our prisoner for now." Glimmer stated.

"Did you say Beast Island? The place where leaves have razor sharp teeths and where trees are literal snakes?!" Adora gasped.

"Bruh.. it's a lot worse.. those were just children stories.." Darkith chuckled.

"How could she ever survive there.. what have I done!?" Scorpia said.

"What do you mean by what you've done?" Adora asked.

"Well, Scratch ordered her to be sent to Beast Island when Entrapta was going to warn Hordak about that portal.. thing.." Scorpia sighed and there was a long pause before she continued. "And I let it happen.. I thought I was being a good friend to Scratch, but turns out she's a bad friend to me and now I think I don't know a single thing about friendship.."

"Aww.. you came here to learn how to be friends? How sweet." Perfuma said.

" *Good friends here is a loose term..* " Catra muttered.

"Hey, Entrapta if anyone could probably disable the Heart." Bow suggested.

"Thats right, with her help.. but we must go to Beast Island.." Adora said.

"No, we aint going anywhere!" Glimmer stated.

"We need Entraptas help and she needs ours!"

"She has a habit of blowing up everything she touches!" Glimmer yelled. "Scorpia stays here and you, Adora and Bow come with me! We have things to discuss!" She then teleported Bow and Adora with her.

"So what do we do to Scorpia?" Mermsita asked.

"We should take her to prison.." Frosta said.

"Alright, I'll take her there." Catra volunteered. "Come on Scorpia, I want to talk to you as well."

"Oh.. alright.." Scorpia replied and followed after Catra.

At the Fright Zone, Scratch is spending most of her time looking through screens. Looking for Force Captain Scorpia, if she happened to be anywhere nearby their conquered areas. Without any results, Scratch notices that Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio are back.

"What are you doing here!?" Scratch yelled. "Shouldn't you be on the field?"

"Listen Scratch.. we've just arrived back from Kingdom of Snows.. and we all are tired.. Kyle has frostbite and both of us are on death's doorstep." Lonnie complained. "So give us some rest!"

"Shut up and go back to the frontlines! We aren't resting until all of Etheria is conquered!" Scratch demanded.

"Like hell we would go!" Lonnie yelled.

Scratch drew her sword and pointed it at Lonnie's throat. "Listen.. if I wasn't so busy, I would have cut your head off! So I'm only giving you a warning this time! Problem?!"

"N-No.. Commander Scratch.." Lonnie answered with a weak voice.

"Good, now get going!"

Scratch returned to the monitor room and continued looking at the screens, she would spend hours more looking at different places. Why had Scorpia left, what reason she had to leave.. they were winning. After a long time of looking, still nothing. Double Trouble didn't answer. Scratch was going mad. With a fit of anger she began to slash the screens with her sword and broke the

communication device she had used to keep contact with Double Trouble.

Moments later, before Scratch would have broken the last screen. Hordak contacted her. " *What is the troop's situation?* "

"Ahh.. everything is going just fine." Scratch lied. "The troops have began to move inland as the last of the towns have fallen."

" *Good, keep up the pace and Etheria will be ours.* " Hordak said and shut the communication, leaving Scratch in the pitch black control room.

Glimmer had ordered Bow and Adora to stay in Brightmoon; no one could leave if she didn't give permission for it. Their latest argument had ended in bitter taste. Glimmer was so hellbent on winning that she didn't listen to reason. For her, the only way to win is to use the Heart of Etheria. Even if the risks would be catastrophic.

Meanwhile at the spare room 'prison', Catra was keeping company for Scorpia. Interested in what had happened to her, she asked her pretty mundane questions.

"You know.. No one has ever talked to me like this.." Scorpia said.

"What? You haven't had conversations?" Catra asked, puzzled. "It's like the most normal thing to do.."

"Well in the Horde.. we don't have conversations.. only orders.."

"That sounds painfully boring.. why did you even bother to stay there as long as you have?"

"Well.. I've always told myself I wouldn't fit anywhere.. and my parents gave our land to the Horde willingly.." Scorpia explained.

"Ouch.. hey, don't worry about fitting in." Catra said with a soft tone and put her hand on Scorpia's shoulder. "I don't fit in either.. I'm brash, selfish, short tempered and my first reaction is to punch someone.. though I've been taught to not to.. Anyways the point is, we all are different and thats okay. This whole alliance is the most dysfunctional thing I've ever witnessed."

"Wow.. that's the nicest thing anyone has ever said to me." Scorpia said watery eyes.

Then Perfuma came in, bringing a bowl full of salad. "Hey Scorpia, I brought you something to eat." Perfuma said and handed the bowl to Scorpia.

Scorpia looked at the greenery with a confused look. "Uhh.. What are these? Why are they green? Are they poisonous?"

"It's salad.. you don't have salad in the Fright Zone?" Perfuma asked.

Scorpia's answer was only her puzzled look. "Oh.. well you definitely should eat those, I'm going to get some pillows."

"Wait. Why?" Scorpia asked, but Perfuma was already gone. "Why pillows?"

"She just wants to be friendly with you, having a sleepover isn't that bad thing." Catra answered. "By the way, if I may ask. Where did you get that scar on your cheek?"

"Oh this?" Scorpia said and pointed her pinchers at the scar. "Scratch cut it when she was disappointed at me.. after that incident I had decided that enough is enough and left."

"Oh, I'm sorry. Well there's one more good reason to punch her when I meet her again." Catra said jokingly, trying to uplift the mood.

Then Perfuma came back with the pillows and Frosta alongside her. "Catra, your shift is over. I'll take on from this." Frosta said.

"Alright, then I'll go to see Adora.. she's probably crazy mad at Glimmer.." Catra said and left.

Meanwhile, Bow and Adora were climbing down from their room. "I don't know if this is a good idea after all.. I don't like lying, though this isn't lying.." Bow said with a regretful tone.

"Don't stress about it, even if Glimmer got mad.. at least she wouldn't be around us." Adora replied.

They were now at the outside of the gates and were about to sneak into the woods, only to be stopped by Catra. "Where are you two sneaking?"

"Oh Catra.. you must understand-" But Catra put her finger on Adora's lips, shushing her. "Realx, I know.. you're going to Beast Island to save Entrapta and I'm going with you. Don't forget that you promised to me that you would help at rescuing Shadow Weaver."

"Oh absolutely.. I wouldn't forget that." Adora replied.

"Good, then let's go." Catra said.

They headed to the Mara's ship and were preparing to launch, but they didn't know how. Adora was sitting on the driver's seat and thinking she should be doing something. "So... should I do something?"

"Uhh.. I'm not sure.. never flown a space ship before.." Bow said.

"Well there's got to be something to start it. Right?" Catra said. "I'll just press these random buttons and see what happens.

"No Catra wait!" Adora tried to stop her, but it was too late. Catra was going through the whole control panel til she hit the right button and the ship's engine started and it began to float.

"Hahaa! Nothing beats good old random bullshit go!" Catra cheered.

"Well.. I guess I'll give it a try too.." Adora said and sighed. She pressed on the buttons on the chair, till a voice answered. " *Administrator detected, what is your query?* "

"Ahaha! best strategy ever!" Adora stated.

" *Ship is on standby, set navigational coordinates.* "

"Beast Island." Adora said with a much calmer tone.

" *Setting coordinates to the hazardous disposal site, designation; Beast Island.* " The ship's monotone voice said and showed them a map and marked the location of Beast Island. " *Coordinates set. Is any additional assistance required?* "

"Wow, these First Ones things are so cool!" Catra stated with excitement.

"Uhh.. can you fly us there?" Adora asked.

" *Affirmative, setting autopilot.* "

"Wow.. well this turned out to be easier than I thought.." Bow said.

"Because nothing beats 'random bullshit go!'" Catra yelled, raising her hands in the air as the ship now took off and headed towards Beast Island.

Glimmer had returned to Double Trouble, after practicing more with Darkith. She felt that now her truth spell would work.

"Agh, how long are you going to do this.. but as they say.. if you don't succeed, just keep trying and trying.." Double Trouble said with a rather unbothered tone.

Glimmer didn't listen to anything they said and just drew the spell and cast it. "Tell me everything!" Glimmer demanded.

Double Trouble's smug grin vanished as they now had to speak the truth. "I-I.. I can't cry on cue! Whenever the role calls for tears, the only thing that works is thinking about children falling. They're tears of laughter, but no one can tell the difference!" Double Trouble said with overly dramatic tone. "Oh.. I've never actually told that to anyone.."

"Tell me the Horde's plans!" Glimmer demanded.

"Oh.. why wouldn't you just say so." Double Trouble answered nonchalantly and sat on the cushion. "Scratch and Hordak are worked up because Horde Prime is on his way, with his armada to conquer all of Etheria."

Glimmer's face turned to shock when hearing this. "When?!"

"Any day now darling, I'd say it's curtains for your little rebellion. But hey, while this truth spell is still working. Here's one more thing. If you had trouble defeating this Horde, then you don't have any slightest chance to win against Horde Prime."

"Oh no.." Glimmer teleported back to the room where Adora and Bow were supposed to be, only to see it was empty. "Adora! Bow?!

She teleported to the garden to look at the night sky, seeing Mara's ship flying over the Brightmoon. Darkith appeared behind her and stated; "You can still stop them.. if you so want."

"No, let them go!" Glimmer said with a bitter tone. "If they dont trust me, then I don't have to trust them! Horde Prime is coming and we need to be ready. I'm going to figure out how to access Heart of Etheria and how to use it... whatever the cost may be."

Chapter End Notes

Yayyy.. next chapter Catra and Shadow Weaver finally meet! Been far too long!

Reunion

Chapter Summary

> Adora, Bow and Catra crashlands on Beast Island. Yep the island wasway worse than described and worse thing is, She-Ra's sword doesnt work.
>
> Glimmer has taken matters on her own hands and demands Light Hope to tell her about Heart of Etheria.

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

It's been about an hour since they took off and Beast Island was still nowhere to be seen. Its mark had disappeared from the map, it was like the Beast Island wouldn't want anyone to find it. However, their steady journey soon comes to an end as their ship loses control and crashes onto the island.

"You think we've arrived at Beast Island?" Catra asked.

"Well there's only one way to find out." Adora said. They opened the ship's door and went outside.

They were now surrounded by corrupted First Ones tech, crashed ships and tall spiraling towers and trees, which were covered in black tendrils. "Yoo.. this place is creepy." Catra said and poked the black tendrils with her staff. Tendrils reacted to the poking and withdrew themselves somewhere. "Oohh.. Maybe it's better we don't touch anything here."

"How so?" Bow asked.

"These tendrils seem to be somewhat alive.." Catra said with a shivering tone. "Can we like.. hurry?"

"Yeah.. the sooner.. the better.." Adora replied.

Luckily for them, Micah had been nearby and saw the ship crash nearby. He hadn't seen ships in a long time, so he decided to find out what was going on. Well good thing he did, since our friends were caught in an ambush by spider-like creatures. This gave Micah deja-vu, since he had last time saved Shadow Weaver.. although from a different monster.

Micah easily dispatched the spider monsters and greeted the strangers who had arrived. He recognized Catra immediately, even if the last time he saw her was when she was a child. Micah lowered his hood and revealed himself to them.

"I can't believe it.. King.. King Micah?" Bow asked, it was like he had seen a ghost. "You are alive?"

"Well.. umm.. I think so.." Micah said. "Also Catra, you've grown up."

"Wait, you remember me.. even if it has been at least a decade." Catra asked.

"Hold on.. you've met King Micah before?" Bow asked.

"Yep.. been a while." Catra said.

"Please, call me Micah.. I'm no king here." He replied.

"It's so good to meet you finally, Kin- uhh.. Micah." Adora said.

"Who might you be?"

"I'm Adora, aka She-Ra and we've come to look for Entrapta since we need her help. Have you perhaps seen her?" Adora said.

"Yeah, I have." Micah said.

"Oh that's great, can you take us to her?" Adora asked.

"Well I don't know where she lives here.. but Shadow Weaver does know. She's been spending some time with her." Micah

replied.

"Even better! Shadow Weaver is alive, where is she?" Catra asked with excitement.

"Well I think she's at my.. makeshift home.. Come, I'll show you the way." Micah said and began to lead them further into the woods.

"I must say, how is Glimmer? You're her friends I assume." Micah said.

"Well.. she's fearless and strong with magic and trying her best to help the Rebellion." Adora answered, trying to say something positive even though their bond has been cracking.

"In other words.. she's a total bi-" But before Catra could finish her sentence, Adora shut her mouth with her hand. "Total Best Friend."

"That's great to hear. It's good to know she's learned how to make friends." Micah replied.

" *Seriously Adora?* " Catra whispered.

" *Yes, seriously. You can't just say those things in front of her dad.* " Adora whispered back.

Micah couldn't quite understand what they were saying, but it didn't bother him. "Say.. How's Angella?"

This question made all three of them stop. How would they explain that to Micah. However, you could say it's lucky that more monsters were on their way towards them. "Agh, we got to move faster!" Micah said. "Start running!"

And so they ran through the uneven ground full of roots and rocks, until they found a ditch and jumped in there and waited as

the monsters walked past them. After making sure it was safe to go, Micah gestured with his hand that it was safe to go.

They continued on their trekking and there was quite the awkward silence, since none of them knew how to explain the situation to him. Hopefully he had forgotten it by now.

" *Uhh, so who's going to tell him?* " Catra whispered.

" *When there's a good chance.. which is not yet.* " Adora whispered back.

"Alright, we're here." Micah said and showed them his makeshift house. It was quite comfortable looking, even if a little bit roughly made.

Smell of tea was flowing in the air and it was a smell that Catra hadn't smelled in a long time and it was clear as day who was making it. Catra sprung into running and smashed the door open. "Shadow Weaver!" She yelled, gaining SHadow Weaver's attention.

"Catra?" She asked, not believing her eyes. Was this some sort of hallucination or a spell.. "Is it really you?" Then she felt a tight hug, which confirmed to her that it was as real as possible.

"I've missed you so much! And I have so much to tell you!" Catra said with tears of joy streaming down her cheeks, burying her face into Shadow Weaver's robe.

"And.. And I've missed you as well.." Shadow Weaver said with a joyous voice and hugged Catra as well.

" *Ugh.. this kid is back.. Hey Shadow Weaver!* "

" *Oh fuck off, I don't need your opinions! Let me enjoy it at least a little bit.* " Shadow Weaver said in her mind. "How did you get here?" She asked Catra.

"With Mara's ship." Catra replied.

"Mara?"

"She was She-Ra a long time ago.." Adora answered.

"Ah.. I see." Shadow Weaver replied.

"Micah told us that you would know where Entrapta is, right?" Bow asked.

"Yeah, I know.. is there something I should know?" Shadow Weaver replied.

"Do you know anything about Heart of Etheria?" Catra asked.

"Heart.. Of Etheria?" Shadow Weaver repeated. "I'm not sure.. I have a vague idea.. but that's about it."

"Well, the Heart of Etheria is a super weapon. Capable of destroying the universe.. and She-Ra is the key to it.." Adora explained.

"Now.. everything makes so much more sense." Shadow Weaver replied with a shocked realization on her face. "We've been discussing about Etheria with Entrapta and to some degree.. with the Entity.."

"Entity?" Adora asked.

"It doesn't matter now, it seems you have more urgent matters on hand." Shadow Weaver replied. "Follow me, I know where Entrapta is."

Meanwhile, in the Whispering Woods. Glimmer had arrived at the crystal castle where she knew Light Hope was. She entered the dark castle and demanded to see Light Hope.

"Light Hope, I know you're here. The Queen of Brightmoon demands to speak with you!" She demanded.

There was no answer. "Fine.. I guess I'll have to do it forcefully." Glimmer stated and slammed her staff on the floor, releasing a magical shockwave.

" *Unauthorized trespasser detected. Initiating defense mechanisms.* " The room's lighting turned red and dozens of bots began to appear.

Soon Glimmer was surrounded by spider bots, but they were no challenge to her. Her training with Darkith had made her a lot stronger and confident. Glimmer easily wrecked the bots with a weave of her staff.

"Are you going to let me talk to you, or are you just going to send more bots for me to destroy?!" Glimmer yelled. "I know Adora doesn't want to use the Heart of Etheria, because she's affraid.. but I am not!"

The red lights turned off and the castle returned back to its normal colors. " *Temporary administrator detected Queen Glimmer of Brightmoon. Please enter.* " A monotone voice called and a door opened.

" *Finally..* " Glimmer thought to herself and walked in the room.

There Light Hope greeted her.

"So, I came because of the Heart of Etheria.. How do I access it? Thats all I need." Glimmer said.

"Adora has not yet succeeded in balancing the planet, without it the Heart can not be accessed." Light Hope explained.

"What do I need to do, to balance the planet?" Glimmer asked.

"All of the princesses must be connected to their runestones and there is only one princess who hasn't accepted her destiny.. One whose power was robbed by the Horde's meddling."

"Scorpia.. of course." Glimmer said.

"Yes. She has not shown any connection to her runestone."

"If I succeed in connecting her, will the Heart of Etheria save us from the Horde?" Glimmer inquired.

"Of course, it will grant you power like never before.." Light Hope said.

"Then I'll do it."

"Are you sure you can do it?" Light Hope asked.

It might be hard to talk Scorpia around, but at least she had learned a trick or two from Darkith on how to manipulate someone. "It won't be a problem."

Back at Beast Island, Shadow Weaver was showing a way to where Entrapta resided.

"Hey Shadow Weaver, I also managed to learn how to use artificial magic." Catra said as they walked.

"Oh, I'm so proud of you." Shadow Weaver said with an impressed tone. "Though I'm saddened that I couldn't be there with you."

"It's alright, Castaspella helped me a lot." Catra answered.

"Did she, now? Glad to hear that she's gotten more skilled." Shadow Weaver said. "Hey Micah, it seems your sister has turned out to be quite the sorcerer."

"Heh, I knew she would.." Micah replied.

They continued their trekking through the thick woods and when they reached Entraptas makeshift laboratory, they were faced with an unexpected sight.

Whole place was run down, overgrown with black tendrils and Entrapta was nowhere to be seen.

"Oh dear.." Shadow Weaver said.

Then the Spell of Obtainment manifested in its physical form, scaring everyone except Micah.

"Gah! What is that thing!?" Bow yelled.

Catra took a defensive stance and Adora was about to turn to She-Ra, but Shadow Weaver calmed them down. "It might seem bad, but it isn't as bad.."

" *Now that is more suitable reaction when mere mortals are seeing me.* " Entity said with an overly dramatic tone. " *You should fear me since- OW...* " Entity was interrupted by smack from Shadow Weaver.

"I apologize on behalf of the Entity.." Shadow Weaver said and let out a disappointed sigh. "This is Spell of Obtainment, don't pay any mind to it."

"The Spell of Obtainment?" Catra asked. "The one who kept trying to consume Etheria?"

" *The one and only.* "

"There must be some reason why you decided to show yourself." Shadow Weaver said.

" *Yes of course.. its those black tendrils that worry me.. they seem unnatural.. even for me.* " Spell of Obtainment said.

"Hey, I know this is a lot, but weren't we supposed to find Entrapta?" Adora interrupted.

"Oh right.. let's assume she managed to escape.. before whatever this is taken over." Shadow Weaver said.

" *Oh she's alive.. I can see her tracks.. She has headed towards the middle of this island.* Entity replied.

"Uhh.. Shadow Weaver.. what is this thing with the Entity?" Catra asked.

"Its.. uhh.. it's complicated.. at the moment.. I'd say we have temporary truce." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Riiiight..."

They continued their way deeper to the forest, nearing the center point of the island where a strange and strong signal could be heard.

"Oh no.. I've almost forgotten this.." Micah said when they got nearer. "The signal.."

Now Shadow Weaver heard it as well. "How have I never heard this before.."

"You will hear it, if you stay here long enough.." Micah said. "I have resisted for long.. and it almost disappeared when I met

you."

" *Its only logical it would disappear.. this thing preys on those who are alone.. you will succumb to it.. and become part of it.* " Spell of Obtainment said.

"You know about this?" Shadow Weaver asked.

" *Of course I know.. it's the work of another entity.. somehow it had found its way here.. maybe it's come here before Etheria was taken into despandos.* "

"Can you do something about this?" Shadow Weaver asked. "If it is another entity.."

"What! There are more of these entities?!" Catra said.

" *Yes, there are many of us.. and yes.. I can try to work things out with this entity.. but it will come with a cost.* "

"Of course.. is there anything where you don't require a price?" Shadow Weaver asked sarcastically.

" *Well.. death...* " Entity replied.

"Oh, how original.." Shadow Weaver sighed.

Catra put hand on Shadow Weaver's shoulder and looked at her with a concerned look. "You.. aren't planning.. to.. d-die.. aren't you.."

"Of course not. I have no reason to give up now." Shadow Weaver replied, assuring Catra she's not going to do anything to risk her life.. needlessly.

" *Oh don't be such wimps.. I have no intention to kill my host!* " Entity said with an annoyed tone. " *Do you want to save Entrapta or not?* "

"Of course." Shadow Weaver replied, others agreed as well.

" *Then you just have to trust me..* " Entity said.

"I don't like that, but what other choice do we have.." Shadow Weaver admitted. "So, what's the price?"

" *Ugh... umm.. there's no price.. I was just trying to act cool..* " Entity said with an awkward tone. " *Let's just hope I can reason with this entity..* "

"Im quite literally fallen off the tracks.." Adora said. "We are still trying to find and help Entrapta, right?"

" *Yes.. yes we are.. things have just turned a bit more complicated..* "

"My life in a nutshell." Adora said with a tired and sarcastic tone.

"Ehh, don't worry about it, you're not the only one." Catra said with a chuckle and put her hand on Adora's shoulder. And thus they continue their way towards the center point of the island.

Chapter End Notes

Next time, we are finally getting off from Beast Island.
And who is this new Entity I'm talking about? I have no idea, I'm just making shit up as I go :D

Destiny's Touch

Chapter Summary

> Glimmer convinces Scorpia to connect to her runestone, which Darkith doesn't approve.. but her opinions no longer hold any weight to Glimmer.
> Meanwhile Micah and Shadow Weaver finally get off from the Beast Island with Mara's ship, however they are too late to stop Glimmer.

Chapter Notes

> This a bit longer chapter for once.. and quite hectic.. I seriously wonder, what the hell am I doing?!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At Brightmoon, Scorpia didn't exactly know what she was going to do or wether she was a prisoner or not. She had wandered to Darkith's garden, alongside with Emily. Which angered Darkith, since Emily couldn't stay off from her flower beds.

"Scorpia.. please tell your bot to stay out of my flower beds.." Darkith said with a disdain in her voice.

"Oh.. sorry.. I'll get her off there." Scorpia replied and went to get Emily off. "Come on now... don't anger that scary lady."

Darkith just rolled her eyes, she tried to pay no mind to their shenanigans. But it was useless, before Scorpia could get Emily off they had already broken the flower beds completely.

"Umm.. sorry.. Darkith, but is this place supposed to be a prison? Or something like that?" Scorpia asked with an awkward tone. "I mean.. everyones been so nice.."

"It wasn't a prison.. until now." Darkith answered with a threatening tone and aggressively cut off one of the branches.

"Oh, sorry. I won't bother you anymore." Scorpia apologized and left with Emily.

Then Glimmer came back and like with a snap of an finger, Darkith changed her demeanor. She stood up on her feets and greeted Glimmer with the sweetest tone she could get. "My Queen, you're back. How did it go?"

"We need to go to the Fright Zone!"

"Huh!? My Queen.. I don't understand."

"Simply, we just have to get Scorpia to connect with her runestone." Glimmer replied.

"What?!" Darkith uttered in disbelief. " My Queen, Scorpia, has never shown any kind of connection to her Runestone."

"Are you questioning my authority!?"

"No! I am questioning your reasoning! You need to think this through." Darkith said.

And to add fuel to the fire, one of the guards came to Glimmer and reported that Double Trouble had escaped.

"I don't care. They won't matter. What matters is to save Etheria!"

"You can't just let them go, they are too dangerous-" But Darkith's reasoning was not heard. "Will everyone just shut up!" Glimmer yelled. "I've got this."

"Please, My Queen. Think this through, we need a plan and we need to consult the other princesses." Darkith still tried to reason with Glimmer.

"You asked me what kind of queen I would be! I've decided, I'm going to be the queen that saves Etheria and your usefulness has come to an end. Besides.. other princesses are gone!" Glimmer

stated and ordered guards to keep Darkith away from her from now on.

Darkith was left at the garden with a dumbfounded look on her face, or what was left of it. Once again part of her cracked and fell on the floor. Soon she won't have her hands anymore. What a truly revolting sight she was.

At the Fright Zone, Scratch was losing her nerves. Even if they were winning.. it still wasn't the same without Scorpia. Was Scorpia really that important to her? No, not in a million years.. she was a liability. She was then confronted by Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio, who had just arrived from their latest mission. When noticing that Scratch was in a bad mood, they decided to leave. Not to bother her any further.

"What is your report from the field?" Scratch asked, forcing them to stop.

"Uhh, well we just captured another rebel town.. it's the third in this week!" Lonnie described. "We are finally winning and I think you should be happy as well."

"I don't care, we will only win when all of the Rebellion is wiped out! Until then there's no winning.." Scratch remarked. "Anyways, you may leave. I don't want to see you!"

"Sheesh.. Why even try.." Lonnie sighed. "Alright, we're leaving.."

"And know that if you speak something behind me, I'll know for sure!" Scratch threatened.

"You're delusional!" Lonnie's voice could be heard from the hallway.

Scratch was so pissed, Scorpia has left her, Double Trouble isn't answering.. if they are winning then why are people leaving? Scratch couldn't understand it. She was ripping her hair off and was ready to smash her whole office into smithereens, until she heard familiar voice.

"Oh, I didn't know it was this bad.. this place looks like a mess and so do you.." Double Trouble said.

"Double Trouble!?" Scratch turned to look at them. "You're back?"

"Sorry for my delay.. I got held up in Brightmoon.." Double Trouble answered. "Though nothing to worry about, I have some news that will cheer you up."

Scratch conditioned her hair and cleared her throat. "Alright, better be good."

"Well, the princesses don't get long and most importantly.. She-Ra is gone."

"That means.. Brightmoon is without protection." Scratch realized and a wide grin gre on her face.

"Told you it would cheer you up." Double Trouble said with a grin.

Scratch went and mobilized all the Horde's troops and prepared to invade Brightmoon.

She was overseeing the troops when Hordak came angrily to confront her actions. "I told you to wait for my further orders!"

"Listen, princesses are gone and so is She-Ra. Double Trouble gave me that report." Scratch replied.

"Brightmoon is completely defenseless.." Hordak realized. His tone and demeanor changed. "Good work Scratch."

At Beast Island, everyone had wandered into the midpoint of the island and arrived at the open area. Dark tower stood in the middle of it, towering over the forest and sending a signal that couldn't be comprehended. The tower was tangled with black tendrils that slithered their way into the woods.

"Uhh.. is this really a good idea?" Shadow Weaver questioned.

" *Well.. nope, but if you want to get off this island.. then let me handle the talking and maybe we won't all die.* " Entity replied.

"Are we really putting our chance in the hands of the same entity who craves power?" Catra asked. "And isn't the entity also the reason why you avoided everyone else?"

"Well, Catra.. things have changed. I don't ask you to trust the entity, but trust me.. I won't let anything bad happen to any of you.." Shadow Weaver assured. "And we still haven't found Entrapta."

Spell of Obtainment sighed in annoyance, all these talks made it sick. " *I'm literally trying to save you and that princess and this is how I get treated?* "

"Shush it, you led us here." Shadow Weaver answered. And once again, two of them were bickering.

"Um.. Catra, is that normal?" Adora asked. "I mean.. that entity.."

"Well.. it seems Shadow Weaver has somehow managed to tame the entity.. which is weird, but don't lower your guard. I'm still sure that the entity would want your powers." Catra said.

"How is this even going to help us find Entrapta?" Bow asked.

"I don't know-" But then came a loud rumbling and the tendrils tangled up at the tower began to move. They formed an unrecognizable pile and something that resembled a mouth. ***"Who dares to disturb me?!"*** A loud and thunderous voice asked.

" *Here we go..."* Spell of Obtainment said and separated itself from Shadow Weaver and walked towards the other entity. " *Just keep quiet and let me handle this.* "

Everyone else backed away, there was no way this could end up well for them.. and what about Entrapta? Has the entity already killed her?

"Is that.. Spell of Obtainment? You shut in finally decided to do something." The piece of tendrils asked.

" *Well, if it isn't the Entity of Nihilism.. What are you doing here in Etheria? Can't you see I'm occupying this planet?* "

"Occupying? You are literally bickering with a mere mortal and somehow you let her get the upper hand? Am I talking to the same Spell of Obtainment I used to know?"

" *That doesn't matter, however.. your presence here is the matter. Etheria is mine to consume and you should get your sorry ass out of here!* "

"Oh how very scary, I'm so scared.." Entity of Nihilism said with a mocking tone. ***"You can't even control a mere mortal***

and you call yourself conqueror? You do know what I present.. right?"

" *Your nihilism is overrated, you should go to some backwater planet and stay there. People here in Etheria are not so stupid as to fall for your web of depression and nihilism.* " Spell of Obtainment bragged.

"Do you want to test that?" The Entity of Nihilism said. ***"Why don't you look behind you?"***

And when the Spell of Obtainment did look behind itself, it saw everyone tangled in the tendrils and given up on everything. " *You have to be kidding with me!? Seriously guys?!* "

Micah had given up after learning that Angella was gone and even Shadow Weaver had given up, somehow the Entity of Nihilism had convinced her to give up as well. Only Adora was left struggling with her sword, trying to transform into She-Ra, but couldn't.

"Do you see? These people who you said not to fall for it.. have fallen." Entity of Nihilism said with sardonic tone, relishing in the moment of total depression. ***"Ahhh.. pure depression of nihilism when nothing matters.. I do love the smell of it. Face it Spell of Obtainment, you lost.. You are only a second rate Entity.. compared to me!"***

But then something happened that neither of the Entities could have expected. Adora had turned into She-Ra and broken the bounds of the tendrils, radiating power like none before. It made the both entities shiver and tremble in fear, neither of them had never faced the true power of She-Ra.

"What is that overwhelming power!? I have never faced something like that ever before! "

" *Ugh.. it's.. too much.. to handle.. I'm withering!* " Spell of Obtainment shrieked.

"You Entities think like this is your playground, but it's not!" She-Ra said with a deep and echoing voice. It was like the spirit of She-Ra had just taken over her. **"I have no tolerance for your kind and insignificance! Perish back into the void, whence you came!"** She-Ra pointed her sword at the entities.

" *You fool! What do you think will happen if you banish me?! Shadow Weaver will die if I go!"* Spell of Obtainment yelled.

"Do you really think you can stop us!? There are more of us! The Entity of Nihilism said.

"I've had enough, you should know that She-Ra is more than just a sword and you two are getting in the way of Etheria's fate." She then swung her sword in a circle and formed a portal.

" *That's impossible!?* " Spell of Obtainment yelled. " *Etheria is in a despandos.. no portals should work!* "

"I refuse to lose to this lowly sorcerer.. Know that nihilism can not be defeated by the sword!"

"Silence! It's time for you two to go!" She-Ra said and the portal began to suck the entities towards it. It was like a black hole, sucking both of the entities in. No matter how much they screamed or tried to resist, it was futile. No entity can be stronger than the spirit of She-Ra.

"Curse you She-Ra! Curse you First Ones!" Both of the entities yelled as they turned into formless and were sucked into the portal.

At the void, both of the entities found themselves in a familiar place. Once again.. locked in the abyss.

"Great going, Spell of Obtainment.. if you hadn't come there.. none of this wouldn't have happened."

" *Oh shut it! If you weren't so keen on bragging about your powers and just maybe dragged your ass out of Etheria, at least I could have stayed there.* "

"Oh well if it isn't the Spell Of Obtainment, long time no see." Spell of Forbidden Knowledge greeted. **"It seems that your run in Etheria has come to an end at last."**

" *And now I'm surrounded by these idiots...* " Spel *l of Obtainment muttered.*

"Well *do you know what things are common for the three of us?* " Entity of Nihilism asked.

" *Don't even start...* "

"Well? What is?"

" *We three got kicked out from Etheria."* Entity of Nihilism joked.

" *Haa haa, how very funny. I hope you choke on your own hubris and die!* " Spell of Obtainment remarked with a snark.

"Well, my influence is still on Etheria, so you two can suck it!" Spell of Forbidden knowledge bragged.

" *What!? How!?* "

"Darkith enchanted a sword with my powers when she was still my host. Now that sword is at hands of young and brash kid. Influencing her overtime."

" *Fuck you...* " Spell of Obtainment grunted. " *I'll go somewhere that isn't here..* "

"Sore loser!" Spell of Forbidden Knowledge taunted.

"Hey, *I heard it's new name was Jeff! How lame!* " Entity of Nihilism added.

" *Seriously, fuck off!* " Spell of Obtainment yelled and left the two other entities by themselves.

With a loud bang and a flash of light, both of the entities were gone. The portal was shut and all the tendrils in the Beast Island withered into dust. It was dead silent out there. She-Ra sighed and walked up to her friends, who all had lost consciousness. She walked up to Shadow Weaver, whom she could see was dying. Spell of Obtainment had taken a toll too great. However, it was not a problem for She-Ra. However, something had to be compromised.

Shadow Weaver soon opened her eyes and saw She-Ra standing in front of her. "Wha- what is going on?"

"You are dying, the entities are no more." She-Ra said with a tender and calm voice. "I can still save you, though I have to make a compromise."

"An.. and wh-what is that com-promise?" Shadow Weaver asked, coughing.

"You can not use magic anymore, since it's required to heal you and keep you alive. You will not feel any different from your past, only know that you can't use your magic anymore." She-Ra explained.

"Heh.. 'cough' I think I've got quite enough 'cough' from magic.." Shadow Weave chuckled. "It has not brought anything other than misery.."

"Then I shall start immediately." She-Ra answered and pointed her sword at her. Channeling magic through the sword into her, Shadow Weaver could feel how her insides began to heal. Her emptiness inside of her began to fill up, she didn't feel herself as an empty husk or shell. She felt like a living being, for once.

After She-Ra had healed her, She-Ra turned back to Adora and fainted. There was a chill breath of wind in the air and for the first time in years.. Shadow Weaver could feel her heartbeat.

Soon, others woke up. Wondering what had happened, only Adora was still unconscious.

"Ugh.. what happened?" Catra asked, rubbing her head. "Wait.. where are all the tendrils?"

"Where are the entities?" Micah asked as he looked around.

"She-Ra happened.." Shadow Weaver answered.

"Huh? I thought something was stopping her from using her powers." Bow wondered.

"I don't think it was Adora who was in control.." Shadow Weaver said.

"What do you mean?" Bow asked.

"I think it was the spirit of She-Ra.. She-Ra is more than just a sword.. and what she did was surely something Adora couldn't do."

"What did she do then?" Catra asked.

"She managed to get rid of the entities and.. heal me.. which I thought was impossible." Shadow Weaver said, looking at her hands. Though still covered in scars, which seem to be permanent.. At least she didn't have the hunger and hunger for magic and power anymore. "I just cant use my magic anymore.."

Well that didn't matter, Catra ran to Shadow Weaver and hugged her. First time in a long time, Shadow Weaver could really feel what a hug felt like. It felt really awkward, but at the same time very relaxing. "I don't care if you can't use your magic, at least you aren't dying anymore!"

"Well.. to that I can agree." Shadow Weaver said with a relieved smile on her face.

Then, Adora finally opened her eyes. World seemed to spin around her and everything was hazy. "Ugh.. my head.. what happened?"

"You don't remember?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"No.. how could I?" Adora answered. "I just remember that we all lost hope and then I just blacked out."

"Well, I think She-Ra just saved us from certain doom." Shadow Weaver said.

"What?! How?" Adora asked. "I thought only I could change into She-ra."

"Maybe, there's more to She-Ra than we were told." Shadow Weaver replied. But before they could get any proper relief, something had crept behind them. A large robot stood there, silently. Everyone turned to look at the robot, feeling a dread filling them. They were ready to run away, but it was soon clear that there was no danger. It was none other than Entrapta. She flung herself off from the robot and landed on the ground.

"Oh, hi guys! What a nice surprise!" Entrapta greeted them.

"Entrapta!" Adora yelled. "We were looking for you and we really do need your help."

"Well.. I kinda found out something really cool, I could say that this island has answers for every question I have!" Entrapta exclaimed excitedly. "I wanna show you, come on jump on board."

Everyone stuffed themselves into the robot's cabin and it was as tight as it could possibly be. "I didn't think I'd see you again.."

Entrapta said. "Hey.. where's Jeff?"

"Uhh.. who?" Adora questioned.

"Jeff, it was with Shadow Weaver.. it's not mad now is it?" Entrapta said and looked at Shadow Weaver.

"Uhh.. Jeff.. is no more.." Shadow Weaver answered.

"What?! When?!" Entrapta said.

"Well it got dispatched by She-Ra.. I don't know where exactly it ended up.."

"Wait.. you mean that Entity? Why did you name it Jeff?" Catra asked.

"Jeff was my lab partner and knew a lot about Etheria.. but alas.. if Jeff is gone, there's nothing to be done.. However I found something really interesting about this planet." Entrapta said and they arrived at the cave entrance near the abandoned ruin.

"Take a look at this!" Entrapta said and showed a screen. There were all the runestones connected and planet balanced, showing what the Heart of Etheria was capable of. "Shadow Weaver, we were right.. this whole planet is a weapon, but uncontrollable."

"That doesn't sound good at all..." Shadow Weaver sighed.

"She-Ra is the only one strong enough to stand the heart's power and through her sword be able to activate it." Entrapta explained with an excited tone. "Though the weapon would destroy everything, so they left Etheria.."

"And these were the ones whose studies all the sorcerers of Mystacor based their knowledge on?!" Shadow Weaver said. "I knew it, they were a bunch of fools.."

"We have to stop this!" Adora said. "Entrapta, come with us!"

"Why? This island has everything I need.. why would I leave?" Entrapta said. "Besides.. once the planet is balanced, nothing can stop it."

"But one of the runestones is not lightened up." Bow remarked. "It's the black garnet.."

"So we still have time to prevent this." Adora said. "Please Entrapta, come with us.."

"I've always been left behind.. I don't know what to do.. even Jeff is gone.. it would be just better if I'm alone. I'm not good at these friendship things." Entrapta said.

Then Catra grabbed Entrapta's arm. "Listen, I'm not that good either! It doesn't matter if you're good or not with friendship. What matters is that you try and work for it.. It takes a lot of effort." Catra said and cracked a smile. "Take it from me, the expert at screwing things up!"

"Plus we have a whole working First Ones ship!" Adora added.

This changed everything in Entrapta. "Well why didn't you say so at first! What are we waiting for, lets go!"

Entrapta used her hair to pull everyone with her, taking them towards her bot. Catra felt a bit annoyed that she gave a talk about trying to do your best, only to be beaten by technology.

"I just remembered, Scorpia is at Brightmoon.. You don't think Glimmer would.." Bow said.

"Okay we need to hurry!" Adora said.

Meanwhile, in Brightmoon. Glimmer had confronted Scorpia about the runestone and her being a princess, though Scorpia doesn't want to do it.

"I mean.. I'm not really cut out for princesses. Ialready left the Horde.." Scorpia said. "I don't want to betray them.. nor Scratch, I just want to help Entrapta."

"The fact you left the Horde already indicates betrayal." Glimmer replied. "Besides, do you think Scratch would forgive you or something? Isn't she the reason why you left?"

"But.. I... uhh.." Scorpia couldn't find any words. Glimmer certainly was right.

"Scorpia, you're our only hope. If you connect to your runestone, I'm sure you can do everything to help Entrapta." Glimmer said with a comforting tone.

"Thing is.. the Black Garnet doesn't even want me.. I-I get rejected a lot.." Scorpia sighed.

Glimmer sat next to Scorpia, trying to approach her as calmly as she could. "Tell me about it.. My friends have left me and I was always the weak princess who had to recharge.. I didn't fit in.." Glimmer said and turned to look at Scorpia. She put her hand on Scorpia's pinchers. "But I have changed, we have changed. With your help we can save everyone"

Scorpia thought for a moment and let those words sink in.

"You are not hopeless, you were born for this. And I will help you, we're in this together. And I know you would make a great princess."

Scorpia responded with a tight hug that surprised Glimmer. "Oh.. that was probably too much.." Scorpia apologized and let go of

Glimmer, but was surprised that Glimmer still continued to hug her. "Alright, I'm in. So what now?"

"Now, we're going to save the world!" Glimmer declared.

Back at Fright Zone, Hordak was in his sanctum, running some tests on his improvised hand cannon. Which was interrupted by Double Trouble, pretending to be She-Ra and being shot at. Hordak didn't seem to be too keen on their tricks, so they turned back to their real selves. "Ahh.. I know.. I know... No one is allowed inside your sanctum.. Not since you let that princess in.."

Double Trouble said and transformed her hair to resemble Entrapta's. Hordak only grunted in response, which made Double Trouble change their hair back to normal. "So.. what makes a sanctum anyways?"

They were stopped by Hordak pointing his hand cannon and charging it up. "Oh.. not in for a small talk?" They answered with a sly tone.

"I thought I'd at least get a pat on a back from my daring escape." Double Trouble slowly backed away and stepped on Imp's tail. They crouched next to imp and transformed their tail to replicate Imp's. "It's too bad though.. I was looking forward to meeting this Entrapta princess, but of course as you know.. she wasn't there."

"What.. did.. you say?" Hordak asked with a shocked look on his face.

"Oh you don't have to keep up with the charade with me, I figured out the truth." Double Trouble replied and stood up and started to walk circles around Hordak. "You sent Entrapta to the Beast Island.. so She-Ra would go look for her. A brilliant plan, perfect distraction. Though I really have to applaud your work, you really had me going." Then Double Trouble changed their tone to a more dramatic one. "So scorned about Entrapta's betrayal!"

"Even now you look like you had no idea. Bravo!" Double Trouble said as they looked at Hordak who still had a shocked look his face. "Though I also considered the alternative, that Scratch had lied to you all this time." Double Trouble's face turned into a smug grin. "That she made you think she was your partner in crime, while really.. she was the one who betrayed you." Double Trouble then laughed awkwardly and rested their shoulder on Hordak's. "But between you and me.. there's no way she's that good of an actor."

Double Trouble then clapped their hands together and slowly backed away. "I'll leave you to it. Congrats once again.. great work all around."

When they were gone, Hordak's feelings erupted into a fit of anger. His breathing got heavier and he proceeded to destroy his whole laboratory with his cannon, screaming in anger and betrayal. Only to fall into a silence and shedding a single tear.

At the Brightmoon's runestone, Glimmer was standing with Scorpia. Waiting for Double Trouble's signal. And she soon got an answer. " *Too easy.. as always..* " Including a winky emote.

Glimmer put her pad away and looked at Scorpia. "Are you ready?"

Scorpia took one last breath. "Not really.." She answered with a shy voice, Glimmer extended her hand to Scorpia with a gentle and assuring smile on her face. Scorpia took Glimmer's hand and they teleported away. Just before Adora and her friends arrived with Micah.

They were running towards the throne room. Micah stopped for a while and had a reassured look on his face. "Finally... home.." He then catched up with the others. "Glimmer! Glimmer, where are you?!"

But when he reached the throne room, there was an unpleasant surprise waiting for them. "She's gone.." A raspy and corase voice said. It was none other than Darkith, sitting on a thorne. "Ahh.. this might be my last time when I feel like I have power..." She then looked at the others and was herself quite shocked as well. "Shadow Weaver? Micah? You are really here?"

Micah casted a hastily made spell and launched it towards Darkith, who let the spell hit her and cut her left arm off. Crumbling into dust on the steps of the throne. "What is this traitor doing here?!" Micah asked with an angry and demanding voice.

"Where's Glimmer?!" Adora demanded.

"Ah, she's gone to the Fright Zone.. To connect Scorpia back to Black Garnet.." Darkith answered with an uncaring tone as she stepped off from the throne. "Though I couldn't believe I would see you again, Shadow Weaver?"

"Hold on, what's your deal with her?" Micah asked.

"Ugh.. it's complicated.." Shadow Weaver sighed.

"Anyways, we don't have much time. We have to hurry before it's too late." Adora said.

"I'll go after Glimmer, I'll give her good pummeling." Catra answered with enthusiasm.

"What?" Micah asked with a concerned tone.

"Ugh.. I mean.. friendly advising.." Catra said with an awkward laugh and was on her way.

"Catra! Wait, we just reunited!" Shadow Weaver yelled, but it was useless. Catra was already too far gone.

"Don't worry, I'll go after her. To make sure everything is fine." Bow said and ran after her.

Shadow Weaver could only sigh in disappointment. "Catra has become too brash..."

"Heh, I agree with you." Darkith replied, but her remark was met with a swift death stare and huff. "Oh fuck off! Why haven't you died already?!"

"I wonder the same.." Darkith chuckled.

Chapter End Notes

> Well I managed to finally get rid of the entities, this was something I was thinking for a long time. How can I get rid of Spell of Obtainment?
> Answer; She-Ra
>
> And yes, it was not Adora. It was She-Ra.. spirit of She-Ra, which is older and far stronger.
>
> Press F to pay respect for Spell of Obtainment.

Fate of Etheria

Chapter Summary

Glimmer realizes that Light Hope had lied to her, Adora managed to stop the Heart of Etheria.. but they were taken out from despandos back into universe.
Threat of Horde Prime arrives and this time, for sure.. the Rebellion won't stand a chance.

Chapter Notes

We're in the End Game now!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Scratch arrived at the Hordak's sanctum, as was ordered. Something however was off. Lights were off and Hordak was nowhere to be seen. "Uhh.. Hordak?" Scratch called. "Why did you call me here? The attack on Brightmoon is in full scale."

Suddenly she was met by a huge blast that blew a hole into the wall. She barely managed to dodge it. "Hordak, what the hell is wrong with you!?"

"It seems I missed.. I'm not going to miss again." Hordak answered and fired another shot from his hand cannon.

Once again, Scratch managed to avoid it. "You don't even care to elaborate, why?"

"You betrayed my trust! You said to me that Entrapta betrayed us, but that was not the case!" Hordak growled. "You had no authority to send her to Beast Island! Your days were numbered ever since you betrayed me!"

"You're still crying about that princess?!" Scratch huffed and climbed on top of a catwalk, hiding behind a pillar. "You're pathetic! Haven't you noticed that I was running the place!?"

This only angered Hordak more and he began to shoot faster and faster, though his hastily made shots were easily evaded by Scratch.

But Scratch's luck was about to run its course, she stumbled on a cable and fell on the floor, breaking her ankle. This gave Hordak a great chance to finish her.

She however successfully countered the blast when she drew her sword. The blast was reflected and hit the ceiling.

"That was too close.." Scratch gasped her breath.

"It ends now!" Hordak yelled and pointed his hand cannon towards crippled Scratch.

However.. The damage caused in the room led to the ceiling falling onto Hordak, crushing him, his armor and his hand cannon. Hordak lost his consciousness and this gave Scratch a good moment to breathe.

She slowly and steadily stood up from the ground, but fell on the floor again. She couldn't find balance and she had to resort to limp slowly, dragging herself towards the nearest wall and leaning against it. Her sword was still vibrating and she could hear intrusive whispers from it. Scratch wasn't sure what to do with this sword, so she just threw it next to her. "This shit is too much..."

At Brightmoon, Adora was convincing Micah to stay in Brightmoon since he was clearly weak at the moment. "Please Micah, stay here.. Sorcerers guild has been contacted and they are on their way here." Adora put hands on Micah's shoulders. "I promise you, we will bring Glimmer back home."

"Are you really counting on the sorcerer's guild to do something?" Shadow Weaver asked with a mocking tone. "They've never done much of anything.. just a bunch of fools."

"You do remember that Castaspella is the Head-Sorceress there, she was also the one who helped Catra and was the one who found the way to find you." Adora reminded me.

Shadow Weaver's facial expression changed from conceding to more hesitant. She knew Castaspella was quite capable, but was sure the reason why Castaspella knew anything was that she had used **'her'** research and studies. Since she was also the one not to throw them away when the sorcerer's guild demanded so. Which once again lamented Shadow Weaver's opinion about the guild being a bunch of fools. "Castaspella at least has insight that others there lack.." Shadow Weaver mumbled as she crossed her arms.

"Anyways, speaking of Catra.. Swift Wind, take Bow and Entrapta to the Fright Zone. And pick up Catra on the way.. make sure she won't do anything too brash." Adora sighed.

"And where are you going then?" Bow asked.

"I'm going to the crystal castle, to try to stop Light Hope from activating the Heart." Adora replied.

Adora transformed into She-Ra and Swift Wind carried Bow and Entrapta with him, leaving Shadow Weaver, Micah and Darkith to themselves. What followed was silence and uneasiness.

"Well.. this is kind of awkward.." Darkith said.

"I don't need your opinions.." Shadow Weaver said and began to walk away.

"Where are you going?" Micah asked.

"To the Fright Zone of course. Where else?!" Shadow Weaver snapped.

"But you don't have your magic anymore." Micah reminded me.

Shadow Weaver stopped on her tracks, she had already forgotten that she doesn't have magic anymore. She should have just asked to go with others, but why would she ask them? She had always done everything herself, no help required.

"Uhh.. I have magical plants in the garden. You could use those." Darkith suggested. "Besides, it was Catra who gave me books about magical botany of Etheria.. or something close to that."

"You have a garden?! Who authorized that!?" Micah said.

"Your daughter, Glimmer." Darkith replied.

"I swear if all this is your doing.. You'll see something more than agonizing withering." Micah threatened.

"Ease with the edge there, I had no say in this. Your daughter was most likely manipulated by Light Hope." Darkith answered, raising her hands in the air.

"Take me to that garden!" Shadow Weaver demanded.

"Alright.." Darkith replied while nodding her head.

Darkith led Shadow Weaver to the garden she had been attending and when seeing it, Shadow Weaver was quite surprised. "I didn't know you were good at gardening.."

"Well.. I had to kill time somehow.." Darkith sighed.

Shadow Weaver immediately recognized the different flowers Darkith had been taking care of. She began to pick up the different flowers and crushed them into dust. There were even flowers that produced crystal-like fruits that could be used as a magical catalysator. "This is beyond incredible!"

Shadow Weaver began to draw a teleportation circle and Darkith looked at her with a puzzled look on her face. "I don't understand.. you don't have magic, how are you going to survive in the Fright Zone.. it's most certainly a one way trip."

"Listen.. Darkith, when there is someone you care for.. which I think you wouldn't understand.." Shadow Weaver said, throwing shade at Darkith. "You are ready to do everything you can.. for them."

"But you don't seem like you would care for someone.."

"Maybe.. There are only two people I care for.. and I'm quite sure you know who they are." Shadow Weaver replied as she finished the circle.

Darkith was just standing there and she was thinking, did she herself care for anyone. Well of course she didn't, but something in her wretched guts told her otherwise. She actually was feeling something that she needed to do. "Uhm.. Shadow Weaver.. can you make that circle a bit bigger?"

Shadow Weaver raised her eyebrow. "Why?"

"Because in the Fright Zone.. there's actually something I need to do, unfinished business so to say." Darkith said with an uneasy voice and was avoiding Shadow Weaver's eyes.

"Uhh.. but aren't you a prisoner? I could get into trouble, if I helped you. Besides.. what stops you to run away?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"What you said before.. it made me feel something.. and I have to do it before it's too late for me." Darkith answered. "As you can

see, I'm dying and don't have much time left. But there is someone in Fright Zone that I need to confront first."

"Ah, I see." Shadow Weaver replied. "Honestly.. I don't care, but if it is important.. then why not."

Shadow Weaver proceeded to make the circle larger, she offered her hand to Darkith as she held powdered crystal in her other hand.

Darkith took Shadow Weaver's hand and that was the most awkward thing ever. With that they teleported away, heading to the Fright Zone.

Meanwhile at the Fright Zone, Glimmer and Scorpia were sneaking towards the Black Garnet. But as they sneaked, they encountered Kyle, Lonnie and Roghelio, packing their things onto a transport vehicle. "Scorpia?!" Lonnie asked.

They raised their weapons. "What are you doing here?!"

"Uhh.. well, this is our new recruit.. Glimm- Glimmax. Yes, our new recruit, Glimmax." Scorpia awkwardly made up excuses.

"We thought you got out, if Scratch sees you.." Lonnie said.

"She can't, I know what this looks like, but I'm here to help." Scorpia said with a concerned voice.

Lonnie and Kyle lowered their weapons. "Well.. we're done protecting Scratch, we're done with this whole place.. but you're

one of us Scorpia and we won't stand on your way." Lonnie said.

"Oh, you guys, come here!" Scorpia said with tears of joy and ran to hug them.

Glimmer walked up to them. "I really suggest you to get away, as far as possible."

"Agh.. that's the plan." Lonnie said as she was released from Scorpia's hug. "Take care of her."

With that said, three of them entered into the transport vehicle and began to drive away.

"Should be easy from now on.. seems like a pretty easy day here." Scorpia said.

On the other side of the Fright Zone, Shadow Weaver and Darkith arrived in an empty storage room.

"Where were you heading anyways?" Darkith asked. "This is like the worst place ever."

"I don't know.. I don't know this place at all." Shadow Weaver replied.

"Well you could have asked me, I know.." Darkith said and sighed. "Anyways, our paths separate from here on now.. I don't expect to survive."

"What? How do I even explain your death?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"That's your problem.. you should head to the gates.. Catra is most likely to enter from there, I'll head deeper into the Fright Zone."

"Guess.. this is it then.. I just have to say, you caused way too much trouble than you were worth." Shadow Weaver said.

"At least I had worth, unlike you." Darkith said. She then did something neither her nor Shadow Weaver could have believed. Darkith took off her broken mask, showing her withered gray, old and tired half of the face. With a faint smirk she said. "Though.. I think I was only joking.."

"I guess as well.." Shadow Weaver replied.

Meanwhile, Scoripa and Glimmer had just arrived at the Black Garnet and it seemed like half of the room's roof had been blown off. "Oh, I didn't remember it looked like this.. though it's been a long time." Scorpia said and walked up to the Black Garnet. "Uhh, hey.. Princess Scorpia here.. can we connect?"

She walked up next to Black Garnet and hesitantly tried to connect with it, but before she even made a physical touch she just gave up. "No.. I'm not a real princess.. Im not cut for this." She sighed in disappointment.

"Hey, you can do it. We are in this together." Glimmer comforted and placed her hand on Scorpia's shoulder. "We believe in you, stop doubting yourself."

Scorpia sighed. "I guess.. you're right." She tried once more and placed her pinchers onto Black Garnet, forming a physical connection. The Black Garnet began to vibrate and was soon engulfed with a bright crimson glow. It gave Scorpia an electrifying boost.

Meanwhile at the crystal castle, Light Hope was monitoring the runestones and now saw the Black Garnet activating. "Planet is now balanced." She placed the Black Garnet with the other runestones and settled Sword of Protection into the middle of it. "The Heart of Etheria project is ready to commence."

And with that all across the Etheria, the different runestones lit up and gave every princess a significant boost in their power. With that power they could easily dispatch all the Horde's armies from navy to ground troops.

Adora was running towards the crystal castle and noticed that the runestone in her sword activated and her sword felt immediately a lot heavier. "Oh no... it's happening.."

Back at the Hordak's chambers, Scratch was trying to get up but her ankle told otherwise. She was quickly interrupted by none other than Double Trouble.

"Oof, you look like a mess." They said.

"Double Trouble? What are you doing here?!"

"Well.. I came here to formally inform you that our deal is off." Double Trouble said.

"What do you mean?!" Scratch said with a growling tone, slowly trying to reach her sword. "Are you double crossing me?!"

"Well I wouldn't exactly call it that." Double Trouble said, smirking and took their communication pad. They then proceeded to show Scratch how all the Horde's armies were crushed by the princesses. "Logically I'd choose the winning side. The Rebellion has an ancient super weapon, which they are ready to launch soon. Though, it's nothing personal, it's just good business."

Scratch was getting angry, no one would double cross her right in front of her face and get to walk away. "You think you can just do that and walk away alive?"

"Well considering your situation.. yes." Double Trouble answered and began to walk away. "With that leg, you couldn't even beat a branch.."

And as Scratch was ready to draw her sword, getting herself up from the ground, her ankle said no and she was once again lying on the floor.

Darkith was heading towards Hordak's chambers, it seemed like something had blown up there. Definitely Hordak and Scratch had something to do with it.

When she stumbled in, she saw an unconscious Hordak under the rubble and Scratch lying on the ground. "What the hell has happened here?"

Scratch noticed that voice, it was none other than Darkith. The one she hated more than Catra.

"You- You dare to show up here? Right now!?" Scratch answered with a shaky voice. "To what? To show off your skills? Gloating about being in the princesses 'friend group'..."

"Not at all.." Darkith replied. "I came here because you and I have some unfinished business."

"Oh, so you want to fight me?" Scratch chuckled. "When I'm at my lowest and can barely stand.."

"I was a dick towards you, I don't deny it. Nor will I ever apologize.. that is for weaklings.."

"Heh.. at least we can agree on something." Scratch scuffed. "So.. if you aren't here for apologies.. then what for?"

"To give you a chance to strike down the one who's been responsible for your misery." Darkith said and spread her arms, or rather the only arm she had left. "Hit me with your best shot!"

Scratch looked up to Darkith's face and for the first time ever, she saw her face. Or what was left for it. Stern and serious look on Darkith's face told her everything.

Slowly she grabbed the sword and used it to support herself to get up. Once she got up, she slowly limped towards Darkith, dragging the sword alongside her.

"So, this is not a trick of yours?"

"I don't possess any magic anymore.. I suggest you to be faster though. I don't have much time left." Darkith said with a calm voice and a serious, but tired look on her face.

"Then don't move.." Scratch said and raised the sword. She used all her strength to strike Darkith down. She lunged towards Darkith and cut her half from waist down.

Darkith's upper body fell on the ground and began to crumble into dust, slowly. Her lower half vanished in the air with a burst of purple flame.

Scratch lost her balance after the swing and fell at the opposite side of Darkith. Now that last ripes of Darkith's powers are gone. The sword she had enchanted, shattered into thousand pieces.. leaving only the sword's handle.

Meanwhile Shadow Weaver was looking for Catra, but couldn't find her. She clearly had not come through the gates, Catra must have gone from an alternate route. This frustrated Shadow Weaver, unable to use magic, was the worst. She had to walk or even worse.. run, to find Catra.

Shadow Weaver had a vague memory where Hordak's chambers were.. pretty much near the room where Black Garnet was.

It's obvious Glimmer would be after Hordak and Scratch, Catra was going after Glimmer. It was obvious everyone was heading in the same direction. But what if she faced Horde soldiers along her way? Could she even fight without magic?

But none of that mattered now, the most important thing was to find Catra from this hellhole.

Scorpia and Glimmer were at the Fright Zone's industrial area, where they produced all those bots. With Scorpia supercharged from the Black Garnet, she easily could wreck the whole place.

"Oh wow.. this does pack a punch!" Scorpia exclaimed with an excited tone.

"I'm proud of you Scorpia." Glimmer said. "You should go help other princesses. I'm going after Hordak and Scratch."

"Ah, about Scratch.." Scorpia came into a sudden stop. Even if Scratch had hurt her so much, she wouldn't want her to die. "Uhh, I know she has done terrible things.. but can you at least go somewhat easy on her.. like not killing her?"

"Don't worry, I won't kill her. We're the good guys... remember?" Glimmer said with a serious tone and teleported away.

Adora had arrived at the crystal castle and confronted Light Hope. "Light Hope! Please don't do this!" Adora pleaded as she barged in.

Light Hope turned to look at Adora. " *Good, you're here.. we can now begin. Finally, after a thousand years, my program will be fulfilled. The Heart of Etheria will be unleashed against the enemies of the First Ones.* " Light Hope began to control She-Ra's sword, raising it in the air.

"N-no.. no, there's no First Ones anymore. Whatever war they were fighting, is now long gone." Adora said while trying to resist the control.

" *The First Ones will rise again, you are the descendant of their mighty empire. That is why I used all the strength to reach across the entire universe to find you and bring you here.* " Light Hope explained.

Adora's face turned into a shock, all this time she thought Hordak had brought her here. "You told me Hordak was the one who brought me here. You told me he stole me, but it was you all along! All of this is because of you!" Adora yelled and desperately pulled the sword away, striking it on the floor.

" *This is your intended function, you will bring the First Ones to glory. It is what you are born to do.* "

"No.. No I won't!" Adora said with a desperate voice.

" *The Heart of Etheria has been activated, you will be the one to fire it. There is no stopping it now.* " Light Hope explained. Then the First Ones markings appeared on Adora's skin, she grunted in pain as if to be forced to use the Heart.

Back at the Fright Zone, Glimmer arrived at the room where Hordak and Scratch should have been. Though what she saw was something she didn't expect. Hordak was unconscious, lying under the rubble. Darkith had only an upper torso left and Scratch was trying to lean on the wall.

"Oh.. well, guess you'll get all my attention then." Glimmer said and pointed her staff at Scratch, who was breathing heavily. "Your troops are gone, you're alone. You've Lost!"

"Hah.." Scratch chuckled. "What are you waiting for then?"

"Wha- I don't understand? No insults, no fighting back? What happened!?" Glimmer asked.

"I admit it, you won... I lost! So do what you must!" Scratch taunted.

Glimmer lowered her staff and backed away, but then she felt something draining her. She felt immense pain as her magic was being suck out of her. First One’s markings appeared on her skin as well and she collapsed on the floor. Scratch had a puzzled look on her face, she had no idea what was about to happen.

It was happening all across Etheria, all of the princesses' runestones were overridden and the markings appeared onto them as well. Draining the power from the princess and directing all the magical energy to Adora.

"Agh.. It won't work! Mara made sure of it! So you couldn't hurt anyone else!"

" *Mara. Mara's interference caused a severe delay, but no longer. With the planet being balanced, the portal capabilities are restored. Initiating planetary move out of dimension, Despandos..* "

The runestone in the sword activated and the power of the Heart was channeled through Adora, starting to pull Etheria out from the pocket dimension.

Meanwhile, near the borders of the Fright Zone. Swift Wind was carrying Bow and Entrapta, but something made him lose strength and he had to make a forced landing.

"Swift Wind? You okay, what's happening?" Bow asked with a concerned tone.

"I-I don't know.. its too much.." Swift Wind said and then they were surrounded by a bright glowing light. It seemed to cover all of Etheria.

"What is going on?!" Bow yelled. "Entrapta?"

"It's.. it's a portal. ITS GIANT PORTAL!" Entrapta exclaimed excitedly. "With the planet being balanced, portal capabilities must be back on. WE'RE BEING PULLED THROUGH!"

"Through to where?!"

With a bright flash, the empty sky they had used to was gone. They could see stars, the sky filled with stars. Something that was considered as a myth. "We're not in despandos anymore.. we are in the wider universe!" Entrapta said.

"Ugh, I need to find Glimmer and fast." Bow stated.

Back at the Fright Zone, Glimmer was on her knees and couldn't get up. Glimmer was grunting in pain as her magic was being drained. "Adora was right... Light Hope, used me! She.. activated the Heart!"

"So? I thought you wanted to win?" Scratch asked. "Use your weapon!"

"Argh, I can't.. its going to destroy everything!" Glimmer grunted and tried to stand up, but she was being forced to crawl. "I.. I have to try to stop it.." Glimmer was dragging herself towards the Black Garnet and Scratch was following her. Glimmer was desperately firing magic at the Black Garnet, but it had no use.

At the same time, Shadow Weaver and Catra both arrived there. Making this meet up one of the most awkward ever. "Finally, Catra! I found you!" Shadow Weaver stated.

"How did you get here?!" Catra asked.

"It doesn't matter, what does matter is you! Don't waste your life on petty revenge!" Shadow Weaver said.

"I wasn't going to..." Catra murmured.

"Catra!? Shadow Weaver?!" Glimmer asked. "Help me stop this!"

Meanwhile Scratch was laughing on the floor. "Hah! I can't believe this! Looks like I'm not the only one who tried to win, while destroying this planet!"

Catra wasn't taking any of Scratch's mocking and just smacked her unconscious with her staff.

"Catra!" Shadow Weaver scolded.

"What? I had to hit someone." Catra replied.

"Come on! Just help me!" Glimmer yelled.

"Unfortunately, I can't do anything.. you have to trust Adora to handle this." Shadow Weaver replied.

"Well at least I'm not a real princess!" Catra stated and picked up her staff.

"Catra, what are you doing?"

"Watch this." she said and jumped onto Black Garnet and began to hit the Black Garnet with the staff. Hoping to pierce the crystal.

Meanwhile Darkith, who was about to die. Looked up in the sky from the blown up roof. She gazed at the bright night sky. "Stars.. I knew they were real.." She sighed and remembered her time as Star Bender. "And those fools dared to doubt me back then.." With a faint smile on her face, she closed her eyes and let her body crumble into a pile of dust.

At the crystal castle, Light Hope was observing the balanced planet. " *The Heart is primed and ready, commencing activation.* "

Adora managed to resist the control and tried once more to reason with Light Hope. "Look.. at those stars, these worlds! They all will be destroyed!" Adora yelled with a shattered voice. "Mara sacrificed herself to stop this from happening!"

When Light Hope heard Mara again, her tone shifted. " *Mara.. Mara wouldn't want me to - Mara was a traitor, she turned against her people!* "

"Mara was your friend! She thought you were more than just a program and.. SO DO I!" Adora pleaded. "You can stop this!"

" *I am not as strong as Mara, I can not change my programming.* ***This is our destiny!*** " Light hope said and forcefully raised Adora's sword.

"NO! This is not my destiny!"

" *You will comply."* Light Hope replied and applied more force.

"No, No no!" Adora yelled and tried to resist the controlling.

Now all the energy was collected and the weapon charged up. " *It is time..* "

"No, I'm not going to be controlled! I am not a piece of their machine.! I'm not a weapon and I am going to end this now!" Adora yelled and forced the sword out of Light Hope's control.

" *No, stop!* ***Don't*** *, do it. Do it, don't ..* " Light Hope struggled to go through her programming as memories of her and Mara's past came back to her. " *Don't ..* " Weapon was ready to go, but she lowered her hand and came to the conclusion. " *Do it.* "

Adora could regain control of the sword and with a yell and all her strength, she stroked the sword against the floor. Piercing through the floor and shattering into pieces. It caused a loud and bright explosion and then silence.

Adora opened her eyes and she was surrounded by darkness, till she heard a familiar voice calling for her. " *Adora.* " Light Hope appeared in front of her, putting her hand on Adora's shoulder. " *Thank you...* " With those words said, she disappeared as her program was destroyed and she faded into nothingness. Leaving Adora alone in the silent darkness.

Glimmer could feel the draining wear off and she could stand on now. Hordak however had come back to his senses and was slowly trying to reach Them. With a piece of concrete rubble, he smacked Shadow Weaver off to the side and focused now onto Glimmer. Catra was ready to intervene, but Bow was faster. He shot an explosive arrow at Hordak's chest, forcing him to back off.

"Glimmer! I'm coming!"

"Bow!" Glimmer yelled, but then she, Hordak and Catra were surrounded by a green barrier and they were being sucked into air.

"Ah, Horde Prime. He's here." Hordak stated.

And with a green flash they were gone before Bow could reach them. "No, Noooo!" He yelled and fell on his knees, but as he looked up he saw the armada of Horde Prime. Hundreds of ships, hovering over the skies of Etheria.

"Catra! Catra, where are you!" Shadow Weaver yelled as she looked around her.

"She's up there..." Bow said with a defeated voice and pointed up at the sky.

Shadow Weaver looked up and saw the armada. "We're doomed..." She stated and fell on her knees.

Adora had left the crystal castle and looked up at the sky. With a desperate sigh, she said to herself. "How are we ever going to get through this?"

Glimmer opened her eyes and she felt dizzy, she looked around her surrounded by a tall citadel. She tried to use her magic, but noticed it didn't work here.

Hordak was on his knees and looking at Horde Prime.

"Is that you, little brother?" Prime's voice called. It sounded calm yet sinister at the same time. His chair turned and he looked at Hordak. "I thought you had perished."

"I was pulled into a shadow dimension. All this time I've tried to return to your side." Hordak began to explain. "But it has not been in vain. I have built an empire in your name."

"I received your transmission, but I couldn't determine its source. Until I saw this." Horde Prime said and pulled up a miniscule version of Etheria's Heart. "These energy readings were something I hadn't seen ever before. And when I arrived, this curious planet had appeared."

Glimmer was looking with a horrified look on her face. What had she done, something so terrible that words couldn't even comprehend it.

"I conquered this world, for you. To show you that I am worthy, so that I can retake my place at your side. I have bent its people to my will!" Hordak said.

"To.. your will?" Horde Prime asked calmly and rose up from his seat. He walked up in front of Hordak and kneeled down. "Why can't I see your thoughts?" He said and put both of his hands on Hordak's face and began to read his thoughts.

"I see, you have given yourself a name. You tried to create an empire of your own, there was even a time you wished I wouldn't

have come for you." Horde Prime explained and put his hand on the spot where the crystal that Entrapta had given to him used to be. "Is that so?"

"No, brother. I did it, all of it for you!" Hordak said with a desperate voice.

For a moment, it seemed it had worked. But then Horde Prime snapped and grabbed Hordak by his throat. "You have forgotten who you are! You have given yourself a name! You really thought you could be worthy of standing beside me, to be equal to me!?" Horde Prime yelled. "I made you into my image, but you have become an abomination! So you must be rebooted!" With a quick snap, Hordak was turned into a black slate. "Take him to be reconditioned."

Then Horde Prime began to walk towards Glimmer. "Oh, but I have been rude. We have quest, a royalty.. unless I'm mistaken." Prime said with a gentle voice and offered his hand to Glimmer. "I must apologize for my little brother. His actions have been embarrassing. I only desire peace and order."

"Then.. you'll leave us alone?" Glimmer asked with an uncertain, but a hopeful tone.

"Oh no.. child. I can not let word spread of my brother's botched conquest." Horde Prime said. "In order to thrive, this whole mess must be wiped away. Beginning with you."

"I wouldn't do that if I were you." A voice called and gained Horde Primes attention. Catra emerged from the back of the rubble that had been teleported there alongside them. She walked towards Glimmer and Prime. "You don't want to destroy Etheria, the whole planet is an ancient super weapon. Really really big one at that. This princess here is part of it and if you want to learn how to use it. You need me."

"A weapon?" Prime repeated and took another look at Etheria. "That explains these readings.. they are stronger than I have ever

seen." Then Horde Prime changed his tone to a more polite and gentle one. "Your majesty, what an honor to host a guest of your stature." He said and bowed down. "Trust that, your planet will become the jewel of my empire. And it will allow me to bring peace and order to farthest reaches of the universe."

As Horde Prime walked towards his thorne, Glimmer gave a concerned look at Catra, while she just winked an eye. " *Just play alongside.* "

"Thank you for your allegiance, child." Horde Prime said as he sat down. "All creatures, no matter how small have place of service.. of Horde Prime."

Back at the Planet of Etheria. Adora was watching the endless stream of Prime's ships. She was then confronted by Bow and Shadow Weaver. "Adora!"

She turned to look at them and went to hug bow.

"They took her, they took Glimmer and Catra." Bow said.

"And She-Ra's gone, I broke the sword." Adora said with a sigh.

"Then what are we going to do?"

"We have to save the universe." Adora stated.

Chapter End Notes

Oh wow... this was even longer than earlier chapter... and probably very shitly written..

Anyways, would you guys be intersted in a kind of prequel/standalone story about Catra and Shadow Weaver? Since Im quite unhappy how little I actually wrote Shadow Weaver being Catra's mother.

My idea would be to write more, shorter standalone slice of life chapters. Not in anything particular order. All you would need to know is that the story would take place after the prologue and before the Best Friend Squad.

What you think?

Horde Prime Is Here

Chapter Summary

Horde Prime has plans to inquire information from Glimmer and Catra, by inviting them for dinner.

Shadow Weaver copes her loss of magic and loss of Catra.. again..

Chapter Notes

Wow, its been what.. like 2 months?! How have I been so stuck... ugh anyways, I hope this chapter will suffice you hunger. That is if somene is still waiting for updates :D

See the end of the chapter for more notes

As Horde Primes ships hover over Etheria, tall towers land on the soil and the endless armies of the Horde advance.

Brightmoon was reduced to ashes and the rebellion had to flee. Now holding a hideout near the Whispering Woods. Sorcerers from Mystacor had arrived all around Etheria, to help the people.

Sorcerers cast illusion spells to hide everyone in the refugee camp from the eyes of the Horde.

Adora, with the other princesses were helping people to evacuate. Adora had hard time accepting that she was not She-Ra anymore.

At the refuge camp, Shadow Weaver was doing everything she could to try to help the wounded. Her knowledge in medicine and herbalism were unmatched. Even without her magic, she could

still be useful. However, her advice was mostly dismissed by the other sorcerers from Mystacor.

Adora, Bow and other princesses arrived at the camp with a handful of refugees with them. Adora was beyond exhausted, her recklessness got herself almost killed.

Shadow Weaver noticed that Adora was clearly not alright, giving up on being She-Ra must be hard. So much power, such power...

Scratch had been captured and she had an awkward moment with Scorpia.

"I don't want your pity, I don't need your pity!" Scratch snapped at Scorpia. "It would be better if you just would execute me."

"But we can't do that.. it's not right." Scorpia said.

"Why are you even here? You don't owe me anything. And dont you even dare to mention that princess, I know she's here as well.. all that misses is Catra.. gloating about how much better she is."

"You know.. maybe this just doesn't work.." Scorpia came to a sad conclusion.

"Seems like your slow brains finally catched up!" Scratch said with a piercing tone.

Scorpia just sighed and left Scratch in the tent. She just couldn't understand why Scratch was like that.

It was late evening and stars had covered the sky, Shadow Weaver was sitting outside on a trunk watching the night sky. It would have been beautiful if it wouldn't have been with all those

Horse ships and somewhere.. inside one of those ships were Catra.

She let out a deep sigh, never before had she felt this powerless. Then she noticed that someone sat next to her.

It was Adora and she didn't look any better.

"Can't sleep?" Shadow Weaver asked.

Adora only nodded her head in agreement.

"Same..." Shadow Weaver replied.

"I just get pestered by these weird dreams.. about a portal and something that looks like She-Ra.. it also shows me weird locations.." Adora began her unexpected rant. "It doesn't make any sense! And then there's the problem with Catra and Glimmer.."

"I see.. You know, I keep thinking a lot of things as well and it is agonizing.. knowing you can't do anything and wondering what terrible things might have happened." Shadow Weaver said with a regretful tone.

"So, are you bothered by nightmares as well?" Adora asked.

"Heh.. you have no idea.. my whole life is one big nightmare.. and I can't wake up from it." Shadow Weaver said with a dry tone and a chuckle.

"Such a mood.. if I was She-Ra.. I might be able to help you... but I'm not anymore.." Adora sighed.

"But you did help me, I'm not dying to an otherworldly entity anymore.. although with the cost of my magic.."

"I didn't even know I could do that."

"Well, if we're being honest.. the She-Ra that was there at the Beast Island.. it wasn't you." Shadow Weaver said. "She felt much more powerful.. and older than you."

"I've quite literally fallen off the tracks." Adora replied puzzled.

"I'm as dumbfounded as you, but maybe.. those dreams of yours aren't nightmares.. but something else.. Maybe the spirit of She-Ra is trying to communicate with you." Shadow Weaver suggested.

"You mean like an ancient spirit? Like that entity of yours?"

"Well.. I guess so, but She-Ra's spirit is much better than Spell of Obtainment.." Shadow Weaver chuckled. "I don't know that much of She-Ra, but I'm pretty sure she is much more than just a sword and cog in a machine."

Hearing Shadow Weaver's comforting words with an assuring and gentle tone made Adora relax a bit more, who would have guessed that Shadow Weaver had that kind of a side with her.

"Well.. I guess I'll try to sleep.. can't fight Horde Prime while being half-dead." Adora replied and stood up. "Well.. goodnight, Shadow Weaver."

"Goodnight." Shadow Weaver replied. She felt something unusual inside of her, feelings she hadn't felt in a long time. Or rather feelings she thought to be impossible for her to feel.

She gazed once more into the starry night sky and said; "Goodnight Catra.. if you still are there.. somewhere.."

Meanwhile, somewhere far away from Etheria in Horde Prime's capital ship. Catra looked out from a window, seeing a whole planet being orbitally bombarded. " *I guess those people have no chance of surviving..* "

She then walked into the prison area of the capital ship, going to meet Glimmer. She was being held in a spacious cell. It wasn't the most comfortable place, but it sure did beat the Horde's prisons on Etheria.

Catra knocked on an energy shield that separated herself and Glimmer. "What are you doing here?" Glimmer asked.

"Just checking on you." Catra replied. "I'm hatching a plan, but you need to keep playing. If either of us blows this up, then we're done for."

"O-okay.. what do you need me to do?"

"Keep acting the way you do, I keep acting as an enemy." Catra said and walked off.

Catra was wandering around the hallways, looking for anything that would be crucial for their escape. She came across a room where Horde's troops were being transported to different locations. Probably to Etheria in this particular case. Catra decided to snoop around and see how the transportation machine works.

However, she was caught by one of the Horde clones. "Catra!"

Catra stopped on her tracks and froze. "Uhhh... yes?" She asked and slowly turned her head.

"Horde Prime wants you to join that princess with him for dinner."

"Alright.. I'll be there."

"Also, Horde Prime wants you to get the princess."

"Sure, easy thing."

"Good, that is all." The clone said and walked away.

Catra sighed in relief, for a second she thought she was done for.

Meanwhile Horde Prime was monitoring the recorded footage from her ground troops. His attention was focused on one particular blonde girl. "Who are you.. You seem so familiar.."

Back at Etheria, it was a restless night for Adora. She had these weird dreams and visions of She-Ra, Etheria and her past. None of it made any sense. She couldn't sleep, it felt like she had a fever even though she was fine. She woke up and wiped the sweat off.

She started her room and then glanced at her broken sword. She let out a disappointed sigh and got up. She walked out from her tent and thought that maybe some fresh air would help her calm down and clear her thoughts.

But she wasn't the only one awake at this time of night. She could hear cursing and some sort of spell inactions. It was none other than Shadow Weaver.

"Come on! Work damn it!" Shadow Weaver cursed as she tried to cast spells. Even the artificial magic staff that she made for Catra

didn't work. It seemed to have been broken when Catra fought with it. "Argh! It's no use! Curse this!"

"Worthless piece of junk!" With a fit of rage she threw the magic staff and it pierced into a tree and got stuck there. "Aaargh!" Shadow Weaver

Adora was hesitant to intervene, but decided still nonetheless. "Uhh.. Shadow Weaver?"

When she heard Adora call for her, she immediately calmed down, collected her cool and swiped her messy hair. "Ah, Adora.. how can I help you?" She asked with a calm and collected voice. "Shouldn't you be sleeping?"

"I could ask the same from you.." Adora replied.

"Right.." Shadow Weaver said and coughed. "So.. you heard everything?"

"Yep, it seems I'm not the only one who can't sleep."

Shadow Weaver let out a deep sigh. "I- I haven't used to be magicless. I feel so useless!"

"I can relate to that." Adora said with a faint chuckle and a shrug of her shoulder.

"Oh.. right, you aren't She-Ra anymore.." Shadow Weaver stated. "It can't be helped."

"The sword is broken and my whole purpose was to be a cog in a machine of weapon of mass destruction." Adora's voice began to shatter and she let out a desperate laugh. "Now we're screwed by Horde Prime and both Catra and Glimmer are out there.. off of our reach."

Shadow Weaver noticed that Adora seemed to be in great anguish, but what could she do? She's just a failed sorcerer who

doesn't even have magic anymore. So what could her words even do to help?

She could see Adora fall into despair and she couldn't let the poor girl just suffer like that. So, she did something unthinkable and walked up to Adora. She put her hands around Adora and embraced her into a tight hug.

Adora felt the tight but comforting hug of Shadow Weaver. She never thought Shadow Weaver had this kind of side to her, but she embraced it.

Shadow Weaver bushed Adora's long hair and comforted her. She hummed the same song her mother had used to sing to her when she was ill. That same song she had also sang to Catra as well, to calm her.

Humming the song was the right choice, she was a terrible singer and Catra sometimes used to tease her because of that.

Adora could feel her mind to calm down and her anguish began to fade. Shadow Weaver's tight, but comforting hug alongside her calming humming made Adora feel safety she had never known or felt before.

It took a while until she was completely calm and collected. Shadow Weaver released her grip and asked if Adora felt any better.

"Yeah, a lot of better.." Adora replied with a calm and relieved tone. "I didn't know you had this kind of side. I always thought you were cold."

Shadow Weaver sighed. "Sometimes I wonder about it myself as well, guess there's some things that have changed me."

Adora let out a laugh. "Seems like a cold witch like you have few soft spots."

"I'd rather be called sorcerer than witch." Shadow Weaver replied with a cough. "Witches are uncivilized and amateurs, unlike how us sorcerers are of high stature and educated." Shadow Weaver joked.

And so the sun crept above the forest roof and lit up the area.

"Ah.. I guess it's morning already.." Shadow Weaver stated as she looked up at the sky.

"It seems so.." Adora replied. "We should return to our camp."

As they returned back to the camp, they were completely unaware that they were being watched and Horde's armies were right on their doorstep.

Back at the Horde Prime's capital ship, dinner was being prepared. Both Catra and Glimmer arrived into the Prime's grand dining hall. "Lord Prime, The Queen of Brightmoon." Catra introduced.

"Have a seat, queen." Horde Prime replied.

Prime had prepared a special seat at the other end of the table, while Catra got a secondary one.

"Now then, I am pleased to finally talk to you." Horde Prime said. "But I think it's, better to discuss while eating."

Then a few Horde servants came and served fancy drinks alongside a fancy jelly. Catra and Glimmer gave each other a look.

"Please, do eat." Horde Prime insisted.

Glimmer hesitantly took a bite of the jelly and it was surprisingly delicious.

"Delicious, isn't it? You know, that dish is a rare delicacy from a planet similar to Etheria." Horde Prime explained. "But, do you know why it is so rare? Well, that planet no longer exists."

Glimmer was horrified and dropped her fork, she couldn't believe that she was eating such a dish. Catra on the other hand ignored what Prime said and continued eating.

"Speaking of Etheria." Horde Prime said and opened a large screen showing the rebellion camp back on Etheria. "It seems your friends back at Etheria seem to be quite desperate."

Horde Prime showed them how his troops were defeating the princess and that the rebellion was clearly at the backfoot. "These useless rebellions always form around some sort of beacon of hope... Is it perhaps the old king of Brightmoon?"

Glimmer was shocked, she never thought her father was alive.

"Or perhaps..." Horde Prime turned to look at Catra with a smirk on his face. "It is this old, but experienced sorceress. Who'se had a lot of experience?"

Catra tried to keep her face straight, but she instinctively was scratching the table in anger.

"But I digress.. I think the greatest beacon of hope is her." Moving the point to Adora, who's at the moment fighting against 5 horde troopers. "Ah, there she is. Adora, She-Ra.. your beacon of hope. If I snuff out this beacon of hope, your pathetic rebellion will crumble."

Glimmer couldn't take it anymore. "Please stop!" She yelled.

Horde Prime stopped the troops from moving and looked at Glimmer.

"Please, if you want to use Heart of Etheria.. You need She-Ra to do it, so please... Please spare her." Glimmer pleaded.

"Hmph.. I see.. That makes sense." Horde Prime replied and shut the screen. "I think this has been quite the fruitful dinner, wouldn't you agree? Please, do eat."

At Etheria, Adora was prepared to get gobsmacked, but the troops did not move. Which confused her a lot. She backed away and saw their camp utterly ransacked.

"This is why I said that we should have used an actual shield and not just an invisibility illusion!" Shadow Weaver scolded. "But no! No one never listens to me!"

"Alright, Shadow Weaver. Calm down." Micah said and held Shadow Weaver back. "Save that aggression of yours to Horde."

"But Micah, you have to agree. It was stupid to rely on an illusion spell."

"Yes.. yes I agree. But we have to go, We can't stay here anymore." Micah said.

"But where do we even go?" Mermista asked.

"Yeah, Horde Prime has control almost everywhere at Etheria." Frosta said.

"Well... I had these dreams and visions." Adora said. "There's a place, deep in the Whispering Woods. We could use that as a

hiding spot."

"Great, then we should hurry." Bow said. "Entrapta, come on!"

"But all this Horde tech is just laying on the ground, I can't leave it." Entrapta said as she stuffed all the tech possible into her backpack.

"You're not collecting anything if Horde gets you." Bow said and dragged Entrapta with him.

Scorpia came, carrying a tied up Scratch on her shoulder. "Come on! Why couldn't you just leave there?!" Scratch protested. "I don't need you pity Scorpia, I don't need anyone's pity!"

"Oh shut up, we can't just leave you. You would just use the Horde invasion for your advantage." Adora said.

"Then kill me! I have nothing to contribute to your futile rebellion!" Scratch yelled.

Scopria stung Scratch 'accidently' with her tail and Scratch fell silent real quick. "Sorry, maybe it's better if she's out of it." Scorpia replied.

"I agree." Shadow Weaver said.

They headed deep into the Whispering Woods and their trekking took a long time. Until they found an old cave with thick vines covering the entrance. As they stepped inside, it seemed to be an old storage area. Probably belonging to the Horde. But, it was deep in the forest and Prime had yet to show any signs of control in the Whispering Woods.

"I guess this will be our base of operations for the time being." Adora said and sighed.

"It will do just fine." Micah replied.

At Horde Prime's capital ship, Queen Glimmer had been escorted back to her cell and only Catra and Prime remained in the great dining hall. Catra still tried to play her role. "That was some clever planning, using the princesses weakness against them." Catra said smugly. "Princesses are so easily predictable."

"And so were you." Prime replied and looked at Catra.

"Wha-what do you mean?" Catra had a moment of panic.

"Accelerated heartbeat, dilating pupils and those scratch marks on my table. Which by the way wasn't cheap. Adora means something to you, doesn't she?" Horde Prime said and towered over Catra.

"Ugh, no she doesn't. I'm not a fan of the princesses!" Catra tried to defend, but Prime could easily see through her facade.

"Really now? You aren't that convincing, but now that I know that it's She-Ra who I need for the Heart of Etheria to work... The question comes to, what can you offer to me?"

Catra couldn't get anything to say, she was cornered and had no way out.

"Well, I assure you. You will have your uses. Horde Prime never takes anything that is useless." Prime said while looking down on Catra. "Please, do enjoy your stay. I'll call you if it's necessary, but don't try anything funny. Or else I have to show you what will happen if you disobey the might of the Prime."

"Y-Yes, Lord Prime." Catra meekly answered and bowed. She then left the dining room, her mind filled with dread. How would she

ever get out of here alive?

Chapter End Notes

Like I said earlied, took me way too long to finish this chapter... But I hope it was bearable

Launch

Chapter Summary

> The Rebellion is in a tight spot, Horde Prime has placed his spirals all around Etheria and is now urging to turn Etherian's against She-Ra and the Rebellion. They also have to somehow save Glimmer, but how can they do it when they don't even know where she is. That is where Entrapta comes in. Although the Princesses don't trust her, she is their best chance of finding and saving Glimmer.

Chapter Notes

> Oh yeah another chapter!
> -So soon?-
> I know right.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Princesses were observing from the edge of the forest as Horde Prime spoke to Etherian's. Prime's speech was spine chilling, he urged Etherians to turn against She-Ra and the Princesses. If they want to save themselves from total annihilation.

"We're screwed..." Mermista stated.

Entrapta wasn't worrying about anything that Prime said, she was more excited about the technology Prime had and his tech could be utilized.

Back at the rebellion hideout, Adora had once more these weird dreams about her past, Etheria, She-Ra, Portal and Horde Prime. Nothing made sense and Adora once again woke up and stared at the ceiling. She had lately been aggressively fighting against the

Horde, but since she was not She-Ra anymore it clearly was starting to weigh down on her.

Her body betrayed her and she couldn't even move a limb. Bow had offered her to rest, but what use it was when she was in pain.

Well Shadow Weaver decided to pay a visit to Adora, even if Bow had insisted against it. But Shadow Weaver assured him that she wouldn't do anything that would stress her.

"How are you doing?" Shadow Weaver asked as she entered the tent.

"Terrible.." Adora answered with a raspy and tired voice. "My body feels so stretched and strained.."

"Well, you've been pushing your limits lately.." Shadow Weaver replied. "I'd suggest you take better care of yourself."

"Ugh.. Bow already lectured me about that.." Adora sighed.

"Oh, I'm not here to lecture you.. I was thinking if you would test a medicine I had made." Shadow Weaver said and took a small bottle from her pocket. Shadow Weaver then picked up a glass of water on the side desk and poured her medicine into the glass.

"What are you doing exactly?" Adora inquired.

"I don't know.. medicine of sorts.." Shadow Weaver answered while shrugging her shoulders. "Here, drink it. It should ease your pain."

"You know.. it's kind of suspicious of you to offer me a mystery drink." Adora said.

"Rest assured, it's a medicine. I made it according by the book." Shadow Weaver said.

"If you say so..." Adora replied and drank all of the medicine in one gulp. "Yuck! It tastes terrible!"

"That's how you know it's effective." Shadow Weaver replied with a smirk. "Give it an hour or two.. then you should feel better."

Shadow Weaver began to leave the tent and before she stepped outside, Adora called for her. Shadow Weaver.."

"Yes?" She replied and turned her head.

"Thank you.."

Shadow Weaver had a faint smile on her face. "You're welcome." She said and left Adora to recover.

Shadow Weaver looked around their camp and saw as the others came back from their scouting. "So, anything interesting?" She decided to ask.

"Meh, Prime kept talking about giving She-Ra to him, otherwise we're doomed.." Mermista answered with her dismissive tone and threw her trident aside. She sat on the bench around the campfire.

"Well.. that certainly didn't sound good-" Shadow Weaver was cut off by Frosta. "What are you even standing there? Shouldn't you be somewhere else?"

Shadow Weaver was quite taken back by Frosta's remark.

"Yeah.. isn't she like a monster of sorts?" Perfuma stated. "I remember her turning into one when we rescued Glimmer from the Fright Zone."

"Actually.. that wasn't me." Shadow Weaver said. "It was an entity called-" She was yet again cut off by Frosta. "Isn't there somewhere else you should be? Like brewing your poisons?"

"I don't brew poisons.. ugh whatever.." Shadow Weaver said and left the princesses be by themselves. " *Such bad behavior from a*

child.. "

Shadow Weaver then went into the tent where their prisoner was being held and Micah was trying to question her.

"For the last time, I have no information about Horde Prime! If you didn't know already, Hordak didn't usually tell anyone about anything." Scratch said.

"But you were closest to him, right?" Micah asked.

"Not even close, that twintailed princess was his favorite." Scratch snorted. "You should ask her and stop bothering me!"

"You are our prisoner, you should answer to anything that is asked from you." Micah said.

"Well you know what? I didn't ask to be taken as a prisoner.. you should have just killed me!" Scratch said.

"Having problems?" Shadow Weaver interrupted.

"Oh, well if it isn't the *mother* of that hellspawn called Catra!" Scratch grumbled.

"Watch your tongue." Micah said. "I think this is not the best time, Shadow Weaver.."

"Well, I might have something to make her more compliant." Shadow Weaver said with a suggestive tone and picked up a small bottle from her pockets. "Look at this."

"Oh, is that something that will kill me? Because I sure hope it does!"

"Shut it!" Shadow Weaver snapped. "You don't have to use it ofcourse, but if she's getting out of hand.. this will surely help." She gave the bottle to Micah.

"And what exactly does it do?" Micah asked, raising an eyebrow.

"She should turn less abrasive, the effect will wear off over time. Its just in case Scratch is getting impossible." Shadow Weaver said and left Micah there with Scratch.

Well, now Shadow Weaver didn't have anything special to do. Obviously, the princesses didn't like her that much, Adora was recovering and she herself didn't want to intervene in Scratch's questioning. She would use methods that would be rather... unorthodox.

So she headed into her small tent where she used to brew potions and make medicine. Her knowledge about magic was being ignored and where did that lead to? Prime finding the refuge camp..

Shadow Weaver had no magic, no one didn't care to listen to her, Catra was out of reach.. but at least she wasn't being consumed by the otherworldly entity. For a brief moment Shadow Weaver expected the Entity to say something witty or give a snide remark, but there was nothing. Her body and mind was hers only.. there was no entity..

Somehow, she might have developed a liking towards that entity. What a crazy world she lived in..

Shadow Weaver was about to just hit the mattress and go to sleep, but something kept her awake. As she laid on the mattress, she kept thinking.

"No, I can't become complacent.. I need to do something!" She said to herself. "If Prime is after the Heart and Heart is a superweapon.. maybe, just maybe there's a killswitch.."

Shadow Weaver now knew what she had to do, even if it meant leaving others behind. Not that they cared.. so it wouldn't matter. "I have to dig deep into this."

Meanwhile at the campfire, the princesses thought about methods on how to find Glimmer.

"We have to do something.. we don't know when Adora gets better and even when she does, we don't have a plan on how to get Glimmer back." Merimista said. "We know she's on Horde Prime ship, but we don't know where it is.. well at space, somewhere."

"Well then it's up to us to come up with a plan to save Glimmer, with these." Perfuma said and pulled up their miniature figures.

"We don't need those, all we need is these!" Frosta exclaimed and turned her hands into ice fists.

"And what are you going to do with those?" Mermista asked with an amused tone.

"Punch Horde Prime." Frosta stated with a huge grin on her face.

Perfuma had a concerned look on her face. "Uhh.. perhaps if we meditate we can access.. our princess connection to find Glimmer's spirit.. out in space." Perfuma said with a nervous tone, but everyone was silent.

Until Entrapta came and broke up the silence. "Hello, oh hi! Were you guys talking about space?"

Princesses didn't seem to be that happy to see Entrapta.

"Uhm.. yes.." Perfuma answered. "We were talking about how we could get Glimmer back from space."

"Oh! I'd do anything to get into space!" Entrapta exclaimed with enthralled voice. "An infinite universe of information on our fingertips, full of thousands of planets and stars.. ancient civilization-" Entrpata's mouth was then shut up by Mermista who wasn't that keen on seeing Entrapta. "Enough, this isn't some fun

field trip for you to run your messed up experimentations. Our friends out there, remember?"

Due to her lack of socialization and her being bad at communicating with others, Entrapta just stood there dumbfounded.

"Glimmer! The sparkly one!" Mernista said..

"You've met her multiple times!" Frosta butted it.

"Oh.. right.. I remember.." Entrapta answered, but it seems her answer didn't quite satisfy others, so Scorpia tried to defuse the situation by distracting Entrapta. Scorpia walked to Entrapta and said; "Hey, wow.. look at there, is that a robot?"

"What, where!?" Entrapta exclaimed with excitement and ran off.

"Listen.. I know that Entrapta can sometimes be too much of an ' *Oooo science! Phceow! HaaHaa Haa!* ' but I promise Entrapta has a good heart." Scorpia explained while trying to make her best imitation of Entrapta.

"She's betrayed us before.." Mermista answered with a dismissive tone. "For all we know, as soon as she sees Prime's ship up close, she would switch sides."

"She did use her inventions to attack us a lot.." Perfuma said.

"I'm just saying I don't know how to track a spaceship, but Entrpata might. If you just give her a chance." Scorpia tried to assure everyone.

The princesses looked at each other and thought for a moment, then Entrapta's shenanigans broke the silence and Scorpia tried to plead with a cutesy face.

"Ugh, fine." Mermista said.

They walked up to Entrapta who was at the top of a tent, looking for robots. "Hey geek princess, are you going to help us or not?" Mermista asked, but all she got for an answer was an awkward stare from Entrapta. "Ugh.. if you help us find Glimmer you can go to space.."

"Great, its a deal!" Entrapta yelled as she was right next to Mermista.

Meanwhile at the Horde Prime's ship, Glimmer was feeling anxious as she didn't know if she had made things worse for them or not. Catra was trying to sneak up on the cell where Glimmer was held, she was trying to find a way to open the cell door but was cut short by one of Horde Prime's clones. "You should not be here!" He said and grabbed Catra from her shoulder, which sent shivers through her body.

"Uhh.. I wasn't-" But Catra was cut off. "Prime has decreed that none shall speak the queen, you have disobeyed!"

"What does it matter? I think Prime has a lot more things to worry about." Catra answered, giving a snide remark.

"You unworthy wretch! It is not for you to decide what matters to the Prime. You are a parasite, nothing more than dirt beneath his- guh.. cough. gah-" Prime's clone seemed to start to choke on something and his body started to twitch uncontrollably. Catra

looked at him with fear in her eyes and Glimmer was listening behind the cell, terrified when she could hear Prime's voice speaking. "Little sister, why do you rebel against my order?"

"Ho-Horde Prime?" Catra asked with a stutter in her voice.

"Prime sees all, do not disturb the queen." Horde Prime told and poked Catra's nose. "Now, run along." And with that, Horde Prime was gone and it was just his clone. He pushed Catra aside and opened the cell door. He then escorted Queen Glimmer away. Both Catra and Glimmer looked at each other with worry and dread.

Glimmer was escorted into the trophy room of Prime and there he waited for her. "Ahh, your majesty." Horde Prime greeted her. "Thank you for joining me. I thought that you might enjoy a diversion." He then placed his hand on Glimmer's shoulder and began to showcase his trophies from all across the universe. Glimmer was looking in awe and shock.

"Do you like them?" Prime asked as they walked towards a crystal looking ball at the end of the room. "They are all tokens from different worlds that I have brought into my eternal light."

"Worlds you destroyed." Glimmer said while gritting her teeth.

"I take no joy in destruction, but the weeds must be purged for life to flourish." Horde Prime explained coldly. "Ahh this is my favorite. It's from the first world I conquered. It was highly praised by their people and now it is all that is left of them." He gave the crystal ball to Glimmer, then he went onto his knees so he could look Glimmer face to face. "You know I look for She-Ra, but you're reluctant to help me. But I only wish to use the weapon to bring peace to the darkest corners of the universe."

"Peace?" Glimmer asked with a concerned look on her face. "If you activateHeart of Etheria, there would be no one left."

"Yes, no war, no pain, no suffering. Haven't you ever thought how much suffering there is? All worlds swept aside, a new beginning for the universe." Horde Prime answered. "I know you would understand, all I want to do is what you have already done."

"No-No that wasn't-" But Glimmer was cut off by the screen activating, showing her a picture of her father. She was in utter shock, she thought her father was killed. "What, how is it possible?"

"Do you recognise him?" Prime asked, crossing his arms.

"Dad..."

"Let me be clear, your majesty. Your world belongs to me, but I'm merciful. Would you like to be reunited with your father? Would you deliver me She-Ra?"

"I.. I wanted to use Heart of Etheria.. I thought I could save everyone." Glimmer said as she began to shed tears. "All I did was bring you here!" She then smashed the crystal ball on the floor, shattering it. "I will never help you! And you will never win!"

"That was quite cold from you.. you know.. now there's nothing left of those people.." Horde Prime said with a smirk on his face as two of his clones came there and began to escort her back to her cell.

Back at Etheria at the rebellion hideout, Shadow Weaver had got up from her mattress and went outside. She saw that the camp seemed to be empty, it was silent. The other princesses had probably gone looking for a way to find Glimmer, Bow and Micah were away and Adora was seemingly still recovering. There was only one person she could talk to and it was none other than Scratch, but would it be worth it? Scratch hated her, she hated Scratch. Their conversation wouldn't bring anything new or constructive. She could however get some enjoyment from tormenting Scratch.

But no, she wouldn't waste her time on such a petty thing as cheap revenge. She had much more important matters at hand.

At her tent, Adora was having one of her weird dreams once again. She saw light outside of her tent as she woke up. Once again it was this glowing spirit that looked like She-Ra, but it looked much older and taller than her form of She-Ra. Adora grabbed her broken sword, decided to follow her and ran through the woods till she arrived at the open grass plain and a glowing portal at the middle of it. Next to the portal stood the spirit of She-Ra.

"Who are you? Are you She-Ra?" She questioned from the spirit, but the spirit remained silent. Adora walked a bit closer and fell onto her knees. "She-Ra's gone! The sword is broken, so what I do now?"

The spirit only looked at her, watching silently.

"I'm not sorry I did it.. I just didn't know how much I'd miss her.. not just her strength.." Adora explained with a sad expression on her face. "I guess I liked knowing that I had a destiny... It wasn't my destiny to be She-Ra, Light Hope only brought me her so she could use the Heart. That's the only reason I'm here."

Adora let out a deep sigh and stood up. "I don't know what my destiny is anymore, but I know that my friends need me.. Catra.. needs me.. So I guess I'll just figure things out as I go on. I guess, thanks for everything.." Then the bright light shone even brighter and Adora woke up on her bed once again.

This time she felt a lot better, but with a somber look she placed down her broken sword and began to clear her head. Then Bow bursted inside, calling for her. "Adora!"

"Oh Bow, you were right. All I needed was a good sleep and a medicine from Shadow Weaver.. I feel great."

"Good, because I got a call from Mermista." Bow said and took out his communication device. " *Death's coming!* " Memrista yelled, but Entrapta grabbed her device. " *We found her! We found Glimmer!* " Mermista grabbed back the device and yelled; " *Also, Horde Prime is sending more ships to the Etheria, if you don't move now, you can't ever leave, so... RUN!* "

All of them headed towards Mara's ship, even Shadow Weaver and they had to say goodbyes quickly. "We're exposed here. Micah said. "So we better do good bye's fast."

Adora looked at the princesses and gave a hug to Mermista. "We will be back soon, I promise. The Rebellion is in good hands."

"Oh yeah, phew.. Turns out I'm an awesome leader, so we're going to be fine." Memrista answered with a blush on her face. "And Entrapta helped us a lot." She then grabbed Entrapta next to her. "You're still a weirdo, but we got your back anytime."

Bow was getting really emotional and they all hugged each other tightly.

Swift Wind pulled Adora back and wanted to say his goodbyes. "Adora.. I.. I'm not gonna.. Ugh I don't know how I'm going to say this!" Swift Wind said, while holding his tears.

"You're staying here." Adora said with a gentle smile.

"Adora, I don't belong on a ship, I belong on Etheria, to protect it and with you gone.. someone has to bring the glorious flowing hair!" Swift Winds said, but bursted into tears. "I hope you're not disappointed in me..."

"Of course not, I'm proud. You're exactly where you need to be." Adora said and hugged Swift Wind. "I'm not She-Ra anymore.."

"But I'll always be your trusty steed." Swift Wind said.

"Umm.. Adora.." Shadow Weaver called.

"Yes?"

"I don't know what to say exactly.. but please, make sure you get Catra our from there too." Shadow Weaver said.

"Of course we're going to get her." Adora assured her.

But their moment was cut off by advancing Horde scouting drones.

"Surveillance bots!" Frosta yelled. "If they see the ship, they'll alert the armada and stop us!"

"What are we going to do?" Scorpia asked. "Do we have to stay here?"

"No." Micah answered. "We're getting this hip off from Etheria, no matter what and I got a perfect plan."

As the Horde bots were advancing, they were confronted by She-Ra and pulling their attention away. All the princesses had drawn the bots to a remote location away from the ship and now seemed that they were cornered.

"Uhh.. What do you think Micah? have we wasted enough of their time?" Mermista asked.

"Get my good side." he said and winked and shot a fire blast from his hand.

With group effort they smashed the robots, even Shadow Weaver managed to take down a few bots with the broken staff. " *Damn.. it feels kinda good to wreck things with this..* " She thought to herself as she pierced through the robot's core.

When all the bots were defeated, they saw as Mara's ship had successfully launched and was now heading towards space. All the princesses cheered for their success. Micah removed his disguise and looked up at the sky with a slightly concerned face.

"Are you okay? I know you wanted to go as well." Swift Wind said.

"But if I hadn't stayed.. they wouldn't have been able to go at all." Micah said. "I trust my daughters' friends. They saved me, now they'll save her. See you soon baby girl..."

Chapter End Notes

I skipped a lot from this chapter since I thought that its not directly involved with Catra nor Shadow Weaver, but I included the things with Glimmer and Adora because I feel they are the most important ones. Though note that all that I cut from this chapter still happened, because this story still follows the main storyline of the show.

The Rescue

Chapter Summary

> Adora, Bow and Entrapta head to Horde Prime's ship to save Glimmer. Meanwhile Catra is cornered and her only chance to save Glimmer is to run.

Chapter Notes

> This is a shorter chapter and mostly focuses on one thing only, I've cut lots of things.
> Sadly, no Shadow Weaver in this chapter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At Horde Prime's capital ship, Catra feels that she is quite cornered. Horde Prime had ordered two guards for her, to keep an eye on her. Catra however couldn't care less and ran off, she sneaked back to the room where Horde sent their soldiers through a teleporter. Having a good sight, she memorized how to use the machine and now all she had to do was to get Glimmer. But Horde Prime had other plans, he called Catra on the main bridge and wanted to question her.

"Ahh, Little Sister. It's so good to see you here." Horde Prime said. "You know, just a while ago.. my troops have reported that a ship of ancient origin had departed from Etheria."

"So? What about it? Do I look like a space engineer?" Catra quipped with a sarcastic tone.

"I'm displeased by your behavior." Horde Prime sighed. "You are an honor guest and this is how you repay it?"

"Oh no not at all, I appreciate it. But I don't understand why you would want to question me about that ship." Catra answered.

"Well as you know, I’m looking for She-Ra and I haven't yet found her. However, I sense that she is on that ship." Horde Prime said. "If you are trying to withhold truth from me.. well let me show you what happens."

Catra felt nervous about the situation as Horde Prime placed his hand on her shoulder and began to escort her to a large room where there was a pool at the middle. there wre rows of seats and hundreds of Horde Clones were standing there. "You see, one of my clones has a problem. He began to grow an individuality, called himself Hordak." Prime explained as he brought Catra into the room. "Guess my reprogramming wasn't enough."

"Uhh.. so.. what did you want to show me?" Catra asked. She knew she shouldn't have asked, but she was so nervous that she didn't know what to do.

"Glad you asked." Horde Prime replied. Then the 'individual' Hordak were brought in. "You see, he had began to remember his past and that he named himself." Horde clones escorted Hordak into the pool. "Now I have to wipe his mind clear, so he can join back to our brethren."

The hooded Horde Clones began to chant as the water seemed to turn electric. Hordak's screams of pain horrified Catra, while the chanting kept picking up pace. Then came a loud bang with a green flash and smoke, Prime seemed to be happy about the results. As the smoke cleared, Hordak's eyes were no longer green, but pure white.

"Come forward." Prime said and offered Hordak his hand. "Behold the purest among us." The crowd of hooded clones began to cheer and kneeled down before their purest.

Catra couldn't find any words to describe what she had just seen. The Prime turned to look at frightened Catra. "Do what I ask you to do."

Back at her cell, Glimmer was trying to break the forcefield that held heer in, but throwing chairs at it didn't work. A moment later, Catra came in with some cake. Glimmer had requested better food and Catra came to deliver it. Although she was watched by one Horde clone. Catra looked at the clone and said; "Can you give a little bit of privacy?!"

"Of course, little sister. Horde Prime sees all, Horde Prime knows all." The clone answered and backed away.

Now that they were just two of them, Catra cut into chase. "Ok so, eat this and we will talk. Not to cause any suspicion."

Glimmer nodded and took the box with cake inside. "What's with that guard?"

"Just do as I say." Catra said and sat Glimmer on the bed. "Horde Prime had noticed a ship coming from Etheria towards this place."

"Oh no.." Glimmer realized. "Adora must be on that ship."

"Of course she is, she's coming to save you." Catra answered. "So I hatched a plan, but I don't know if it will save both of us."

"What are you talking about?"

"It doesn't matter. Watch." Catra said and asked to be let out of the cell. When the cell closed Catra swiftly jumped at the back of the clone and smashed him on the floor. She then struck her claws into the clone's neck piece, making him black out.

She then dragged his body and used his hand to open the cell. "See, all worked as planned. Now come along!" Catra said and grabbed Glimmer's hand and they began to navigate through the halls.

"Okay, so what exactly is your plan?" Glimmer asked as Catra pulled her.

"There's a room where they send troops to Etheria, I observed the machine and I'm sure I can get you out of here." Catra answered.

But as they turned to the hallway that led to the said room, a bunch of Horde clones were standing in front of them.

Catra quickly dispatched all of them except one who was trying to get away. "Hit them at back of their necks, it should take them out."

Glimmer did as was told to and it was quite effective indeed, but then the alarms went on.

"Okay, we need to hurry!" Catra yelled and grabbed Glimmer from her hand.

They reached the teleportation room and Catra threw Glimmer on the platform. She then proceeded to shut the doors to hold the clones for a while. At this moment Glimmer realized what Catra meant when she said she couldn't get both of them out. "Catra.. what are you doing?"

"What does it look like?" Catra asked with a smug look on her face. "I'm saving you and Adora. I can't let Prime get her." Then the Horde clones began to breach in, but the doors still held.

Meanwhile at Darla, Entrapta had finally managed to fix the ship and everything was working as intended. " *There is a transmission being received, would you like to open the communication?* Darla said.

"Patch it through." Adora said and then she heard something she couldn't believe. " *Adora?* " Catra's voice called.

"Catra..."

" *Heh you sound surprised.. Anyways, I'm sending Glimmer to you. I don't know your exact location, but I can get your quadron. You have to be there to catch her!* "

"Wa-Wait.. What? What's going on? Glimmer is with you?" Adora asked, trying to make any sense of anything.

" *We don't have time, the clones breached the doors!* " Catra said and punched one of the clones. " *You need to be in these coordinates to catch Glimmer, don't come here- Argh! Horde Prime's ready for you!* "

"Catra.."

" *You goof! Listen to me, I don't think I'm going to make it.. So these will be my last words for you- Argh! Adora.. I love y-* " The transmission went silent, but Catra managed to send Glimmer away.

"No. No-no-no! Catra, come back!" Adora yelled desperately.

" *The communications have been closed.* "

"Entrapta, do whatever you can to get us to those coordinates." Bow said.

Entrapta exclaimed with excitement, steering a spaceship was so exciting. As their ship headed towards the coordinates Catra had given them. Bow and Adora put on their space suits and were ready to receive Glimmer.

" *We're almost at the coordinates.* " Entrapta said through the comms.

"We're ready." Adora answered. as the cargo bay door opened and the vast space opened before their eyes and it was breathtaking. Then they could see a green glow forming from a distance and Bow went towards it, with a cable attached to his suit so he could be pulled back into the ship.

As Glimmer had teleported there, she was surrounded by a forcefield and Bow quickly catched her. Adora then began to pull the cable to get both bow and Glimmer back inside of the cargo bay.

When Glimmer was safe and the cargo bay door shut, they could finally catch a breather. "Bow.. Adora.." Glimmer said with a dimm voice.

"It's okay.." Bow answered.

"What.. happened back there?" Adora questioned with a soft, but confused tone.

"Well.. I think Catra's plan worked.. though.. I'm not sure if it worked for her..." Glimmer answered.

Back at Prime's Capital ship, Catra was brought to Horde Prime who was most displeased. "The ship has changed its course and I take it that you had something to do with it."

"Oh, how very sharp of you!" Catra answered with a sarcastic tone.

"You should think of your actions more carefully.." Horde Prime said with a disappointed tone.

"Haven't you understood already, we Etherian's are so very emotional. it doesn't matter what will happen to me, all it matters is that you won't get Glimmer and you can't get Adora!" Catra said while gritting her teeth.

"Oh you are very wrong. There is no place that my light wouldn't reach." Horde Prime replied and placed his hand under Catra's chin. She replied to him by biting his hand with her teeth.

"Argh! You insolent child!" Prime yelled with anger and smacked Catra so hard that she lost her consciousness. "You will be of use to me, one way or another.."

Chapter End Notes

I hope I can get the next chapter out soon, but we'll see.

To Get Catra Back

Chapter Summary

In this chapter, Adora, Bow, Entrapa and Glimmer embark on a risky operation to get Catra back. Things won't go smoothly as Prime has done something to her, hopefully not anything irreversible.

Meanwhile Shadow Weaver stumbles deep in the Whispering Woods, trying to find some answers. However she comes by something she never expected, or maybe she should have expected.

Chapter Notes

I'm likely combining 2 episodes, since I'm cutting the Star Sisters and our friends little quest for fuel. They'll be mentioned however.

And we might get an surprise visit from a certain someone or somewhat..

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora, Bow, Glimmer and Entrapta were now heading towards Horde Prime's capital ship. They had successfully managed to refuel their ship from an old planet. However this planet was totally desolate, because of the actions of Prime.

They had also met a trio called Star Sisters, even if they were hesitant to help them first. They still managed to work something out and our friends even managed to convince the Star Sisters to stand against Prime.

Adora also had managed to unlock her powers as She-Ra, temporary that is. During their great distress when the cave was collapsing on them, Adora had managed to turn into She-Ra. Not quite sure how, but Adora had an hunch why that was.

She also remembered the words Shadow Weaver had told her some time ago, when she managed to banish Spell of Obtainment. Shadow Weaver had mentioned that the She-Ra who did it felt different, more ancient.

Also, Madam Razz had also told her that the sword she used to hold wasn't the reason why she could become She-Ra. It was because She-Ra was something much greater than a sword.

Completely lost in her thoughts, Adora could feel a tap on her shoulder. She snapped out of her thoughts and looked at Glimmer.

"Adora, are you alright?"

"Yeah, I was just thinking.." Adora replied.

"Ah.. okay. So did you think of a plan?" Glimmer said.

"Of course." Adora answered with a proud smile. "Horde Prime wants She-Ra and I can give him that."

"What do you mean? That sounds dangerous!" Bow exclaimed.

"Don't worry, I've got this." Adora replied. She then grabbed everyone and began to explain her plan on how to get Catra back.

Meanwhile back at Etheria, deep in the Whispering Woods. Shadow Weaver stumbles and bumbles through the forest, getting stuck on every possible branch.

It must have been hours by now, she had trekked through the woods but, without any books or maps she couldn't make a lot of progress. She had used to having conversations with the Spell of Obtainment and the knowledge she used to get from the said entity was truly remarkable.

Now? She didn't even have any clue where the First Ones ruins could be, it was like the forest had changed. It wasn't the same Whispering Woods she had used to live in. Everything was familiar, yet everything was off and unknown.

Was she really so out of touch? What had happened to her vast knowledge she used to have when she was Light Spinner and even greater knowledge when Spell of Obtainment had infused with her?

"Nothing makes sense anymore!" Shadow Weaver yelled at the night sky. She fell onto her knees and was ready to give up, but then something happened that she didn't expect.

A form of light shimmered in front of her, it seemed to try and communicate to her.

Shadow Wever quickly pulled herself up from the ground and followed the light through the woods.

"Hey, wait a moment!" She yelled as she was trying to keep up with the light, but it didn't answer.

She kept following the light and soon more and more spore-like lights formed around her, guiding her towards something. After a while of following the lights, she found herself surrounded by strange creatures.

At first she was startled, thinking it was a trap. But when she had a closer inspection at the creatures, she could see that something

was wrong with them.

She could now feel magic around her and it was being drained. Sure she couldn't use magic herself, but she could still feel it around her. She then touched one of the creatures and could feel the magic being drained from it.

" *But what could be causing this?* " She thought to herself. It had to have something to do with the First Ones and that's what she needed. She needed to head somewhere where she could research it. And the only possible place she knew where to find those old texts was none other than Mystacor.

Even the slightest idea of going to Mystacor disgusted her, she had nothing but bad memories of that place. But this wasn't the time to be stuck in the past, Etheria's fate was far more important and it was worth the cause.

What Shadow Weaver didn't know at the moment was that she was being watched. From the void beyond the universe, Spell of Obtainment was observing her. " *Seriously!? It took you that long to realize something was wrong!?* " Spell of Obtainment bursted in frustration. " *Its a miracle this old hag has survived for this long!* "

"Heh.. still stuck in the past?" Spell of Forbidden Knowledge taunted. "You know you should just forget her and look for a new host."

" *I know that! But for some reason I can't!* " Spell of Obtainment replied with a frustrated tone.

"Oh, I know. You have feelings for her." Other Entities said with a mischievous tone. "You cheeky bugger!"

"Yeah, weren't you all about conquering and domination? Weird to see you so attached to a mere mortal.." Spell of Forbidden Knowledge said. "Unless.. have you perhaps developed a soft spot for her?"

" *Why won't you guys just bugger off! I don't miss her! I'm not attached to her and I have not developed a soft spot for her!* " Spell of Obtainment yelled.

"Whatever you say.."

The other entities left, leaving only the Obtainment there, observing Shadow Weaver. Spell of Obtainment knew that the other entities were right. For some reason it just couldn't let her go. Still salty from the banishment and unfinished business back in Etheria, but what could it do?

Entities were bound by rules and they could be only summoned, if the right ritual was performed and the Spell summoned. With a frustrated groan, Spell of Obtainment stopped observing the woman and mumbled to themselves. " *I can't believe that I actually miss her.. what the hell did that woman do to me? And why would I ever want to go back to that place? Full of disgusting people talking all about friendship.. makes me sick! Yet.. I can't let go..* "

Meanwhile in space, the best friend squad was heading towards the Horde Prime capital ship.

Adora had moments ago informed Prime that she would give herself in and Prime bought it, though he had his suspicions.

As the ship got closer and closer, Adora told Bow and Entrapta to sneak in and search for Catra. While she would distract Prime. They also gave each other small earbuds so they could communicate with each other without others noticing.

"Are you sure you're going to be fine?" Bow asked with a hint of worry in his tone.

"I'll be fine." Adora assured them and opened the ship's landing bridge. "Just hide in some of the crates or containers and you two will be fine."

Two Horde clones were approaching Adora and they asked her to follow them, since Horde Prime is waiting for her. At the same time some other clones inspected the ships cargo bay and came to a conclusion that there was no one else.

The moment the clones had left, Bow and Entrpata snuck into the capital ship, heading for prison section as Glimmer had instructed them where to find it.

Adora soon arrived at the main bridge of the Horde Prime's ship. Their communications were cut off at some point so Adora couldn't know what others were up to.

"Ah, Adora.. She-Ra.. Welcome." Horde Prime greeted her with open arms, displaying a fake graditue. "Oh how long have I waited for this day."

"I could say the same thing..." Adora answered. "But you should know that you will fail, the sword is broken and I cant turn into She-Ra anymore."

"Oh that doesn't matter, I've had quite a lot of time to study your planet and I do have to admit, you First Ones were quite the clever bastards." Prime answered with a nonchalant tone. "Given enough time and I'll get access to Heart of Etheria, sooner or later. Oh and did you think you could fool me with your surrender?"

"What!? I'm here as you wanted." Adora stated.

"Oh, don't think I wouldn't notice your friends sneaking into my ship. Horde Prime sees all, Horde Prime knows all.." He said with a malevolent tone. "Oh I have something very special to show you." Then Horde Prime snapped his fingers and soon steps could be heard. "Hi Adora." A familiar voice said, with a monotone and emotionless tone.

"Catra?!" Adora said with a shocked voice and it soon turned into anger. "What have you done to her!?"

"Oh he hasn't done anything to me." Catra replied and placed her hand on Adora's cheek. "He just showed me what true peace and prosperity is. Say, little sister.. shouldn't you join us as well?"

Adora pushed Catra away and tried to back away, only to be blocked by multiple Horde clones.

"Please, it is futile to resist." Horde Prime said with a calm voice. Prime snapped his fingers again and Catra attacked against Adora, forcing her into combat.

Adora had a hard time fighting against her friend, she mostly tried to fight defensively and tried to deflect Catra's attacks. However, Catra is a dirty fighter and that makes things even harder.

Catra's kicks and clawing ripped through her clothes and skin. As much as Catra hurt her, Adora couldn't bring herself to hurt Catra.

"Please Catra! You have to resist! Show that you are stronger than Prime's control!" Adora tried to get to Catra, but all she got was her claws clutching to her face.

Adora fell on her knees as blood streamed across her face. Catra stopped her attacks and took a choke hold on Adora, placing her claws at Adora's throat and waiting on Prime's orders.

"Catra.. please! Come back!" Adora pleaded as she cried. "I don't know what I would do without you!"

"It is useless." Horde Prime said. "It would be wise to yield."

"Horde Prime, give me your order." Catra said while tightening her grip on Adora's throat.

Adora was filled with great distress and fear, but also her need to save Catra and everyone else from Prime's clutches grew stronger. She was determined to put an end to this all. "I will not let you get away from this!" She yelled.

As Prime was ready to give his signal to Catra, Adora yelled; "For the honor of Grayskull!" Then a bright flash filled the room and through there came She-Ra. A much older, stronger and a lot more mature.

Catra had to take steps back and Prime had to shield his eyes. "What devilry is this!?"

"I said, you will not get away with this." Adora's voice told with a deep voice. She swung her sword and sent a bright projectile slash towards Prime.

The slash threw Prime against his throne and the slash broke all his monitors.

Catra tried to attack She-Ra, but she grabbed her hand before Catra could strike. "I am sorry it has come to this, please don't think of me badly." Adora said and struck Catra's neck with the hilt of her sword.

Catra was knocked out and the chip that was used to control her was disabled. Adora picked Catra up and carried her on her shoulder.

As she was walking towards the exit, a group of Horde clones approached, blocking her way.

Adora didn't have time for this. "Move out of my way!" She said with a commanding tone. With a slash of her sword, she sent the clones flying off the bridge.

Nothing was stopping Adora now, she slashed her way through the hallways until she bumped into Bow and Entrapta.

"Bow, Entrapta! You're alright." She exclaimed.

"Yeah.. and we got a third companion.." Bow said as the Horde clone introduced himself.

"Umm.. I don't quite understand.."

"Don't worry, he has helped us through many doors." Entrapta said. "Can he come with us, please?"

"We'll explain later." Bow said.

"Right, we don't have much time." Adora replied.

When they reached the ship and headed off from Prime's capital ship, Adora placed Catra on the bed in the bedroom of the ship.

Entrapta had changed their course towards an asteroid field, so Prime would have a harder time to track them.

Meanwhile at Etheria, Scratch was cursing her situation. Tied up in the tent and alone felt worse than being dead. Why did they take her as a prisoner? Was it because of their morals? Or their pity? Whatever it was, it vexed her.

Scratch didn't pay a lot of attention, but what she happened to hear from time to time was that Horde Prime had come to

conquer Etheria and Adora had gone to space, to get that annoying, irritating and smug cat.

" *Why am I here.. just to suffer.. Why can't it just end?* "

Now that she was alone, without a purpose and Darkith being dead.. she had nothing. She had a lot of time to reflect and dwell on her thoughts. She even got memories when she, Scorpia and Entrapta were working together. What was the worst thing about that? The fact she might've had fun back then, until her own selfishness and bitterness took better of her.

She also recalled that she used to be friends with Adora when they were young, but Darkith made sure they couldn't spend time together and forced them to be rivals instead. That backfired hard..

She remembered how much pain she had caused, she abused Scorpia, sent Entrapta to death, made Adora's life hell and probably everyone's else too.

" *Oh why did it come to this!? Why can't it be over?* "

All Scratch could hope for is that Prime would be successful in his campaign, so she herself could be forgotten and probably die somewhere and no one would remember anything about her. Since her actions were unforgivable, it would be for the best.

"Why can't this just be over already!?" Scratch yelled.

However, it seemed that fate had other plans for her. Since Scorpia herself came to visit her. Scratch froze in place, not that she could move that much anyways. But she just didn't know what to do now. Usually she would just tell Scorpia to piss off and scoff at her feelings.

But now things were different, she didn't say anything. Even if she would have wanted to, Scratch couldn't bring herself to even utter a single word.

"Uhh, Scratch.. I know you don't want to talk." Scorpia began. "I don't think I should either as well, but something in me wants to talk to you."

"Uhh.. save your urge to talk.." Scratch managed to answer. "I'm going through things at the moment.. I don't know how to say this.. but.. I have hurt you a lot.. a-and I-I don't think I wanna do it now, so please.. leave me be."

"Is that.. an apology?" Scorpia asked with a gleam in her eyes and excited tone.

"I wouldn't go that far.. more like an acknowledgement." Scratch said with an uncertain tone. "Don't push your luck."

"Oh.. alright, I'll leave you to it then." Scorpia said and resisted her urge to hug Scratch. She was making progress. Scorpia exited the tent and Scratch was once again alone with her thoughts.

" *Alright Scratch.. slow and steady.. slow and steady.* "

Chapter End Notes

I think this chapter had lots of self-reflection, also sorry for speedrunning the Prime's ship part. I'm trying get this story finished and there's a lot I need to write.

Recovery

Chapter Summary

> Catra wakes up in Mara's ship, slowly recovering from what she has gone through.
>
> At Etheria, Shadow Weaver finds her way back to the rebellion camp. She finds out that the camp is pretty much empty.
>
> Prime has started his second phase in his conquer, he has begun to chip Etherian people.

Chapter Notes

> This is a shorter chapter, maybe even a bit rushed.. but I hope its passable.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Somewhere in space, in Mara's ship. Catra is still out of the game and Adora feels bad for what she did, but she had no other choice.

While Adora and others were thinking on how to get back to Etheria, Catra was in deep sleep. Her dreams were quite out of ordinary. Due to her connection to Prime's Hivemind, she could see glimpses of the past.

There was this weird planet that flashed in the memories and also glimpses of Prime's war against the First Ones. Then she saw Adora in the flashes, controlled by the Prime and unleashing the Heart of Etheria to destroy everything in the known universe.

Catra woke up screaming and covered in cold sweat. Her scream caught Adora's attention and she rushed in. "Catra! Are you

alright!?"

"A-Adora... " Catra looked at her with confused look on her face. "Whe-Where am I?"

"Relax, you're in Mara's ship.. or as Entrapta likes to call her, Darla." Adora replied, assuring Catra everything was fine. "I'm so glad you're back."

Catra then hugged Adora, but soon noticed the cuts in Adora's body and when looking closer at her face, she could see scratch marks there as well. Catra pulled herself away from Adora amd went to sit on the bed.

"Is something the matter?" Adora asked with a worried tone.

"Di-did.. I do those.." Catra uttered the words, looking away from Adora.

"Hey, it's nothing. You were under Prime's control, so-" But Adora was cut off by Catra. "But I hurt you, all I do is hurt people. One way or another!"

"Catra, it's okay." Adora tried to assure her. "I hurt you as well when I knocked you out."

"Adora, don't.. just let me be alone.." Catra said with a shaky voice.

"Oh, alright.. I'll leave, but remember that I'm right behind that door. Whenever you're ready." Adora said with a saddened voice and left Catra alone.

Now that she was alone, she bursted into tears and buried her head under the pillows. Why did she feel bad for something that was out of her control? Why did she push Adora away?

Why did she feel like her heart was ripping apart? Oh, right.. Maybe it was because she loved Adora and couldn't bear to see

her get hurt. Especially when she was the one who had done the hurting.

She was about to confess to Adora back when she was saving Glimmer, but now she couldn't bring herself to even look at Adora. All she could do now was to bury her head into the pillows and hope when she next time wakes up, her mind would be clearer and she wouldn't be dwelling on guilt.

Back at Etheria, Shadow Weaver finally found her way back to the rebel camp. Only it is empty. That was weird, where could they have all been gone?

Shadow Weaver searched around campgrounds, but did not find a single soul.

" *Where could they all be? Maybe I shouldn't have left, who knows what happened to them..* "

She then came across the tent where they kept Scratch, she entered in the tent and found Scratch, still tied up and sulking in the corner.

"Oh.. what are you doing here?" Scratch asked with a sarcastic tone as she noticed the woman standing at the exit. "Shouldn't you be somewhere else?"

"Well aren't you the lively one..." Shadow Weaver answered back. "You wouldn't happen to know where others are?"

"Hmph! No, I don't! Couldn't care less and if I did, I wouldn't tell you." Scratch said with a snarky voice.

"Yeah, I shouldn't had to expect much from likes of you." Shadow Weaver sighed. "It's hard to believe you got as far as you did, because with that kind of attitude.. you would get yourself killed."

"Heh, you can blame that on your bestie, Darkith." Scratch replied with a chuckle.

"If you think about it like that, then you're sorely mistaken. It was more like we had a common enemy." Shadow Weaver said.

"I got into so much shit because of you and her." Scratch scuffed.

"That's not my problem. If all you have to say for yourself is pointless bitching, then we are both wasting our time."

"I couldn't care less."

"Because you don't have anyone you care about! I DO! And I have no idea if I'll ever see her again." Shadow Weaver snapped and stormed off.

Now that Scratch was once again alone, she could reflect on Shadow Weaver's words. Didn't matter how much she denied her feelings, she somewhat felt something for Scorpia. She didn't know what it was and wished she could forget it, but couldn't.

So, Shadow Weaver was wrong. She actually cared for Scorpia, if that's what you would call it.

Shadow Weaver was fuming with rage, how could someone be so ignorant and infuriating at the same time. Did she not care about anything, not even her own life?

Well sure, Shadow Weaver herself sometimes pushed the limits of her body that would most likely lead to death. She had nearly killed herself many times during her carelessness and rage.

But still, those things she did.. was because she thought the life of the person she cared for was more important than her life.

There was no point dwelling on this, Scratch was a lost cause and she really had some more important and life threatening things she had to take care of.

Meanwhile in Mara's ship, Catra has finally woken up and her mind was a lot clearer than before. She could hear others chatting about something on the other side.

Catra left the bedroom and headed into the main room.

"Oh Catra! You're awake." Entrapta said as she noticed her. This immediately caught Adora's attention.

"Ah Catra, did you sleep well?" Adora asked.

"Yeah.. you could say I did.." Catra answered and rubbed the back of her head, just now noticing that her long hair was gone. "Anyways.. Adora, I'm sorry for the earlier.. my head was just going through alot."

"You have nothing to apologize for." Adora said with a relieved smile on her face.

Catra sighed with relief herself and hugged Adora.

"Anyways, is there a way to get back to Etheria?" Adroa turned her head and asked Entrapta.

"Well, it seems Prime has set a naval blockade around Etheria." Entrapta answered.

"Yeah, we could never get past them.. well without them seeing us." Bow said.

"Does Prime have any kind of weakness?" Glimmer asked.

"Nope, Horde Prime has no weakness." Wrong Hordak answered. "He's so great that there is no possibility for weakness to exist."

"You might be wrong." Catra said.

"What do you mean?" Adora asked.

"Well, I was connected to Prime's hivemind and while I was out, I saw glimpses of a planet." Catra explained. "I think there might be the answer we seek."

"Nope, there is no planet that could host a weakness to Prime." Wrong Hordak said firmly.

"I know what I saw, it is a planet." Catra stated.

"Craitus does not exist." Wrong Hordak answered.

"Craitus? Is that its name?" Adora confirmed. "Entrapta?"

"I'm on it!" She exclaimed and proceeded to search for the planet. "Uhh.. I found it, but I need administrator access."

"Darla, show us Craitus." Adora stated.

" *Confirmed, locating Craitus.* " Computer voice answered and showed them the coordinates of the said planet.

"Horde Prime is definitely hiding something and doesn't want that planet to be found." Catra said.

"Horde Prime destroyed the planet, so it can't exist." Wrong Hordak tried to convince himself and others that there was no weakness.

"Darla, set the course towards Craitus." Adora stated firmly.

Back at the rebellion hideout, Shadow Weaver was still fuming over her conversation with Scratch. But fortunately for her, the princesses were back or at least some of them. "What happened? Where's the rest of you?" She inquired.

"Stayed behind." Mermista answered. "Horde Prime has begun to somehow mind-control people here at Etheria."

"What about Micah?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"He stayed behind, to give us a chance to escape." Perfuma said with sadness in her tone.

"Of course.. that's what he would do." Shadow Weaver sighed.

"Do you know anything about Adora? Is she coming back?" Frosta said.

"Wish I knew, but I'm afraid at I know as much as you do." Shadow Weaver replied. "But we have more urgent matters to attend to, it's about Etheria's H- " Shadow Weaver was quickly cut off by Mermista pushing her out of her way. "Listen, we are not going to use the Heart, it would be a catastrophe. Besides, Adora and Glimmer aren't even here!"

"It's not about using the-" Shadow Weaver tried to explain, but was once again cut off by Frosta. "Do you care about anything other than power? What about Adora or Glimmer?!"

"I do care! And that is why you have to listen to me. Etheria has been chained by the First Ones and if we don't do anything about it.. soon we don't have a planet anymore!" Shadow Weaver explained with a deep voice.

"You just made that up, so you could get more power!" Mermista said. "Come on, I think I have an idea how we could get in contact with Adora."

Rest of the princesses left Shadow Weaver there standing alone, they clearly had other plans. Only Scorpia seemed to be hesitant, but she still followed them.

" *The disrespect..* " Shadow Weaver thought. "Fine.. I can manage this myself.." She was determined to save Etheria, even if she had to do it alone.. even if it was the last thing she would ever achieve.

Chapter End Notes

> Bruh it has taken me forever to write a chapter this short.. the closer we get to the final, the harder its to write.
>
> I am still uncertain how I'm going to finish this story, or how the hell Im going to conclude Scratch's arc and story..

Its like Spain, but without the letter S

Horde Prime's Weakness

Chapter Summary

> At Craitus, Adora, Bow, Catra and Glimmer are trying to figure out Prime's weakness. With Entrapta's and Wrong Hordak's "voluntary" help, they'll surely discover it.
>
> Meanwhile in Etheria, rest of the princesses are heading to meet an mysterious prince called Peek A Blue. Since it is rumoured that he can foresee things.
>
> Shadow Weaver is once again without any help, of is she?

Chapter Notes

> Wow.. can you believe this? I mamaged to get a new chapter out..

See the end of the chapter for more notes

At the rebellion hideout, the princesses had decided to go look for Peek A Blue. Said prince was rumoured to have a sight that could see into future and far into galaxy. As the princesses were making their departing, Scorpia was in Scratch's tent, saying good byes.

"So, you're going far into oceans to look for this prince?" Scratch said, processing Scorpia's explanition. "You know that the whole thing might just be a hoax. I've never heard of him."

"I know its a bit far fetched, but what other choise we do have?" Scorpia said. "We need to know if Adora is even alive. Without her, all of us are as good as dead."

"I don't need to hear that, Shadow Weaver already ranted me about that.." Scratch mumbled.

"Oh... okay.. I get it." Scorpia said with a montone voice.

"It's just.. Scorpia.. ugh I don't know how to say this.." Scratch had hard time to find the right words. "Just, don't do anything stupid alright? *Please come back safely..*"

"What were those last words? I didn't quite hear them." Scorpia answered with an hopeful tone.

"Ugh, just remember to come back! Don't do something stupid!"

"You got it." Scorpia answered with an happy tone. Scratch on rolled her eyes back, Scorpia was way too kind to be in the Horde.

As the rebel camp went silent, Shadow Weaver was left there alone. Technically she wasn't alone, but she wouldn't waste her time on Scratch.

She sat on a rock and spun the broken staff in boredom, as the time passed she had began to accept the inevitable. "*Etheria's fate has been sealed, is there anything we can do?* "

"There's nothing we can do.." Shadow Weaver sighed as an answer to herself.

But then happened something Shadow Weaver couldn't have expected, Castaspella appeared through the bushes and she was pulling her dress that was caught on a branch. "Agh! These stupid branches, stupid dress.. always getting stuck on everything!"

Shadow Weaver was amused, chuckling quietly as she watched Castaspella struggle. She didn't know for sure, but something about Castaspella's clumsiness always managed to get better of her.

Castaspella had finally managed to get free from the bush and was now wiping her dress to get rest of the branches and leaves off.

"Next time, maybe you shouldn't stray from the path. Knowing how clumsy you are." Shadow Weaver greeted Castaspella with an smirk on her face.

"Shadow Weaver?" Castaspella replied with an surprised tone. "Its been years and thats how you greet me?"

"You're just so amusing sometimes, I can't help it." Shadow Weaver replied.

"I came all the way here from Mystacor.. aand... where is everyone?"

"Rest of the Princesses have gone off to an adventure somewhere.. not that I care." Shadow Weaver said and shrugged her head. "They don't have any idea on what to do, but I have. However, I can't do it alone."

"What are you planning?" Castaspella asked.

"Releasing the magic inside of the Heart of Etheria."

"What!? Isn't that dangerous!?" Castaspella said with a hint of panic in her voice.

"I know how it sounds, but you have to trust me. I'll show you the proof." Shadow Weaver assured Castaspella.

"What are you on about? I don't understand." Castaspella said.

"I'll explain it to you, but right now's not the time."

"You've changed since the last time we met and I'm not sure wether to better or worse."

"I don't really care about what others think of me. All I wan't to do is to save Etheria and Micah.. and I'd hope to see Catra again.." Shadow Weaver said with finishing her last sentence with a mellow and somewhat desperate tone.

"Alright.." Castaspella sighed. "But promise me this wont get us killed."

Meanwhile in the distant system, Adora and her friends had arrived on Craitus. It was a desolate place, rocky cliffs all around and hundreds of ruins littered across the plains from both the First Ones and Horde.

All of them had space suits on, so they could walk and breath safely on this desolate, but somewhat hostile looking planet.

As they walked through the ruined planet, they could see dozens of communitaction spires that Prime had installed on Etheria as well.

"You know what, I don't like this planet very much.." Bow said with a shaky tone.

"Its not that bad." Catra replied. "Besides, this place has probably been abandoned for thousands of years. Right, Entrapta?"

"You're not wrong Catra. According to my data.. this planet hasn't been in a habitable state at in for 4000 years.." Entrapta answered.

"Whoa.. so the conflict between the First Ones and Horde has spanned over 4000 years? Maybe even longer.." Catra said.

"Do you think First Ones even exsist anymore?" Glimmer asked.

"Thats something I can't answer, it would be speculating at that point." Entrapta replied.

They continued their trekking on the desolated planet, until they came across a wrecked Horde ship. It had crashed into ravine and only half of it was visible.

"Well would you look at that.." Catra said with an awe. "It looks so grand, even if its half buried in the ground."

"It kinda reminds me of Fright Zone.." Adora said.

"Well, to be exact. Fright Zone is build around a crashed Horde ship." Entrapta replied. "I think we should go to investigate that ship."

"You want us to go into a wrecked Horde ship? That could be very dangerous." Bow said with a warning tone.

"What's the worst that could happen, besides we have She-Ra." Glimmer said.

"Haha, yeah, but it only works when I'm under stress... or when in great need. I can't just call up to She-Ra anymore." Adora answered with a nervous laugh.

"Don't sweat about it." Catra assured her. "I'm quite capable, so if there is anything trying to get us.. I'll take care of it." Catra gave that smug smirk of hers and a wink. It made Adora feel less stressed about. Though Catra still was a enigma to her in some aspects.

"Now would you look at that." Entrapta exclaimed. "Its an link station."

"And what exactly does that mean?" Catra asked.

"I can plug Wrong Hordak into it and it will give us more information and perhaps even reveal some secrets." Entrapta explained.

"Don't you try to plug me into anything!" Wrong Hordak tried to resist, but Entrapta plugged him anyways and now they could see the layout of the ship and Wrong Hordak could see Horde Prime's humiliatining loss through the data. This began an exsistential crisis in him.

"Now we can navigate through the ship." Entrapta replied.

"Uhh.. how does that make any sense?" Catra asked.

"Science!" Entrapta claimed.

"That still doesn't explain anything!" Catra argued.

"Come on Catra, let he do her thing. We ain't cut for that kind of stuff." Adora assured Catra. "Come on, lets go."

After a whole lot of bumping and crahsing inside the Horde ship, because for some reason the layout of the ship changed almost at every turn and Entrapta's cryptic advices didn't help at all. Neither did Wrong Hordak's exsistential crisis about Horde Prime.

"Wait.. there wasn't a wall before." Bow exclaimed.

"Tell us something new.." Catra murmured.

"*Well, there's 4th person behind you.*" Entrapta's voice said. "*And before you question me, remember that data never lies.*"

"Wait what?!" Glimmer said and turned to look behind them. There stood a shadowy figure and it disappeared as soon as it had appeared.

"Yup, I wan't to get out of here." Catra said.

And before they could react, the walls were closing on them and thorned vines began to surround them.

"We're so going to die!" Bow screamed.

"No.. this is different.." Glimmer said calmly. "These are just illusions."

"What!? They are?" Catra questioned.

"Simple illusion magic, that I can easily counter." Glimmer said and with few swift spell cast, the hallway walls turned back to normal and thw thorned vines vanished. "I think I figured Prime's weakness.."

"Really, tell us." Adora said.

"It's magic, simple as that."

"Bruh.." Catra sais with a dull face and she was kind of disappointed that it was something so obvious. "You know what, that's kinda lame.."

"What? Shouldn't you be happy we have a solution now." Glimmer said.

"Well duh, Etheria is literally magic storage.. thanks to First Ones." Catra said.

"Okay, save the bickering for later. We have a world to save." Adora said.

And when they were about to leave, Catra stepped on a ventilation shaft and fell into darkness.

"Oh come on!" Glimmer exclaimed.

Chapter End Notes

Also, if there's typos and such.. don't worry Im going to fix them later on.

Do You Trust Me?

Chapter Summary

> Shadow Weaver is trying to convince Castaspella to release the magic in the Heart of Etheria. And in the process.. they may develop something more than just sharing of the common goal.

Chapter Notes

> Wow.. it took me sixty frikking one chapters, over 170k words and 2 years at least to get into the SWxCasta... damm..

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Castaspella and Shadow Weaver were trekking through the Whispering Woods. For Shadow Weaver it was effortless, after all she has lived there for so long. However, it was a different story for the Head Sorceress.

She got her cape stuck in every branch possible, lost her balance several times when miss stepping and overall she was just a terrible hiker.

"Come on now.. princess. We have a long way ahead of us." Shadow Weaver said.

"We've been walking for hours now! We got to be close!" Castaspella then tripped on an exposed tree root and fell into a bush.

"We've been walking for hours because you trip on everything and get stuck everywhere." Shadow Weaver remarked with a snarky tone

"Ugh, you are so mean!" Castaspella yelled from the bush. "Show some courtesy and help me up."

Shadow Weaver rolled her eyes and let out an annoyed sigh. "Fine.. princess." She said and offered Castaspella her hand.

"And don't call me princess!"

As Shadow Weaver was about to pull Castaspella up, she let go of her hand and once again Castaspella was in the bush. "Sorry, my hand slipped." Shadow Weaver apologized with a sarcastic tone.

"You did that on purpose!"

"Did I?" Shadow Weaver replied with a nonchalant tone. She then gave Castaspella her hand and pulled her up. "There we go, princess." With a smirk on her face, she turned away and continued onwards.

Castaspella was fuming with annoyance. "I can't believe that after all these years, you've turned into such a bitter bi-" But she cut herself off before finishing her sentence. "Uh.. sorry.. I didn't mean to say that.."

Shadow Weaver replied with an amused chuckle. I didn't expect you to know such a language."

"It's not that I usually curse.. you are somehow just so annoying.. for no reason."

"What would you think if I told you that I like you more when you're angry." Shadow Weaver replied.

Castaspella was stunned, why would anyone like someone when they were angry? I don't understand?"

"I don't either." She replied and shrugged her shoulders. "Come on, we're getting close."

"My legs are killing me! I have bruises, my cape and dress is in shreds and then there's Horde Prime chipping Etherians!" Castaspella lamented and fell on her knees.

Shadow Weaver once again sighed in deep and thought how could someone so childish and petulant be a head sorceress, but at the same time she somewhat understood her. At times like this, the worst of the people come out. "Here, climb on." She said and kneeled in front of Castaspella. "I'll carry you there."

"What? Are you serious?!"

"I am, now hurry before I change my mind." Shadow Weaver said.

Castaspella placed her hands around Shadow Weaver's shoulders and she in return placed her hand under Castaspella's thighs. Both of them felt awkward, but didn't say anything.

Despite her slender figure and scarred body, Shadow Weaver was quite strong. Which surprised Castaseplla.

Sure their pace slowed a bit, but at least they moved onwards consistently. Castaspella could hear Shadow Weaver's breathing get heavier and her body was shaking by each step she took as she carried Castaspella uphill. "Am I too heavy?" She asked with a shy tone.

"Do you really want an answer for that?" Shadow Weaver replied with a smirk on her face and side-eyed at her

"I just thought, if this is too much for you.. I don't wanna be a burden.."

"Nonsense! You are not a burden and I'm not tired!" Shadow Weaver said with determination. That in fact was a lie, carrying Castaspella was tiring her, but she was too prideful and stubborn to admit it.

As they continued their way, Shadow Weaver could feel Castaspella's breath in her ears. It sent shivers, but not particularly bad ones. Just that her ears were highly sensitive and somehow it made her feel something she had thought to forgot a long time ago.

It didn't help that Castaspella was asleep, her hair smelled particularly good. Her black lipstick basically touched her neck and all the perfumes filled Shadow Weaver's nose. " *First Ones damn it, why did her have to be so beautiful!? I have no time to think on things like this!* "

After a long while, they were there. Shadow Weaver told Castaspella to wake up. "We're here."

Castaspella opened her eyes and looked around her. It truly was something she hadn't expected to see. There were light magical particles flowing in the air like fireflies, then she saw tens if not hundreds of different animals in an exhausted state. Like something was draining the life out of them.

"Shadow Weaver.. what is this place?"

"It's not just this place.. it's all around Etheria. I'm ashamed to admit that it took me this long to realize what really was going on." She replied. "The First Ones didn't enhance this planet.. they suppressed its magic for their own use.. they were foolish to store all that magic in one single place."

"And this place is the Heart? Right?"

"That is correct." Shadow Weaver replied.

"But if First Ones were restricting magic, how does releasing it help defeat Horde Prime?" Castaspella asked.

"It will make us more powerful than him, by releasing magic.. everyone gets a tremendous boost for their powers." Shadow Weaver said.

"What about you? Is this some great plan for you to get ultimate power?"

"No.. all I want is to save Etheria and Micah. I owe him that.. and probably a lot more.. in fact, I can't even use magic as of now.. it was the cost I paid to not die from the entity." Shadow Weaver explained.

Castaspella had fallen off the tracks by now and was really confused.

"What I mean is, this is not for me to gain some ultimate power. This is to save Etheria and in the process.. I might be able to correct some of my mistakes." As stupid as it sounds to herself, it was the truth. "So, help me undo First Ones strains on this planet.. and stop me if you think I'm going too far."

Castaspella had to think for a moment, last time that the Heart of Etheria was used it almost led to a total destruction of Etheria, but what reason did she have to lie?

"Castaspella, do you trust me?" Shadow Weaver said and looked her in the eyes. Offering her hand to her.

There was sincerity in Shadow Weaver's eyes.. The last time she had seen her was during the Princess Prom. Castaspella knew inside of her that she could trust her, but for some reason she hesitated. Shadow Weaver was unpredictable, but if she would have wanted the power.. she probably would have already done it.

"Head Sorceress Castaspella.." Shadow Weaver called.

"Alright, I trust you." She said firmly and shook her hand. "However, you have to promise me that this won't kill us."

"You'll have my word." Shadow Weaver replied with a serious tone. However.. inside she felt unsure.. surviving this wasn't guaranteed.

"So, how are we going to undo the restraints?" Castaspella asked.

"I don't know, if only I had my research I conducted back in my time in Mystacor."

"Well, then it's a good thing I made sure of it that your research wasn't destroyed." Castaspella said with a smile and feeling of pride.

"I'm surprised they even allowed you to do that." Shadow Weaver said. "Quite impressive, princess."

"Oh for the last time, don't call me a princess!" Castaspella pouted.

"Oh, you are just so cute- I mean.. amusing that is. Teasing you is just so fun." Shadow Weaver replied with a suggestive tone and a smirk on her face.

"What did you just say?"

"Let's move along.. Head Sorceress."

Chapter End Notes

A shorter one again.. I think..

There's 4 more chapters left, and one of them is epilogue. Next three chapters are going to be long and might take a while, who knows. But be prepared for long chapters.

Scratch's fate

Chapter Summary

After what seemed to be eternity, Adora and others finally return to Etheria. And oh boy have things changed around there.

This chapter includes Shadow Weaver's and Castaspella's investigations and also Scratch's fate.

Chapter Notes

This chapter is a long one

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Darla came swiftly crashing into Whispering Woods. They had managed to get past the Horde blockade with the help of Melog. A shapeshifting being, who happened to have a form resemblance to a cat.

Catra had met Melog at the crashed Horde ship and it seemed that Melog responded to her feelings. If Catra was angry or frustrated, Melog turned into a much larger and aggressive person. If Catra was in a neutral or happy mood, Melog remained more of the same.

"We're back in Etheria, Woohooo!" Glimmer exclaimed.

"Thanks to Melog." Adora said.

"Shadow Weaver.. she must be pissed about what I did.." Catra said with a monotone voice.

"I don't think she's pissed.. in fact she seemed to be rather worried about you." Adora comforted her. "You know.. she was weird enough to comfort me.. which I wasn't expecting."

"What? Shadow Weaver comforting someone?" Glimmer asked with a faked surprised tone.

"You don't know anything about this matter!" Catra snapped.

"I was trying to joke.."

"Well that's in bad taste." Adora affirmed. "Anyways, we need to head to the camp."

"Well good thing we didn't land too far away." Entrapta replied.

"Great, then let's go." Adora said.

They trekked through the forest, until they arrived at the camp. However, it was completely empty. There was no one there.

"Hello!? Is anyone here?" Adora asked.

"Umm.. do you think Prime has got the others already?" Bow asked with a shaky tone.

"No, I don't think so.." Catra replied. "We would probably be ambushed by now."

They looked for a while, but didn't find a single person. That is until they came into the tent where Scratch was being held captive.

"Ah, great.. if it isn't the princess Adora.. Squeaky Sparkles.. and the Bitch.." Scratch said with a snarky and condescending tone. "If you're looking for the other princesses.. they aren't here."

"Where are they then? And don't think of doing anything funny!" Glimmer asked with a threatening voice. All of them were quite angered how Scratch had called them.

Scratch rolled her eyes and lifted her chained hands in the air. "What do you think I could even do?" She questioned with a sarcastic tone.

"I suppose nothing.." Adora sighed and tried to be the mature one. "Now, tell us.. where the others went?"

With an annoyed groan, Scratch replied. "They went to look for someone called Peek-a-Blue.. really sketchy if you ask me."

"And we didn't!" Glimmer added, but Adora pulled her away. "Not now Glimmer.."

"What about Shadow Weaver? Do you know anything about her?" Catra asked.

"Oh? Missing mom already?" Scratch said with a mocking tone. "Seriously, all you do is cry after her. It's pathetic."

Catra knew she did have a short and fiery temper, for all this time she tried to control it, but couldn't keep it in anymore. She rushed towards Scratch, grabbed her by the throat and began to strangle her. "Say one more word and you're dead!"

"Catra, Catra! Stop it!" Adora yelled and pulled her away from Scratch, She dragged Catra outside of the tent and tried to calm her down. "Please, it's not worth it. She's just trying to get under your skin."

"And she's pretty fucking good at it!" Catra yelled and Melog responding to her feelings turned into a larger, more threatening form.

"Please, just calm down." Adora pleaded. "Take Melog and go for a walk.. something else than strangling her."

After a while, Catra let out a deep sigh and came to regret her sudden rage. "I know you're right.. I'll just go cool off for a while."

"Yeah, you do that." Adora said and sighed in relief.

Meanwhile, in the tent Scratch was catching up with her breath and stroking her throat. "Damn.. didn't expect her to get so mad."

"You seriously should know better, we've known each other for a long time.. why do you have to be like this?" Adora asked, knowing very well that she wouldn't get any real answer.

"You're seriously asking it now?" Scratch replied. "Allow me to laugh at your stupid question, Ha Ha Haa!"

"Is this really all you're capable of? Cheap insults?" Glimmer questioned. "I wish I could have been the one to strangle you."

"Be my guest." Scratch said with a smirk on her face.

"Glimmer, not helping!" Adora said. "This leads to nothing.."

They then left the tent and Scratch was once again by herself, she really knew how to make enemies.

"Entrapta, anything new?" Adora asked.

"Nope, not even a single move by the Horde, not any signs of the other princesses." She replied, while going through her pads.

"Argh, we finally get back here and then there's no one here!" Adora yelled frustrated and kicked a rock.

Elsewhere, Catra was blowing off her stems and trying to calm down. Many thoughts raced through her mind, about her poor behavior, wondering where Shadow Weaver would have gone, Adora and her difficulties to turn into She-Ra.. and so many more.

As she wandered around the outskirts of the camp, she came across a rock and next to it layed her broken staff. It broke when she got caught by Horde Prime and it was obvious that Shadow Weaver had kept the staff around.

She inspected the piece of the gem that was from Shadow Weaver's mask and it was shattered. Goodbye artificial magic.. Now it's just like any other staff.

Catra suddenly got mad at herself, because many of her actions were the cause of this. Almost in a fit of rage she was about to break the staff, her attention was caught by several footsteps.

From the midst of the forest ran Perfuma, Frosta and Netossa. They noticed Catra and asked if the others had got back.

Catra nodded in response and soon she was pulled by them back to the camp.

At the camp, Entrapta looked at one of her pads and saw four dots coming their way. "Hey, we got company." She exclaimed.

Adora, Bow and Glimmer readied themselves for a threat, but it was the other princesses and they seemed to be filled with terror and exhaustion.

"Hey, what happened?" Adora asked with a worried tone.

"Horde Prime's got them!" Frosta yelled.

"Scorpia, Spinnerella and Mermista all are chipped." Netossa said.

"Wha- how? What happened?" Glimmer asked.

"Well.. our mission was to meet this mysterious prince.. who just happened to be Double Trouble in disguise." Netossa explained. "Scorpia stayed behind.. she's for sure chipped."

Scratch could hear the other princesses talk about what had happened. At first she didn't pay any mind to it, but when Scorpia was mentioned she had no other choice, but care.

" *That fool! I told her.. I-I told her..* " Scratch thought to herself. She couldn't hold it anymore, this was the first time she shed a single tear.

The princesses talked about lots of things, how things had changed around Etheria and Catra shared the information on how to un-chip others.

This caught Scratch's attention and now she actually hoped someone would come to talk to her.

"So, you need to strike at the chip in the neck? Is that really all?" Netossa questioned.

"Yes, it is as simple as that.. however.. if they stay chipped too long.. it might not be enough." Entrapta added. "We would need to cause a disruption and that would only work if you hacked his system."

"How could we even hack it?" Perfuma asked.

"Simple, we would just need to connect into one of Horde Prime's spirals and upload the virus there.. so the chips would lose their connection."

"Right.. and how will we ever succeed in that?" Netossa asked.

"Meh, I don't know. I thought you would come up with an idea." Entrapta replied.

"But we can un chip individual persons.. correct?" Netossa asked.

"Yes.. it seemed to have worked for me at least.." Catra said.

"Then we should come up with a plan on how to get them back." Adora said, with determination.

"Well then, we should commence the emergency meeting." Glimmer suggested.

"Right." Netossa replied.

After that they gathered in the main area of the hideout and laid out the map of Etheria.

Netossa pointed at a nearby town in the map and said Spinnerella had been sighted there. "As her wife, I should be the one to get her back. But I could use it for help."

"I'll help you gladly." Glimmer said.

"Me too." Frosta volunteered as well.

"And I guess me too." Bow said and looked at Glimmer. "Can't let you do anything reckless."

"Of pfft, when have I ever done anything reckless." Glimmer replied with a dismissive and nonchalant tone, earning a serious eyeful from everyone in the room. "Yeaaah.. I guess I'm quite reckless.." She admitted.

"Anyways.. any idea where Scorpia might be?" Netossa asked.

"It's just a hunch.. but I think she could be heading to Fright Zone.." Adora suggested. "After all.. that place was probably a closest place she could call home."

While their emergency meeting was commencing, Scratch had managed to get herself free from the chains that held her in the tent, though her handcuffs were still in place. She was eavesdropping and when she heard they mentioned Scorpia going back to the Fright Zone, she couldn't resist anymore and barged into the room.

"If someone needs to go to the Fright Zone, then send me." She said as she entered.

Everyone was looking at her with shock, how had she managed to get herself free and why did she come here instead of running away?

"What?" Scratch scoffed. "You know what, you all have just amazing expressions on your face right now."

Without a moment, Catra pinned Scratch against the wall and pointed her staff at her throat.

"Chill, I can assure you all that I'm not trying to cause anything." Scratch said with a hint of frightness in her voice.

"And why should any of us believe you?!" Catra scowled at her. "One wrong move or word and you'll be spilling like a fountain."

"Catra!" Adora yelled and rushed to calm Catra. She pulled her away from Scratch. "I understand your feelings, but now's not the time."

"Uhh.. fine.." Catra sighed and stepped aside.

"So, Scratch." Adora said and turned to look at her. "Explain yourself."

"Ugh!" Scratrch rolled her eyes and let out an annoyed sigh. "Alright.. I'll tell you. It's my fault that Scorpia left Fright Zone and it's my fault for being a bad fri- boss for her. Sure she got on my nerves and screwed up the simplest of things, but I still shouldn't have hurt her.."

"Wow... so you're feeling bad about your co-worker, but not about the thousands of innocent lives you've taken or the fact that my mother is gone because of you!" Glimmer said with a condemning tone.

"Your guilt tripping doesn't work on me, because I have lost the ability to care about things a long time ago." Scratch replied.

"Yet you care about Scorpia, who you've been abusing for a long time." Glimmer said.

"That is a different thing! I only want to do this because its my fault Scorpia is in this situation."

"Forget it Glimmer, you can't change your mind like her." Catra replied.

"I know there's no way I can undo things, but I can at least try to get my co-worker back." Cratch said. "And if anyone knows the Fright Zone the best."

"I guess you're right." Adora sighed. "So if you go there, who else would go with you?"

"I'll go." Catra said.

"Do you think it's a good idea? Considering your feelings?" Adora questioned.

"I know how to un-chip people and I'll make sure she won't try to do anything stupid." Catra assured.

"Yeah, because you're probably going to do something stupid then." Scratch replied sarcastically.

"Catra, can I trust you to not kill her?" Adora asked with a serious tone and looked at her.

"I'll give you my word and I intend to keep my word." Catra said, raising her arm.

With a deep sigh, Adora agrees to Catra's suggestion.

"Are you sure you two can handle it?" Glimmer asked.

"Don't worry, we'll make it work." Catra assured.

Scratch only gave a half heartedly nod and roll of her eyes.

Meanwhile, somewhere far away from all in the Whispering Woods Shadow Weaver and Castaspella had made a makeshift hideout. They had managed to sneak into Mystacor and take Shadow Weaver's studies.

They were almost about to be caught, but Castaspella's illusions came in a clutch.

"You know, you could thank me for saving our asses back there." Castaspella said as she finished their hideout.

"Well, a broken clock is right twice a day." Shadow Weaver replied, smirking.

"Was that you trying to insult me or compliment me?"

"Maybe both?" Shadow Weaver said with a nonchalant tone. "Now, how about we focus on studying stuff.

"I guess you would be right." Castaspella said and sat next to Shadow Weaver. "So, what are we exactly looking for from your studies?"

"Anything that might have something to do with the First Ones or about the Heart of Etheria." She replied.

Castaspella nodded and opened one of Shadow Weaver's books, noticing it was almost all about the Heart of Etheria and possible ways to use it. She was quite surprised, after all she rarely even read any of her more absurd studies. "It seems Spell of Obtainment wasn't the only thing you studied."

"Well... Spell of Obtainment was a mistake on my part.. that much I'll admit. I shouldn't have even considered it but here we are. I studied Etheria a lot and in many different ways. Even after I went into exile, I still continued my research.. however it seems my house is gone alongside all of my other studies."

"Yeah, I can see.. lots of ancient ruins in these books.." Castaspella said as she went through the book.

"Ruins?" Shadow Weaver reaffirmed. "Of course, why hadn't I figured it out sooner."

"Figured out what exactly?"

"The First Ones ruins, Mystacor was built on top of one!" Shadow Weaver said. "Cas.. look anything pre-Mystacor."

"I.. alright then."

After a long while of studying, headache and reading through books and documents.. they finally had some leads.

"So.. what we now know is.. Mystacor is built on top of First Ones ruins, there is a failsafe mechanic.. designed by a bunch of rebellious First Ones.." Shadow Weaver went through their conclusion.

"Then all we have to figure out is how to activate this failsafe.. but there isn't a lot about it." Castaspella said. "Still, I must ask.. where did you get your hands on all of this stuff?"

"My hunger for knowledge.." Shadow Weaver replied. "All in all, we have a lead on the failsafe.. but all the things I went through.. I have come to a quite disturbing conclusion."

"And what is it?"

"The texts seem to suggest that no mortal can activate it, without dying.." Shadow Weaver said with a dead look on her eyes. "These First Ones seemed to be quite suicidal about their failsafe.."

"So all of this is for nothing!? We spent hours studying and the conclusion is that we can't do anything about it!?"

"There is only one strong enough to withstand the power.. and that is She-Ra.." Shadow Weaver said.

"But Adora can't control her She-Ra anymore.. or.. thats what I have heard." Castaspella said.

"Not entirely, she can turn into She-Ra.. but the conditions seem to differ a lot from situation to situation." Shadow Weaver said and placed the book on the side. "I think She-Ra is not just the sword, but an entity like spirit.."

"Okay.. now you have lost me, She-Ra an entity?"

"I've seen it, when we were on Beast Island and that She-Ra I encountered there was not the same we've been used to.. if I had to throw a wild guess, I'd say that the First Ones tried to weaponize She-Ra or control it.. like they did with Etheria." Shadow Weaver explained, trying to be as clear as possible.

Castaspella nodded in agreement, she understood what Shadow Weaver meant.. but it was still something so out of left field that it

puzzled her deeply. "I think I got it.. seriously, you are amazingly perceptive and smart."

Shadow Weaver looked away and curled her hair with her finger and her ears pointed downwards. She wasn't good with compliments, since she herself almost never complimented anyone. "Sheesh.. it's just that I've spent too much of my lifes in these studies.. nothing that amazing about it.."

"Aww.. no need to be so humble.." Castaspella saif with a soft tone and got closer to Shadow Weaver. She placed her hand around her shoulders and leaned in.

"I think this is not the best time for fooling around.." Shadow Weaver said. "We have much more pressing matters on our hands.."

"Don't worry, we'll come up with something." Castaspella assured. "Besides.. your so tense and seem to be tired.. maybe we should rest a bit?"

Shadow Weaver side-eyed at Castaspella who was leaning on her, why was she so damn cute looking.. or was she too beautiful? Shadow Weaver didn't understand much about these kinds of things, but this might be the last time she would ever feel a person so close to her. So, with a sigh and nodding of her head. "Fine.. but only for a while."

"Yes, I was afraid that you would refuse." Castaspella said with a joyful expression on her face.

With that being said, both of them laid on the soft makeshift mattress they had made from bushes and leaves. They laid there tightly next to each other and felt the warmth from each other.

Castaspella was a fast sleeper and almost immediately fell asleep, snuggling tightly next to Shadow Weaver.

" *I can't believe she already fell asleep.. she must be so tired..* " Shadow Weaver thought to herself and embraced Castaspella, this

feeling of warmness was new to her. It made her feel good and comfortable, but she herself couldn't sleep since the dreadful thought of the failsafe kept her awake and worried about what would happen.

Scratch and Catra had arrived near the Fright Zone and their uneasy alliance was already beginning to tear apart.

"I honestly doesn't understand why you of all people decided to accompany me." Scratch complained. "We hate each other, so why?"

"I don't know.. it's just a hunch." Catra replied with an annoyed tone. "I'm also probably the only one in the group who's least lenient of others."

"For the last time, this is not my plan to escape.. it's for me to fix something.. if that is still possible." Scratch said.

"Am I sensing a hint of regret in your tone?" Catra asked slyly and poked at Scratch.

"No! Just shut up!" Scratch yelled, but then Catra placed her hand on her mouth and pulled her behind a container. "Shh.. Scorpia is there."

"Oh.. well.. Any plans genius?!" Scratch asked with a sarcastic and condescending tone.

"Can't you seriously think of anything else than insults?" Catra snapped.

"Shhh, you dumb bitch! Scorpia will hear us." Scratch yelled, not realizing that Scorpia just happened to hear them. Scorpia turned to look at them and proceeded to throw a wrecked horde tank.

"Ayo!" Catra yelled and jumped off from the cover and hid behind another fallen debris. "Well done you doofus!"

Scratch had evaded the tank as well and was hiding behind a large water pipe. "Shouldn't have said anything!"

"That doesn't help our cause at all!" Catra yelled.

"Okay.. maybe you're right.." Scratch panted as she evaded another thrown metal pipe. Scratch had to quickly think of something, but thinking quickly wasn't never her strongest points.

"Oh, now I got it. Catra, I'll draw her attention. Meanwhile you strike her from the back. I know you're good at backstabbing." Scratch said.

"Fine.." Catra replied with annoyance in her tone.

Scratch crawled behind the rubble and raised her arms up. "Uhh.. heyyy Scorpia.. I know you're probably really mad from before.." She started her awkward distraction while Catra began to sneak behind Scorpia.

"Scratch!" Scorpia yelled and lifted another tank from the ground, throwing it at Scratch.

" *How many tanks did we have stored in one room?* " Scratch thought to herself and jumped aside. "Scorpia, I know why you're so mad at me.. I would probably be too!"

Catra sneaked through the wrecked hall and climbed on the catwalk at the higher level of the room. She observed as Scratch evaded all the stuff thrown at her and seeing her run like no tomorrow was quite amusing to her..

But she had to stop idling around and get to moving, Scorpia had to get back. She snuck behind Scorpia as she was too focused on Scratch. This was her chance, so she jumped at the back of Scorpia and tried to strike at the chip.

However, Scorpia wouldn't make that easy and she grabbed Catra and pushed her against a pillar so hard that it cracked.

Catra let out a scream of pain as she felt like all her bones had just shattered. She was out of breath and her vision was getting blurry. She could however recognize Scorpia trying to impale her with her tail.

At this moment, Scratch jumped in and grabbed Scorpia from her neck. However.. she wasn't so strong that she could take Scorpia with her.

Scratch was grabbed and slammed on the hard concrete floor.

"Augh!" She yelled in great pain as she felt her bones crack.

Now Scorpia had turned her attention towards Scratch and turned her back on Catra.

Scratch laid on the floor, unable to move as she was crippled from the neck down to her toes. She felt numb.. as if all her body was just weight that she couldn't move or control. Scratch saw Scorpia ready to pierce her with her tail..

And then, Scorpia's tail impaled her chest, but at the same time Catra managed to get all her strength and stroke her claws into the chip and rip it off from Scorpia's neck.

Then her strength failed and she fell on the floor.. exhausted and beaten.

Meanwhile Scorpia had come back to her senses and as she saw Scratch on the floor.. impaled and crippled, she felt huge regret and pain filled her heart. As tears streamed from her eyes, she yelled with a desperate voice. "Scratch! I-Im so sorry! I-I.. I don't know how I could have something so horrible!"

She then picked Scratch up into her arms and held her tight. "I'm so sorry, I know you can't forgive me, but-" She was then cut off by Scratch as she coughed.

"Sc-Scorpia.. th-there's no reason for you to a-ask forgiveness.." She replied and coughed some more. "Instead.. I-I.. I should be the one to ask forgiveness from you.. how I treated you.. and even when you were the only one to believe in me.. I put you down all the time.."

"Sc-Scratch? Why are you saying this?" Scorpia asked, crying and sobbing.

"Y-You shouldn't weep for someone like me.. I just wish I had realized things sooner.."

"Scratch.. I-I don't know what to say.." Scorpia continued her weeping.

"Then don't say anything.. all that matters is that you're back and well.." Scratch's voice was getting weaker. "Heh.. I'm going to beat the shit out of Darkith.." She finished with a smug smile on her face. She then gave her last look to Scorpia. "Goodbye.. Scorpia.."

And then everything went silent, Scorpia hugged Scratch's dead body tightly and cried. Nothing like this wouldn't have happened if she had listened to her back at the camp.

But Scorpia couldn't just stay there and do nothing, she also didn't want to leave Scratch into Firght Zone, the place they both hated.. even if Scratch reveled from the power she had gained there.

Scorpia also noticed unconscious Catra and picked her up on her left shoulder, while carrying Scratch on her right. " *At least I'm going to give Scratch a proper burial.. I'll promise..* "

Chapter End Notes

Another one bites the dust..

First Darkith, then Scratch.. Who's going to be next?

Failsafe

Chapter Summary

Shadow Weaver and Castaspella return to the Rebellions camp and share their knew found knowledge of a failsafe, build by a bunch of rebellious First Ones.

There will be some friction between Glimmer and Shadow Weaver, since both of them have a different look on things.

Chapter Notes

It might be a bit petty for SW to try one up a teenager, but I guess thats just how she is...

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Princesses were gathered in the tent, discussing their plans going forward. They had got Scorpia and Spinnerella back, but Mermista and Micah were still under Prime's control, as were most of Etheria.

Entrapta had a crazy plan how they could get everyone back, but that wasn't enough. Even if they could get everyone back, it still wouldn't be enough to defeat Horde Prime.

Scratch was dead and only one who mourned her was Scorpia, others didn't pay that much attention to that. Catra was still out and Spinnerella was still recovering from her injury.

Scorpia was next to the grave she had made for Scratch, even if Scratch told her to not cry for her, she couldn't stop it. Maybe

there could have been something she could have done to help Scratch.. Yet there wasn't, Scratch had made it pretty clear where she stood.

It was confusing for Scorpia, Scratch had treated her badly and always belittled her.. still she cared enough to try and get her back from the Primes control.

Meanwhile, Shadow Weaver and Castaspella returned back to the camp. Shadow Weaver carried Castaspella on her shoulders since she had sprinkled her ankle and had trouble walking.

"You owe me, twice." Shadow Weaver muttered as she let Castaspella down.

"Sure, sure.. but dont we have something more important first?" Castaspella asked.

"Right.."

Two of them entered into the main tent and saw Adora, Bow and Glimmer, but Catra was not to be seen with others.. This was quite a surprise.

"Catra.." Shadow Weaver said. "Where's she?"

Others turned around and saw Castaspella and Shadow Weaver standing there.

"Oh, you are most welcome." Glimmer said. "We've been a bit short on Princess power.."

"Where is Catra?" Shadow Weaver repeated.

"Oh, she's resting at the back. Scratch and Catra pulled a risky stunt.." Adora replied. "Scratch died and Catra got injured."

"Uhm.. I see. Well I gotta see her." Shadow Weaver said and turned to look at Castaspella. "Could you explain our findings to others meanwhile?"

"Ofcourse." Castaspella replied and with that Shadow Weaver went to see Catra.

Shadow Weaver walked next to Catra and watched as she rested there. Should she try to wake her up.. maybe she should just let her be. She sighed and sat down on the floor, it was very painful for her to sit on the floor as her bones hurt. Was she really so old that she couldn't even properly sit on the floor?

Shadow Weaver heard as Castaspella was explaining about their findings, though Castaspella didn't have to take so long.. seriously sometimes it felt like Castaspella was a child.

Not too long after, Catra opened her eyes and saw Shadow Weaver sitting next to her. "Shadow Weaver?"

"Yes Catra, I'm here." She replied with a calm voice. "And you're lucky to be here too, if what I heard was true."

Catra coughed a bit and let out a chuckle. "I guess.."

"You're so reckless.. the first thing you did when we last met was to run straight into the Fright Zone.. now.. you got yourself almost killed.. again.." Shadow Weaver said with a deep sigh.

"I'm fine." Catra replied. "I was just a bit roughed up."

"A bit roughed up? You look terrible, can you even walk?" Shadow Weaver asked and raised her eyebrow.

"Sure I can." Catra assured and got up from the bed and began to walk, although a bit wobbly. "See?"

"You're unbelievable.." Shadow Weaver said and rolled her eyes. "Here, you can climb on my back."

"You do know I'm not a child anymore.. right?"

"Trust me, I carried Castaspella, I can carry you as well. No need to stress your legs." Shadow Weaver said.

Catra shrugged her head and climbed on Shadow Weaver's back, placing her hands around her shoulders and Shadow Weaver grabbed from Catra's thighs to keep her up.

"You know.. this brings me some memories.." Catra said.

"Sure it does." Shadow Weaver replied and they headed to the main room.

It seemed Castaspella wasn't even close to getting to the point. She was still going on her childish ways.

"And so, deep under Mystacor-" Suddenly Castaspella was cut off by Shadow Weaver's snappy yet tired tone. "Lies a failsafe built by the bunch of traitorous First Ones.

"You said I could explain it." Castaspella said with a visible frustration on her face as she looked at Shadow Weaver.

"You were taking too long." Shadow Weaver replied dismissively.

"So.. then there's a way to stop Prime for good?" Adora asked.

"Yes." Shadow Weaver said.

"But if its under Mystacor and now that it's controlled by Horde Prime.. how are we even going to get in?" Perfuma asked.

"Well.. we have Melog." Catra said.

"Who?" Netossa asked.

"A shapeshifter friend we got along our way." Adora explained.

"Right..."

"So, I guess we should start to plan our action then." Glimmer said.

So, they commenced their operation. Scorpia, Spinnerella and Netossa took a backseat and stayed at their camp, while Frosta, Perfuma and Entrapta stayed behind to keep on watch. Though Entrapta used her time to study and experiment on how to disconnect everyone from Horde Prime's network.

Their infiltration to Mystacor proceeded flawlessly thanks to Melog. Shadow Weaver and Castaspella were leading the way while others followed closely behind. Their group was comparatively large, considering that they were doing a sneaky infiltration mission.

It didn't take them long till they found their way under the Mystacor and ancient ruins that lay there. There were inscriptions carved on the walls and they told different stories of the past.

There was an inscription about the Spell of Obtainment which caused a slight uncomfort to Shadow Weaver, considering what she did when the Entity was in her.

Castaspella however was eagerly explaining the different inscriptions, being the childish princess she was. "Some sorceresses used forbidden spells to get what they wanted, followed by terrible consequences."

"Hey Shadow Weaver, doesn't that look like Jeff?" Catra said and pointed at the inscription.

"Yes.. that is *Jeff* .." Shadow Weaver murmured.

"Who Is Jeff?" Castaspella asked.

"Oh that's just the name Entrapta gave to the Spell of Obtainment." Shadow Weaver casually replied.

"It was named?!"

"Long story, maybe I'll tell you about it later.. by the way, you know Spell of Obtainment was a mistake.. one which I admit, but remember that it was Micah who tried to do it, while ignoring the warnings."

This caused an annoyed reaction from both Castaspella and Glimmer. "That was uncalled for.." Glimmer said. "You should think before you say it."

"Well excuse me, princess." Shadow Weaver replied with a sarcastic tone. "You are one to talk."

"Are you intentionally trying to make me mad?!" Glimmer raised her voice.

"Mayhaps." Shadow Weaver replied and shrugged her shoulders.

Catra then grabbed Shadow Weaver by her robe and whispered to her. " *I don't think this is the best time to antagonize them..* "

"I guess you're right." Shadow Weaver sighed. "Anyways.. we're here."

"We're where?" Adora asked.

"At the secret door, now I need both Glimmer and Castaspella to open it." Shadow Weaver said.

"You're asking us to do it? I thought you never asked anything from anyone." Glimmer snarked.

"Save your pettiness for after the war." Shadow Weaver said.

Castaspella showed Glimmer how to do the spell to open the door while others watched.

Soon a rumbling could be heard and the wall came down, revealing a secret passageway.

"Now, follow me. Also we might need some light as well." Shadow Weaver said as she went inside Catra following right behind her.

"Castaspella.. Do you really trust her? I mean this looks suspicious as hell." Glimmer said.

"I do trust her, even if she's difficult to be with.. I trust her."

"What other choice do we even have?" Adora affirmed.

"Hey, you guys coming or what?! Shadow Weaver's voice called from the dark.

"Coming right away." Castaspella replied and casted an light spell that would enlighten their way.

Walking through the passageway, it soon began to widen up and reveal much larger hallways, almost templelike corridors.

"Oh yeah, it might be a good time to mention that this place might have traps." Shadow Weaver mentioned casually.

"And you decide to tell us just now about it?" Glimmer asked with an annoyed tone.

"Hey, I've never been here, I didn't even know of this place's existence until recently. So I couldn't know what laid ahead. It is however always good to assume that ancient ruins include traps." Shadow Weaver explained with a snarky and condescending tone.

"Is this bitch serious?" Glimmer said in an annoyed, yet quiet tone. However Shadow Weaver could easily hear her.

"You should mind your tongue, young lady. It is not appropriate for you." Shadow Weaver replied with a smirk.

"I'll show you appropriate!" Glimmer said and cast a small wind spell that pushed Shadow Weaver against the wall, setting off the place's defense mechanism.

The room was swiftly filled with flames from the floor and walls and Shadow Weaver disappeared behind the wall of flame.

Everyone looked with horrified expressions. "Shadow Weaver!" Catra yelled.

"Glimmer.." Castaspella said with a disappointed and stern voice.

Glimmer was momentarily shocked but quickly shrugged it off. "To be honest, that kind of was on her."

"Glimmer!" Adora exclaimed. "You don't have to stoop on the same level of pettiness as her."

Catra was about to do something very brash and irrational, till she heard Shadow Weaver's voice.

"I'm alright, it's just an illusion."

"What! And illusion?!" Castaspella repeated.

"Yes, kind of clever but ultimately useless trap." Shadow Weaver's condescending voice called behind the wall of flame. "Now come on, we don't want to waste anymore time."

Everyone gave an uncertain look to each others, but decided to go, their ruckus was probably heard and they had to hurry.

It didn't take them long till they arrived at the great hall, it was a spacious room and at the otherside of it were three pillars that held a rune that looked like it was made by the First Ones and shaped like a heart.

"Is this it, the failsafe?" Adora asked.

"Yes, it is.. we don't have much time left. Adora, you must do it." Shadow Weaver said with a calm yet serious voice.

"Wait just a minute." Glimmer interrupted. "Why don't you take it? You desire power over everything else?!"

"I can't anymore.. if I could, I would.. saving Etheria would be worth dying for.." Shadow Weaver replied.

"Are you insinuating that Adora would die if she took it?" Glimmer asked.

Others turned to look at Shadow Weaver with serious and worried looks. "Is there something you aren't telling us?" Castaspella

asked.

Now she was in a tight spot, hadn't Castaspella listened nor bothered to read while they were studying? It was clear that First Ones were crazy.

"It.. it is a possibility.." Shadow Weaver said with uncertain and sorrowful expression. She had a hard time finding the right words. "But as She-Ra.. she has the best chance of surviving.."

"You can't be serious!? So your plan is to sacrifice Adora!" Glimmer yelled.

Catra looked at Shadow Weaver in disbelief, was she really about to sacrifice her love.. to save Etheria.

"I would do it myself if I could! But I have nothing! I would just die and the failsafe wouldn't activate under a mere mortal like me!" Shadow Weaver raised her voice.

But then the room's doors burst open and Micah arrived there with a bunch of sorceresses.

"Well well.. What do we have here? I heard quite a lot of noise, I didn't expect such a family reunion." He said with a cold and monotone voice, like it sounded like him, but it still wasn't like him.

Everyone quickly took up defensive positions and Adora didn't have any time to think anymore. In a dire situation like this she had to act. "For the honor of Grayskull!" She yelled and successfully transformed into She-Ra. She ran up to the pillars and grabbed the failsafe.

The room was filled with bright light and it blinded Micah and the other sorcerers. And as soon as Adora had grabbed the failsafe, it was now integrated into her chest.

"Alright, I got it and didn't die." She replied with a relieved tone.

"Great, then we run for it!" Shadow Weaver yelled.

The room began to shake and crumble, they had no time to try and save Micah or others, they had to leave. As much as it pained Shadow Weaver and others, it had to be done.

Rest of their escape went smoothly as they fled in the cover of Melog, back into Whispering Woods.

When they would arrive at the camp.. there would be a lot of heated arguing, which Shadow Weaver hated.

Back at the rebel hideout, the tensions rose. Most of it was because of Shadow Weaver's plan. She couldn't take the heat and left the tent to go somewhere to be alone.

Catra had really mixed feelings about all of this. Firstly, she was a bit bitter that Shadow Weaver hadn't told her everything, but that was the case usually. However, she agreed that Horde couldn't be stopped without drastic measures.

But could she be ready to accept that it might cost the life of her love? This thought gut wrenched her and made things even harder.

Castaspella was mostly neutral, she had accepted and she also knew that this plan would be risky. Didn't mean that she liked it at

all.

Glimmer was the one most furious about the situation, she never liked Shadow Weaver and always saw her as an unpredictable wild card that could backstab them anytime. She didn't want to have her friend sacrifice herself because some people long time ago made a suicide plan.

Adora was unusually calm, normally she probably would have been stressed and freaked out, but maybe because she was in the form of She-Ra and because this She-Ra's spirit seemed to influence her, making her more mature than she actually was.

However, thinking about Catra made her nervous and she wanted to make sure everything was fine.

Catra sat in the back of the tent, silently watching into nothingness and lost in thought. Until Adora broke the silence. "Are you alright Catra? You don't seem so well."

"Oh, Adora.." Catra snapped out of her thoughts. "I was.. just.. thinking.."

"Is this bothering you?" Adora asked and pointed to the heart in her chest. She then sat next to her. "Catra?"

"Well.. if I'm being honest, then yes it does bother me." Catra replied. "I love you.. and I don't know what I would do if I lost you."

"Hey, I'm not going to die. I'm She-Ra and she can't die." Adora tried to assure her.

"She-Ra might not die, but Adora might.." Catra said with an uncertain voice as tears dropped from her cheek. "I'm in love with Adora.. not She-Ra."

"Hey, I'm not going to die. It was only a possibility and to think I survived from taking the failsafe, I'm pretty sure my survival is guaranteed."

"You promise?"

"I'll promise." Adora said with a soothing tone and hugged Catra.

She embraced her hug and it made her feel a lot better. Maybe things wouldn't be as bleak as they seemed.

Chapter End Notes

I'm not sure how happy I am for what I have written. If you feel things were skipped or left unexplained, I know.. I don't

like it either, but I just kind of want to get this project finished.

So, sorry if this chapter feels rushed and badly written.

"Your stories are always badly written."
~Spell of Obtainment~

Heart of Etheria

Chapter Summary

> Adora has decided to fulfill her destiny and free all the magic inside of the Heart of Etheria.
>
> Horde Prime launches his final and largest attack on the planet and proceeds to hack the planet to bring perfect peace and order to the universe.

Chapter Notes

> I apologize for my sloppy writing in this chapter, the pacing will be ass and it might feel rushed.
>
> But I have worked over 2 years on this story.. I want to finish it.
>
> Also.. I skipped a lot of things/changed order of events/ etc.. because forst and fistmost this is a SW/Catra focused fanfic, so obviously those two take the center stage.
>
> Apologies about my rant.. please try to enjoy this last chapter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora and Catra arrived at the main room as everyone else except Shadow Weaver had gathered. Entrapta was explaining her plan on how to free everyone from Prime's control.

It was a risky move almost as risky as taking the failsafe and releasing all the magic inside of Etheria. Plan relied on getting close to one of the Prime's spires and uploading a virus that would sever the connection.

That much Catra understood, even if she couldn't get all the technicalities.

So now they decided to split into two groups.. mainly just Adora and Catra going to the heart and others went to take on the Horde in hopes of getting everyone back.

However there was one thing they had no idea about, was that Horde Prime had discovered a way on how to reach Etheria's Heart and release all the magic, knowing very well that it would lead into total destruction of the Universe.

Shadow Weaver was sitting on a rock next to a pond in the woods, moping how things have turned ugly. " *Was it the right thing to do? What if I were wrong? What if they die.. and it would be because of me..* "

She knew she would be detested by every single princess.. It even seemed like Catra wouldn't stand seeing her anymore. "How did it come to this?"

"By chance of bad luck and sheer desperation?" Shadow Weaver's ears twitched and she turned to look at the woman standing behind her, that being none other than Castaspella.

"Oh.. its you.." Shadow Weaver sighed and turned to look away.

"I knew you wouldn't go far." Castaspella replied.

"Why are you here? Did you come to lecture me about my decisions? How I am rude, or ill mannered?" Shadow Weaver said with a disdain in her voice.

"Nope, I'm not here to lecture you about anything. I'm partly guilty of the same thing as you. Though I wasn't so bitchy about it." Castaspella replied with a smirk and playful tone.

"What are you? Some sort of doppelganger? And what have you done to the real Castaspella?" Shadow Weaver answered with a joking tone.

Castaspella let out a small giggle, like she was some child that had heard something fun. "I didn't know you could joke."

"Well you don't know many things about me. If you're referring to me being bitch to Glimmer.. she had it coming." Shadow Weaver said and her ears pointed downwards, displaying her uneasiness and displeasement.

Castaspella sat next to Shadow Weaver and leaned against her shoulder.

"Hey, what are you doing?!" Shadow Weaver asked with a confused and embarrassed tone. "Do you really think now its best time for this!?"

"You aren't against it, now are you?" Castaspella replied and placed her hands around Shadow Weaver's shoulders while leaning into her.

Shadow Weaver was beyond flabbergasted about this whole thing, was Castaspella making moves on her? Right before the inevitable doom? At first she wanted to push Castaspella away, but refrained from doing it.

She hated the feeling of enjoying it. This wasn't like her and it most certainly wasn't the right time for this.

But alas.. her body acted against her "logical reasoning" and embraced Castaspella instead. She actually really wanted someone to comfort her, even if she would never admit it openly.

"We all do mistakes from time to time." Castaspella assured her. "I'm sure they won't remember you badly after this."

"If they make it out alive that is.. were someone to die.. I'd probably be banished to Beast Island.. again.." Shadow Weaver

sighed.

"Then what if you were able to stop it?"

"Stop what, exactly?" Shadow Weaver asked.

"Them dying of course, I'm sure you if anyone would be able to do it." Castaspella said. "With or without magic, you have always figured a way.. so why not now?"

Castaspella then let go of Shadow Weaver and stood up. "We're going to proceed with the plan, whether you mope here or not."

With that being said Castaspella left Shadow Weaver alone at the shore of the pond. She placed her hands into the pockets of her robe and she felt something sharp in there.

" *I don't remember putting anything in my pocket..* " Shadow Weaver thought and pulled up a few luminary crystals. She had in fact stolen them when she and Castaspella were visiting Mystacor. " *Now.. I got it..* "

She knew that even without magic, using luminary crystals would give an ability to use magic for a short period of time. However.. It comes off with a heavy cost, but now was not time to think about it.

There's no going back anymore, so why not give everything now.

Meanwhile on Horde Prime's capital ship, Prime was getting ready to bring perfect peace to the universe. He had acquired knowledge of Heart of Etheria and mechanizations of the First Ones. He could hack into the planet and override its system, turning First Ones technology against them.

Catra and Adora were heading into a secret entrance that would ascend deep into Etheria's core. Shadow Weaver had found and corrected the map and left it for them to use.

"Do you think Shadow Weaver will run away?" Adora asked as they walked into the steep hallway.

"I don't know.. why would she? Where would she go and what would she even achieve by doing it?" Catra replied. "I did not actually think she would be willing to go so far.. to risk killing you in the process."

"I guess others weren't wrong when they called her unpredictable loose cannon." Adora said.

"Normally I would take offense to that, but in this situation.. I'll let it slip." Catra said.

"Yeah.. anyways, there should be a door right here.. but I don't see one." Adora said as she looked at the map and then at the deadend. "Do you think she made a mistake in the map?"

"Highly doubt it, if there's one thing she's good at, it's maps and ancient writings. She dedicated her whole life for those." Catra said. "I think this is more like a diversion.. I don't think the First Ones would make things easy for us."

And it surely was a diversion, however it turned out to be much more than just that. In a sudden change of the hallway, Adora

was separated from Catra. It seemed like the doors and hallways changed as they pleased all on their own.

"Adora?! Where did you go!? Adora!" Catra yelled in panic as she now stood alone in a crossway of the tunnels. "What the hell is going on!? And she got the map as well.. fuck First Ones!"

Meanwhile somewhere else in the tunnels, Adora was as panicked as Catra, maybe even more so. "Catra!? What happened to you!?" She yelled but couldn't get any answers. "Catra!"

She still held on to the map, but threw it away in a fit of rage. "Stupid map! Not much use if this place changes all the time!

Shadow Weaver was wandering through the woods and came by a peculiar drill. It seemed that the Horde was installing it on the ground. She hid in the trees and observed them. As the drill began to dig through the ground, the First Ones sigils began to activate. This time they glowed green, like the color of the Horde.

She had seen enough, whatever this was, it was going to affect Adora's and Catra's mission. So she had to act now.

But before she could leave, she saw a large projection of Horde Prime.

"You Etherian's have discarded my goodwill, by continuing this futile resistance of you. I sought to look for peace, but you have left me no other choice. Rejoice Etheria! Final Judgment shall fall upon you and there will be perfect order and peace!"

" *He's an bigger megalomaniac than Spell of Obtainment...* " Shadow Weaver thought as she listened to his speech, but now was not the time to dwell on that.. she had to find Catra and Adora.

She took out one of the luminary crystals and cut her hand with it, then she crushed the luminar crystal into powder and let it mix up with her blood. This gave her temporary magic, but it would drain her, even more than the Spell of Obtainment.

She could already feel dizzy and the pain it caused was immeasurable, but she had to endure it. " *Now.. Where are you Catra..* " She kept thinking of Catra so she could teleport to her.

The last remains of the Rebellion had challenged the Horde, it was supposed to be a quiet operation. However things have now escalated as they are surrounded by hundreds of Horde clones.

Entrapta and Bow managed to sneak into the spire, but Prime caught them red handed. Prime managed to capture Entrapta, while she managed to get her device out of the way before she was gone.

It now fell to Bow to finish the job..

Outside, the rest of the princesses kept fighting and they were doing quite well. Until Micah and Mermista arrived.

Glimmer faced her father herself. "Father.. I'm sorry it had to come to this."

"It doesn't matter, Prime will succeed and you all will fail." Micah's voice taunted.

Glimmer and her father clashed in a magic duel, obviously Micah was a lot more skilled than her, but she couldn't give up.. not now.

At the Prime's capital ship, on the main bridge Entrapta was held down by two Horde clones while Prime spectated the fight. "You should know this is all futile." He said.

"That's where you're wrong." Entrapta replied. "You should never underestimate us."

This angered Prime, so he grabbed Entrapta from her hair and casted an projection, showing all of the remaining princesses. **"You should just give up and I promise to grant you all peace, or does your little princesses life mean nothing to you?"**

This almost made everyone stop their fighting, but at that moment, Bow had managed to upload the virus into the system. Causing all the chips to fall off.

Prime was baffled about this, he didn't even consider that it was even possible.

"I told you, never underestimate Etherians." Entrapta replied smugly.

"This ends now! Execute her, now!" Prime commanded one of the Horde clones, not knowing it happened to be Hordak, who had held onto the chip given him by Entrapta.

Entrapta looked up to him and he looked back, with an uncomfortable expression on his face.

"What are you waiting for? Kill her!" Prime commanded with an impatient tone.

Hordak raised his arm and was ready to blast Entrapta into smithereens. Prime seemed to be happy and turned to look away.

"No.." Hordak replied.

"What did you say!?" Prime turned to look at him. "Are you disobeying my orders?"

"Yes, because I am not just a clone.. I gave myself a name.. I'm Hordak." He replied, pointed his gun at Prime and blasted him so hard he flew through the screens on his command bridge, falling into the chasm.

Hordak seemed to be victorious for a moment, but Prime possessed him soon after. "Hmph! I guess I have to do it all by myself."

He then teleported both of them back to Etheria and challenged everyone there to fight him, but not before sending his whole army against the alliance.

Meanwhile at the tunnels deep beneath the surface of Etheria, Catra was running in panic as she tried to look for Adora. Only to

end up in deadends and probably getting lost into the deep web of the tunnels.

That is.. until black flames in the form of a circle formed behind her and Shadow Weaver appeared, out of breath and exhausted.

"Shadow Weaver!? What are you doing here?" Catra questioned, she was not expecting to see her at all. "I thought you couldn't use magic?"

"Ah.. listen Catra, we don't have much time. Prime is overwriting Etheria and trying to blow up the whole universe." Shadow Weaver explained. "We must hurry, where's Adora?"

"We got separated.. this place is pulling tricks on us." Catra said. Then she saw the green glow coming behind her and the tunnels were lightened up by the First Oned sigils. "Uhh.. Shadow Weaver?"

"We're so out of time, hurry! Grab my hand and we'll get to Adora!" Shadow Weaver said and offered her blood soaked hand.

"What happened?" Catra asked as she saw her hand. "Why are you bleeding?"

"We have no time! Don't worry about me!" Shadow Weaver raised her voice and without any more questions asked, Catra grabbed her arm and they teleported away.

They arrived into a spacious hall and saw a monster that looked like something straight up from Beast Island. There also was a projection of Horde Prime, taunting Adora.

" *Goodbye, my oldest enemy.* " Prime taunted.

"Adora!" Catra yelled and rushed to defend her. "Are you alright?" However she was clearly not, she had a deep cut in her leg and it seemed like she was also being corrupted.

Shadow Weaver managed to collect her thoughts and gather her strength.

"Shadow Weaver, help Adora! I'll hold this thing off!" Catra said as she attacked the monster.

Shadow Weaver walked up to Adora and picked her up. "Come now.. we have Etheria to save." She said and began to escort Adora.

Prime's projection began to taunt Catra for her futile effort. " *Do you really think what you are doing will change anything.. Little sister?* "

"Fuck you!" Catra yelled as the creature pinned her down and grabbed her with its tendrils.

" *It is truly a shame you won't be able to see the end of it all.. Whatever your precious little princess is doing, will only lead to death..* " Prime said with a devilish smile on his face. He had truly won and the pesky rebellion on the surface would be snuffed out swiftly.

Adora and Shadow Weaver had almost reached the heart, until Adora heard Catra's desperate screams.

"Catra- I-I must go.." She said with a weak voice and almost fainting, but still standing. "I can't leave her.."

"No- cough.. we are so close..ugh!" Shadow Weaver tried reason, but her strength was failing as well. "The heart is right there.." But it was no use, Adora had made her mind and was determined to save Catra.

Shadow Weaver stood there, between Adora and the heart. As she looked towards the heart, she could feel her magic returning. She was filled with the power she had long forgotten and yearned

for. She looked at her blood soaked hand and clenched the fist. " *I know.. what I must do..* "

Meanwhile the monster was almost ready to eat Catra, but it was savoring its prey and the back of everything, Prime kept taunting her. " *This world will be gone, the whole universe will vanish, your Adora will die! So tell me, little sister.. Was it all worth it?* "

Catra closed her eyes and had accepted her fate as the monster was going to eat her, but then she could hear something swooshing by and she soon found herself on the floor.

Shadow Weaver emerged from the corridor and was blasting spells against the monster. "Take Adora and run!" She said and covered for Catra.

"What are you doing?!"

"Run, I said run!" Shadow Weaver snapped and pushed Catra into the corridor and then she sealed the entrance with a barrier.

"No! What are you doing!?" Catra yelled, banging her fist against the barrier and crying.

"You must make sure Adors reaches the heart.. it's too late for me.." Shadow Weaver said with an unusually soft voice. "You two will make it and you will have a bright future ahead of you.."

Shadow Weaver was restraining the monster with dark tendrils, but the monster wasn't going to give up. Each second ate her away, she could feel terrible pain as her body was breaking under her robes.

"N-no.. it can't go like this!" Catra yelled.

"Catra.." Adora's voice called and she placed her hand on Catra's shoulder.

Catra was momentarily distracted, Shadow Weaver gave a warm smile to two of them. She picked up one of the lunar crystals in her pocket and threw it at the entrance of the corridor.

Both Adora and Catra looked at her with disbelief written on their faces.

"Catra.. I'm so proud of you.. and I'm sorry I can't be there with you.." Shadow Weaver said with a somber yet encouraging tone.

Catra had turned into a sobbing mess as she witnessed losing her mother figure.. again.”

"I'm sorry..." Shadow Weaver said and then she bursted into bright flames and incinerated the monster and herself. After that brief moment, the place fell into silence. Now all that was left of Shadow Weaver, was a cracked lunar crystal where she had carved her real name.

It was so that Catra could have something to hold on..

Catra picked the crystal up and stuffed it into her pockets. She then wiped the tears away and grabbed Adora tightly. "Alright.. let's get this done.."

Their walk to the heart was slow and filled with agony. When they finally reached the heart, Adora was almost dead. She didn't have strength left in her and all Catra could do is to watch slowly losing her.

The whole place was beginning to collapse around them as Prime's overwriting was almost done, soon there would be no Etheria, no universe and no them..

"Adora! Don't leave me! Don't go where I can't follow you!" Catra pleaded and looked at Adora whose eyes were closing and breathing began to slow. "Adora! Stay with me! After all what we have gone through, STAY!"

Adora was probably now somewhere between the realm of the dead and living. She was surrounded by darkness and hopelessness. All she could hear was a faint calling. It seemed like she was about to give up, the corruption was spreading and she was dying.

She was ready to accept it, until something broke the silent darkness. She saw a bright light and there was a hand reaching out for her and someone calling her name. It began to sound familiar each time and soon she could see Catra.

Now Adora realized that she couldn't give up, if Catra could manage to reach here.. then she should reach back. She grabbed Catra's hand and she was pulled back from darkness, right into Catra's arms.

"Is.. is it really you." Adora asked with a faint voice.

"Of Course it's me." Catra said with a crying voice, but still a smile on her face. "Adora.. if we don't make it.. I want to tell you this, I really.. really love you."

Adora was surprised, of course she knew that Catra liked her and she liked her back, but this really confirmed that they never had a real chance to confess. "It might sound silly but.. I love you as well."

"You goofus.." Catra replied.

It was now or never, they shared their first real kiss. A kiss of two lovers in the face of peril. As they shared their passionate kiss, Adora could feel herself fill with life again. The corruption healed and she was like before, now she could release the magic of the heart.

Back at the surface of Etheria, Prime was gaining his upper hand and now it seemed it was time. The earth around all of Etheria began to crack and bright beams of lights pushed through. **"Rejoice, Etheria, as you shall see perfect order! Soon we all are gone and there is nothing left! The last day of the universe!"**

But right as it seemed that the planet was about to blow up, everything went silent.. which was kind of anticlimactic considering how much Prime hyped up their coming destruction.

"What.. Did something go wrong?" Prime thought.

Suddenly the silence was broken and a bright beam of light was shot from the newly formed ravine. It overgrown Prime's capital ship with vegetation and the outer extensions fell onto ground. Prime's capital ship was crumbling and soon all of Etheria was filled with never before seen greenery and life.

Prime fell onto his knees and witnessed his defeat. How was this possible? It couldn't have been.. or could it?

Then She-Ra emerged from the ravine, swaying her sword and pointed it towards Prime, while carrying Catra on her shoulder.

"This is it, Prime! Your end is nigh." Adora called and walked up to Prime. "You are not going anywhere.."

Catra jumped off of She-Ra and Prime watched with a horrified look on his face as She-Ra grabbed his face and looked into his soul.

"It is over.." She-Ra said and with a sudden bright flash of light, Prime was banished from the universe, leaving the original host of its body behind.

Hordak could now see the warrior that had always ruined his plans and now he couldn't do anything else than just accept the fate.

All the other Horde clones were freed of their hive-mind and could not really comprehend what had happened.

All of the princesses gathered around and hugged each other.

Glimmer, Castaspella and Micah shared an affectionate group hug. "I can't believe this to be true." Castaspella said.

"Me neither, dear sister."

"We're back together." Glimmer said.

After everything was clear, even Scorpia reunited with everyone, well mostly with Entrapta. Since she probably was her only real friend among the others.

"You did it Adora!" Bow exclaimed alongside Glimmer.

"No, we did it." Adora replied and pulled Catra into a hug. "Without her, I might not be here at all."

"Ah geez, you're making me blush.." Catra replied with an awkward tone.

"Best Friend Squad hug!" Bow exclaimed and pulled all four of them into a hug and they lost their balance, landing on the soft grass. All they could do about it was to laugh.

As the sun casted it first light on the sky and all the different stars and planets that were still to be seen. "Imagine all those different planets out there.." Glimmer said.

"Yeah, we must go there one day and see them all!" Catra said with excitement in her tone.

"Imagine.. all of the universe to explore." Bow said.

As everyone had calmed down a bit, not that it would really calm down for a long time. This day would be celebrated and remembered across all of Etheria.

Castaspella looked around, expecting to see Shadow Weaver. Afterall, she was the one who had put everything into motion. Surely she would want to come rub some salt and tell everyone she was right.

But Shadow Weaver was nowhere to be seen. Castaspella knew others didn't care that much, but Catra should at least.

So, she decided to ask Catra when she was alone and looking at the sky.

"Its beautiful, is it not?" Castaspella said.

"Yes.. it is.." Catra replied with a shaky tone and clenched her fist.

"Is something the matter?" Castaspella acquired.

Then Catra bursted into tears and dropped the broken lunar crystal on the grass. Castaspella was surprised, how did she manage to get her hand on one of these?

"Catra.."

"She's dead.."

"Who? Wait.." The sudden realization hit Castaspella. "You mean Shadow Weaver is dead?"

"Yes, she saved me and Adora.. with the cost of her life.." Catra answered and fell onto her knees, sobbing as tears streamed across her cheeks.

Castaspella was shocked. Why did she have to do it? Surely there would have been a better option. And Shadow Weaver had promised to her she would tell her everything, they had promised to come back.. and now.. Shadow Weaver was no more.

Castaspella's heart filled with sorrow, so all she could do was to comfort Catra, so she could comfort herself as well and share the pain. Catra felt the same way, she could share this feeling of sorrow with Castaspella.

Since Shadow Weaver meant so much to both of them.

Chapter End Notes

Now we only have the epilogue left, to tie all the lose ends.

R.I.P Shadow Weaver

"Da fuck? I'm not dead! I'm stil-"

-Sush, the dead don't speak.-

Epilogue

Chapter Summary

A send off to the story and tying up the lose ends.
Again.. we'll be moving on breakneck speed.

Chapter Notes

Even though the last chapter was end of story, I still wanted to write the epilogue. (I know some of you would be heartbroken if I didn't)

Anyways, if I ever happen to write a sequel to this, then this epilogue will also kind of work as an prologue to that.

Depending if there's a demand for this timeline, if not I'll start working on something new.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

What Shadow Weaver did was the right thing. That's how she thought about it. Why should she keep weighing down on Catra? Why should she bother to continue existing in a world where she was widely despised?

At least now she could be at peace and know that Catra had a bright future.

However.. she found herself awake, floating in a space surrounded by emptiness. A faint beating of a heart could be heard and each beat gave a radiation of warmth.

"Where in the First Ones name am I!?" Shadow Weaver wondered. "Shouldn't I be dead!?"

She noticed that she could move freely in space and wander around. Was she somewhere real between realms? Wasn't this something Angella was trapped in? Or that's what she had heard. Well.. she believed that there was an afterlife, but if the afterlife was being stuck in between realms, then she wished it didn't exist.

But maybe she could find something positive about this, she decided to head towards the sound of the beating heart and when she arrived there, she realized that it was the Heart of Etheria..

"Am I stuck inside of Etheria? What could possibly cause this?" Shadow Weaver said to herself, now that she had all the time to ponder to herself.

As time passed, or rather.. it did not, but who cared.. she was trapped in the vast emptiness of space. Until, something quite familiar appeared behind her.

" *Well, well.. long time no se..* "

That voice sent shivers down Shadow Weaver's spine, she knew whom that voice belonged to. "It can't be.. you.." She muttered.

" *Oh but it is me, did you miss me?* "

"Not really, why are you here? Why aren't you pestering some other hopeless sorcerer?" Shadow Weaver snidely remarked.

" *You know what, to be honest.. I just couldn't take it anymore..* "

Shadow Weaver was puzzled, was there something that even the Spell of Obtainment would fear? "What exactly?"

" *The other entities spent all their time mocking me. Calling me soft! Imagine that! They even assumed I had developed feelings?! How crazy is that?!* "

Shadow Weaver bursted out in laughter. "I can't believe it! You, developing feelings? HA!" She rolled on the empty space, cackling uncontrollably.

" *Yeah, so I decided to dip. Then I saw you were taken by the abyss and decided to pay a visit.. like.. you know..* "

Wait.. Spell of Obtainment came to see her? What if it was true, if it had actually managed to develop feelings. "Sooo, tell me. What are you really doing here?"

" *I could offer you a deal.* " Entity said.

"A deal? Yeah, no thanks. I've got enough of your deals!"

" *No, this time will be different.. I'm actually ashamed to admit this, but I'd like to meet that crazy scientist girl.. She really seemed to understand a lot of things.* "

"So you have developed feelings." Shadow Weaver remarked slyly. "The great and powerful Spell of Obtainment is in reality a sofite."

" *It's not like that! Old hag, look.. you're the one who's dead!"* Spell of Obtainment snapped. " *So listen up! I as a entity of great power and chaos to some extent, I can bend the rules of the universe.* "

"Alright, I'm listening." Shadow Weaver replied intrigued.

" *Good, So, I can technically bring you back alive.. but I have one condition.* "

"Ah, here we go again.. you want to infect me again? Or do you perhaps want to target someone else?"

" *No, I can simply bring you back, if you promise not to banish me with that stupid princess of yours.* "

"If you were banished already and you can come back.. why would you worry about ending up here again?"

" *You ask an awful lot of questions..* " Spell of Obtainment said. " *Fine, I just don't want to go back to the other entities, they really get on my nerves and before you ask why, I wouldn't just go somewhere else, is that I'm intrigued to meet up with that scientist girl.* "

"Wow.. You keep yapping a lot.. but I guess, your deal is fair." Shadow Weaver said. "But what about me? Are you going to latch onto me again? Or what?"

" *Simple, you bind me into some sort of object, I'd prefer a runestone.* "

"Oh geez and where the fuck would I get a runestone for you?" Shadow Weaver asked sarcastically.

" *Etheria is full of those, I can even bring you back near to one. So if you would, once comply with me and stop being such a bitch.* "

"Fine, agreed.. But if you deceive me, I'll make sure you will find yourself back in the shadow realm faster than you could say hag.."

" *Alright, it's a deal.* "

Then Spell of Obtainment offered one of its tendrils to Shadow Weaver and she hesitantly gave her hand to it, they shook their hands and with that Spell of Obtainment brought them somewhere distant place in Etheria.

Shortly after Horde Prime's defeat, things started to look bright for Etheria. Hordak, alongside other ex-horde members, were tasked to clean up Beast Island. After all, Hordak used that island as his dumping place.

The Horde clones, on the other hand, were tasked to help rebuild Etheria.

Lands taken by the Horde, were given back to their righteous owners. That included Scorpia's kingdom and she was shortly after crowned the queen of it.

Micah assumed his position as the king of Brightmoon, temporarily. Since it was expected that Bow and Glimmer were soon to marry, which would make Bow the new king.

Micah also partly returned to Mystacor, to help her sister out.

Castaspella was grateful for his help and was very much happy to have him back, but she hadn't gotten past Shadow Weaver's death.

Micah understood her well and could share his feelings of sorrow with her.

As five years had passed, Catra still had troubles letting the past go. She clinged to the crystal left by Shadow Weaver, hoping there would be something to be done.

However, she was soon to marry Adora alongside with the wedding of Bow and Glimmer. Making it a double wedding and a great day of celebration.

When Catra was dressing up for the wedding, she could still remember the night of Princess Prom and how Shadow Weaver had been there with her to choose her clothes.

But dwelling onto past did no good, she had to look for future. Today was the great day of her and Adora's wedding. "Catra, are you ready?" Adora yelled from the other room.

"Yes, I'm ready." Catra replied.

"You look beautiful." Adora said as they walked together towards the altar, where Micah was waiting.

"And you look amazing yourself." Catra said with a joyous expression.

The double wedding was indeed a great night of celebration, it meant a new age for Etheria and a new bright future for Adora and Catra.

Fast Forward about a half a month.

Castaspella was wandering through the Whispering Woods, she didn't have any particular reason to be there. Yet she was walking, trekking through the thick woods. Life on Etheria had never been better, Bow and Glimmer married, as did Adora and Catra.. yet something was still missing. Well, mostly for her.

Catra had her somber moments when she would just look at the night sky and hoping something would change, other people

didn't pay any attention to that. Nor did they never ask about Castaspella what was bothering her. Micah knew, but there wasn't much he could do about it.

" *Oh why Shadow Weaver, why did you have to go back on your promise.. you have missed so much. Yet I feel no one misses you.. in some cases understandably so..* " She thought to herself. There was so much she wanted to ask about her, so much to talk about and.. she might have ever fallen in love during their time together.

She had always admired Shadow Weaver in some ways and she was well aware that Shadow Weaver tried to stop that dreaded spell, yet it was too little too late.

Castaspella arrived at the same pond where she had found Shadow Weaver, the same night she had died. She sat on the stone and looked into the crystal clear water. "Why.. Why did you always have to be so difficult?! Even if you didn't have to!" She yelled into the night sky.

"Oh, are you perhaps referring to me?" A sultry yet coarse voice called behind Castaspella, she instantly jumped off the rock and looked behind her. There stood none other than Shadow Weaver herself.

She was beyond flabbergasted, how was this possible? Was this a dream? Hallucination? "Is.. is it really you?" She carefully asked.

"Who else do I look like to you?" Shadow Weaver replied with her easily recognisable snarky and condescending tone.

"You aren't a hallucination, now are you?"

"Nope.. in the flesh." She replied. "Though I did not expect to see you here. Come here often?"

"No.. I was just walking through the forest.. Besides, you are the one owing me an explanation! It's been what.. like five years and

you only now show up! You missed Adora's and Catra's wedding." Castaspella said.

"Has it been that long? Well, that tends to happen when you are dead." Shadow Weaver replied. "But rest assured, I'll explain everything to you.. even if it sounds crazy."

"You owe Catra an explanation as well."

"That much is true."

"So, you're back then? No crazy twists? No unplanned sudden deaths?" Castaspella questioned.

"It seems so, I also happen to have something I need to deliver to Entrapta." Shadow Weaver replied, showing a small runestone.

"Nothing makes sense here.. and why do you have a runestone in the first place?"

"Uhh.. reasons? Castaspella, I'm tired.. I've been trekking through Etheria and now I'm out of my breath.. So could we continue this in the morning?"

"Sure.. and if you are not here in the morning, then I can assume this was a really lucid dream." Castaspella said.

" *Are you really going to spend a night here? I thought we were going to see that Entrapta girl.* " Spell of Obtainment muttered.

" *We're going when we're going, right now.. no. I need to catch up on a lot of things.* " Shadow Weaver replied whispering.

"Excuse me, are you talking to someone?" Castaspella inquired.

"Mayhaps?" Shadow Weaver answered with a nonchalant tone.

"You are as unbelievable as ever."

"But I bet you wouldn't like me if I wasn't?" Shadow Weaver replied with a suggestive tone and winked her eye.

Castaspella was blushing, of course she liked when Shadow Weaver was this unreasonable snarky bitch, who always tried to get under her skin. Castaspella didn't want to admit to it, but it might be true what they say about her at Mystacor. Castaspella has a really bad taste in women.

"I take that as an yes." Shadow Weaver smirked.

"Gosh, what am I going to do with you!" Castaspella let out a flustered complaint.

"Well, we both know what you want and I want it as well."

Then Castaspella had enough, she lunged at Shadow Weaver taking her down with her on the soft grass. They kissed passionately and Shadow Weaver wasn't really expecting something so sudden, but she didn't mind it.

"Promise me that you won't ever ever disappear like that again." Castaspella said and stopped kissing, letting Shadow Weaver some room to speak.

"I promise and this time, I really mean it." Shadow Weaver said with a serious tone.

"Then that settles it." Castaspella said and they continued to make love through the night.

" *Ugh, this is so gross.. get a room you two..* " Spell of Obtainment complained. " *There will be no living with her after this ..* "

At the next morning, Castaspella woke up as the sun shone through the trees. As she opened her eyes, she saw Shadow Weaver, sleeping right next to her. " *So it wasn't a dream..* "

This also meant that Shadow Weaver really was back. She decided to kiss Shadow Weaver on her cheek. Her ears twitched and she let out some mumbling.

"Wake up sleepy, it's morning." Castaspella said gently to Shadow Weaver's ear.

Shadow Weaver shrugged her body and opened eyes, her tired look piercing Castaspella. "What do you want?" Her coarse voice called.

"That it's morning, we have a long trek ahead of us." Castaspella said with a chirpy and energetic voice.

"Were you always this energetic?"

"Yes."

"Agh, fine.. I'll get up." Shadow Weaver said and stretched her arms, as she stretched her bones cracked. "Damn my back hurts."

"Oh you're just fine. Here let me help you." Castaspella replied and helped to straighten Shadow Weaver's back. "Feel any better?"

"Much so.. thanks.. I guess."

"Come on, let's get going. I'm sure Catra would be more than happy to see you."

Meanwhile, back at Mystacor, Micah had begun to worry where Castaspella had gone. She normally didn't leave without saying anything and she rarely spent her night away.

"Father, I think you're worrying without a reason." Glimmer said as she watched Micah walk around circles, a worried look on her face.

"But what if something has attacked her? Maybe kidnapped? Even in Mystacor, people have no clue where she is."

"She's an adult, quite capable at that as well. As am I and so are you. I don't think there's anything to worry about." Glimmer tried to calm him.

"I guess you are right." Micah said, calming down a bit. "Maybe I'm worrying for nothing.."

"That's better, I'm sure Castaspella comes back fairly soon." Glimmer said.

Then Adora and Catra arrived in the room. "Is something wrong, King Micah?" Adora asked.

"Ex-king." Micah pointed out. "I was just a bit worried about Castaspella."

"Oh, I know where she probably is." Catra said. "She's still waiting for Shadow Weaver and she had gone to the place where they saw each other last time."

"Catra.. it's been five years.. I'm pretty sure she's not coming back and what makes you think she would even want to come back?" Glimmer said, in which Catra replied with a distained hiss.

"How do you know where she had gone?" Micah asked, ignoring the friction that was growing between the two.

"Because she told me, she's been doing it for quite a while.. As much as I wish she would come back, I don't think she will. So I'm fairly sure Castaspella will come back soon." Catra explained.

"Well.. she never told me anything like that. Though she has expressed a lot of grief, there's so much I can do about it." Micah said and let out a sigh.

"You have done everything you could. Rest is up to her." Catra assured Micah.

"Wow, you've become quite a professional." Adora said, nudging at Catra.

"Professional? About what? All I do is share my opinions."

"Well at least you aren't as brash as you used to be." Adora said.

"Well that's thanks to you.."

"Anyways, I'm sorry I bothered you all." Micah apologized. "Please, carry on what you were doing."

Then Micah went outside at the main gate of Brightmoon, looking from over the bridge to Whispering Woods. Now that he was no longer a king, he spent his time mostly helping around Mystacor and Brightmoon.

But other than that his life had become dull and uneventful, he also missed Angella. Entrapta had been looking into possibilities and theories about portals and alternate dimensions, but they had mostly ended in a deadend.

When he was about to leave, he glanced one last time at the edge of the forest and saw movement. It didn't take him long before he could recognize Castaspella and she was followed by another person.

He was beyond happy to see his sister safe, he rushed to meet them and it truly was a surprise when he recognized the woman with Castaspella.

"Sister, you're back." He exclaimed happily. "And you're okay."

"Of course I'm okay, I'm your sister." Castaspella replied and two of them hugged.

"Micah.." Shadow Weaver's voice called.

As Micah was done hugging Castaspella, he looked at the other woman. "Shadow Weaver.." He looked puzzled seeing her. "It's been like five years.."

"Yeah, your sister said something along those lines as well." Shadow Weaver replied. "Glad to see that you're doing well."

"Same here.. though I have several questions." Micah said.

"Your sister said the same.." Shadow Weaver replied.

"I see.."

"Yes she pestered me the whole time we were walking here."

"Well, you owe that much and you'll owe the same to Catra. Speaking of her, do you know where she is?" Castaspella said.

"She's at Brightmoon right now, kind of funny to think about.. but were thinking of you.. or mostly me just being worried." Micah said with and embarrassed tone.

"I'm so happy that you cared, but rest assured I can handle anything." Castaspella said, boasting.

"Except me." Shadow Weaver commented with a smirk on her face, making Castaspela blush.

"Erhm.. almost anything." She corrected and nudged Shadow Weaver with her elbow.

"I don't think I should stick my nose into your business.." Micah replied offhandedly.

They walked back to the grand garden of Brightmoon, where Catra and Adora were enjoying each other's company. Catra could hear multiple footsteps coming to their way. Her ears twitched and she stood up.

"Something matters, love?" Adora asked.

"No.. but I smell something really familiar." Catra replied and walked towards the sound. She saw Castaspella, Micah and unbelievably.. Shadow Weaver. She didn't know what to think about, was this real? She was probably even more confused than Castaseplla was.

Her nose didn't lie and her eyes didn't deceive her, it was clearly Shadow Weaver. Adora came behind her and was as surprised. "Wow.. didn't think that was possible.."

Catra then ran towards Shadow Weaver as tears streamed from her eyes.

"Oh, hey. There's someone wanting to meet you." Castaspella tapped on Shadow Weaver's shoulder.

"Catra.." Shadow Weaver managed to say, she was almost ready to cry herself, but withhold her tears.

"Shadow Weaver!" Catra yelled as she was running towards her.

Shadow Weaver turned towards Catra and she was embracing for a hug.

After five years, they finally met again. Catra buried her head into Shadow Weaver's robes and she embraced Catra in a tight hug.

"You're back!" Catra's muffled voice said.

"Yes, I am back and I'm proud to see that you have grown up to be such a fine woman." Shadow Weaver said with a gentle voice. This was a rare moment for Castaspella to see the soft side of Shadow Weaver.

"Please, promise me you won't ever do something like that again." Catra cried.

"I promise." She replied with a soothing voice and pat Catra's hair. "I'll be here for you and I won't leave you."

" *Ugh, this is so lame and corny! Please deliver me to Entrpata asap!* " Spell of Obtainment wailed, but its complaining were ignored.. as always.

The End

Chapter End Notes

I thank everyone who had made into the end, it took well over 2 years to finish this story. I hope you have enjoyed and if you have any questions.. feel free to ask.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!